HEMSHECH SAMECH-VAV

A Translation and adaptation
into English of

The continuum of Chassidic Discourses

Famously known as

Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah 5666

Volume 1

By

Our Master and Teacher
The Holy and Godly Tzaddik

Rabbi Sholom Dovber Schneerson

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Forward

The words[1] of our Rebbe's, our leaders, about the wondrousness and greatness of the series of discourses (*Hemshech*) known as "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah* – 5666" of his honorable holiness, the Rebbe Rashab, are well known. In it, he explains the primary foundations of the teachings of Chassidus. Amongst its many qualities is that it stands as a clear testament to the expansiveness and breadth of the teachings of Chassidus.[2] Similarly, all the qualities by which the discourses of his honorable holiness, the Rebbe Rashab, are praised, (namely, that in them the matters within the teachings of Chassidus are explained with greater expansiveness, and with a greater degree of intellectual understanding and grasp), are present with especially great measure in this series of discourses (*Hemshech*).[3] Now that we are in the 120th year (5666 – 5786) since it was first brought forth into the world, it is thus an auspicious and propitious time[4] to publish it for the first time in English translation, making these wellsprings available to the public.[5]

This translation is based on the fifth printing of the revised edition (preceded by six printings of the first edition) published by Kehot Publication Society in the year 5778 (2018). The incredible attention to detail and accuracy demonstrated in the research, annotation, indexing, typesetting, printing and publishing,

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[1] See the preface ("*Petach Davar*") of *Hemshech* 5666 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 3 [5778 edition]).

[2] See the Sichah talk of Simchat Torah 5690, Ch. 17 (Likkutei Dibburim Vol. 2, p. 300a; *Hemshech* 5666 p. 746 [5778 edition]).

[3] Sichah talk of Acharon Shel Pesach 5730 (printed in Likkutei Sichot Vol. 7 p. 206; *Hemshech* 5666 p. 749 [5778 edition]).

[4] See the discourse entitled "*Vayihiyu Chayei Sarah*" 5741, Ch. 9 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5741, p. 78).

[5] See the famous letter of the Baal Shem Tov, printed in Keter Shem Tov 1, and translated at the beginning of The Way of The Baal Shem Tov, at translation of Tzavaat HaRivash.

required unfathomable toil and exertion with literal self-sacrifice and utter devotion by the teams of dedicated individuals, and Kehot Publication Society. Moreover, the Chassidic Discourses presented in this series (*Hemshech*) represent but a small portion of the full corpus of the teachings of his honorable holiness, the Rebbe Rashab, let alone the seven oceans of Chabad Chassidism that literally can fill an entire library, most of which were painstakingly published from manuscript for the benefit of Klal Yisroel by these same individuals.

Truly, words cannot possibly capture or express our great depth of gratitude, both personally and of the Jewish people collectively, to these teams of devoted Chassidim, for their preservation, publication, and dissemination of these holy teachings, which are the very lifeblood of Chassidism and Torah True Judaism.

We therefore stand with complete awe and humility before them, in that all our efforts in adapting these works into English utterly pale in comparison to the efforts of those who preceded us with the original publications, to which any translation can never do full justice. It is our sincere prayer and supplication before *HaShem*, blessed is He and blessed is His Name, that their merit should stand in good stead on behalf of the Jewish people and the entire world, and usher in the time of complete peace and tranquility with the true and complete redemption, when "the earth shall be filled with the knowledge of *HaShem* as the waters cover the ocean floor."

3rd of Tammuz, 5786

ג' תמוז שנת **תשפ"ו**, שנת **פקוד"י יהו"ה ישרי"ם** משמחי לב

The Translators

Warning

The Holy Torah, the living words of the Living God, commands us,[6] "You shall not desecrate My Holy Name." In explaining the true unity and service of *HaShem*, blessed is He, this book necessarily and unavoidably makes use of His Holy Name. It therefore is holy and sacred and great care should be taken not to desecrate it in any way, shape or form.[7]

Now that we have entered the era of the true and complete redemption, it is our mitzvah and obligation to learn and disseminate the teachings of the knowledge of *HaShem*,[8] "So that all the peoples of the earth may know that *HaShem*, He is God, there is none else." Nevertheless, it behooves us to do so with the utmost reverence and care to sanctify His Great and Awesome Name. Therefore, wherever His Divine names are found in this book we have placed quotation marks between the letters, thus assuring that they are not the actual Divine names themselves.

In addition, it should be noted that the ineffable name of *HaShem* **is not to be pronounced** whatsoever. This is as stated in the prophecy of Amos,[9] "He shall say: 'Silence-הס, for we must not (orally) make mention with the Name *HaShem*!'"[10] Rather, one must

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[6] Leviticus 22:32

[7] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 115a

[8] Kings I 8:60

[9] Amos 6:10

[10] That is, it forbidden to orally mention His Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה. Therefore, when we pray or read the Torah, we must be silent-הס-65, by saying His title Lord-*Adonay*-אדנ"י-65 instead. However, since His title Lord-*Adonay* is also holy, therefore, in regular conversation, we say *HaShem*, which means "The Name." See

toil only to **know** *HaShem* and thereby know His Name, as stated,[11] "For he has loved Me, therefore I shall deliver him; I will set him on high, because he knows My Name." The verse specifies, "because he ***knows*** My Name," and not because, "he says My Name," or because, "he uses My Name." As known, the Ten Commandments warn us, that the only sin *HaShem* does not forgive, is the sin of bearing His Holy Name in vain.[12] It is thus of critical importance that we alert you to this.

Therefore, because the focus of this book is solely on the unity and service of *HaShem*, blessed is He, great care must be taken to treat it with the utmost respect. Be aware that it should not be defaced, destroyed or taken into any impure place, such as the toilet or bathroom.

If, for whatever reason, you need to dispose of this book, do not discard it in the trash. Instead, drop it off at your local Orthodox Jewish Synagogue, where it can be enjoyed by someone who will appreciate its value (or, if it is tattered beyond repair from much use, will be respectfully disposed of, according to the manner prescribed by Torah law.)

On the other hand, whosoever studies this work and contemplates its great depth, is assured abundant blessings from *HaShem,* blessed is He and blessed is His Name. This is as stated,[13] "Whosoever lengthens their contemplation of His Oneness shall be rewarded with length of days and years."

It is our sincere hope and prayer that our humble offering will find favor before *HaShem*, blessed is He, and that the dissemination of these teachings will be the final act that ushers in the true and

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Ginat Egoz by Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated under the title HaShem is One, Vol. 1.

[11] Psalms 91:14

[12] Exodus 20:6

[13] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 13b

complete redemption. May we fully realize the time,[14] "When there will be neither famine nor war, envy nor competition, for goodness will flow in abundance and all delights will be as freely available as dust. The occupation of the **entire** world will be solely to know *HaShem*. Therefore, the Jews will be great sages[15] and know the hidden matters, grasping the knowledge of their Creator according to the full extent of human potential, as Isaiah (11:9) states, 'The earth shall be filled with the knowledge of *HaShem* as the waters cover the ocean floor.'"

The Translators

[14] Mishneh Torah, Melachim u'Milchamot 12:5

[15] Who will teach the entire world about *HaShem,* for all the nations will be thirsty for this knowledge and will greatly desire it.

Discourse 1

"*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah… -*
When the holiday of Rosh HaShanah…"

Delivered on the 2nd night of Rosh HaShanah, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

It states in Mishnah,[2] "When the holiday of Rosh HaShanah fell out on Shabbat, they would sound the Shofar in the Temple, but not in the [rest of the] country." The Talmud[3] explains[4] that this is due to a rabbinic decree of Rabbah. For Rabbah stated, "Everyone is obligated in the blowing of the shofar, but not everyone is expert in blowing the shofar, so one

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[1] Part of the discourse is founded upon the discourse entitled "*Zachor Et Yom HaShabbat*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5569 p. 165 and on, as is cited in later notes. Some matters discussed in this discourse are further explained in the discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" 5684 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 p. 83 and on); Discourse entitled "*Tikoo BaChodesh*" 5691 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 p. 6 and on); Discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" 5692 & 5710 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5692 p. 1 and on; 5710 p. 3 and on); Discourse entitled "*Tikoo BaChodesh*" 5698 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5698 p. 15 and on); Discourse entitled "*Shofar Shel Rosh HaShanah*" 5699 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5699 p. 1 and on); 5702 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5702 p. 3 and on); Discourses entitled "*LeMa'an Yeidu*" and "*Shokav Amudei Sheish*" 5702 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5702 p. 27 and on; p. 31 and on); Discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5731 (Torat Menachem Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 352 and on [in earlier editions, Vol. 5 p. 151 and on] translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5731, Discourse 16); Discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah* 5735 (translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5735, Discourse 45).

[2] Mishnah Rosh HaShanah 4:1; Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 29b

[3] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 29b ibid.

[4] Regarding the coming section, see Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 56a; Siddur Im Da"Ch 240c and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 1; 5665 p. 1; 5672-5676 p. 1; Sefer HaMaamarim 5692 & 5710 ibid.; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 17; p. 51 (in earlier editions, Vol. 1 p. 421; Vol. 3 p. 293); Likkutei Sichot Vol. 7 p. 51 and on; Sefer HaSichot 5749 Vol. 2 p. 703 and on.

might come to carry his shofar to an expert in order to learn and would thus be transgressing the prohibition of carrying four cubits in a public place."

Now, at first glance this is not understood.[5] How is it that our sages, of blessed memory, saw fit to uproot a positive Torah commandment based on a decree of mere concern? Moreover,[6] the concern for transgression only applies to unlearned folk and those of weak attention.[7] Why then did they bar great sages and righteous *Tzaddikim* from fulfilling this positive commandment?

The question is further magnified when we consider the great importance of the *mitzvah* of shofar, which is a very lofty *mitzvah*.[8] For, as known,[9] all the commandments of the month of Tishrei are general commandments [that affect the entire year]. This accords with the statement in Midrash Rabbah[10]

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[5] See Likkutei Torah ibid.

[6] See Likkutei Sichot Vol. 7 ibid. p. 52, note 25; Vol. 39 p. 193, note 46.

[7] Those who are not knowledgeable in the laws of Shabbat, and those who although they are knowledgeable, may forget and carry in a public place. (Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 ibid. p. 17 note 7.)

[8] Similarly see Sefer HaMaamarim 5659; 5672-5676, and Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid., and elsewhere. Also note Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah ibid. states, "especially the *mitzvot* of Shofar and Lulav etc., which reach the highest of heights." In the discourse entitled "*Tikoo*" 5691 ibid. it states, "the *mitzvah* of Shofar is an extremely lofty and exalted *mitzvah*, since the substance matter of the *mitzvah* of Shofar is the matter of repentance (*Teshuvah*). [Also note that this language "a very lofty *mitzvah*" is utilized regarding the *mitzvah* of repentance (which is the substance matter of the *mitzvah* of the Shofar as will later be explained), in Ohr HaTorah Bechukotai (Vol. 2) p. 643; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 254; 5633 p. 121; p. 123, and elsewhere.]

[9] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5566 Vol. 2 p. 748; 5569 p. 286; Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Chag HaSukkot p. 1,756; Zot HaBrachah p. 1,866; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 2 p. 589; 5654 p. 36; 5656 p. 277 and on; p. 413 and elsewhere.

[10] Midrash Vayikra Rabbah 29:8; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 20 p. 555 in the note.

about the verse,[11] "In the seventh-*Shevee'ee*-שביעי month," that it is called thus because "it is sated-*Musba*-מושבע in everything," being that this month contains many *mitzvot*.

Additionally, the *mitzvot* of Tishrei differ from the commandments of the rest of the year, in that they are general *mitzvot*. This is specifically so of the *mitzvah* of shofar, which arouses and draws down influence from the innerness of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He.

Now, as known,[12] the inner spiritual intent of the commandment of shofar is the matter of repentance - *Teshuvah*. This is reflected by the first blast of the shofar which is like a simple cry and is akin to the awakening and arousal of the inner essence of the soul, which comes into revelation specifically as a simple cry. For, there is another aspect of arousal of the innerness of the soul in the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, with the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) which specifically is quiet, like the service of the priests (*Kohanim*), as it states,[13] "The *Kohen* serves with the desire of the heart," referring to quiet arousal etc., as known.[14] However, in our case, it specifically is with the cry of the voice, referring to the

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[11] Numbers 29:1

[12] See Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Teshuvah 3:4 (cited later in the discourse itself); Shnei Luchot HaBrit, Mesechet Rosh HaShanah, Torah Ohr (216a); Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah p. 1,378; [Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5692; 5710; 5699 & 5702 cited in the endnotes].

[13] See Zohar III 39a; 88b; 177b (as noted by the Rebbe in the discourse by this title in Sefer HaMaamarim 5710 ibid. cited in the endnotes.)

[14] Likkutei Torah, Ve'Etchanan 8b; Drushim L'Chag HaSukkot 80a; Siddur Im Da"Ch 268b; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 133a and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek Vol. 1 p. 102; 114 and on; Vol. 2 p. 682 and on; p. 688 and on; Ohr HaTorah Vayeitzei p. 177b; 188b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 22 and on.

matter of repentance. Both are aspects of arousal of the innerness of the soul but differ in their substance.[15]

In the "desire of the heart" the arousal comes through closeness, in that one senses and is aware of the limitless light of the Unlimited One felt in his soul. This comes through contemplating the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, and how totally wondrous it is, in that it transcends all worlds and cannot be revealed in his soul. (This is because his soul is not a receptacle for the radiance of such light to be openly revealed within it.) Because of this, a great yearning is aroused in him to "run" and become included in *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light, as will be explained later.[16] The essential matter of this "running" (*Ratzo*) is the matter of closeness and the desire to become absorbed and subsumed [in His Godliness] etc.[17]

In contrast, this is not so of repentance (*Teshuvah*), which does not come from a sense of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in one's soul. Rather, it specifically is aroused because of one's distance from *HaShem*-יהו"ה. That is, he is greatly pained by the fact that he has become distant.[18]

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[15] With respect to the difference between the service of Him with "the desires of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) and repentance (*Teshuvah*) – see the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 1-3 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 725 and on).

[16] This will be explained further on in the series, in the discourse entitled, "*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 20).

[17] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 4 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 733).

[18] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 5 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 733).

Now, here too, *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness is sensed, but in the way expressed in the verse,[19] "It is an evil and bitter thing that you have left *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God." However, one does not sense the greatness and wondrousness of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, nor is this what arouses his soul. Rather, he only is touched to the very core of his heart by his great distance, and this is what causes his arousal.

Now, here too, there is an aspect of drawing towards and "running" (*Ratzo*) to *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness, however, it differs from the closeness mentioned above, in that it is not a desire to become absorbed and subsumed in *HaShem's*-יהו"ה transcendent Oneness. Rather, it is solely the desire to be close to His Godliness, or rather, to no longer be distant, but close. That is, this only is the matter of giving oneself over to matters of Godliness and fulfilling His will etc.

This is why the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), which is caused by closeness and itself is a matter of closeness,[20] comes in a way of silence. In contrast, repentance, which is specifically caused by distance, specifically comes in way of the simple cry of the voice etc.

Now, there also is a level of repentance that manifests in silence. This is when the matter touches a person to such an inner depth that he has no strength to cry out. This level is called the "cry of the heart," which is higher than the "cry of the voice," and is reflected in the subsequent sounds of the shofar; the sounds of the *Teruah* and *Shevarim*. This also is known as

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[19] Jeremiah 2:19

[20] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 7 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 734).

the "inner unheard voice,"[21] as known and explained elsewhere.[22]

We therefore find that the shofar represents the matter of repentance (*Teshuvah*). This accords with Rambam's statement in Laws of Repentance,[23] as follows, "Although the command to blow the shofar on Rosh HaShanah is a Torah ordinance, it also contains an allusion, as if the shofar is saying, 'Wake up, you sleepy ones, from your sleep and you who slumber, arise. Examine your deeds, repent and remember your Creator. Those who forget the truth in the vanities of the times and throughout the year devote their energies to vanity and emptiness, which does not benefit or save; look to your souls. Improve your ways and your deeds and let every one of you abandon his evil way and thoughts.'"

(It should be noted that here he hints at the three matters of [the verses of] Kingship (*Malchiyot*), Remembrance (*Zichronot*), and shofars (*Shofrot*).[24] That is, the statement "Wake up... inspect your deeds, repent etc.," refers to the matter of Kingship (*Malchiyot*). For, quite simply, sin is the matter of transgressing the command of the King of the world and is a rebellion against His Kingship, Heaven forbid. This is rectified by accepting the yoke of His Kingship and giving oneself over

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[21] Zohar I 50b; 210a; (Also see the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 8, printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 734.)

[22] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 231d and on; Ateret Rosh 19b and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 3 p. 766 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5651 p. 47 and on; 5653 p. 158 and on; 5659 p. 201 and on; 5661 p. 202; 5665 p. 91 and on; 5668 p. 12 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 822 and on; Vol. 3 p. 1,244; 5679 p. 15 and on; 5680 p. 75; 5702 p. 5.

[23] Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Teshuvah 3:4

[24] See Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 16a

to *HaShem*-יהו"ה and the fulfillment of His blessed will. This is the matter of the repentance of Rosh HaShanah; that one regrets and is embittered over having caused his soul to become so distant from *HaShem*-יהו"ה and returns to Him with all his heart. He invests himself totally to be *HaShem*'s-יהו"ה servant alone and dedicates himself to fulfill His blessed will.

Furthermore, as known,[25] primarily, the matter of repentance is specifically in regard to fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which is imperative to serving Him like a servant, and it specifically is in regard to it that it applies to plead for forgiveness, as explained in the Chassidic discourse entitled "*Ki Eemcha HaSelichah*" of the year 5634.[26]

Moreover, there is an essential difference between accepting the yoke of Heaven on Rosh HaShanah compared to accepting the yoke during the rest of the year. During the rest of the year, the acceptance is only external acceptance of the yoke of Heaven [as it relates to action], which is below and external to the inner powers of one's soul. In contrast, accepting the yoke of Heaven on Rosh HaShanah is from the innerness of the essential self of the soul,[27] as explained elsewhere,[28] and is like the matter of repentance (*Teshuvah*) etc.

The second part of the statement, "remember your Creator..." refers to the matter of [the verses of] Remembrance

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[25] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 1 p. 277 and on; Vol. 2 p. 547 and on; Kitzurim v'Ha'arot L'Tanya p. 41 and on; p. 174 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5699 p. 8 and on.

[26] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5634 p. 325 and on; p. 332 and on.

[27] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 9 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 735).

[28] See *Sefer HaMaamarim* 5651, p. 8 and on, p. 16 and on; 5656 p. 244 and on; 5660 p. 23 and on; 5662 p. 225 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1, p. 144 and on.

(*Zichronot*), in that spiritually, remembrance is that a person always remembers and is aware of *HaShem*-יהו"ה presence, without forgetting this reality etc.[29]

(Now, it should be mentioned that accepting the yoke of Heaven is not a matter of comprehension or any specific feeling, but is only the matter of investing and giving oneself over to *HaShem*-יהו"ה. In contrast, [the matter of the verses of] Remembrance (*Zichronot*) involves knowing *HaShem*-יהו"ה, as in the aspect of,[30] "The truth of *HaShem*-יהו"ה endures forever." That is, he comprehends that *HaShem*-יהו"ה and God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם are entirely one,[31] and the like. This is like the matter of "guarding-*Shamor*" [oneself against the negative prohibitive *mitzvot*], which corresponds to the feminine (*Nukva*) aspect, whereas "remembering-*Zachor*" corresponds to the masculine (*Duchra*) aspect.[32])

The words, "Look to your souls, improve your ways etc.," refer to the matter of [the verses regarding] shofar (*Shofrot*), in that it discusses the giving of the Torah, which was accompanied by the sound of the shofar,[33] for it was then that

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[29] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 10 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 735).

[30] Psalms 117:2

[31] See Zohar I 12b; Zohar II 26b; 161a; Zohar III, 264a.

[32] Zohar I 48b; 265b (Hashmatot); Zohar II 92a; Zohar III 92b; 224a, explained in Torah Ohr Yitro 70c; 71c and on; 73b; as well as later in the continuum in "*Hashlamat HaDrush*" (p. 709, p. 710, p. 717). [In other words, guarding (*Shamor*) oneself against the transgression of negative commandments relates to the acceptance of the yoke of Heaven, and is therefore related to the feminine aspect (*Nukva*), in that she "does not have anything of her own" but is the recipient. That is, accepting the yoke of Heaven does not require knowledge or grasp of Godliness as a prerequisite. In contrast, remembrance (*Zachor*), relates to the masculine aspect (*Duchra*), in that it requires the acquisition of knowledge and grasp of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה truth.]

[33] Exodus 19:16, 19:20, 20:15

they took on the commitment to fulfill *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Torah and *mitzvot* etc.)

This then, is the general matter of the *mitzvah* of shofar, which is the *mitzvah* of repentance that transcends all other *mitzvot*.[34] More specifically, the drawing down of all influence that takes place on Rosh HaShanah is by means of the shofar. As known,[35] Rosh HaShanah is the matter of building the Sefirah of Kingship-*Malchut* and it is then that the aspect of the Crown of Kingship-*Keter Malchut* is drawn down. As stated in Pri Etz Chayim,[36] this is why it is called *Rosh HaShanah* - the "head-*Rosh*-ראש" of the year, because the Crown of Kingship-*Keter Malchut* is drawn down.

Now, as known,[37] the matter of the Crown of Kingship-*Keter Malchut* is the matter of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה desire (*Ratzon*) for kingship, the root of which is very lofty, in the aspect of the inner Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. This accords with the statement,[38] "This day is the beginning of Your works, a remembrance of the first day."

Just as on the very first day, at the beginning of creation, the arousal of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה desire for kingship and for worlds was of His own accord, as in the statement,[39] "In the beginning

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[34] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5672-5676 p. 1 and on; 5689 p. 4 and on; 5691 p. 9 and on; p. 15 and on; 5706 p. 3 and on.

[35] Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Rosh HaShanah, Ch. 1 and on; Shaar HaKavanot, Kavanot Rosh HaShanah, and elsewhere.

[36] Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Rosh HaShanah, Ch. 1-2

[37] Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 56c; Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 241c; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,216 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 18; 5706 p. 14; Discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5717, (Sefer HaMaamarim 5717, p. 5 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5717, Vol. 1, Discourse 1)

[38] See the Musaf liturgy of Rosh HaShanah (from Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 27a).

[39] Zohar I 15a

of the rule of the King etc.," which refers to the arousal in the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One before the constriction-*Tzimtzum*.[40] In the same way, on each and every Rosh HaShanah[41] everything reverts to its original state.[42]

It therefore is necessary to rouse the desire for kingship in the Inner Essential Self of the Unlimited One, blessed is He.[43] This is accomplished though the shofar, as it states,[44] "On Rosh HaShanah recite verses of kingship (*Malchiyot*) before Me, in order to make Me king over you, say verses of remembrance (*Zichronot*), so that the remembrance of you will rise up before Me for good. And how will all this be accomplished? Through the shofar." That is, through the cry of the simple voice of the shofar from the depths of the heart we arouse and draw down the aspect of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה desire for kingship etc.

This being so, why did our sages, of blessed memory, abolish this commandment when Rosh HaShanah falls out on Shabbat? How then are we to draw down the influence of Rosh HaShanah? Moreover, although we still recite the verses relating to shofar even when Rosh HaShanah falls out on Shabbat, nevertheless, the commandment of shofar and the service of the inner cry, is specifically accomplished through the blast of the shofar etc.

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[40] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 10.

[41] See Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Rosh HaShanah ibid. Ch. 1; Likkutei Torah, Nitzavim 51b, and elsewhere.

[42] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 11 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 735).

[43] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 12 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 735).

[44] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 16a; 34b

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Now, to understand this, we must first understand the above-mentioned statement of our sages, of blessed memory,[45] "On Rosh HaShanah recite verses of kingship (*Malchiyot*) before Me, in order to make Me king over you, say verses of remembrance (*Zichronot*), so that the remembrance of you will rise up before Me for good. And how will all this be accomplished? Through the shofar."

Now, at first glance, the word remembrance indicates recollecting something that until now was not in one's mind. However, how is this applicable Above in *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness, being that it states,[46] "You bring life to all," that is, He gives vitality to all of creation and brings everything into being from nothing to something at every moment.[47] He therefore knows and supervises all creatures,[48] "from the horns of the buffalo [to the eggs of lice] etc." If God forbid, they would not be in His mind, blessed is He, they could have no existence or vitality altogether. Rather, He knows and supervises everything.

Moreover, even the aspect of supervision that relates to His upper knowledge (*Da'at Elyon*), which does not come out in a way of investment (*Hitlabshut*) [within the worlds] but remains transcendent (*Makif*), is nevertheless still called

[45] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 16a; 34b

[46] Nehemiah 9:6

[47] See Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 1 and on (76b and on).

[48] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 107b; Avoda Zara 3b

"knowledge" and is like the statement,[49] "Everything is openly revealed and known before Him." This Godly knowledge is the primary force that gives vitality to the worlds,[50] as stated in Tanya at the end of chapter forty-eight.[51] This certainly is the case with regard to His lower knowledge (*Da'at Tachton*), which actually comes to be vested in the worlds, as explained elsewhere.[52] This being so, how is it applicable to use the term "remembrance" in relation to *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness Above?

We also must understand the order of these three matters, [the verses of] kingship (*Malchiyot*), remembrances (*Zichronot*), and shofars (*Shofrot*),[53] in that we say the verses of remembrances after saying the verses of kingship. Now, at first glance, it would seem more appropriate to say the verses of remembrances first and only then to say verses of kingship, because once the aspect of kingship has been drawn down, it no longer is applicable to think that the king would forget His nation, that the matter of remembrance should be relevant. This being so, after having said the verses of kingship, by which the statement, "so that you make Me king over you" is

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[49] See Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 13b; Kiddushin 30b; Sanhedrin 76b; Chulin 63b, and elsewhere; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 18 p. 197 note 11.

[50] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 13 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 735 and on).

[51] Tanya, Ch. 48 (68b)

[52] See Torah Ohr, Vayera 14d and on (in the note); Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken Parshiyot Vol. 1 p. 106 and on; Derech Mitzvotecha 81b and on (in the note); Sefer HaMaamarim 5643 p. 123 and on; 5663 Vol. 1 p. 34; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 18 ibid. p. 197 and on.

[53] See Ra"N to Rosh HaShanah 34b ("*Tanu Rabbanan*"); Magen Avraham to Orach Chayim, Hilchot Rosh HaShanah 593 S"K 4; Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe 493:2

accomplished, of what relevance is it to then say verses of remembrance?

Another matter that must be understood is why the verses of shofar are only said at the end. At first glance, we would think that these verses should be said first, since after all, both kingship and remembrance depend on the shofar.[54] Therefore, it makes sense to begin with the verses of shofar.

Although it indeed is true that the actual blowing of the shofar precedes the blessings of kingship and remembrance, nevertheless, at first glance, it seems fitting to also say the verses of shofar before the verses of kingship and remembrance, because of the simple fact that, as stated above, the influence of kingship and remembrance are specifically drawn only by means of the shofar.

However, since this is not the order, it must be said that the verses of shofar following the verses of kingship and remembrance serve an additional purpose besides drawing down His kingship etc., since this was already accomplished through blowing the shofar. We therefore must understand the meaning of blowing the shofar before [reciting] the verses of kingship and remembrance and how it differs from the verses of shofar that follow the verses of kingship and remembrance.

(Additionally, although when Rosh HaShanah falls out on Shabbat, we do not blow the shofar, we must understand why we nevertheless still say the verses of shofar after saying the verses of kingship etc. Furthermore, according to the above clarification that the drawing down of kingship and remembrance specifically depend on first blowing the shofar,

[54] See Likkutei Sichot, Vol. 4, p. 1146, note 17.

the above question is magnified. That is, how can we draw this influence down when Rosh HaShanah falls out on Shabbat?)

Now, the Talmud[55] derives the shofar blasts that accompany the verses of kingship, remembrances and shofars, from the two verses about blowing the shofar that relate to Rosh HaShanah,[56] and from the single verse that relates to Yom Kippur, as it states,[57] "And you shall make a proclamation with the blast of a horn on the tenth day of the seventh month." We therefore must understand why two verses were said regarding Rosh HaShanah and one verse was said regarding Yom Kippur. We must also understand which [of these] verses relate to kingship and remembrance, and which one relates to shofar.[58]

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Now,[59] to understand all the above, we must preface with the following explanation.[60] As known, the ultimate purpose in creating and bringing the worlds into existence, and the ultimate intent in the descent of the soul into the body, is to draw down the revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, into the worlds through fulfilling Torah and

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[55] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShana 34a

[56] Leviticus 23:24 ["In the seventh month, on the first day of the month... a memorial proclaimed with the blast of a horn"], and Numbers 29:1 ["And in the seventh month, on the first day of the month... it is a day of blowing the horn for you."]

[57] Leviticus 25:9

[58] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 14 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 737).

[59] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 100; 5684 & 5702 ibid.

[60] The conclusion of the matter is discussed later in the discourses entitled "*Eem Bechukotai*" 5667 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 586) and "*Kodesh Yisroel*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 671 and on).

mitzvot. This is the matter of unifying the limitless light of the Unlimited One, Who transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*) with how He fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*).[61]

This is like the statement made[62] before fulfilling every *mitzvah*,[63] "This is with the intent of unifying the Holy One blessed is He and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*)."[64] That is, it is the unification of the light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*) with His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*),[65] which is the matter of the revelation of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. For, this is the entire purpose and intention in the creation of the worlds and the descent of the soul, as stated,[66] "The Holy One, blessed is He, desired to have a dwelling place in the lower worlds." This is analogous[67] to one's home, in that

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[61] See the introduction to Imrei Binah, translated as The Gateway to Understanding ibid.

[62] Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaZmirot Ch. 5; Sefer HaLikutim, Parshat Re'eh; Shaar Ruach HaKodesh (12b, Yerushalayim 5672); Kiseh Melech to the introduction of Tikkunei Zohar, section beginning "*v'Ee Teimrun*"; Shaar HaKollel Ch. 6, S"K 2 (from the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5702 cited in the first endnote; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket 4 p. 245 (in earlier editions, Vol. 2 p. 82).

[63] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 198; 5679 p. 518; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid.; Sefer HaSichot 5752 Vol. 2 p. 454.

[64] See Likkutei Torah, Va'etchanan in the discourse entitled "*v'Zot HaMitzvah*" [9a]; Drushei Rosh HaShanah, (second) discourse entitled "*Tikoo*" Ch. 2 [55c] (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5710 cited in the endnotes.)

[65] See Tanya, Ch. 41 (57b; 58a); Also see Likkutei Torah cited in the preceding note (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5710 cited in the endnotes.)

[66] Midrash Tanchuma Bechukotai 3, Naso 16; Bereshit Rabbah, Ch. 3; Bamidbar Rabba, Ch. 13; Tanya Ch. 36 (45b).

[67] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 489; Ohr HaTorah Balak, p. 997; Shir HaShirim (Vol. 2) p. 638 and on; 5670; 5679 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 2 p. 353; 5662 p. 335; 5669 p. 160; 5678 p. 193; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 256 (and in earlier editions, Vol. 1 p. 207); Discourse entitled "*v'Atah Yigdal Na*" 5720 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5720 p. 164 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5720, Discourse 22).

one's entire self dwells in his home. Similarly, *HaShem's*-יהו"ה desire is for the Essential Self of His Unlimited Light to be revealed below, as it were.

This is as stated at the beginning of *Emek HaMelech*,[68] that the creation of the worlds was brought about by means of the first restraint-*Tzimtzum* in the Limitless Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) and there remained a void (*Chalal*) and empty space (*Makom Panuy*),[69] and it is from this that there was a root for the existence of vessels (*Keilim*) and all the worlds etc.[70]

After the restraint-*Tzimtzum*, the revelation of a Line (*Kav*) was drawn down, which is the aspect of a revelation of [limited] light[71] that illuminates the vessels (*Keilim*) and the worlds etc. (It is through this that actual creation was brought about. For as known, the existence of the vessels (*Keilim*) and the existence of the worlds in general, is by means of the Line-*Kav* with the power of the Impression-*Reshimu*, which is like a heyulie power, as explained elsewhere.[72]) Now, all the worlds and their lights (*Orot*) and vessels (*Keilim*) are contained within this void (*Challal*) and empty space (*Makom Panuy*) that remained after the first restraint-*Tzimtzum*.

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[68] Emek HaMelech, Shaar Shaashuey HaMelech, Ch. 1

[69] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher) Anaf 2

[70] Etz Chayim ibid. Anaf 3

[71] [That is, a limited ray of light that is according to the capacity of the vessels (recipients) and worlds. This is as opposed to the Infinite Light prior to the first *tzimtzum* restraint. See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 14-15.]

[72] See Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 92c-d; Shaarei Orah 84b; Ohr HaTorah, Megillat Esther p. 92 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1 p. 35 and on; 5665 p. 291-292; [Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe Ch. 14-15 ibid.]

However, when the verse states,[73] "He put him in the garden of Eden to work it and to guard it," and as known[74] the word "to work it" (*Le'avdah*-לעבדה) refers to the 248 positive action commandments, whereas the word "to guard it" (*Le'shamrah*-לשמרה) refers to the 365 negative prohibitive commandments, this refers to drawing down additional light through the Line-*Kav* from the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that preceded the restraint-*Tzimtzum*, until ultimately, there will be a full revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) within the void, just as it was before the restraint-*Tzimtzum* etc.

Now at first glance, it is not understood what the novelty in this is. For did not the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) already fill the void before the first restraint-*Tzimtzum*? Rather, the simple explanation is that when the Unlimited Light filled the void before the creation of the worlds, the existence of worlds was not possible. Therefore, this revelation was not within worlds. However, once the worlds were brought into being and the Unlimited Light, which preceded the restraint-*Tzimtzum* is drawn down into revelation, now the revelation is within the worlds.

Moreover, although it is true that before their existence, when there was a revelation of the light that preceded the

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[73] Genesis 2:15; In the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha*" 5736 (translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736, Discourse 1, Ch. 4) the Rebbe adds, "The same is so presently (after 'He banished him etc.'), in that the only difference is in the place of the work, but even now, additional light is caused in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) through our work in fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*."

[74] Yalkut Reuveni to Genesis 2:15; Zohar I 27a; Zohar II 165b; Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 21 (62a); Tikkun 55 (85b) (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5710 ibid. 5702 ibid.)

restraint-*Tzimtzum*, they could not exist, nevertheless, after having been brought into being, they also became capable of receiving this light. We may say that this is similar to the statement in Etz Chaim[75] about the revelation of the Line-Kav;[76] that if the [light of the] Line-*Kav* had remained as it was at the beginning[77], it would be impossible for the vessels (*Keilim*) to exist, but since they came into being first, then even when the light of the Line-*Kav* radiates in them, they do not become nullified. In general, it is the same way regarding the Unlimited Light that preceded the restraint-*Tzimtzum*, in that after the worlds were brought into being, they also became capable of receiving this light.[78]

The analogy for this[79] is like when a teacher wants to bring down intellectual influence to his student. Were he to reveal the entire depth and inner essence of his wisdom, the student would be incapable of receiving it. He therefore must teach a restrained form of intellectual light, according to the capacity of the student to receive. However, once the student has received this restrained light and it is grasped and absorbed in his mind, he then will arrive at the inner depth and essence of the teacher's mind, since he now has the capacity to receive

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[75] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1, Anaf 3 ibid.; Also see Ohr HaTorah Chanukah (Vol. 5) p. 947a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5626 p. 25; 5629 p. 25; p. 399; 5633 Vol. 1 p. 130; Vol. 2 p. 504; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 28; Sefer HaMaamarim 5678 p. 283; 4679 p. 82 and elsewhere.

[76] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 p. 136 and on.

[77] [That is, if the Line-*Kav* had merely remained as it was rooted in its source before the restraint-*Tzimtzum*, rather than emerging after the complete withdrawal (*Siluk*) of the Unlimited Light. See the citations referenced in footnote 75 ibid.]

[78] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 2 p. 137 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 233 (Vol. 2 p. 232 in earlier editions).

[79] [See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 12-13.]

it. (This is the meaning of the statement,[80] "He will come to grasp the original intent of his teacher after forty years.")

Additionally, this also is due to the improvement of the vessel. In other words, through grasping intellectual light in his brain, the vessel of his brain becomes improved and refined, for as known,[81] if a teacher influences his student over an extended period of time, the sensibilities of the student become refined and similar to those of his teacher.

Through this example it is understood that after the worlds are brought into being and the light of the Line-*Kav* illuminates within them, and as also known,[82] the inner light (*Ohr Pnimee*) refines the inner half of the vessel (*Kli*) and the encompassing light (*Ohr Makif*) refines the outer half of the vessel (*Kli*) etc., they then even become capable of receiving the aspect of the general light that transcends the revelation of the Line-*Kav.*

The primary allowance for this drawing down is through Torah,[83] as written,[84] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה will give strength to His people," about which it states,[85] "There is no strength but Torah." That is, it is through Torah that the righteous

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[80] Talmud Bavli, Avodah Zara 5b; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 49 and on, and elsewhere.

[81] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5655 p. 217; 5700 p. 15; 5708 p. 48; 5709 p. 51; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 15 p. 86; Sefer HaSichot 5748 Vol. 1 p. 240; p. 247; Sefer HaMaamarim 5684; 5692; 5702 cited in the endnotes ibid.

[82] Etz Chaim, Shaar 2, Anaf 3 (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5710 ibid.)

[83] Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 82 ibid.

[84] Psalms 29:11

[85] Midrash Shir HaShirim Rabbah, 1:4, 2:3 (3); Midrash Tehillim to Psalm 8:3; Also see Talmud Bavli, Zevachim 116a; Vayikra Rabbah 35:5; Yalkut Shimoni, Beshalach, Remez 244; Also see the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5687 p. 112.

(*Tzaddikim*) become capable of receiving the aspect of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends the worlds, without their being nullified out of existence. Similarly, it is through this that the worlds in general become capable of receiving this light, as stated in Tanya, at the end of chapter thirty-six.

We therefore find that although the light that is finally revealed, is the very same light that filled the empty space of the void before the restraint-*Tzimtzum*, nevertheless,[86] the novelty is that the revelation is within the worlds themselves.

Moreover, we may even say that there will be a greater revelation of a more supernal light than was previously revealed, and that this is the additional light that is drawn down through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*. This is because they cause the inner Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One to be revealed, which even transcends the light that filled the empty space of the void, as will later be explained.[87]

However, in general, this is the revelation of the aspect of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*), and it is for this ultimate purpose that the worlds were created.

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[86] See Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket 4 p. 192 (Vol. 2 p. 73 in prior editions).

[87] Later in the series, in the discourse entitled "*Kodesh Yisroel*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 671 and on).

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Now,[88] at the beginning of Etz Chaim it states[89] that the reason for the creation of the worlds was to reveal the perfection of His powers, actions, names, and titles. It similarly states in Zohar[90] that the purpose of the creation is "to make Himself known etc." According to these reasons, His intention is for the revelation of the light that fills the worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*) since this is what is meant by His powers and blessed actions. This is because these powers relate to the worlds and are revealed through the existence of the worlds.[91]

Even though, as known, the primary existence of the worlds is from the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends the worlds, as stated,[92] "Whatever *HaShem*-יהו"ה desired, He did," nevertheless, this is only in a concealed way,[93] and although through the existence of the worlds we can know of the existence of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends the worlds, since it is impossible for there to be tangible limited existence except through the

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[88] Regarding the coming section discussing the matter of the reasons for the creation, see what is stated in the name of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch, in Pelach HaRimon Shir HaShirim 38b; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Inyanim p. 95; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Eem Bechukotai*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 566); Sefer HaMaamarim 5672-5676 p. 77; p. 218; 5677 p. 194 and on; Discourse entitled *Bati LeGani* ibid.; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 6 p. 18 and on and the notes there, and elsewhere.

[89] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher) Anaf 1; Also see Shaar HaHakdamot, Hakdamah 3; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 6 p. 18 note 55.

[90] Zohar II 42b

[91] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 15 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 737 and on).

[92] Psalms 135:6

[93] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 16 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 738 and on).

limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends the worlds, as explained elsewhere,[94] nevertheless, this knowledge is not the same as the actual revelation of His transcendence of the worlds (*Sovev*) within the worlds (*Memaleh*).[95]

Additionally, about the statement in Etz Chayim there, that through the creation we can come to know the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which is the matter of "He was and He is and He will be as one-*Hayah v'Hoveh v'Yihiyeh*-היה והוה ויהיה,"[96] meaning that He was before the existence of the worlds, He will be after the existence of the worlds, and He is during the existence of the worlds,[97] even if we were to say that [the Name] *HaShem*-יהו"ה is the aspect of His Unlimited Light that transcends all worlds, nevertheless, the knowledge and awareness of this, cannot yet be described as the aspect of the revelation of how He transcends the worlds (*Sovev*) within how He fills the worlds (*Memaleh*).[98] Rather, the primary revelation that comes about through creation is the revelation of the light that fills and is invested in the worlds (*Memaleh*).

The same is true of the statement in Zohar, that the purpose of creation is "to make Himself known through it."

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[94] See Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 90b and on; 92b and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 4 p. 1,287 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5688 p. 180; 5650 p. 329; 5679 p. 665 and on; 5687 p. 41 and on; 5699 p. 63 and on; 5705 p. 77 and on, and elsewhere.

[95] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 17 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 740 and on).

[96] Zohar III 257b; Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 1 Ch. 9; Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 7 (82a).

[97] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 18 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 740 and on).

[98] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 19 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 740 and on).

Such possible knowledge and grasp of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness is in the aspect of how He fills all worlds (*Memaleh*),[99] as discussed there in Zohar (Parshat Bo, 42b) that this refers to the lights (*Orot*) that become enclothed within vessels (*Keilim*).

Now, although it certainly is so that these above-mentioned intentions are fulfilled through the creation and existence of the worlds, nevertheless it cannot be said that this is the ultimate true intention for creation.[100] For, the statement of Etz Chayim that "He should be perfect in all His actions and powers etc.," means that before the existence of the worlds, these powers were concealed, in that they were only potential. They were not in a state of revelation and therefore were not in a state of total perfection, because something is imperfect if it is only a potential that has not yet been actualized, and it is through the existence of the worlds that they were brought out from potential to actualization and revelation, as it states in Etz Chaim, in the note there.[101]

Now, this reason is not truly applicable Above in Godliness, and only applies in relation to created beings. That is, something that is only in potential (*Koach*) is certainly nothing at all, especially if it altogether is not in any state of actualization (*Po'el*).[102] Only when it is revealed to physically

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[99] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 20 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 740).

[100] See Likkutei Sichot Vol. 20 ibid. p. 284 note 28; Vol. 25 p. 432 note 73; p. 463 note 25.

[101] Etz Chayim, Shklov edition 5542, and elsewhere (cited in the notes and explanations (of Rabbi Menachem Menkhin Halperin of righteous memory) printed in the sides of the page of Etz Chayim Warsaw edition 5751).

[102] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 21 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 741 and on).

actualize something, can it be called actualization (*Po'el*).[103] However, as known, Above in *HaShem's*-ה"והי Godliness, immediately upon the arousal of His desire to create, the worlds were instantly brought into being.[104]

This is like the statement in Pardes Rimonim, (the Gate of Brilliance,[105] chapter three) as follows: "It states,[106] 'His thoughts are not like our thoughts etc.' For when a human being imagines something in his mind, to create it, his thoughts do not actualize it[107] etc. We therefore find that the actualization (*Po'el*) is more perfect than the potential (*Ko'ach*), since potential (*Ko'ach*) lacks existence and has no perfection whatsoever. Rather, actualization (*Po'el*) is primary and is the actual existence of the thing, without which there is nothing. However, this is not so of the actualizations and creations of the King, King of kings, the Holy One blessed is He, because when it arose in His will to create and emanate, the worlds were instantly emanated and took form etc." (This concludes the quote of his words.)

Now, this refers to the ten *sefirot* that are hidden (*Eser Sefirot HaGnuzot*) in He who emanated them, which came into being by the arousal of His desire. As known, and explained

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[103] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 22 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 745).

[104] See Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 17c and on; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5569 p. 183 and on; Derech Mitzvotecha 178a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5634 p. 240; 5639 Vol. 2 p. 454 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayedaber… Bamidbar Sinai*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 304 and on), and elsewhere.

[105] Pardes Rimonim, Shaar HaTzachtzachut (Shaar 11), Ch. 3, cited in Derech Mitzvotecha 58a and in Likkutei Torah and Derech Mitzvotecha in the prior note.

[106] Isaiah 55:8

[107] Also note the discourse entitled "*Ki Yeda'ativ*" 5784 ibid.

elsewhere,[108] this was in the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that preceded the restraint-*Tzimtzum*. This accords with the statement in Pirke D'Rabbi Eliezer,[109] "Before the creation of the world, there was Him and His Name alone," and it was in this level that the arousal of His desire took place, as discussed in the Shnei Luchot HaBrit, on page four.[110] This level is known as the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) of the general worlds (*Olamot d'Klallut*). That is, immediately upon the arousal of His desire to emanate, the aspect of ten *sefirot* were instantly emanated etc.

Even according to Pardes Rimonim, in the Gate of the Order of Emanation[111] chapter four, which is quoted in the above-mentioned Shnei Luchot HaBrit; even before the arousal of His desire, the *Sefirot* were there in potential (*Ko'ach*), which is similarly stated in Avodat HaKodesh.[112]

However, from the explanation there, it is understood that even then, they still had a certain aspect of actualization (*Po'el*). This is as stated there, "They are concealed within Him, in His power, as a refined and concealed **existence**," and it likewise states later, "They exist, but in such a refined way that

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[108] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Inyanim p. 89; Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 10-11; Ohr HaTorah Inyanim p. 330 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5653 p. 253; 5657 p. 191 and on; 5668 p. 196 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 24 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Ki Eemcha Mekor Chayim*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 244).

[109] Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer Ch. 3

[110] See the notes and explanations of the Rebbe Rayatz, Ch. 23 (printed in the additions (*Hosafot*) to the newer edition of *Hemshech* 5666, p. 745).

[111] Pardes Rimonim, Shaar Seder HaAtzilut, Shaar 5, Ch. 4

[112] Avodat HaKodesh, Part 1, Ch., cited and explained in the later discourse entitled "*Ki Eemcha Mekor Chayim*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 247 and on); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5656 p. 379; 381 and on.

it is not proper to use the term 'existence' in relation to the *Sefirot*, rather there is an absolute and true unity."

Nevertheless, it is understood that there is some kind of actual refined existence, and we therefore must say that it does not apply to say that, Above in *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness there is potential (*Ko'ach*) without actualization (*Po'el*).[113] (However, do not think that actualization (*Po'el*) or potential (*Ko'ach*) are logical necessities of their own accord, God forbid, but are rather by *HaShem's*-יהו"ה will and desire.)

(It could be said that the true meaning of the matter of a potential (*Ko'ach*) unto itself,[114] refers to the level or aspect that completely transcends being defined as the existence of something. This refers to the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which completely transcends being defined as existence versus non-existence, Heaven forbid.[115] This is because the reality of His Being is that He exists, but not in a way of existence like other existences.

Rather, on this level, it is inapplicable for there to be a matter of actualization (*Po'el*) and it also is inapplicable for

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[113] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 p. 16 and on; p. 23 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayeilech Ish MiBeit Levi*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 184 and on); Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 19 p. 193 and on; Vol. 20 p. 283 and on; Vol. 25 p. 246, and elsewhere.

[114] [That is, without actualization (*Po'el*).]

[115] See Moreh Nevuchim, Part 1, Ch. 57; In Sefer HaMaamarim 5677 p. 73 it states, "As stated in Sefer HaYashar of Rabbeinu Tam, 'He exists but in a manner that completely transcends being defined as existence versus non-existence.'" – See Sefer HaYashar Tochachat Musar attributed to Rabbeinu Tam (see Shem HaGedolim, Ma'arechet Gedolim, section on R' Zerachiyah HaYevani); Shaar 3 "on matters of faith and matters regarding the mysteries of the Creator, blessed is He." Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 440; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 135; Vol. 3 p. 1,144; Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 440; 5705 p. 187; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Anochi HaShem Elokecha*" 5667 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 426 and on) and elsewhere.

there to be a matter of potential (*Ko'ach*). For, although His Essential Self indeed contains everything; it is not that He contains them in potential, God forbid (for there would then be some kind of defined existence, God forbid).

Rather, it is He who brings all existence into being, like the statement,[116] "From the reality of His Being, all beings exist." This is why we liken it to the aspect of a potential *(Ko'ach*), but only in relation to how He brings all existence into being. This is because, in reality, it does not apply to say about His Essential Self that there is either the aspect of potential (*Ko'ach*) or actualization (*Po'el*). Moreover, it should be said that the same is similarly so of the essence of the light (*Etzem HaOhr*) etc.)

Now, in the aspect of the arousal of His desire, that is, when it arose in His will to emanate, there was an immediate emanation of ten *Sefirot* in the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), even before the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and before the first restraint-*Tzimtzum*, as quoted above from Pardes Rimonim. It can be said that this refers to the aspect of the letters of the Impression-*Reshimu*, as they were before the restraint-*Tzimtzum*.[117] About this it states in the beginning of Zohar,[118] "In the beginning of the rule of the King, He engraved an engraving in the upper purity."

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[116] Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Yesodei HaTorah 1:1

[117] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5664 p. 11; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 20; Vol. 2 p. 1,010; Also see the end of the later discourse entitled "*Adam Ki Yihiyeh*" 5666 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 270); Discourse entitled "*Panim b'Panim*" and discourse entitled "*Ein Omdeem*" 5667 (p. 615; p. 639); [Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 12-13.]

[118] Zohar I 15a

That is, in the beginning of the arousal of His will, He engraved an engraving, referring to the aspect of letters that are engraved in the Essential Self etc. This refers to the estimation that He estimated within Himself in potential[119] (of what would be brought forth after the *Tzimtzum*-restraint), as discussed elsewhere.[120] This refers to the aspect of the Impression-*Reshimu* as it is before the restraint-*Tzimtzum*, when the limitless light of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, radiated within it in a revealed way.

According to what is explained elsewhere,[121] the matter of "the beginning of the rule of the King" transcends the aspect of the arousal of His will to emanate. (See what is written in the discourse of Rosh HaShanah 5665,[122] regarding the matter of thought and desire etc.) According to this, we may say that the letters of the Impression-*Reshimu* even transcend the aspect of the arousal of His desire. (This is like the example of the letters of thought explained in Likkutei Torah,[123] in the discourse entitled, "To understand what is written in Otzrot Chaim" at the end of chapter three.)

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[119] Mikdash Melech commentary to Zohar I 15a ibid.; Also see the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5709 p. 38 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 352.

[120] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Parshiyot Vol. 1 p. 67; Torat Chayim Noach 67a; Maamarei Admor HaEtmza'ee Na"Ch p. 130; Kuntreisim p. 201; Sefer HaMaamarim 5656 p. 371; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 10-11.

[121] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5660 p. 7; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 129 and on; Vol. 2 p. 1,173; Vol. 3 p. 1,218; Also see the end of the later discourse entitled "*Kedoshim Tihiyu*" 5667 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 639); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5656 ibid. p. 374.

[122] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 4 and on; 5703 p. 14 and on.

[123] Likkutei Torah, Hosafot to Vayikra, p. 52d and on, explained in the later discourse entitled "*Kodesh Yisroel*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 673 and on).

Nevertheless, from all this we glean that Above in Godliness, potential (*Ko'ach*) does not lack actualization (*Po'el*).[124] This being so, it cannot be said that the true reason and purpose for creation is to actualize the potential, being that *HaShem*-יהו"ה was absolutely perfect both in potential (*Ko'ach*) and in actuality (*Po'el*) even before the creation of the world.

Likewise, according to the reason stated in Zohar that the purpose of creation is "to make Himself known etc.," the primary knowledge and grasp of His Unlimited Light, blessed is He, is in the supernal worlds, such as the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and the worlds above the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). This is because in those worlds, there is a radiance of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה blessed is He, in a revealed way. This is through the revelation of the Line-*Kav*, which illuminates the Unlimited worlds (*Olamot HaEin Sof*) that transcend the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and illuminates within the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) itself. In those worlds, the Being of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness is actually known and grasped.

In contrast, in the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) the light is concealed and hidden, and does not illuminate in a revealed way. Additionally, even in the spiritual worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) all knowledge or grasp is only of the existence of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness, but His actual Being is not grasped whatsoever.

[124] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 p. 16 and on; p. 23 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayeilech Ish MiBeit Levi*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 184 and on); Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 19 p. 193 and on; Vol. 20 p. 283 and on; Vol. 25 p. 246, and elsewhere.

Rather, the creation of these worlds is specifically in a way that the Godly light of *HaShem*-ה"יהו itself is not revealed within them in a felt way, through which they are caused to have a sense of being separate entities etc.

In the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and certainly in the worlds above Emanation (*Atzilut*), the way they exist is that the Godly light radiates within them and is felt within them. This is why there is no sense of separate existence in those worlds, but they rather are an aspect of Godliness.

For example, even the vessels (*Keilim*) of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) are actual Godliness and are unified with His light, as it states,[125] "He and His organs are one etc." The entire existence of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is in a way of closeness, for they [i.e., the ten *Sefirot* of the world of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*)] are simply the aspect of the revelation of that which is concealed (*Giluy HaHe'elem*), as explained elsewhere.[126]

It can be said that because of this, it is called "Emanation-*Atzilut*-אצילות," which is of the same root as the word "proximity-*Eitzel*-אצל," indicating closeness.[127] In other words, the emanation of the ten *Sefirot* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is in a state of closeness. This is why the ten *Sefirot* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) are always bound

[125] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 3b

[126] See Torah Ohr Mishpatim 75d; 76b; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 Vol. 1 p. 292 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 11 and on; Vol. 2 p. 639 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*HaChodesh*" and on (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 211 and on); Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 19.

[127] See Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 16 (Shaar ABY"A) Ch. 1; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 349; 5629 p. 372; 5650 p. 420; p. 462; 5657 p. 133 and on, and elsewhere.

and unified with the limitless light of the Unlimited One who emanates them, as stated,[128] "He and His life force are one; He and His organs are one."

However, in the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) the way they are brought into being is through the Creator being concealed and hidden from the created, so that the light itself does not radiate, nor is it felt within them. And although the light of the soul (*Neshamah*) of the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) is Godly light, in that the soul (*Neshamah*) comes from the vessels (*Keilim*) of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*),[129] as known,[130] nevertheless, the light itself is not felt or truly grasped within the vessels (*Keilim*) of the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*). This accords with the statement in Tikkunim,[131] "In the world of Creation (*Briyah*), He and His life force and His organs are **not** one etc." This is why they are made in such a way that they have a sense of separate existence.

Nevertheless, in the spiritual worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) they are created in such a way that, at the very least, the existence of Godliness is felt, and they therefore are not separate entities completely unto themselves.

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[128] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar ibid. 3b

[129] See Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 5 [108b]; Epistle 20 [130a; 131b] (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5702 ibid.)

[130] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 44 (Shaar HaShemot) Ch. 1-2; Kuntres Acharon to Tanya 156b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5650 p. 288 and on; 5662 p. 228 and on; 5704 p. 35 and on.

[131] See Tikkunei Zohar ibid.

However, this physical world was specifically created in such a way that even the existence of Godliness is unfelt and there is a sense of separateness from their source. (It is only through much work and toil that one can come to grasp and feel the Godly light, and with one's soul a person can even come to feel His light that transcends the worlds, and beyond this, even His Essential light. This is the matter of,[132] "You shall see your world to come in your lifetime," as explained elsewhere.[133] However, this comes specifically through work and toil, and even then, it is not compelled to be, but rather it is [granted as a gift] of free choice and will.)

This accords with the explanation elsewhere[134] about the difference between the creatures of the concealed world and the creatures of the revealed world. That is, the creatures of the concealed world were created in such a way that they are still unified to their source and feel the Godly vitality within them. In contrast, the creatures of the revealed world were specifically created in a way that they are separate from their source and do not feel the Godly light and vitality.

This being so, it is understood that true knowledge and grasp of Godliness is specifically in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and in the Unlimited worlds (*Olamot Ein Sof*), and it is in this way that they were brought into being. That is, they were

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[132] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 17a

[133] See Tanya, Ch. 14 (20a); Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 149; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 59 (end of Ch. 35); Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 392; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,258.

[134] See Torah Ohr Beshalach 62b; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Parshiyot Vol. 1 p. 255 and on; 267 and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 41c and on; Shaar HaEmunah of the Mittler Rebbe, Ch. 52 and on (84a and on); Sefer HaMaamarim 5668 p. 93 and on; 5677 p. 161 and on, and elsewhere.

brought into being in a state of closeness, specifically so there will be a revelation of Godly light within them.

In truth, the matter of knowing the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) applies even before the creation of the world and even before the emanation of the supernal world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). This is as stated in Shnei Luchot HaBrit 4a, in explanation of the statement in Zohar Pekudei 239a, as follows, "'The Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) is unknowable' – that is, before it arose in His desire. However, after it arose in His blessed desire to emanate, He then is knowable etc." This is because the arousal of His desire is an aspect of revelation and since, at this point, there already is an emanation of the potentiality for the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), as discussed above, therefore He already is knowable. Moreover, this is likewise the case after the restraint-*Tzimtzum*; that the revelation of knowledge and light is specifically in the supernal world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), and the worlds that transcend Emanation (*Atzilut*).

However, in the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) and certainly in this lowest world, there is no radiance of revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*). On the contrary, their entire existence is brought about specifically through the concealment of the light, and the knowledge of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, can only be attained through hard work and much toil.

Now, as known, the ultimate purpose in the creation and existence of the worlds is to bring this lowest world about. This is as stated in Tanya, chapter thirty-six, that the purpose of the chaining down of the worlds and their descent from level to

level is not for the supernal worlds, but rather, the ultimate purpose is for this lowly world.[135]

This is like the statement,[136] "The end action arose first in thought." That is, specifically the end action, which is the actualization of this physical and separate existence, arose first in thought in the inner Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. This also is like the statement,[137] "The earth preceded the heavens," meaning, in thought.[138] It was only in speech that the heavens preceded the earth, because this is the order of the creation and the chaining down of the worlds.

In other words, for there be the aspect of separate actualized action by means of the restraint-*Tzimtzum* and the complete concealment of the light, it was necessary for there to first be the existence of the heavens. This refers to the spiritual worlds, which include the entire chaining down (*Hishtalshelut*), and specifically the spiritual worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*).

This is because through them, the light is constricted and concealed from level to level and with many myriad

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[135] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 30 and on; 5678 p. 112 and on; 5703 p. 98 and on; Discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5711 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 266, and in earlier editions Vol. 1 p. 6 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5711, Discourse 1); Also see the discourse entitled "*Mitzvatah Mishetishka*" 5713 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5713 p. 57 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5713, Discourse 7); Discourse entitled "*Lehavin HaHefresh*" 5719 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5719 p. 89 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5719, Discourse 11).

[136] See the liturgical hymn "*Lecha Dodi.*"

[137] Talmud Bavli, Chagiga 12a; Midrash Bereishit Rabbah, end of Ch. 1; Torah Ohr [Bereishit] 2b; [Mikeitz] 34d, and elsewhere (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5702 ibid.)

[138] See Torah Ohr Vayigrash 43c and on; Torat Chayim Vayigrash 89a and on, and elsewhere.

constrictions, concealments and withholdings, until the existence of this world became possible, which is a coarse and material physical world that has no revelation of light, to the point that there can even be an admixture of evil in it.

Now, since *HaShem's*-יהו"ה ultimate Supernal intent is specifically for this lowly world to exist, it cannot be said that His intention is only to "make Himself known," being that this was specifically accomplished by the existence of the supernal worlds. It therefore would be completely unnecessary for this lowly world to exist altogether, and certainly, it could not be said that the existence of this lowly world is His primary intention.

Similarly, it cannot be said that the reason for creation was necessitated by His perfection, that is, to actualize His perfection, because He already was perfect before the creation of the worlds and before His emanating etc. Moreover, the fulfillment of such an intention could have been accomplished by the existence of the supernal worlds alone.[139]

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Rather, the explanation is as stated in Midrash[140] on the verse,[141] "His thighs are like marble pillars." It states there, "His thighs (***Shok**av*-**שוק**יו) refer to the world, for the Holy One, blessed is He, yearned (*Ni**shtok**ek*-**נשתוק**ק) to create it etc." In other words, He creates solely because of His desire (*Teshukah*-

[139] For further explanation of this see the discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5731 ibid., translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe, 5731, Discourse 16.

[140] Midrash Bamidbar Rabbah 10:1

[141] Song of Songs 5:15

תשוקה) to do so, not because it is necessary for His perfection, Heaven forbid to think so.

It also was not[142] for Him to be known, for as explained in Etz Chaim, this reason too is for His perfection, since, if it was not for His perfection, it would altogether not be understood. For what difference does it make to the Holy One blessed is He, and what effect does it have on Him, whether or not He is known? It therefore is explained that this too is for His perfection, so that it should be revealed from the potential (*Ko'ach*) to the actual (*Po'el*), from concealment to revelation, and for it to be revealed it was necessary for the light to have a recipient who would thereby know Him.

Nevertheless, it cannot be said that this is why this lowly world exists, for this could have adequately been accomplished by the existence of the upper worlds (and even by the existence of the general world of Emanation (*Atzilut d'Klallut*) that precedes the restraint-*Tzimtzum*, as discussed above). Accordingly, it would be completely superfluous to bring this lowly world into being, especially since this world is specifically created in such a manner that the light is hidden and concealed, as discussed above.

Rather, the reason for the creation is simply because the Holy One, blessed is He, desired it, and we do not know an intellectual reason for why He desired it etc. The intention of His desire is to reveal the Essential Self of His Unlimited Light, specifically below in this lowly world. About this Midrash

[142] Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 6 ibid. p. 18 note 55; Vol. 20 p. 283, note 24.

states,[143] "The Holy One blessed is He desired to have a dwelling place in the lower worlds." This is not out of any necessity or intellectual reasoning,[144] but solely because this is what He desired,[145] in a way that transcends intellect and reasoning. (This is like the statement of the Alter Rebbe, of blessed memory,[146] "On a desire there is no question.")

Hence,[147] He desired that the lower worlds exist and that the aspect of the Essential Self of His Unlimited Light be drawn down below, and it therefore is possible to draw down this revelation specifically in this lowly world, as will later be explained.[148] This drawing down is from the inner Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which is much loftier than the revelation of His inner light (*Memaleh*) that illuminates within the worlds.

This is because the inner light is only a ray according to the limited capacities of the worlds, and within this ray there are different levels, from higher to lower, until this world where the light is completely hidden and concealed.

In contrast, when the drawing comes from the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, there are no divisions of upper or lower and the primary

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[143] Midrash Tanchuma Bechukotai 3, Naso 16; Bereshit Rabbah, Ch. 3; Bamidbar Rabbah, Ch. 13; Tanya Ch. 36

[144] See Likkutei Torah Balak 70c (and there is an alternate redaction in Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5564 p. 175); Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 Vol. 1 p. 338; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 453 and on; 5630 p. 289.

[145] See Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 227 (in earlier editions, Vol. 4 p. 128) note 32; Sefer HaSichot 5750 p. 305 note 64.

[146] See Ohr HaTorah Balak p. 997; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5700 p. 9; 5702 p. 34; Discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5731 ibid.; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 6 p. 21.

[147] See Likkutei Sichot Vol. 20 p. 284, note 27; Vol. 25 p. 251

[148] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 463 and on.

revelation is specifically below. This is simply because this is what He originally desired to bring about in the first place, as it were, and because it specifically is accomplished through our toil below.

This then, is the ultimate purpose of the creation and existence of the worlds and this is why the soul descended into this world, in that the souls of the Jewish people draw down the aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, through serving Him, blessed is He. This drawing down and revelation is by means of the inner lights (*Memaleh*) so that the revelation should be below and so that it should be revealed as an inner light[149] (as discussed in the discourse entitled "The holiday of Rosh HaShanah" from the year 5659[150]).

This is accomplished through studying *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Torah and fulfilling His *mitzvot*, for through this, the souls of the Jewish people draw down the aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, into the world. About this our sages, of blessed memory, stated,[151] "The word[152] 'In the beginning-*Bereishit*-בראשית' refers to Israel, who are called 'the first-*Reishit*-ראשית,' and Torah, which is called 'the first-*Reishit*-ראשית.'" That is, through the souls of the Jewish people and the Torah additional lights are drawn down into the worlds, this being the revelation of the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He.

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[149] [That is, the transcendent light of *Sovev Kol Almin* will be revealed within *Memaleh Kol Almin*.]

[150] Sefer HaMaamarim 5659, p. 102 and on.

[151] Bereishit Rabbah 1:4; Vayikra Rabbah 36:4; Also see Rashi to Genesis 1:1

[152] Genesis 1:1

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Now, the general[153] explanation[154] is as we find, that all drawings down of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Light into the worlds of Emanation, Creation, Formation, and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) depend on us fulfilling His *mitzvot*, as stated,[155] "If you walk in My statutes and keep My commandments, to do them; then I will give your rains in their season and the land shall yield its produce and the trees of the field shall yield their fruit etc." It similarly states,[156] "And it shall come to pass, that if you listen diligently to My commandments that I command you this day... that I will give the rain of your land in its season etc." As known,[157] these all refer to the drawing down of spiritual influence from the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that emanates to the worlds of Emanation, Creation, Formation, and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*).

Now, at first glance, it is not understood why all this depends on fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*. Is it not so that there has been a covenant from the days of the flood, symbolized by the rainbow, as in the verse,[158] "and I will look upon it and

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[153] Regarding this section until the end of the discourse see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5569 p. 165 and on.

[154] In the original handwritten manuscript of the *Hemshech* there was an alternate wording of this section which was modified by the Rebbe Rashab as it now reads. See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 11, note 146 for the original wording.

[155] Leviticus 26:3-4

[156] Deuteronomy 11:13-14

[157] See Ohr HaTorah Chukat p. 785; Hosafot p. 16 (5758 edition); Also see Ohr HaTorah Bechukotai (Vol. 1) p. 197; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 37 p. 79 and on.

[158] Genesis 9:16

remember the everlasting covenant?" That is, this covenant is that there always will be sustenance and influence to all the worlds from the Supernal Emanator, from the very beginning of all levels of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) to the very end of everything in Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) and this physical world, as the verse states,[159] "for as long as the earth remains, seedtime and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night shall not cease." This being so, this covenant will not be nullified, even if Heaven forbid, the *mitzvot* are not fulfilled. This being so, why then does it state here that it depends on "if you walk in My statutes, and keep My commandments?"

However, the explanation[160] is that certainly, because of the covenant mentioned above, there cannot be a complete nullification of the spiritual influence drawn to the worlds in the chaining down of Emanation, Creation, Formation, and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), but nonetheless the commandments must be fulfilled. This is because all the influence drawn down to the four worlds of Emanation, Creation, Formation and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*, *Yetzirah, Asiyah*) is in a way of constriction (*Tzimtzum*). That is, it is drawn down in limited measure, as determined by the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*),[161] for the sole purpose of sustaining and vitalizing the worlds.

However, fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot* specifically allows for **new light** and influence to be revealed; greater than

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[159] Genesis 8:22

[160] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5630 p. 105; 5654 p. 177 and on.

[161] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 14-15

the measure apportioned [by the Measuring Line] at the beginning of the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) because of the above-mentioned covenant. About this the verse states, "If you walk in My statutes and keep My commandments etc." This is because additional light and new influence is thereby drawn down, much greater than the principle set according to the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*).

This then, is the matter of *mitzvot*, in that they specifically draw **additional** light into the worlds, as stated, "He put him in the garden of Eden to work it and to guard it." As known, "to work it" refers to the 248 positive action commandments etc. This indicates that through [fulfilling the] 248 positive action commandments new light is constantly drawn down into the Upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*). This then,[162] is the meaning of "working" the garden, in that although the garden already was created out of nothing (*Yesh M'Ayin*), as stated,[163] "And *HaShem Eloh"im*-יהו"ה אלהי"ם planted a garden in Eden to the east (*MiKedem*-מקדם)," this was only with the limited lights and revelations of the order of the chaining down of the worlds.

Now, in the creation of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) it mentions the name, "*HaShem Elohi"m*-יהו"ה אלהי"ם" in its complete form,[164] because in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) there is a radiance of a more Supernal light than what

[162] See Ohr HaTorah Chukat p. 784 and on; p. 15 and on; p. 23 and on; p. 30 and on; p. 39 (5758 edition).

[163] Genesis 2:8

[164] [As opposed to the first chapter of Genesis, the act of creation, in which only the name "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם" is mentioned.]

illuminates in the world. For as known,[165] in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) there is a radiance and revelation of the light of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and the souls in the garden of Eden actually grasp the ray of Godliness etc.

This is as stated[166] on the verse,[167] "I have set My rainbow (*Kashtee*-קשתי) in the cloud" that it refers to "that which is likened to Me (*Hamukash Lee*-לי המוקש)." As explained elsewhere,[168] this refers to the revelation of the Line-*Kav* that radiates in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*), where "the righteous *Tzaddikim* sit and delight from the ray of the Indwelling Presence of *HaShem*-ה"והי (*Shechinah*)."[169] That is, they grasp the aspect of the essential being of this ray etc., as explained elsewhere.[170]

Nevertheless, all this is still the aspect of the light of the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*), for as it states, "And *HaShem*-ה"והי God planted a garden in Eden." That is, this was part of the determination for creation at the very outset of the creation and existence of the Garden of Eden, as it states,[171] "With the letter *Yod*-י He created the world

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[165] Also see the later discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 16).

[166] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 35:3

[167] Genesis 9:13

[168] Sefer HaMaamarim 5654, p. 51; Ohr HaTorah, Noach 70a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5634, pg. 59 and on; *Hemshech* 5672, Vol. 1, p. 565; Vol. 2, p. 681; 5698, p. 226 & 269

[169] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 17a

[170] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 1 p. 186 and on; 5634 ibid. p. 57 and on; 5653 p. 263 and on; 5654 ibid. p. 51 and on; 5660 p. 131 and on; 5665 p. 112 and on; 5672-5676 p. 118 and on; 5677 p. 27 and on; 5682 p. 24 and on; 5692 p. 294 and on, and elsewhere.

[171] Talmud Bavli, Menachot 29b; Also see Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 4 (106b and on) (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5702 ibid.)

to come." The letter *Yod*-י of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה name refers to the aspect of *Chochmah*-insight, referring to the aspect of "the Supernal Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] whose seat is in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*)."[172]

However, added revelation of Godly light in the Garden of Eden specifically depends on the service of man below in fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*, because through this, we draw additional lights into the Garden of Eden from the limitless light of the Unlimited Emanator, blessed is He. The same is true of all worlds in general.

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About this the verse states,[173] "The trees of *HaShem*-יהו"ה have their fill, the cedars of Lebanon which He has planted." The "trees of *HaShem*-יהו"ה" refer to the revelation of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*), wherein there is a revealed radiance of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, as stated, "And *HaShem*-יהו"ה planted etc." "The trees of *HaShem*-יהו"ה have their fill" refers to the drawing down of additional lights in the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה that radiates in the Garden of Eden, through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*.

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[172] As stated in various places in Chassidus. (See Torah Ohr Mishpatim 75a; *Hemshech* "*v'Kachah*" 5637 Ch. 29 (p. 39); Sefer HaMaamarim 5696 p. 119; 5700 p. 59; 5703 p. 133 and elsewhere); Also see Ramaz to Zohar II 220b; See the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5700 ibid.

[173] See Psalms 104:16; Also see Ohr HaTorah Chukat ibid.; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,255 and on.

To explain, many verses in Torah end with the words,[174] "I am *HaShem*-יהו"ה." Now, at first glance,[175] it is not understood why they end with the words, "I am *HaShem*-יהו"ה," for is it not so that the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is not fully known and revealed to us? Rather, the explanation is that the drawing down of new light from the Essential Self of He who emanates, into the worlds of Emanation, Creation, Formation, and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), through the fulfillment of Torah and *mitzvot*, is drawn down into the four letters of His Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה.[176]

First is the constriction of Insight-*Chochmah*, which is represented by the letter *Yod*-י, which is like a point. Then, from the *Yod*-י there is a spreading out of the length and breadth of Understanding-*Binah*, which is represented by the letter *Heh*-ה. Then there is a drawing down from above to below, which is the length represented by the letter *Vav*-ו. Then from the *Vav*-ו there is a drawing down of expression represented by the final letter *Heh*-ה etc.

This is a general principle in the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) from cause to effect; that

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[174] Leviticus 18:5-6; 18:21 and other places.

[175] Regarding the coming section until the end of the discourse, also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5568 Vol. 1 p. 161; Siddur Im Da"Ch 5c; Ohr HaTorah Yitro, p. 914 and on; Vayikra (Vol. 3) p. 839; p. 843; Ohr HaTorah Shlach p. 587 and on; p. 598; p. 624 and on; 5656 p. 271; p. 273; 5660 p. 95; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 8.

[176] Regarding the coming section (discussing the matter of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה as it relates to constriction (*Tzimtzum*), expansion (*Hitpashtut*) etc.), see Tanya, Iggeret HaTeshuvah Ch. 4 (94b); Likkutei Torah, Nitzavim 45c; Drushim L'Shemini Atzeret 92d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 2 p. 877 and on; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 150a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5651 p. 22 and on; 5652 p. 94 and on; 5656 p. 250 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Kedoshim Tihiyu*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 274 and on).

everything comes about through these four levels, constriction-*Tzimtzum*, spreading forth-*Hitpashtut*, drawing down-*Hamshachah*, and expression-*Hitpashtut*, all of which are included in the four letters of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה. It is in this manner that light comes out, as explained elsewhere[177] about the four letters of the name *HaShem*-יהו"ה which are drawn down through the Line-*Kav*.

It likewise is so particularly, in that each specific influence of light also bears the aspect of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה. For example,[178] in the light of Insight-*Chochmah*, the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is drawn down in expansion (*miluy*) with the letter *Yod*-י [יו"ד ה"י וי"ו ה"י]. Similarly, Kindness-*Chessed* and the other emotive attributes are drawn down with the name *HaShem*-יהו"ה expanded with *Alephs*-א [יו"ד ה"א וא"ו ה"א] etc.

In the same way, the drawing down of new light through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot* is also through the four letters of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, because through this, the light can be drawn down as an inwardly manifest light (*Ohr Pnimi*). About this it states[179] that the *mitzvot* depend on the four letters of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה. Similarly, the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is found within each *mitzvah*.[180] In other words, the specific four-

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[177] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5652 ibid., p. 97 and on.

[178] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 5 (Shaar TaNT"A) Ch. 1; Shaar 18 (Shaar RaPa"Ch Nitzutzin) Ch. 1, and elsewhere; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken Inyanim p. 137 and on; 206 and on; 5567 p. 277 and on; Et'halech Liozhna p. 20 and on; Ohr HaTorah Inyanim p. 248 and on.

[179] Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar Kriyat Shema, Shaar 49, Ch. 2; Shaar HaKavanot, Inyan Drushei HaLayla, Ch. 5, and elsewhere; Introduction to Tikkuntei Zohar 2a; Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Shabbat Shuva 64d.

[180] Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 29 (73a); Tikkun 70 (131b); Ta'amei HaMitzvot of the Arizal, Bereishit; Likkutei Torah Shlach 46a; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Bamidbar Vol. 2 p. 757 and on; Kuntreisim p. 322 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,274 and on.

letter Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is according to the level of the drawing down of that specific *mitzvah*. For example, through the *mitzvah* of *Tefillin*, additional light is drawn down to the aspect of the brain and intellect etc.[181] The same is true of each specific *mitzvah*.

Now, because this drawing down of influence is from the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One and is a revelation of new light that had not yet been drawn out from He who emanates, therefore it states about this, "I am *HaShem-Ani HaShem*-אני יהו"ה." "I-*Ani*-אני" refers to the aspect of the Crown-*Keter*, which is called "nothing-*Ayin*-אין,"[182] and it is this aspect of "I-*Ani*-אני" that illuminates the new Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה through the fulfillment of each *mitzvah*.

In other words, this is not an aspect of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that was already drawn down into the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) but is rather a new Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה drawn down from the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. This is as stated at the giving of the Torah,[183] "I am *HaShem* your God-*Anochi HaShem Elo"hecha*-אנכי יהו"ה אלהי"ך," referring to the level of[184] "I am who I am-

[181] See Torah Ohr, Mikeitz 35b and on; Ohr HaTorah Vayikra (Vol. 3) p. 916; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 111 and on; 5653 p. 255 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 4 p. 260 (in earlier editions, Vol. 2 p. 90) and elsewhere.

[182] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Ten (*Keter*); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 3 (Shaar Eem HaEin Sof Hoo HaKeter) Ch. 1; Etz Chayim, Shaar 6 (Shaar HaAkudim) Ch. 3; explained in Sefer HaMaamarim 5656 p. 361 and on; Also see p. 328 and elsewhere.

[183] Exodus 20:2; Deuteronomy 5:6

[184] As stated in various places in Chassidus (see Tanya, Mahadura Kamma, end of Ch. 49 p. 406; Torah Ohr Va'erra 56d; Beshalach 64b) Also see Likkutei Torah of the Arizal Toldot 27:19; Zohar I 167b; Zohar III 11a

Anochi, *Mi SheAnochi*-אנכי מי שאנכי"[185] which is an aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light the Unlimited One that transcends the entire chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*), and it is from this level that He is drawn down to be "*HaShem* your God-*HaShem Elo"heicha* – יהו"ה אלהי"ך," that is, a new Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, as mentioned before. He is called "**your** God-*Elo"hecha*-אלהי"ך," because this is specifically accomplished through you. That is, it is the souls of the Jewish people who draw this down through fulfilling His Torah and *mitzvot*.

[185] That is, it is beyond knowing Him.

Discourse 2

"*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha… - This day is the beginning of Your works…*"

Delivered on the 2nd day of Rosh HaShanah, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

We recite,[2] "This day is the beginning of Your works, a remembrance of the first day." Now, we first must understand the matter of the words, "the beginning of Your works-*Techilat Ma'asecha*-תחלת מעשך," which mean "the beginning of action" (*Techilat Asiyah*). We therefore must understand what exactly this beginning of action is. The continuation of the verse, "a remembrance of the first day" must also be understood, since it is not clear which is the first day that is remembered as the "beginning of action."

Now, to understand this, we first must understand what was discussed before about *HaShem's*-יהו"ה ultimate purpose and intention in creation; that is, that the ultimate purpose of the decent of the soul into the body is to draw down additional light from the Inner Essential Self of the limitless light of the

[1] This discourse is based in the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah She'bBrachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 514 and on; Discourse entitled "*v'Nahar Yotzei*" in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit (Vol. 3) p. 534b and on, as cited in later notes. For further explanation of the matters discussed in this discourse, see the discourses entitled "*Yechayeinu MiYomayim*" and "*Mah Yafeet*" 5691 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 p. 243 and on; p. 251 and on); Also see the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5736, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 1.

[2] In the Rosh HaShanah Musaf liturgy (Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 27a).

Unlimited One, by fulfilling His Torah and *mitzvot*, until a full revelation of His Unlimited Light will be revealed below. This is the meaning of the word "In the beginning-*Bereishit*-בראשית,"[3] that is, "for the sake of the Jewish people and for the sake of the Torah,"[4] as discussed before.

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To further understand the drawing down of additional lights through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*, we must begin[5] by explaining the verse,[6] "No eye has seen it aside for You God, who does it for whoever awaits Him." About this our sages, of blessed memory stated (in Talmud Bavli, Brachot 34b), "What is meant by 'No eye has seen it'? Rabbi Shmuel Bar Nachmani said, 'This refers to Eden, which has never been seen by the eye of any creature. Perhaps you will say, 'Where then was Adam?' He was in the Garden. Perhaps you will say,[7] 'The Garden and Eden are one and the same.' This is not so! For the verse states,[8] 'And a river went out of Eden to water the Garden' - the Garden is one thing and Eden is another thing."

The explanation is that about the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) the verse states,[9] "And *HaShem Eloh"im*-יהו"ה אלהי"ם planted a Garden in Eden to the east (*MiKedem*)." From this

[3] Genesis 1:1

[4] See Rashi & Ramban to Genesis 1:1; Also see the preceding discourse (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 11).

[5] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid.

[6] Isaiah 64:3

[7] Regarding the version of the text here, see *Hemshech* 5666 p. 14, note 6 and Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid.

[8] Genesis 2:10

[9] Genesis 2:8

verse one might assume that the Garden and Eden are identical, since the Garden is in Eden. Another verse therefore informs us, "And a river went out of Eden to water the Garden." From this it is understood that the Garden is one thing and Eden is another thing.

Now, as known,[10] Eden represents the aspect of the simple essential pleasure in the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, which is called "The Delight of the King in His Essential Self – *Sha'ashuei HaMelech B'Atzmuto*."[11] This is the aspect of the hidden pleasure (*Oneg Ne'elam*) that transcends being drawn into revelation. Regarding this it states, "No eye has seen it," in that it has never been seen by the eye of any creature, including our teacher Moshe and our forefathers, [Avraham, Yitzchak and Yaakov]. Even Adam, the first man (*Adam HaRishon*), who was formed by "the hand of the Holy One blessed be He,"[12] did not see this, even in his spiritual state before the sin [of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil], when he was the epitome of perfection.[13] This is because it transcends being drawn into revelation.

Only in the coming future, when the dead will be resurrected (*Techiyat HaMeitim*) will this level be revealed, since the aspect of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent

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[10] See Shaar HaEmunah from the Mittler Rebbe, p. 61b and on; Also see Torah Ohr Shemot 49b.

[11] See the beginning of Shever Yosef (by Rabbi Yisrael Sarug); Emek HaMelech, Shaar Shaashuei HaMelech; Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 27a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5644, p. 306; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 24.

[12] See Midrash Bereishit Rabba 24:5.

[13] See Torah Ohr, Vayechi 46d; Torat Chayim 95a; 96c and on.

Intrinsic and Unlimited One will then be revealed. About this we say,[14] "There is none like You, our savior, until the resurrection of the dead," for in that time, *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Essential Self will truly be revealed. This is because the revelations of the coming future will not be in way of spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*) or the revelation of lights (*Orot*), but rather, the essential hiddenness (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) will be drawn down and revealed, or it could be in a way of ascent; that the souls of the Jewish people will ascend to the aspect of the essential hiddenness (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*). This is as stated,[15] "After two days He will revive us; on the third day He will raise us up, so that we may live in His Presence," that is, **literally** in His Presence, in the aspect of the inner Essential Self of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה Himself, blessed is He.

Now, the souls who currently reside in the Garden of Eden receive and derive pleasure from the ray of the Indwelling Presence of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Shechinah*).[16] However, even for the highest souls, this only is a glimmer of the aspect of the hidden essential pleasure (*Taanug HaNe'elam HaAtzmi*). This is because it is drawn down by way of many consecutive constrictions (*Tzimtzumim*) and concealments until it comes into the capacity of the souls to receive. This is the matter of the river that went out of Eden, which separates between Eden

[14] In the liturgy of the "*Yotzer*" blessing of Shabbat prayers.
[15] Hosea 6:2
[16] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 17a

and the Garden. That is, only a glimmer is drawn down to "water the Garden."

Therefore, in the coming future, when the dead will be resurrected, we will attain the revelation of the aspect of Eden itself. This accords to what our sages, of blessed memory stated,[17] "All the prophets only prophesied about the days of Moshiach,[18] but about Eden, 'no eye has seen it.'" This is because the revelation of the aspect of Eden[19] will only happen later, with the resurrection of the dead (which will be the chief revelation in the matter of Moshiach.)

This will require a splitting and crossing of the river, as it doubly states,[20] "Until Your people pass over *HaShem*-יהו"ה, until the people you have acquired pass over." This second "passing over" refers to the future crossing, through the River Euphrates (*Nahar Prat*),[21] which is the river that comes out of Eden.[22]

This is akin to the fact that after the exodus from Egypt, before they could receive the Torah, it was first necessary for there to be the splitting of the sea. As known,[23] the giving of the Torah represents the drawing down of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) into revelation. The "sea-*Yam*-ים" is the

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[17] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 34b

[18] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 ibid. (p. 245), [that the reason for this is that the substance matter of a prophet is revelation, and the substance matter of the days of Moshiach is revelation, and it is for this reason that the prophets only prophesied about the days of Moshiach].

[19] Regarding the coming section, see Likkutei Torah Tzav 17a and on; Shaar HaEmunah of the Mittler Rebbe 83b and on; 89b and on.

[20] Exodus 15:16

[21] See Targum and the commentators to Isaiah 11:15

[22] Talmud Bavli, Bechorot 55b

[23] See Torah Ohr, Bereishit 3b; Yitro 68d (cited in Likkutei Torah Tzav ibid.)

quality of Kingship-*Malchut* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*),[24] which conceals the lights of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). Therefore, before the Torah was given, the sea had to split, that is, the concealments split open, the purpose of which was to bring about a connection between the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah, Asiyah*), through either a revelation of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) in the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah, Asiyah*),[25] or the ascent of the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah, Asiyah*) to the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*),[26] as discussed elsewhere.[27]

It likewise will be so in the coming future, in order to reach the inner aspect of Torah, as it is in the aspect of "The delight of the King in Himself," referring to the Torah teachings that Moshiach will teach the people.[28] It will then be in a way of "seeing", unlike how Torah is learned today, which only is by way of intellectual comprehension.

Rather, through the Torah teachings that Moshiach will teach all Israel, we will behold the Essential Being, as explained in Likkutei Torah[29] in the discourse entitled "*VeHeinif*." In other words, the essential being of the Torah will be revealed as it is in the Essential Being and Self of the Unlimited One

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[24] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla translated as Gates of Light, Gate One (*Malchut*).

[25] See Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Chag HaMatzot, Ch. 8; Shaar HaKavanot, Inyan Sefirat HaOmer, Drush 12.

[26] Zohar II 48b

[27] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 289d and on; Shaar HaEmunah of the Mittler Rebbe 71b; 86b, and elsewhere.

[28] Likkutei Torah Tzav ibid.

[29] Likkutei Torah Tzav ibid.; Shaar HaEmunah p. 79a and on.

(*Atzmut Ein Sof*), which is the aspect of Eden itself. Now, for such a revelation to come about there must be a "splitting" of the river, as stated,[30] "And He shall wave His hand over the river...and smite it into seven streams etc." This is because the river separates and conceals the revelation of the aspect of Eden. It therefore must specifically be split.

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Now, as known,[31] the "River-*Nahar*-נהר" corresponds to Understanding-*Binah*,[32] whereas Eden corresponds to Wisdom-*Chochmah*.[33] Now although, as explained before, Eden refers to the aspect of the hidden, essential and simple pleasure in the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*), generally speaking, this is in the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah* in its inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*) which transcends the chaining down of worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*). That is, "the inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is the inner aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik* [pleasure]."[34] This refers to the concealed aspect of

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[30] Isaiah 11:15 ibid.

[31] Likkutei Torah, Tzav 15d; Shir HaShirim 39d, and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1.

[32] See Zohar II 123b; Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Eight (*Binah*); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim), Ch. 13 section on "*Nahar*"; Also see Zohar I 26a and the note in Derech Emet of Rabbi Chayim Vital there, and elsewhere.

[33] Zohar Vol. 1, p. 247b; Vol. 3, p. 290a; Tanya Igeret HaKodesh, 107a (Epistle 5) & 125b (Epistle 17); Also see Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Eight (*Binah*) and Gate Nine (*Chochmah*).

[34] See Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema Ch. 15; Ramaz to Zohar III 276b; Likkutei Torah Nitzavim 49d; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 126 and on; p. 135 and on.

Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which even transcends experiential pleasure, as explained elsewhere.[35]

This also accords to the explanation in Zohar[36] that the principal aspect of Eden corresponds to the Crown-*Keter*, which is called,[37] "the Upper Eden-*Eden Ila'ah*."[38] We must say that this too refers to the Hidden Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'a*) of the Crown-*Keter* and refers to the inner aspect of the Hidden Wisdom *(Chochmah Stima'a)* which is concealed by its very nature, as explained elsewhere.[39] The same can even be said about higher levels, all the way up to the origin of all levels.

Now, the River (*Nahar*-נהר) that comes out of Eden refers to the aspect of Understanding-*Binah*, and the souls in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) derive pleasure from this level. That is, they derive pleasure from their grasp and comprehension of Godliness, which is the aspect of Understanding-*Binah*, as explained in chapter thirty-nine of Tanya. This is like the revelation of Godliness that is drawn down into the worlds from the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). That is, it is drawn down in a

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[35] See Ohr HaTorah Naso p. 257; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 185 and on; 5644 p. 324.

[36] See the introduction to Tikkunei Zohar (12a); Tikkun 55 (88a), cited in Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 16, section on "Eden"; Torah Ohr Shemot 49b and elsewhere.

[37] Zohar Vol. 2, p. 210b; Vol. 3, p. 182b; Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 48, p. 85a

[38] See Zohar III 210b; Zohar III 182b; Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 48 (85a); Tikkun 55 ibid.

[39] See Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefillin 183a and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 127); *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 406 and on; p. 416; Discourse entitled "*HaOseh Sukkato*" 5720 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5720 p. 13 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5720, Discourse 2).

concealed and hidden way by means of Kingship-*Malchut*, which conceals the light (*Ohr*).

As known,[40] Kingship-*Malchut* is the aspect of the Supernal speech (*Dibur*),[41] because, like speech, it conceals the light that is drawn down. This is like the quality of speech in man, in that although the letters of speech are vessels for the intellect and emotions, in that they are drawn down to vest in speech, nevertheless, the letters conceal the intellect within them, and it becomes hidden in them.

This is observable in a small child. Although he may understand all the letters and words that he hears and can even repeat them, nonetheless, it could be that he does not understand the concepts contained in them. Only a person who already is wise of his own accord understands through the medium of the letters. However, in and of themselves, the letters exist as an aspect of concealment relative to the existence of the intellect and emotions.

We may understand the letters of Kingship-*Malchut* in the same way; that they conceal the intellect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and Knowledge-*Da'at*, as well as the emotive qualities (*Midot*) of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) that vest within the Supernal speech (*Dibur*). They are concealed to such an extent that in the world of Creation (*Briyah*) there is no revelation of them at all, except for a very limited glimmer of their light.

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[40] Regarding the coming section see Likkutei Torah Tzav ibid. 16d.

[41] See Zohar I 86a and Ohr HaChamah and Ramaz there; Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim), beginning of Ch. 4, section on "*Dibur*"; Me'orei Ohr and Kehilat Yaakov, section on "*Dibur*," and elsewhere.

This also is so of the Upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*) of the world of Creation (*Briyah*); that is, "the[42] "Supernal Mother-*Imma Ila'ah* [Understanding-*Binah*] resides on the Throne."[43] This refers[44] to the aspect of the "river that goes out from Eden" in which the river (*Nahar*-נהר) represents the matter of thought (*Machshavah*)[45] in that just as the flow of a river never ceases, so likewise, thought flows ceaselessly without rest or quiet. Therefore, thought is compared to a river (*Nahar*-נהר) because it flows constantly, as in the verse,[46] "All nations shall flow (*Naharu*-נהרו) to it."

Now, thought (*Machshavah*) is also made up of letters and they too are merely garments for the essence of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, just like speech (*Dibbur*), except that, of the two, thought (*Machshavah*) is the inner garment. Nevertheless, relative to the essentiality of the Supernal Wisdom-*Chochmah*, it too is a concealing garment. This is like the letters of speech (*Dibur*), except that the concealment as it is in thought (*Machshavah*), is not as great as it is in speech (*Speech*). Beyond this, in and of itself, comprehension conceals the light of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, for as known,[47] as the light actually is in Wisdom-*Chochmah*, it cannot radiate in Understanding-*Binah*. This is because, in and of itself, comprehension conceals. This then, is the meaning of the river (*Nahar*-נהר) that

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[42] Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 6 (23a)

[43] [That is, the "Supernal Mother-*Imma Ila'ah*" which refers to the *Sefirah* of Understanding-*Binah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), is what illuminates the world of Creation (*Briyah*), which is called "the Throne."]

[44] Regarding the coming section, see Likkutei Torah Tzav ibid. 17a and on.

[45] See Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 17c, and elsewhere.

[46] Isaiah 2:2

[47] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A) Ch. 13, explained in Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 347 and on.

separates between the aspects of the Garden (*Gan*-גן) and Eden (עדן), because the revelation that illuminates the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) is only a tiny glimmer drawn down from the aspect of the "River" (*Nahar*-נהר).

Now, although it was explained above[48] that in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) there is a revealed radiance of the light of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), in that "the Supernal Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] resides in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*),"[49] nevertheless, the light of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) that radiates in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) is only from the aspect of Understanding-*Binah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

It may be said that there is an advantage to the revelation of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*), relative to the revelation of the aspect of Emanation (*Atzilut*) that is within the world of Creation (*Briyah*) in general. For,[50] about the river that goes out of Eden the verse states,[51] "and from there it separated and became four heads." This refers to how the aspect of Understanding-*Binah* vests within Kingship-*Malchut*, which then vests within the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) and becomes separated.

In contrast, about the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) the verse states that the River "goes out" of Eden, meaning that as

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[48] At the end of the preceding discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 12).

[49] As stated in various places in Chassidus. (See Torah Ohr Mishpatim 75a; *Hemshech* "*v'Kachah*" 5637 Ch. 29 (p. 39); Sefer HaMaamarim 5696 p. 119; 5700 p. 59; 5703 p. 133 and elsewhere); Also see Ramaz to Zohar II 220b; See the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5700 ibid.

[50] Regarding the coming section see Ohr HaTorah Bereishit ibid. (534b and on); Also see Torah Ohr Vayeishev 27c; Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim 39b.

[51] Genesis 2:10

it is in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) itself, it is without separation and cessation. It can be said that it is as they illuminate in the world of Creation (*Briyah*) that they are in a state of separateness. (This could be the matter of the chambers and halls mentioned in Tanya there.) In contrast, in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) there is a radiance of Understanding-*Binah* as it comes out of Eden without any separation [into four heads] whatsoever.

This is as stated in Zohar toward the end of Parshat Noach 74b, "If you say that it is written, 'And a river goes out from Eden... and from there they are separated,' it sounds[52] as if they derive their sustenance from the Garden, which is Kingship-*Malchut* (within which there is the radiance of the aspect of Understanding-*Binah*) and that this is called 'separation-*Pirud*-פירוד.' Nonetheless, certainly only when they are taken from there are they separated, but when they gather there to derive sustenance, there is no separation."

The Zoharei Chamah[53] commentary explains that this refers to the four encampments of the Indwelling Presence of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, the *Shechinah*, and that the matter of separation here is not complete separation, Heaven forbid. Rather, it is separation that is akin to the verse,[54] "Their wings were spread apart (*prudot*-פרודות)," referring to the aspects of love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, in that these states of arousal are separate and

[52] The words "it sounds… this is called 'separation-*Pirud*-פירוד" are additional to the language of the Zohar, but this is as stated in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit ibid.

[53] Zoharei Chamah to Zohar I ibid. Also see Ohr HaTorah Bereishit ibid. 543b that Zoharei Chamah explains the matter of "from there they are separated" to refer not to the external husks (*Kelipot*), but also to the four encampments of the *Shechinah*.

[54] Ezekiel 1:11

different from each other. This is explained in Likkutei Torah, in the Shavuot discourse entitled "*uSefartem Lachem*,"[55] (wherein it explains that even this "separation" is only regarding the "wings," and specifically refers to four of the organs of speech. However, the palate, which is the fifth organ of speech from which the letters גיכ"ק (*Gimel-Yod-Chof-Kuf*) emerge, refers to the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, corresponding to the word "their faces"[56] which are not at all in a state of separation). [The Zoharei Chamah continues,] "And when are they in a state of separation? When they are separated from there. However, when they still are connected to the *Shechinah*, they are not separated and they all constitute one single unity etc."

This then, is the great advantage of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*), about which it states, "A river goes out from Eden to water the Garden," in that there is a radiance of the aspect of Understanding-*Binah* as it still is unified with Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is the meaning of the statement that in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) there is a revealed radiance of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), because "the Supernal Father-*Abba Ila'ah* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] resides in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*)." It is for this reason that the River (*Nahar*) goes out from the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), because in and of itself, in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), all levels are unified and it is called[57] the "World of Oneness" (*Olam HaAchdut*).

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[55] Likkutei Torah Bamidbar 10a; Also see Likkutei Torah Tzav ibid. (18a).

[56] Ezekiel 1:11 ibid.

[57] See Zohar III 83a (Ra'aya Mehemna); Avodat HaKodesh, Part 1, Ch. 2; Torah Ohr Va'era 57a; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,448 and elsewhere.

This is because Wisdom-*Chochmah* is the aspect of "nothingness" (*Ayin*), and therefore because in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) in general, there is a radiance of the light of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*], therefore it is in a state of perfect unity. (The true beginning of the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) is from the aspect of Understanding-*Binah*, as explained elsewhere.[58]) In this manner, in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) there is a revealed radiance of the aspect of Understanding-*Binah* as it still is unified to Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

It also can be said[59] that in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) there is also a revelation and radiance of Wisdom-*Chochmah* itself. This is as stated in Biurei HaZohar[60] about the teaching in Zohar Parshat Va'era[61] on the verse,[62] "and *HaShem*-יהו"ה remembered," that the River (*Nahar*-נהר) refers to the aspect of Foundation-*Yesod* of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*].

According to this, the words "to water the Garden" refer to the aspect of Understanding-*Binah*. This is as explained in Mikdash Melech[63] to Zohar Yitro 90a, that it is through Understanding-*Binah* that there is a drawing down to Kingship-*Malchut* as well, and that these two are hinted by the two letters

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[58] See Likkutei Torah Tzav 11d and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 152

[59] Regarding the coming section, see Ohr HaTorah Bereishit ibid. p.536b; Also see p. 529b and on.

[60] Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe p. 11b and on; Also see Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek Vol. 1 p. 47 and on.

[61] Zohar I 115a

[62] Genesis 21:1

[63] Cited in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit ibid. p. 536b

Heh-ה of the words[64] "to work it-*LeAvdah*-לעבדה" and "to guard it-*LeShamrah*-לשמרה." We may therefore say that this radiance is revealed through Kingship-*Malchut* into the upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*) in the world of Creation (*Briyah*) as well.

(In the above Biurei HaZohar it explains that this refers to the inner union (*Yichud Pnimi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah* and it can be said that this is the primary matter of the "ray" of their Torah study and service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in which the souls delight etc.) This then, is the meaning of the statement,[65] "The coming world (*Olam HaBa*) was created with the letter *Yod*-י," that is, with the lower thorn of the *Yod*-י which refers to the aspect of Foundation-*Yesod* of the Father-*Abba* (Wisdom-*Chochmah*).

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Nonetheless,[66] all the above is only the aspect of a tiny radiance and glimmer, rather than the aspect of the essential pleasure of the aspect of Eden. It is specifically within this glimmer that all the ascents of the souls in the Garden of Eden take place, in that three ascensions take place every day. Similarly, on Shabbat and holidays, the souls ascend to the upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*), as stated in

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[64] Genesis 2:15; Also see Rabbeinu Bachaye to Genesis 2:15 that "to work it-*LeAvdah*-לעבדה" and "to guard it-*LeShamrah*-לשמרה" refers to the two letters *Hey*-ה of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה. Also see Ohr HaaTorah Bereishit ibid. p. 537a.

[65] Talmud Bavli, Menachot 29b

[66] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 ibid. p. 514.

Tanya.[67] All these ascensions are only within the glimmer that radiates from Eden, within which there are many levels,[68] for as known,[69] there are many levels in the Garden of Eden.

This is explained elsewhere[70] on the words,[71] "Abundance of all things (*Kol*-כל)," that this refers to[72] "all (*Kol*-כל) the days of the coming world." This is like the teaching,[73] "The righteous have no rest, neither in this world nor in the coming world, as it states,[74] 'They go from strength to strength etc.'" In other words, specifically because it only is a glimmer and radiance, there are many levels.

As known,[75] in the coming future the matter of ascents and descents will no longer take place, because then, the matter of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) itself, in which levels do not apply, will be revealed. However, right now there are many levels because only a glimmer is revealed. This is because about every radiance of light it must be said that there is a higher and lower aspect, a beginning and an end. That is, where the ray is close to its source there is greater radiance,

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[67] Tanya, Ch. 39 (52a); Also see Likkutei Torah Va'etchanan 9a

[68] See the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5736 ibid., translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 1. [In other words, even the aspect of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) which is beneath Eden is limitless (*Bli Gvul*).]

[69] See Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 17 (126a), and elsewhere; Torah Ohr, Tetzaveh 81c.

[70] Torah Ohr, Tetzaveh p. 81b and on

[71] Deuteronomy 28:47

[72] Mishnah Avot 4:17

[73] Talmud Bavli, ending to tractate Brachot (as brought in the introduction to the Shnei Luchot HaBri 17a) and elsewhere; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 14 p. 179 and on; Vol. 15 p. 137 and on).

[74] Psalms 84:8

[75] See Likkutei HaShas of the Arizal, end of Brachot; Likkutei Torah Shlach 39d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5566 p. 259; 5568 Vol. 1 p. 544; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayishlach Yaakov*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 140); Likkutei Sichot Vol. 14 & Vol. 15 ibid. Sefer HaSichot 5752 p. 502 and on.

whereas, at its end, where it is distant from its source, the light has dissipated considerably.

This is like the light of a candle, in that there is no comparison between a person who stands close to the candle, compared to when he stands far from it, even if he is in the same room. The same is true of the light of a torch and even the light of the sun. Certainly, the light that is close to the sun is much more intense than the light that reaches us.

Now, through these examples we can understand how it is Above in Godliness. Certainly, the light (*Ohr*) that is closer to the Luminary (*Ma'or*) is much more intense. This is so of all aspects of light (*Ohr*), in that there is a huge difference between its initial radiance as it first comes out of the Luminary (*Ma'or*) and the furthest reaches of its spreading out. Now, having established that light, in general, has a beginning and end, it therefore follows that there are many, many levels and degrees in it. In contrast, the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One is equally present everywhere, because He has no beginning or end nor any division of levels whatsoever.

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This then is the Godly service of the souls in the Garden of Eden, in that just as the souls below, in this world, have their service, so likewise the souls Above, in the Garden of Eden, have their service, which is the ascent from level to level. That is, each consecutive ascent requires a nullification of the level

before it.[76] Only then can there be an ascent and inclusion into the higher level. That is, only when there is total and complete nullification of the existence (*Bitul B'Metziut*) of the lower level, to the point that one completely forgets the pleasure of the previous level, as if it is nothing, can one then ascend to the higher level of pleasure and delight in Godliness above it, which is incomparably greater.

This is because the general totality of this revelation of a radiance of the aspect of the Supernal pleasure transcends the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*), and therefore, although there are multiple levels in the radiance, each level cannot compare to the level above it, so much so, that there is utterly no comparison between the lower level and the upper level. There must therefore be a complete and total nullification of the former state of experience to come to the next state of experience, which is incomparably higher than it.

This is like the study of any wisdom; When it becomes necessary to come to a higher comprehension of the wisdom, which is incomparably higher than how the wisdom was grasped initially, a person must first negate his previous understanding of it, like what it says about Rav Zeira, that to be able to learn the Jerusalem Talmud, he undertook one-hundred fasts to forget the Babylonian Talmud.[77]

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[76] See Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket p. 223 and on (in earlier editions, Vol. 3 p. 36 and on); Also see the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5636 ibid. translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 1, [that this explanation emphasizes the greatness of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*)].

[77] Talmud Bavli, Bava Metziya 85b; Also see Torah Ohr Yitro 69c and elsewhere.

However, at first glance, is it not so that when learning, a person must first understand one matter, such as something minor, so that he can then come to understand a higher matter? [Is it not from his comprehension of the first matter that he comes to comprehend the next matter, thus climbing from level to level in understanding, like climbing the rungs [of a ladder]? However, in the case of Rav Zeira, he apparently had to forget [the first level of understanding to reach the higher level of understanding]. The explanation is that[78] "There is no Torah like the Torah of the land of Israel," and the Babylonian Talmud cannot at all compare to it.[79]

Therefore, even though his learning was in a way of love and fear of *HaShem*-ה"והי, blessed is He, and he was unified with the light of the Torah, so much so that[80] "fire did not burn him," nevertheless, in order to approach the study of the Jerusalem Talmud he had to forget the Babylonian Talmud. That is, there had to be a total negation of his first level of awareness and comprehension, and only then could he ascend [to the higher level of awareness and comprehension].

This is likewise so when one wants to understand any deep matter. It specifically requires great toil, as in the dictum,[81] "I have toiled and I have found." On the other hand, a concept of lesser depth can be understood with minimal toil and effort. However, great intellectual depth specifically comes

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[78] Midrash Bereishit Rabba 16:4

[79] See Shaarei Orah of the Mittler Rebbe 22a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5681 p. 195 and on; 5708 p. 121 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayiten Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 119 and on).

[80] Talmud Bavli, Bava Metzia 85a ibid.

[81] Talmud Bavli, Megilla 6b

through great toil. This is because it specifically is the toil that clarifies and sublimates the vessel of one's brain to the matter under contemplation.

Moreover, to grasp a deeper matter, one must go through a state of bewilderment (*Hishtomemut*-השתוממות),[82] as in the verse,[83] "And he was bewildered (*Eshtomem*-אשתומם) for quite some time." That is, his original level of comprehension must be negated until the illumination of comprehending is altogether lacking from his mind, in that he altogether cannot grasp the deep matter. Only then can he come to grasp the matter in greater depth.

This is like a seed planted in the earth,[84] in that it first must decompose and undergo the complete negation and loss of its form. Only then is the power of growth drawn to it, to arouse new growth from nothing to something, and until it decomposes, this is not yet possible. Because of this, the sages stated,[85] "The Torah is not permanently established except in a person who kills himself for it, as it states,[86] 'This is the Torah; when a man dies in the tent etc.'" They likewise stated,[87] "If any scholar sits before his teacher and his lips do not drip bitterness etc." This is because to be a proper receptacle that

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[82] In the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah She'bBrachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 514 and on ibid., it cites the verse (Genesis 24:21), "The man was bewildered (*Mishta'eh*-משתאה) etc." Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 92b and on; Torat Chayim, Chayei Sarah 140a and on; Shaarei Teshuvah, Shaar HaTefilah, Ch. 34 and elsewhere.

[83] Daniel 4:16; Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 47a

[84] See Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh Epistle 8 (113a); Hosafot to Torah Ohr 114d; Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim 16a and elsewhere.

[85] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 63b

[86] Numbers 19:14

[87] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 30b

receives, he specifically must first undergo the nullification (*Bittul*) of his being.

The same principle is true of the ascent of the soul during prayer, which is brought about specifically by the bitterness and lowliness one feels before the ascent. As known,[88] the entire matter of prayer is that of coming close to *HaShem*-יהו"ה, to illuminate his soul with Godly light. [The purpose of prayer is] to bring one to closeness and adhesion to Godliness or to arouse a yearning and passion for Godliness in a way of thirst and desire, like flames of fire in his soul.

To elucidate, the matter of closeness and adhesion to Godliness happens when the Godly light radiates in his soul in a revealed way. This comes about through grasping and contemplating (*Hitbonenut*) Godliness with great adhesion of the mind to know the Godly matter being contemplated and understand how and what it is. Through this the light radiates in his soul in a revealed way, as explained elsewhere.[89]

Now, depending on the Godly matter being contemplated, there are various levels in this. If he contemplates the aspect of the light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*), this being the Godliness manifest in the worlds, this may actually be grasped and comprehended, and the Godly light will actually illuminate his soul in a revealed way. That is, he will come to a state of closeness and adhesion to the Godly light that will radiate in his soul.

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[88] See Torah Ohr Terumah 79d and on; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 35 p. 126; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 ibid. p. 252 and on.

[89] See Sefer HaArachim Chabad, Vol. 1, section on "*Ahavat HaShem*," Ch. 2 & Ch. 6.

However, if his contemplation is into the limitless light of the Unlimited One that transcends the worlds, this being the aspect of the wondrousness and transcendence of His Unlimited Light, he then will comprehend, grasp and feel the wondrousness and incredible transcendence of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, in his soul (through the deepening of his attention).[90]

Now, it also is possible for this to radiate in his soul in a revealed way, as a true inner feeling. However, this only applies to very lofty souls who are ready vessels to receive the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. An illumination of the wondrous radiance of His Unlimited Light will actually shine in their souls in a revealed way. This being so, they too are in a state of love and adhesion (*Dvekut*) to *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He.

This level is known as "love of Him with delight in Him-*Ahavah B'Ta'anugim*," because in the essential self of their souls, they derive great pleasure from the light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that radiates within them, literally to the point of expiring. In other words, on this level of adhesion (*Dveikut*) their souls can literally expire.

However,[91] if a person's contemplation is into the limitless light of the Unlimited One as it wondrously transcends the worlds, and the light does not radiate in his soul in a revealed way, but is nonetheless grasped and felt, in that even though it does not radiate in a revealed way, he nonetheless feels its

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[90] [*Ha'amakat HaDa'at* – Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1.]

[91] See the prior discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 1 and on); Sefer HaArachim ibid.

wondrousness and greatness (in that this feeling too is an inner feeling, only that his grasp is just of the **wondrousness** of the Unlimited Light, rather than feeling the wondrous light itself, and moreover, this feeling of wondrousness is not actually an inner feeling, but he rather feels that it is very high and removed from him, that is, it has not fully internalized in him – nonetheless, it is not completely external to him, but is rather not truly internalized in him because the essential, wondrous light is removed from him) (in that his soul is not a ready receptacle for this, being that such a light specifically applies to very great and righteous individuals whose souls are ready receptacles for *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light, blessed is He, which not everyone merits to attain.)

In such a case, the love he experiences is in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and an arousal of yearning, like a flaming fire of desire and thirst to become subsumed in the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. This is because, were the light to actually radiate in his soul in a revealed way, his soul would then be in a state of joy and delight, for he would delight in *HaShem*-יהו"ה in a state of total adhesion to Him and His light. This is the aspect of "love of Him with delight in Him – *Ahavah B'Ta'anugim*." However, when the light does not actually radiate in a revealed way, but he only feels the great wondrousness and transcendence of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, then he will be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) to ascend and be subsumed in the Unlimited Light.

The general matter is that this is the revelation of the light of his Godly soul through the Godly light that radiates

within it, when he contemplates the greatness and transcendence of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. He will be aroused in his soul, either in a way of closeness and adhesion or in a way of ascent and desire to become subsumed etc.

However, for this Godly service to take place during prayer, whether in a way of closeness and adhesion, or in a way of ascent and desire, it must specifically be preceded by a sense of bitterness and humility. This is like the teaching,[92] "One should not stand in prayer except in a state of seriousness," which is the state of submission and humility.[93] In other words, he should be embittered about his distance, and make an honest accounting within himself of how distant he has become etc., as explained elsewhere.[94]

Through this he becomes sublimated and humble. In other words, he becomes despicable and lowly in his own eyes. It is specifically through this that afterwards, the light of his soul can illuminate his prayers in a manner of comprehension and contemplation that the Godly light will illuminate his soul in a way of closeness and in a way of fiery [passion] etc.

The more deeply he is embittered over his great distance, the greater will be the revelation of Godly light and joy in delighting in *HaShem*-יהו"ה during prayer. This is like the dictum,[95] "According to the pain is the gain." In other

[92] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 30b

[93] See later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 642.

[94] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 2 p. 331; 5656 p. 349; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 505 and on; Also see the end of the later discourse entitled "*Ein Omdeen*" 5667 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 642).

[95] Mishna Avot 5:21

words, exactly commensurate to his agony and bitterness over his great distance, will his subsequent experience of illumination and revelation of abundant Godly light be.

This is like the repentance of Rosh HaShanah and Yom Kippur. If one's repentance is deep, affecting him to the inner core of his soul because of his great distance, this bitterness in his soul will bring him to tears, until he loses all form, as if he is actually nothing.

This is the matter of the *Shevarim* and *Teruah* blasts of the Shofar which are like the sound of "moaning" or like "short, piercing cries"[96] which are like the[97] "inner, unheard voice," as explained elsewhere.[98] Specifically through this, a higher light will shine upon him with great abundance, as in the verse[99] "From the straits I called to *Ya"H*-י"ה," which is the aspect of straits and utter negation, in which one becomes actual nothingness. Specifically through this, "*Ya"H*-י"ה answered me with great expanse,"[100] in a way of great breadth and abundance.

It similarly states,[101] "Out of the depths I called to You *HaShem*-יהו"ה." In other words, the drawing down of the Name HaShem-יהו"ה anew from the inner Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, specifically comes through repentance (*Teshuvah*) from the depths of the heart with the complete nullification of one's being etc.

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[96] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 33b

[97] Zohar I 50b; 210a

[98] See the beginning of the prior discourse "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 2).

[99] Psalms 118:5

[100] Psalms 118:5 ibid.

[101] Psalms 130:1

This principle applies to our daily prayers as well. About this it states,[102] "One should not stand in prayer except in a state of seriousness." It is specifically through the bitterness and negation of self that the light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה subsequently shines upon a person during prayer.

The same holds true of Torah study. A person who studies Torah does not easily come to complete mastery of his studies, but only through great toil and effort to the point of almost despairing of ever attaining insight into its ultimate depth. He will become consternated to the depths of his soul over his tremendous unworthiness and lack of understanding, so much so, that he can literally become physically ill over it, and the like. Only then will he come to the depth of insight, with an increase of much illumination[103] and clear and brilliant explanations.[104]

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Because of this,[105] we find that whenever someone wants to ascend from a lower level to a higher level, there always must be something delineating between the two levels. Through this, his former state of being becomes negated until he forgets it completely. Just as in the descent of the light from

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[102] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 30b

[103] See Ecclesiastes 2:13

[104] See Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe 111a; Torat Chayim Chayei Sarah 134a and on; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1, p. 11b.

[105] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah She'bBrachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 515; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid. p. 73.

Above, we find that there are several levels through which the light is drawn down into revelation below, these being the "screens" (*Parsa'ot*) between the various levels in each world, in addition to the screens between one world and the other, and it is through these screens that the light is transformed, so that it can be received by the lower world, as explained elsewhere;[106] in the same way, in the ascent from below to Above, there is something that separates and acts as an intermediate, within which the lower level is negated, thus making it possible for a person to ascend.

This is likewise so of the ascent of the souls from the lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*) to the upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*). Since there is no comparison between them, there is something that acts as a partition to delineate between them. This is the[107] "River of Fire that was flowing forth from before Him" (*Nahar Dinor*) in which the souls immerse when ascending from the lower Garden of Eden to the upper Garden of Eden.

The explanation is that through this the original pleasure and grasp of the lower Garden of Eden becomes nullified and forgotten, so as not to interfere with the incomparably higher pleasure and grasp of the upper Garden of Eden, because the difference between them is like the difference between gross physicality and refined spirituality.

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[106] Torah Ohr, Lech Lecha 12a; Siddur Im DA"Ch 145a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 88 and on; 5678 p. 140 and on, and elsewhere.

[107] See Daniel 7:10; Zohar I 201a; Zohar II 211b and elsewhere; Torah Ohr Miketz 31a; 32d; Yitro 69c; Megillat Esther 96a; Likkutei Torah Beshalach 1d; Beha'alotcha 33d; Drushim L'Shemini Atzeret 84d; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid.

This is akin to the fact that souls ascending from this world of Action (*Asiyah*) to the lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*) must undergo a process of nullification to forget the pleasures of the physical body to which their soul became attached. This process cleanses the soul of any impressions of the[108] "visions of this world," for otherwise it would be incapable of absorbing the ray of Godly delight within the lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*).

Moreover, even in the physical world itself, we find that physical lusts and pleasures distract the soul from any sensitivity to Godliness during prayer. In other words, one's involvement in physicality throughout the day automatically causes distraction during prayer, even when he truly desires to pray in earnest when standing before *HaShem*-ה"והי. Because of this, he must first undergo bitterness and a sense of lowliness, as explained above on the teaching,[109] "One should not stand in prayer, except in a state of seriousness."

Likewise, any impressions of the "visions of this world" and its physical matters, even if only fleeting, distract the soul from the supernal pleasures of the Garden of Eden. This then, is the matter of the "River of Fire" (*Nahar Dinur*) that the soul must pass through before entering the Garden of Eden, even though it already has undergone purgatory and has been purged of all its evil lusts. However, the "River of Fire" referred to here, is produced from the "sweat of the Chayot angels,"[110] and is lower than the "River of Fire" that separates between the

[108] Zohar Vol. 2, p. 211b
[109] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 30b
[110] Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 13b

lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*) and the upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*).

(The root of the "River of Fire" is very lofty. It is rooted in the aspect of Splendor-*Tiferet*, as explained elsewhere.[111]) It specifically is in this higher "River of Fire" that the souls must immerse before coming before *HaShem's*-יהו"ה in the upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*). That is, their previous state [in the lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*)] must be completely nullified.

It states[112] in Sefer HaBahir[113] that there is a "Column" between the lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*) and the upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*) by which the souls ascend. This too is the matter of nullification (*Bittul*), but on a much loftier plane than the "River of Fire."

In the nullification of the "River of Fire" the souls are stripped of the physicality of their former pleasure and intellect. In contrast, the "Column" involves the process of ascent and inclusion of the souls into the higher level, before full inclusion and unity is affected. This second nullification (*Bittul*) is caused by the revelation of the light of the higher pleasure of the upper Garden of Eden, which shines upon the soul.

However, both the "River of Fire" and the "Column" are intermediary levels, except that the "River of Fire" is from the

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[111] Zohar I 23b and Derech Emet commentary of Rabbi Chaim Vital there; Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 14 section on "*Nahar*"; Ohr HaTorah Na"Ch (Vol. 1) p. 695.

[112] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah She'bBrachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 517.

[113] This is brought in various places in Chassidus in the name of Sefer HaBahir. See for instance, Likkutei Torah Beshalach 2a; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 71a and elsewhere; Torah Ohr Tetzaveh 81c. Also see Zohar I. 219a; Zohar II 211a

angle of the lower being, whose sense of somethingness becomes nullified, whereas the "Column" comes from Above and is the radiance of the Supernal light as it shines upon the soul.[114]

(Torat Chaim, in the discourse entitled[115] "*VaTeiled Adah*," explains the service of prayer along the same lines. That is, there first must be a state of lowliness and bitterness. Only then can one receive illumination of Godly light during prayer. However, it will only be in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) which is the desire to become subsumed. However, at this point, he is not yet subsumed. It is only after this that actual inclusion and unification with the Godly light occurs.

It may be said that this likewise relates to the ascent of the rectified sparks of holiness from the created realms of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) to the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).[116] This is because the rectification in the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) is accomplished through the nullification of their somethingness (*Bitul HaYesh*), which is brought about through the aspect of the restraint of evil

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[114] The Rebbe Rashab concluded stating: "Perhaps this can be enlightened by the matter of the two Kruv angels discussed in Torah Ohr, in the discourse entitled "*Mi Yitencha*" in Parshat Terumah, and the explanation of the discourse entitled "*Maggid MeReishit Acharit*" (Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5568 Vol. 1, p. 564 and on.) [The Rebbe instructed that this passage need not be copied into the text, but also instructed that such passages should also be printed but with mention that it was noted that they need not be printed. See the Sichot of Shabbat Parshat Re'eh, Shabbat Mevarchim Elul 5742; Shabbat Parshat Ha'azinu, Shabbat Shuvah (in the second gathering) 5745 (Torat Menachem, Hitva'aduyot 5742 Vol. 4 p. 2060 and on; 5745 Vol. 1 p. 73.]

[115] Torat Chayim, Bereishit 34b and on.

[116] See Torah Ohr Vayeishev 28a and on; Likkutei Torah Tzav 7d and on, and elsewhere.

(*Itkafiya*). Therefore, although this separates them from evil, they nevertheless cannot ascend to become included in the holiness and Godliness of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). That is only accomplished by illumination from Above through *HaShem*'s-יהו"ה Name of *Ma"H*-מ"ה-45 [יו"ד ה"א וא"ו ה"א] of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) which constitutes the second refinement (*Birur Sheini*) from Above to below.[117] This brings about a much greater level of nullification (*Bittul*) and the souls can then become included in the Godliness of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), which is the aspect of true nullification.)

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Now, in this, the souls undergo many ascensions from level to level, for there are numerous levels of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*). However, in general, there are three types of Gardens of Eden, corresponding to the three worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), which are very different from each other.

For example,[118] an artisan derives great pleasure in the action (*Asiyah*) of making an exquisite vessel. Nonetheless, this pleasure cannot at all compare to emotional pleasure, such as the pleasure of love or kindness. Our father Avraham, for example, derived immense pleasure in bestowing kindness, which is an emotion, the pleasure of which is much higher and

[117] See Torah Ohr Vayeishev 28a and on; Likkutei Torah Tzav 7d and on, and elsewhere.

[118] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah She'bBrachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 516 and on.

beyond comparison to the pleasure of action. This is because action is a physical pleasure, whereas love is a spiritual feeling. On the other hand, emotional pleasure cannot compare to the intellectual pleasure of understanding and comprehension, which is incomparably higher.

From these examples we understand that the lower Garden of Eden of the world of Action (*Asiyah*), cannot compare to the Garden of Eden of the world of Formation (*Yetzirah*), which is like the emotional pleasure mentioned above. How much more is this so regarding the Garden of Eden of the world of Creation (*Briyah*), which is like the pleasure of understanding and comprehension.

Now, there even is a Garden of Eden in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), which is totally beyond comparison to the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*). However, more specifically, there are myriad levels upon levels, and the service of the souls is to continuously rise from level to level.

This is because the souls are called "travelers" (*Mahalchim*).[119] Just as the souls travel from this world to the Garden of Eden, it cannot be said that once they arrive, they do not continue to "travel," but merely sit and delight in the ray of the Indwelling Presence of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, the *Shechinah*. Rather, even there, they continue the service of "traveling" to higher and higher levels of Godly pleasure. This is because the radiance is the radiance of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), and therefore, there must be constant ascension through the total

[119] See Torah Ohr Vayeishev 30a and on; Likkutei Torah Bechukotai 45a and on.

nullification of the lower level and inclusion into the higher level. This is the meaning of the statement,[120] "And the holy ones shall praise You every day," that is, they ascend from level to level every day without cessation[121] or limit.

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Now, this illumination of pleasure in the Garden of Eden is called "the beginning of Your works,"[122] because the word "beginning-*Techilah*-תחלה" indicates something higher than the aspect of the "head-*Rosh*-ראש"[123] [which also means, "beginning"]. This is like the statement,[124] "Their beginning-*Techilatan*-תחלתן is bound to their end," which is explained elsewhere[125] to mean that "the beginning-*Techilah*-תחלה" is found more at the end than at "the head-*Rosh*-ראש." This is because "the beginning-*Techilah*-תחלה" transcends "the head-*Rosh*-ראש," and is not of a comparable level altogether. This is because the "head-*Rosh*-ראש" and the "end-*Sof*-סוף" are related and can therefore be compared to each other. In contrast, the "beginning-*Techilah*-תחלה" that transcends the "head-*Rosh*-ראש," is beyond such comparison. Therefore, "the beginning-*Techilat*-תחלת of Your works" refers to that which transcends

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[120] See the liturgy of the "*Atah Kadosh*" blessing in the Amidah prayer.

[121] Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 54a

[122] See Likkutei Torah, Shmini Atzeret ibid.; Ohr HaTorah, Bereishit Vol. 3, p. 530a; Drushim L'Shemini Atzeret p. 1,808.

[123] See what is noted in the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5736 ibid. translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 1.

[124] Sefer Yetzirah 1:7

[125] Sefer HaMaamarim 5630, p. 320; 5632 Vol. 1, p. 107; Vol. 2, p 367; 5633 Vol. 1, p. 116; 5648 p. 215 and on; 5653, p. 244; 5658 p. 27; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vehayah Ki Tavo*" 5666 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 347 and on).

the world of Action (*Asiyah*), which in general, includes all three worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*).

Similarly, even the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) may be considered to be an action, because as it relates to the general worlds that precede it, the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is called "the Man of Action" (*Adam d'Asiyah*) as known.[126] Thus, the Garden of Eden of each world is called "The beginning (*Techilat*-תחלת) of Your works," because it refers to the radiance of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) as discussed above, which is beyond relationship to worlds.

However, it still is called "The beginning of Your works-*Techilat Ma'asecha*-תחלת מעשיך," because although the radiance is from the aspect of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), it nevertheless manifests within the chaining down of the worlds, for as explained before, the revelation of the Garden of Eden is the aspect of Understanding-*Binah*, which is the primary matter of the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut)*. It is the radiance of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and pleasure (*Taanug*), which vest within Understanding-*Binah*. This is because it only is a glimmer and can therefore vest within the various levels of the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*). It thus is called "The beginning of Your works-*Techilat Ma'asecha*- תחלת מעשיך," though it is a level that is separately transcendent from the world.

[126] See Likkutei Torah Masei 95a; Maamarei Admor HaZaken Inyanim p. 1 and on; Ohr HaTorah Inyanim p. 77 and on. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 18.

Now the reason we say that "this day" of Rosh HaShanah is "the beginning of Your works" is because it is this aspect of the revelation of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and pleasure that the souls of the Jewish people draw down into the Garden of Eden. This is the ray that is drawn down through their Torah learning and their service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה etc.,[127] (and in general, the Garden of Eden is the reward for those souls who invested themselves in fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*). In other words, "this day" of Rosh HaShanah, which is the day that Adam, the first man was created, is "The beginning of Your works."[128]

[127] See the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5736 ibid. translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 1, that there are two aspects in this, the drawing forth of the radiance of Eden, and the drawing forth of the essence of Eden.

[128] As will be further explained in the next discourse (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 28); Also see the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5736, ibid. translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 1.

Discourse 3

"*Shuvah Yisroel… -*
Return, O' Israel…"

Delivered on Shabbat Shuvah, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "Return, O' Israel, until *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God, for you have stumbled etc." Now, we must understand the meaning of the words, "until-*Ad*-עד *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God." Should not the verse have said "to *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God"? To understand this, we must begin with the explanation given above[3] about the service of the souls in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*).

Now, it was explained that they are like "travelers" (*Mahalchim*), in that they undergo many ascensions from one level to the next. Moreover, being that the pleasure of the Garden of Eden emanates from the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), blessed is He, therefore these ascensions are not gradual and incremental, but the ascents from level to level are in a way of "traveling" (*Hiluch*), such that the first state of consciousness

[1] This discourse is based in the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah She'bBrachah Rishonah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 520 and on; Discourse entitled "*Vayechulu HaShamayim*" in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit (Vol. 3) p. 505b; Discourse entitled "*Lehavin Parsha Rishona d'Kriyat Shema*" in Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 76a and on, as cited in later notes.

[2] Hosea 14:2

[3] In the previous discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 17 and on).

must be negated before the next state of consciousness can be reached.

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Now, all these ascents are relative to the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*), which only constitutes a mere glimmer or ray of the simple essential pleasure drawn by the above-mentioned River (*Nahar*) within which there are levels beyond count, as explained above. On the other hand,[4] Eden itself has never been seen, for even in the many ascents of the souls in the Garden of Eden, no eye has ever beheld Eden itself. Rather, this will specifically be revealed in the coming future, about which the verse states,[5] "Your Master shall no longer hide Himself and your eyes will see your Master."

The essential pleasure will then be revealed; that is, the matter of "the delight of the King in Himself," as it is in the transcendent Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) - that which the souls currently "travel" and ascend to, but have no grasp of etc. Rather, all their many ascensions are only within the aspect of the ray of the essential pleasure, as discussed before.

Albeit there is an infinite aspect to this ray and therefore the levels of ascent within it are beyond count, as explained above. (Because of this, with each new ascent, the lower state of consciousness must be negated before rising to the higher state of consciousness. This is because each state of

[4] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid.
[5] Isaiah 30:20

consciousness is incomparably higher than the level below it, as explained before.)

Nevertheless, despite all the ascents, the soul never actually reaches the essential exaltedness of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) in a way of essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*). On the contrary, the higher the ascent, the more wondrously unattainable and ungraspable He becomes. This is because, since there is no measure to the exaltedness of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), His simple pleasure is likewise Unlimited.

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This explanation of the matter[6] is as elucidated elsewhere[7] about the words,[8] "Praised and glorified be His Great Name forever and ever-*Adei Ad*-עדי עד." That is, there are two meanings to the words "*Adei Ad*-עדי עד." The first is that it is a term of eternality,[9] that is, "forever and ever." The second is that it is a term that denotes separation, that is, "up until" as in the Talmudic statement,[10] "Until here-*Ad kan*-עד כאן is the border of the Shabbat boundary (*Techum*)." Now, both meanings are true, for as known,[11] "His Great Name-*Shmo*

[6] Regarding this section see the discourse entitled "*Mah Yafeet*" 5691 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 p. 251 and on); Also see the second discourse entitled "*Shuvah Yisroel*" 5737 in Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 96 and on (in earlier editions see Vol. 4 p. 13 and on).

[7] See Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 456d and on; Also see Likkutei Torah Pekudei 5a; 7b and on; Torat Chayim ibid. p. 444c; 447c; Ohr HaTorah Na"Ch (Vol. 1) p. 210.

[8] See the liturgy of the "*Baruch SheAmar*" in the morning prayers.

[9] As in "forever and ever He shall be king-*L'Adei Ad Yimloch*-לעדי עד ימלוך" (Torat Chayim ibid. p. 456d).

[10] Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 58b

[11] See Torah Ohr Shemot 49d and on, and elsewhere.

HaGadol-שמו הגדול" refers to the aspect of His Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) which is limitless (*Bli Gvul*) on whatever level it is.

This is so, whether it refers to His Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) as it transcends the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) or whether it refers to His Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) as it precedes the first restraint (*Tzimtzum*), which is the absolutely unlimited aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. In both aspects the meaning of the words "*Adei Ad*-עדי עד" is that of eternality. In other words, there is no measure whatsoever that is appropriate to praise and glorify the transcendence of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He.

For, although there indeed can be praises and glorifications that are justifiably limited, this is only appropriate when the one being praised is limited, whether limited in wisdom or limited in greatness etc. Therefore, when the limit of his greatness is reached, the praise of him also ceases, simply because he cannot truthfully be praised beyond this point.

However, about the transcendence of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, who truly and absolutely is beyond limitation or measure, the praises and glorifications appropriate to Him likewise are unlimited and immeasurable. This then, explains the ascensions of the souls in the Garden of Eden, which, as discussed before, are limitless and beyond count, being that *HaShem*-יהו"ה Himself, blessed is He, is utterly Unlimited (*Ein Sof*).

However,[12] specifically because of this, we come to the second meaning of the word "*Ad*-עד," which is a term that denotes separation, that is, it means "until here-*Ad Kan*-עד כאן" and no further. The reason for this separateness is because even the greatest praises and glorifications are utterly inadequate to even touch upon *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Essential Self whatsoever.

This is because two matters are involved here,[13] "until and including" (*Ad v'Ad Bichlal*-עד ועד בכלל) and "until, but not including" (*Ad V'Lo Ad Bichlal*-עד ולא עד בכלל). The meaning of "until and including" is that from one level of consciousness, a person can reach the next level of consciousness. On the other hand, the meaning of "until, but not including" is that from the first level of consciousness, a person can never reach the next level of consciousness, since they altogether are not comparable to each other.

This then, is the meaning of separateness. In other words, even if one were to reach the loftiest of levels, nonetheless, he would only be reaching "until, and not including", meaning that he could never reach the true light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה.[14] It can be said that this principle also applies to the ray itself [that is revealed in the Garden of Eden]. Here too, the separateness of "until, but not including" applies. That is, even when the soul ascends to a given level of consciousness,

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[12] Regarding the coming section see Torat Chayim ibid. p. 457a and on.

[13] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 26b; See Ohr HaTorah ibid.

[14] See Ohr HaTorah ibid, that the matter of "until and including" is the aspect of *Arich Anpin* which is called the root of the emanations, and is included amongst the ten *Sefirot*, whereas "until, but not including" is the aspect of *Atik Yomin* which is the lowest level of the Emanator. Also see Likkutei Torah Pekudei ibid. 7c.

that level cannot function as a springboard to the next level, being that the two are incomparable.

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The explanation is that when a light is limited in essence, its levels are also limited and therefore comparable to each other. For example, generally, the revelations of light within the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) are limited lights, and although there are countless levels in this, they nevertheless all relate to each other. This is because light as a whole, and therefore all its levels are limited. This being the case, it applies to say that from the lower level of consciousness one could arrive at the higher level of consciousness.

This is analogous to the development of one's intellect, in that one first learns basic concepts and gradually advances to understanding greater and greater concepts. This specifically is so regarding related concepts, in which the lower concept is necessary to arrive at the higher concept. Even within a single concept, a person first grasps the concept externally, through which he then delves deeper into it, until he attains greater and greater depths of the same concept. Generally, our knowledge of higher concepts comes by first grasping lower concepts. Through this we ascend to higher and higher gradations of comprehension and understanding.

This is the meaning of Rambam's statement in "Laws of the Foundations of the Torah" (chapter three, Halacha nine)[15]

[15] Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Yesodei HaTorah 3:9

about the stars and planets, that "they have self-awareness and awareness of the angels above them etc." The explanation of the Mefaresh commentary on the Rambam, is that "first they know and recognize themselves and then they recognize their [angelic] cause." In other words, through recognition of themselves, they come to recognize their cause. (Now, in regard to their recognition of the Holy One, blessed is He; [this does not mean that they have actual recognition of Him]. Rather, they merely recognize that there is a Primal Cause whose existence is independent and intrinsic unto Himself, as Rambam explains in chapter two (Halacha eight)[16] about the knowledge of the angels.) This kind of grasp reflects the principle of "until and including," being that from the first level of consciousness one comes to grasp a higher level of consciousness.)

However, the above specifically relates to the matter of cause and effect (*Eela V'Alool*) in which there is a relation between the two. Such is not the case regarding the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) of *HaShem*-הוי"ה, which transcends the chaining down of cause and effect, although here too, there are levels, for as explained before,[17] every aspect of light contains countless levels.

Moreover, this even applies to the Unlimited Light that encompasses all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*). As explained elsewhere,[18] even the level of encompassing circles-*Igullim* has

[16] Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Yesodei HaTorah 2:8

[17] In the previous discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 18).

[18] Sefer HaMaamarim 5657, p. 238 and on; Also see *Hemshech* 5672, Vol. 1, p. 150 and on; p. 158 and on.

higher and lower levels. However, here, the levels are not comparable to each other. (As explained elsewhere,[19] because of this, the "travel" and ascent within the levels of the Unlimited Light can only be accomplished specifically by a "traveler" (*Mahalech*) who is not bound by limitations, **specifically** because the levels are not comparable to each other. This is the difference between "those who stand-*Omdim*-עומדים"[20] and "those who travel- *Mahalchim*-מהלכים,"[21] in that for both there is a matter of "traveling," as explained elsewhere.[22])

In other words, in this, though a person may know and grasp one level, his knowledge cannot aid him in attaining or grasping the next level. Moreover, he is utterly distant from it because it is separate in relation [to him]. On the contrary, only when his previous grasp is utterly nullified will he come to the higher level of understanding, as explained above. Were he to gain the higher level of understanding through the first level, then the first level would necessarily remain intact, since the higher level was specifically reached through the lower level.

For example, from the external understanding of a concept one arrives at its inner understanding. Therefore, to attain the inner understanding, one's external understanding must be complete. In other words, he must know it thoroughly. Therefore, when he then delves deeper into it with the precision of his external understanding, he can then come to an understanding of its inner depth.

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[19] Sefer HaMaamarim 5654, p. 220; p. 224 and on

[20] See Zachariyah 3:7 and the commentaries there. [This refers to angels.]

[21] Zachariyah 3:7 ibid. [This refers to souls.]

[22] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5659, p. 24; 5660, p. 107 and on; 5671, p. 69 and on, and elsewhere.

However, here [on the level of "until, but not including" the exact opposite phenomenon must take place; that is], to reach the next level of understanding there must be a complete and total nullification of his previous understanding. This is because here, the various levels of depth cannot compare to each other and therefore, one cannot come to the higher level by means of the lower level. On the contrary, his current understanding only distracts and confuses him, [thus obstructing him from understanding the deeper level]. Therefore, this can only be accomplished by the utter negation of his previous understanding.

Now, a person comes to the higher level through the nullification of the lower level, because it is specifically this that prepares him to be a vessel to receive the revelation of the higher light. This is like the nullification brought about through bitterness and humility before prayer. As discussed above, this brings about the complete loss of awareness of self in a person, and it is specifically this loss of awareness of self that causes *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godly light to shine upon him during prayer.

Likewise, here, in our case, a person can only ascend to the higher level of consciousness of Godliness through complete non-awareness of self. This reflects the principle of "until, but not including," because no matter what level of consciousness he achieves, he still will be utterly distant from the higher level that transcends it.

Moreover, the principle of "until, but not including" is all the more pertinent relative to the true transcendence of the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, because even if a person were to attain the loftiest of levels, he still would be

utterly distant from the aspect of *HaShem's*-ה"והי true Unlimited light (*Ohr Ein Sof*).

That is, regarding limited states of revelation, the principle of "until and including" applies, being that a person can reach the higher level through his grasp of the lower level. However, in regard to *HaShem's*-ה"והי Essential Self, the principle of "until, but **not** including" applies, because His Essential Self is always beyond one's ability to grasp.

On the contrary, the higher he ascends, the more astoundingly distant His Essential Self becomes for him. In other words, the higher his grasp of the **ray** of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) of *HaShem*-ה"והי, the greater will his realization be of the utterly awesome gap between himself and the reality of *HaShem*-ה"והי, and he will increasingly realize that *HaShem*-ה"והי is utterly beyond grasp.

However,[23] only a person who greatly toils in the knowledge of the lofty levels within the limitless light of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-ה"והי, blessed is He, can come to truly realize and appreciate how the true reality of His Essential Self is not within the category of being graspable. This is because one who has not toiled in these matters does not know how He is not within the category of knowledge (but only accepts it as an article of faith, which is not knowledge), and only one who has toiled in this truly knows.

[23] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1 p. 116; 5685 p. 69 and on; 5708 p. 70 and elsewhere.

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Now, this is why the higher the souls of the Garden of Eden ascend in the ray of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*), the more awesome, exalted and transcendent the true reality of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Essential Self becomes for them. Their comprehension therefore comes to greater and greater states of nullification (*Bitul*). In other words, relative to the true reality of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Essential Self, their grasp becomes null and void.

(Moreover, this is besides the nullification of grasp brought about by the level they have attained. For as known,[24] the higher the level, the more refined and stripped of physicality the comprehension becomes, in that it becomes more and more spiritual and intangible. Therefore, with the ascension of the supernal levels of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*), all knowledge and grasp becomes stripped of physical reference, so much so, that ultimately, it cannot even be defined as "comprehension" altogether. Therefore, the ascension to higher levels of the [ray of the] Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is in a way that one's comprehension is nullified; that is, the higher the ascension, the greater the nullification.)

(Only in the coming future will there be a revelation of the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in a manner of grasp, as stated about Moshiach,[25] "Behold, my servant will become wise; he will be exalted and high and exceedingly lofty," for in

[24] See *Hemshech* 5672, Vol. 1, p. 400 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5686, p. 348 and on; 5691 p. 235 and on.

[25] Isaiah 52:13

that time, understanding will be on the highest of levels. It similarly states,[26] "(Only in this can a person boast), that he contemplates and knows Me," or as it states in the Rosh HaShanah prayers, "Every effect shall know that You caused it." For, at that time, our knowledge and grasp will be of the transcendent exaltedness of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, blessed is He.)

This then,[27] is the meaning of[28] "no eye has seen it." In other words, presently, even in the ascents of the loftiest souls, such as the souls of our forefathers [Avraham, Yitzchak and Yaakov] or our teacher Moshe, of blessed memory; with all their limitless ascents beyond count, to the loftiest spiritual heights in the ray of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-ה"והי (*Ohr Ein Sof*), nonetheless, they can never reach the aspect of the transcendent exaltedness of His Essential Self. Hence, "no eye has seen it, God, aside for You," since,[29] "no one knows Him, except Himself alone." However, in the coming world, with the resurrection of the dead, the reality of His Essential Self will become openly revealed to the souls, even as they reside within bodies. About this the verse continues, "He does for those who await Him."

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[26] Jeremiah 9:23

[27] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid. p. 521.

[28] Isaiah 64:3

[29] Zohar III 288a (Idra Zuta); Also see 129b (Idra Rabba); 140b; 159a

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Now, attaining the aspect of the essential pleasure is specifically accomplished through fulfilling the physical *mitzvot*. As our sages of blessed memory stated,[30] "Every Jew has a share in the coming world, as it states,[31] 'Your people are all righteous *Tzaddikim*,'" which specifically refers to fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality. Because of this, they all have a share in the coming world, that is, in the aspect of the essential pleasure etc.

The explanation is that[32] as stated,[33] "The end action arose first in thought." From this we understand that there is an aspect of beginning and end, which are called the "head-*Rosh*-ראש" and "end-*Sof*-סוף," and that the end action arose at the beginning of the thought. This is because thought has two levels. "The beginning of thought" is called "the head-*Rosh*-ראש of thought," and the end of thought is called "the end-*Sof*-סוף."

The explanation is that when it arose in His simple desire to emanate and create etc., this is called the beginning of thought. In man below, this is analogous to when it arises in a person's desire to do something. This first arousal of his desire is called "the head of thought." On the other hand, the "end of thought" is when he has already determined **in thought** exactly

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[30] Mishnah Sanhedrin 10:1 (Perek Chelek)

[31] Isaiah 60:21

[32] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Parsha Rishona d'Kriyat Shema*" in Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 76a and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 1 p. 208 and on; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema, Ch. 38 and on (41c and on).

[33] See the liturgical hymn "*Lecha Dodi*" in the Friday night prayers.

what he will bring out into revealed actuality. The beginning of thought and the end of thought relate to each other, because that which was determined at the end of thought, is exactly what arose at the beginning of thought.

The analogue of how it is Above in Godliness may now be understood. Namely, the aspect of *Zeir Anpin* of the world of *Atzilut* (Emanation) is called "the end of thought" because it is the source and root for the actualization of "creation out of nothing" in the three worlds of Creation, Formation, and Actualization (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*). It therefore is the end (or last) level of thought. On the other hand, when it arose in His simple will for the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) to come into being, that was the beginning of thought. This thought came to completion in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) where the *Sefirot* came into revelation. Thus, the seven *Sefirot* of *Zeir Anpin*, that is, Magnanimity-*Gedulah*, Might-*Gevurah*, Splendor-*Tiferet* etc. are called the "seven days of construction" in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).[34]

However,[35] the statement, "the end action arose first in thought," refers to the actualization itself, which follows thought. It cannot be said that the actualization itself arose in thought, because what arose in thought was only the thought that there should be actualization. Rather, the meaning of "the end action arose first in thought" is that it arose even before the

[34] See Tanya, Ch. 3 (7a); Likkutei Sichot Vol. 7 p. 72; Maarei Mekomot Hagahot vHa'arot Ktzarot to Tanya ibid. cites to Me'orei Ohr, Ot Yod, Section 8; Ot Beit, Section 10.

[35] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 74; 5684 p. 122 and on.

"beginning of thought." It is only the end (or last) level of thought itself that arose in the beginning of thought, for the beginning of the desire was that there should be a chaining down of worlds and this was determined and finalized at the end of thought with the emanation of the ten *Sefirot* of *Zeir Anpin* of Emanation (*Atzilut*), which is the end of the chaining down that allows for the existence of the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Actualization (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*). However,[36] the aspect of the **end action itself** is what arose even before the "beginning of thought." This is what brought about an arousal of the desire in the first place.

This is as our sages of blessed memory stated,[37] "With whom did He consult? With the souls of the righteous *Tzaddikim*." That is, "With whom did He consult" is in reference to the first arousal of the desire that arose in His will to emanate and create, this being brought about by "the souls of the righteous *Tzaddikim*." In other words, it arose in His thought that there would be souls of a righteous people who would manifest within bodies to fulfill Torah and *mitzvot* in actuality, and because of this, the desire to emanate etc. arose in His will.

This then, is the meaning of the statement, "The end action arose first in thought." That is, it is the fulfillment of the Torah and *mitzvot*, **in actuality**, that arose first in thought, even before the arousal of the desire for the entire chaining down of the worlds, and it was for this end that there was an arousal of desire for worlds in the first place.

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[36] Regarding the coming section, see Siddur Im Da"Ch ibid. p. 76b and on.
[37] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 8:7

In other words, the ultimate intention that arose in the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which transcends the above-mentioned aspects of thought and will, is the fulfillment of Torah and *mitzvot* in actuality. It is for this reason that His will was then aroused. Hence, it is through the fulfillment of Torah and *mitzvot*, **in actuality**, that the essential pleasure of His Essential Self is drawn forth, because it is the inner essential intent in the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He.

It is for this reason that about the actual fulfillment of the *mitzvot* it states,[38] "It brings Me satisfaction of spirit that I spoke and My will was actualized." This is because *HaShem's*-יהו"ה ultimate intention is the actualization of Torah and *mitzvot* and therefore, this is what "brings Me satisfaction of spirit." It is specifically this that draws down the aspect of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה simple essential pleasure.

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Based on this we can understand why on Rosh HaShanah we say,[39] "This day is the beginning of Your works etc." At first glance, why is this so? Was not the creation of world actually on the twenty-fifth of Elul?[40] Why then is Rosh HaShanah called, "the beginning of Your works?" However, the explanation is that "the beginning of your works" refers to

[38] Torat Kohanim and Rashi to Leviticus 1:9; Sifri and Rashi to Numbers 28:8

[39] In the *Zichronot* prayer of Musaf (from Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 27a).

[40] Midrash Vayikra Rabbah 29:1; Pirke D'Rabbi Elazar Ch. 8; Tosefot entitled "*L'Tekufot*" to Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 8a; Rabbeinu Nissim to Talmud Bavli Rosh HaShanah 16a

HaShem's-יהו"ה ultimate intent, which is like "the end action that arose first in thought," mentioned above.

This specifically applies to Rosh HaShanah, the day that Adam, the first man, was created. Only then did the original intent that arose in the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One become fulfilled, because that is when the actual performance of Torah and *mitzvot* became applicable. It is because of this that Rosh HaShanah is called "the beginning of Your works," because whatever was created before it, did not truly constitute "the beginning of Your works" and only related to the "beginning and end of thought." This is as stated,[41] "The entire world was created only to command this one." Rather, the true "beginning of Your works," which even transcends the beginning of thought, specifically applies to the performance of the *mitzvot*, which only became applicable with the creation of man. Because of this, Rosh HaShanah is called "the beginning of Your works."

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To further explain,[42] let us examine the verse,[43] "I have seen a conclusion to every end (*L'chol Tichlah Ra'itee Ketz*- לכל תכלה ראיתי קץ), but Your commandment is exceedingly broad." Rashi explains this to mean, "Everything that has an end, has a conclusion and limit." In other words, he translates "*Tichlah*-

[41] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 6b

[42] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Vayechulu*" in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit (Vol. 3) p. 505b ibid.; Also see Ohr HaTorah to Tehillim (Yahel Ohr) p. 471.

[43] Psalms 119:96

תכלה" to mean "conclusion-*Siyum*-סיום." However, this explanation is not readily understood, for if this is so, the word "end-*Tichlah*-תכלה" has the same meaning as the word "conclusion-*Keitz*-קץ." What then, is the meaning of, "I have seen a conclusion-*Keitz*-קץ to every end-*Tichlah*-תכלה?"

In Talmud (Eruvin 21a) Rashi explains the same verse, "I have seen a conclusion to every end," to mean that "at the end of everything, there is a limit to its being, 'but Your commandment is exceedingly broad,' and there is no end to its limit." According to this, we can say that the word "end-*Tichlah*-תכלה" is analogous to the end of the world, in that it has a limit to its being and will end. In other words, though currently, we are in the middle of the world, nevertheless, since it is limited, it is understood that it has an end. This is like what Metzudat David explains that, "About anything that is limited, it can be seen in the mind's eye that it has an end."[44]

However, on the words, "to every end-*Tichlah*-תכלה," Rabbi Avraham Ibn Ezra explained, "In our language the word '*Keitz*-קץ' can either mean 'beginning' or 'end,' as in the verse,[45] 'at its two extremities-*ketzotav*-**קצו**תיו.'" Accordingly, since the beginning is also called "*Keitz*-קץ," and "*Tichlah*-תכלה" and "*Keitz*-קץ" have the same meaning, therefore the meaning of the verse is that whatever has a beginning (*Tichlah*-תכלה) must have an end (*Keitz*-קץ).

However, it seems more fitting to interpret it the other way around; that "*Tichlah*-תכלה" here means "end" whereas "I

[44] Meaning that one sees its end before it comes about in actuality (see Ohr HaTorah Bereishit ibid.)

[45] Exodus 25:19; 39:4

have seen a *Keitz*-קץ" means "beginning," that is, the first extremity. The meaning would therefore be, "Whatever has a conclusion must have a beginning." This is because, in practice, the word "*Tichlah*-תכלה" generally is used to mean "end," whereas the word "*Keitz*-קץ" can also mean "beginning." This is like the statement,[46] "He exists Above with no beginning (*Keitz*-קץ) and below without conclusion (*Tachlit*-תכלית)." Similarly, in Talmud Bavli (Niddah 58b) it states, "My words have no *Keitz*-קץ and the words of my companions have no end-*Sof*-סוף." Here, the meaning of "*Keitz*-קץ" is "beginning," as understood from the commentary of Maharsha.

According to these commentaries we may say that the verse, "To every end-*Tichlah*-תכלה I have seen a beginning-*Keitz*-קץ" refers to revelations within the chaining down of the worlds; that they are within measure and limit. This is because the revelations within the chaining down of the worlds are lights (*Orot*) vested in vessels (*Keilim*), and by definition, vessels (*Keilim*) are limited. For example, the vessel of Wisdom-*Chochmah* or the vessel of Kindness-*Chessed* etc., draw down limited revelation.

Now, in actuality, the vessels of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) are drawn down until the end of the world of Actualization (*Asiyah*), for as known,[47] the thirty vessels of *Zeir Anpin* and *Nukvah* become the *Neshamah, Ruach* and *Nefesh* of the worlds of Creation, Formation and Actualization (*Briyah,*

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[46] Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 57; Zohar Chadash Yitro 34c; Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 19

[47] Etz Chayim, Shaar 44 (Shaar HaShemot) Ch. 1-2; Tanya Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 20 (130a); Sefer HaMaamarim 5650 p. 285 and on; 5662 p. 228 and on; 5704 p. 35 and on.

Yetzirah, *Asiyah*) respectively. Nevertheless, what is drawn down to the world of Creation (*Briyah*) is only the inner aspect of the vessels. (Actually, it only is the inner aspect of the externality of the vessels, as discussed in Tanya, Kuntres Acharon, in the section entitled, "To understand what is written in Pri Etz Chaim."[48]). Similarly, only the intermediate aspect of the vessels is drawn down to the world of Formation (*Atzilut*) etc.

In general, these come down with measure and limit, as in the statement,[49] "The measure of the stature of He who formed creation etc.," which refers to the aspect of the vessels (*Keilim*) of *Zeir Anpin*. Similarly, in Avodat HaKodesh[50] it states about the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, that just as He has unlimited power, He likewise has the power to limit and the first limitations that came from Him were the vessels of the ten *Sefirot* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

Similarly, the lights too are measured and limited, for as known, the entire drawing down of the Line-*Kav* is to bring about the matter of limitation and measure, as stated in Torah Ohr in the discourse entitled, "*Yaviyu Levush Malchut*."[51] The entire purpose of the *Kav* (line) is to bring about the matter of

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[48] Tanya, Kuntres Acharon p. 156a and on.

[49] See Shiur Komah (printed with Sefer Heichalot in Sefer Merkavah Shlomo (Yerushalayim 5684); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 4 (Shaar Atzmut v'Keilim) Ch. 1; Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A) Ch. 2; Shaar 44 (Shaar HaShemot) Ch. 7; Mikdash Melech to Zohar II 56a; Shnei Luchot HaBrit 325b and on; Also see the citations in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Bamidbar Vol. 1 p. 304; Devarim Vol. 3 p. 819.

[50] Avodat HaKodesh, Part 1, Ch. 8

[51] Torah Ohr Megillat Esther 92c; Also see the later discourse entitled "*HaChodesh*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 215); Discourse entitled "*Adam Ki Yakriv*" (p. 252 and on); Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 14-15, and elsewhere.

up and down, as stated in Etz Chayim.[52] In other words, wherever there is a greater degree of illumination and revelation along the Line-*Kav*, it is considered to be higher, whereas wherever there is less illumination and revelation, it is considered to be lower.

An example is the difference of illumination in the worlds that are higher than the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), compared to the illumination in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) itself. For example, in Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*), the light of the Line-*Kav* is completely revealed, so much so, that all its levels are in a state of actual inclusion and unity, and though it states about this level that,[53] "He gazes and glances to the end of all generations," nevertheless,[54] "He beholds them all in a single glance," in an all-inclusive way, so that they exist as a single essence, as explained elsewhere.[55] This is because the revelation of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) literally radiates there.

Higher than this, at the very beginning of the Line-*Kav*, the radiance is even more refined, as stated in Etz Chayim that[56] "there is a level similar to The Ancient One-*Atik* above the skull

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[52] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher) Anaf 2; Mevo She'arim, Shaar 1, Ch. 2; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Eileh Toldot No'ach*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 67 and on).

[53] See the liturgy of the *Zichronot* blessing of Musaf prayer on Rosh HaShanah.

[54] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 18a and Chiddushei Aggadot of the Maharsha there

[55] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 328 and on; 5663 Vol. 2 p. 189; 5664 p. 41; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Adam Ki Yihiyeh*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 265 and on); discourse entitled "*uSefartem Lachem*" (p. 347 and on), and elsewhere. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe translated as The Gate of Unity Ch. 13 ibid.

[56] Etz Chayim, Shaar 9 (Shaar Shevirat HaKeilim) Ch. 6; Zohar HaRakiya to Zohar I 15a, cited in Likkutei Torah Hosafot to Vayikra 51d; Masei 95b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5644 p. 347; 5664 p. 162 and elsewhere.

(*Galgalta*) of Primordial Man-*Adam Kadmon.*" In other words, it even is beyond comparison to the aspect of Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*), even though there literally is a revelation of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) in Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*).

In contrast, the level of *Akudim* is less radiant, because there are ten lights there,[57] as well as an aspect of vessels (*Keilim*), as stated in Etz Chayim[58] that the revelation of vessels (*Keilim*) first begins in *Akudim*, and as known,[59] the revelation of vessels (*Keilim*) results from the constriction of the light (*Tzimtzum)* and the lack of revelation. Nevertheless, even in *Akudim*, the Unlimited Light was revealed, and because of this, its ten lights were bound up and included in a single vessel.[60]

Then, with the revelation of the *Sefirot* of *Nekudim*, though there was abundant light in them, they nevertheless were ten lights in ten vessels.[61] This matter is even truer of the world of Repair (*Tikkun*), in which there is diminished light (*Ohr*) in an abundance of vessels (*Keilim*),[62] for as known, the aspect of vessels (*Keilim*) primarily takes place in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). Because of this, in the scheme of the

[57] Etz Chaim, Shaar 6 (Shaar HaAkudim) Ch. 1; Shaar 7 (Shaar Mati v'Lo Mati) Ch. 1

[58] Etz Chaim, Shaar 6, Ch. 1 ibid.; Shaar 7, Ch. 1 ibid.

[59] Etz Chaim, Shaar 7 ibid., Ch. 3; Sefer HaMaamarim 5661 p. 176; 5670 p. 30 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1, p. 13; 5689 p. 253 and on; 5692 p. 66; 5704 p. 41; 5710 p. 59 and on.

[60] Etz Chaim, Shaar 6, Ch. 1 ibid.; Shaar 7, Ch. 1 ibid.

[61] Etz Chaim, Shaar 11 (Shaar HaMelachim), Ch. 1

[62] Etz Chaim, Shaar 10 (Shaar HaTikkun), Ch. 5

"general worlds" (*Olamot d'Klallut*), the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is called the world of Actualization (*Asiyah*).[63]

The same principle applies in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) relative to its particular *Sefirot*. For example, there is greater illumination of the Unlimited light in Wisdom-*Chochmah* than in Understanding-*Binah*, as stated in Etz Chayim[64] that the Unlimited light radiates in the Crown-*Keter* and Wisdom-*Chochmah* in a way of closeness, compared to Understanding-*Binah*, which in comparison, is in a way of distance.

Obviously,[65] the distance referred to here is not spatial difference, Heaven forbid to think so, but is rather that the illumination in Wisdom-*Chochmah* is greater and more revealed. This is discussed at length in the great discourse entitled "*V'Kachah*" of the year 5637.[66]

It is the Line-*Kav* that gives measure to the manner of revelation on each level, all the way from the infinite worlds to the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), including each *Sefirah* in particular. As known, and as discussed elsewhere, every *Sefirah* has lines and conduits specific to it, which give measure to how the light will be revealed in that *Sefirah* in particular.[67]

Now, generally speaking, the revelation of the Line-*Kav* concludes in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).[68] However, as

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[63] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 17-18, and elsewhere.

[64] Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A), Ch. 13

[65] Sefer HaMaamarim 5626, p. 347 and on; 5650 p. 282 and on

[66] Chapter 29 and on (p. 39 and on); Also see *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 74.

[67] See Mevo She'arim ibid., Shaar 1, Ch. 2; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 19b and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Eileh Toldot Noach*" ibid. (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 68 and on); *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 61 and on.

[68] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 47 (Shaar Seder ABY"A) Ch. 1

known,[69] the revelation of the Line-*Kav* within the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is actually only a glimmer of it, because essentially, the Line-*Kav* really only radiates in the infinite worlds, which transcend the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). Only a glimmer of the Line-*Kav* actually reaches the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and ends in Kingship-*Malchut* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

Therefore, the statement[70] that "the Line-*Kav* pierces the screen between the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) and penetrates into the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), as it does in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*),[71] only occurs through the vessels (*Keilim*) of Kingship-*Malchut* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), however, it does not truly radiate within the worlds of Creation, Formation and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) themselves.[72]

Now, it similarly states that the Line-*Kav* itself manifests within the upright aspect (*Yosher*) of Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*) and ends in the world of Actualization (*Asiyah*).[73] However, in general, regarding the level of *Adam Kadmon*; even those aspects that are drawn to the worlds, are

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[69] See Derech Mitzvotecha 37a; 119b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5669 p. 161; Also see Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 20 (131b).

[70] Tanya, Igeret HaKodesh, Epistle 20 (131b); Etz Chaim, Shaar 3, Ch. 1

[71] In the original Hebrew text this is reversed, and for understandability is thus translated in accordance with *Hemshech* 5666, p. 30, note 65.

[72] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 147; 5665, p. 190 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 and Sefer HaMaamarim 5677 ibid. Also see the later discourse entitled "*Koh… Eem Lo Breetee*" 5667 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 557).

[73] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 2 (Shaar Hishtalshelut Yod Sefirot Derech Iggulim) end of Anaf 2; Shaar 43 (Shaar Tziyur Olamot ABY"A), Hakdamah, and elsewhere; Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 237 and on.

nevertheless removed from the worlds and do not radiate in a revealed manner within them, as explained elsewhere.[74] This is why the worlds have a sense of tangible existence as a separate "something" (*Yesh*), because if there would be illumination from Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*), the worlds would be utterly nullified out of existence.

Rather, though the aspect of *Adam Kadmon* is drawn to the worlds, it nevertheless remains hidden from them. Hence, though in reality, all beings are indeed utterly nullified before *HaShem*-יהו"ה because of the sublimation that results from the aspect of *Adam Kadmon,* as it states,[75] "All statures bow before You," (perhaps due to the level of the Circles-*Iggulim* of *Adam Kadmon*), nonetheless, this is not felt by the creations. Whatever felt nullification they may have, is by choice, rather than by imposition from Above, as explained elsewhere.[76] It therefore is understood that the aspect of the Line-*Kav* does not radiate directly in the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), but only a glimmer or a glimmer of a glimmer of it illuminates them.[77]

We therefore find that in its entirety, the revelation of the Line-*Kav* has a limit, in that its light comes to a conclusion, as stated above. We therefore are forced to say that it also has

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[74] See Likkutei Torah, Tazria 21c; Siddur Im DA"Ch 141c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 326; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek Vol. 1 p. 260; Sefer HaMaamarim 5652 p. 43 and on.

[75] See the liturgy of the *Nishmat Kol Chai* prayer; Torat Chaim Bereishit 30a; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 112; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Adam Ki Yihiyeh*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 269), and elsewhere.

[76] Sefer HaMaamarim 5652, p. 51; 5657 p. 246; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Adam Ki Yihiyeh*" ibid.

[77] See Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 20 ibid. Also see Likkutei Torah Re'eh 20d; Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 321; 324; 5669 p. 121 and on.

a beginning (*Keitz*-קץ) Above. In other words, it was only drawn down after the initial constriction (*Tzimtzum)*, specifically after the light that preceded it was concealed, bringing about an empty space (*Makom Panooy*) that was empty of Godly revelation and light. Only after this, did the Line-*Kav* begin to radiate, as in the teaching,[78] "At first there was darkness and then the light returned."

Therefore, even though the Line-*Kav* is indeed drawn from the aspect of the Unlimited Light which precedes the restraint (*Tzimtzum*), nonetheless, because it was preceded by the restraint and empty space, which represent the absence of light, it was therefore subsequently drawn down with measure and limit. It therefore is limited and has an end.

This is because before the restraint (*Tzimtzum*), the Unlimited Light filled all the space of the void equally[79] from beginning to end. Likewise, in the coming future the essential illumination of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) will be revealed as it was before the restraint (*Tzimtzum*), as stated,[80] "Your Master shall no longer hide Himself."

In other words, there will no longer be restraints and concealments, but there will instead be rest for eternal life.[81] This refers to "rest" from the restraint (*Tzimtzum*), as it states,[82] "And God-*Eloh"im*-אלהי"ם ceased on the seventh day." In other words, "on the seventh day" there was a cessation and

[78] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 77b
[79] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher) Anaf 2
[80] Isaiah 30:20
[81] Talmud Bavli, Tamid 33b
[82] Genesis 2:2

respite of the restraint (*Tzimtzum*) brought about by *HaShem's*-יהו"ה title God-*Eloh"im*-אלהי"ם.[83]

Now, this will primarily be revealed in the seventh millennium, which is called,[84] "a day of complete rest (*Shabbat*) and respite." At that point, there will be a complete revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in the lower worlds. There then will be no beginning or end to revelations, as stated,[85] "For they shall see eye to eye when *HaShem*-יהו"ה returns to Zion." It similarly states,[86] "And the glory of *HaShem*-יהו"ה will be revealed and **all** flesh together will see that the mouth of *HaShem*-יהו"ה has spoken."

Now, this kind of revelation already took place in the Holy Temple, for in the Holy of Holies[87] there was a revelation of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light, as it states,[88] "He constricted His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) between the two poles of the Holy ark." This also generally took place in the Holy Temple as a whole, as we see from the ten miracles that happened in the Holy Temple on a permanent basis.[89] It likewise states,[90] "Three times a year all your males shall come

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[83] Likkutei Torah, Balak 72a; Pinchas 79c; Shir HaShirim 32a, and elsewhere; Also see Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) and The Gate of His Title (*Shaar HaKinuy*).

[84] Talmud Bavli, Tamid 33b ibid.

[85] Isaiah 52:8

[86] Isaiah 40:5

[87] See Tanya, Ch. 53 (74a) and on, and elsewhere..

[88] See Midrash Tanchuma VaYakhel 7; Bereishit Rabbah, 5:7; Vayikra Rabbah 10:9; Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:14 (3); Likkutei Torah, Emor, 34b (in the name of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch); Ohr HaTorah, Chanukah, Vol. 5, p. 925a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632, Vol. 1, p. 48; p. 210, and elsewhere.

[89] Mishnah Avot 5:5

[90] Exodus 23:17

to be seen before the Master, *HaShem*-יהו"ה," about which it states,[91] "Just as one comes to be seen, so too, one come to see – with his own two eyes etc." In other words, they beheld actual revelations of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness in the Holy Temple, as stated,[92] "Bring them and implant them in the mount of Your inheritance, the place of Your dwelling that You prepared, *HaShem*-יהו"ה etc." This phenomenon specifically took place in the Holy of Holies where there was a true revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in the lower worlds.

Now, actually, even in our times, on every Shabbat there is a revelation akin to this. On Shabbat, *HaShem*-יהו"ה rested from the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) and therefore on every Shabbat there is illumination that does not come by way of the medium of constriction (*Tzimtzum*). Therefore, the light is automatically drawn down below as well. This is as stated,[93] "The seventh day is the Shabbat of *HaShem*-יהו"ה," because on Shabbat there is an illumination and revelation of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה not by means of the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) of His title "God-*Eloh"im*-אלהי"ם."

This is why work activities are prohibited on Shabbat,[94] in that "one who makes gestures in the presence of the king [is liable] etc."[95] Work activities are only permitted during the rest of the week, because then, *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Godliness is concealed within the creation. However, on Shabbat, His

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[91] Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 2a

[92] Exodus 15:17

[93] Exodus 20:9

[94] Sidur Im DA"Ch p. 149b and on; Derech Mitzvotecha 8b and elsewhere; Ohr HaTorah Lech Lecha Vol. 4, p. 720a and on; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 33 p. 143 note 41; Sefer HaSichot 5749 Vol. 2 p. 705 and on.

[95] Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 5b

Godliness radiates in a revealed way, and it therefore is prohibited to perform work activities, as discussed in Tanya, at the end of chapter forty-six.[96]

Therefore, on Shabbat there is no admixture of evil, even below in this world,[97] as the verse states,[98] "The dung of your holidays," but does not say, "The dung of your Shabbat."[99] The reason is because the consumption of food on Shabbat is only good, without any admixture of evil whatsoever.

This is akin to the *Panag* bread[100] of the coming future, as it states,[101] "In the future, the earth will give forth buns of bread" that have no admixture of evil. It is similarly so on Shabbat, even in our times, because on Shabbat the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה shines below. Therefore, about Shabbat it states,[102] "all doers of iniquity will be dispersed" – automatically!

This is similarly so of Torah study. It too draws down a revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Ohr Ein Sof*) to below. This is because the root of its power to draw down is in the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that precedes

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[96] Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 149; 5678 p. 152; Also see the note of the Rebbe in Shiurim b'Sefer HaTanya, p. 638.

[97] Torah Ohr, Chaye Sarah 15c and on; Siddur Im Da"Ch 202c and on, and elsewhere.

[98] Malachi 2:3

[99] Zohar II 88b; Explained in Torah Ohr Chayei Sarah ibid. 15c and on; Siddur Im Da"Ch ibid. p. 203c and on.

[100] Ezekiel 27:17 and the commentaries there; Zohar I 47b; 235b; 246a; Likkutei Torah Bamidbar 5d; Ekev 15a; Torat Chaim Shemot Vol. 1, p. 23b

[101] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 30b

[102] Psalms 92:10

the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) as stated,[103] "And there was a voice from above the firmament."

As known,[104] this refers to the voice of Torah, which transcends the separating firmament, and as known, the root of this firmament is the aspect of the first *Tzimtzum* (restraint). This being so, the voice of Torah, is above the *Tzimtzum* (restraint) and therefore automatically can be drawn all the way down without restraint.

Now, as known,[105] the Torah below is literally exactly as it is Above, unlike the revelation of the Line-*Kav*, which because it has higher and lower levels, is not the same at its end as it is at its beginning. In contrast, because Torah is limitless (*Bli Gvul*), when it is drawn down, it is the same from beginning to end, as stated,[106] "Its measure is greater than the earth etc."

(Elsewhere,[107] it states that the primary revelation of Torah specifically takes place below, rather than Above, and it therefore was not given to the angels.[108] However, as will be explained,[109] we may say that this primary aspect specifically refers to Torah as it literally is rooted in the Essential Self of

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[103] Ezekiel 1:25; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Nevi'im p. 235; Ohr HaTorah Yitro, Vol. 8, p. 2,982; Drushim L'Chag HaShavuot (5755 edition) p. 52; p. 54 and on.

[104] See Sefer HaMaamarim, 5638, p. 146.

[105] See Tanya, Ch. 4 (8b and on); Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 53; p. 111 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 740 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 118 (in earlier editions see Vol. 2 p. 207).

[106] Job 11:9; Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 21a

[107] Torah Ohr, Yitro, p. 71a and on; 72b and on; Ohr HaTorah Bereishit Vol. 6 p. 1,023b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5638 p. 219 and elsewhere.

[108] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 88b and on

[109] In the discourse entitled "*HaShamayim Keesee*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 526 and on); Also see Torat Menachem Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket 3 p. 119 (Vol. 4 p. 207 in earlier editions), note 48; p. 20 (Vol. 6 p. 105).

HaShem-יהו"ה and can only be revealed to souls in bodies. (This will be revealed in the "coming future" when "a new Torah will issue from Me – that is, a novelty in Torah."[110] Nonetheless, there will not be another giving of the Torah.[111]

Rather, what is meant here is that the Torah will be revealed as it is, literally, in the aspect of the "delight of the King in His Essential Self" which "no one can measure," and only "God understands its way."[112] (This is like the above-mentioned verse, "No eye has seen it, God, aside for You.") This is why at the time of the resurrection of the dead; the souls will specifically manifest in bodies.) (Something like this even takes place today, in the Torah study of exceptionally righteous individuals, as it states,[113] "You shall behold your world[114] within your lifetime etc.")

However, from the angle of the revelations of the light of Torah, the Torah exists in every world; in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) as well as the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Actualization (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*). Moreover, even the angels receive the light of Torah through the souls, as stated,[115] "The companions listen to your voice," as discussed elsewhere.[116]

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[110] Midrash Vayikra Rabbah 13:3; Yalkut Shimoni to Isaiah, Remez 429

[111] Sefer HaMaamarim 5640, Vol. 1, p. 284; 5647, p. 87; 5656 p. 356; 5663 Vol. 2, p. 259; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1, p. 366; Sefer HaMaamarim 5677, p. 291; 5681 p. 167; 5685 p. 199; 5709 p. 57; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 719 and elsewhere.

[112] Job 28:13 & 28:23

[113] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 17a

[114] [i.e., the coming world (*Olam HaBa*).]

[115] Song of Songs 8:13; Midrash Shir HaShirim Rabbah 8:11; Zohar III 22a

[116] Ohr HaTorah, Bereishit Vol. 6, p. 1,023b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5638, p. 219

In any event, the fact that the primary aspect of Torah is below in this world, is not because it is in a state of limitation and measure. If that were the case, its primary revelation would specifically be above, like all other revelations in the worlds. This is because the lights (*Orot*) and vessels (*Keilim*) are measured by means of the "Measuring Line" (*Kav HaMidah*),[117] so that the degree of revelation will be according to the vessels and worlds, and those that are more fitting receptacles for the revelation of the Unlimited Light would have greater illumination. Thus, the revelations measured by the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*) specifically bring about greater revelations Above, in the supernal worlds and lesser ones below.

This being the case, the fact that Torah is primarily revealed below, in this world, specifically is **not** due to the dictates of the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*) but is due to a different matter altogether. Rather, in reality, Torah completely transcends all measure and limitation. It is specifically because of this that it can even be drawn down to this physical and lowly world.)

This also is why the fire of purgatory has no dominion over Torah scholars,[118] (akin to Shabbat, in that purgatory rests on Shabbat).[119] It similarly states,[120] "Only a person who is occupied in the study of Torah can be considered to be free."

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[117] Zohar II 233a; Likkutei Torah Naso 27c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 Vol. 2 p. 586 and on; Ohr HaTorah Shlach p. 493 and on, and elsewhere; *Hemshech* 5666 p. 215; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 13-14.

[118] Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 27a

[119] Zohar III 273a (Ra'aya Mehemna)

[120] Mishnah Avot 6:2

This is because through Torah, a radiance and revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה shines below in this world. This is as stated,[121] "When two people are occupied in the study of Torah, the Indwelling Presence of *HaShem*-יהו"ה rests upon them… and even when one person studies etc." It likewise is stated,[122] "The only place the Holy One, blessed be He, has in His world, is within the four cubits of Torah law (*Halachah*)." In contrast, in the worlds, the revelation of His Godly light is measured and limited, in other words, there is an aspect of an end and conclusion, as discussed above. The reason is because they have a beginning, in that they are drawn down by means of the constriction (*Tzimtzum*).

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Now, according to the explanation above about the matter of "until and including" and "until, but not including," the revelations of the chaining down of the worlds correspond to the aspect of "until and including." This is because they are comparable to each other.

That is, if a person is standing on one level, he can relate to the other levels, both the ones above him and the ones below him. (This is why the beings and entities on these levels are called "standing-*Omdeem*-עומדים.") Because of this, through one level, one can understand a higher level. Therefore, on whatever level one may be, he can relate to the level higher than him, since it too has a beginning and an end. This is according

[121] Mishnah Avot 3:2 & 3:5
[122] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 8a

Rashi's explanation of the verse, "To every end etc.," that "though we are standing in the middle of the existence of the world, in our mind's eye we can perceive that there is an end." In other words, even when we stand on one level, we can know that there is an end to the higher level too – even though we have yet to reach that level. This is because all these levels are limited and therefore are comparable to each other.

In contrast, the lights that transcend the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) are limitless and cannot be compared to each other whatsoever. They therefore correspond to the aspect of "until, but not including," as discussed above. Therefore, though a person is standing on one level, it cannot be said that he is aware of the aspect of the beginning and end of the higher level, because he has no point of reference by which to compare it to. Additionally, as stated above, though he comprehends the level he is on, this cannot be called true comprehension, because it is intangible and totally stripped of any physicality. In other words, even the matter that he grasps is in a state of limitlessness.

Hence, his grasp of the level he is on, does not assist him in understanding the higher level, because the way he grasps the lower level does not at all apply to grasping the higher level. On the contrary, he only perceives the transcendence of the higher level and how grasping it is inapplicable, even in a spiritual way, stripped of all tangible reference. For, as explained before, the higher a person ascends, the more astounding, lofty and distant the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, the Unlimited One, becomes for him. The same applies to the levels of radiance themselves, that whatever level a

person achieves, he only perceives the astounding loftiness and distance of the higher level, and that it altogether is not subject to grasp.

Afterwards, when he does come to the higher level (in the above-mentioned manner of grasp or much higher levels, in a manner that is stripped of physicality) this is through the total nullification of his previous state of being and existence. Only thus can he truly attain the higher level, which is incomparably higher. In other words, at first, he had no capacity to reach this level at all, but through nullification of awareness of self, he comes to it automatically.

Therefore, on this level it is inapplicable to say, "I have seen an end," since it is "until, but not including." However, the above is all according to the interpretation of Rashi on the words, "I have seen an end etc."

However, according to Rabbi Avraham Ibn Ezra, "I have seen an end to every beginning," means that the revelations of the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) are all within measure and limitation. Therefore, about them the verse states, "I have seen an end," being that they specifically come about by means of constriction (*Tzimtzum*). Accordingly, the continuation of the verse, "Your commandment is exceedingly broad," must be explained to refer to the lights that transcend the chaining down of the worlds and are limitless, without beginning or end, in that this is a revelation from the aspect of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that precedes the constriction (*Tzimtzum*).

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This then, is the meaning of the verse,[123] "Return, O Israel until *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God." In other words, repentance must be in a manner of "until, but not including." This is because, as known,[124] forgiveness of transgression comes specifically from the aspect of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that transcends the chaining down of the worlds. Within the chaining down of the worlds, blemishes are applicable, as known.[125] Therefore, the rectification of these blemishes specifically comes from the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that transcends the chaining down of the worlds. It is specifically this that is drawn down through repentance from the depths of one's heart.

About this, the verse states,[126] "To You my heart has said, 'Seek My [inner] face (*Panay*-פני); Your [inner] face (*Panecha*-פניך) *HaShem*-יהו"ה do I seek." In other words, drawing down the inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*-פנימיות) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, comes about specifically through seeking "My [inner] face (*Panay*-פני)," this being the matter of repentance (*Teshuvah*) from the inner depths of one's heart. This is specifically what arouses and draws forth the aspect of the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. The verse therefore states, "Return O' Israel until *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God,"

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[123] Hosea 14:2 ibid.

[124] Sefer HaMaamarim 5639, Vol. 2, p. 547 and on; 5651 p. 21 and on.

[125] Torah Ohr, VaYera 15a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5665, p. 25 and on; p. 32 and on; 5677 p. 196 and on; 5703 p. 92 and on, and elsewhere.

[126] Psalms 27:8

meaning that repentance should reach the level that is "until, but not including," which is the aspect of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that transcends and surrounds all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*).

The verse continues,[127] "For you have stumbled in your iniquity." In other words, it is incumbent on a person to repent because,[128] "He has placed the world in their hearts," that is, in the heart of man. That is, for there to be a drawing down of Godly revelation into the world, a person must draw down revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה upon his soul. This is done through fulfilling His Torah and *mitzvot*, thereby also drawing down Godly influence into the world.

As explained before,[129] the primary intent in performing the *mitzvot* is to draw down revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה to the worlds, thus fulfilling His desire for a dwelling place in this lower world.[130] Therefore, when "you have stumbled in your iniquity" and have not fulfilled this intent, *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light must be drawn down through repentance (*Teshuvah*).

The meaning of the words "you have stumbled" is that it is because of this lacking that we stumble and fall, Heaven forbid, thus causing the descent of the world as well, since the entire purpose of the descent of the soul into this world is only to draw down *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light into the worlds. This is because also the soul is rooted in the Essential Self of

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[127] Hosea 14:2 ibid.

[128] Ecclesiastes 3:11

[129] In the prior discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*."

[130] Midrash Tanchuma Bechukotai 3, Naso 16; Bereshit Rabbah, Ch. 3; Bamidbar Rabbah, Ch. 13; Tanya Ch. 36 (45b).

the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. This is why it specifically descended into the physical body, as explained elsewhere.[131]

This is like the explanation above[132] about the fact that Torah is rooted in the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה and was therefore specifically given below in this world. This is likewise so of the souls, and it is because of this that it is specifically within their capacity to draw down the aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. Such is not the case regarding the angels or any of the supernal levels in the chaining down of the worlds, in that they do not have this capacity. Since this is the entire purpose of the descent of the soul into this world; therefore, when a person lacks the matter of drawing down Godly influence, he then stumbles and falls from his spiritual level. Moreover, he also causes the world to descend.

Now, at first glance we may ask, are not the revelations within the worlds according to the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*)? Why then do the sins or blemishes of man have such an impact on the worlds? However, because "the world is placed in the heart of man," and because the ultimate intent of creation, as a whole, was to draw down the aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה into the worlds, therefore, when a person draws down *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light by fulfilling His Torah and *mitzvot*, he causes all the worlds to ascend. The opposite,

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[131] Biurei HaZohar Admor HaEmtza'ee, p. 99a and on; Ohr HaTorah Bereishit Vol. 3 p. 527a; Torat Shmuel, Drushei Chatunah p. 3 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayigash*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 648 and on).

[132] Earlier in this discourse (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 30).

that he can cause all the worlds to descend, Heaven forbid, is also true. The sin of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil is the prime example of this. However, in reality, every sin or transgression has this effect.

All this is rectified through repentance from the depths of one's heart, which draws down the aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, by which all blemishes are rectified. This is why it states, "Return, O Israel until *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God," to the aspect of "until, but not including" which is the aspect of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Unlimited Light that transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*). Through this, pardon and forgiveness are drawn down.

Discourse 4

"*Lulav v'Aravah… -*
The waving of the Lulav and willow…"

Delivered on the 2nd night of Sukkot, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The Mishnah states,[2] "The waving of the Lulav and willow was performed for six or seven days. Now, how was the Lulav waved for seven days? If the first day of the festival fell on Shabbat, the Lulav was waved for seven days; however, if it fell on a different day of the week it was waved for only six." In other words, on the first day of the festival the commandment of Lulav superseded the Shabbat within the borders of Israel, but if it fell on a different day, it did not supersede the Shabbat. Now, the above was only true during the time of the Holy Temple.

However, after the destruction of the Holy Temple, even if the first day of the festival falls out on Shabbat it does not supersede the Shabbat. The Talmud provides the reason for this

[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*v'Heet'halachtee b'Tochachem*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Vayikra Vol. 2 p. 826 and on; Discourse entitled "*v'Atah Yisroel*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 1 p. 262 and on; Discourse entitled "*Mah Navu Lechayayich BaTorim*" in Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim 13a and on, as cited in later notes. Regarding the beginning and end of the discourse, also see the discourse entitled "*Lahavin HaMishnah Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" in Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 56a.

[2] Mishnah Sukkah 24:1; Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 42b

prohibition;[3] that it is because of the decree of Rabbah, who said, "It is a restrictive measure lest a person takes his Lulav in his hand and goes to an expert to learn, thereby carrying it four cubits in the public domain."

Now, we must understand why the sages saw fit to uproot a positive Torah commandment because of a concern of this kind. Regarding the Lulav, the matter itself contains no inherent concern for [Biblical] transgression, for it concerns only the [aforementioned] carrying. This is also unlike the Shofar, which involves a skill [i.e., giving further justification for refrain].[4] The Lulav involves no forbidden work (*melachah*) prohibition, but carrying alone, as discussed by Tosefot in Tractate Rosh HaShanah.[5] This being the case, why did they uproot a Torah *mitzvah* based on mere concern?

Now, as known,[6] the Sukkah represents the aspect of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*), as the verse states,[7] "And the Sukkah shall be for shade in the daytime etc." It similarly states,[8] "If the walls extend up to twenty cubits high, a person is sitting in the shade of the Sukkah." We therefore must understand the matter of the encompassing aspect (*Makif*) of the Sukkah.

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[3] Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 42b ibid.

[4] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 117b; 131b; Rosh HaShanah 29b

[5] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 29b ibid., section entitled "*Aval*". See also Magen Avraham to Orach Chayim, Hilchot Rosh HaShanah 598 S"K 4; Machatzit HaShekel and Levushei Serad ad loc.

[6] Meorei Ohr Ot Samech, Section 15; Torah Ohr, Miketz 34b; Likkutei Torah Netzavim 48c; Drushim L'Shmini Atzeret 84a and on; Siddur Im DA"Ch 265a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 369.

[7] Isaiah 4:6

[8] Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 2a

Additionally, as known,[9] optimally, the rite of Lulav should specifically be done in the Sukkah. We therefore must understand the relationship between the Lulav and the Sukkah. Additionally, the verse states about the Sukkah,[10] "You shall dwell (*Teishvu*-תשבו) in Sukkot for seven days." However, as known, the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) do not dwell or become inwardly settled (*Hityashvut*-התיישבות). If so, what is the meaning of, "You shall dwell (*Teishvu*-**תשבו**) in Sukkot?

Now, to understand this, we must first preface with what was previously explained[11] about the verse,[12] "To every end I have seen a beginning," referring to the revelations within the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*), which are limited. That is, there is a cessation and end to their being drawing down. The automatic outcome of this is, "I have seen a *Keitz*-קץ" – meaning "a beginning." This is because their beginning follows the first constriction (*Tzimtzum*). They therefore are in the category of "until and including." This being the case, from whatever level of consciousness a person has attained, he can perceive the next, higher level and grasp that it too is limited and has an end.

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[9] See Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar HaLulav, Ch. 3 ("*Inyan Netilat Lulav*"); Shaar HaKavanot, beginning of Drushei Chag HaSukkot; Sidder HaArizal, Kavanot Lulav V'Na'anuav; Mishnat Chassidim, Mesechet Yemei Mitzva Sukkah, Ch. 5; Siddur Admor HaZaken, Dinei Netilat Lulav; Also see the discourse entitled "*BaSukkot Teishvu*" 5736 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 126 and on (in earlier editions see Vol. 1 p. 175 and on), translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 3); Likkutei Sichot Vol. 22 p. 124 and on.

[10] Leviticus 23:42

[11] In the discourse entitled "*Shuvah Yisroel*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 28 and on").

[12] Psalms 119:96

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Now, Ibn Yichia[13] explains this verse as follows, "To every end I have seen a beginning," that this means, "to every pleasure and delight etc." Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 17, similarly explains, "To every end-*Tichlah*-תכלה refers to the expiry of the soul - *Kallot HaNefesh*-כלות הנפש." In other words, I have seen a beginning, end and limitation to the expiry and yearning of the soul. However, the continuation of the verse, "Your *mitzvah* is exceedingly broad" means that the pleasure inherent in the *mitzvot* is unlimited.

In Midrash Rabbah Bereishit, chapter ten,[14] it states, "To every end – everything is limited, the heavens and earth are limited, (that is, all the pleasures in the heavens and earth are limited), except for one thing that has no limits. What is that one thing? It is Torah."

As known, the explanation[15] of the matter is that the faculty of "pleasure" is the loftiest of all the encompassing lights of the soul. This is in accordance with the statement,[16] "There is nothing loftier than pleasure," because pleasure (*Taanug*) even transcends the power of desire (*Ratzon*).[17] It is

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[13] Commentary to Chamesh Megilot and Ketuvim by Rabbi Yosef the son of David Ibn Yichia, cited in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit Vol. 3, p. 506a; Also see the beginning of the discourse entitled "*L'Khol Tichlah*" 5659 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 97).

[14] Bereishit Rabbah 10:1

[15] Regarding the next section see the discourse entitled "*v'Khol HaAm Ro'eem*" 5647 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 p. 102 and on); Discourse entitled "*v'Hoo K'Chatan*" 5657 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 150 and on).

[16] Sefer Yetzirah 2:7; Also see the later discourses entitled "*Lech Lecha*" and "*Ki Yeda'ativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 86 and on; p. 97 and on);

[17] Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 24

clearly observable that pleasure (*Taanug*) is the cause of desire (*Ratzon*) and that the reason a person has a desire for any given thing is because of the pleasure in it. Without the pleasure in the thing itself, there is no desire for it. This being the case, pleasure transcends desire and is its cause.

The same principle applies to all the powers of the soul, such as the soul-power of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. It too is dependent on pleasure, as in the dictum,[18] "A person should always study what his heart desires (*Chafetz*-חפץ)," and as known,[19] the word *Chafetz* (desire), specifically refers to a desire that is pleasurable. Specifically as a result of the pleasure, he will have insight and bring forth novel ideas on the subject, as explained elsewhere.[20] Similarly, we observe that a person will have an essential delight in something (such as building his home etc.) especially when it follows the dictates of his wisdom (*Chochmah*). This is because his wisdom goes according to the pleasure he has in it, as explained elsewhere.[21] In the same way, all the soul-powers depend on the pleasure in them and the pleasure is automatically drawn out to illuminate them etc. Nevertheless, the light of the pleasure that illuminates all the soul-powers is only a glimmer of the pleasure. Because of this, there are changes and varying degrees of it.

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[18] Talmud Bavli, Avoda Zarah 19a

[19] Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 28d; 33d; Responsa of the Tzemach Tzedek, Even HaEzer Vol. 2, siman 263, p. 8c.

[20] Sefer HaMaamarim 5664, p. 270; 5665 p. 243; 5671 p. 6; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1, p. 91; p. 411; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 88); Discourse entitled "*Ohr HaLevanah*" 5667 (p. 547).

[21] See Torat Chayim, VaYigash 90c and on; *Hemshech* 5672, Vol. 2, p. 1,116 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei Yaakov*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 128) and elsewhere.

For, as known,[22] an essence is indivisible and does not spread out of its essential self. Hence,[23] the essential self of the soul, as it is essentially, does not spread forth or divide into its individual powers. Now, if there is a drawing forth from the essence of the soul, it is drawn out and illuminates as it essentially is – equally in all its particular powers. For example, when at a time of great joy there is a revelation of the aspect of the *Yechidah* level of the soul, such as on the wedding of an only child or the like; at such a time, the aspect of the *Yechidah* of the soul, including all its powers and faculties, from the intellectual powers, to the powers of speech and action, become revealed and the soul radiates equally in all of them, with great strength and revelation, as discussed elsewhere.[24]

Now, although this is a revelation of the hidden powers of the soul, as described elsewhere,[25] nevertheless, at such a time, these hidden powers manifest within the revealed powers, because even then, he conceptualizes with the essential power of his intellect, specifically according to the light of the intellect in his brain. This is because the power of intellect concealed in the soul is not in a state of intellect at all, as known and discussed elsewhere.[26]

In contrast, in the above-mentioned revelation, it indeed is in a state of the existence of revealed intellect, only that in the

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[22] See Moreh Nevuchim, Part 1, Ch. 51; Torat Chayim 65a; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKriyat Shmah, Ch. 8, p. 20a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5646 p. 2; 5652 p. 96; 5658 p. 164 and on, and elsewhere.

[23] See Moreh Nevuchim, introductions to Part 2, introduction 11.

[24] Sefer HaMaamarim 5653 p. 239; 5654, p. 288 and on; 5658, p. 100, and elsewhere.

[25] Discussed at length in Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 223 and on, as well as the citations in the previous note.

[26] Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 205 and on; 5660, p. 113 and on

strength of its flow, there is an illumination and revelation of the essential light of the soul, thus giving him the capability of conceptualizing hidden and wondrous matters, which he would not have otherwise been capable of conceptualizing.

In addition, everything he conceptualizes at such a time comes in a way of actual comprehension of the essential brilliance of the concept, as it is. This is as explained elsewhere in the discourse entitled "*V'Chol HaAm Ro'im*" of the year 5665.[27]

This same principle applies to all the other powers, including the power of speech. It manifests within the revealed power of speech and so he speaks etc. In other words, the concealed powers manifest in the revealed powers, except that the power and strength of the soul illuminates in them equally.

It is similarly so regarding true repentance (*Teshuvah*) from the depths of one's heart, at which time the essential light of the soul radiates in a revealed way. For as known,[28] regarding the service of the mind and heart, the revelations that come forth from the powers of the Godly soul are only the aspect of the revealed powers of intellect and emotions. That is, he will conceptualize and contemplate in his intellect and will arouse love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which is the revelation of the powers of the Godly soul, but only the revealed powers.

However, the matter of repentance (*Teshuvah*) arouses the essential self of the soul, and he is "moved from his place"

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[27] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665, p. 263 (in the discourse entitled "*Naso*" which is a continuation of the referenced discourse.)

[28] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5651, p. 40 and on.

because of the constrictions caused by the sins and transgressions that soiled his soul over the course of the year, Heaven forbid.

Additionally, in the ten days of repentance, which is a time when the "Luminary comes close to the sparks,"[29] he considers his great distance in his heart, in that he has removed himself from Godliness, which touches him to the depth of his soul. (In other words, he is touched both by his great distance, in that he finds himself entrenched in the external husks (*Kelipot*) and the side opposite holiness (*Sitra Acharah*) that are[30] "despised by *HaShem*-יהו"ה," Heaven forbid, and by the blemish he has caused, both Above in the spiritual realm, and below in his soul, as explained elsewhere.)[31]

(This is especially so during the ten days of repentance, at which time the Luminary is close. At this time the matter touches him to a greater degree in the innerness of his heart. This is similarly so at other auspicious times, such as during the midnight prayer of *Tikkun Chatzot*, or before prayer etc.)

He becomes embittered by this in his soul, to the point that his very essence is greatly moved by a powerful bitterness. This can be compared to very deep internal physical pain, God forbid, which causes the essential self of the soul to be stirred and moved. The same is so of a true penitent, that when the

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[29] See Derech Chaim (translated as The Path of Life), p. 13d; 21b; 91a; Kuntres HaAvodah, end of Ch. 5 (p. 33); Sefer HaMaamarim 5687, p. 37; Also see the discourse entitled "*Padah b'Shalom*" 5712 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5712, p. 182, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5712, Discourse 5); Also see the Sichah talk of the 2nd day of Sukkot 5714 (Torat Menachem, Hitva'aduyot 5714 Vol. 1 p. 38).

[30] Deuteronomy 16:22

[31] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 25 and on; 5703 p. 82 and on, and elsewhere.

matter touches him to the inner depth of his heart, the essential self of his soul is stirred and moved by great bitterness. The result is that there is an automatic drawing and desire to come close to Godliness, in that his whole being is moved, literally to the point of expiring.

Now, he is not necessarily even conscious of this "drawing forth of the soul," because, at this point, he only is aware of the bitterness and anguish he feels from his sense of distance. Therefore, he is not necessarily aware of being drawn close to Godliness (since this is the aspect of the[32] "inner, unheard voice", which also is called "the cry of the heart" as discussed elsewhere).[33]

Nonetheless, in truth, his Godly soul is very strongly drawn to Godliness, but it is unfelt. This is because this "drawing" is caused by his great sense of distance, in that his current condition brings him great anguish. This causes him to flee from evil and death. The automatic result is that he flees to the place of life. However, the main thrust here is fleeing from evil and death.

In addition, his being drawn to Godliness is like a person who despairs in his soul, which makes this all the stronger. Now there are two matters in this, however only one applies here. This is because at times, a person despairs specifically because of his sensitivity to the Godly light. He feels its

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[32] Zohar I 50b; 210a

[33] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5651, p. 8 and on; p. 16 and on; 5656 p. 244 and on; 5660 p. 23 and on; 5662 p. 225 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1, p. 144 and on; Also see the previous discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 2).

greatness, which causes him to almost despair at the impossibility of attaining such a lofty level.

However, here, the opposite is true. He does not feel the greatness of Godliness at all. Rather, he only is aware of his own lowliness and how he altogether is disconnected from Godliness. For his despair is that he questions how closeness to Godliness could at all be possible for him, since he realizes his lowly state and that he has no relation to this altogether.

This causes him great anguish, which moves him to be drawn to Godliness with even greater strength. However, it [specifically] is the despair itself over his distance that causes the great and overpowering anguish, and because of this, he is unaware that, in actuality, he is being drawn to Godliness.

Now, there is an aspect of arousal to repentance akin to this that is not because of the constrictions of one's sins but is rather because of closeness to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), that is, "the closeness of the Luminary." This [closeness] arouses the soul to draw close to Godliness.

Now, this too, is not because he feels the limitless light of the Unlimited One and is therefore drawn to it, because then it would be a drawing forth and yearning known as the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*)[34] - a level of service attained through intellect and reason.

That is, because [through intellect and reasoning] he feels the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) he therefore is drawn to it. Here however, one does not feel the

[34] See the previous discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 1 and on).

revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, because this is an arousal of the soul as it **transcends** intellect and reason and is rather caused by the closeness of the Luminary to the spark.

(In reality, relative to the true exaltedness of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, all are considered to be sinners and transgressors, as explained elsewhere.[35] This is why in the ten days of repentance, all of us, regardless of our spiritual standing, confess, "We have sinned, we have betrayed etc."[36])

Now, in the above-mentioned revelation of the essential self of the soul, the essence illuminates all the faculties equally. Proof of this is the fact that when the essential light is revealed, all the various faculties and emotions literally undergo a transformation of their essential nature. As clearly observable in a true penitent (*Ba'al Teshuvah*), his very being changes from one extreme to the other, and he no longer desires all the things he previously lusted for altogether.

As known,[37] a *Ba'al Teshuvah* must be one who says, "I do **not** want,"[38] and indeed, this is how he is; he does not want anything at all, but his only desire is for Godliness, and this desire is at **full strength**, so that he is sensitive to all Godly

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[35] Sefer HaMaamarim 5651 p. 75 and on; p. 212, 214 and on; 5659 p. 64; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 100 and on; p. 114 and on (in earlier editions see Vol. 3 p. 19; Vol. 4 p. 18 and on).

[36] See Taamaei HaMitzvot of the Arizal, Parshat Kedoshim; Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar HaSelichot, Ch. 8; Siddur HaArizal before Tachanun; Derech Mitzvotecha 28a; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid.

[37] See Keter Shem Tov, Section 395; Likkutei Amarim of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch 26c; Likkutei Torah Va'etchanan 9d; Sefer HaMaamarim 5704 p. 136; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 4 p. 1182 and on; Vol. 39 p. 97 and elsewhere.

[38] See Torat Kohanim and Rashi to Leviticus 20:26

matters. This is because this greatly touches him on a very personal level, and as known, one is sensitive to whatever touches him personally. He thus becomes sensitive to all Godly matters, which previously he had no feelings for.

Similarly, his intellectual powers undergo an essential transformation, because the foundations and basis of his intellectual makeup take on a different form. In other words, besides the changes to his reasoning and grasp, there also are foundational principles, such as primary axioms, that he now accepts as intellectually true. The foundational principles from the side of holiness and the foundational principles from the side of the external husks (*Kelipah*) and the side opposite holiness (*Sitra Achara*) are different, and therefore, in a true *Ba'al Teshuvah*, the foundational principles of his intellect undergo profound transformation.

We therefore find that all his various faculties undergo essential change and each becomes imbued with great strength and vitality. Even the physical manifestation of his faculties will be different, so that the *mitzvot* he performs will also be with great strength and much vitality. This is like how it is, that on Rosh HaShanah and Yom Kippur, every Jew fulfills the *mitzvot* differently than how he may fulfill them during the rest of the year. This is because, on such occasions, the essential light of his soul even illuminates his physical actions.

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Now,[39] all the above is the result of the illumination and revelation of the light of the essential self (*Etzem*) of the soul. However, regarding the aspect of revelations (*Giluyim*) of the soul as they radiate in the revealed powers, it only is a glimmer of the essential self (*Etzem*) of the soul. Regarding this glimmer, the more it is drawn down and grasped in the revealed powers, the more concealed it becomes, and thus does not radiate in such a revealed way.

This may be understood by something that is clearly observable. When a person has insight into any given subject, his initial grasp of it comes from the power to conceptualize in his soul (*Koach HaMaskeel*). At that level, it does not yet bear the characteristics of intellect altogether, as explained before.[40] Nevertheless, it is from there that the insight of wisdom (*Chochmah*) is revealed.

This is the first revelation of light in the revealed intellect. This may be compared to a "flash of lightning"[41] because at this point it has not yet settled in the vessel of his mind. Rather, it only hovers above his mind in a state that is not yet fully grasped. Though he already knows it, he only

[39] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5747 ibid. p. 102 and on; 5757 ibid. p. 150 and on.

[40] Earlier in this discourse.

[41] See Tanya, Igeret HaKodesh, end of Epistle 15 (124a). Torah Ohr, Bereishit 6c; Likkutei Torah, Shlach 44d; Matot 87c; Ve'Etchanan 2d; 3c; Ki Teitzei 39a and on; Drushim L'Shmini Atzeret 85d; Torat Chayim Bereishit 10a; Noach 47d and on; Pirush HaMilot 6d; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2, p. 1,198; Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 130, and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1.

knows it generally, rather than truly grasping it in the vessel of his mind.

The reason is because the illumination of the insight of Wisdom-*Chochmah* comes primarily from the **light** (*Ohr*) of the intellect, rather than the intellect itself. Because of this, he cannot fully grasp or express it in letters, whereas it is specifically through the letters that the matter can be grasped. This is because this primary revelation is of the light (*Ohr*), rather than the intellect, and it is impossible for light to be grasped through letters.[42] Only afterwards does the conceptual point come to be grasped and understood. This happens specifically when the light becomes concealed. Only then can the intellect be felt and grasped, and all the details of the concept can be expanded and comprehended in and of themselves.

The same is true of the concept as a whole; it comes to be actually grasped in the vessel of the mind. However, we clearly observe that when the concept becomes grasped and comprehended, the light of the concept becomes concealed, whereas the intellect of the concept becomes felt and apparent to a greater degree. The more the concept is grasped, the more the light becomes concealed.

The same is true of the light of pleasure that illuminates the intellect. At the initial point of insight, which comes like a flash of lightning, there is a much greater radiance and

[42] In explanation of the difference between the light (*Ohr*) of the intellect (*Sechel*) and the intellect (*Sechel*) itself, see Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 3, p. 33. Also see Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, the beginning of The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*).

revelation of the pleasure. This is like the statement,[43] "The face of Rabbi Elazar shone when he discovered a new Tosefta." This pleasure comes from the **essence** of the concept, which is not so once it is grasped in a way of comprehension.

This is because although[44] the revelation of the Ancient One-*Atik* is in Understanding-*Binah*,[45] this is only because in Understanding-*Binah* it becomes more pronounced and felt. Nevertheless, the primary revelation of pleasure is in Wisdom-*Chochmah*, and within Wisdom-*Chochmah* itself, the primary pleasure is from the essential light that radiates, whereas in the Understanding-*Binah*, the pleasure is only from the aspect of the intellect.

We therefore find that regarding the general revelation of the light of the soul, particularly the revelation of pleasure; it is not equal throughout all the various faculties of the soul. In the faculty of Wisdom-*Chochmah* there is greater revelation than in the faculty of Understanding-*Binah*. In addition, the revelation of pleasure in Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which flashes like a lightning bolt, only takes place during the actual moment of insight. However, with the slightest passage of time, the concept "ages" for him, so to speak, and the pleasure dissipates. This is all the more so in regard to the pleasure of comprehension and grasp. It too dissipates shortly. From this,

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[43] Talmud Yerushalmi, Shabbat 8:1; Midrash Kohelet Rabbah 8:1 (4); Also see Likkutei Torah Pekudei 3c; Tzav 9a; Masei 93b and elsewhere.

[44] Regarding the coming section, see Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzedek, Vol. 1, p. 364 and on.

[45] See Torah Ohr, Lech Lecha 11b; Torat Chaim 81b and on; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 40.

we understand that the pleasure drawn into the faculties is only a glimmer of the essential pleasure.[46]

This likewise is so the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Avodah*). That is, when a person contemplates (*Hitbonenut*) Godliness and the greatness of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, and he is aroused with love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in his heart in revealed manner, or whether his love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה may remain hidden in the contemplation itself, for he delights in the Godliness that he grasps.

Nevertheless, this is only a glimmer of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, for as known,[47] whatever comes into grasp is distant from the Essential Self, because about the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One it states,[48] "No thought at all can grasp Him." Therefore, whatever illumination there is in a way of comprehension is only the aspect of a glimmer.

Even in the aspect of the "sight" of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, there is not truly an illumination from the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. Proof of this is from Moshe, who corresponds to the aspect of *Ma"H*-מ"ה of Wisdom-*Chochmah*-**חכמה**, as he stated,[49] "And what are we-*V'Nachnu Mah*-ונחנו מה." For as the verse states,[50] "And the man Moshe was very humble, more than any man on the surface

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[46] Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 ibid. p. 103 where he cites to Torat Chayim, Shemot Vol. 1, p. 102a and on.

[47] Sefer HaMaamarim 5677 p. 27; 5682 p. 24, and elsewhere; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 78 and on).

[48] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a.

[49] Exodus 16:7-8

[50] Numbers 12:3

of the earth," because he was in the state of the essential negation of self (*Bittul*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. Nevertheless, he requested of *HaShem*-יהו"ה,[51] "Please show me Your glory," to which he was answered,[52] "You cannot see My face... you shall see My back, but My face shall not be seen." This is because whatever is revealed in the aspect of the "sight" of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is not the aspect of the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, as He is, in and of Himself.

From this we can understand how it is Above in Godliness, in that the aspect of the radiance of the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that radiates in the ten *Sefirot* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is only a mere glimmer. For although it states in Etz Chayim[53] that in Wisdom-*Chochmah* there is a radiance of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) in a way of closeness, this only refers to the fact that the limitless light radiates in Wisdom-*Chochmah* more than how it radiates in Understanding-*Binah*.

Nevertheless, it is not an illumination of the aspect of the Essential Self. This is why there are differences between the revelations in Wisdom-*Chochmah* and the revelations in Understanding-*Binah*. For, when there is an illumination from the Essential Self of His Unlimited Light (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*), He illuminates them all equally.

This accords with the explanation above in the analogy of the soul, and it is similarly so Above in Godliness. For

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[51] Exodus 33:18

[52] Exodus 33:20-23

[53] Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A) Ch. 13, explained in Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 347 and on; 5650 p. 282 and on, cited in the previous discourse entitled "*Shuvah Yisroel*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 29 and on).

example, in the "coming future" when there will be a revelation of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Essential Self, the revelation will be equal throughout all the chaining down of the worlds.

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This then, it the meaning of the verse, "I have seen a beginning to every end," which refers to all the pleasures throughout creation. For the source of the worlds is from the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as the verse states,[54] "You have made them all with Wisdom-*Chochmah*," and it is the beginning of the chaining down of the worlds. This is as stated in Zohar[55] about the verse[56] "And God said, let us make man," "In the entire act of creation, Father-*Abba* (Wisdom-*Chochmah*) said to Mother-*Imma* (Understanding-*Binah*) etc." About all this, "I have seen a beginning," meaning that it all is in a way of measure and limitation. This is because it only is a glimmer from the aspect of the Supernal pleasure that manifests in the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*).

Similarly, the general desire for all of creation is only the aspect of the externality of His will, blessed is He, because, as known,[57] the entire matter of the inner desire for creation is solely for the purpose of Torah and *mitzvot*. This is like the statement,[58] "The word 'In the beginning-*Bereishit*-בראשית'

[54] Psalms 104:24
[55] Zohar I 22a
[56] Genesis 1:26
[57] See Maamari Admor HaEmtza'eee, Vayikra, Vol. 2, p. 813 and on.
[58] See Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 1:4; VaYikra Rabbah 36:4; Rashi & Ramban commentary to Genesis 1:1, and elsewhere.

refers to two things that are called "primary-*Reishit*-ראשית." These are the Jewish people who are called "first-*Reishit*-ראשית" and Torah, which is called "the beginning-*Reishit*-ראשית."

This refers to *HaShem's*-יהו"ה primary, inner intention for creation, whereas the desire for the creation itself is external to this. It therefore is readily understood that the aspect of the pleasure in His desire for creation is only a glimmer of the essential pleasure. This is not so of the desire for Torah and *mitzvot*, which is His inner essential desire. Therefore, within this desire is a manifestation of the aspect of His essential Supernal pleasure.

This then, is the meaning of "I have seen a beginning to every end." That is, every aspect of pleasure and expiry, referring even to the Godly pleasure experienced by the souls, comes with measure and limit. This is true whether it is the Godly delight of the souls in the garden of Eden in their countless ascents from level to level, as discussed before, or whether it is the delight of the souls here below, which is achieved through serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, through contemplation (*Hitbonenut*) of His Godliness and the "sight" of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. The same is true of the revelation of pleasure that radiates in the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*). They all are in an aspect of measure and limit, for they merely are a glimmer of the pleasure.

However, the verse continues, "Your commandment is exceedingly broad." This is because the pleasure in His desire for the *mitzvot* is from His inner essential pleasure, which completely transcends His pleasure and desire for the chaining

down of the worlds. This is especially so regarding the physical performance or "actualization" of the *mitzvot*, since "the end action arose first in thought."[59]

It is specifically this desire for the actual fulfillment of *mitzvot* that is the ultimate, inner intention in *HaShem's*-יהו"ה inner Essential Self, blessed is He. It is therefore specifically through this, that His inner essential pleasure is drawn forth, as it states,[60] "It brings satisfaction of spirit before Me that I commanded and My will is fulfilled." This "satisfaction of spirit (*Nachat Ru'ach*) before Me," refers to His inner, essential pleasure and comes about specifically when "My will is fulfilled" in actuality.

This is why in the coming future there will be a true revelation of that which is drawn down, which currently is accomplished by our service when we fulfill the *mitzvot*. Moreover, this revelation will specifically be here below. In truth, the actual fulfillment of the *mitzvot* creates a vessel for Godliness even in our times. However, its revelation will be in the coming future. This is because there then will be a revelation here below of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*). In other words, there will be a revelation of His simple essential pleasure that is manifest in the fulfillment of the *mitzvot*.

[59] Lecha Dodi, Friday night prayers.
[60] Torat Kohanim and Rashi to Leviticus 1:9; Sifri and Rashi to Numbers 28:8

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Now, from the above, we can understand[61] why those who perform the *mitzvot* are called[62] "Those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One." At first glance, this statement is not understood. Why are they called "those who actualize the will of the Ever-Present One?" Even before the Torah was given, was there not already a drawing forth and actualization of the will of the Supernal One through the creation and coming into being of the worlds?

This is as stated, "In the beginning God created-*Bereishit Bara*-בראשית ברא etc.," which Onkelos translated as, "with the primordial He created-*Bekadmin Bara*-בקדמין ברא," which refers to the aspect of the Crown-*Keter*.[63] And as known, the Crown-*Keter* refers to the aspect of desire (*Ratzon*-רצון),[64] as in the verse,[65] "You crown him with desire (*Ratzon*-רצון), like a shield." Another verse similarly states,[66] "I have said (*Amarti*-אמרתי), 'The world will be built with kindness,'" which refers to a "saying" (*Amirah*-אמירה) in His will, as stated

[61] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*v'Heet'halachtee b'Tochachem*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Vayikra Vol. 2 p. 826 and on ibid.

[62] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 35b

[63] See Torat Chaim, Bereishit 7c and on; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 8 & 9, and elsewhere.

[64] Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinyim) Ch. 20, section on "*Ratzon*"; *Hemshech* 5672, Vol. 1, p. 2 and on; Also see Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Nine (*Chochmah*) and Gate Ten (*Keter*); Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 24.

[65] Psalms 5:13

[66] Psalms 89:3

elsewhere.[67] We likewise say,[68] "Blessed is He who said (*Amar*-אמר), and the world came into being etc.," or in the words of the Zohar,[69] "When it arose in His will to create the worlds," or,[70] "in the beginning of the arousal of the will of the King to rule etc." Similarly, Etz Chayim states,[71] "When it arose in His simple will (*Retzono*-רצונו) etc."

From all the above verses and references we see that there already was a drawing forth of His will (*Ratzon*-רצון) with the creation of the worlds. This being so, why then are Jews referred to as "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One" through their fulfillment of the *mitzvot*?

An additional question that arises from the above statement, is that immediately before performing the *mitzvot* we say,[72] "This is with the intent of unifying the Holy One blessed is He and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*)."[73]

Now, it was explained before[74] that this refers to the unification of how *HaShem*-הוי"ה transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*), with how He fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*), which is accomplished through fulfilling His *mitzvot*. However, since there already was a drawing forth of His desire

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[67] Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 11d and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 1, p. 34 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5651 p. 172 and on

[68] Baruch SheAmar prayer

[69] Zohar Vol. 1, 86b

[70] Zohar Vol. 1, 15a

[71] Etz Chayim, beginning of Shaar HaKlallim

[72] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 198; 5679 p. 518; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid.; Sefer HaSichot 5752 Vol. 2 p. 454.

[73] See Likkutei Torah, Va'etchanan in the discourse entitled "*v'Zot HaMitzvah*" [9a]; Drushei Rosh HaShanah, (second) discourse entitled "*Tikoo*" Ch. 2 [55c] (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5710 cited in the endnotes.)

[74] In the discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" 5666 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 5).

to bring about worlds, and since desire corresponds to the aspect of His transcendence (*Sovev*), there already was a unification of the Holy One, blessed is He, and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*), at the time of creation. (This is the meaning of "Father-*Abba* (Wisdom-*Chochmah*) said to Mother-*Imma* (Understanding-*Binah*)," or alternately, the unification of *Zeir Anpin* and *Malchut*, all of which refer to the unification of the Holy One, blessed is He, and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*).

Moreover, although it is known that the actualization of creation is brought about by the aspect of how *HaShem*-יהו"ה fills the worlds (*Memaleh*), nevertheless, this is specifically brought about by the power of how He transcends the worlds (*Sovev*), which is what dictates and gives power to the inner manifest lights (*Ohr Pnimi*), as explained elsewhere.[75]) This being so, what then is this matter of the unification of the Holy One, blessed is He, and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) accomplished by fulfilling the *mitzvot* specifically?

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Rather, the explanation is that, in truth, even now we need to draw forth His desire to create the worlds, through our arousal from below. This is as stated in Etz Chayim,[76] that at first, the arousal was[77] "because He delights in kindness," but

[75] See Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 90b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5648 p. 180; 5650 p. 329; 5679 p 665 and on; Discourse entitled "*Bereishit Bara*" 5691 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 p. 95 and on), and elsewhere.

[76] Etz Chayim, Shaar 8 (Shaar Drushei Nekudot) Ch. 6

[77] Micah 7:18

afterwards, it depends on arousal from below. This is because the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One transcends all *Sefirot* and qualities, as stated,[78] "He is One, but not a numerical one of the ten *Sefirot* whatsoever... He is wise but not with a knowable wisdom..." to the point that "He is not of any of these qualities at all etc." (As explained elsewhere,[79] when we call Him wise, blessed is He, it is only to remove the notion that He is lacking wisdom, but this is not to say the He is wise in a way of actual wisdom, called a "knowable wisdom.")

Now, just as He is completely removed and transcends the aspects of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, or the emotional qualities (*Midot*), He likewise is removed from the aspect of desire (*Ratzon*). For even the arousal of His desire to create, only comes about through constriction (*Tzimtzum*). For, as we see, the word "desire-*Ratzon*-רצון" shares the same letters as the word "pipe-*Tzinor*-צנור,"[80] [which constricts the flow]. Hence, it too is a completely novel creation relative to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*).

This is akin to the words of the prayer,[81] "In His kindness He renews the act of creation every day, constantly." That is, the drawing forth of His desire to create and bring the worlds into being at every moment is a matter of novelty and

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[78] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a

[79] See Likkutei Torah, Pekudei 6c; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 1,080; Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 584 and on; 5693 p. 528 and on.

[80] See Likkutei Torah of the Arizal, Genesis 25:21 (Toldot); Exodus 34:7 (Ki Tisa); Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar HaSelichot, Ch. 8; Also see Zohar III 289a; Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 28 (148a); Torah Ohr Yitro 69b; Likkutei Torah Matot 83a; Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2 p. 119 and on.

[81] In the "*Yotzer*" blessing of the Shema recital.

renewal, because relative the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, it is novel and requires renewal, being that it has no relation to Him whatsoever.

This accords to the explanation in the discourse entitled, "And the entire nation saw," of the year 5665.[82] It therefore is necessary for us to constantly draw forth this aspect of His desire anew, that He should constrict Himself, as it were, and desire to create the worlds and bring them into existence.

This is like how on Rosh HaShanah we renew the drawing forth of the desire for the creation of the worlds, which, in general, is the matter of arousing His desire for kingship, for "there is no king without a nation."[83] This is because on Rosh HaShanah, everything reverts to its initial state,[84] and the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One becomes completely removed from the aspect of desire (*Ratzon*).

This is why on Rosh HaShanah it is necessary to draw forth a desire for kingship and the existence of the worlds. This is accomplished through accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven with our very essence and through the recitation of the ten verses of Kingship (*Malchiyot*). In other words, it is a "remembrance of the first day,"[85] on which creation was

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[82] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665, p. 236 and on.

[83] Rabbeinu Bachaye to Genesis 38:30 and beginning of Numbers 24; Sefer HaChayim L'Achei HaMaHaRaL, Sefer Geula V'Yeshuah, Ch. 2; Emek HaMelech Shaar 1, Ch. 1; Tanya, Shaar HaYichud V'HaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 7; Igeret HaKodesh, Epistle 20, p. 130b; Likkutei Torah, Balak 68c; Netzavim 44d, and elsewhere.

[84] Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Rosh HaShanah Ch. 1; Likkutei Torah, Nitzavim 51b, and elsewhere.

[85] See the "*Zichronot*" section of Musaf prayer on Rosh HaShanah (from Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 27a).

brought about "because He delights in kindness,"[86] and we draw forth this desire anew on Rosh HaShanah. The same is true throughout the whole year for,[87] "In His kindness, He renews the act of creation every day, constantly." We therefore need to draw forth this aspect of His desire, constantly.

This is accomplished through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*, as it states,[88] "The Holy One, blessed is He, made a condition with all of creation etc." It similarly states,[89] "These are (*Eileh*-**אלה**) the generations of the heavens and the earth," regarding which the sages commented[90] that the heavens and earth exist, "In the merit of[91] 'These are the names (*Eileh Shemot*-**אלה** שמות) of the children of Israel' and in the merit of[92] 'These are the *mitzvot* (*Eileh HaMitzvot*-**אלה** המצות)."'

This is why Torah scholars are called[93] "builders," for they are involved in the construction of the world. On the simplest level, this is because through their involvement in Torah study they draw forth His desire to create the worlds and it is through this that the worlds are sustained. This is the simple meaning of the teaching,[94] "The righteous sustain the world that was created through ten utterances."

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[86] Micah 7:18
[87] See the "*Yotzer*" blessing of the Shema recital ibid.
[88] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 88a; Avoda Zarah 5a
[89] Genesis 2:4
[90] See Midrash Shemot Rabbah 48:1; Midrash Tanchuma Vayakhel 4
[91] Exodus 1:1
[92] Leviticus 27:34; Numbers 36:13
[93] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 114a
[94] Mishnah Avot 5:1

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Now, it is explained elsewhere[95] that the drawing forth of vitality to sustain the worlds, which "are renewed in His kindness," is through doing one's business dealings honestly and faithfully. This is because the creation of the worlds is called[96] "work-*Melachah*-מלאכה," and this is why the word "work-*Melachah*-מלאכה-96" has the same numerical value as *HaShem's*-יהו"ה title, "Benevolent God Lord-*E"l Adon"ay*-א"ל אדנ"י-96."[97]

This is because His title "Benevolent God Lord-*E"l Adon"ay*-א"ל אדנ"י" relates to actualization,[98] and corresponds to the matter of the "work-*Melachah*-מלאכה" of creating the worlds, which are renewed by His kindness.

The drawing forth of this renewal is accomplished through doing our business dealings faithfully and honestly, for this too is called "work-*Melachah*-מלאכה." We know this from what the prophet Yonah was asked,[99] "What is your work-*Melachah*-מלאכה," about which the commentaries[100] explain that they asked him, "Do you do your business faithfully (*b'Emunah*)?" In other words, when a person conducts his business and does his work with honesty and faithfulness, without a shred of sin, cheating or theft, Heaven forbid, he

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[95] Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 Vol. 1, p. 4 and on; 5679, p. 40 and on; 5698, p. 82 and on.

[96] Ohr HaTorah, Yitro, p. 951

[97] Me'orei Ohr, Ot Mem, Section 30; Ohr HaTorah, Bereishit Vol. 2, p. 458a; Yitro, p. 955.

[98] Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Olam HaAsiyah, Ch. 3; Likkutei Torah Masei 89b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 1, p. 149; Vol. 2, p. 375

[99] Jonah 1:8

[100] See Metzudat David to Jonah 1:8 ibid.

causes the limitless light of the Unlimited One to be drawn into the aspect of "work-*Melachah*-מלאכה" etc.

Now, this can be explained according to what is written elsewhere,[101] that there are two kinds of "work-*Melachah*-מלאכה" corresponding to two kinds of servants. The first servant performs lowly work, such as chopping wood and the like. These are tasks that are below the dignity and honor of the master to do himself, like chopping wood or setting the table and the like. When the servant performs these tasks, he serves his master by doing work that the master himself would not lower himself to do. This is called a poor servant, who takes pleasure from the labor of his hands and the toil of his work. The work is lowly, but is fitting to his stature and being, and at fitting times, he is compensated for his work.

The second servant is one who performs refined and intellectual tasks, things that the master himself would also do, such as managing the business, cutting diamonds and precious stones, and the like. These are honorable professions that enrich the master. Therefore, when the servant performs this work, he is called "**his** servant," for he performs work that the master himself would otherwise do and completes in place of his master.

This analogy may be applied to understanding the service of *HaShem*-ה"והי as well. This is because the creation

[101] See the discourse entitled "*v'Atah Yisroel*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 ibid.; Also see Shaarei Teshuvah of the Mittler Rebbe Vol. 1 p. 71a and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Hanachot 5577 p. 292; Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 p. 171; 5679 p. 42; Also see the discourses entitled "*Achat Sha'alti*" and "*Deershoo HaShem*" 5724 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5724 p. 5 and on; p. 15 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5724, Discourse 1 & Discourse 2).

and existence of the worlds is from the aspect of the Supernal speech of Kingship-*Malchut* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), as it states,[102] "And God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם said," and[103] "The world was created with ten utterances." This is because the speech of the Holy One blessed is He, is considered to be an action.[104]

This may be compared to lowly work, such as chopping trees, about which it states,[105] "It is not fitting for the King to be involved in matters of a commoner," for it would involve lowering himself greatly. This is the meaning of the Rabbinic adage,[106] "In a place that you find *HaShem's*-יהו"ה greatness, that is where you find His humility." This is why, in this case, a servant who is compensated for his work is necessary.

(Nevertheless, one must fulfill the words of the sages,[107] "Do not be like servants who serve their master to receive reward." In other words, when it states that the toil should not be done only for reward, we could say that this kind of toil could solely be to receive the reward, which is not so of intellectual toil. This is because intellectual toil is not for any reward, but for the toil itself. The proof is that even the master himself performs this higher kind of toil. In contrast, in the other kind of toil, even if the servant is not working for the sake of compensation, nonetheless, generally speaking, this kind of

[102] Genesis 1:3 and on; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 4, and elsewhere.

[103] Mishnah Avot 5:1

[104] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 44:22; Yalkut Shimoni Lech Lecha 78; Rashi to Genesis 15:18; Talmud Bavli Shabbat 119b

[105] Zohar III 149b

[106] Talmud Bavli, Megillah 31a

[107] Mishnah Avot 1:3

work is usually done for compensation. In other words, the work itself is not paramount and essential in and of itself, and if it were possible to do without it, it would not be done at all. It therefore is not of paramount importance, but only to receive reward etc.)

This is as stated in Zohar (Pinchas 223a), about the three kinds of servants[108] mentioned in the "Prayer of David."[109] About this kind of toil David stated,[110] "Save your servant...for I am poor and impoverished etc." At first, he approaches as a beggar standing at the door, so that afterwards he may receive reward. In other words, through the aspect of lowliness, in that he lowers himself during prayer, like a beggar who has nothing of his own, he affects a response of lowliness from Above in Godliness, in that *HaShem*-יהו"ה also lowers Himself, as it were, to create and vitalize the worlds.

This is like accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom, which is literally compared to a yoke that is imposed upon a person. In other words, this is when a person does not truly desire it, but must force himself to do so, by accepting the yoke. That is, it specifically applies to a person for whom Godliness is greatly concealed in his soul, in that he altogether does not become aroused by matters of Godliness. The rectification for this is to accept the yoke of Heaven upon himself (*Kabalat Ol Malchut Shamayim*), specifically by force

[108] Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 ibid. & Shaarei Teshuvah ibid.

[109] Psalm 86

[110] Psalm 86:2 - 86:1 in reverse order; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 ibid. p. 265.

of willpower.[111] That is, in every matter, he forces himself to do the opposite of his desire.

This even helps him overpower the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the external husks (*Kelipah*). Though he has no feeling for Godliness whatsoever, he does the right thing anyways, by accepting the yoke of Heaven upon himself (*Kabalat Ol*). However, this is comparable to a poor servant, who has no personal desire for Godliness, in and of himself. Rather, he only pleads,[112] "My God, save your servant." In and of itself, this kind of service is not a lofty service that is of paramount importance but is simply a necessary service.

The second kind of servant is one who performs honorable work that the master would otherwise do himself, such as cutting diamonds and other precious stones. He does this instead of his master. This refers to drawing down Godly revelations into the worlds by fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*. This is the matter of wealth.[113] In other words, it is not merely to vitalize and sustain the worlds, but is rather an aspect of wealth, in that it draws down additional revelation of Godliness into the worlds, in excess of what is merely needed to sustain them.

This may be understood[114] through the verse,[115] "Your cheeks are comely with rows, your neck with beads." The words "your neck with beads" refers to the aspect of precious stones and diamonds that are bound together by a thread. The

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[111] Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562, p. 264 and on.

[112] Psalm 86:2

[113] Sefer HaMaamarim 5660 p. 53 and on; Meluket Vol. 4, p. 25, p. 36

[114] This next section is based on Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim p. 13a; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5564 p. 9 and on.

[115] Song of Songs 1:10

thread goes through and unites them all, so that they become inseparable.

This is analogous to,[116] "The voice is the voice of Yaakov," which refers to the voice of Torah,[117] "whose foundation is in the holy mountains," referring to the aspect of the supernal Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

It manifests within physical matters, such as the six orders of the Mishnah, which include the order of *Zera'im* (planting) and *Mo'ed* (holidays) etc., [that is, the Torah laws *Halachot*-הלכות]. This is why it is called[118] "The pathways of *HaShem*-יהו"ה," because it is like a path or road upon which a person travels from his place to another distant place. Likewise, Torah constitutes the "travel-*Haleechot*-הלכות" of Wisdom-*Chochmah* through the whole chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*), until it reaches this world.

This is called "the voice of Yaakov-יעקב," which is a composite of the letter *Yod*-י and the word *Ekev*-heel-עקב.[119] This represents the "thread" of Wisdom-*Chochmah* that[120] "threads through from the highest end to the lowest end." In other words, it may even be found in the concluding end, which is very distant from the beginning end. The "lowest end" refers

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[116] Genesis 27:22

[117] Psalms 87:1

[118] Psalms 25:10

[119] Etz Chayim, Shaar 3 (Shaar Seder HaAtzilut of Rabbi Chayim Vital), Ch. 2; Pardes Rimonim Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchai HaKinuyim) Ch. 10, section on "Yaakov."

[120] Exodus 26:28; Zohar I 1b; Zohar II 175c, and elsewhere; Also see Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim ibid., which cites to Likkutei Torah Tzav 9b; Likkutei ibid. 8d; Zohar II 175b.

to this world, which is called[121] "the world of separation" (*Alma d'Pruda*).

Nevertheless, the Supernal "voice" is drawn down from Above, so that even this world is connected and unified to *HaShem's*-יהו"ה unity, blessed is He. The same is true of the *mitzvot,* which also are called, "The ways of *HaShem*-יהו"ה," since it is through them that *HaShem's*-יהו"ה limitless light is drawn down to manifest within physical objects, unifying them to His limitless light, blessed is He. (See Torah Ohr,[122] in the discourse entitled "*Mi KaHaShem Elokeinu HaMagbehee*.")

Now, Above in Godliness, this represents the drawing down of the Line-*Kav*, which is called,[123] "The precious and holy thread" (*Chuta Yakeera Kadishah*) because it illuminates and manifests within Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and within the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) in general, so that there can be an illumination and revelation of the Line-*Kav* even in the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) in that it is like a thread that unifies.

Now, the aspect of boring holes through the precious stones, thus making it possible for them to be bound together, refers to the fact that one must make an empty space within himself, so to speak, as in the verse,[124] "My heart is empty within me." That is, one must become an empty vessel in order

[121] Zohar I 22a; 155a; Zohar III 110a (Ra'aya Mehemna)
[122] Torah Ohr, Miketz, p. 38c and on; 39b and on,
[123] Zohar III 134a
[124] Psalms 109:22

to contain[125] that which is drawn down from the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. This is because His limitless light only dwells or becomes revealed in a person who has completely nullified his own existence (*Bittul B'Metziyut*) to *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, to the point that he literally is as nothing (*Ein*). He thus takes up no space at all and is not a separate something (*Yesh*) unto himself.

One achieves this self-nullification (*Bitul*) through the "voice of Yaakov (*Kol Yaakov*-קול יעקב)," as it states,[126] "the voice (*Kol*-קול) arouses the intention (*Kavanah*-כוונה)." This refers to the level of "intention" (*Kavanah*-כוונה) of the soul, in which the soul desires to leave the sheath of the body and "gush into the bosom of her Father," with total nullification of self, to become unified with the source of all life and pleasure, the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He.

Thus, the drawing down of vitality through doing business honestly and faithfully is like the simple servant who serves his master to receive reward. In other words, this only draws down the vitality necessary to sustain the worlds. However, through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*, we draw down actual revelation of His Godliness into the world.

The difference between these two kinds of work and labor may be understood in a more refined way, as follows: Simple work, like chopping wood etc., or doing one's business honestly and faithfully, corresponds to the matter of the work

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[125] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 40a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5634 p. 302 and on; 5660 p. 74 and on, and elsewhere.

[126] Reishit Chochmah, Shaar HaKedushah Ch. 15; Shnei Luchot HaBrit, p. 82b; Tur Orach Chayim, Siman 61; Shulchan Aruch Admor HaZaken, Siman 65, 101:3; Sefer HaMaamarim 5659, p. 6.

of affecting refinements (*Avodat HaBirurim*). This refers to the work of gathering and assembling the sparks of Godliness that have fallen into this "world of separation" (*Alma D'Pruda*). This is the meaning of the verse,[127] "And you shall gather your grain," as explained elsewhere.[128]

This is accomplished through doing one's work or attending to one's business in physical matters, when it is done honestly and faithfully, without the slightest hint of transgression. Through conducting oneself honestly in his business affairs, a person refines and gathers the Godly sparks that have become scattered and separated in these physical matters. This is all the more so if his intentions are for the sake of Heaven, in that his desire to make a profit is for the purpose of giving charity, studying Torah and doing *mitzvot* etc.

This is likewise so if his business dealings do not distract him from his prayers and Torah study. That is, he does not become so totally consumed and absorbed in his work that it impedes his spirituality. Rather, through conducting his business affairs in the proper manner, he refines and uplifts the Godly sparks hidden in physical matters.

This also includes eating for the sake of Heaven. That is, though the food he eats is physical, he makes the appropriate blessings before and after eating, thus uplifting the food. Moreover, for him, the act of eating itself is for the sake of Heaven, rather than simply to satisfying his lusts. Instead, he

[127] Deuteronomy 11:14
[128] Sefer HaMaamarim 5626 p. 169; p. 171; 5631 Vol. 1, p. 5, and elsewhere.

eats only with the purpose in mind of deriving the energy to study Torah and pray.[129]

This is especially true if while eating he consciously intends to derive vitality from the sparks of holiness in the food,[130] as the verse states,[131] "Not by bread alone does man live, but by everything that proceeds out of the mouth of *HaShem*-יהו"ה does man live etc." This refines the sparks that fell into physicality and uplifts them.

However, as known,[132] this ascent is only within the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), but does not bring about their ascent to become subsumed within the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). Rather, it only is through the **total** nullification of one's being (*Bittul B'Metziyut*) that there can be ascent to the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

This is as known[133] regarding the difference between Yosef and the other tribes. The service of the other tribes was to refine the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), which is the nullification (*Bittul*) of the aspect of the name *Ba"N*-ב"ן (יו"ד ה"ה ו"ו ה"ה) and is only the negation of the "something" (*Bittul HaYesh*). Through this kind of self-nullification, one draws down a radiance of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) into the world of Creation (*Briyah*), within

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[129] See Tanya, Ch. 7 (11a and on).

[130] Likkutei Torah of the Arizal, to Deut. 8:3; Torah Ohr, Noach 9d; Beshalach 65d; Likkutei Torah, Tzav, 13b; Emor, 38c; Matot 81b; Eikev 14a

[131] Deuteronomy 8:3

[132] Torah Ohr, Vayeishev 28a and on; Torat Chayim, Vayeishev 66b and on.

[133] Torah Ohr, Hosafot to Vayechi 103a and on; Also see the citations in Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 63.

the chamber of the Holy of Holies (*Kodesh HaKodoshim*) of the world of Creation (*Briyah*), as explained elsewhere.[134]

In contrast, Yosef was the aspect of the nullification (*Bittul*) of the name *Ma"H*-מ"ה (יו"ד ה"א וא"ו ה"א) which is the matter of the total nullification of his very being (*Bittul b'Metziyut*). Through this, he could uplift all the holy sparks so that they actually became subsumed within the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

Moreover, through this, there is a drawing down of actual revelation of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) into the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*). It is through prayer with the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) (as well as Torah that is studied in a way that is from Above to below, as explained elsewhere)[135] and through the fulfillment of Torah and *mitzvot*, that there is a drawing down of light and revelation from Above to below.

This then, is the meaning of the statement that the righteous sustain the world, for they draw down revelation of Godliness and the revelation of the Line-*Kav*, which radiates within Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

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Additionally, we may say that the fact that the Jewish people are called "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One," refers to the fact that through Torah and *mitzvot*, they draw down a revealed illumination of His will in the world.

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[134] Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1, p. 56 and on; Vol. 2, p. 31 and on

[135] Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 291 and on; p. 289 and on; 5659 p. 162 and on

For although there is a drawing down of His will to the worlds, as in the statement, "It arose in His will to create the worlds," nevertheless, His will does not radiate in a revealed way. The only revelations that are drawn down are the revelations of the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*). However, His will, as it is, in and of itself, does not radiate in a revealed way. However, through our work in serving Him we draw down actual revelation of His will into the world.

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Now, from all the above, we can understand the matter of the Sukkah, which is the revelation of the encompassing lights (*Makif*) that correspond to the covering-*Schach* and shade of the *Sukkah*. On Rosh HaShanah we draw down the desire (*Ratzon*) for the worlds, this being the matter of His desire for kingship that is drawn to the worlds, being that "there is no king without a nation." Therefore, there automatically is a drawing down of desire for worlds. The actual revelation, however, takes place on Sukkot. This is as stated,[136] "Blow the shofar at the new moon when it is covered (*BaKeseh*-בכסא),[137] for the day of our festival." For, on Rosh HaShanah and Yom Kippur the moon is still hidden and concealed.

That is, although on Yom Kippur there is a drawing down of light, it nevertheless remains Above and is not drawn down below. Rather, the revelation below specifically occurs

[136] Psalms 81:4

[137] In Psalms 81:4 it is spelled "בכסה" [which shares the same letters as "in the Sukkah-*BaSukkah*-בסכה"].

on Sukkot (*Sukkah*-סכה), which takes place on the full moon, and this is the meaning of the [continuing] words, "for the day of our festival." However, even then, the revelation is still in a transcendent, encompassing way (*Makif*). Therefore, it is specifically through the *mitzvah* of waving the Lulav that it radiates in an inner manner (*Pnimiut*).

This is because[138] the Lulav corresponds to the drawing down of Knowledge-*Da'at* into the female-*Nukvah* aspect of *Zeir Anpin*, which is located at the chest of *Zeir Anpin*.[139] In other words, it draws it down into the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* of Kingship-*Malchut* which corresponds to the chest (*Chazeh*) of *Zeir Anpin* etc. This is a drawing down of an inwardly manifest light (*Ohr Pnimee*). This is why, optimally, the *mitzvah* of Lulav should be performed in the Sukkah, so that the encompassing light (*Makif*) should be drawn down in an inwardly manifest way (*Pnimiut*).

Because of this, when the first day of the festival falls out on Shabbat, the *mitzvah* of Lulav is not performed, because as known, on Shabbat there also is a drawing down of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) in an inner way (*b'Pnimiyut*). This is also why we do not perform the *mitzvah* of Tefillin on Shabbat,[140] because Tefillin correspond to the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the four parts of the mind (*Mochin*), and this

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[138] Regarding the coming section see Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 57d; Siddur Im DA"Ch 244b and on.

[139] Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar HaLulav Ch. 3; Siddur Im DA"Ch 263c and on.

[140] Mishnat Chassidim, Mesechet Shacharit D'Shabbat, 1:2; Pri Etz Chayim ibid., Ch. 19; Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah, Vol. 6, p. 2,489; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 2, p. 458; 5670 p. 201; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1, p. 492; Also see the later discourses entitled "*Yehudah Atah*" (*Hemshech* 5672 p. 172); "*v'Aseeta Chag Shavuot*" (p. 317).

is why they are worn protruding above one's head.[141] On Shabbat the encompassing light (*Makif*) radiates in an inner way, and therefore it is unnecessary for the *mitzvah* of Lulav to be performed, in that the inner illumination happens in any event.

However, during the time of the Holy Temple they would perform the *mitzvah* of Lulav when the first day of the festival fell out on Shabbat. This is because there are various levels in the encompassing lights (*Makifim*), and although on Shabbat, the encompassing light (*Makif*) radiates in an inner manner (*b'Pnimiyut*), nevertheless by performing the *mitzvah* of Lulav they were able to draw down a more inner and transcendent encompassing light (*Makif HaElyon*). This is why they performed the *mitzvah* of Lulav even on Shabbat, to draw down this loftier encompassing light (*Makif HaElyon*). However, this only took place during the time of the Holy Temple, because at that time they had the ability to draw down this more supernal encompassing light (*Makif HaElyon*) and it therefore took precedence over Shabbat, even outside the borders of Israel. (For the reason as to why it was performed even outside of the borders of Israel, see what is written in Likkutei Torah,[142] in the discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*") (Additionally, this was specifically the case on the first day of the festival, for it was then that this primary revelation took place etc.)

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[141] This will be discussed at greater length in the next discourse (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 50).

[142] Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanahm, p. 57d

However, nowadays it is not performed on Shabbat. This is because during exile (*Galut)* it is not possible to draw down the upper encompassing light (*Makif HaElyon*) in a way of revealed illumination, since presently, this aspect cannot be drawn down by the Lulav in an inner manner (*b'Pnimiyut*). However, whatever is drawn down by the *mitzvah* of Lulav is drawn down by Shabbat itself anyways. Therefore, in our times, we do not perform the *mitzvah* of Lulav on Shabbat, even if it is the first day of the holiday.

Discourse 5

"*BaYom HaShemini… - The eighth day…*"

Delivered on Shemini Atzeret, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "The eighth day will be restricted for you etc." About this Midrash Rabbah states,[3] "This is analogous to a king who made a seven-day feast to which he invited all the people of the land. After the seven days of feasting, he said to his beloved friend, 'Our obligation to the people of the land has been fulfilled. Now, let me and you have a small feast together from whatever you find.' In the same way, the Holy One, blessed is He, said to the Jewish people, 'The eighth day will be restricted for you.' That is, now let Me and you have a small feast together, just[4] 'one bullock offering and one ram offering etc.'" This is to say that on the other days of the festival of Sukkot, they offered seventy bullocks corresponding to the seventy nations,[5] but on Shemini Atzeret,

[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*v'Heet'halachti b'Tochachem*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Vol. 2 p. 414 and on; Discourse entitled "*Lehavin HaHagah b'Likkutei Amarim*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Inyanim Vol. 1 p. 113 and on, as cited in the later notes.

[2] Numbers 29:35

[3] Bamidbar Rabbah 21:24

[4] Numbers 29:36

[5] Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 55b; Bamidbar Rabbah 21:24 ibid.

only one bull was offered, corresponding to the Jewish people alone.

We therefore must understand the offering of the seventy bullocks on behalf of the seventy nations and how it corresponds and draws influence to them. What is this influence and why was it specifically on the festival of Sukkot that the seventy bullocks were offered?

Furthermore,[6] from the words of Midrash, it appears as if the influence drawn to the Jewish people on Shemini Atzeret is from the same level as what was drawn to the seventy ministering angels of the nations on Sukkot, as it states, "Now, let Me and you have a small feast together, from what you find etc." This seems to indicate that the influence drawn to the Jewish people is from the same level, which is not understood, for certainly the influence to the Jewish people should be from a much higher and loftier level!

Now, to understand this, we first must preface with what was discussed before[7] about the Jewish people being called, "Those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One." That is, through serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה with Torah and *mitzvot* we draw down Godly revelation into the worlds. That is, we draw down the revelation of the Line-*Kav* that illuminates Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), so that it also will illuminate the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) in a revealed way. Moreover,

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[6] See the discourses entitled "*BaYom HaShemini*" and "*Vayomer Lo Yehonatan… Machar Chodesh*" 5736, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 4 and Discourse 5.

[7] In the previous discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 40 and on).

through this, even His will (*Ratzon*) illuminates the world in a revealed way.

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However, all the above refers to the manifestation of lights and revelations in the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) but cannot yet be considered as being the revelation of a new, novel light. However, the true intent of "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One" is that through fulfilling His *mitzvot* we draw down the inner Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One that transcends the revelations of the Line-*Kav*. This revelation transcends the desire to merely create and bring worlds into being.

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Now, as known, the explanation is that there are two levels of desire.[8] There is the innerness of desire and the externality of desire. Above in Godliness, these correspond to the innerness and externality of the Crown-*Keter*. This is like the statement in Tikkunei Zohar,[9] "The limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is inner and the Supernal Crown-*Keter* is external." In other words, the Crown-*Keter* is the externality (*Chitzoniyut*), whereas the limitless light of the Unlimited One within it, is its innerness (*Pnimiyut*).

[8] See Likkutei Torah, Bamidbar 18b; Shlach 38c; Shir HaShirim 28d, 33d, and elsewhere.

[9] Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 22 (68b)

By way of analogy, this may be understood as it is in man, who also has both inner and external desire. His external desire becomes revealed, whereas though his inner desire is the ultimate intent, it remains concealed and not openly expressed.

This may be seen in one's involvement in his business matters.[10] His investment of himself into all the particulars of his business is openly revealed, in that his mind and thoughts are immersed in the business, and he makes various business trips and the like, to advance it.

However, except in a very external way, these activities are not at all his ultimate desire. Rather, his ultimate desire and purpose in all his business activities is to turn a profit. This is the true, underlying reason and motivation for his desire to engage in business in the first place. However, this ultimate inner intent is not readily revealed or recognizable. It remains hidden and all that is observable is his external involvement in the business. However, this involvement is only secondary to his true inner intent and desire [to turn a profit].

This may also be understood through a person who wants to build a house to live in. Here, because his need for shelter and furnishings is as great as his need for food and clothing etc., his will is revealed in his desire to build a house. Nonetheless, this desire for a house does not constitute his entire inner essential desire but is only its manifestation based on reason.

That is, his reason is that he needs a place to live in, just as he needs clothes to wear and food to eat. Moreover, the kind of house he needs or desires will be according to his income and

[10] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 136; 5638 p. 40; 5665 p. 151, and elsewhere.

social standing etc. However, this is not his inner, essential desire. Rather, his inner, essential desire[11] is that in the inner hidden recesses of his soul, he delights in having a home [to dwell in] with all his being. That is, his delight in having a dwelling place is beyond any specific reason, in that ultimately, it is the simple pleasure of his essential self.

That is, in truth, his desire for a dwelling place has nothing at all to do with reason, but originates in the inner essential desire of his essential self. Only later, when it comes out as an external desire, does it vest in reason, such as the need for shelter or that it would be good to have a home to call his own etc.

However, these reasons originate in the externality of his desire, whereas in his inner self it is not at all because of any reason or rationalization. Proof of this is the fact that if there would be logical reasons to oppose this desire, though this automatically would weaken the revealed external desire, nonetheless, his inner essential desire for a dwelling place would remain as strong as ever.

That is, in the inner essence of his soul, he would still want a home, without this desire being diminished whatsoever. This is because the inner desire has nothing to do with reason but results from his essential self.

This then, is the primary distinction between the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*) and the externality of the desire (*Chitzoniyut HaRatzon*). The externality of the desire is a composite of various matters, such as intellect and reasoning, which cause one to desire one thing over another.

[11] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid.

Although this too only originates in desire, rather than intellect, it nevertheless comes out in a revealed reason and rationalization for the desire, or it could be composed of emotional traits, such as love, kindness, grandeur or glory, and the like.

In contrast, the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*) is not at all a composite, but reflects the dictates of the essential self, as it is, in and of itself. It thus is quite impossible for a person to express or reveal his inner essential desire by way of insight or comprehension.

This is why it is called "the hidden and concealed desire" or "the simple desire," because even as it comes into revelation, it only is revealed as is, in its simple essential state. Unlike the external desire, it cannot be expressed or explained according to reason and intellect. This is because the inner desire is beyond reason, and as such, is unlimited.

This is not so of the external desire. That is, since it comes out as a revealed light for a specific matter, that matter therefore limits it according to reason and intellect. In contrast, since it is not composed of reason and intellect, the inner desire does not manifest as a revealed light, and therefore, in and of itself, it is unlimited and beyond definition.

Through this example in man, we can now understand how it is Above, in the Supernal Crown-*Keter*, within which there are inner and external aspects. The externality of the desire (*Chitzoniyut HaRatzon*) is that which is drawn out as a revealed desire. This is like the statement,[12] "When it arose in His will to create the worlds," which is an aspect of revealed

[12] Zohar Vol. 1, p. 86b

desire (*Ratzon Galuy*). It manifests as a composite, into the aspects of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah* and the emotive qualities (*Midot*) of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). This is comparable to the intellect and reasoning for a desire in man below. Similarly, the verse states about the creation,[13] "In the beginning-*Bereishit*-בראשית" which is translated[14] as "with Wisdom-*b'Chochmeta*-בחוכמתא."

Now, is it not so that the creation of the worlds came about from the aspect of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה desire (*Ratzon*)? However, the explanation is that it manifests as a composite with Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, or the emotive qualities (*Midot*) of "He desires kindness,"[15] or "It is the nature of the good to bestow goodness etc."[16]

In other words, these are in a way of revealed desire (*Ratzon Galuy*), which is a composite (*Murkav*) of various matters, and therefore, there is a cause and reason for the desire. (This is because even before the actual revelation of the desire, there already is a hidden reason for it, which is the reason that caused it, such as the "nature of the good." Therefore, once it becomes revealed, it manifests in the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, to be a reason and intellect for the desire etc.) This is the external aspect of Crown-*Keter*, which is called the "head

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[13] Genesis 1:1

[14] Targum Yerushalmi to Genesis 1:1 translates "*Bereishit*-בראשית" as "*b'Chochmah*-בחוכמא." However, see Zohar I 31b that "Yonatan translated '*Bereishit*-בראשית' as '*b'Chochmeta*-בחוכמתא.'"

[15] Micah 7:18

[16] Emek HaMelech, Shaar 1 (Shaar Sha'ashuey HaMelech) Ch. 1; Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah translated as The Gate of Unity & Faith, Ch. 4; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Kuntreisim p. 5.

of Emanation (*Atzilut*)," and does not contain very much of the inner, essential aspect.

An example is the verse,[17] "For I said, the world will be built with kindness." That is, it arose in His desire that the worlds should be built through the quality of Kindness-*Chessed* because[18] "He desires kindness." This is the aspect of the externality of the desire (*Chitzoniyut HaRatzon*) that comes to be revealed in intellect, reasoning and emotions etc., because even the emanation of the ten *Sefirot* with their lights (*Orot*), vessels (*Keilim*) and chambers (*Heichalot*), as in the statement,[19] "He made ten fixtures by which to conduct the world, according to kindness and judgment etc.," are all merely like the above-mentioned external desire for a home and nice furnishings. However, it is not the primary, inner, essential, simple desire or pleasure, because His Essential Self is not vested in it.

In contrast, the innerness of the Crown-*Keter* is considered as being the aspect of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), as in the above-mentioned statement, "The limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is on the inside and the Supernal Crown-*Keter* is on the outside." This refers to the aspect of the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*), which is of the inner Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. It is the aspect of desire as it is in a state of hiddenness and concealment and is called,[20] "the most Hidden of all the hidden and the most Supernal of all the supernal, for

[17] Psalms 89:3
[18] Micah 7:18 ibid.
[19] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a
[20] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a ibid.

no thought at all can grasp Him." In other words, it cannot at all be grasped or revealed in a way of wisdom or emotions, since it is not at all a composite of anything foreign. This is to say that there is no cause or reason at all for this desire. Rather, it is the aspect of the truly simple and essential will of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Essential Self, blessed is He. It completely transcends insight or reason and is therefore of His concealed Essential Self,[21] within which His entire being is vested, as it were, since it is not at all in the realm of revelation in a way of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

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This then, is the root of the *mitzvot* below [in this world]. They truly are called the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*) of the Supernal One, referring to the **innerness** of the Crown-*Keter*. They do not manifest in the revelation of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and intellectual reasoning whatsoever, not even in the aspect of the "Concealed Wisdom" (*Chochmah Stima'ah*) of the Crown-*Keter* called "the hidden reason for the desire" (*Ta'am Kamus LaRatzon*)[22] etc.

For although it is explained elsewhere[23] that "the hidden reason for the desire" is the aspect of the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*), nonetheless, this refers to the desire

[21] Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid. states, "within His Essential Self."

[22] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 21 & Ch. 24, and elsewhere.

[23] Likkutei Torah, VeEtchanan 12a; Shir HaShirm 47d and on; Siddur Im Da"Ch 130c, 161b; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 47a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 2, p. 394, and elsewhere.

concealed in the hidden Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*) of the Crown-*Keter* called, "the hidden reason for the desire" (*Ta'am Kamus LaRatzon*) which cannot come into revealed reason and intellect. This is like the statement,[24] "Silence! It thus arose in thought before Me," indicating a level of thought which does not manifest in revealed reason and intellect that explains why He wants it so. Rather, this desire goes against reason and intellect, in that it was stated in response to Moshe's question,[25] "Is this the Torah and is this its reward?" Rather, although it is a simple desire that is concealed from the intellect, nevertheless, Above, "there is a hidden reason for it."[26] The Holy One, blessed is He, therefore responded, "Silence! It thus arose in thought," which was not merely a stubborn response, Heaven forbid to think so. For in truth, even the hidden and concealed reason (which also is called "intellect that is hidden from all conceptualization" (*Sechel HaNe'elam MiKol Ra'ayon*)) at the very least is still a reason for the desire. Therefore, one way or another, this desire is still a composite of reason and intellect, only that it is hidden intellect (*Sechel Ne'elam*) that transcends revealed insight and grasp. Nonetheless, even here, there still is a reason for the desire.

(This is so, even when the desire is caused by pleasure that transcends reason, that is, the reason (*Ta'am*-טעם) is not intellectual, and is not even a concealed intellect, but is solely

[24] Talmud Bavli, Menachot 29b

[25] Talmud Bavli, Menachot 29b

[26] In the Hebrew the Rebbe Rashab uses a play on the verse in Deuteronomy 32:34 – "concealed with Me."

due to the "taste" (*Ta'am*-טעם) or pleasure[27] of it.[28] Even this is not truly the inner essential desire, because even here, there still is a cause for the desire, which is the "taste" or pleasure of it.)

The true aspect of the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*) is that there is no reason for it at all,[29] not even a hidden reason (not even "taste" or pleasure). This then is the primary aspect of the innerness and essence of the desire, for as known,[30] it is rooted in the essence of the skull (*Galgalta*)[31] which even transcends the hidden wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'a*)[32] of the Crown-*Keter*. This level is the primary root of the *mitzvot*, for in truth, they are rooted in the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-*Keter*, which even transcends the hidden reasons (*Ta'am Kamus*) of the will of the Supernal One in the *mitzvot*. This level will be revealed in the coming future,

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[27] [The word for "reason-*Ta'am*-טעם" also means "taste-*Ta'am*-טעם" or flavor.]

[28] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 137; 5660 p. 15; 5663 p. 27; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 89) and elsewhere; Also see the discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5728 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 316 (Vol. 2 p. 249 in earlier editions) translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5728, Discourse 16; Discourse entitled "*Chayav Inish*" 5718 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5718, p. 162 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5718, Vol. 2, Discourse 16).

[29] See Shnei Luchot HaBrit 4b in the note (citing Rabbi Yosef Alkastilla); Yonat Eilem Ch. 2; Torat Chayim, Noach 63a; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 17 & Ch. 21, and elsewhere.

[30] See *Hemshech* 5672, Vol. 1, p. 393, explained in Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid.

[31] See Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2, p. 231 (i.e., "He specifies the 'essence-*Etzem*-עצם of the skull' (in which the term 'essence-*Etzem*-עצם' also means 'the bone-*Etzem*-עצם') perhaps in order to negate the aspect of the "hairs" (*Sa'arot*) of the skull (*Galgalta*), based on what is explained in the later discourse *BaYom HaShemini* 5667 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 495 and on); Also see Hosafot to Torah Ohr, beginning of Tetzaveh.")

[32] See Igrot Kodesh ibid. in explanation of the fact that "the essence of the skull (*Galgalta*)" is the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* of the Long Patient One-*Arich Anpin* which is lower than Kindness-*Chessed* of The One of Ancient Days-*Atik Yomin*.

and is the meaning of the teaching,[33] "The reward of a *mitzvah* is the *mitzvah*," in that the **true** reward is that the essence of the *mitzvah* itself will be revealed.[34]

This is because all the revelations of the present time, even including the grasp of the loftiest souls in the Garden of Eden, who delight in the ray of the indwelling Divine presence of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, the *Shechinah*,[35] are in a way of reason, intellect or pleasure, of which it is a composite. Though it may be in a way of hidden and concealed reason, nonetheless, it still is an aspect of reason. Thus, they only delight in a "ray"[36] of their Torah learning and service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He. However, they do not reach the level of the essence of the *mitzvot* themselves, as they are in His inner desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*), in which there altogether is no reason for the desire, not even a concealed reason.

It is this essence of the *mitzvot* that will be revealed in the coming future. This is what Moshiach will reveal of the reasons for the *mitzvot*, as they essentially are.[37] (This will be explained later about desire (*Ratzon*) and pleasure (*Taanug*).)[38] It therefore states about Moshiach,[39] "Behold, My servant will become wise, he will be exalted and become uplifted and exceedingly high." This is a much higher level than the concealed wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*) of the Crown-*Keter*,

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[33] Mishnah Avot 4:2

[34] See Tanya Ch. 37 & 39; Likkutei Torah, Behar p. 42b and on, and elsewhere.

[35] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 17a

[36] See Tanya Ch. 39, and elsewhere.

[37] See Rashi to Song of Songs 1:2; Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 48a; Siddur Im DA"Ch 131a and on.

[38] See the later discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 101 and on).

[39] Isaiah 52:13

as Etz Chaim states[40] that the word "exceedingly-*Me'od*-מאד" refers to the aspect of Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*).

This will even be much loftier than the current revelations of the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Torah, that correspond to the hidden wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'a*) of *Arich Anpin* and *Atik Yomin*,[41] and is called the hidden reasoning for the desire of the Supernal One within each *mitzvah*. For example, the *mitzvot* of Tallit and Tefillin have a concealed reason for the desire of the Supernal One that vests in them.

That is, the garment of the Tallit itself corresponds to the aspect of the general encompassing light (*Makif*) and the Tzitzit that protrude from it represent the drawing down of radiance from the encompassing light (*Makif*),[42] as stated,[43] "The word Tzitzit only means something that protrudes (*Yotzeh*)." Similarly, the four Torah portions of the Tefillin correspond to the four encompassing lights (*Makifim*) in the four aspects of the brain (*Mochin*). This is why they are worn protruding above one's head, as explained elsewhere.[44]

The same is true of all the *mitzvot*, that there is a hidden reason for them, this being the inner aspect of Torah.

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[40] Etz Chayim, Shaar (Shaar Sedfer HaAtzilut) Ch. 2, as also evidenced by the proof given in Etz Chayim there, that "exceedingly-*Me'od*-מאד" shares the same letters as "man-*Adam*-אדם." Also see Biurei HaZohar Vayeishev 23a and on, and the end of the discourse entitled "*Eem Bechukotai*" in *Hemshech* 5666 (from Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2 p. 229); Also see Likkutei Torah Tzav 17a; Ohr HaTorah Na"Ch (Vol. 1) p. 265; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 1, p. 266; 5698 p. 200, and elsewhere.

[41] See Igrot Kodesh Vol. 2 p. 230 ibid.

[42] See Likkutei Torah, Shlach 44b, 46c, 49b; Korach 52b and on, and elsewhere.

[43] Talmud Bavli, Menachot 41a

[44] See Siddur Im DA"Ch, 16a and on, 18d; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefillin 155a and on; Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 46d and on.

Nevertheless, this is not the true innerness of the desire of the Supernal One, called the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-*Keter*, that corresponds to His essential simple desire in the *mitzvot*, for which there altogether is no reason, not even a hidden reason. Currently, this level is drawn down through doing the *mitzvot* in actuality, and will [ultimately] be revealed by Moshiach in the coming future.

This then, is why the Jewish people are called, "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One," in that they actualize and draw down the desire of the Supernal One through the *mitzvot*. In other words, they draw down the inner essential will of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, that transcends all desires for worlds. This is because His desires for worlds are just external desires. It rather is specifically through fulfilling His *mitzvot* that we draw down and fulfill His inner will (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*).

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Now, regarding the statement, "Those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One," we must understand the meaning of [the title] "the Ever Present One-*HaMakom*-המקום," [the literally meaning of which is, "The Place-*HaMakom*-המקום"]. As known,[45] the explanation is that it refers to the light of

[45] Sefer HaIkkarim, Maamar 2, Ch. 17; Emek HaMelech, Shaar 1, Ch. 1; Shaar 8, Ch. 9; Likkutei Torah, Hosafot to Vayikra 51b and on; Sefer HaChakira of the Tzemach Tzedek, p. 75a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 Vol. 2 p. 560 and on; 5643 p. 94; 5680 p. 185 and on; 5687 p. 84 and on; Discourse entitled "*Padah b'Shalom*" 5713, Ch. 4 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5713 p. 52 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5713, Discourse 6); Also see *Hemshech* 5666 p. 637.

HaShem-יהו"ה that surrounds and transcends and all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*). This is as written in Pardes Rimonim,[46] in the section dealing with the word "Place-*Makom*-מקום," that one explanation is that it refers to the Supernal Crown (*Keter Elyon*). That is, the word "Place-*Makom*-מקום" refers to the source, as in the statement,[47] "Blessed is the glory of *HaShem*-יהו"ה from His Place-*MiMekomo*-ממקומו," that is, from the root and source of glory.[48] The same may be understood regarding the statement, "Those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One-*HaMakom*-המקום," that it refers to the matter of drawing down the desire from its very root and source.

However, the Alter Rebbe, of blessed memory, explains in various places[49] that the word "Place-*Makom*-מקום" refers to the aspect of the light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*). This likewise is understood from the explanations in Likkutei Torah of the Arizal,[50] on the verse,[51] "Behold, there is a place (*Makom*-מקום) by Me." Likewise, Zohar Beshalach 63b on the verse,[52] "Let no man go out of his place (*MiMekomo*-ממקומו)," states that the word "his place-

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[46] Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim), Ch. 13, cited in Sefer HaChakirah ibid. p. 75b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 ibid.

[47] Ezekiel 3:12

[48] See at length inMaamarei Admor HaZaken 5569, p. 185 & 196; Derech Mitzvotecha p. 178b and on; p. 183b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 14; 5634 p. 243 and on, and elsewhere.

[49] See Maamarei Admor HaZeken, Hanachot HaRav Pinchas p. 157; 5569 p. 136; Likkutei Torah, Bechukotai 48b; Behaalotcha 29d; Shelach 43a; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Vayikra Vol. 2, p. 825 and on.

[50] Likkutei Torah of the Arizal to Exodus 33:21 (Ki Tisa), cited in Likkutei Torah, Hosafot to Vayikra ibid.; Sefer HaChakirah ibid. 76b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 ibid.; 5643 p. 95; 5657 p. 128.

[51] Exodus 33:21

[52] Exodus 16:29

Mekomo-מקומו" refers to the Lower Glory (*Kavod Tata'a*), which refers to the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, which is the source of all "Space-*Makom*-מקום" below, as written,[53] "Your Kingship is the kingship of all worlds."

This is to say that His aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* is the source of the worlds, which are subject to space and time.[54] Similarly, the aspect of the Supernal emotive *Sefirot* (*Midot*) is called "Space-*Makom*-מקום," being that they represent the aspect of the six directions of three-dimensional space. Therefore, generally, this is the aspect of the light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*), which is referred to as "Space-*Makom*-מקום," because it only is in this aspect in which speaking in terms of space and time is relevant.

This accords with the explanation elsewhere[55] on the matter of time and space, that in time there is past and future in a way of order and gradation, and space consists of [the three dimensions of up-down, front-back, right-left].[56] Likewise, the aspects of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) also represent the aspect of time, as will be explained later,[57] all these matters only being relevant in the aspect of the light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*).

It thus is in this regard that it states that "they actualize the will of the Ever Present One (*HaMakom*-המקום)." That is,

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[53] Psalms 145:13

[54] See Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 7 (88a).

[55] Moreh Nevuchim, Introduction to Part 2 (introduction 15), Ch. 13; Derech Mitzvotecha 57a and on; Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzedek p. 74b.

[56] Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Yesodei HaTorah 2:6; Moreh Nevuchim Part 1, Ch. 8; Likkutei Torah, Hosafot to Vayikra 54b; Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzeddek 74b.

[57] In the discourse entitled "*Vayechulu*" 5666 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 58 and on).

they draw His will down into the aspect of space-*Makom*-מקום. This is the matter of drawing down revelation of His Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*) into the aspect of the source of space, that is, into His general aspect of "filling all worlds" (*Memaleh Kol Almin*) and particularly into the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, until there is actually a revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) below within space.

This is specifically drawn down through *HaShem's*-ה"והי Godly will in His *mitzvot*, and therefore, upon performing the *mitzvot* we say, "For the sake of unifying the Holy One, blessed is He, with His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*)." This is because, in essence, the matter of unifying the Holy One, blessed is He, with His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) specifically brings a revelation of how He transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*) into how He fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*), which specifically comes about through fulfilling the *mitzvot*.

As explained above, since the externality of the desire (*Chitzoniyut HaRatzon*) is a composite, it therefore comes in a limited fashion, in that what it is invariably composed of limits. In contrast, the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*) is not a composite and is thus not limited. It thereby is understood that from the externality of the desire (*Chitzoniyut HaRatzon*), which is limited, there cannot be a drawing down of Godly revelation in the aspect of space. On the contrary, the parameters of time and space are drawn **from** it. Rather, it only is specifically when there is a drawing down of the innerness of

His desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*) that there is a drawing down of Godly revelation in the aspect of space (*Makom*-מקום).

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Now, to clarify this further,[58] we must begin by explaining why all Supernal revelations are called "Light-*Ohr*-אור." To illustrate, there is the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), the light of Wisdom-*Chochmah* (*Ohr HaChochmah*) and the light of Understanding-*Binah* (*Ohr HaBinah*) etc. In the writings of the Arizal, these are called, "Light-*Ohr*-אור," rather than "Influence-*Shefa*-שפע."[59]

The explanation is that although it is known[60] that in the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) from level to level, the lowest level of the upper level is the source and beginning for the existence of the lower level,[61] nonetheless, it is not in the way of cause and effect (*Ila V'Alul*) mentioned by the philosophers.[62] This is because "cause and effect" refers to an actual drawing down from one entity to the

[58] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaZaken Inyanim ibid., and with variations, see *Hemshech* "*v'Khol HaAm Ro'im*" in Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 274 and on.

[59] See Ohr HaTorah, Inyanim p. 110 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 173 and on (in earlier editions see Vol. 2 p. 293 and on, and elsewhere).

[60] See Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 39d; Torah Ohr, Vayishlach 25c; Likkutei Torah, Zot HaBracha 95b; Shir HaShirim 42b and on, and elsewhere.

[61] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 7-8, Ch. 10, and elsewhere.

[62] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken Inyanim ibid. (and Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 ibid.); Also see Likkutei Torah Nitzavim 46c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken HaKetzarim p. 516 and on.

next entity, in which the externality of the cause is drawn down to the effect etc.

However, such is not the case Above in Godliness, in which the being and essence of the upper level is not at all drawn down to the lower level. Rather, only an aspect of light and radiance is drawn from the upper to the lower. By way of example, this may be understood from the rays of the sun, in which the light is altogether not of the sun's essential being.

This likewise is so of the light and vitality of the soul. It too is not of the essential self of the soul but is only like a light and ray. In this regard the ray may be compared to a person's garment, as opposed to his body. Likewise, it is understood that this ray cannot at all be compared to the essential self of the soul. Rather, in comparison to the essential self, it only can be considered to be akin to a garment.

However, it is not actually like a person's garment, which is completely separate from himself and does not at all issue from his body. This is unlike the ray of light that issues from the body of the sun and never actually separates from it. This is because when the sun is concealed, its rays of light also become concealed, whereas when the sun is revealed, its rays radiate round about it. This being so, the sun relative to its rays may be compared to a snail, whose "garment" is part and parcel of himself.[63] In other words, on the one hand, it is like a garment that cannot compare to the essential self, but on the other hand, it is rooted and drawn from the essential self. (For

[63] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 21:5

a thorough explanation of this, see the discourse entitled, "*v'Khol HaAm Ro'eem*,"[64] as previously mentioned.[65])

This may be understood by understanding how it is in man, as in the verse,[66] "From my flesh I shall behold God." For example, this may be understood through contemplating the letters of one's thoughts. (As known,[67] the letters of thought are considered to be an aspect of vessels (*Kelim*). However, here we will use them to illustrate the matter of lights (*Orot*).

Now, in Etz Chayim, Shaar Seder ABY"A, chapter three, it explains that thought (*Machshavah*) is the light that spreads forth in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) etc. We may say that this is because the garment of thought (*Machshavah*) is a special garment, in that it is unified with the light (*Ohr*) vested within it. Because of this, thought may also be called light (*Ohr*).

Now, it may also be explained like this: Since thought (*Machshavah*) is a special garment that is unified with the essential self – that is, with the light (*Ohr*), including the root and source of the light (*Ohr*) – therefore, in this respect, it is unlike the matter of vessels (*Kelim*). In general, vessels (*Keilim*) are not unified with the source of the light (*Ohr*), but only with the light (*Ohr*) vested within them and therefore are only comparable to the thoughts that come by way of actual letters. However, thought (*Machshavah*) itself is unified with the actual essence and source of the light (*Ohr*). This is akin to how all the "motions" of the soul and its desires immediately

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[64] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 ibid., p. 274 and on

[65] In the prior discourse "*Lulav v'Aravah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 37, p. 40).

[66] Job 19:26

[67] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 287 and on, and elsewhere.

manifest in thought. As a result, thought (*Machshavah*) may also be called "desire" (*Ratzon*),[68] because whatever arises in the desire automatically comes into thought, being that it is unified with the essential self.

Nonetheless, in this kind of thought, the thought does not come into actual letters. Moreover, it is unlike speech (*Dibur*), which is an actual separate garment. Rather, though it still is considered to be a garment (*Levush*), thought is connected and unified to its source. It therefore is a fitting analogy for the matter of lights (*Orot*). About this, see Zohar I 65a, regarding the matter of thought, as well as the comments of Mikdash Melech there, where it states that thought (*Machshavah*) corresponds to the aspect of *Atik Yomin*. Also see Pardes Rimonim, Shaar HaTzachtzechoot, Ch. 6. This may also be explained according to the statement elsewhere,[69] that just as the lights (*Orot*) of the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) come from the vessels (*Keilim*) of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), as stated in Etz Chayim[70] that the vessels of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) become the lights (*Orot*) of the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*), likewise, the lights of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) are the aspect of the vessels (*Keilim*) of the ten hidden *Sefirot* (*Eser Sefirot HaGnoozot*) which transcend the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). This then,

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[68] Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 40.

[69] Sefer HaMaamarim 5663, Vol. 1, p. 119; 5677, p. 85; 5688 p. 32.

[70] Etz Chayim, Shaar 44 (Shaar HaShemot, Ch. 1-2; Also see Tanya, Kuntres Acharon 156b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5650 p. 288 and on; 5662 p. 228 and on; 5704 p. 35 and on.

explains how thought (*Machshavah*) may be considered to be an aspect of light (*Ohr*).)

Now, the letters of thought are drawn from the essential self of the soul, as stated in the writings of the Arizal,[71] "the soul is full of letters," as explained elsewhere,[72] and as the verse states,[73] "The man became a living soul," which Onkelos translates as, "The man became a speaking spirit." In other words, the powers of speech and thought are **inherent** to the human soul and are of its essential self. Nonetheless, when the power to think manifests in the mind to think actual thoughts, the thought takes form in tangible letters, which altogether cannot compare to the essence of the soul itself. This is because the essential self of the soul is unlimited and indivisible, and therefore tangible thought cannot be compared to it. Nevertheless, the root that thought is drawn from to manifest as thought is the essential self of the soul, and as the letters exist in the soul, they literally are like the analogy of the ray of light as it exists in the sun.

From all the above, we can understand why the coming into being of the lower level from the upper level is only compared to a ray of light (*Ohr*). In other words, compared to the lower level, the upper level is like its luminary (*Ma'or*), and the lower level is analogous to the ray of light that issues from the upper level, which at its root, is of the essence of the upper

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[71] Etz Chaim, Shaar 5 (Shaar TAN"TA), Ch. 3; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Bamidbar Vol. 1, p. 309 and on;

[72] See Likkutei Torah, Bechukotai, 45d; Naso 26b; Shir HaShirim 4b; Also see the discourse entitled "*Vayedaber… Anochi*" 5666 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5666-5667 p. 41 and on); Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 38.

[73] Genesis 2:7

level, but when it issues and spreads out from it, it becomes an altogether different thing.

(We may say that what is meant here, is that when the light (*Ohr*) manifests within the vessel (*Kli*), it then can be regarded as a separate thing. However, this does not mean that it is actually separate, Heaven forbid to think so,[74] but is only **as if** it is separate.

As explained elsewhere,[75] there are three levels in the lights (*Orot*). The first level is as they are included in the Emanator, *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, about which it states,[76] "You are One, but not numerically." The second level is the aspect of the descent of the light (*Ohr*) from His Essential Self to manifest in vessels (*Keilim*). About this it states in Sefer Yetzirah,[77] "Ten *Sefirot* without whatness," for here, they are still without whatness, that is, without any existence as separate entities, in and of themselves. The third level is when the lights (*Orot*) actually become invested in the vessels (*Keilim*), at which point they take on the being and characteristics of Wisdom-*Chochmah* or Kindness-*Chessed* etc. This is as explained elsewhere,[78] that the vessels (*Keilim*) are the matter of giving "color" to the lights (*Orot*), in that they give description to the light (*Ohr*). See the discourse entitled, "*Tze'enah uRe'enah*" of the year 5660.[79]

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[74] [Since the light (*Ohr*) cannot exist without the Luminary (*Ma'or*), as mentioned before.]

[75] Torat Chayim, Noach 65d and on; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 664 and on.

[76] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a

[77] Sefer Yetzirah 1:5

[78] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5664 p. 47; p. 75 and on, and elsewhere.

[79] Sefer HaMaamarim 5660, p. 113 and on.

Now, it is specifically about the second level that we may say that it is like a garment. For even though it is not a separate entity, nevertheless, since it only is a radiance of a ray, it cannot at all compare to the Essential Self. It therefore is like a garment. In contrast, on the third level, because of the "coloration" of the lights (*Orot*) caused by the vessels (*Keilim*), they can be considered as entities that are separate from the Essential Self, since in the Essential Self this matter is altogether not applicable. See the above-mentioned discourse, "*Tze'enah uRe'enah*.")

Nonetheless, they still are united with the Essential Self, to the point that if the Source would be withdrawn, the ray would cease to be. This would not be so if the chaining down would be in a way of cause and effect (*Eela v'Alul*), from entity to entity, as explained in the above-mentioned discourse entitled "*v'Khol HaAm Ro'im*."[80]

It therefore is this way with all the statures (*Partzufim*) as they descend one from the other. An example is the emotive qualities (*Midot*). Although relative to the power of thought, which issues from them, they are like luminaries with being, nonetheless, relative to their source, which is the power of Understanding-*Binah* and is called,[81] "The mother of the children," they only are like a ray of light. Similarly, Above in Godliness, the stature (*Partzuf*) of *Zeir Anpin* is only a radiance from the quality of Understanding-*Binah*.

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[80] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 ibid., p. 278.

[81] Psalms 113:9; Zohar I 219a; Zohar II 84a; 85b; Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 1; Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Shmini Atzeret 88d, and elsewhere.

This is likewise so of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, relative to the Crown-*Keter*, and is likewise so of the Crown-*Keter*, relative to the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*). That is, the Crown-*Keter* is like desire (*Ratzon*), which only is the spreading forth of radiance from the essential self of the soul.

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Now, in general, about the matter of lights (*Orot*) and vessels (*Keilim*) mentioned in Etz Chayim, these three levels exist on every single level. For example, the power of thought, that spreads forth from the essential self of the soul has these three levels:

The first level is the initial spreading out from the source. At this point, it still is somewhat comparable to the essential self. However, this is not to say that it is comparable in its essential being, that is, that it is identical to the essential self, because after all, it only is a radiance and ray of it. Rather, what is meant is only that it still is included with the essential self.

Thus, when we say that it is comparable to the self, this only means that since it is not yet a revealed or tangible light, it cannot be considered as being separate. This is because this initial spreading out is still hidden and therefore cannot truly be called an actual drawing out. True drawing out is when there is revealed illumination. However, at this stage, it only is a slight initial drawing out that subsequently is drawn out as revealed

illumination. That is, since this level is still hidden, it cannot yet be considered as having separate existence. On the contrary, it still is totally subsumed and unified with its source.

(Further analysis is needed to discern whether this is the first level explained before, that is, the ten *Sefirot* as they are included in the Crown-*Keter*, whereas according to what was said here, it seems to refer to the Crown-*Keter* itself.)

Now, when the radiance spreads out further, to become thought, that is, when he thinks about something, then it takes on the aspect of revelation and existence. We now could say that it is in the aspect of a radiance of light (*Ohr*) and garment (*Levush*). This is the second above-mentioned level. When this thought then becomes limited into a division of letters, in which the letters are felt, it takes on the aspect of vessels (*Keilim*) which limit the light. This is the third level.

We thus find that the aspect of lights (*Orot*) and vessels (*Keilim*) is the matter of thought (*Machshavah*) itself, in that when one thinks about something, the thought becomes defined. However, the power to think as it initially is drawn from its source, is not yet a defined thing unto itself. We therefore understand that it is not at all differentiated and separate from its source, but is rather always included in its source, even though it has been somewhat drawn out, as explained above.

Above in Godliness, this refers to the aspect of the Crown-*Keter*. For, although it too is drawn out from the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One to be the Crown-*Keter* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), nevertheless it still is in a state of concealment. As such, it still

is included subsumed in its Source (and is like the light as it is included in His Essential Self, in that His Essential Self also includes the aspect of the revealed light, as explained elsewhere).[82] This is because the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is the aspect of revelation of light that begins from Wisdom-*Chochmah* down, being that Wisdom-*Chochmah* is the beginning of revelation (*Giluy*).

In this itself, there are two levels. There is the aspect of the light (*Ohr*) as it is, in and of itself, in a state of simplicity, and there is the aspect of the form and image it takes on as a result of the vessels (*Keilim*). (It may be said that this is like the difference between the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which is the Name of His Essential Self (*Shem HaEtzem*), as opposed to an adjective, which is a descriptive title (*Shem HaTo'ar*), as explained elsewhere[83] that the title (*Shem HaTo'ar*) still is in the aspect of the innerness of the vessels etc.) All the more so, in regard to the vessel (*Kli*) itself, which most certainly is defined. Generally, this aspect is like a garment (*Levush*) which cannot at all compare to the Essential Self. However, the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* is above revelation and has no separate existence altogether, in that it is subsumed in its source.

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[82] Sefer HaMaamarim 5662, p. 322; 5664, p. 233, and elsewhere.

[83] Torat Chayim, Shmot Vol. 1, p. 112a and on, cited and explained in the discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5720 Ch. 4 and on (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Bati LeGani Vol. 1 p. 353 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5720, Discourse 10); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5664 p. 71 and on.

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Now, it was explained before that in relation to its Source, every stature (*Partzuf*) is only like an aspect of a ray and radiance. For example, the aspect of *Zeir Anpin* (the Small Countenance) of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), which is the source of the worlds, is called,[84] King of the world-*Melech Olam*-מלך עולם, as stated,[85] "For in six days *HaShem*-יהו"ה made the heavens and the earth," referring to the six Supernal days[86] which correspond to His emotive qualities of Kindness-*Chessed*, Might-*Gevurah* etc. These qualities are the root and source of all life, to enliven all creatures in the upper and lower worlds. Nonetheless, relative to Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, they only are a light and ray. That is, they constitute drawing down Godliness in a manner of constriction (*Tzimtzum*) and division. This is because every revelation of light (*Ohr*) must specifically be preceded by a constriction (*Tzimtzum*). There cannot be revelation without constriction (*Tzimtzum*) preceding it. (Therefore, all the light (*Ohr*) before the first constriction (*Tzimtzum*) is considered to be the aspect of the light (*Ohr*) as it still is subsumed in His Essential Self, as explained elsewhere.)[87]

Thus, in essence, the light (*Ohr*) itself is constricted and comes in a way of division, as explained above about the letters of thought. The same principle applies to the aspect of

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[84] Jeremiah 10:10; See Likkutei Torah, VeEtchanan 7a; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzedek Vol. 1, p. 239, and elsewhere.

[85] Exodus 20:10; Exodus 31:17

[86] Zohar I 247a; Vol. III 94b

[87] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 322; 5664 p. 233 and elsewhere.

Wisdom-*Chochmah* relative to the will (*Ratzon*) of the Supernal One that transcends Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as known that "the Father-*Abba* (Wisdom-*Chochmah*) suckles from the eighth *Mazal*."[88] Even the will (*Ratzon*) itself, which is the root and source of all the emanated *Sefirot*, is merely an aspect of the spreading forth of light and radiance from the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One.

However, there nonetheless is a difference between the aspect of will (*Ratzon*) and the other nine powers that spread from it, in that it is an encompassing transcendent light (*Makif*) and is neither an inner light (*Ohr Pneemee*) nor a vessel (*Kli*) altogether. This is because it is the initial spreading out from the Essential Self to a greater degree than the other nine. This is like the analogy of the power of thought when it initially spreads forth. Though it is not of the essence of the source, nevertheless it always is unified with the source and cannot yet be considered as something separate, which is not so of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which can be regarded as a "something" (*Yesh*) in a state of being, as in the analogy of thought itself.

We now must understand this fact that desire (*Ratzon*) is not something unto itself, even though it is the aspect of desire (*Ratzon*). This may be understood through the example of the desire of the soul. Although desire is a soul power, it nonetheless is not something separate from the soul. This is because the matter of desire is that the soul **itself** is drawn to

[88] Zohar III 289b; Etz Chayim, Shaar HaKlallim Ch. 5; Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 28 (148a), and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 25.

something.[89] Therefore, desire is nothing more than the soul itself being drawn to desire something. Although the fact that he desires something is specifically through the "Power to desire" (since in and of itself, the soul is above this, in that in its essential self, desire is inapplicable) it nevertheless is the soul that desires.

This is unlike the powers of wisdom and intellect, which are entities unto themselves, outside the soul. For although it is the soul that conceives concepts, nonetheless, the power of intellect that conceives it (as revealed intellect, in which he conceives and has insight and comprehension) is a separate existence unto itself.

Proof of this is that once he conceives it and writes it down in a book or teaches it to someone else, it remains intact, even after his soul withdraws from the power of intellect and the concept dissipates from his mind. Nonetheless, what he conceived remains intact.

This being so, we must say that although the power of intellect drawn from the soul is solely an aspect of radiance and light and does not come about in a manner of cause and effect from entity to entity, nonetheless, when it is drawn out, it becomes something unto itself. This is because when it spreads out it becomes distant from the essential self of the soul, and as a result, it takes on existence, specifically because it becomes enclothed in the organ (vessel) of the brain.

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[89] Ateret Rosh, p. 65a and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1, p. 87; Sefer HaMaamarim 5678, p. 305; 5686 p. 309, and elsewhere. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 24.

(This is so, even though we must differentiate between the drawing forth of the power of intellect from the soul and the drawing forth of intellect to someone else, which indeed is a matter of cause and effect, from entity to entity, which is not so of the drawing of intellect in general, in which case, when the soul withdraws, the power of intellect ceases and nothing remains of it. Therefore, in reality, it only is an aspect of light (*Ohr*) and radiance. (We may also say that this is because it is a drawing forth from nothing to something (*Yesh MeAyin*), as explained elsewhere.) Nonetheless, we understand that, at the very least, it is the existence of light-*Ohr*).

However, regarding the power of desire (*Ratzon*), after a person has desired and his soul has withdrawn from that desire, nothing is left of it. That is, desire always depends on the soul to desire it. It thus is understood that desire is not something unto itself but only exists because of the soul.

This being the case, in every stature (*Partzuf*) the aspect of its Crown-*Keter* is not of the same category as its other *Sefirot*. Rather they are in an aspect of inner lights (*Ohr Pneemee*), that is, lights (*Orot*) within vessels (*Keilim*), because at the very least, they have existence unto themselves. In contrast, the Crown-*Keter* is an aspect of encompassing light (*Ohr Makif*), in that it has no existence unto itself, because its entire existence is of the Essential Self.

For example, as it were, the Crown-*Keter* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One as it is drawn to desire emanation. Although before the drawing forth of the Crown-*Keter* this desire is inapplicable, nonetheless, even once it is

drawn out, it has no independent existence unto itself at all, akin to the desire of the soul. Without the soul, desire has no existence whatsoever, since it is nothing more than the pull of the essential self. This is likewise so Above in Godliness. Here too, it has no existence unto itself but is solely because of the Essential Self. It therefore is not in the category of being manifest in vessels (*Keilim*) but is rather a transcendent encompassing aspect (*Makif*).

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Now, from all the above, we can understand what was previously explained, that the drawing forth of the desire (*Ratzon*) into revelation is accomplished specifically through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*. In other words, this is because desire (*Ratzon*) draws out the Essential Self to desire. Hence, the drawing out of this revelation is accomplished specifically through Torah and *mitzvot*, and revelation is specifically drawn to the souls of Israel.

However,[90] the reason for offering the seventy bullocks on the festival of Sukkot is to draw down a revelation of the encompassing lights (*Ohr Makif*) upon the seventy ministering angels of the nations as well, in order to purify them. Although generally speaking, this kind of purification comes about through the inner light (*Ohr Pnimi*), which is the matter of gradual purification through the service of prayer and is

[90] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*BaSukkot Teishvu*" 5636 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 130 and on, and in earlier editions, Vol. 1 p. 179 and on; translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 3); Also see Torah Ohr Mikeitz 34b; Derech Mitzvotecha 74b.

compared to battle,[91] in which the animalistic soul stands in opposition and the Godly soul overpowers it by contemplating (*Hitbonenut*) the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה etc., until the animalistic soul also understand that Godliness is good, thus fulfilling the *mitzvah*,[92] "You shall love *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God with all your heart" meaning[93] "with both your inclinations etc." The same principle holds true when eating, as it states,[94] "One who wishes to eat bread must do so by the blade of the sword." All this comes about through the inner manifest powers and lights (*Pnimiyim*).

However, for the seventy ministering angels of the nations to be purified, the encompassing light (*Ohr Makif*) must be drawn down, in that "the encompassing light (*Ohr Makif*) blinds them."[95] Elsewhere,[96] it is explained that through offering the seventy bullocks they are obliterated, certainly caused by the [overpowering] revelation of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*). Therefore, for them to be purified the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) must specifically be drawn down to them. This is specifically done through the souls of Israel, as the verse states,[97] "All nations, praise *HaShem*-יהו"ה… for His kindness has overpowered **us**." This is because the encompassing light (*Ohr Makif*) is drawn down primarily and

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[91] Likkutei Torah Balak 72a cites Zohar; Also see Ki Teitzei 34c; 35c; Zohar III 243a (Ra'aya Mehemna).

[92] Deuteronomy 6:5

[93] Mishna Brachot 54a; Sifri and Rashi commentary to Deuteronomy ibid.

[94] Zohar Vol. 3, p. 188b

[95] See Shaar HaKavanot on the "*Alenu L'Shabeiach*" prayer; Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A), Ch. 13; Likkutei Torah, Korach 53d.

[96] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5569, p. 244 and on; Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Sukkot p. 1,765; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 4, p. 1,489 and on.

[97] Psalms 117:1-2

specifically to the souls of Israel and then, to purify the nations, the souls of Israel draw the encompassing light down to the nations through their seventy ministering angels.

This specifically takes place on the festival of Sukkot, because there then is a revelation of the encompassing light (*Makif*), this being the aspect of[98] "His right hand embraces me," thus bringing about closeness. However, on the festival of Shemini Atzeret, "The eighth day, will be restricted for you-*Lachem*-לכם," meaning for the souls of Israel alone. The drawing down of Godly influence on Shemini Atzeret is of the innerness of the encompassing light (*Pnimiyut HaMakif*). This occurs on the eighth day, corresponding to the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Understanding-*Binah*,[99] through which the innerness of the encompassing light (*Pnimiyut HaMakif*) is drawn down, as explained elsewhere.[100]

Nevertheless, on Shemini Atzeret the externality of the encompassing light (*Chitzoniyut HaMakif*) is also drawn down to the souls of Israel, in that the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) is pulled along with the innerness (*Pnimiyut*). This then, is the meaning of the above-mentioned statement, "Now let Me and you make do with what you find," in that even the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) is specifically drawn down to the souls of Israel, akin to the verse,[101] "So that I and Your people are distinguished from all the people on the surface of the earth." This is why the verse states, "will be restricted for you-*Lachem*-לכם,"

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[98] Song of Songs 2:6; 8:3

[99] *Binah*-Understanding is the eighth *Sefirah* counting from below to above.

[100] See Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Shmini Atzeret p. 1,788 and on, and elsewhere.

[101] Exodus 33:16

specifying "for you-*Lachem*-לכם," as in the verse,[102] "They will be yours alone, strangers not sharing them with you." That is, the innerness of the encompassing light (*Pnimiyut HaMakif*) is specifically for the souls of Israel alone, and on Shemini Atzeret, even the externality of the encompassing light (*Chitzoniyut HaMakif*) radiates specifically in an inner way. This then, is the meaning of "will be restricted for you," that is, it is specifically "for you-*Lachem*-לכם."

[102] Proverbs 5:17; Midrash Shemot Rabbah 15:23

Discourse 6

"*Vayechulu HaShamayim v'HaAretz… -*
The heavens and earth were completed…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Bereishit, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "The heavens and the earth and all their hosts were completed (*Vayechulu*-ויכלו)." Now, on the verse,[3] "I have seen an end (*Tichlah*-תכלה) to every beginning, but your commandment is exceedingly broad,"[4] Midrash Rabbah states,[5] "The heavens and the earth have limit in space and time,[6] but one thing has no limit in space and time, and what is it? Torah, as the verse states,[7] 'Its measure is longer than the earth and broader than the sea etc.'"

Now, we must understand this statement that the heavens and earth have a limit in measure and time. For is it

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[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*Lehavin HaHagaha b'Likkutei Amarim*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken Inyanim Vol. 1 p. 115 and on, as cited in later notes. Regarding the beginning and end of this discourse, see the discourse entitled "*Vayechulu HaShamayim*" in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit Vol. 3 p. 506b.

[2] Genesis 2:1

[3] Psalms 119:96

[4] In other words, the term "completed-*Vayechulu*-ויכלו" is of the same root as "end-*Tichlah*-תכלה," indicated that they have beginning and end. See Ohr HaTorah ibid.

[5] Bereshit Rabbah 10:1, cited before in the discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 35); Also see Ohr HaTorah ibid. p. 506a.

[6] See Matnot Kehunah (and Rashi and the Aruch) to Midrash Rabbah ibid., regarding the [meaning of the Greek] word "*Sikusim*-סיקוסים."

[7] Job 11:9

not so that influence is drawn to the world in an endless and limitless way? For, as known,[8] His desire (*Ratzon*) is drawn to the worlds in a limitless way (*Bli Gvul*) as the verse states,[9] "In the beginning-*Bereishit*-בראשית God created etc.," which Onkolus translated as "With that which precedes-*BeKadmin*-בקדמין God created" meaning with desire (*Ratzon*) [which is the "primal beginning" and refers to the Crown-*Keter*][10] and precedes [the actual beginning], and [as known] desire (*Ratzon*) is unlimited (*Bli Gvul*).

We therefore must say that the difference [between the Torah and "the heavens and the earth"] is in how they become revealed below. That is, about His desire for worlds, even though, in and of itself, the desire is limitless, nonetheless there is an end and cessation to how far down the desire goes. That is, it does not illuminate all the way down in a revealed way. In contrast, His desire for Torah and *mitzvot* is drawn down without end or cessation. That is, it also illuminates in a revealed way below. Now, this must be understood. If desire (*Ratzon*) is limitless, why then is [the desire for the world] drawn down with an end and limit, without illuminating all the way down in a revealed way?

Now, to understand this, we must preface with the explanation before[11] about the difference between the Crown-*Keter* and all the other *Sefirot*, both as it applies to the general

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[8] Torat Chaim, Bereishit 7c and on.

[9] Genesis 1:1

[10] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Ten (*Keter*); Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 8 and elsewhere.

[11] In the previous discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 55 and on).

Crown-*Keter* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), as well as to the particular Crown-*Keter* of each stature (*Partzuf*) individually. That is, in regard to the nine [lower] *Sefirot*, they are the aspect of a revealed illumination of light (*Ohr*), meaning that their state of being is that of light (*Ohr*) and as it manifests in a vessel (*Kli*) it comes into a different state of being etc. In contrast, in regard to the Crown-*Keter*, even though it too is drawn down, it nevertheless is a concealed drawing down that remains subsumed in His Essential Self, and is not in the aspect of a revelation of light (*Ohr*). It thus follows automatically that it is not in a state of being and is certainly not in the state of separate being.

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This then,[12] is why the Crown-*Keter* of every stature (*Partzuf*) transcends the aspect of time relative to that stature (*Partzuf*). For, as known,[13] time is in the world of Creation (*Briyah*), and the time of "the six millennia [of the world]"[14] comes at the beginning of the coming into being of the world of Creation (*Briyah*), rather than the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). That is, the six millennia do not factor into the emanation of the Supernal world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) but only begin with Creation (*Briyah*). This is because the world of Emanation

[12] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Inyanim ibid.

[13] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5566 Vol. 1 p. 59 and on; p. 88; Derech Mitzvotecha 59a and elsewhere.

[14] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 31a and elsewhere.

(*Atzilut*) transcends time.[15] Therefore, time does not factor into the emanation of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), since it is above time. Rather, time specifically begins with the world of Creation (*Briyah*).

This answers[16] the question of the philosophers[17] about why the world specifically was created when it was created, rather than earlier. This is because before the world was created, time did not exist. It therefore does not apply to ask why it was not created earlier, being that there altogether was no matter of "before and after" in terms of time. Rather, time only began at the beginning of creation (*Briyah*).

However, it is understood that in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) itself, there also are the aspects of Emanation, Creation, Formation and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*).[18] Emanation of Emanation (*Atzilut* of *Atzilut*) is the aspect [of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה desire for the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), which is] it's Crown-*Keter*.[19] Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) are Creation of Emanation (*Briyah* of

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[15] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5566 ibid. Derech Mitzvotecha ibid. and elsewhere.

[16] Siddur Im DA"Ch p. 75d and on; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKriyat Shema p. 40c and on; (Siddur Im Da"Ch and Imrei Binah ibid. cite this question to Etz Chayim in the name of the Kabbalists – see Etz Chayim Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher) end of Anaf 1), and elsewhere.

[17] See Emunot V'Deot of Rabbi Saadya Gaon, Maamar 1, end of Ch. 5 cited in Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzedek 112a.

[18] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 47 (Shaar Seder ABY"A) Ch. 2; Shaar HaHakdamot, Drushei ABY"A, Drush 9 (p. 399, Yerushalayim 5748).

[19] Ramaz to Zohar III 176b; Likkutei Torah Balak 69c and on; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5567 p. 311; Ohr HaTorah VeEtchanan p. 285 & 296 and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzedek, Vol. 2, p. 963 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 Vol. 1, p. 189 and on; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 553; p. 640.

Atzilut), the emotive *Sefirot* of *Zeir Anpin* are Formation of Emanation (*Yetzirah* of *Atzilut*) and Kingship-*Malchut* of Emanation is the Actualization of Emanation (*Asiyah* of *Atzilut*). Thus, the Crown-*Keter* of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is the aspect of Emanation of Emanation (*Atzilut* of *Atzilut*). This being so, the aspect of time [as it is] in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) begins with Creation of the world of Emanation (*Briyah* of *Atzilut*).

Now, here we are not referring to actual time, but only to the "order" of time,[20] in that time will be a progression from past to future. Moreover, even this order only applies from Creation of Emanation (*Briyah* of *Atzilut*) and down. However, in Emanation of Emanation (*Atzilut* of *Atzilut*), that is, in its Crown-*Keter*, it utterly is above time. The same is true of each stature (*Partzuf*) which comprises Emanation, Creation, Formation and Action (*Atzilut, Briyah, Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*).

Now, a stature (*Partzuf*) means that it is composed of ten *Sefirot*. Therefore, each stature (*Partzuf*) includes Emanation, Creation, Formation and Actualization (*Atzilut, Briyah, Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) as stated in Etz Chayim in Shaar HaPartzufim.[21] Thus, the Emanation (*Atzilut*) of each stature (*Partzuf*) – which is its Crown-*Keter*, is above time.

An example of this is the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*. As known,[22] Kingship-*Malchut* is the root of time and space, as

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[20] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 3:7; Derech Mitzvotecha 57b and on; Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzedek p. 111b and on; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 10 p. 176; Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2 p. 224 and on.

[21] Etz Chayim, Shaar 29, Drush 1, and elsewhere.

[22] See Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 7 (88a); Also see Torah Ohr, Mikeitz 37a and elsewhere.

in the verse,[23] "Your Kingship is the Kingship of all worlds" [space] and,[24] "*HaShem*-ה"והי is King, *HaShem*-ה"והי was King, *HaShem*-ה"והי will be King forever and ever" [time]. However, this only is in the aspect of the lower nine *Sefirot* of Kingship-*Malchut*, whereas the Crown-*Keter* of Kingship-*Malchut* (which is in a state of constant adhesion to *Zeir Anpin*) transcends the aspect of time.

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Now, to further clarify, time is rooted in the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*).[25] Elsewhere[26] it is explained that in the *Sefirot* time is the matter of precedence and subsequence etc. That is, as it is spiritually, the order and gradation of precedence and subsequence etc., is also a matter of time. This too comes through the aspect of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*), in that it then applies for there to be matters of precedence and subsequence. That is, the spreading forth of the Crown-*Keter* ceases, and there [then] is a drawing down of the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah* etc. However, when the drawing down is not in a way of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*), the matter of precedence and subsequence does not apply. For,

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[23] Psalms 145:13

[24] See the liturgy of the *Pesukei D'Zimrah* prayers; Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2, p. 78; Mesechet Sofrim Ch. 14; Shaar HaKolel, 5:5

[25] See Likkutei Torah Chukat 65a; Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 61a and elsewhere.

[26] See Derech Mitzvotecha ibid. 59a; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek, Vol. 1 p. 257 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5677 p. 67.

in such a case, the drawing forth is such that they all come into revelation equally etc., as explained elsewhere.[27]

In any event,[28] the root and cause of time on every level is the matter of the "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) in it. This is as stated,[29] "The *Chayot* (חיות) [angels] were running and returning." That is, the Godly vitality (*Chayut*-חיות) drawn from the word of *HaShem*-יהו"ה to vitalize all the creations, is in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), that is, it is through the matter of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*) etc.[30]

This is analogous to the breath of the spirit of life in man. At every moment there is a drawing of vitality from the source of his soul, and it then immediately reverts to withdraw from the body to ascend and become subsumed in the source from where it was drawn, whereupon a new drawing of vitality is brought about etc.

The same is so of the Godly vitality drawn down to vitalize the world. That is, once it is drawn down it immediately withdraws to become subsumed in its source, this being the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*), and new vitality is then drawn down. The same is so of the drawing down of the light (*Ohr*) in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), in that it too is in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*). This is because the

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[27] See Derech Mitzvotecha and Biurei HaZohar ibid.

[28] From this point until the end of the discourse see the discourse entitled "*Lehavin HaHagahah b'Likkutei Amarim*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken Inyanim ibid.

[29] Ezekiel 1:14

[30] See Ohr HaTorah Terumah p. 1,357 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 203 and on; 5659 p. 187 and on; 5664 (5745 edition) p. 182 and on; 5665 p. 225 and on; 5677 p. 143 and on; 5682 p. 257 and on; 5691 p. 300 and on; 5704 p. 251 and on, and elsewhere.

light (*Ohr*) is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) to ascend and become subsumed in its source etc., the reason for which is explained elsewhere.[31] Through this the divisions of time come about, because since there is the matter of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*), the light and vitality thus comes by way of division, in that there is a withdrawal followed by a new drawing forth etc.

That is, there is cessation to the light (*Ohr*), because if it was in a state of being drawn down alone (without the withdrawal and spreading forth) it would have no cessation to it and would thus be in a state of limitlessness. However, with the withdrawal and spreading forth, there thus is cessation to its drawing forth, this being the divisions of time. This is because time itself is the cessation. For example, when we say that something is drawn out for an hour or two, this is because there is cessation to its drawing out, this being the matter of time. This being so, the cessation in the light (*Ohr*) is the source of time etc.

Likewise, in the withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*) there also is a matter of time. This is because that which was withdrawn is the past, and that which spreads forth is the future, thus bringing about the matter of time, meaning past and future etc. This is especially so considering that the vitality drawn forth is a [new and] different light and vitality, being that the original vitality reverts to be subsumed in its source and a new vitality is drawn forth etc. This is like the statement in chapter forty-one of Tanya about the matter of the twelve permutations (*Tzirufim*) of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה

[31] See at length in Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 ibid. and 5677 ibid.

[during the day] and [the twelve permutations of] the name my Lord-*Adona"y*-אדנ"י [during the night], in that at every moment[32] a new permutation (*Tziruf*) is drawn forth.

Now, in regard to the statement that vitality (*Chayut*) is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) (meaning that the vitality itself is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*)), this refers to the general totality of that vitality. That is, the general vitality from the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה or from the name my Lord-*Adona"y*-אדנ"י is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*). However, in this vitality itself, at every moment there is a drawing forth of a new permutation, different from the permutation there was a moment before etc. This is because in the drawing forth of the vitality there are many levels.

For example, when vitality is drawn forth from the aspect of Kindness-*Chessed*, it also includes the aspect of Might-*Gevurah*, as well as the aspects of Might of Might (*Gevurah SheB'Gevurah*) and Kindness of Kindness (*Chessed SheB'Chessed*) etc., with a great many particulars etc. Then with every aspect of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*) vitality is renewed from a different state and level etc., and even though Above they all are in a state of endlessness (*Ein Sof*), unity and inter-inclusion etc., nonetheless, once the vitality is drawn down, it comes to a state of division, such that at every moment a different vitality is drawn forth, through which the aspect of time is brought about.

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[32] See Mafteychot, Hagahot, v'Ha'arot Al Sefer Shel Beinoni HaNimtza'ot b'Drushei K"K Admo"r Moreinu HaRaSha"B (printed in Sefer HaMafteichot, Kehot 5726 (p. 762)).

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Now, the desire (*Ratzon*) of every world transcends the aspect of time within it. This is because the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) is when the vitality is in a state of revelation from its source, is distance from its source, and manifests within a limited vessel (*Kli*). This is like the above-mentioned[33] analogy of the letters of thought (*Machshavah*), and [the distinction between] thought itself and defined thought.

Now, thought itself refers to revealed thought, such as when one thinks about something, in that the thought has an existence. (That is, here we are not referring to the **power to think** as it is included in its source etc., as mentioned before). This also is so of defined thought, which certainly is felt as an actual existence of thought, and as explained before, the same is so of the light (*Ohr*). That is, it specifically is when the light is distant from its source that yearning to be subsumed in its source applies. That is, it yearns to be subsumed in its source and wants to depart from the limitation to become subsumed in its source. This is the matter of the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire to leave the vessel (*Kli*) [which limits] etc.

Now, at the moment of departing, it still is in the vessel (*Kli*) and only is in a state of separating, for after all, it is a matter of "running" (*Ratzo*), and once it has left the limitation and become subsumed in its source etc., how can "running"

[33] In the previous discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 52).

then apply? Rather, [the matter of] "running" (*Ratzo*) applies **only** as it is in the vessel and distant from its source etc.

Now, the general matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) is the aspect of withdrawal (*Histalkut*). That is, in relation to the vessel (*Kli*) it certainly is in a state of withdrawal (*Histalkut*), as explained elsewhere.[34] However, it also is in a state of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) in relation to the light (*Ohr*). For, since it manifests within the vessel (*Kli*), it thus is distant from the essence, and is in a different state of being, being that upon its revelation it is caused to be the existence of light (*Ohr*), which particularly is so of the coloration caused to it by the vessel (*Kli*), as a result of which it's state is that of being a separate being, as discussed before. This being so, the "running" (*Ratzo*) is the aspect of the withdrawal from one state of being to another state of being, meaning to a state of being that is incomparably beyond the first state of being. This then is an aspect of ascent, in that it is uprooted from its state of being and existence to its source, where in comparison, it no longer has being at all etc.

However, this is not so of the root and source of the vitality of the worlds as it begins to be drawn out from the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*). This is because desire (*Ratzon*) is never drawn out such that it becomes distant or is in a state of separateness from its source. Rather, the desire is the aspect of the initial drawing forth from the source, when it still is concealed and included in its source. Therefore, the matter of "running" (Ratzo) [to its source] does not apply to it, since [in

[34] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5664 ibid. p. 190; Also see p. 187 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5652 p. 75 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5660 p. 2.

the first place] it never is distant from its source and is thus never in a state of separateness from it. Hence, "running" (*Ratzo*) [to its source] does not at all apply to it.

Rather, this fact, that it is drawn out a little and then automatically reverts to be subsumed in its source, in that all light drawn out automatically reverts to be subsumed in its source, is called "coming and not coming" (*Mati v'Lo Mati*),[35] meaning that it spreads out but does not spread out, which is different from the matter of "running and returning" (*Ratzo V'Shov*). This is because "running" (*Ratzo*) [to its source] is the matter of exiting the vessel in a way of withdrawal, whereas "returning" (*Shov*) is the matter of spreading down and settling within the vessel, because with the return (*Shov*) it shines in the vessel in a revealed way.

Neither of these apply to the matter of desire (*Ratzon*). This is because desire is not in way of "running" [to its source], since it never becomes distant [in the first place] and is not in an aspect of withdrawal, in that it is not a different existence [than the source]. Rather, it comes to a state of the "absence of spreading forth," meaning to a greater state of inclusion in its source, and though the inclusion is greater than before, nonetheless, this cannot be called "running" (*Ratzo*) [to its source]. Rather, running, exiting, and withdrawing do not apply here, being that desire (*Ratzon*) is never in a state of distance [from its source], nor does it vest in a vessel (*Kli*). On the contrary, it's state is that of inclusion in its source, except that,

[35] Zohar I 16b; Torah Ohr Bereishit 2d; Hosofot to Meggilat Esther 123a; Likkutei Torah Masei 95c, and elsewhere.

at first, it is drawn out a little, and even this is within His Essential Self rather than by way of revelation.

(This is like the light as it is included in *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Essential Self, in that, as of yet, the drawing forth is still totally within His Essential Self. That is, even as it is drawn forth, it still is in a way of being subsumed in its source.) Now, the fact that it then reverts to be included in its source only means that now it is not even drawn out in **such** a way. In other words, now there only is the absence of spreading forth, called, "not coming" (*Lo Mati*).

In like fashion, the aspect of drawing forth called "coming" (*Mati*) is different than the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). [This is because returning (*Shov*)] is the matter of the actual revelation of light (*Ohr*) settling in a vessel (*Kli*). Such is not the case here, because though it is drawn and spreads forth, it does not spread forth in a way of revelation, but is only drawn out a little, and [even then] is still is concealed and included in His Essential Self etc. (In contrast, about light that manifests in vessels, even during a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) [to its source], it nonetheless remains in the vessel, as explained before. However, here the opposite is true, in that even when it is "coming" (*Mati*) it altogether has no relation to vessels (*Keilim*) etc.)

Moreover, this matter called "coming and not coming" (*Mati V'Lo Mati*) or spreading forth and not spreading forth, is due to the Essential Self. This is so both of the aspect of "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) as well as of the aspect of "coming" (*Mati*). On the other hand, the "running and returning" (*Ratzo V'Shov*) of the light, is due to the light (*Ohr*) as it is in and of itself, rather

than its source, since it is distant from its source. This being the case, the fact that it is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) [to its source] is not because the source is acting upon it, but because of the light (*Ohr*) itself, since it is distant from its source and desires to be close and be subsumed in its source.

For example, in the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, below, the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire is brought about through the comprehension and Godly contemplation of the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה and how He fills all worlds and transcends all worlds etc. This "running" (*Ratzo*) is brought about by oneself, meaning, by his own strength in his comprehension of Godliness. That is, it is not that Godliness illuminates within him in a revealed way and that he thereby is caused to have a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire. (That kind [of arousal] is the aspect of love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*), as discussed in chapter forty of Tanya.) Rather, here it is through one's grasp of the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה and his own distance from this, that he thereby is caused to have a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire.

This is similarly so of the matter of "the *Chayot* [angels] were running and returning," as it is Above in the Godly light and vitality. That is, the "running" (*Ratzo*) stems from [the level] itself, in that it desires to become subsumed etc. In contrast, this is not so of the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*). That is, the "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) which is like the matter of the "running" (*Ratzo*) does not stem from oneself and his comprehension, but stems from the Source, in that the Source shines within him in a revealed way and he thereby is in a state of being subsumed in his Source. This is why the term

"running" (*Ratzo*) does not apply to this, since this does not stem from being in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) in and of oneself, but solely because of the Source etc.

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Now, in the revealed *Sefirot* a similar phenomenon also takes place. For, as stated in Etz Chayim, in Shaar Mati v'Lo Mati,[36] when there is a "coming" (*Mati*) in the Crown-*Keter*, there then is a "not-coming" (*Lo Mati*) in Wisdom-*Chochmah*. That is, when the light (*Ohr*) illuminates in the Crown-*Keter*, the light (*Ohr*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* becomes subsumed in the Crown-*Keter*. Likewise, when there is a "coming" (*Mati*) in Wisdom-*Chochmah*, there then is a "not-coming" (*Lo Mati*) in Understanding-*Binah* etc.

However, it can be said that there indeed is the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) in this aspect. For example, when it comes to love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) out of the Godly light (*Ohr*) shining for him in a revealed way etc., there nonetheless is the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) here, in that he "runs" and is drawn to adhere to Him etc., except that this **pull** [of the desire] is not in a way of thirst [and yearning] which specifically only applies when he still is distant. Nonetheless, when the Godly light (*Ohr*) radiates upon him in a revealed way and he delights over the light, the matter of thirst [and yearning] no longer applies. However, even so, there indeed is the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) here, in that he is drawn to the limitless light of the Unlimited One with the totality of his essential self.

[36] Etz Chayim, Shaar 7, Ch. 1 and on.

This is because he nonetheless is an independent being unto himself, and thus the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) is present in this.

However, this is only **before** he truly comes to adhere to the limitless light of the Unlimited One, whereas once he truly comes to adhere to Him, the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) no longer applies. Nevertheless, then too, there also is a matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) except that it is greatly concealed and not very sensed, since he is involved in being subsumed and adhering to his source, and thus does not stand as a being unto himself etc.

The same may be understood about the desire (*Ratzon*). That is, even though in a concealed way there also is an aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) in it, it nonetheless does not apply to use the term "running" (*Ratzo*) about it, being that it is subsumed in its source and is not in a state of motion, nor is it sensed etc. This is especially so considering the explanation before,[37] that the general matter of desire (*Ratzon*) is the **pull** of the soul, meaning that desire is not an existence of something unto itself, and is nothing but the pull of the soul etc.

The same is likewise so Above, in that the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*) is not an existence unto itself but is solely the pull of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One to desire something, so to speak. Even though there indeed is certainly the presence of the aspect of desire (*Ratzon*), whereas when it comes to His Essential Self, in and of Himself, before the arousal of His desire, He has no

[37] At the end of the discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 55).

relation to this altogether, nevertheless, once He desires, it still is the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One who desires, and but for Him there would be no existence of desire (*Ratzon*) at all, Heaven forbid, as discussed before.

In any event, the dominant force in this is the matter of His Essential Self etc. This being so, when it comes to this aspect of being subsumed [in His Essential Self], it only applies to use terms such as "the absence of spreading forth." That is, when it comes to the existence of something that is not the aspect of His Essential Self, it is appropriate to use the term "running" (*Ratzo*). However, when it comes to the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*), in which the primary matter is the aspect of His Essential Self, it does not apply to use the term "running" (*Ratzo*), but only "the absence of spreading forth," this being the matter of "not coming" (*Lo Mati*).

The same applies to the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). That is, when it comes to the light (*Ohr*), when there is a drawing forth and illumination of the revelation of light (*Ohr*), this is not a revelation of His Essential Self but is only the revelation of the aspect of light (*Ohr*). It thus applies to use the term "returning" (*Shov*) about it, in that at first it was in a state of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and subsequently in a state of "returning" (*Shov*). However, when it comes to the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*), the "drawing forth" is that His Essential Self is drawn forth, and as mentioned before, it is the aspect of the "pull" of His Essential Self [to something]. It thus does not apply to use the term "returning" (*Shov*) about it, but only the term "coming" (*Mati*), which is the aspect of the "spreading forth."

(In general, as the light (*Ohr*) is considered unto itself, it is in the state of "running and returning" (*Ratzo v'Shov*). In contrast, about the desire (*Ratzon*), which stems from His Essential Self, "running and returning" (*Ratzo v'Shov*) does not apply in this, but only that it "spreads forth and does not spread forth" etc.)

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This then, was the level of Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai, who said (Idra Zuta 292a),[38] "My soul is bound to Him with a single knot, I am unified with Him and am aflame in Him." This is because the ascent of the feminine waters (*Ha'ala'at Mayim Nukvin*) is the matter of nullifying one's limiting parameters, as known, which only applies when one is subject to the limitations of a vessel. As explained before,[39] ascent is the matter of being uprooted from one state of being to another state of being, meaning that he is an existence of something, especially when he manifests within a vessel (*Kli*) which limits etc. Only then does the matter of ascent apply, such that one becomes nullified of his previous state of being and ascends to be subsumed in the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One.

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[38] The quote is brought in this form in various places in Chassidus, and I have thus far located it in Idra Zuta, Zohar III (288a), "Rabbi Shimon opened and said… 'I am bound with the Holy One, blessed is He, with a single knot etc.,'" and (292a), "My soul is one with Him, and is enflamed in Him" – from a note of the Rebbe in Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 164 (Vol. 2 p. 122 in earlier editions); Also see Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 284 (Vol. 3 p. 151 and on).

[39] Earlier in this discourse (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 59).

However, when one is not in a state of existence and is not within the limitations of a vessel, but nonetheless is in a state of being slightly drawn out of the source, and still is in a state of the previously mentioned "primal beginning," then the ascent of the feminine waters (*Ha'ala'at Mayim Nukvin*) does not apply to him. Rather, only the drawing down of the masculine waters (*Hamshachat Mayim Duchrin*) applies, being that the masculine waters (*Mayim Duchrin*) are also a drawing forth from the source.

(Now, it seems to me[40] that what is meant here is that the drawing down of the masculine waters (*Hamshachat Mayim Duchrin*) likewise is the drawing down of the source itself. In other words, this is unlike light (*Ohr*), which is like a separate thing relative to its source in the Essential Self. We explained above that when the light (*Ohr*) becomes distant from the Essential Self it takes on the existence and being of light (*Ohr*) and vests within a vessel (*Kli*), thereby becoming a separate entity.

In contrast, desire (*Ratzon*) has no being of its own as a separate entity, but rather is only the essential self being drawn to something etc.,) except that in this there is no aspect of a vessel (since that which is drawn to manifest in a vessel is only the light that comes into revelation, which specifically takes place when there is distance). Rather, as explained above, it is the drawing forth of the source itself. (That is, it only is the "primal beginning" of the drawing forth). (Alternately, we could say that the intention in [the words] "there is no aspect of

[40] This is a comment on the words of the discourse of the Alter Rebbe referenced previously from which this section of the discourse is quoted.

a vessel" is that desire (*Ratzon*) is not a vessel (*Kli*) for containing the drawing down of His Essential Self, but is rather the general matter of the pull of His Essential Self to be drawn [to something] etc.)

This then, is the meaning of "I am aflame in Him," meaning that his flame and passion is due solely to the Essential Self and Source. (Sefer Pnei HaMelech[41] explains the words, "I am aflame in Him" as follows: "*HaShem*-יהו"ה shines within the soul and desires to dwell in it, at which point the soul becomes aflame in His light, like the flaming light of a torch." We therefore find that the flame is the revelation of the light of the soul and that it is drawn forth and illuminates, specifically in Him. This is the aspect of the drawing forth of the Essential Self which illuminates and enflames.) At once the soul merges and becomes subsumed in the Source. (This is the meaning, "I am unified in Him," which is the aspect of the unification and inclusion in His Essential Self etc.)

This is the meaning of the verse,[42] "My soul shall glory in *HaShem*-יהו"ה," that is,[43] "like a flame that rises of its own accord," which is the matter of,[44] "This service is a gift that I have given." In other words, it is given from the Source to arouse the soul, not that the soul is aroused through its own comprehension. Rather, when it becomes subsumed in a singular point, which is the matter of desire (*Ratzon*) that

[41] Commentary on the Idrot of the Zohar from the author of Mikdash Melech (London 5533).

[42] Psalms 34:3, referenced in the words of Rabbi Shimon Bar Yochai there.

[43] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 21a; Rashi to Numbers 8:2; Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Temidin U'Musafin 3:15

[44] Numbers 18:7

transcends comprehension, it then becomes a "flame that rises of its own accord" due to the flame of the Source, and it merges with the Source, like a flame that extends somewhat from the fire and then returns to merge with the fire (like the fire of a coal as it is in the coal etc.).

This is the matter of abundant love of Him (*Ahavah Rabbah*) (or the matter of love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*). As explained before, when the Essential Self shines in a revealed way, the aspect of the "running" (*Ratzo*) is then in a way of love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) which is the matter of the actual expiry of the soul in a way of abundant love of Him (*Ahavah Rabbah*). This is the matter of arousal and inclusion in the Source and happens automatically with the revelation of the Essential Self etc.)

This is higher than the aspect of the vessel (*Kli*) that Aharon, the high priest, drew down to the souls of the Jewish people from the Source (that is, from the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה) when he lit the flames of the Menorah. (This was done through the aspect of the "beard" (*Dikna*), which is the matter of the vessel (*Kli*) and garments (*Levushim*) for the aspect of the Supernal love, these being the garments of Torah and *mitzvot*, as explained in Torah Ohr, in the discourse entitled "*V'Asita Bigdei Kodesh.*")[45] This then is the meaning of the words, "My soul shall glory in *HaShem*-יהו"ה" – that is, in *HaShem*-יהו"ה **Himself**; to be enflamed and aroused with desire in His Essential Self, this being the matter of, "I am unified in Him etc."

[45] Torah Ohr, Tzav 82c;

Now, this likewise was so[46] of the Torah study of Rabbi Shimon Bar Yochai in the revealed parts of Torah, in that "his Torah study was his vocation,"[47] meaning that it was the instrument [vessel] of his craft. Even on the simple levels of Torah law, he knew the inner aspects. Thus, by means of the innerness of Torah, when he studied Torah, he drew down the Essential Self of the limitless light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, the Unlimited One, throughout all worlds. For, since he was unified and bound to the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*), blessed is He, as mentioned above, therefore his entire Torah study drew down the masculine waters (*Hamshachat Mayim Duchrin*) (and His Essential Self was in the aspect of the masculine waters (*Mayim Duchrin*) this being the meaning of "I am aflame in Him," as discussed above.)

On the other hand, when the other sages of the Mishnah would study Torah, they would cause the ascension of the feminine waters (*Haalaat Mayim Nukvin*). This is because their Torah manifested in physical matters; that this is forbidden and this is permissible, that this can ascend [and this cannot ascend] etc. And as explained above, involvement in the aspect of the vessels (*Keilim*)* is the matter of the ascent of the feminine waters (*Haalaat Mayim Nukvin*). (This being so, that which

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[46] Also see the later discourses entitled "*uSefartem Lachem*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 289); "*Titein Emet L'Yaakov*" (p. 407); Also see Torat Menachem Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 277 (in earlier editions Vol. 2 p. 302 and on).

[47] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 11a.

* That is, in the aspect of the light (*Ohr*) as it is manifest within the vessel (*Kli*). (The Rebbe commented on these words that it is not necessary to comment on them. Also see *Hemshech* 5666 p. 22 and the gloss to note 110.)

was drawn down was not of the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה).

In contrast, Rabbi Shimon Bar Yochai's study of the revealed part of the Torah was through his knowledge of its innerness. He therefore drew down the masculine waters (*Hamshachat Mayim Duchrin*), this being the matter of drawing down the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He. In the "coming future" it will likewise be so, as the verse states,[48] "Your Master will no longer hide in His cloak, and your eyes shall see your Master." That is, it no longer will be in a way of manifestation in vessels (*Keilim*).

About that time, the verse states,[49] "They will see eye to eye when *HaShem*-**יהו"ה** returns to Zion." This is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* (Wisdom-*Chochmah*) as it is in the Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and Knowledge-*Da'at* of the Female-*Nukva* (Kingship-*Malchut*) that will be revealed to all the souls of Israel. Likewise, prayer will no longer be in a way of "running and returning" (*Ratzo V'Shov*) but will rather be in a way of "coming and not coming" (*Mati V'Lo Mati*) stemming from the aspect of *HaShem's*-**יהו"ה** Essential Self.

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Now, with the above in mind, we can understand how the Crown-*Keter* transcends the aspect of time. This is because the Crown-*Keter*, which is the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*), has

[48] Isaiah 30:20
[49] Isaiah 52:8

no relation to the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), which is the aspect of the withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and drawing down (*Hamshachah*) to be in a state of expression and be settled in a vessel. Rather, its primary matter is the aspect of a drawing down. In other words, the matter of the ascent, referring to being uprooted from one state of being to another state of being, does not apply in it, since it is not distance from the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, nor is it in a limited state. Therefore, its primary aspect is that of drawing down, but the drawing down is such that it is His Essential Self that is drawn down. This is the aspect of the "primal beginning" of the drawing forth, which is not in a state of revelation in vessels (*Keilim*) etc.

Moreover, the fact that there is a matter of passion and being subsumed in it, this being the matter of "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) does not stem from the aspect of the vessels (*Keilim*), nor does it stem from its own being, but it rather stems from the Source, meaning from the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One etc. It therefore does not apply for there to be a matter of time there, since the matter of time only applies in relation to the light (*Ohr*), which is in a state of an existent entity and in a state of limitation. This is why its ascent is an aspect of actual ascent, in that it withdraws from its existence and limitation and becomes nullified (this being the ascent from one state of being to another state of being). There then is the aspect of the "returning" (*Shov*), this being the actual drawing down into the aspect of revelation and being settled etc. These literally are two [different] aspects, that of withdrawal (*Histalkut*) and that of spreading forth

(*Hitpashtut*), which is why it applies for there to be the divisions of time in this etc.

In contrast, as explained before, in the desire (*Ratzon*) this does not apply. This is because in the aspect of the light (*Ohr*) the "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) are opposites of each other. That is, the "running" (*Ratzo*) is the matter of ascent and withdrawal from being an existent entity, to the aspect of the "absence of existence," whereas the "returning" (*Shov*) is when he comes from the state of absence of existing to the state of existing etc.

However, in the desire (*Ratzon*), the aspects of "coming and not coming" (*Mati v'Lo Mati*) are not opposites or separate levels from each other. This is because even the state of "coming" (*Mati*) is not an aspect of independent existence, since his state is that of being subsumed in his source, such that it is yet to be an existence of light (*Ohr*), as discussed before. This being so, the "not coming" (*Lo Mati*), which is the greater state of being subsumed, is not an opposite of the "coming" (*Mati*). The same is so of the aspect of "coming" (*Mati*), in that since it does not become an independent existence, it is not the opposite of the "not coming" (*Lo Mati*).

(Now, one should not say that when he is in a state of "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) he altogether has no existence, for that is not so, because that is not what becoming subsumed (*Hitkallelut*) means (but this is rather like the matter of[50] "He extended His finger and burned them etc.") Rather, becoming

[50] Talmud Bavli, Yoma 21b; Sanhedrin 38b; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 162; 5632 Vol. 1 p. 275; 5643 p. 97, and elsewhere.

subsumed (*Hitkallelut*) means that one still exists, except not in a state of independent existence etc.)

We thus find that the aspects of "coming" (*Mati*) and "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) are not aspects or levels separate and opposites of each other, since He is present in both, and both are a state of the absence of [independent] existence etc. It therefore does not apply to discuss the matter of the divisions of time here. It rather is called "the day that is entirely lengthy,"[51] meaning in a state of limitlessness (*Bli Gvul*). It is called "**entirely** lengthy" in that even at its beginning it is "lengthy." This is because in something that has a beginning and end, its primary "lengthiness" specifically refers to its end. For example, when discussing the matter of length in reference to time, its lengthiness is primarily recognized specifically at its end (and moreover this lengthiness is not true lengthiness, since it is in a state of limitation). In contrast, when it comes to something that has no beginning, the matter of its lengthiness is equal both at its beginning and at its end. This then, is the meaning of "entirely lengthy," in that it is limitless (*Bli Gvul*) in essence, and the divisions of time do not apply in it.

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Now, when it comes to the above-mentioned aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*), even though it is inapplicable for there to be the aspect of time in it, it nevertheless is the root and source of the aspect of time. In other words, the aspect of the desire

[51] See Talmud Bavli, Kiddushin 39b; Also see Torah Ohr Toldot 18d and elsewhere.

(*Ratzon*) is also only the aspect of a light and ray, only that it is the aspect of the beginning of the drawing forth. Nevertheless, it is the aspect of a ray and is not the aspect of His Essential Self. This is why at the very least it applies for there to be the aspects of "spreading forth" and "the absence of spreading forth" in it, these being the matters of being drawn (*Hamshachah*) forth or being subsumed (*Hitkallelut*) etc.

Furthermore, in regard to what was explained before, that desire (*Ratzon*)] is not an independent existence unto itself, but is rather the "pull" of His Essential Self [to something] this too means that it is the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One who desires the desire, so to speak. This is because before the arousal of His desire, it does not apply to say about His Essential Self that "He desires." This being so, His desiring with the power of desire is not the true aspect of His Essential Self etc. Therefore, when it comes to this aspect and level, though it does not apply to discuss the aspects of "withdrawal" (*Histalkut*) and "spreading forth" (*Hitpashtut*) as they are in the states of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), it nonetheless applies for there to be the aspects of "coming" (*Mati*) and "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) in it, that is, "spreading forth" and "not spreading forth," which also is the matter of "spreading forth" (*Hitpashtut*) and "being subsumed" (*Hitkallelut*).

It is due to this that it is, at the very least, a source for the aspects of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) present in the light (*Ohr*). That is, the reason that the light (*Ohr*) is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) is because it is brought into being through the "coming" (*Mati*) and "not

coming" (*Lo Mati*) present in the source etc. (It can be said that the "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) brings about the aspect of the "running" (*Ratzo*), and the "coming" (*Mati*) brings about the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). See the discourse entitled "*Vayedaber… Zot Chukat HaTorah*" 5665.)[52]

This being so, at the very least it is the root and source of time. For, even though the desire (*Ratzon*) is an aspect that is limitless (*Bli Gvul*), nevertheless since it has the aspects of "coming" (*Mati*) and "not coming" (*Lo Mati*) in it, therefore, at the very least, it is the aspect of the source of time.

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However, through [our fulfilling] the *mitzvot* the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*) is literally drawn from the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, in which it altogether is inapplicable for there to be the aspects of "being subsumed" (*Hitkallelut*) or "spreading forth" (*Hitpashtut*), not even in a way of "coming" (*Mati*) and "not coming" (*Lo Mati*).

The explanation is as discussed in chapter forty-one of Tanya, that the union of the Holy One blessed is He and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) brought about through the *mitzvot* is His **true** desire. In the note there, he states that this is the matter of sweetening the severities (*Gevurot*) with the kindnesses (*Chassadim*) of the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin*, this being the matter of "the thirteen white [streaks of hair] of the Long Patient One-*Arich Anpin*,"[53] which are the aspect of

[52] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 225 and on.
[53] See Mishnat Chassidim, Mesechet Arich Anpin, Ch. 4

the kindnesses (*Chassadim*) of the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin*.[54]

The explanation is that, as known,[55] in the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin* there also are the aspects of kindnesses (*Chassadim*) and severities (*Gevurot*). The aspect of the severities (*Gevurot*) of the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin* is that the Source of Life (*Mekor Chayim*) is drawn forth to vitalize in a constricted way (*Tzimtzum*) (that is, it is not the aspect of the essence of the light, but only a radiance by way of constriction (*Tzimtzum*)), and it immediately is withdrawn to its source etc. This then, is why the desire (*Ratzon*) is in a state of "coming and not coming" (*Mati v'Lo Mati*), because it is drawn forth through the aspects of the severities (*Gevurot*) of the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin*.

Now, as known,[56] the severities (*Gevurot*) are the aspect of fiery flames, this being the matter of the passion and [yearning] to become subsumed etc. (The general explanation of the matter is that through the severities (*Gevurot*) there only is caused to be a drawing forth of a light and ray, which is why it applies for there to be the aspects of passion and becoming subsumed in it etc.) Thus, it is the aspect of the Source of Life (*Mekor Chayim*) and is the source and root for vitality to be drawn forth in the worlds in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), as discussed before.

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[54] See Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2 p. 231 regarding what is stated here regarding the relationship between the desire for the *mitzvot* and the kindnesses (*Chassadim*) of the One of Ancient Days-*Atik Yomin*.

[55] See Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 4; Also see the Hosafot to Torah Ohr Shemot 107c; Sefer HaMaamarim 5652 p. 20 and on.

[56] See Tanya, Ch. 50.

However, the aspect of the kindnesses (*Chassadim*) of the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin* literally are the opposite. That is, they are like the drawing forth of waters that descend from a high place to a low place,[57] in which the descent to below affects no change in their existence altogether, since they are the same as they were at the very beginning of their drawing forth etc. Additionally, the nature of water is to be drawn from a high place to a low place. That is, they have the opposite nature of fire, the nature of which is to withdraw from below to above,[58] which is also why it cannot be drawn from Above to below except by way of constriction (*Tzimtzum*) etc. (That is, because this is the opposite of its nature, it must be by way of constriction (*Tzimtzum*).

Additionally, because its nature is that of ascent, this being the matter of concealment and hiddenness, therefore, the drawing down by way of the severities (*Gevurot*) is drawn forth by way of constriction (*Tzimtzum*). That is, only a radiance is drawn forth, in which it is applicable for there to be a drawing down (*Hamshachah*) and becoming subsumed (*Hitkallelut*) etc.) In contrast, the kindnesses (*Chassadim*) of the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin* are only the source of drawing down (*Hamshachah*), and not the aspect of ascent (*Ha'ala'ah*) whatsoever. In this there is literally a drawing forth of the aspect of His Essential Self, not by way of constriction (*Tzimtzum*) at all. Therefore, it is through doing so that we sweeten the aspect of the severities (*Gevurot*) of the Ancient of

[57] Talmud Bavli, Taanit 7a; Also see Tanya, Ch. 4 (8b); Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 118 and on (in earlier editions Vol. 4 p. 206).

[58] See Tanya, beginning of Ch. 19 (24b).

Days-*Atik Yomin*. That is, the nullification of the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) is caused and an illumination of the aspect of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One. In this aspect, since it is the aspect of a drawing forth of the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, it is inapplicable for there to be a matter of drawing down (*Hamshachah*) and becoming subsumed (*Hitkallelut*) in it, meaning, the aspects of "spreading forth" and "the absence of spreading forth."

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Now, from all the above it is understood that the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*), which is the aspect of the Source of Life (*Mekor Chayim*) to vitalize the worlds, is the source and root of the aspect of time, since it only is the aspect of a light and ray, and also has the aspects of "coming" (*Mati*) and "not coming" (*Lo Mati*), which are the aspects of "spreading forth" (*Hitpashtut*) and "being subsumed" (*Hitkallelut*).

In contrast, the desire for the *mitzvot* is a drawing forth of the aspect of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, in which there is not even a source and root for the aspect of time etc., as explained before. Therefore, it specifically is this aspect that is called "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One (*Oseen Retzono Shel Makom*-עושין רצונו של מקום)," in that they draw forth the aspect of the limitless light of the Unlimited One who transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*) into the aspect of the "space-*Makom*-מקום" of His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*) including all the way down to below.

This is because when it comes to the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*) that relates to vitalizing the worlds, since it is the aspect of the source for the limited vitality of His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*), how then can there be a drawing forth from there of the revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) within the aspects of space and time? [That is], how can there be the negation of the limitations of space and time when in the desire itself, there at the very least is the source of the limitation, when it is from it that there is the drawing forth of the limitations of His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*)?

Rather, this is specifically brought about through the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot*, wherein there is not even the aspect of a source of limitation, and their entire substance is specifically to be drawn below as Above, without any constriction (*Tzimtzum*) etc. Therefore, it is specifically through [the *mitzvot*] that there is a drawing forth of the aspect of His desire (*Ratzon*-רצון), blessed is He, into "space-*Makom*-מקום," so that even within space and time there will not be the limitations of space and time.

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This then, is the meaning of the statement in Midrash, "Everything has limits of space and time. The heavens and earth have limits of space and time." That is, even the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*) to create the world, even though, in and of itself, it is in a state of limitlessness, nevertheless, in its drawing forth there is the aspect of an end and limit, and it is not drawn

into revelation below. This is because there is a source for the limitations of time and space even in the desire (*Ratzon*), as discussed before." [The Midrash continues], "except for the Torah, which does not have the limitations of space and time." This refers to the desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot*, which is limitless, since there is a drawing forth in this of the aspect of the Essential Self of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, in which it altogether does not apply for there to even be the aspect of a source for time and space. Therefore, when this aspect and level is drawn forth, the revelation is also drawn forth into the aspects of time and space.

This[59] explains the statement,[60] "Whosoever prays on the eve of Shabbat and recites the passage,[61] 'And the heavens and the earth were completed' (*Vayechulu*-ויכלו) Scripture regards it as though he is a partner with the Holy One, blessed is He, in the creation of the world." This is because the verse, "And the heavens and the earth were completed" (*Vayechulu*-ויכלו) refers to the fact that the Godly power drawn to the heavens and the earth is limited. However, when a Jew declares, "And the heaven and the earth were completed," he testifies that the world was created in six days and that He rested on the seventh day etc., as known.[62] This, in itself, is part and parcel of the *mitzvah* of Shabbat, about which it states, "Your commandment is exceedingly broad." In other words, through doing so, he draws down the aspect of the Essential Self of the

[59] Regarding this section of the discourse see Ohr HaTorah, Bereishit Vol. 3, p. 506b ibid.

[60] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 119b

[61] Genesis 2:1

[62] Kol Bo, Section 35; Tur and Shulchan Aruch 268:7; Maharsha to Shabbat 119b ibid., (cited in Ohr HaTorah ibid.)

Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*) and reveals it in the heavens and the earth. Therefore, it is as if he becomes a partner in creation with the Holy One, blessed is He, for he draws down revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Ohr Ein Sof*) into the world.

Now, although it is written,[63] "[I *HaShem*-יהו"ה do everything; By Myself I spread the heavens, I established the earth;] who is with Me?" meaning,[64] "who was with Me in the act of creation?" this refers to the essential act of creation [out of nothing]. However, in regard to once the world has been created, it states,[65] "He placed the world in the heart of man," to draw down revelation of Godliness into the world. This is accomplished through a Jew reciting the verse, "And the heavens and the earth were completed" (*Vayechulu*-ויכלו), this being the matter of fulfilling the *mitzvah* of Shabbat. He thereby becomes a partner, in that he draws down a revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Ohr Ein Sof*) into the heavens and the earth.

Now, a partner (*Shutaf*-**שותף**) means a friend (*Chaver*-חבר), as the verse states,[66] "She is your friend (*Chavertecha*-חברתך) and the wife of your covenant," which Targum translates as, "She is your partner (*Shutaftach*-**שותפ**תך) etc." This then, is the matter of the union of the Holy One, blessed is He and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) brought about through fulfilling the *mitzvot.*

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[63] Isaiah 44:24
[64] Midrash Bereishit Rabba 1:3
[65] Ecclesiastes 3:11
[66] Malachi 2:14

This then, is the meaning of the verse, "And the heavens and the earth were completed" (*Vayechalu*-ויכלו), in other words; they are limited and have a conclusion. That is, even the desire (*Ratzon*) for the creation of the world has limitation and conclusion. However, through fulfilling the *mitzvot* we draw down the aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*) which is beyond the desire (*Ratzon*) for worlds, through which Godliness is drawn into revelation in the world. This then, is the meaning of [the teaching], "Whosoever recites the verse, 'And the heaven and the earth were completed' on Shabbat, becomes a partner in the creation." For, he draws down the revelation of the Unlimited Light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה (*Ohr Ein Sof*) into the world, this being the matter of uniting the Holy One, blessed is He, with His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) etc.

Discourse 7

"*Eileh Toldot Noach… -*
These are the offspring of Noach…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Noach, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "These are the offspring of Noach, Noach was a righteous man." Rashi explains, "This comes to teach that the principal offspring of the righteous are their good deeds." Now, the source of this Rashi is in Midrash Rabbah,[3] which states, "This is the meaning of the verse,[4] 'The produce of the righteous is a tree of life.' What is the produce of the righteous? *Mitzvot* and good deeds!" To explain, the word "Offspring-*Toldot*-תולדות" is a term denoting revelation, and thus about this the verse states, "These are the offspring (*Toldot*-תולדות) of Noach," in that his primary "offspring" and revelations were his *mitzvot* and good deeds.

Now, we must understand what this statement comes to negate. That is, being that it states that their primary offspring

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[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah SheB'Brachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 537 and on; Discourse entitled "*HaNechemadim MiZahav*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken Ketuvim Vol. 1 p. 7 and on; Discourse entitled "*v'Heet'halachti b'Tochachem*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Vayikra Vol. 2 p. 817 and on; p. 828 and on – as cited later in the notes.

[2] Genesis 6:9

[3] Bereshit Rabbah 30:6

[4] Proverbs 11:30

are *mitzvot* etc., it must be negating something, and we therefore must understand what is being negated. Now, it does not apply to say that it comes to negate their actual physical offspring, for it cannot be said that they are not their offspring, though this has nothing to do with revelations. Rather, it must be said that the intention is to [negate] something related to the *mitzvot*, which also is a revelation, but even so, the primary revelation and offspring are *mitzvot* and good deeds. We therefore must understand the intention here.

Now, to understand this, we must begin with the explanation before[5] about the difference between the desire (*Ratzon*) for the creation of the world and the desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot*. That is, in regard to the desire (*Ratzon*) for the creation of the world, though the desire itself is unlimited (*Bli Gvul*), nevertheless the source of limitation is in it. Thus, the revelation [of the limitlessness] within the [limited] aspects of space and time arising from this desire (*Ratzon*) is not possible. In contrast, the desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot* is from the innerness and Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*), in which there is not even a source for the limitation. Thus, from this desire (*Ratzon*) the revelation [of the limitlessness] within the [limited] aspects of time and space is possible.

[5] In the previous discourses entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 47 and on), and "*Vayechulu HaShamayim*" (p. 64 and on).

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Now, the root of the matter is that, as known,[6] the Line-*Kav* drawn down from the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) to bring the worlds into being and vitalize them, is drawn by way of an incomparable leap, rather than by way of order and gradation. This refers to the matter of the first constriction-*Tzimtzum* that took place in the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) so that an empty place (*Makom Panuy*) remained. This is such that there was a cessation of the light (*Ohr*) in that it became concealed and subsumed within the Luminary (*Ma'or*). After this the Line-*Kav* was drawn down, it only being a radiance of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that precedes the constriction (*Tzimtzum*), rather than the essence of the light (*Ohr*) etc. This [radiance] was drawn down by way of a constricted Line-*Kav*, with measure and balance, commensurate to the degree that the worlds are capable of receiving, as explained at the beginning of Etz Chayim,[7] at the end of Anaf 3.

[6] See Ohr HaTorah Va'era p. 148; p. 152 and on; p. 210 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 p. 124; 5655 p. 207 and on; 5656 p. 352; 5701 p. 142 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 231 (Vol. 2 p. 230 in earlier editions), and elsewhere. Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 p. 59.

[7] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher), Anaf 3

Now,[8] the general purpose of the Line-*Kav* is to bring about up and down,[9] as stated in Etz Chayim, Anaf 2,[10] and at length in Mevo She'arim, Shaar 1, Chapter 2. For, if the illumination from the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) would not be by way of the Line-*Kav*, all the worlds would be equal etc. This is why the Line-*Kav* was drawn down, so that there would be the aspects of upper and lower. That is, the world that receives from the upper end of the Line-*Kav* which adheres to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is in the aspect of upper, in that the radiance of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is greater in it. In contrast, as the light is drawn further down from its adhesion to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) it becomes diminished and is the aspect of the lower.

The same is so of each *Sefirah* in each world, in that they too have upper and lower aspects. This is brought about through the manner of the revelation of the Line-*Kav* within every *Sefirah* etc., as discussed in Mevo Sha'erim there, and as explained elsewhere.[11] Because of this, there necessarily is an order of precedence in them from one to the other. That is, the higher *Sefirah* which is called "upper", precedes the "lower" in its coming into being and revelation.

As stated in Mevo She'arim, in His knowledge the Emanator decided that multiple lines would not be drawn down

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[8] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 230 and on; p. 237 and on; 5662 p. 329 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 61 and elsewhere.

[9] Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity Ch. 13-14.

[10] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher), Anaf 2

[11] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 230 and on.

from the Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) to encompass every *Sefirah*. For, although this would bring them into existence, they would all be equal in level. That is, it would **not** be as if there were no lines altogether, for then, not only would they be equal in level, but their existence would be utterly nullified, and the worlds could not exist as [separate] entities. For if that were the case, the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) would only serve to draw down and bring the worlds into revelation. That is, [it would be that] they initially were subsumed in the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that precedes the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) and the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) would serve to bring about their being drawn down and revealed, however, in essence, their state of being would still be the same as it was before the constriction (*Tzimtzum*).

Now, in reality, this is how it is even now, as known about the matter of "*HaShem* is One-*HaShem Echad*- יהו"ה אחד,"[12] because the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) indeed shines upon them in a revealed way. This is because in relation to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) does not hide or conceal,[13] and it shines in a revealed way after the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) just as it did before the constriction (*Tzimtzum*). They thus are utterly nullified of their existence and are absolutely unified with Him.

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[12] See Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) and on; Also see Derech Mitzvotecha 62a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 156 and on; 5643 p. 95 and on.

[13] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 12-13.

This being so, what then is the matter of creation?[14] Does the verse not say,[15] "In the beginning God created etc.?" Thus, the matter of creation is only that they were drawn down and revealed. That is, at first, they were subsumed, and the matter of creation is that they were drawn down and revealed outside His Essential Self, so to speak, but are nonetheless completely nullified and unified etc. In other words, the nullification and unity of the worlds [with Him] is like the unity in the lights (*Orot*), [about which it states],[16] "He and His organs are one." Now, in reality, the same is so of the worlds as well, and to an even greater extent, due to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that shines upon them in a revealed way in His knowledge, blessed is He.

Likewise, had the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) shone upon [the *Sefirot*] not by way of the Line-*Kav*, the revelation would be in such a way as this [i.e., their existence would be utterly nullified] etc. Rather, when the light shines by way of the Line-*Kav*, rather than the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) as it is itself, they thereby are caused to be in a state of [sensing their] existence. However, had there been many lines, they all would be equal in level and there would not be a matter of upper and lower in them.

This is why, in His knowledge, the Emanator decided that the light should be drawn down by way of a single Line-*Kav* drawn down from level to level, meaning from the upper world to the lower world, in which the lower world is brought

[14] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 ibid. p. 161 and on.
[15] Genesis 1:1
[16] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 3b

into being from the upper world. Likewise, the *Sefirot* are also drawn down from level to level and chain down one from the other, automatically necessitating that they have the aspects of upper and lower, precedence and subsequence.

Now, even if they did not chain down from each other, they still would necessarily have the aspects of upper and lower, precedence and subsequence, due to their being drawn down from the Line-*Kav*. Nonetheless, if that were the case, we could say that there only would be these aspects of upper and lower, precedence and subsequence, in relation to the worlds themselves, but not within each specific world and the *Sefirot* in that world. That is, even though they differ one from the other in essence, there would not be the aspects of upper and lower, and especially not the aspects of precedence and subsequence.

This is because each world has a measure as to how the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) will be revealed in that world. That is, the general revelation within that world accords to the manner of the measure of that world, including all the particulars within it. For example, about the *Sefirot* of the world of Chaos-*Tohu* which are "one under the other,"[17] and this likewise is so of the essential *Sefirot* that do not chain down from each other, although they too have aspects of intellect (*Mochin*) and emotions (*Midot*) which differ from each other in the very essence of their beings, in that emotions (*Midot*) are in a state of arousal that spreads outside of the essence, whereas the aspect of intellect (*Mochin*) is adhesion to

[17] See Etz Chayim, Shaar HaKlallim Ch. 1; Shaar 10 (Shaar HaTikkun) Ch. 5; Torah Ohr Shemot 52a; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 44c.

the essence, nonetheless, in both the revelation of light is equal. That is, in the emotions (*Midot*) there also is an illumination of the intensity of the light and revelation, just as in the intellect, as known and explained elsewhere.[18] Therefore, in the revelation of light in them they do not have the divisions of upper and lower, nor do they have an order of precedence and subsequence. Rather, they all come into revelation at once, as explained elsewhere.[19]

In contrast, when they indeed chain down one from the other, they necessarily have the aspects of upper and lower, precedence and subsequence, as discussed in the discourses entitled "*U'BeYom HaBikkurim*" of the year 5651,[20] and "*VeChol HaAm Ro'eem*" of the year 5665.[21] (This then, explains the aspects of time and space as they are Above in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). That is, the aspects of above and below are the aspect of space (*Makom*-מקום) as it is Above,[22] whereas the aspects of precedence and subsequence are the aspect of time (*Zman*-זמן) as it is Above, as discussed in the above-mentioned discourse by the title "*U'BeYom HaBikkurim*.")[23]

Now, there are also various veils (*Parsa'ot*) in the worlds, even in the limitless worlds that precede the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). This is as stated in Zohar at the beginning

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[18] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5653 p. 239; 5654 p. 288 and on; 5658 p. 100; 5665 p. 267; Also see the beginning of the prior discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 36).

[19] See the citations in the preceding note.

[20] It is possible that this should say 5654 (see Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 ibid.).

[21] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 ibid.

[22] See Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Yesodei HaTorah 2:6; Also see Likkutei Torah Bechukotai 48b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 348.

[23] Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 ibid. p. 291

of Idra Rabba,[24] "He spread one veil (*Parsa*) before Him," referring to the aspect of the veil (*Parsa*) positioned at the naval (*Taboor*) of Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*), as stated in Etz Chayim, Shaar HaNekudim, chapter 2. There likewise is a veil (*Parsa*) between the Crown-*Keter* and the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). In the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) there likewise is a veil (*Parsa*) between [the intellectual and emotive faculties] Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah* and *Zeir Anpin*,[25] this being the matter of "the firmament above the upper *Chayot* etc."[26] This certainly is so between the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and the world of Creation (*Briyah*), as well as between the world of Creation (*Briyah*) and the world of Formation (*Yetzirah*) etc.[27] (It is stated in Etz Chayim referenced above, that the aspect of the veil (*Parsa*) of Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*) is for the sake of creation.)

Now, the entire matter of the veils (*Parsa'ot*) is to conceal the light. This is especially so of the veil (*Parsa*) between the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and the world of Creation (*Briyah*), which is to hide and conceal the light of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) so that it will not illuminate in the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*).

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[24] Zohar III 128a

[25] See Zohar I 65a; Ohr HaTorah Inyanim p. 180; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 Vol. 2 p. 572.

[26] Zohar II 211a; 213a; Also see Likkutei Torah Tazriya 22d; Siddur Im Da"Ch 64a and elsewhere.

[27] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 8 (Shaar Drushei Nekudot) Ch. 2 ibid.; Torah Ohr Lech Lecha 12c and on, and elsewhere.

Now, as known,[28] the veils (*Parsa'ot*) are the aspect of letters (*Otiyot*) which are called "inanimate" (*Domem*) in that they have no spreading forth whatsoever. However, we indeed observe that, for example, when it comes to the letters of speech, although they are inanimate (*Domem*), they nonetheless reveal the intellect. This is because the transference of intellect to one's fellow is through the letters of speech. We thus see that the light of the intellect or the emotions of the heart illuminate through them. Even though they also conceal the innerness of the light, nonetheless they also reveal light, as discussed elsewhere.[29] That is, since they are letters ordered in combinations that align with the intellect, they thus are receptacles for the light which manifests in them in a revealed way and illuminates through them.

However, when the letters are unordered and there is no separation between one letter and the other, they then do not reveal the light. On the contrary, in and of themselves the letters cause the matter of the cessation, separation, and concealment of the light, so that it is not revealed. An example is the letters (*Otiyot*) in Kabbalistic amulets (*Kamiyot*), in which the letters are not ordered, specifically to conceal the secret contained in them. This then, is the matter of the veil (*Parsa*) Above in Godliness. That is, they are letters (*Otiyot*) that are not ordered, thus causing the cessation and concealment of the light so that

[28] Regarding the coming section see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah ibid. (p. 537 and on), and with variations in Sefer HaMaamarim 5660 p. 129; 5671 p. 60 and on.

[29] See Shaar HaEmunah of the Mittler Rebbe, p. 84b and on; Likkutei Torah Tzav 16d; Also see the beginning of the prior discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 16) and elsewhere.

it will not be revealed as is. Rather, the light which penetrates the veil to be revealed, is only a secondary offspring light (*Ohr Shel Tolda*),[30] which altogether cannot compare to the light (*Ohr*) as it transcends the veil (*Parsa*).

This is like concealing the light of the sun with a thick cloth woven with many strands one upon the other, such that there is no empty space or separation between them, leaving no place for the light to pass through. It rather only passes through the very finest holes in the weave. Such light becomes fully changed, such that it altogether is unlike the light that preceded it.

The same is understood as it is Above about the matter of the veil (*Parsa*) between the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and the world of Creation (*Briyah*). That is, it serves in concealing the light as it is in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), that being the radiance of the Line-*Kav*, so that it will not illuminate as it is in a revealed way, but only that which penetrates through the veil (*Parsa*), by which it undergoes a change of being and is now called "an offspring light" (*Ohr Shel Tolada*).

Now, all the constrictions and concealments accord to the dictates of the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*),[31] which measures all measures of the bestowal of the light, that is, how it should be for the existence of the world to be possible. This

[30] See Torah Ohr, Lech Lecha 12b; 13a; Vayera 14c; Sefer HaArachim Chabad Vol. 3 p. 511.

[31] See Zohar II 233a; Likkutei Torah Naso 27c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 Vol. 2 p. 586 and on; Ohr HaTorah Shlach p. 493 and on and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 15.

is as the verse states,[32] "Who measured the waters with His tool," in that He measures the aspect of the "waters above the firmament"[33] as well as the separating veil (*Parsa*) and determines how it will be drawn down. This is because, if the light would be drawn down as is, the worlds could not exist. This is the purpose of this measurement, to constrict and conceal the light.

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Now, this measurement is rooted in the Primordial Desire in His Essential Self (*Ratzon HaKadoom b'Atzmuto*) in the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) before the constriction (*Tzimtzum*), according to the desire that arose in His will, blessed is He, about the order and way that the worlds will be created. That is, when His desire for worlds arose, so to speak, there was an estimation in this desire of how the worlds are destined to be. This refers to the estimation within Himself in potential, of what is destined to actually be after the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) etc.[34] [This estimation] is the root of the measurements of all the ways that the light would be drawn down in all the constrictions and concealments, so that the worlds would come into being as they arose in His desire, blessed is He.

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[32] Isaiah 40:12; Also see Ohr HaTorah, Na"Ch Vol. 3 p. 1,216 (to Zohar II 175b); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 334.

[33] Genesis 1:7

[34] Mikdash Melech commentary to Zohar I 15a ibid.; Also see the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5709 p. 38 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 352. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 10-11.

However, as known[35] there are three general levels in the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*). The first is the thing being measured by means of the Line that gives measure (*Kav HaMidah*). The second is the Line itself, that measures and gives measure and limit to all things. The third is the Essential Self who transcends the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*), and from whom the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*) is drawn down in this way, within whose power it is to change the way of the measurement to be in a completely different way. About this Sefer Yetzirah states,[36] "The Holy One, blessed is He, created the world with three things, with an Author (*Sofer*-סופר), a book (*Sefer*-ספר), and a story (*Sippur*-סיפור)."

To explain, the story (*Sipur*-סיפור) refers to the letters that are already counted and measured with limited measure. The book (*Sefer*-ספר) is what gives measure to the measure of the letters. The Author-*Sofer*-סופר [which is written] with the letter *Vav*-ו,[37] is the One who writes the book, in that from Him the two aspects of the book (*Sefer*-ספר) and the story (*Sippur*-סיפור) are drawn.

By way of a physical analogy,[38] this is like an author who writes various letters. There necessarily are two matters in this. The first is after he already has finished writing the letters with ink on parchment, meaning that they already are limited

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[35] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaZaken Ketubvim ibid., and with variations in Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 153 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 p. 60 and on ibid.; 5661 p. 192 and on; 5680-5681 p. 38 and on; 5692 p. 107 and on.

[36] Sefer Yetzirah 1:1; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 408; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch p. 500.

[37] [See Sefer Yetzirah 1:1 ibid., that the other two aspects are written as "*Sipur*-ספר" and "*Sefer*-ספר," whereas the "author-*Sofer*-סופר" is written with the *Vav*-ו.]

[38] Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 ibid.

and measured. The second is when he has yet to write the letters, but he only thinks in his mind and considers how to write them, and then chooses and decides how to write them. In this decision there already is a potential limitation and measure to the letters, except that they have yet to be brought into actuality. However [when they indeed come into actuality] it is certain that they will accord to how he measured and limited them in potential when he considered them in thought. This is called the Measuring Line, by which he metes out the measure of the letters in actuality.

This likewise is like a measuring rod by which merchandise is measured. In this too, there are the things that already have been measured by the measuring rod, and there is the measuring rod itself, which stands ready to measure all measurements of any objects. However, it specifically will be measured according to the measure of the measuring rod itself. That is, even if the measuring rod has not yet measured anything, nonetheless, it is certain that all its measurements will specifically be by its own measure, since it itself has measure. However, the person who is measuring has the power to completely change the measurement and measure with a different measure, not at all according to the measure of this measuring rod.

It likewise is understood in the above-mentioned analogy of the author (*Sofer*-סופר), that the measure of the letters (*Otiyot*) is according to the desire (*Ratzon*) he first envisioned in his thought. From that thought there cannot be a different measure, since it itself is already specifically measured in this measure. This is akin to how there cannot be a different

measurement from the measuring rod, as explained before. However, in regard to the author (*Sofer*-סופר) himself, He has power to change it and write it in a completely different way etc.

From all the above examples, we may understand the matter as it is Above when it comes to the measurement of lights (*Orot*) within vessels (*Keilim*), as well as the above-mentioned screens and veils (*Parsa'ot*). These are the aspect of the actual measurements in regard to the drawing down of the lights (*Orot*), and this is[39] according to the decree of His wisdom (*Chochmah*) and desire (*Ratzon*), blessed is He, in the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that precedes the constriction (*Tzimtzum*), that it should specifically be in this way. This is the matter of the estimation in potential of the way of the form of the worlds, that they should specifically be in such a way. This is the Line-*Kav* that measures[40] what the measure of the lights should actually be. This is because the Line-*Kav* that measures itself has measure. That is, from the aspect of this thought and desire, there cannot be a different measure, but it only is according to the measure and estimation that took place in potential.

However, this is the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) of the desire (*Ratzon*) which relates to the existence of the worlds. As it is in the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One Himself, it is the aspect of light (*Ohr*) that relates to another, and already is measured as to how it will be

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[39] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid. Also see the discourse entitled "*HaChodesh*" in Sefer HaMaamarim 5670 ibid. [See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 71, note 36.]

[40] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5670 ibid.

in actuality. However, in regard to the innerness and Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, who transcends the desire (*Ratzon*) that relates to worlds and transcends the estimation in potential etc., from there the measure can come in a completely different way. That is, the way the drawings down are brought about can be completely different, **not at all** according to the dictates of the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*). This is because in relation to the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, the measure causes no element of concealment whatsoever, and He literally can shine with the light of His Essential Self, as He literally is.

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This then,[41] is the difference between the desire (*Ratzon*) for the act of creation, and the desire for the *mitzvot*. To explain, as known,[42] the primary source for the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) is the aspect of His desire (*Ratzon*). This refers to His simple desire (*Ratzon Pashut*) that precedes the constriction (*Tzimtzum*). About this, it states in Zohar,[43] "In the beginning of the reign of the King etc." In Etz Chayim it states,[44] "When it arose in His simple desire etc." That is, everything that has subsequently been done in the entire order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*),

[41] Regarding the coming section see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah ibid. (p. 538); Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 ibid. p. 62; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5678 p. 55.

[42] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Vayikra ibid. (p. 826 and on), and elsewhere.

[43] Zohar I 15a

[44] Etz Chayim, Shaar 1 (Drush Iggulim v'Yosher) Anaf 2

from the beginning of all things to the end of all things,[45] is all as it arose in His thought, in the aspect of His simple desire (*Ratzon HaPashut*).

However, the general aspect of this desire (*Ratzon*), even though it is in His Essential Self that precedes the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) and still utterly transcends even being a source for the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*), nevertheless in His Essential Self, it so to speak, is the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) of His desire (*Ratzon*), which relates to worlds, and it thus is measured with the aspects of measure and limitation, that it should specifically be in this way.

Even though it literally is limitless relative to the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*), it nevertheless has measure in potential, in that the desire (*Ratzon*) is for it to specifically be in such and such a way etc. From this aspect there subsequently is a drawing down of measure in actuality after the constriction (*Tzimtzum*), in a way of drawing down the lights (*Orot*), such that there is Above and below, precedence and subsequence, so that the worlds will descend from level to level, especially through veils that conceal and hide, in that it all is drawn from the aspect of this desire (*Ratzon*).

However,[46] the desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot* is of the innerness and Essential Self of the limitless light of the

[45] See the introduction to Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity.

[46] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah ibid. p. 539; Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 335 and on; 5657 ibid. p. 156 and on; 5671 ibid. p. 62 and on. [Those citations state, "the desire **for Torah** and *mitzvot*," and later the discourse also discusses **the letters of Torah**. See there. Here,

Unlimited One, which transcends the desire (*Ratzon*) for worlds, and it is not measured by that measure or limitation altogether. Therefore, the revelation drawn down from there is in an entirely different way. That is, that there literally will be the revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) in the worlds, **not** according to the measure of upper and lower, but rather that the revelation below will be exactly as it is Above etc.

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Now, the *mitzvot* also have measure, in that all the *mitzvot* have limitations and measures in themselves and in the way they are fulfilled. An example is the *mitzvah* of Tefillin, in that the head Tefillin must specifically consist of four Torah portions in four compartments, whereas in the hand Tefillin they are in a single compartment.[47] Moreover, there are many particulars in the laws of writing of the Torah portions, as well as how the compartments should be formed and the way they should be donned etc.[48] Likewise, the Tzitzit must specifically be made in such and such a way. The same is so of all the *mitzvot*, such as the Sukkah, which cannot be less than seven

however, he only mentions the desire for the *mitzvot*, and this is similar so in Sefer HaMaamarim 5680-5681 ibid.]

[47] See Talmud Bavli, Menachot 34b; Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Tefillin 2:31; Tur and Shulchan Aruch Orach Chayim 32:2.

[48] See Tur and Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chayim 32.

handsbreadths and a bit,[49] nor higher than twenty cubits etc.,[50] this being the measure in the desire (*Ratzon*) of the Supernal One for the *mitzvot*, that the desire is that it specifically must be in such and such a way etc. This then, is the meaning of the Torah being the explanation of the *mitzvot*, in that it explains what His desire (*Ratzon*) is.

Now, all this is a matter of measure in the drawing down of the lights (*Orot*). That is, it specifically is when the *mitzvot* are done in precisely this way that the light is drawn down, and if not etc. Furthermore, seemingly, the essential being of the light drawn down is the light of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*). For example, through the *mitzvah* of Tefillin there is a drawing down of the four aspects of the mind (*Mochin*),[51] and through the *mitzvah* of Tzitzit there is a drawing down of the thirty-two pathways of Wisdom (*Lamed-Beit Netivot Chochmah*),[52] and in the Sukkah there is a drawing down of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the Mother-*Immah* (Understanding-*Binah*) etc.[53]

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[49] See the note of the Rebbe to the discourse entitled "*MeEimatai Korin*" 5642 (printed as a pamphlet – Kehot 5725), p. 5, where it says, "This is as stated in various places – "and a bit." See Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 16b; Tur and Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chayim 634; Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 10. However, this requires further analysis. (For, seemingly, the "bit" is necessary, as "when a person sits, he occupies one cubit, and his table a handbreadth [i.e., there are six hands-breadths in a cubit, plus one handsbreadth is seven hands-breadths], and [another] handsbreadth cannot sit within a handsbreadth. Moreover, it should be noted (Sukkah 5a) that the smallest dimension of the vessels is a handsbreadth.)

[50] See Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 2a (in the Mishnah); Tur and Shulchan Aruch Orach Chayim 633.

[51] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 6c and on; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefillin 174a and on.

[52] See Likkutei Torah, Shlach 47b; Korach 53a, and elsewhere.

[53] See Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 80b; Siddur Im Da'Ch 259a and on; 260b and on; 265a and on; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 421.

Moreover, as known,[54] all the *mitzvot* depend on the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, and the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is the aspect of the light (*Ohr*) of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) and its four letters are the way in which the light is brought forth and drawn down, as explained elsewhere at length,[55] and as we explained in short.[56]

However,[57] the explanation is that this measure is not a measure in the light itself, in how it will be drawn down with measure and balance in a way of constriction and concealment, such that it has the divisions of upper and lower etc. This is because, in reality, none of this applies to the inner and essential light (*Ohr Pnimi v'Atzmi*) drawn down through the *mitzvot*.

To further explain, the matter of the measure in the light itself, which is for the purpose of limiting and concealing the light, only applies in the radiance (*Ha'arah*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), even in the limitless light of the Unlimited One as it precedes the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) in the externality of the light (*Chitzoniyut HaOhr*) that relates to the worlds. However, in the essence of the light (*Atzmut HaOhr*) measure does not apply altogether, and the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) neither causes constriction nor concealment in it, as explained elsewhere.[58] It rather is the

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[54] See the introduction to Tikkunei Zohar (4b; 5a); Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Shabbat Shuvah 64d; Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 35 and on, and elsewhere.

[55] See Torat Chayim, Shemot Vol. 1 p. 150a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5651 p. 22 and on; 5652 p. 94 and on; 5656 p. 250 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Kedoshim Tihiyu*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 274 and on).

[56] At the end of the discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 12 and on).

[57] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 ibid. (p. 341 and on); Likkutei Sichot, Vol. 19 p. 26.

[58] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid. p. 202; 5665 p. 183.

measure of the way the light will be drawn down, meaning[59] [the measure] of when the essential light (*Ohr HaAtzmi*) will be drawn forth. That is, it is such that when the *mitzvot* are done in precisely such and such a way that it is drawn down, because such it arose in His essential desire (*Ratzon HaAtzmi*).

That is, it was measured in this way in the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*) in which it altogether[60] was that [the *mitzvot*] must specifically be done precisely in such and such a way. This is because it is understood that the *mitzvah* itself is not the reason or cause for the measure and limitation in the desire (*Ratzon*). That is, the fact that there is measure in this desire, that the *mitzvah*, such as Tefillin and the like, must be done in precisely such and such a way, is not that the doing of the *mitzvah* is the reason and cause for the measure and limitation.

Now, this is unlike the measure of the desire that relates to the worlds, in which the worlds themselves are the reason and cause for the measure etc. For, since it arose in His will that there will be worlds, and that there will be a revelation of His Unlimited Light (*Ohr Ein Sof*) in them, and that there will be differences in the various ways of the revelations etc., and it also arose in His blessed will that there will be the existence of

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[59] Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 ibid. p. 63, "In other words, the measure is measure of essentiality (*Medidah Atzmiyut*-מדידה עצמיות), meaning, by what mechanism is the aspect of His Essential Self drawn forth, and that this is brought about specifically through these matters." Also see p. 196, "This, then, is the matter of the essential measure (*Medidah Atzmit*-מדידה עצמית), meaning, by what mechanism His Essential Self is drawn forth." Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 14 p. 323 wherein the terminology utilized is "essential limitation-*Hagbalah Atzmit*-הגבלה עצמית." Also see *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,336 where it states, "essential measure and limitation-*Medidah v'Hagbalah Atzmit*-מדידה והגבלה עצמית."

[60] See Shnei Luchot HaBrit 4b in the note (citing Rabbi Yosef Alkastilla); Yonat Eilem Ch. 2; Torat Chayim Noach 63a; Also see the prior discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 49 and on).

this lowest world (for the sake of fulfilling *HaShem's*-ה"והי Supernal intent, in that "the Holy One, blessed is He, lusted for a dwelling place in the lower worlds etc."),[61] and since it is not possible for this world to be brought forth with a sense of independent existence without being preceded by the coming into being of the upper worlds, thus, the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) acts as an intermediary between the limitless light of the Unlimited One who Emanates, and the creations, as known.[62]

Moreover, this is so not only of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), but also of the worlds that transcend the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). That is, from the very inception of the creation of novel being, it all is for this lowest world to be. That is, there first must be the existence of the aspect of Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*) and then there must be a descent from level to level, and only specifically then is it possible for the existence of the lower world to be.

(Now, when it is stated that it cannot be in any other way, in reality, from the perspective of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), the existence of the lower world indeed is possible without the intermediary of the upper worlds preceding it. Nevertheless, because He intended the existence

[61] Midrash Tanchuma Bechukotai 3, Naso 16; Bereshit Rabbah, Ch. 3; Bamidbar Rabbah, Ch. 13; Tanya Ch. 36 (45b); Also see *Hemshech* 5666 ibid. p. 5 & p. 10 and on.

[62] See Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 93a; Likkutei Torah Va'etchanan 12a; Also see at length in Ohr HaTorah Megillat Esther p. 270 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 Vol. 1 p. 312 and on; 5632 Vol. 1 p. 134 and on.

of the worlds to be [specifically in this way] it therefore specifically had to be in this way, as explained elsewhere.)[63]

Because of this a measure and estimation took place in potential within His simple desire (*Ratzon HaPashut*) as to how the lights would be drawn down, so that novel existence would be brought about in such and such a way. This being so, the measurement of the light (*Ohr*) was such that worlds could be brought forth from it, this being the matter of the limitation of the light etc.[64] Therefore the worlds themselves are the reason and cause for the measure within His simple desire (*Ratzon HaPashut*).

Now, since the worlds are the cause for the measure, it follows automatically that the measure is to limit and constrict the light (*Ohr*), such that the worlds are able to receive, being that this is the cause for the measure, so that there can be worlds in such and such a way. Therefore, the manner in which the light (*Ohr*) is measured is in such a way that worlds can come into being from it, which is the matter of the limiting of the light (*Ohr*).

In contrast, about the desire (*Ratzon*) that the *mitzvot* must be done in such and such a way, it cannot be said that the doing of the *mitzvot* themselves is the reason for the measure. This is because it is clearly understood that doing the *mitzvot* altogether has no relation [to Him, and as stated],[65] "What does

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[63] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Parshiyot Vol. 1 p. 337; Ohr HaTorah Yitro p. 1,010; Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 Vol. 1 p. 302; 5653 p. 170 and on; 5658 p. 120; 5659 p. 144; 5662 p. 315; 5692 p. 425; 5704 p. 69; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 29 p. 30; Sefer HaSichot 5748 Vol. 1 p. 135 and elsewhere.

[64] Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 5 p. 66 and notes 69-70.

[65] See Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 44:1; Midrash Tanchuma Shemini 8, and elsewhere.

He care…?" That is, it is of no relation [to Him] for it to be of importance to Him whether they be specifically done in such a way.

Moreover, as understood it does not apply to say that the doing of the *mitzvot* should be the cause of the measure. For, even without the measure in the [Supernal] desire (*Ratzon*), it would be possible to do the action. That is, it does not apply to say that had it not arisen in His will that the *mitzvah* of Tefillin must be done in this particular way, it would be impossible to do the act of donning Tefillin in this way. How could it be fitting to say such a thing? Certainly, even if it did not arise in His will that the *mitzvah* of Tefillin must be done in such a way, it still would be possible to do it. Although it is true that the actual physicality of the Tefillin, such as the parchment and leather etc., could not possibly exist had it not arisen in His blessed will for there to be parchment etc., nonetheless, this relates to the desire (*Ratzon*) for the creation and existence of the worlds, in that this may be said about the very existence of parchment etc. Nonetheless, it does not apply to say that [once the parchment exists] it would be impossible to write the Torah portions with ink on the parchment and don Tefillin even had it never arisen in His desire for it be so. This being so, the action is not the cause of the measurement.

Now, since the action is not the cause of the measurement, it follows automatically that the measure is not for the purpose of limiting and constricting the light. Rather, it solely is that such it arose in His will that this will be the *mitzvah* and that it must be done in such a way, without any reason for the desire (*Ratzon*) altogether. In truth, we specifically must

fulfill the *mitzvah* in such a way solely because this is what arose in His desire, blessed is He. It follows that we must do it specifically in this way and not in any other way, Heaven forbid, and had *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Supernal desire been for us to chop wood, we would be obliged to chop wood, and the like.[66]

However, in regard to the measure of the desire for the *mitzvot*, in that there is the measure that they be done in this specific way, there is no reason altogether. It thus follows automatically that here there also is no measure or limitation in the essence of the light, and the only measure is that the light must be drawn down specifically through doing of these specific deeds. Nevertheless, that which is drawn down through this is the aspect of His essential light (*Ohr HaAtzmi*), as it is, having no measure and limitation, and it is drawn down in all the worlds without differentiation between upper or lower at all.

Now, in regard to [the statement before that] fulfilling the *mitzvah* of Tefillin brings a drawing down of the four aspects of the mind (*Mochin*), this does not refer to the intellect (*Mochin*) of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*). There rather is an actual drawing down of completely new intellect (*Mochin*). That is, in the intellectual aspects (*Mochin*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and Knowledge-*Da'at*, there is an actual illumination from the innerness and Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*) that utterly transcends the intellect (*Mochin*) of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder*

[66] See Likkutei Torah Shlach 40a; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5566 Vol. 2 p. 526; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 21 p. 17, note 51; Discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5735 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Bati LeGani Vol. 1 p. 175, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5735, Discourse 14).

Hishtalshelut). In turn, this aspect of intellect (*Mochin*) illuminates in *Zeir Anpin* and *Nukva*, and in the totality of all the worlds, that is, in all the worlds, and in all their levels.

The same is true of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the Mother-*Imma* (Understanding-*Binah*) drawn down through fulfilling the *mitzvah* of Sukkah. That is, in this there actually is a drawing down of the innerness and Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*) in the drawing down of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the Mother-*Imma* (Understanding-*Binah*) in all the worlds, literally all the way down below.

This likewise is the matter of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה upon which the *mitzvot* depend. This refers to the aspect of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה that is much higher than the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*).

As known,[67] there is His Essential Name (*Shem HaEtzem*), and there then are names related to His deeds (*Shem HaPe'ulah*).[68] A name related to a deed (*Shem HaPe'ulah*) is only like a glimmer of radiance, and thus comes by way of measure and limitation etc. In contrast His Essential Name means that His Essential Self is called thus, meaning that in this Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה there literally is a revelation of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and

[67] See at length in Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 112a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 184; Discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5720 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Bati LeGani Vol. 1 p. 353 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5720, Discourse 10.

[68] See Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) and The Gate of His Title (*Shaar HaKinuy*) and on.

Unlimited One,[69] and although it too has letters (*Otiyot*),[70] they nonetheless are essential letters (*Otiyot Atzmiyim*) that reveal the totality of His Essential Self.

This Name is called "a garment of light" (*Levush Ohr*),[71] in that it neither covers nor conceal at all, but on the contrary, it reveals the totality of His Essential Self etc. This is because without letters (*Otiyot*) no revelation of light would be possible.[72] This is especially so in order for the inner manifest light (*Ohr Pnimi*) to be, in that this must be brought about through letters (*Otiyot*). This then, is the matter of the four letters of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which are the matter of the coming forth and drawing down of the light to be in the aspect of an inner manifest light (*Ohr Pnimi*). Nevertheless, in this there is a drawing down of the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*).

[Now, in regard to the statement before], that the letter *Yod*-י of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is the aspect of constriction

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[69] See at length in Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) and on.

[70] In Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 it states that "it is explained elsewhere that about the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה of His Essential Self, there are no letters (*Otiyot*) there [also see Ginat Egoz ibid., cited in the discourse entitled "*Shiviti*" 5720], as discussed about this in the discourse entitled '*v'Aseeta Chag Shavuot*' 5657 [this should perhaps say 5656]. However, it can be suggested that this is referring to how it is within His Essential Self, whereas when this essential aspect is drawn forth, it then is drawn forth by way of the four letters of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה etc." [See at length in Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla ibid., translated as HaShem Is One.]

[71] See *Hemshech* "*Chag HaShavuot*" 5662 ibid. that "the garment of Torah is called 'a garment of light' (*Levush Ohr*), as it states, 'He covers Himself with light as a garment.'" Also see Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer, Ch. 3.

[72] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5568 Vol. 1 p. 14; Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 41 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,417 and on; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 66 and on, and elsewhere; Also see Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) ibid.

(*Tzimtzum*), and the letter *Hey*-ה is the aspect of drawing forth (*Hamshachah*)[73] etc.,[74] this constriction (*Tzimtzum*) is akin to the matter of the statement,[75] "He constricted His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) [between the two rods of the Holy Ark] etc." That is, the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, constricts Himself to be drawn down and found below etc. This is as the verse states,[76] "Truly, the heavens and the heavens of the heavens cannot contain You, but for this house that I have built etc." That is, this does not mean that the essence of the light becomes constricted and limited, but that the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה Himself, blessed is He, who "the heavens and the heavens of the heavens cannot contain," constricted Himself, so to speak, to be in the Holy of Holies as He literally is. (It is explained elsewhere[77] that the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) of the Line-*Kav* is also akin to [the matter of], "He constricted His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) etc.," but that it refers to the light (*Ohr*), whereas here we are discussing His Essential Self etc.)

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[73] [This should perhaps say "spreading forth-*Hitpashtut*" as stated earlier and elsewhere in Chassidus, whereas the *Vav*-ו of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is generally associated with "drawing down-*Hamshachah*" as discussed before.]

[74] See the end of the discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" ibid.

[75] See Midrash Tanchuma VaYakhel 7; Bereishit Rabbah, 5:7; Vayikra Rabbah 10:9; Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:14 (3); Likkutei Torah, Emor, 34b (in the name of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch); Ohr HaTorah, Chanukah, Vol. 5, p. 925a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632, Vol. 1, p. 48; p. 210, and elsewhere.

[76] Kings I 8:27; Chronicles II 6:18

[77] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 88.

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This then, is why it specifically is through His desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot* that the revelation of *HaShem's*-ה"והי transcendent Unlimited Light is drawn to be revealed in the aspect of space (*Makom*-מקום). This revelation is not drawn down from the desire (*Ratzon*) to create the worlds, since that is the root of the measure that measures the way the light is drawn down, such that there are divisions of upper and lower, (these being the aspect of divisions [that bring about] space and time, as explained before.) On the contrary, it is from this desire for worlds that the aspects of space and time are drawn into being, and the aspects of concealment and hiddenness below.

Rather, it is specifically from the upper desire (*Ratzon HaElyon*) for *mitzvot*, which is far beyond the matter of measure, that the light that is beyond measure is literally drawn down to reveal His Essential Self below. It thus is specifically through the *mitzvot* that "They actualize the will of the Ever Present One (*Makom*-מקום)," thus drawing His Essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) to be revealed in the aspect of space (*Makom*-מקום). This is why specifically upon doing the *mitzvot* we say,[78] "This is for the sake of unifying the Holy One, blessed is He, and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*)."

This is because although in the creation of the world there also was the union (*Yichud*) of the Holy One, blessed is He, and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*)," this being the matter of the union (*Yichud*) of [the Name] *HaShem*-ה"והי and

[78] See the prior discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 4).

[His title] God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם, nonetheless, this refers to the [lower Name] *HaShem*-יהו"ה of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*), about which it states,[79] "He included the quality of compassion (*Rachamim*) [with the quality of judgment]," this being the revelation of the Line-*Kav*, as known,[80] and is the aspect of His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*). Moreover, even that which is drawn from His unlimited surrounding transcendent light (*Sovev*) to bring novel existence into being, in that "everything that *HaShem*-יהו"ה desired He did etc.,"[81] this only is a drawing down of the power of His surrounding light (*Sovev*) in a concealed way (in that the encompassing light (*Ohr Makif*) gives power to the inner manifest light (*Ohr Pnimi*)). However, it does not come into revelation (because if it would illuminate openly in a revealed way the existence of novel being etc. would not be possible, as known and explained elsewhere.)[82]

Moreover, in regard to the revelation of His surrounding light (*Ohr HaSovev*) that is drawn to the worlds, this being the encompassing light (*Ohr Makif*) which does illuminate etc., nevertheless, this revelation is Above and not below. This is because although His surrounding light (*Ohr HaSovev*) is Above just as it is below, nevertheless, below it is in a state of concealment, whereas Above it illuminates with greater

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[79] See Rashi to Genesis 1:1; Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 12:15; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 20, p. 31 note 7; Also see Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, beginning of Ch. 7.

[80] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 51

[81] Psalms 135:6

[82] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 290 and on; Also see Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 90b and on; 92b and on, and elsewhere.

revelation.[83] As known, the analogy for this is from thought and desire, which are the aspects of encompassing lights (*Ohr Makif*) and are present in the foot just as in the head, but even so, in the head there is a revealed illumination, whereas in the foot it is there in a concealed way, as explained elsewhere.[84]

All this is because it is the externality of His desire (*Chitzoniyut HaRatzon*). In contrast, the desire (*Ratzon*) for Torah and *mitzvot* are the innerness of the desire (*Pnimiyut HaRatzon*) of the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*). Thus, it specifically is through them that a drawing down is caused of the union (*Yichud*) of the Holy One, blessed is He, and His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*), so that there is an actual revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One who surrounds and transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*) within His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*) (this being the general aspect of "space-*Makom*-מקום," as discussed before) for there to be a revelation below.

This also is the matter of the Union (*Yichud*-יחוד), Blessing (*Brachah*-ברכה) and Sanctity (*Kedushah*-קדושה)[85] brought about through the *mitzvot*.[86] That is, as known, "Blessing-*Brachah*-ברכה" is the aspect of His light that fills all

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[83] See Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 70 (Vol. 5 p. 194 in earlier editions).

[84] See Likkutei Torah Naso 24a; Derech Mitzvotecha, Mitzvat Binyan Mikdash (85b); Sefer HaMaamarim 5648 p. 187 and on; In regard to the matter of thought which is specifically openly revealed in the head, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 222; Derech Mitzvotecha, Mitzvat Tzitzit (15a); Ohr HaTorah, Korach p. 676 citing Etz Chayim; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 p. 292 and on; 5685 p. 260 and on; 5709 p. 119 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim Yiddish p. 7 and on.

[85] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 30.

[86] Regarding the coming section see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Vayikra ibid. (p. 812; 818).

worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*),[87] whereas "Sanctity-*Kedushah*-קדושה" is the aspect of His light that surrounds and transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*). Then, through [fulfilling] the *mitzvot* the Union (*Yichud*-יחוד) of Blessing (*Brachah*-ברכה) and Sanctity (*Kedushah*-קדושה) is caused (forming the acronym "*Yabok*-יב"ק-112"),[88] this being the union of His light that surrounds and transcends all worlds (*Sovev Kol Almin*, [*HaShem*-יהו"ה-26]) and His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*, [God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם-86]).[89] This is the matter of the blessing (*Brachah*) made over the *mitzvot* [in which we recite], "Who has sanctified us with His commandments etc." That is, through fulfilling the *mitzvot* we draw the aspect of the sanctity of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) to be drawn down below, this being the matter of "actualizing the will of the Ever Present One (*Makom*-מקום)."

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Now,[90] all this is specifically drawn down through fulfilling the *mitzvot* below in actual deed, rather than through the upper *mitzvot* as they are in a state of spirituality etc. The

[87] See Likkutei Torah, Zot HaBrachah 93d.

[88] See Zohar III 216b; Also see Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 10 (25a) and elsewhere; Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 10, section on "*Yabok*-יבק"; Torah Ohr, Vayishlach 25a; Likkutei Torah, Zot HaBrachah 93d; Also see Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) ibid.

[89] Also see the introduction to Imrei Binah of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gateway to Understanding.

[90] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid. (p. 818).

explanation is that, as previously explained,[91] the desire for the *mitzvot* is the aspect of His essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*), which is not a composite of anything else. As such, it specifically is for *mitzvot* done in actual deed. This is because the spirituality of the *mitzvot* are the aspects of reason and intellect, these being the intentions (*Kavanot*) of the *mitzvot*, and this being so, in this the desire is a composite with reason. Thus, in this the aspect of His essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) is not drawn down. Rather, it specifically is in actual deed, which altogether is of no comparison, that it does not apply for desire in this be a composite with anything else. Thus, it specifically is in this that there is a drawing down of the aspect of His essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) etc.

Proof of this is from our forefathers, in that "our forefather Avraham, peace be upon Him, fulfilled the entire Torah before it was given."[92] That is, they fulfilled the *mitzvot* spiritually, through which they brought about the upper unity (*Yichud*) in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).[93] Nonetheless, about them He said,[94] "I did not make my Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה known through them." The Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה mentioned here [is the upper Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה] which refers to the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) [as He is, in and of Himself]. Thus, because it refers to the Unlimited Light of the Essential Self, it therefore

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[91] See the previous discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 49 and on).

[92] Talmud Bavli, Yoma 28b

[93] Torah Ohr, Lech Lecha 11d; Yitro 68a and on; Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 9b

[94] Exodus 6:3

states, "I did not make My Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה known through them (*Noda'ati*-נודעתי)," rather than saying, "I did not inform them (*Hoda'ati*-הודעתי) of My Name," as explained elsewhere.[95] That is, it is in the aspect of the third person narrator of the Torah,[96] as discussed elsewhere.[97]

This aspect was not revealed or drawn down by fulfilling the *mitzvot* as they were done by our forefathers. Rather, it only upon the giving of the Torah does it state,[98] "Therefore say to the children of Israel, I am *HaShem*-יהו"ה." This is because when the Torah was given at Mount Sinai, we were given physical *mitzvot*, and specifically in this there is a drawing down of the essence of the limitless light of the Unlimited One.

This is also why[99] in fulfilling the *mitzvot*, the most important thing is specifically to fulfill them by accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven, this essentially being the nullification of one's own [independent] desire. That is, [one does them] in a way that transcends the reasons and intention for the desire. This accords with the Halachic opinion that having intention (*Kavanah*) is not a necessary component in fulfilling the *mitzvot*.[100] That is, it is not the primary aspect of

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[95] See Rashi to Exodus 6:3; Also see Ibn Ezra, Ramban, Ohr HaChayim ad loc.; Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of His Name (*Shaar HaShem*) ibid.; Torah Ohr, Va'era p. 56a; Also see

[96] See Ramban's [Nachmanides]introduction to his Torah commentary; Ohr HaTorah, Mishpatim p. 1,219; p. 1,239; Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 272.

[97] See Torah Ohr Va'era 56a and elsewhere.

[98] Exodus 6:6

[99] Regarding this section until the end of the discourse, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Vayikra ibid. (p. 828 and on).

[100] Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 95b; Pesachim 114b; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 235c; Ateret Rosh 53a; 59a; Shaar HaEmunah of the Mittler Rebbe 5a; 26b; Derech Chayim 56d and on; Also see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid. p. 817.

the *mitzvah* that it should be done with reason or with devotional intentions of the mystical meanings of the Supernal intent within it.

For example, in the *mitzvah* of Tefillin there is the mystery and reason of the encompassing aspects (*Makifim*) of the four intellectual faculties (*Mochin*), and in the Tzitzit there is the aspect of the thirty-two pathways of wisdom (*Lamed-Beit Netivot Chochmah*) etc., and the same is so of the other *mitzvot*. Rather, we do not do the *mitzvot* out of any intentions or reasons at all, but solely because they are the essential desire of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Supernal will, in that thus it arose in His will, and this is why one fulfills them. He thus has much vitality in doing the *mitzvah*, in that through this he fulfills the desire of the Supernal One, or whether because the desire of the Supernal One is being fulfilled. That is, he has great vitality and delight in the fact that the will of the Supernal One is fulfilled. Moreover, when one contemplates doing a *mitzvah* [and realizes] that it is the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the innerness and Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה Himself, blessed is He, the *mitzvah* becomes very precious to him. He then will derive tremendous vitality and pleasure from the act itself, being that this act literally is *HaShem's*-יהו"ה essential desire.

This is the meaning of the words,[101] "It brings Me satisfaction of spirit that I spoke and My will was done." That is, the fact that "My will was done" in actuality, "brings Me satisfaction of spirit." That is, this is his satisfaction of spirit and pleasure [in the performance of the *mitzvah*], that is, "It

[101] Torat Cohanim and Rashi on Vayikra 1:9; Sifri and Rashi on Numbers 28:8

brings Me satisfaction of spirit etc." Thus, by doing the *mitzvot* in this way of accepting the yoke of His Heavenly Kingship upon ourselves, we draw down the aspect of His essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*).

This is the element of superiority of *mitzvot* fulfilled in actual deed over Torah study. This is because "the Torah emerged from Wisdom-*Chochmah*,"[102] and is the aspect of reason and intellect etc. Moreover, the *mitzvah* of Torah study is entirely and specifically the matter of attaining Torah knowledge.[103] In contrast, fulfilling the *mitzvot* specifically involves doing actual physical deeds, and in a way of accepting the yoke of His Heavenly Kingdom, and it specifically is this that draws down the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One.

This is the meaning of what the verse states about Moshiach,[104] "Who was raised on high-*Al*-על," that, "He raised the yoke-*Olah*-עולה of the Torah," specifying "the yoke-*Olah*-עולה of the Torah" being that [this aspect] reaches Above to the essential the desire of the Supernal One, which transcends the hidden reason for the desire (*Ta'am Kamus l'Ratzon*). This refers to the matter of "the Crown of the Good Name (*Keter Shem Tov*) which ascends higher than them all,"[105] higher than the Crown of Torah (*Keter Torah*) which is the desire (*Ratzon*)

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[102] Zohar II 62a; 85a; 121a; Zohar III 81a; 182a; 261a

[103] See Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe, Orach Chayim 50:2 and Hilchot Talmud Torah 2:13 (regarding the study of the Oral Torah); Also see Likkutei Torah Vayikra 5b; Shir HaShirim 28a and elsewhere.

[104] See Samuel II 23:1; Midrash Bamidbar Rabbah 18:21; Midrash Shmuel 29; Tanna D'Bei Eliyahu Rabbah, beginning of Ch. 2; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Ner Chanukah*" (p. 148).

[105] Mishnah Avot 4:13

in the primordial Wisdom (*Chochmah HaKedoomah*). (Then, through the Torah, he can draw down that aspect of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) that specifically comes through "being precise with the words of Wisdom-*Chochmah* etc.,"[106] as will be explained.)[107]

Now, our sages stated in Talmud[108] that "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One" specifically refers to the first paragraph of the *Shema* recital. About this it is explained in the name of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch, of righteous memory,[109] that this specifically comes through [loving *HaShem*-יהו"ה] "with all your more"[110] (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך). This is one and the same as the above-mentioned matter of accepting the Heavenly yoke, which also is the matter of the essential nullification (*Bittul Atzmi*) that transcends reason. This is because the love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה indicated by "with all your heart and with all your soul"[111] stem from reason and intellect, with grasp and contemplation of Godliness and with a sense of Godliness in ones soul, through which he is roused with a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire to become subsumed etc., or alternatively, with a state of closeness to adhere to His Godliness etc. This also includes the aspect of abundant love of Him (*Ahavah Rabbah*) as well as the aspect of

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[106] Zohar I 130b

[107] See the later discourse entitled "*v'Avraham Zakein*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 104 and on).

[108] See Talmud Bavli, Brachot 35b and Chiddushei Aggadot of the Maharsha there.

[109] Ohr Torah of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch, Section 166; Also see Likkutei Torah, Shlach 42c and on; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema 72c and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 197; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 12 p. 98 and on.

[110] Deuteronomy 6:5

[111] Deuteronomy 6:5 ibid.

love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*), meaning to delight over *HaShem*-יהו"ה with yearning and desire, in a state of the expiry of the soul etc. This is because this all is with the aspect of reason (*Ta'am*-טעם), such as the hidden reason (*Ta'am Kamus*-טעם כמוס) and with "flavor" (*Ta'am*-טעם) and pleasure.

Now, the fulfillment of the *mitzvot* is the matter of the second paragraph of the *Shema* recital,[112] "It shall be that if you will listen etc." That is, through the intentions of the *mitzvot* he thereby adheres to Godliness. This is as Tanya explains,[113] that love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה is the source of the 248 positive action *mitzvot* etc. That is, this still is not the matter of "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One," in that through this one does not draw down the aspect of the essence of His desire (*Ratzon*). Rather, it only is through loving *HaShem*-יהו"ה "with all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך), which is not out of any grasp or out of the sense of the goodness of Godliness, such that he delights in it etc. Rather, it stems solely from the essential self of one's soul which is drawn to the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. It is then that his fulfilling the *mitzvot* is done by accepting the Heavenly yoke upon himself, only to fulfill His will without any intention or reasoning etc. Specifically this aspect is the matter of "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One," who draw down the aspect of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein*

[112] Deuteronomy 11:13

[113] Tanya, Ch. 4 (8a); Also see Chinuch Katan (75b); Kuntres Acharon, in the discourse beginning "*Hinei Lo Tovah*" (162a).

Sof) etc., and bring about that it specifically will be revealed below.

That is, when one does the *mitzvah* with devotional intention, by it being preceded with love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה "with all your heart and with all your soul," he thereby also draws down a revelation of light, however, here the primary revelation is Above, and not below. For, though it was explained before that through fulfilling the *mitzvot* we draw down the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One into the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) so that there are revelations in all worlds, literally all the way down, such as in the four intellectual aspects (*Mochin*) of the Tefillin, and the Sukkah, and the like, as discussed before, this is specifically so when it first is preceded by love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה "with all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך) and when the action is done in a state of accepting the Heavenly yoke. This is as stated in Tanya,[114] that there must be two intentions (*Kavanot*) when fulfilling a *mitzvah*. That is, there is the general intention of accepting the yoke of Heaven upon oneself, and there is the particular intention as it relates to that particular *mitzvah*. However, the drawing down of His Essential Self is brought about by specifically accepting the yoke of Heaven, and then the light is literally drawn down into the totality of the worlds, all the way down below.

[114] Tanya, Ch. 41 (56b); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 Vol. 2, p. 578; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 4 p. 15 (Vol. 2 p. 57 in earlier editions).

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Now, with the above in mind, we can understand the verse, "These are the offspring (*Toldot*-תולדת) of Noach," in that "the principal offspring (*Toldot*-תולדות) of the righteous are their *mitzvot* and good deeds." The intention is to their fulfilling the *mitzvah* in actual deed with the acceptance of the yoke of Heaven, this being the primary "offspring" and revelation.

To further explain, there also is an "offspring" and revelation in the intentions (*Kavanot*) of the *mitzvot* as well as in the love of Him "with all your heart etc.," but the essential light (*Ohr HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One is not drawn down in this. Rather, this only happens when the *mitzvot* are done with the acceptance of the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom, and with the preface of loving *HaShem*-יהו"ה "with all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך), through which there is a drawing down of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One etc., and this also is the primary "offspring" and revelation to below. For, in regard to the revelation brought about through the devotional intentions (*Kavanot*) of the *mitzvot*, the revelation primarily is Above, whereas below there only is an illumination of radiance. In contrast, when the *mitzvot* themselves are done with the acceptance of the Heavenly yoke, this thereby draws forth the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, and He literally is drawn down to below as He is. This then, is the meaning of the verse, "These are the offspring (*Toldot*-תולדת) of Noach etc.," in that the principal offspring (*Toldot*-תולדות) and revelation is in fulfilling the act of the *mitzvot* in actual

physical deed, this being the matter of “those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One etc.”

Discourse 8

"*Lech Lecha… -*
Go for yourself…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Lech Lecha, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה said to Avram, 'Go for yourself from your land… and I will make you a great nation, I will bless you, and I will make your name great." Now, this must be better understood. For, as known,[3] traveling [to a distant place] decreases one's renown. This being so, what is the meaning of Him stating that by [fulfilling] "go for yourself" this will thereby bring about that "I will make your name great." Now, Rashi explains that this itself is why He blessed him with increased renown, in that "since traveling causes diminishment in three things,[4] He therefore blessed him 'I will make you etc.'" However, the language of the verse seems to indicate that by [fulfilling] "go for yourself" he automatically will come to increased renown, and we therefore must understand how this is.

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[1] This discourse is based on the explanation to the discourse entitled "*Ha'azinu*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5567 p. 363 and on; Discourse entitled "*Vayikahalu*" 5629, 5639 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 379 and on; 5639 Vol. 2 p. 555 and on); Discourse entitled "*uV'Vo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch p. 479 and on – as cited in later notes.

[2] Genesis 12:1-2

[3] See Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 39:11

[4] See Midrash Rabbah ibid.

Now, Matnot Kehunah[5] writes in Rashi's name that this is because the *mitzvot* of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, cannot be fulfilled while traveling in the same way as when one is in the comfort and tranquility of his home. It thus is understood that increase of renown also comes through fulfilling the *mitzvot*. We therefore must understand the relation between *mitzvot* and a name, both in regard to the diminishment of the name, and that by fulfilling the *mitzvot* increase is caused in the renown of the name.

Now, to understand this, we must begin with the explanation before,[6] that the matter of "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One" refers to drawing down the inner and essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) through which revelation is drawn down to below, and that this drawing down comes about by fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actual deed through accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom, and by being preceded with love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה "with all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך).[7] It was explained[8] that the matter of "with all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך) does not accord with reason and intellect, but rather stems from the essential self of the soul which is drawn to the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He.

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[5] Matnot Kehunah to Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 39:11 ibid. Also see Rashi's commentary to Bereishit Rabbah ibid., that "it causes diminishment to one's renown in that when a person is traveling, he is not able to engage in the *mitzvot* to the same degree as when a person is tranquil in the comfort of their home."

[6] At the end of the previous discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 51) and on.

[7] Deuteronomy 6:5

[8] At the end of the previous discourse entitled "*Eileh Toldot Noach*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 77).

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Now, the explanation[9] is that Zohar states,[10] "No thought at all can grasp You, but He is grasped in the desire of the heart (*Re'uta d'Leeba*)." The meaning of [the words], "no thought at all can grasp You," is that it refers to the innerness and Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. That is, grasp or comprehension of Him altogether does not apply.

This is because the matter of grasp only applies to the aspect of the limitless light of the Unlimited One that relates to worlds, meaning the Godly radiance that manifests in the worlds to enliven them, and in general, this refers to the limitless light of the Unlimited One that relates to worlds. However, in regard to the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, it does not apply for Him to be grasped through comprehension.

To further explain, as known,[11] there are two kinds of grasp (*Hasagah*). That is, there is positive grasp (*Hasagat*

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[9] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5567 and the discourse entitled "*Vayikahalu*" ibid. Also see the discourse entitled "*Ki Li Bnei Yisroel Avadim*" in Sefer HaMaamarim 5687 p. 175 and on; Discourse entitled "*Margela b'Pumei d'Rava Tachlit Chochmah*" 5689 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 105 and on); 5729 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5729 p. 60 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5729, Vol. 1, Discourse 10); 5746, 5740 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 87 (Vol. 5 p. 94 in earlier editions)).

[10] This is as brought in various places in Chassidus citing Zohar. See Zohar III 289b (Idra Zuta), "He is not known and He is not knowable… except in the desires of the heart (*Re'uta d'Leeba*)," and introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a (Patach Eliyahu), "There is no thought that grasps Him altogether" (Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid., note 14).

[11] See Moreh Nevuchim, Part 1, Ch. 58; Ikkarim, Maamar 2, Ch. 22 and on; Also see Ch. 30; Likkutei Torah Pekudei 3d; 6c; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 446a and on; 454b and on, and elsewhere; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 190 and on;

HaChiyuv) and there is grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*). Positive grasp (*Hasagat HaChiyuv*) refers to grasping the essential thing, in that one grasps how and what it is. In contrast, grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*) means that the essential thing cannot be grasped except through [the process of elimination, in which one] negates whatever of it is graspable, in that the graspable does not at all apply to the ungraspable. In general, positive grasp (*Hasagat HaChiyuv*) relates to the Godly radiance manifest in the worlds. For, since it is a constricted radiance that manifests in the worlds, a matter of grasp and comprehension thus applies to it, to know how and what it is, such as in the verse,[12] "From my flesh I behold God."

However, in relation to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends manifestation in worlds, actual grasp does not apply, but only grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*). That is, one negates those matters in the radiance that are graspable and thus cannot apply to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) who is wondrously beyond worlds.

This is a matter of grasping His wondrousness (*Hasagat HaHafla'ah*), meaning that one grasps how the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is wondrously beyond the worlds. Through this negation he grasps the quality and manner of the wondrousness, in that he negates those matters in the [limited] radiance that do not apply to the wondrousness of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*). He thereby

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Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 582 and on; 5680 p. 204; Sefer HaSichot Torat Shalom p. 103 and on, and elsewhere.

[12] Job 19:26

grasps the quality of the wondrousness of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) until he can have some measure of recognition of its essential wondrousness etc., as known and explained elsewhere.[13]

Now, all the above applies to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that relates to worlds. However, regarding the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One who has no relation to worlds at all, even grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*) does not apply. This is because grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*) only applies to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that relates to worlds, since it relates to the radiance that indeed manifests in the worlds. That is, this refers to the aspect of His surrounding light (*Ohr HaSovev*) which is the source of His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*). It thus applies to negate the particulars present [and positively grasped] in this radiance.

However, about the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One that does not at all relate to the radiance, it does not apply to negate matters that are present in the radiance from Him, since it altogether is of no relative comparison to Him. Even though these matters certainly are negated from the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, it nonetheless does not apply to come to know His wondrousness from them. For, since they altogether are of no comparison to Him, how is it that by negating such matters he thereby will come to know the wondrousness of the

[13] See Likkutei Torah Pekudei 6c ibid.; Sefer HaMaamarim 5670 p. 2; p. 128 and on, and elsewhere; Also see Moreh Nevuchim Vol. 1 ibid. Ch. 59 and on.

Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One? Moreover, it certainly is not possible for even to have a tiny measure of recognition of His true being.

We thus find that no grasp or comprehension, not even grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*) which is the highest level of grasp, applies to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*). Moreover, the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One is not even grasped through the sight (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is because the sight (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is perception with the eye of the intellect, and cannot grasp His Essential Self. Proof of this is from Moshe, as explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*").[14]

This then, is the meaning of the words, "No thought at all can grasp You." That is, the thought and comprehension of Understanding-*Binah*, even on the loftiest level, which is the matter of grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*) and even the thought (*Machshavah*-מחשבה) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, [which is] "the thought of *Ma"H-Chashav Ma"H*-חשב מ"ה,"[15] this being the aspect of sight (*Re'iyah*), cannot not grasp His Essential Self.

Moreover, not only is He not grasped by the souls as they are below, but even in the upper worlds He is altogether not grasped, including in the worlds that are higher than the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). That is, even in the aspect of the Upper Wisdom (*Chochmah Ila'ah*) of the world of Emanation

[14] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 39.

[15] See Zohar I 24a; Torah Ohr Vayigash 43d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 148 and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 40.

(*Atzilut*) and higher than the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), there is no grasp of the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One.

This then, is the meaning of the words, "No thought at all can grasp You," in that even the Primordial thought (*Machshavah HaKedoomah*) and the Primordial Wisdom (*Chochmah HaKedoomah*) do not grasp His Essential Self (*Atzmut*) etc. However, "He is grasped in the desire of the heart (*Re'uta d'Leeba*)."

That is, the very aspect and level that thought (*Machshavah*) cannot grasp, is indeed grasped in the desire of the heart (*Re'uta d'Leeba*). We therefore must understand what the elevated level of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) is, such that it grasps the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He.

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However, the explanation is that, as known,[16] in the general matter of love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, there are two levels. There is inner love (*Ahavah Pnimit*) and external love (*Ahavah Chitzonit*). External love (*Ahavah Chitzonit*) is love derived from knowledge and comprehension, meaning that love is born through contemplating and grasping Godliness.

Now, there are various ways in the contemplation (*Hitbonenut*). For example, there is contemplation of the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, meaning, the spreading forth of His

[16] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 204; 5685 p. 291 and on; 5689 p. 171 and on, and elsewhere.

greatness in the worlds, and how He brings worlds and creations beyond count into being and vitalizes them. This is as in the verse,[17] "How abundant are Your works, *HaShem*-יהו"ה," and[18] "How great are Your works, *HaShem*-יהו"ה."[19]

That is, there are very great creations and many creations to no end and without measure, through which we see and recognize the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, as in the teaching,[20] "'[Your's *HaShem*-יהו"ה is] the greatness-*Gedulah*-גדולה'[21] referring to the act of creation (*Ma'aseh Bereishit*)."

Another verse states,[22] "Great is *HaShem*-יהו"ה and much praised in the city of our God." That is, when is He great? When He is in "the city of our God-*Eer Elo"heinu*- עיר אלהי"נו."[23] That is, through "the city of our God-*Eer Elo"heinu*-עיר אלהי"נו," referring to the world of the Supernal speech (*Dibur*) that brings the worlds into being, there is recognition of the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. This is as stated in Midrash Tehillim on the verse,[24] "The heavens declare the glory of God," that, "This is analogous to a very mighty man who came to a land where his might was not known. A certain wise man was there who said, 'His strength may be known by the boulder he wrestles.' So likewise, 'The heavens declare the glory of

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[17] Psalms 104:24

[18] Psalms 92:6

[19] Also see Torah Ohr, Va'era 56b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5626 p. 105; 5627 p. 416.

[20] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 58a

[21] Chronicles I 29:11

[22] Psalms 48:2

[23] See Zohar II 235a; Zohar III 5a; Zohar Chadash Tisa 44a; Chukat 51a; Also see Torah Ohr Va'era ibid. Sefer HaMaamarim 5661 p. 171 and on; 5679 p. 345 and on; 5700 p. 39 and on, and elsewhere.

[24] Psalms 19:2

HaShem-יהו"ה.'" In this contemplation (*Hitbonenut*) of the spreading forth of His greatness, an arousal of His soul toward Godliness is caused and he comes to the aspect of a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire.

This is especially so when one contemplates how all this only comes about by the utterance and breath of His mouth.[25] For example, [we recite],[26] "Blessed is He who spoke and the world was," in that all the worlds came into being with a single utterance.[27]

He alternately may contemplate that in essence everything has a Godly force in it that brings it into being and vitalizes it, in that nothing can make itself nor vitalize itself etc.,[28] as explained in detail elsewhere.[29] Through delving one's mind (*Ha'amakat HaDa'at*)[30] into this, the Godly light and vitality becomes precious to him, and he is automatically roused to invest his entire will and desire into Godliness etc.

Now, all the above is the contemplation of the Godly radiance manifest in the worlds etc. However, when one contemplates the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) which transcends the worlds, and how He is wondrously beyond worlds, such that the totality of the Godly light and vitality that manifests in the worlds, even in the upper worlds, is just a radiance, whereas the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the

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[25] See Psalms 33:6

[26] In the "*Baruch She'Amar*" blessing at the beginning of the morning prayers.

[27] See Zohar II 20a; 276b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5697 p. 217.

[28] See Emunot VeDe'ot of Rabbi Sa'adya Ga'on, Maamar 1, Ch. 2; Chovot HaLevavot, Shaar 1 (Shaar HaYichud) Ch. 5 & Ch. 6.

[29] See Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzeddek 7b; 105a; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 813 and elsewhere.

[30] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1.

limitless light of the Unlimited One is wondrously beyond and separately transcendent from worlds, he grasps this with a quality and way of perceiving the wondrousness of it etc.

He thereby comes to be roused with great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) to desire the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. This is like the verse,[31] "Who do I have in the heavens, and but for You, I desire nothing on earth." That is, he has no desire for all the revelations, but his ultimate yearning and desire is for the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One.

Now, these contemplations (*Hitbonenut*) generally take place during prayer. That is, during the verses of song (*Pesukei d'Zimra*) the contemplation is on the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה as it relates to the creation and coming into being of the worlds and how all the worlds were created with a single utterance etc.

During the blessings of the *Shema* recital, he contemplates the matter of "holy-*Kadosh*-קדוש," and how the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is holy and wondrously transcends the worlds etc. During the recital of *Shema* itself the contemplation of the Essential Self (*Atzmut*) of the limitless light of the Unlimited One is primary. This is the meaning of the words, "Listen Israel-*Shema Yisroel*- שמע ישראל."[32] That is, the word "listen-*Shema*-שמע" is a term denoting understanding[33] and divides into "the name-*Shem*-שם"

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[31] Psalms 73:25; Also see Likkutei Torah Tazriya 20a and on; Shoresh Mitzvat HaTefillah, Ch. 40 (Derech Mitzvotecha 138a) and elsewhere.

[32] Deuteronomy 6:4

[33] See Samuel I 3:10; Rashi to Genesis 41:15; Torah Ohr, Bereishit 1a; Likkutei Torah Naso 20d; Pinchas 80a and elsewhere; Also see the discourse entitled "*Margela b'Pumei d'Rava*" 5689 ibid.

and "seventy-*Ayin*-ע,"[34] referring to how the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*[35] ascends to the lower seven *Sefirot* of Understanding-*Binah*, this being the matter of the big letter *Ayin*-ע etc.

As known, in Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah* the nullification (*Bittul*) is that of His Upper Unity (*Yichuda Ila'ah*), meaning how "everything is as nothing before Him."[36] This is because the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) transcend the worlds, as known[37] about the teaching,[38] "[The Torah] preceded the world by two-thousand years etc." Therefore, on this level the union (*Yichud*) is in the aspect of His Upper Unity (*Yichuda Ila'ah*), meaning how "everything is as nothing before Him."

This itself is the difference between the [first verse] of "Listen-*Shema*-שמע" and [the continuation], "Blessed is the Name of His glorious Kingdom forever and ever" (*Baruch Shem*), referring to His quality of Kingship-*Malchut* and is the aspect of His Lower Unity (*Yichuda Tata'ah*). For, since His quality of Kingship-*Malchut* is the source of the worlds, it thus cannot be said about it that [relative to it] the worlds are of no consequence at all, for if that was the case, what then is brought into being? Rather, in relation to His quality of Kingship-

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[34] See Zohar II 160b; Zohar III 236b; 258a; Also see Torah Ohr ibid.; Likkutei Torah Bechukotai 47d and elsewhere.

[35] [Which is hinted at in the term "name-*Shem*-שם." See Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 326 and elsewhere.]

[36] Zohar I 11b

[37] See Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 1d; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5628 p. 4 and on; 5629 p. 9; 5633 Vol. 2 p. 540 and on; 5634 p. 54 and on; 5677 p. 168 and on; 5709 p. 272 and on.

[38] See Midrash Tehillim 90:4; Bereishit Rabbah 8:2; Tanchuma Vayeishev 4; Zohar II 49a.

Malchut, they only are in a state of the nullification of their somethingness (*Bittul HaYesh*). However, relative to the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends the worlds, the worlds are of no consequence whatsoever, being that they are not in an aspect of existence.

The explanation is, that this is because the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends the worlds, also shines upon the worlds (and as known,[39] in relation to this aspect and level, the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) effects no concealment at all), and thereby the worlds are completely nullified of their existence. In contrast, relative to the radiance that becomes the source for the worlds, the worlds indeed are in a state of existence, except that they are nullified by way of the nullification of their somethingness (*Bittul HaYesh*).

This then, is the meaning of [the statement that][40] "Listen Israel" (*Shema Yisroel*) refers to the aspect of His Upper Unity (*Yichuda Ila'ah*), to become subsumed in His Singularity, blessed is He. In contrast, "Blessed is the Name of His glorious Kingdom" (*Baruch Shem*) is the aspect of His Lower Unity (*Yichuda Tata'ah*),[41] meaning how all things have Godly light and vitality, and their primary aspect is the Godliness. Through all this one is brought to [the continuing verse],[42] "You shall love *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God etc."

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[39] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 184.

[40] See Zohar I 18b; Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 7 (81b and on); Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema 40c; 62c and on, and elsewhere.

[41] See the citations in the preceding note. Also see the introduction to Imrei Binah, translated as The Gateway to Understanding.

[42] Deuteronomy 6:5

However, all the above-mentioned general levels, as they generally are, still are of the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) of the heart, this being the external love (*Ahavah Chitzonit*) of Him. This is because they come about through grasp and contemplation. Thus, the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) is not grasped in this, but only [the knowledge of] His existence.[43]

In contrast, inner love (*Ahavah Pnimit*) of Him is the aspect of the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the heart, which does not come from intellectual contemplation, but from higher than the intellect. This is called "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), in which and through there is grasp even of His Essential Self. This is as specified in the teaching, "No thought at all can grasp Him," in which "thought" (*Machshavah*) is specified. In contrast, the aspect of His Essential Self indeed is grasped in "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*).

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Now, the explanation[44] is that the innerness of the heart (*Pnimiyut HaLev*) refers to the essential bond coming specifically from the *Yechidah* essence of the soul. By way of analogy,[45] this is like the bond between a father and son, which

[43] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5567 ibid.

[44] See Torah Ohr, Tetzaveh 84b and on; Likkutei Torah Balak 67d; Ateret Rosh 18b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 89; Igrot Kodesh of his honorable holiness, the Rebbe Rashab, Vol. 3 p. 53 and on, and elsewhere.

[45] See Kuntres HaAvodah Ch. 5 (p. 31); *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 55 and on, and elsewhere; Sefer HaArachim Chabad, Vol. 1, section on "*Ahavah.*"

is not at all based on reason or intellect.[46] It rather, is only because the soul of the son is drawn from the father, literally from the aspect of his essential self. He thus is considered as literally being like him, in that "a son is the leg of his father"[47] [meaning like an extension of himself]. It thus follows automatically that he specifically is bonded to the essential self of the father.

This is unlike the love between two friends. For although here too a strong bond and love is possible, nevertheless, there is some reason for this love and bond, whether because the one he loves is good to him, or because the one he loves is a great and outstanding person, as a result of which he is drawn to love and bond to him. That is, this love involves a degree of contemplation and understanding, such as how good and how kind he is to him. Or it could be that he understands intellectually that this person is very good and great, and moreover he understands what it is that makes him great. Through understanding his greatness, he is caused to become bonded to this person and given over to him. However, this specifically is when he understands his greatness.

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[46] "Although it is explained in books of Torah ethics that the reason for the obligation to honor one's father and mother is because they feed him and give him to drink etc., nevertheless, the love of the son towards his father does not stem from the fact that he bestows to him, but is rather because they are a single essence." (See the discourse entitled "*Margela b'Pumei*" 5746 ibid., note 7.)

[47] Etz Chayim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Pirkei HaTzelem) Ch. 1 citing our sages, of blessed memory; Yonet Eilem, beginning of Ch. 4; Ch. 82; Emek HaMelech, Shaar Olam HaBriyah, Ch. 17 (174c); Shnei Luchot HaBrit 154a; Also see Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 70b; Tosefot to Yevamot 3a ("*Mekamei*"); Rathi to Ketubot 92a ("*K'Baal*"); Also see Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzedek 46a (which calls this "a common adage"), and this is similarly stated in Sefer HaMaamarim Hosafot p. 365.

However, if not for this understanding, he would not be bonded and given over to him.

It thus is self-understood that this bond of love only touches on what is revealed and known to him about the one who is loved, but not his very essence. This is because that which is revealed of the beloved is what causes this love. That is, he recognizes his good character traits or his good intellect, and the like. This being so, the bond is only because of his character traits, rather than love of his essential self.

In contrast, a father's love for his son is not because the son is good or because of his qualities, nor is it because of the influence that he provides to him, but is rather because they are one essence. Therefore this love requires no contemplation altogether. That is, the love is not the result of intellectual reasoning, nor is contemplation required to arouse it. It rather is solely due to the essential self [i.e., as they are indeed one], and it thus follows automatically that the love literally is for his essential self, not merely because of the revelation [of his character]. This is because the revelations are not the cause of love, but the love is specifically because of his essential self.

Moreover, in the son too this love and bond is constant, and although, at times, it may be concealed, all that is needed to rouse it from its concealment into revelation, is to simply take to heart that [after all] his father is his father, through which his love for his father will reawaken on its own. At other times, his love for his father may be roused because of distance. That is, the love is aroused when they are far from each other. Nonetheless, specifically because this is an essential love, it doesn't require any specific contemplation.

We thus find that specifically one's son can awaken love in the essential self of his father, whereas a different person is incapable of rousing love to the same degree. For example,[48] if the son cries out "Father!", the father will literally be moved to the very core and essence of his being. This will not happen to the same degree if someone who is not his son cries out to him. Even though, here too, he may be moved, he nonetheless will not be moved in the very essence of his being, as when his own son cries out. This is because the cries of his son literally are of his own essence and thus literally touch his essential self. This is because the bond of a father and son is literally an aspect of their essence.

This likewise is understood about the true bond of the souls of the Jewish people with *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, as stated in Torah,[49] "You are children of *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God," and as in the verse, [50] "Israel is My firstborn son." That is, they have an essential bond to Godliness. Hence, it is the essential nature in the Godly soul of a Jew to cling to the Source from where it was hewn, and this bond of love is beyond any intellectual reasoning, but only because they are like one essence.[51]

Moreover, this bond is constant in the soul and must merely be aroused at times, simply by recalling and placing it upon one's heart that,[52] "You are our Father". Or it may be

[48] Also see Kuntres U'Maayon p. 33.
[49] Deuteronomy 14:1; Tanya Ch. 2 (6a) and elsewhere.
[50] Exodus 4:22
[51] Also see at length in Shefa Tal, Hakdamah Ben Me'ah Shanah.
[52] Isaiah 63:16

roused because he senses his distance, as in the verse,[53] "From the straits I called to *Ya"H*-ה"י" or the verse,[54] "And the children of Israel groaned because of the bondage and they cried out" This crying out to *HaShem*-יהו"ה is because[55] "You are our father." That is, at such a moment he feels that "You are our father," and the essential bond is thus awakened.

Now, this essential bond literally takes hold of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, just as the son rouses the essential self of his father, as discussed above. In the same way, the souls of the Jewish people, which have an essential bond to *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, can grasp His Essential Self which "no thought can grasp." This is because thought and comprehension can only grasp that which is revealed, but not His Essential Self. That is only possible with the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), for there it is grasped and bonded with His Essential Self, therefore, it is specifically in this manner that His Essential Self can be grasped.[56]

Now, the heart is lower than the mind, and this being so, it could be asked, how it is that specifically the heart has this aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) which grasps the aspect of His Essential Self? The explanation is as stated in Idra Zuta,[57] that "*Zeir Anpin* is unified and dependent

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[53] Psalms 118:5

[54] Exodus 2:23

[55] Isaiah 63:16 ibid.

[56] "As in the known dictum, 'Essence takes hold of Essence.'" (See the discourse entitled "*Margela b'Pumei*" 5729 ibid., translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5729, Vol. 1, Discourse 10.)

[57] Zohar III 292a; Also see Torah Ohr Yitro 72b and on; 73a; Likkutei Torah Shemini 19b; Bamidbar 19b; Chukat 58b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 107.

on the Ancient One-*Atika*," whereas, "the Father-*Abba* and Mother-*Imma* (Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*) are included in the *Mazla*." That is, Wisdom-*Chochmah* receives[58] from the eighth *Mazal* - "and He preserves Kindness-*Notzer Chessed*-ונוצר חסד,"[59] which is the aspect of the hairs (*Sa'arot*) drawn from Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Crown-*Keter*.[60] Likewise, Understanding-*Binah* receives from the thirteenth *Mazal*, "and He cleanses-*v'Nakeh*-ונקה".[61]

In contrast, the emotions (*Midot*) literally receive from the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik*. Although the emotions (*Midot*) are born of the intellect (*Sechel*), nonetheless this only is in relation to their birth, whereas their essential root is from the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik*. This is why we see that even emotions born of intellect, can grow beyond the intellect that spawned them. This is because they have a more primordial source. This is why the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) is specifically in the heart, and through this one can literally come to grasp the aspect of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, that "no thought can grasp."

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[58] See Etz Chayim, Shaar HaKlallim Ch. 5; Shaar 13 (Shaar Arich Anpin) Ch. 9; Shaar 14 (Shaar Abba v'Imma) Ch. 3; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 25.

[59] Exodus 34:6-7 [i.e., the eighth of the thirteen attributes of mercy.]

[60] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 25 ibid.

[61] Exodus 34:6-7 [i.e., the thirteenth of the thirteen attributes of mercy.] Also see Etz Chayim ibid., and Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe ibid.

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Now, the automatic consequence of this love in "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta D'Leebah*) is that the fulfillment of the *mitzvot* each day is by accepting the yoke of Heaven (*Kabbalat Ol*), without any personal motive, but solely for the sake of the will of the Supernal One, to fulfill His will. This is similar[62] to how it was at the giving of the Torah, as the verse states,[63] "All that *HaShem*-יהו"ה has spoken we will do (*Na'aseh*) and we will hear (*Nishmah*)." That is, because their innerness was bound to Him in an essential way, they therefore said, "All that *HaShem*-יהו"ה has spoken we will do and we will hear," meaning that "we will do whatever we hear," in a way that is higher than reason. This specifically comes through the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*).

This is because in love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה brought about through comprehension, even on the loftiest of levels such as great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) of Him [expressed in the verse], "Who do I have in the heavens etc.," the subsequent fulfillment of the *mitzvot* is to draw down light. However, after the [experience of] "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) fulfilling the *mitzvot* is by way of accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom, solely in order to fulfill His will, blessed is He.

Moreover, the level of nullification (*Bittul*) associated with the matter of accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom is much higher than even the aspect of love of Him "with all

[62] See the discourse entitled "*Ki Li Bnei Yisroel*" 5687 ibid.
[63] Exodus 24:7

your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך) which stems from the bond etc. This is because, even so, it is the aspect of love (*Ahavah*) and a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire. In contrast, accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven is an even greater nullification (*Bittul*), and this is the element of superiority of a servant over a son (as will be explained).[64]

This then, is the matter of "those who actualize the will of the Ever Present One." That is, they literally draw down the aspect of the essential will and desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One. This is specifically brought about through prefacing with the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), which grasps the aspect of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, as discussed before. It is through the subsequent fulfillment of the *mitzvot* in the aspect of accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven, that we thereby draw down the aspect of His essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) in the *mitzvot*, through which there even is a drawing down of revelation below, within the aspects of space and time.

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Now, to come to the above-mentioned aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), there first must be the work in serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, with the revealed powers of the soul.[65] This is why love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה "with

[64] See the later discourse entitled "*uMikneh Rav*" and the discourses that follow it (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 410 and on).

[65] See the discourses entitled "*Vayikahalu*" ibid. that the aspect of "the desires of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) is the aspect of the hidden love (*Ahavah Mesuteret*)

all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך) is mentioned after [loving Him] "with all your heart and with all your soul etc."

This likewise[66] is the order of prayer. That is, first there are the "verses of song-*Pesukei d'Zimra*-פסוקי דזמרה" which are to "prune the mighty-*Lezamer Areetzeem*-לזמר עריצים,"[67] through praising and lauding *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He. This is because before this, due to the coarseness of the body and animalistic soul, a person has no relation to any of this at all, such as ascending in levels etc. Rather, he first must depart from his previous level and state. This is done through the verses of song (*Pesukei d'Zimra*) which are praises lauding the greatness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in creating and bringing the worlds into being, as well as the manner of His creation, in that they were created with a single utterance.

This is then followed by the blessings of the *Shema* recital, with contemplation on the nullification (*Bittul*) of the angels to *HaShem*-יהו"ה. Through this the animalistic soul is also nullified, since they [i.e., these angels] are its root, as

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which is not openly revealed etc., and that in order for it to be drawn forth from concealment into revelation, this is specifically through the lower desire that is drawn from the aspects of grasp and intellect etc. For, the externality of the heart (*Chitzoniyut HaLev*) is the receptacle for the innerness of the heart (*Pnimiyut HaLev*). Thus, there must first be contemplation of Godliness with the aspects of grasp and understanding, and thereby there is a subsequent drawing forth of the aspect of "the desires of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) that is drawn from the aspect of the essence of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

[66] See Torah Ohr, Bereishit 1d and elsewhere; Also see *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 619 and on; Discourse entitled "*Ani LeDodi*" 5712 & 5715 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5712 p. 356 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5712, Discourse 23; Sefer HaMaamarim 5715 p. 196 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5715, Discourse 21).

[67] See Isaiah 25:5; Also see Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate One (*Malchut*).

known.[68] Moreover, this also relates to the Godly soul, in that the contemplation of how the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) is holy and separately transcendent, brings about the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire. Then, afterwards, upon reciting the verse,[69] "Blessed is the glory of *HaShem*-יהו"ה from His place," the request is for there be a drawing down and revelation of light, only that the drawing down should be of the aspect of the glory of *HaShem*-יהו"ה from His place, meaning, specifically from its root and source.[70]

Then [afterwards] there is the primary service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה by the souls, during the recital of "Listen Israel-*Shema Yisroel*," (which is "the song of the souls.")[71] This is the contemplation of "*HaShem* is One-*HaShem Echad*-יהו"ה אחד,"[72] to become subsumed in His Singularity, blessed is He. This is the matter of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) [indicated by the verse], "Who do I have in the heavens etc."

Then, afterwards, upon reciting "with all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך) one comes to the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) stemming from the essential bond of the desire, as explained before. We then recite,[73] "And these words that I command you this day [shall

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[68] See Torah Ohr Vayeishev 30b; Likkutei Torah Naso 28c and on; Ki Teitzei 34d; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 2 p. 386, and elsewhere.

[69] Ezekiel 3:12

[70] Also see *Hemshech* 5666 ibid. p. 51.

[71] See Talmud Bavli, Chullin 91b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 2 p. 404; 5650 p. 352; 5708 p. 203.

[72] See Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) and on.

[73] Deuteronomy 6:6

be upon your heart]," referring to the words of Torah.[74] That is, after the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), which is love of Him "with all your more," it is then that through fulfilling the *mitzvot* by way of accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven we draw down additional lights into the Torah.

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Now, to further explain,[75] the verse states,[76] "All that is called in My Name and for My glory, I created it, I formed it, [I even actualized it]," referring to the souls of the Jewish people.[77] This is as Targum Yonatan explains,[78] "All this is for the sake of your righteous forefathers [upon whom My Name is called]" The meaning of "All that is called in My Name," in which the word "called-*Nikra*-נקרא" is a passive verb (*Lashon Nifal*), is that they are called and drawn down "in My Name." This indicates that the aspect of "My Name" is lower than the one who is called and drawn to there from Above.

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[74] See Zohar I 268a; Chinuch Mitzva 418; Sifri and Rashi to Deuteronomy 6:6 ibid.; Talmud Bavli, Yoma 19b and Rashi there; Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe, Orach Chayim 156:16; Hilchot Talmud Torah 3:2; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 34, p. 32 and on.

[75] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5567 ibid. (p. 366 and on; Also see p. 356 and on); Likkutei Torah Balak 67a ibid.; Ha'azinu 73d and on.

[76] Isaiah 43:7

[77] See the discourse entitled "*Vayikahalu*" in Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 & 5639 ibid, that the word "All-*Kol*-כל" refers to the aspect of the souls of the Jewish people who are called "All-*Kol*-כל," and that it is this aspect of "All-*Kol*-כל" who are "called by My Name." Also see Ohr HaTorah Ha'azinu p. 1,651 that "the general totality of the souls of the Jewish people is called 'All-*Kol*-כל,' and that man is generally inclusive of all the worlds.

[78] Targum Yonatan ben Uziel to Isaiah 43:7 ibid.

Now, as known,[79] "My Name-*Shmee*-שמי" refers to the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, and the Jewish people are higher than "My Name-*Shmee*-שמי." For, as stated,[80] "Israel ascended in thought," and "the thought of Israel preceded everything."[81]

Now, in its first root, the aspect of "My Name-*Shmee*-שמי" refers to the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) as it is before the constriction (*Tzimtzum*),[82] this being the aspect of "My Name that is unified to Me."[83] This is as in the teaching,[84] "Before the world was created" – meaning before the constriction (*Tzimtzum*)[85] – "there was Him and His Name alone." This aspect of "His Name-*Shmo*-שמו" refers to the revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), which in the aspect of His Essential Self is the aspect of the light (*Ohr*) that relates to the worlds. This is why it is called "His Name-*Shmo*-שמו," in that, by way of analogy, it is like someone's name, as known.[86]

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[79] See Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 21, section on "name-*Shem*-שם"; Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 27a, and elsewhere.

[80] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 1:4; Zohar I 24a; Zohar II 119a and on; Zohar III 229b, and elsewhere; Likkutei Torah Bechukotai 45a, and elsewhere.

[81] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah ibid.

[82] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 10.

[83] See Talmud Bavli, Sotah 38a; Moreh Nevuchim Vol. 1, Ch. 61. [Note that the above translation was rendered in accordance with the text of the discourse in which the term is "My Name that is unified with Me-*Shmee HaMeyucha Bi-* שמי המיוחד בי" as opposed to "My Name that is singularly unique to Me-*Shmee HaMeyuchad Li-*שמי המיוחד לי," as it is rendered in Sotah 38a ibid.]

[84] Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer, Ch. 3; Also see Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) ibid.

[85] See Avodat HaKodesh Part 1, Ch. 2, cited and explained in Ohr HaTorah Yitro, p. 839 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5644 p. 346; 5654 p. 298 and on.

[86] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 & 5654 ibid.

Now, just as the aspect of His Essential Self is of the utmost simplicity of simple unity, this likewise is so of the aspect of the revelation of the light of His Essential Self, which is called "the light of the Unlimited One" (*Ohr Ein Sof*), in that it too is simple etc.[87] This is the meaning of "Him and His Name alone etc."[88] It thus follows automatically that before this it was not possible for the worlds to be brought into being, except by way of the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) and empty space (*Makom Panuy*), after which the Line-*Kav* was drawn down as a narrow and constricted [revelation].

Moreover, it was drawn down through various veils (*Parsa'ot*) so that there could be the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), as well as the world of Creation (*Briyah*), until the world of Actualization (*Asiyah*), as explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Eileh Toldot Noach*").[89]

In any event, from all the above, at the very least it is understood that the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) is the first root for the entire chaining down of the worlds of Emanation, Creation, Formation, and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*). This is the meaning of the verse,[90] "Your Kingdom is the Kingdom of all worlds." The word "**Your** Kingdom-*Malchutcha*-מלכותך" is in the second person, referring to the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* of

[87] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 10 ibid.

[88] See Shaar HaYichud ibid.

[89] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 67 and on.

[90] Psalms 145:13

the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), and as known,[91] it is the source of all aspects of Kingship-*Malchut* of every world.

About this the verse states, "All that is called in My Name," meaning that they are "called" in My Name, in that they draw additional lights into My Name. This is because the souls of the Jewish people are literally rooted in the aspect of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, and through their "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) and their fulfillment of the *mitzvot*, they thereby draw down additional light in "My Name-*Shmee*-שמי."

This is like the statement,[92] "And may they rest in it, [all of Israel] who sanctify Your Name." That they "sanctify Your Name-*Mekadshei Shmecha*-מקדשי שמך" means that they bring sanctity (*Kedushah*-קדושה) to His Name. That is, they draw the aspect of "You are holy-*Atah Kadosh*-אתה קדוש" into the aspect of "Your Name is holy-*Sheemcha Kadosh*-שמך קדוש."[93]

Now, this drawing down, that is "called" and drawn into My Name, is "for My glory-*L'Chvodee*-לכבודי," and as it states,[94] "'Glory-*Kavod*-כבוד' refers only to Torah." This is because the Torah is the receptacle for the revelation of light. This accords to the known[95] matter about the teaching,[96] "Torah study is greater [than deed]." That is, although the arousal and drawing down of the light is accomplished by fulfilling the *mitzvot*, nonetheless, the receptacle for the general light is

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[91] See Torah Ohr, Yitro 73d and elsewhere.

[92] In the liturgy of the Amidah prayer of Shabbat.

[93] See the "*Atah Kadosh*" blessing of the Amidah prayer.

[94] Pirkei Avot 6:3

[95] Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 2, p. 482; 5634 p. 87 and on; 5654 p. 329; 5678 p. 122 and on, and elsewhere.

[96] Talmud Bavli, Kiddushin 40b

Torah. This is why it specifically is called "**My** glory-*Kovd**ee***-כבודי," because it is the initial enclothement of the Essential Self of the Emanator.

This is also the meaning of, "I created it, I formed it." For, as known,[97] the difference between Creation (*Briyah*) and Formation (*Yetzirah*) is that Creation (*Briyah*) refers to the matter of creating novel existence from nothing to something (*Yesh MeAyin*).[98] In contrast, Formation (*Yetzirah*) is merely the revelation of that which is concealed, similar to forming and shaping a lump of metal, and the like. Nothing is novel [in the existence] of this form, except that its substance has been shaped and engraved with form and image, which is called something from something (*Yesh MeYesh*).

The example for this is the difference between thought and speech. The letters of thought are novel creations, in that before thought, no letters were tangibly sensed, and it only is in thought that novel letters come to be. In contrast, there is no novelty in speech, but only the revelation of that which was concealed [in thought].

Within the powers of the soul, this is the matter of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*. That is, the point of [the insight of] Wisdom-*Chochmah* comes in a way of novelty, in that before this it did not exist as actual intellect in the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) and it then came forth to be the novel existence of intellect. This is as stated,[99] "Wisdom-*Chochmah* is found from nothing-*Ayin*,"

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[97] See at length in Sefer HaMaamarim 56662 p. 356 and on; 5663 Vol. 1 p. 193 and on; Vol. 2 p. 301 and on.

[98] See Ramban to Genesis 1:1

[99] Job 28:12

meaning from nothing to something (*Yesh MeAyin*). In contrast, the power of Understanding-*Binah* receives from Wisdom-*Chochmah* and is the aspect of something from something (*Yesh MeYesh*). This is because the seminal point of Wisdom-*Chochmah* includes everything in a concealed way, and that which is concealed in Wisdom-*Chochmah* comes to be revealed in Understanding-*Binah*.

This also is the primary difference between the Written Torah and the Oral Torah. That is, the Written Torah is the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*,[100] and is drawn from nothing to something (*Yesh MeAyin*) from the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. In contrast, the Oral Torah is the aspect of Understanding-*Binah*,[101] which only is the revelation of that which is concealed in the Written Torah, to explain and elucidate every *mitzvah* in the Written Torah. This then, is the meaning of "I created it, I formed it," which refers to the Written Torah and the Oral Torah. Both are included in the meaning of "for My glory," only that they are divided into two levels, concealment and revelation.

The meaning of [the continuing words],[102] "I even actualized it," is that through fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actual deed we affect a drawing down [of His Essential Self] into "My Name, and for My glory." About this it states, "I even actualized it-*Af Aseeteev*-אף עשיתיו," in which the word "even-*Af*-אף" comes to make a separation in this,[103] indicating the

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[100] See Zohar II 276b (Hosafot); Also see Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 29 (151a); Torah Ohr Va'era 59a and on, and elsewhere.

[101] See the citations in the preceding note.

[102] Isaiah 43:7 ibid.

[103] See Likkutei Torah Balak 67a; Shaarei Teshuvah 107d and elsewhere.

astounding difference there is in action (*Asiyah*), even over and above the aspect indicated by the word "I created it" (*Beriyah*).

This is as in the verse,[104] "Is not obedience better than a choice offering etc." This is because *HaShem's*-יהו"ה primary Supernal intent is specifically for the actual deed, and although it is true that through the sacrifices we affect a drawing down of the revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*),[105] nonetheless, obedience in actually fulfilling the *mitzvot* by accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven is "better than a choice offering etc." This is because in this way we literally draw down the aspect of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) and there thereby is literally caused to be a drawing down of additional light in Torah from the aspect of His Essential Self.

This then, is the meaning of "they actualize the will of the Ever Present One." That is, there first must be the aspect of the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) stemming from the bond with His Essential Self, and then through fulfilling the *mitzvot* by accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven, we draw down the aspect of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*), and through doing so thereby draw down additional lights into Torah.

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[104] See Samuel I 15:22; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5564 p. 130; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 306.

[105] See Zohar II 239a; Zohar III 26b

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However, we now must better understand the explanation before[106] about the matter of Eden, about which the verse states,[107] "No eye has seen it etc." That is, Eden is the aspect of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) that utterly transcends the revealed pleasure of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*). That is, even the loftiest souls [in the garden of Eden] with all their many ascensions, such as our forefathers [Avraham, Yitzchak and Yaakov] and our teacher Moshe, peace be upon him, have never beheld the actual essential pleasure of Eden. This is rather specifically drawn through fulfilling the *mitzvot*.

This is the meaning of the verse,[108] "[I have seen an end to every beginning, but] your commandment is exceedingly broad." That is, "to every beginning" – which refers to the pleasure drawn down to vest in the desire to create the world, and the revelation of pleasure to the souls in the Garden of Eden – "I have seen an end" and limit, because it merely is the aspect of a ray and spreading forth of the pleasure. However, "Your commandment is exceedingly broad," in that it specifically is in the *mitzvot* that *HaShem's*-ה"והי essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) is drawn down, as in the statement,[109] "It brings

[106] In the previous discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 14) and on.

[107] Isaiah 64:3; Talmud Bavli, Brachot 34b

[108] Psalms 119:96

[109] Torat Kohanim and Rashi commentary to Leviticus 1:9; Sifri and Rashi commentary to Numbers 28:8

satisfaction of spirit before Me [that I commanded and My will was actualized] etc."

Now, at first glance this is not understood. This is because the *mitzvot* are the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*) of the Supernal One, and at first glance, desire (*Ratzon*) and pleasure (*Taanug*) are two distinct powers.[110] Although it is so that pleasure (*Taanug*) vests within desire (*Ratzon*), this nevertheless cannot be essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*). This is because the vestment[111] of one power within another power is merely the aspect of its spreading forth, rather than how it essentially is. This being so, even if we were to say that the pleasure (*Taanug*) vests in the desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot*, nonetheless, it would merely be the spreading forth (*Hitpashtut*) of the pleasure, rather than the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) itself.

Moreover, as previously explained,[112] in reality there is no reason (*Ta'am*-טעם) for desire, even the reason (*Ta'am*-טעם) of "flavor-*Ta'am*-טעם," in that it is pleasurable. This being so, what is the meaning of, "It brings satisfaction of spirit before Me [that I commanded and My will was actualized]," which at first glance seems to indicate that nonetheless there indeed is pleasure (*Taanug*) in the desire (*Ratzon*) for the *mitzvot*.

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[110] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 24.

[111] See *Hemshech* 5672, Vol. 1, p. 3 and on, and elsewhere.

[112] In the discourse entitled, *Bayom HaShemini Atzeret* 5666.

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Now, to understand this[113] we first must understand the root of desire (*Ratzon*) and pleasure (*Taanug*) and the difference between them. For about the difference between pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*) we find two opposites. Now, at first glance, we can clearly observe through the senses, that [of the two] pleasure (*Taanug*) is the more inner aspect of the soul and there is nothing loftier than it, as stated,[114] "There is nothing loftier than pleasure." In contrast, compared to pleasure (*Taanug*), desire (*Ratzon*) is merely its external garment, meaning that it only is that which spreads forth from the power of pleasure (*Taanug*).

To explain, it is readily observable that whatever one has no pleasure in, he will not be roused with desire for, nor will he have any yearning for it at all. In contrast, whatever he has pleasure in will have a pull on him to desire and yearn for it. Moreover, commensurate to the strength of the pleasure in which he delights in it, whether it is deep and inner or only external, so will be the degree that his desire is drawn and pulled to that thing, whether a lot or a little, whether inwardly or externally. This is because a person generally only yearns and desires that which he has pleasure in etc.

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[113] Regarding the coming section of this discourse and the next discourse (entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*"), see the discourse entitled "*uVevo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" ibid.; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken HaKetzarim p. 538; 5568 Vol. 1 p. 47; Maamarei Razal p. 270; Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe 19a (translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 24) and on; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 204d; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 393 and on; p. 406 and on; p. 717 and on; Kuntres Limud HaChassidus p. 4; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 29 p. 179.

[114] Sefer Yetzirah 2:7; Also see the next discourse entitled "*Ki Yeda'ativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666, p. 96, note 56).

This is akin to emotions (*Midot*) derived from intellect (*Sechel*), which do not become aroused in a person of their own accord but only according to his intellectual grasp. That is, when he grasps that something is good, this arouses the emotion of love and desire for it, and if not, no love will be aroused for it at all. This is also true of desire that transcends emotions and is the innerness of the emotions. It too comes specifically from intellect, as explained elsewhere.[115] (This is the matter of how Splendor-*Tiferet* of the Mother-*Imma* (Understanding-*Binah*) becomes the Crown-*Keter* of *Zeir Anpin*,[116] this being the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*), which is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the emotions (*Midot*) as derived from the intellect-*Sechel*).

This same is so of desire (*Ratzon*) that transcends intellect (*Sechel*), in that it depends on pleasure (*Taanug*) and is not roused except when one has pleasure in something. This is why we observe that desire [for something] is not constant. That is, sometimes he does not desire it, indicating that there necessarily is a higher power that causes the desire to come forth.

As explained elsewhere[117] the power that causes and moves the desire is the power of Knowledge-*Da'at*. (This Knowledge-*Da'at* refers to the airy membrane (*Avirah*) that encompasses the Hidden Brain (*Mocha Stima'a*)), as explained

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[115] See Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 47c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Hanachot HaRav Pinchas, p. 50; Siddur Im Da"Ch 130b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 257.

[116] Etz Chayim, Shaar 36 (Shaar Miyut HaYare'ach) Ch. 1 and elsewhere; Also see the citations in the preceding note.

[117] Hagahot to the discourse entitled "*Patach Eliyahu*" in Torah Ohr, 5658 p. 44.

elsewhere.)[118] This is because Knowledge-*Da'at* is the power of [mental] connection.[119] That is, by connecting himself to something, he gains a feel for it. That is, he arouses a certain degree of interest and pleasure in it, by which he is roused with desire for it.

Now, we observe that one's pleasure in something is concealed and is internal to his soul, whereas the desire for it comes into revelation like an external garment, in that it only is like an expression and revelation of the pleasure in this desire.

This likewise is so in our service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה with abundant love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) of Him. This refers to the aspect of desire (*Ratzon*) in which the soul is drawn with the desire to become subsumed and nullified to Him, blessed is He. This comes from the sensitivity and feel of the soul, in that he senses the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, and is thereby drawn to be subsumed.

The substance of this feeling is that he senses the aspect of the transcendent wondrousness of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, how *HaShem*-יהו"ה transcends all worlds, and His essential wondrousness, in that He is transcendent in essence. This too is a matter of feeling pleasure in His Godliness (except that here the pleasure (*Taanut*) is concealed, whereas the desire (*Ratzon*) is revealed). It specifically is because of the sense of pleasure, that the matter of great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) comes about.

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[118] Etz Chayim, Shaar 13 (Shaar Arich Anpin) end of Ch. 6; Likkutei Torah Shlach 49d; Ohr HaTorah Bereishit Vol. 3 p. 497a; Shlach p. 648; Balak p. 964; Inyanim p. 79.

[119] Tanya, Ch. 3 (7b), and elsewhere. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1 and elsewhere.

Now, according to the above, we see that pleasure (*Taanug*) is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the desire (*Ratzon*), called "yearning" (*Chefetz*-חפץ), whereas desire (*Ratzon*) is the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) and garbs the pleasure (*Taanug*) within it. It thus is possible for there to be pleasure without desire, such as the pleasure of intellect or the pleasure of emotions, that do not have to manifest in an arousal of desire. Moreover, there cannot be the arousal of desire without being preceded by pleasure.

Now, just as there are myriad levels in pleasure (*Taanug*), one higher than the other,[120] this likewise is so of desire (*Ratzon*), each level of desire being specifically commensurate to the level of the pleasure. This is observable in the pleasure one may have in various kinds of activity, such as delighting in beautiful things, such as a beautiful building, beautiful art, or beautiful writing or clothing. All these pleasures are less than the pleasure in speech, which is more spiritual and ethereal.

For example, one has significantly more pleasure and delight in words of love, or in words of wisdom and intellect, such as when a teacher teaches his student or the like, than the pleasure in action. Likewise, the pleasure in speech is less than the pleasure in thought, which is more spiritual and ethereal [than speech]. For example, we clearly observe that when one contemplates a matter of intellect and strongly grasps it, he derives great pleasure from this thought, much more than the pleasure in speech. Generally, there is much more pleasure on

[120] See Likkutei Torah, Beshalach 1c and on; Hosafot to Vayikra 52c and on.

the level of thought called[121] "the meditations of the heart" (*Higayon HaLev*) than there is in speech. Likewise, the pleasure of emotions, is greater than the pleasure of thought, and likewise, the pleasure of deep intellectual insight into the depth of intellect [is greater] than the pleasure of emotions, until the pleasure of exaltedness and greatness, which is the greatest pleasure of all.

This likewise is so relationally in drawing forth desire (*Ratzon*) in that which one delights in; that the desire will be commensurate to the pleasure, be it in action, speech, thought, emotions, intellect etc., until the pleasure in greatness, the desire for this being much deeper than them all.

(However, it can also be that one derives more pleasure from an act, such as the act of building a beautiful house, or making things of beauty or beautiful garments, even more than delighting in the pleasure of wisdom, greatness and all precious treasures. This is because there is more strength in the pleasure of action than the beginning of pleasure, which is more spiritual.)

Now, we also observe the very opposite. Namely, that desire (*Ratzon*) is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) and pleasure (*Taanug*) is the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) that enclothes it. Additionally, we observe that pleasure specifically depends on desire, in that whatever one does not desire will not be pleasurable to him. Even if, in and of itself, it is pleasurable, nevertheless, if he does not want it, he will have no pleasure in it, nor will he have any desire to have pleasure in it. On the

[121] Psalms 19:15 and elsewhere; Also see Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 100d; Ohr HaTorah, Megillat Esther p. 31 and on.

contrary, whatever is against his desire, not only does not bring him pleasure, but can even be agonizing to him.

In contrast, to the extent that he turns his desire toward something, whatever it may be, to that extent, he will have pleasure and delight in it, even if it is something which in essence is not pleasurable. For example, regarding tasty foods, things of beauty or beautiful buildings; if he has no desire in them, he will have no pleasure in them. This even applies to the pleasure of wealth, treasure, and even greatness and power. If one has no desire for them, he also will have no pleasure in them.

The opposite is also true; that one has pleasure in whatever he desires. An example is the love of a friend. Because his friend is desirable to him, he therefore enjoys his company. Now, it cannot be said that this is because his friend is pleasurable in essence, in that we see that someone else who does not love this person will have no pleasure in him at all. Rather, it only is because he loves him and finds him to be desirable, that he has any pleasure in him. The reverse is true of someone he hates. He will have no desire for him and thus will have no pleasure in him. He will neither desire his favors, nor will he desire any delightful things from him. On the contrary, whatever good and pleasurable qualities he sees in his enemy will be detestable to him.

Moreover, we observe that in times of trouble, may the Merciful One spare us, one's desires become diminished. That is, he will have no desire to take pleasure in anything, even in his only son. In contrast, the opposite is so in times of joy.[122]

[122] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 223 and on, and elsewhere.

At such times his desires will be broadened, and he even will have pleasure in someone who he usually despises and has no pleasure in. For example, we observe that on joyous occasions, one may even delight in shallow and trivial matters that he otherwise would not take pleasure in. This is only because [at such times] he is essentially satisfied, and thus finds everything to be good and pleasurable.

We thus see that pleasure (*Taanug*) is specifically aroused by desire (*Ratzon*) and depends on it. This being so, desire is inner to the pleasure and sustains it, whereas the pleasure is external and apparent to the eye of the beholder. Moreover, the pleasure is commensurate to the desire. That is, if the desire is deep and inner, the pleasure will also be so, and if the desire is external, the pleasure will also be so. Thus, the gradations of pleasure, one higher than the other, also depend on the gradations of desire, as mentioned before about gradations of action, speech and thought.

Now, according to this, it must be said that there cannot be pleasure without first having a desire to have pleasure in it. (For example, pleasure in intellect only is if he desires intellectual pleasure or desires the intellectual matter, either generally or specifically. This is as stated,[123] "One is drawn to study that which his heart desires." It specifically is then that he will have pleasure in it.)

Moreover, desire (*Ratzon*) can exist without any pleasure (*Taanug*) at all. This is because there is no reason for desire. This is not only so of an intellectual reason, but even in

[123] Talmud Bavli, Avoda Zara 19a; Also see the previous discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 36).

relation to pleasure being the reason for the desire. We observe this in our service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, for as explained before, great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה is aroused from [sensing His] transcendence and wondrousness etc. However, there is an aspect of desire in which one is drawn to Godliness because of the essential self of his soul, rather than because of any sense of *HaShem's*-יהו"ה astounding wondrousness or transcendence, but simply because of the essential self of the Jewish soul, without any cause or reason at all.

This is[124] clearly observable on Rosh HaShanah and during the ten days of repentance, when the hearts of all Jews become roused towards Godliness, and thus these times are suitable for repentance and bitterness of the soul over one's distance from *HaShem*-יהו"ה. This is because during this time, a Jew is in a state of arousal toward Godliness, and therefore at such times he feels his distance and is embittered over it. That is, this arousal is not because he is close and thus drawn to Godliness. Rather, since on Rosh HaShanah and during the ten days of repentance, he is aroused and drawn to Godliness, he therefore feels his great distance and is very embittered by this.

Now, the general arousal and drawing to Godliness that occurs on Rosh HaShanah and during the ten days of repentance, is not because one senses the greatness of Godliness. (This is evident from the fact during this time this arousal happens to all Jews, including simple folk who have no connection to sensing the greatness of Godliness.) Rather, it

[124] Regarding the coming section also see the discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*" ibid. (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 37).

only is because at such times the Luminary is close to the spark[125] that all Jewish souls are caused to automatically be drawn to Godliness to whatever degree, in a way that is beyond reason or feeling or any other cause at all.

Now, just as this is so of every Jew during the ten days of repentance, because of the closeness of the Luminary, we can also understand this about loftier people who "serve *HaShem*-יהו"ה with their souls"[126] in that they uplift their souls to *HaShem*-יהו"ה, as the verse states,[127] "To You *HaShem*-יהו"ה I lift my soul."

This is not due to feeling the transcendence and wondrousness of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, but is rather because of the essential desire of the Jewish soul, in that in the inner essence of his soul a Jew desires the limitless light of the Unlimited One, and he desires this with the totality of the essential self of his soul. Therefore, when he senses the limitless light of the Unlimited One, *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, in the essential self of his soul, he is drawn to Him with all of his being, not at all because he senses the pleasure of it.

We thus see that there is desire (*Ratzon*) without pleasure (*Taanug*), like a son who is drawn to his father, which only is because his desire for his father is essential (being that they actually are one essence), as explained before. For this has nothing to do with delighting in him, being that it is clearly

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[125] [As in the verse (Isaiah 55:6), "Seek *HaShem*-יהו"ה when He is found, call Him when He is near."] See the prior discourse "*Lulav v'Aravah*" ibid.

[126] See Shaar HaEmunah of the Mittler Rebbe, 46a; Derech Chayim 26a; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Kuntreisim p. 103, p. 137; Sefer HaMaamarim 5688 p. 52 and on; Also see the later discourse entitled "*HaChodesh*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 208) and elsewhere.

[127] Psalms 25:1, 86:4

observable that even if he has no delight in him, for example, if his father is simple and cannot compare to the stature of his son, nonetheless the son has an essential desire for his father and is drawn to him. We thus see that this has nothing to do with pleasure (*Taanug*), but is only out of desire (*Ratzon*) itself, even without pleasure (*Taanug*). This being so, it is the very opposite of the first explanation given above, where it was explained that desire (*Ratzon*) depends on pleasure (*Taanug*) and that without pleasure there can be no desire.

However, the explanation is that both are true. This is because pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*) are one, for both are an aspect of the essence and are equal in level. Therefore, sometimes the pleasure is inner and the desire is external, and sometimes, the desire is inner and the pleasure is external. That is, they are interchangeable, so that either one enclothes the other, or vice versa.

However, in this a distinction must be made. That is, they only exchange with each other when spreading forth from the essence, and the way they exchange depends on which one is essential and which one is spreading forth. That is, if the pleasure (*Taanug*) is essential, the spreading forth of the desire (*Ratzon*) will be external to the pleasure. This is the arousal of the desire toward whatever in essence is pleasurable, and as explained above, the desire will be commensurate to the pleasure. On the other hand, if the desire is essential, meaning that in his heart he has a simple essential desire for any given thing, he then will desire to have pleasure in it. Thus, here the pleasure is external and spreads forth from the desire.

Albeit, this entire matter of how they enclothe each other only applies to how they spread forth. However, in the essential pleasure and essential desire, called "simple pleasure" (*Taanug Pashut*) and "simple desire" (*Ratzon Pashut*), the desire does not enclothe the pleasure nor does the pleasure enclothe the desire, and thus desire (*Ratzon*) can be without being preceded by pleasure (*Taanug*), and pleasure (*Taanug*) can be without being preceded by desire (*Ratzon*).

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Now, the entire above analogue can be applied to understanding the root of the *mitzvot*, which are the aspect of the desire of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*). For, as explained above in the first explanation, there cannot be desire without it being preceded by pleasure, and pleasure is inner, whereas desire spreads forth from it and is external. In the same way, when it comes to the desire of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*) for each *mitzvah*, within the desire there is an aspect of His Supernal pleasure, and it is because of this [pleasure] that the desire is drawn forth, specifically commensurate to the pleasure.

In general, this is called, "the reasons of the commandments-*Ta'amei HaMitzvot*-טעמי המצות." However, what is meant is not merely intellectual reasoning for the *mitzvot*, but the pleasure in the desire, which is called its "flavor-*Ta'am*-טעם," like the flavor of sweetness. This is like the verse,[128] "Good reasoning and knowledge-*Tuv Ta'am*

[128] Psalms 119:66

V'Daat-טוב טעם ודעת" which has two meanings,[129] the "reasoning-*Ta'am*-טעם" of knowledge (*Da'at*), or the "flavor-*Ta'am*-טעם" and pleasure of it.

[In Zohar][130] this is called the aspect of the "thirteen white [streaks of hair] of the paths of the skull," referring to the inner aspect of the desire of the Supernal One for the *mitzvot*. This is also called,[131] "The pathways of *HaShem*-ה"יהו," or the six hundred and thirteen paths that spread forth to be revealed externally, until they manifest below in doing the *mitzvot* in action, as well as in thought, speech, emotions, and intellect.

That is, the pleasure in fulfilling the *mitzvot* in action is inner (*Pnimiyut*), whereas the desire in the action is external (*Chitzoniyut*) and enclothes it, and above this, there is the pleasure and desire in speech and thought, like the speech and thought of Torah or the intention in fulfilling the *mitzvot*.

However, the opposite is also true, that the desire (*Ratzon*) is inner (*Pnimiyut*) whereas the pleasure is external (*Chitzoniyut*) and enclothes the desire. This refers to the reasoning for the *mitzvot* (*Ta'amei HaMitzvot*-טעמי המצות), which are below the essential desire (*Etzem HaRatzon*) for the *mitzvot*. That is, desire has no reason, only that the desire comes as a composite, in that it manifests in pleasure (*Taanug*), which gives the *mitzvah* a "flavor" (*Ta'am*-טעם) and pleasure.

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[129] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 137; 5660 p. 15; 5663 Vol. 1 p. 27; Also see the previous discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 49 and on).

[130] See Zohar III 136a (Idra Rabba); Mishnat Chassidim, Mesechet Arich Anpin, Ch. 4; Tanya Ch. 41 (48a).

[131] Psalms 25:10; Also see Zohar III 129a (Idra Rabba).

It could be said that this refers to the fact that each *mitzvah* also has a revealed reason that accords to intellect. For example, the *mitzvot* prohibiting theft and robbery and the like, about which our sages, of blessed memory, stated,[132] that even if Torah had not commanded us against these matters, we still would understand them, because the intellect necessitates them. Nonetheless, their primary aspect is the desire (that is, whosoever is careful about such matters is fulfilling the desire of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*), and whosoever sits and abstains from transgressing them, still receives reward),[133] except that it is a composite with "reason-*Ta'am*-טעם" and intellect, as well as the "flavor-*Ta'am*-טעם" and pleasure.

However, both the above-mentioned aspects only relate to the spreading forth of the pleasure (*Taanug*) or desire (*Ratzon*), in which they interchange with each other. But, as explained above, in the essential simple pleasure and desire, they do not enclothe each other, in that there can be pleasure without desire. We could say[134] that this is like the verse,[135]

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[132] Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 100b

[133] Talmud Bavli, Kiddushin 39b

[134] In the discourse entitled "*uV'Vo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" ibid. it states, "There can be pleasure without desire, as in 'It brings Me satisfaction of spirit that I spoke and My will was actualized,' which transcends the specific desire." [With respect to what is stated here about pleasure without desire, this being the matter of the essential delight and pleasure in the souls of the Jewish people, see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 11 p. 6, note 55, that the choice of the Holy One, blessed is He, in the Jewish people transcends the aspect of desire, but literally stems from His Essential Self. This is like the root of the matter of the pleasure, which is in the innerness of His Essential Self, literally. It is only that the matter of choice (*Bechirah*) transcends even the aspect of pleasure, since it is literally of the aspect of His Essential Self, in that it is He who derives the pleasure.]

[135] Deuteronomy 10:15 – "and this took place prior to the giving of the Torah." See Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 330 (Vol. 1 p. 61 in earlier editions) in the note.

"Only in your forefathers did *HaShem*-ה"והי delight," referring to His essential delight and pleasure in the souls of the Jewish people, even before the Torah and *mitzvot* were given. There likewise can be desire without pleasure, as in the statement,[136] "Silence, it thus arose in My thought,"[137] similar to the decrees (*Chukim*) of the Torah, the primary matter of which is desire above reason or cause.

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Now, from all the above we can now understand the meaning of the verse "Go for yourself… and I will make your name great." As known[138] about the matter of "Go for yourself-*Lech Lecha*-לך לך" [which can also be understood to mean, "Go to yourself-*Lecha Lecha*-לך לך], it refers to going and reaching the root and source of your soul, akin to the verse,[139] "Rise up, my love, my beautiful one, and come away."

"My love" refers to the Torah, "my beautiful one" means fulfilling the *mitzvot*, "and come away" means coming

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[136] Talmud Bavli, Menachot 29b

[137] [The term "thought-*Machshavah*-מחשבה" here is interchangeable with and means "desire-*Ratzon*-רצון." See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Nine (*Chochmah*). Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 21.]

[138] See Alshich and Panim Yafot (by the author of Sefer HaHafla'ah) to the beginning of the Torah portion of Lech Lecha, cited in Ohr HaTorah Lech Lecha Vol. 4 p. 675a; 681a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 p. 20; p. 34; 5700 p. 13; 5702 p. 50; Discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" 5725 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5725, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5725 Vol. 1, Discourse 9); Also see the later discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" 5667 (p. 523 and on). Also see the citations in the next note.

[139] Song of Songs 2:10; Also see Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 16c and on; Ohr HaTorah, Lech Lecha 680b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 10; p. 14; 5630 p. 9; 5654 p. 48; 5655 p. 18 and on; 5672-5676 p. 62; 5679 p. 60 and on; 5705 p. 89.

to the root and source of the soul. This is because the entire soul does not manifests in the body,[140] but only a glimmer and ray of it, whereas its primary essence remains Above. The verse thus states, "Go **to** yourself-*Lech Lecha*-לך לך," in that a person must come to the root and source of the soul.

This refers to the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) which comes from the essential desire of the soul and its essential bond with the limitless light of the Unlimited One, as discussed before. Through this, one can then draw down the essential desire of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) by fulfilling His *mitzvot*, as discussed before.

This then, is the meaning of "I will make your name great," referring to the matter of "All that is called in My Name-*Shmee*-שמי," meaning that additional light is drawn down to The Name-*Shem*-שם, as discussed before. This then, is the matter of expanding The Name to make it great, specifically by fulfilling the *mitzvot*, by which there is a "calling" and drawing down in The Name-*HaShem*-השם, as mentioned before.

This then, explains Rashi's statement on Midrash Rabbah, that the matter of diminishing or expanding The Name-*HaShem*-השם, is through the *mitzvot*. That is, through fulfilling the *mitzvot*, The Name-*HaShem*-השם is made great. This happens when fulfilling the *mitzvot* is preceded by love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה "with all your more" (*Bechol Me'odecha*-בכל מאדך), referring to the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*) and is the matter of "Go to yourself-*Lech Lecha*-לך לך."

[140] See Likkutei Torah, Ha'azinu 71d; Shir HaShirim ibid. 16d and elsewhere.

However, to attain the "desire of the heart" (*Re'uta D'Leeba*), there must be the matter of "[Go to yourself] from your land and from your birthplace." This is like the verse,[141] "Forget your people and your father's house etc.," referring to leaving the animalistic soul, in that as long as the animalistic soul continues to conceal, all the above-mentioned aspects are not possible. Therefore the aspect of "forget your people," must take place and only after this can there be the continuation of the verse, "and the King will desire your beauty." More specifically, we can say that "from your land" refers to leaving the coarseness of the animalistic soul, and "from your birthplace and your father's house" refers to the emotions and intellect, respectively.[142]

(We can also say that this is the matter of the blessings before the *Shema* recital, that relate to subjugating the

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[141] Psalms 45:11-12

[142] Similarly see Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 p. 51 that "your land" is the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, and included in this are the aspects of Victory-*Netzach*, Majesty-*Hod*, and Foundation-*Yesod*; "your birthplace" refers to the aspects of Kindness-*Chessed*, Might-*Gevurah*, and Splendor-*Tiferet*; "your father's house" refers to the aspects of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and Knowledge-*Da'at*. This is likewise stated in *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 720; p. 1,195; Sefer HaMaamarim 5702 p. 55; 5705 p. 95; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 2 p. 659; Vol. 20 p. 59; p. 305; p. 52, and elsewhere. In Sefer HaMaamarim 5769 p. 62 it states "your birthplace and your father's house" can be said to refer to the intellect and emotions of the external husks (*Kelipot*). "Your birthplace" are the intellectual aspects which give birth [to the emotions] etc., and "your father's house" are the emotions. The same is similarly stated in the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" 5745 that there must be a departure from "your land-*Artzecha*-ארצך" which refers to man's "desires-*Retzonot*-רצונות." Likewise, "your birthplace" refers to the intellect (*Mochin*), as stated in Tanya that the intellect (*Mochin*) gives "birth" to the emotions (*Midot*), and "your father's house" refers to the emotions (*Midot*) that are born of the intellect (*Mochin*). Also similarly see the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" 5746 [Also see the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" 5745 that these two explanations are connected with the two meanings of "*Lech Lecha*-לך לך," from below to Above or from Above to below.]

animalistic soul at its root, whereas the recital of *Shema* itself, is the subjugation of the animalistic soul through contemplation, as discussed before.)

Through the above, we then come to the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), which is the matter of "Go to yourself-*Lech Lecha*-לך לך etc." From all the above, we can understand the statement, "and I will make your name great," that specifically through the matter of "Go to yourself" The Name-*HaShem*-השם is made great. This is because "Go to yourself-*Lech Lecha*-לך לך" means to "go to the root of your soul," this being the aspect of "the desire of the heart" (*Re'uta d'Leeba*), after which fulfilling the *mitzvot* causes The Name-*HaShem*-השם to be magnified.

Discourse 9

"*Ki Yedaativ… -*
For I have known him…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Vayera, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "For I have known him, because he commands his children and his household after him to keep the way of *HaShem*-יהו"ה etc." Targum Onkelus[3] [translates the words], "for I have known him-*Ki Yeda'ativ*-כי ידעתיו" as "it is revealed before Me that he commands etc." That is, he explains the word "*Yeda'ativ*-**ידע**תיו" as denoting "knowledge-*Yediyah*-**ידיע**ה." However, Rashi, of righteous memory, questions this, stating that based on this, the word "because-*Lema'an*-למען" does not fit with the meaning of the sentence. He therefore explains the word "I have known him-*Yeda'ativ*-ידעתיו" as having love and affection "because he commands his children etc."

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[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*uV'Vo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch p. 483 and on – as cited in later notes. With respect to the beginning and end of the discourse – see Ohr HaTorah Vayera 89a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 16; p. 21 and on; 5634 p. 47; p. 52; 5680 p. 132 and on; p. 140; The beginning and end of the discourse are also explained in the discourses entitled "*Ki Yeda'ativ*" 5736 and "*v'HaShem Amar HaMechaseh*" 5737 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 254 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 7; Meluket 1 p. 259 (in earlier editions see Vol. 1 p. 205 and on; p. 209); Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24.

[2] Genesis 18:19

[3] Targum Onkelus to Genesis 18:19 ibid.

Now, this must be better understood, since according to the Targum translation, the word "because-*LeMa'an*-לְמַעַן" actually serves no meaning. This being so, how does Targum explain the words, "*Ki Yeda'ativ*-כִּי יְדַעְתִּיו" as meaning "knowledge-*Yediyah*-יְדִיעָה?" Additionally, about the explanation of Targum and the explanation of Rashi who explain the word as either meaning "knowledge-*Yediyah*-יְדִיעָה" or "affection-*Cheebah*-חִיבָּה," we must understand what the spiritual difference is between them, as well as what the affection is.

Now, to understand all this we must begin with the explanation before[4] about desire (*Ratzon*) and pleasure (*Taanug*), that both are of the essence and are equal in level, which is why they are interchangeable, such that sometimes pleasure (*Taanug*) is the inner aspect and sometimes desire (*Ratzon*) is the inner aspect. However, when we state that they exchange with each other, this only relates to their spreading forth, whereas as they are essentially they do not vest in each other and there thus can be desire (*Ratzon*) without pleasure (*Taanug*) and pleasure (*Ratzon*) without desire (*Ratzon*).

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However the above explanation is not yet fully satisfactory, because if we say that the essential pleasure and the essential desire do not interchange with each other, if so, where is the interchangeability derived from when they indeed spread forth from their essence to their externality?

[4] In the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 89).

Now, we do indeed observe this kind of inter-inclusion and enclothement of the powers of the soul within each other. An example is the powers of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, in which Wisdom-*Chochmah* manifests within Understanding-*Binah*. That is, Understanding-*Binah* receives from Wisdom-*Chochmah*, in that the seminal point of Wisdom-*Chochmah* manifests within Understanding-*Binah*, in that at first Wisdom-*Chochmah* includes Understanding-*Binah* within it, as in the teaching,[5] "Be understanding **in** wisdom."

That is, the seminal point of Wisdom-*Chochmah* [insight] includes what then comes to be grasped and comprehended in Understanding-*Binah* (even though Understanding-*Binah* is the opposite of the seminal point of Wisdom-*Chochmah*). In the same way, Understanding-*Binah* also includes Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as in the teaching,[6] "Be wise **in** understanding." Likewise, the emotions receive from Understanding-*Binah,* and are included within Understanding-*Binah*.

In the same way, the emotions also include one another. An example is Kindness-*Chessed* and Sternness-*Gevurah*, in which Kindness-*Chessed* includes Sternness-*Gevurah* and Sternness-*Gevurah* includes Kindness-*Chessed* and they manifest in each other. This is why we find that there can be a Kindness-*Chessed*, the [inner] cause of which is Sternness-

[5] Sefer Yetzirah 1:4; See at length in Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 73 and on; Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1, and elsewhere.

[6] See the citations in the preceding note.

Gevurah, and Sternness-*Gevurah*, the [inner] cause of which is Kindness-*Chessed*, as known and explained elsewhere.[7]

The same is so of all the powers of the soul, such as the power of vision, the power of hearing and the like, in that they are inter-included with each other. For example,[8] if there is an ailment in one limb or power, it is sensed in another limb or power. Sometimes, if one power is missing, another power can become strengthened. An example is the loss of the power of vision, because of which the power of hearing can be strengthened, and as known, the same is true in the reverse.

Now, as known, as these powers are as general powers in the essence of the soul they are distinct from each other, as explained elsewhere.[9] However, even so, as mentioned above, as they spread forth into revelation they indeed manifest in each other by way of inter-inclusion etc. However, this is as the soul powers become constricted to become inner manifest powers (*Kochot Pnimiyim*), in which case they take on measure relative to each other, and it thus applies for them to become included one with the other, and thus can manifest within each other.

Elsewhere[10] it also explains that this is specifically brought about by the vessels (*Keilim*) [the organs and limbs of the body]. That is, it is when they manifest within vessels

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[7] See Likkutei Torah Re'eh 27c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5570 p. 225; Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 157 and on, and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 22.

[8] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 31.

[9] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5653 p. 240; 5654 p. 287 and on; 5658 p. 99 and on; 5679 p. 460 and on.

[10] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5653 p. 239; p. 243 and on; 5659 p. 30 and on, and elsewhere.

(*Keilim*) (at which time they are in the aspect of inner manifest powers (*Kochot Pnimiyim*)) that they come to be inter-included.

The same is so of the matter of the 248 *mitzvot*, which are the "248 limbs of the King,"[11] in that they too are inter-included with each other. This is why a person who is occupied in fulfilling one *mitzvah* is exempt from fulfilling another *mitzvah*.[12] This is because [through engaging in one *mitzvah*] he also affects the drawing down brought about by the other *mitzvah*, as explained elsewhere.[13] Nevertheless, one could posit that this is specifically as they are in the aspect of the "248 limbs," meaning that the desire (*Ratzon*) of the Supernal One in the *mitzvot* is in the aspect of the "limbs" and vessels (*Keilim*) of *Zeir Anpin*.

Proof for this is the statement in Zohar,[14] that the Yenuka told Rabbi Yitzchak and Rabbi Yehudah, "I can tell by the scent of your clothes that you have not recited the *Shema*." That is, because they were preoccupied with the *mitzvah* of providing [funds] for a bride to be wed (*Hachnasat Kallah*), they thus were exempt from the *Shema* recital. Yet, even so, he recognized this "by the scent of your clothes," meaning in the aspect of the encompassing light (*Makif*) of the garments of fulfilling the *mitzvot*.

That is, although they were exempt, being that they also affected the drawing down brought about by the *Shema* recital,

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[11] Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 30 (74a)

[12] Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 25a

[13] Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 254 and on; Torat Shmuel, Drushei Chatunah p. 1 and on; p. 123 and on; 5655 p. 37; Also see the later discourse entitled "*HaShamayim Keesee*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 688); 5679 p. 463; 5688 p. 144.

[14] Zohar III 186a (Yenuka)

it may be posited that this [only] is as [the *mitzvot*] are in the aspect of the "248 limbs" which are in a state of inter-inclusion, but not in the aspect of the encompassing light (*Makif*).

(It may also be posited that since the Torah is the aspect of the form of the Supernal Man, as the verse states,[15] "This is the Torah [of] man," it thus is indeed true that according to Torah, one who is engaged in one *mitzvah* is exempt [from another *mitzvah*].)

This being so, in regard to the aspects of pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*) which are encompassing aspects (*Makifim*), how does it apply for there to be the aspects of inter-inclusion and manifestation in them, being that there is no inter-inclusion and unity in the simple essential powers?

We also must understand what was explained before, that the way they interchange in their manifestation depends on which is the essential aspect and which is the aspect of spreading forth, such that if the essential aspect is the pleasure (*Taanug*) [then the aspect that spreads forth is desire (*Ratzon*)] etc., as discussed before. This itself is not understood. That is, why is it that sometimes this one will be the essential aspect and sometimes that one will be the essential aspect?

Even more generally, what is not understood is that since it was explained before that pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*) are one, in that both are essential aspects, this being so, how does is apply for an essence to have two matters - pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*)? That is, this only applies in the [manifest revealed] powers, in which there can be

[15] Numbers 19:14

two kinds of powers. However, in an essence it does not apply for there to be two kinds of essence, in that an essence is one.

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Now,[16] we first should preface that even though we explained before that sometimes pleasure (*Taanug*) is inner and sometimes desire (*Ratzon*) is inner, we nonetheless see that the power of desire (*Ratzon*) has an advantage over the power of pleasure (*Taanug*). That is, we observe that there is greater strength to desire over pleasure. This is so much so that something pleasurable can be overturned into something painful, and something painful can be overturned into something pleasurable.

To further explain, pleasure (*Taanug*) has no power over desire (*Ratzon*) to cause a person to change from not desiring something to desiring it, or from desiring something to not desiring it. This is because pleasure does not have the power to cause a person to desire that which he does not desire.

An example is a great sage who greatly delights in intellect and thus automatically loves concepts etc. However, what concepts does he desire? He specifically desires concepts stemming from the side of holiness, such as the wisdom of the Torah and the like, whereas about matters that are in opposition to Godliness or that can bring loss or ruin on the side of

[16] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*uV'Vo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch ibid. p. 483 and on; Also see *Hemshech* 5666 p. 86; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 407 and on; Discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" 5720 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5720 p. 20 and on, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5720, Discourse 3).

holiness, Heaven forbid, he has no desire for altogether, and even if he knows that they contain deep wisdom and concepts, his pleasure in ideas will have no effect in causing him to desire those ideas. That is, his desire [for concepts] because of his great pleasure in ideas remains unchanged, but even so, he has no desire at all for these ideas.

He likewise will not at all change from desiring not to desire. That is, whatever he essentially desires will always remain unchanging. For example, the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) present in every Jew will altogether be unchanging, even if he becomes sunken in many physical pleasures, Heaven forbid, as a result of which he will automatically become very distant from Godliness. Nevertheless, his essential desire never changes at all, and from time to time it will be revealed.

We even observe this in a non-observant Jew, that on joyous occasions he will be drawn to God fearing people and will speak about the goodness of fear of God and closeness to Godliness in fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot* and how he too truly desires this, and the like. This is not a lie but is truly so. That is, from the angle of his desire he truly yearns to be close to Godliness and everything stemming from the side of holiness, except that this desire is very concealed. Nonetheless, his essential desire never undergoes change.

This is like the verse,[17] "Many waters cannot extinguish the love." The "many waters" refers to the matter of abundant physical pleasures, which cannot extinguish the love that the

[17] Song of Songs 8:7

Congregation of Israel (*Knesset Yisroel*) has for the Holy One, blessed is He.[18]

Therefore, about the coming future the verse states,[19] "Those who are lost in the land of Assyria will come," and as known,[20] the land of "Assyria-*Ashur*-אשור" refers to the matter of abundant physical pleasures. That is, even "those who are lost in the land of Assyria-*Ashur*-אשור," meaning who are sunken in the overabundance of physical pleasures, until it is as if they are lost in them, may the Merciful One protect us, nonetheless, when "the great Shofar will blow,"[21] even "those who are lost in the land of Assyria-*Ashur*-אשור will come and prostrate etc." This is because even now, this is their essential desire; it is essentially unchanging, and is why they will come.

This is why this specifically is so of the souls of the Jewish people, since they have the aspect of the essential desire and bond, as indicated in the verse,[22] "You are children to *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God," as explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*").[23] This desire is never lost, Heaven forbid, and is forever unchanging.

Now although about the coming future the verse states, "I will transform the nations to all call in the Name *HaShem*-

[18] See Torah Ohr Noach 8c and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 246 (Vol. 1 p. 273 in earlier editions).

[19] Isaiah 27:13

[20] See Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 50a; Ateret Rosh 25b, and elsewhere.

[21] Isaiah 27:13 ibid.

[22] Deuteronomy 14:1

[23] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 81 and on.

יהו"ה etc.,"[24] and another verse states,[25] "All the nations will stream to it etc.," nonetheless,[26] as known[27] they will not be equal to the Jewish people. This is as in the verse,[28] "There are sixty queens, and eighty concubines etc.," which Midrash Rabbah[29] states refers to the nations of the world.

That is, after their refinement they will be called "queens" and "concubines" etc. However, even so, the verse concludes, "My dove, she is one," referring to the souls of the Jewish people who will be elevated and separate from all the nations of the world, even in the coming future.

However, the separateness is primarily in the essential point of the desire (*Ratzon*), which specifically is present in the souls of the Jewish people, since "you are children to *HaShem*-יהו"ה." This is like the explanation elsewhere[30] about the matter of the Crown of Kingship (*Keter Malchut*), that this was something impossible for Haman to give to [Mordechai] even after his refinement, since he altogether does not have this aspect in him, as explained in Torah Ohr, in the discourse entitled "*Yaviyu Levush Malchut*" and its explanation.[31]

That is, this drawing forth stemming from the essential point of the desire is only found in the souls of the Jewish people, and it never becomes extinguished and is forever

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[24] See Zephaniah 3:9; Also see Rashi to the first verse of the *Shema* recital, Deuteronomy 6:4.

[25] Isaiah 2:2

[26] Regarding the coming section see Ohr HaTorah Na"Ch (Vol. 2) p. 906.

[27] Exodus 33:16 and elsewhere.

[28] Song of Songs 6:8

[29] Midrash Shir HaShirim Rabbah 6:8; Also see Rashi to Song of Songs ibid.

[30] See Shaarei Orah 62b; 64a; 73a and on; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5679 p. 667 and on; 5687 p. 48 and on; 5705 p. 78 and on.

[31] Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 91a; 92a

unchanging, and even with an abundance of physical pleasures this desire undergoes no change, Heaven forbid. We thus see that pleasure (*Taanug*) has no power over desire (*Ratzon*) to cause it to change or be overturned.

In contrast, the desire (*Ratzon*)[32] indeed has power over the pleasure (*Taanug*) and can overturn something pleasurable to something painful, and something painful to something pleasurable. For example, if a person yearns for something, though it may be very painful, for him it will be pleasurable. For example, if he willingly and with desire accepts great suffering and penances upon himself, for him the penances will be pleasurable. This is why[33] the sages permitted fasting on Shabbat because of a [disturbing] dream, since for him it is considered as pleasurable.

The opposite is also true, that if he despises pleasures, even the most coveted and delightful pleasures, he literally will consider them as being painful and agonizing. An example is perfectly righteous people about whom the verse states,[34] "Despise evil," in that they literally despise all [worldly] pleasures with utter disgust and revulsion, as stated in Tanya,[35] except that in the perfectly righteous this comes about because

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[32] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*uV'Vo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch ibid. p. 483; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 ibid. p. 410.

[33] See Tur and Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chayim 288:4; Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe, Orach Chayim 288:3; Also see the Sichah talk of Shabbat Parshat Vayeishev 5737, Ch. 23 and on, in explaining this proof from the last of fasting for a [disturbing] dream on Shabbat.

[34] Psalms 97:10

[35] Tanya, Ch. 10 (14b and on, cited later in the discourse itself); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5628 p. 42; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 123 (Vol. 2 p. 279 in earlier editions).

of their love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה and pleasure in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*), through which they thereby despise evil etc., as discussed in chapter ten of Tanya.

In truth, as understood from the statement in Tanya there, despising evil stems from love and desire, in that because of his great love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, he therefore despises anything in opposition to Godliness, in that "God made one opposite the other."[36]

In contrast, it is love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) that transforms the aspect of the "waters"[37] of the animalistic soul into good, so that the evil of the animalistic soul is transformed to absolute goodness, literally like the good inclination. However, to remove "the soiled garments," meaning to greatly despise all the pleasures of this world etc., this is brought about through love and desire for *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He.

In any event, we see this even in those who truly return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*), that he will despise all bodily pleasures with actual disgust, and will accept all suffering and penance with actual pleasure. This is only because of his great yearning and desire to truly return.

Now, although it also is in the power of pleasure (*Taanug*) to despise all [worldly] pleasures, such as how the perfectly righteous despise evil, as mentioned above, nevertheless, this power of pleasure (*Taanug*) stems from his sense of how it essentially is evil and inherently disgusting to

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[36] Ecclesiastes 7:14

[37] [See Tanya, Ch. 1, that "the appetite for all worldly pleasures emanates from the foundational element of water etc."]

the ultimate degree. This is because, in truth, all physical pleasures are the dross of the Upper Pleasure (*Taanug HaElyon*)[38] and truly are disgusting. This is as in the verse,[39] "for all tables are full of vomit, filth." That is, "all tables" refers to "the sacrifices of the dead,"[40] referring to physical pleasures, which truly are "vomit, filth."[41] However, this is when he comes to the true realization that they inherently are evil and disgusting.

This is caused by the strong bonds of his love for *HaShem*-יהו"ה in the aspect of love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*), through which he comes to the true realization of how they inherently are disgusting. This is because in relation to true pleasure (*Taanug*) in the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) all pleasures are automatically nullified, especially physical pleasures that are disgusting in essence. (Thus in all pleasures, when one comes to an even greater pleasure, the previous [lesser] pleasure is nullified.)

However, in those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) it is not because in and of itself the essence of the thing is disgusting to him, or because of his sense of Godly pleasure etc. It rather is because of his desire and yearning to truly return, and because of the strength of his desire to be close to *HaShem*-יהו"ה and be nullified to Him (not because of the pleasure, but because of his essential self) and to distance

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[38] See Likkutei Torah, Shlach 46d and on; Also see Torah Ohr, Tetzaveh 81b, and elsewhere.

[39] Isaiah 28:8

[40] See Psalms 106:28; Mishnah Avot 3:3

[41] See Tanya, Ch. 14 (20a); Also see the end of Ch. 24 (31a)

himself from all evil. Because of this, all physical pleasures become utterly despicable to him, this only being because of his desire (*Ratzon*) for Godliness, and not because he inherently despises them out of his sense of Godly pleasure.

We thus find that in a perfectly a righteous person his loathing of evil because of his pleasure in Godliness is not a transformation of the essential physical pleasure into disgust and pain. Rather it only is that because of his pleasure in Godliness, he comes to realize that in truth, they inherently are disgusting.

In contrast, in one who returns in repentance (*Baal Teshuvah*) for whom this does not stem from pleasure (*Taanug*) but from desire (*Ratzon*), in that he desires to return and be utterly distant from evil, his hate for all physical pleasures is solely because of their opposition to Godliness. Thus, in such a case the essential pleasure [itself] is transformed into disgust and pain.

(If we would say that in perfectly righteous people their disgust for evil stems from their love and desire for *HaShem*-יהו"ה, as mentioned before, it likewise would be so that the pleasure itself would be transformed into disgust.)

This is especially so when in accepting sufferings as pleasurable, such as giving up one's life for the sanctification of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, he will willingly accept the suffering and pain of death, as in the teaching,[42] "Even if He takes your soul." This matter is not found to such a degree in the perfectly righteous-*Tzaddikim* in their service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה with great love and delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanaugim*).

[42] Sifri to Deuteronomy 6:5; Talmud Bavli, Brachot 54a in the Mishnah.

Although in the great love with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) there also is self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*), this being delight in *HaShem*-יהו"ה literally to the point of expiry, nonetheless this is only commensurate to the pleasure, meaning that it only stems from the pleasure and is not due to his essential desire and bond to *HaShem*-יהו"ה etc. Rather, it is commensurate to the **pleasure** in the essential bond, to the point that "my soul yearns, it indeed expires."[43]

This[44] is much lower than actual self-sacrifice for the sanctification of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. This is like Rabbi Akiva who said,[45] "When will I be given the opportunity to fulfill this," even though he indeed had self-sacrifice in his great love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) on the loftiest level, except that he did not come to the [actual] expiry of the soul. This is because "Rabbi Akiva entered in peace and went out in peace etc."[46] Moreover, this itself is because the desire (*Ratzon*) has power over the pleasure (*Taanug*), as will be explained.

However, from the angle of the pleasure (*Taanug*), he indeed had the aspect of love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) on the loftiest of levels, such that he literally was able to come to the expiry of the soul, but even so,

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[43] Psalms 84:3

[44] See Shaarei Orah 8a and on; 81a and on; 90b; Shaarei Teshuvah Vol. 1 p. 46b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 280; 5652 p. 75 and on; 5664 (5745 edition) p. 191; 5691 p. 313 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket p. 191 and on (Vol. 2 p. 71 and on in earlier editions).

[45] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 61b

[46] Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 14b [and 15b "he ascended in peace and descended in peace, but see] Yerushalmi (Chagigah 2:1) and in Ein Yaakov (Likkutei Sichot Vol. 3 p. 990, note 10); Also see Midrash Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:4 (section beginning "*Hevi'ani*").

he said, "When will I be given the opportunity to fulfill this" This is because [actual] self-sacrifice for the sanctification of *HaShem*-יהו"ה stemming from the essential bond of desire (*Ratzon*) in *HaShem*-יהו"ה, is much higher than the self-sacrifice present in love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*). This only comes through the power of desire (*Ratzon*) [which can cause the] suffering to actually be pleasurable for him.

In other words, through the medium of great love with delight in Him (*Ahavah Rabbah b'Taanugim*), we are incapable of coming to the sanctification of His Name with the acceptance of suffering and difficult torments. Rather, this comes solely through the strength of stubbornness, in that "they are a stiff-necked people,"[47] this being the aspect of the simple essential desire present in every Jew, in that since they are a single essence, he is incapable of being separated from Godliness. Specifically by this power he will accept all suffering and torment. The same is true of those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*), as discussed before.

From this it is understood that it is desire (*Ratzon*) that has the power to literally ascend in elevation upon elevation in the essence of the soul, which is not at all so of the power of pleasure (*Taanug*). This is because the ascents of pleasure (*Taanug*) are only to the place where the depth of the pleasure reaches in the essence of his soul, and not beyond that.

[47] Exodus 32:9; Also see Midrash Shemot Rabbah 42:9; Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 123b; Likkutei Torah Balak 67d and elsewhere.

In contrast, this is not so[48] of desire (*Ratzon*), which literally reaches the essence of the soul, higher than pleasure (*Taanug*), and there is no end at all to its spreading forth. This is so much so that it states,[49] "Nothing can stand in the way of desire," whereas it does not state, "Nothing can stand in the way of pleasure."

This is because desire (*Ratzon*) can stand in opposition to pleasure (*Taanug*) and can dominate and override it, as explained before. In contrast, desire (*Ratzon*) has nothing that can stand in opposition to it, in that pleasure (*Taanug*) has no dominion or reign over desire, to override it, but the opposite is true, that desire (*Ratzon*) rules over pleasure (*Taanug*).

The proof of this is that also with respect to great love with delight in Him (*Ahavah Rabbah b'Taanugim*) itself, indeed the desire (*Ratzon*) rules and controls the pleasure (*Taanug*). This is why he can maintain his soul so that it will not expire out of great love with delight in Him (*Ahavah Rabbah b'Taanugim*) to the point of actual expiry, but instead goes to the state of "turning back" (*Shov*)[50] to fulfill Torah and

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[48] In the discourse entitled "*uV'Vo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch ibid. it states, "in contrast, the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) reaches even higher in the essence of the soul than the essence of the soul itself,* and is higher than pleasure (*Taanug*). The proof for this is from self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*) or from difficult sufferings, such that he willingly destroys his soul with a strong desire for self-sacrifice in actuality, or alternatively, it is like the abandonment to be killed in battle etc., this being much higher than the power of the ascent of pleasure in the soul. [* i.e., this desire can reach beyond what a person is capable of in his soul, in and of itself.]

[49] This is brought in various places, but as of this time, I do not know its [original] source – see the note of the Rebbe in Sefer HaMaamarim 5703 p. 12; In Igrot Kodesh Vol. 22 p. 293 he cites to Zohar II 162b (which states, "All matters in the world depend only upon desire").

[50] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 7a

mitzvot, like Rabbi Akiva who entered in peace and went out in peace. This is because "it is against your will that you live etc.,"[51] which is much more difficult than the expiry of the soul, as explained elsewhere.[52]

This is only because his essential desire is the desire of *HaShem*-יהו"ה and the desire of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*) is specifically for the matter of "returning" (*Shov*), as the verse states,[53] "He did not create it for destruction etc.," as explained elsewhere.[54] He thus has dominion and reign over the power of pleasure in the aspect of the expiry of the soul, to [instead] come to a state of "returning" (*Shov*).

(Now, although at times there is a dominance of the lust and pleasure, even in things that are damaging and destructive to his soul, and he is unable to have dominion over his soul by strength of will (*Ratzon*), to restrain himself from it when the power of lust dominates, and on the contrary, he draws his desire into this, this [only] is because he does not sense that this is damaging to his soul.

However, if he would sense that it is damaging to his soul, then because of the desire to live he would rule over the spirit of his lust. This is so even in something that is not literally immediate and life threatening, such that he would imminently die, because in such a case he certainly would rule over his lust.

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[51] Mishnah Avot 4:22

[52] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 p. 256 and on; 5665 p. 105; Also see the end of the later discourse entitled "*Ki Ka'asher HaShamayim*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 201 and on).

[53] Isaiah 45:18

[54] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 ibid. p. 257; 5652 p. 76.

For example, it is spiritually so that the spirit of folly covers over the truth, in that one does not sense that by [engaging in it] he becomes separated and that this brings him to transgress, may the Merciful One save us. However, if he were to sense that he thereby becomes separated [from Him] he would not transgress under any circumstance. For example, were they to force him to worship idolatry, may the Merciful One save us from such matters, he would stand steadfastly and literally give up his life with self-sacrifice, since he senses that by doing so, he would be completely severing himself [from Him]. In such a case, there truly is no obstacle or obstruction, and he has dominion over [himself] in all things, as explained in chapter twenty-four and at the end of chapter eighteen of Tanya.)

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However,[55] based on this we must understand the statement[56] "nothing is loftier than pleasure." That is, based on

[55] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*uV'Vo'ah Lifnei HaMelech*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch ibid. p. 485; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 ibid. p. 410; Vol. 2 p. 717 and on.

[56] Sefer Yetzirah 2:7; In the Sichah talk of Shabbat Parshat Balak 5743 (Torat Menachem, Hitva'aduyot 5743 Vol. 4 p. 1762) it was explained that "pleasure is the loftiest matter, as stated in Sefer Yetzirah, 'There is nothing loftier than pleasure.' Although there is give and take discussion regarding desire (*Ratzon*) and pleasure (*Taanug*), as to which precedes which (as explained in *Hemshech* 5666) – nevertheless, the conclusion is that the power of pleasure (*Taanug*) is the loftiest, in alignment with what is stated in Sefer Yetzirah. It should be pointed out that by custom of the Jewish people the parts of Sefer Yetzirah are called "chapters-*Perakim*" and the paragraphs in each "chapter-*Perek*" are called "*Mishnayot*." We thus find that they have the unique strength of "a Mishnaic teaching," which is something in which it is inapplicable for there to be error [see Avodah Zarah 35b; Chullin 116b; Yevamot 30a and elsewhere]. In a letter responsa the Rebbe further

the above explanation they should have said "nothing is loftier than desire," since the desire rules over the pleasure.

The explanation is that indeed there certainly is more strength and dominion in the power of desire (*Ratzon*) than in the power of pleasure (*Taanug*). However, this is not because in the essence of the soul desire transcends pleasure, for this is not so. Rather, the opposite is true, that in the essence of the soul pleasure is more inner. Because of this, in a concealed way, every desire has pleasure in it, even a desire that [seems to have] no pleasure.

That is, in the explanation before (in the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*")[57] that a person can desire something not out of any pleasure but just because of the essential self of his soul, nonetheless there is a hidden pleasure in this, but not a felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*). That is, it is not at all sensed or revealed even to himself. Nevertheless, there indeed is a hidden pleasure (*Taanug Ne'elam*) in it.

For example, when it was stated that the son desires the essence of his father, even though, as explained before, he has no pleasure from him, but the opposite, what is meant is that he has no **revealed** pleasure (*Taanug Nigleh*), such that he would be capable of describing the pleasure in whatever sense it may be, even as a hidden feeling, but even so, concealed in his soul

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explained that it is not in accordance with what is explained here, and he further explained that his intention in elucidation of the words of Sefer Yetzirah is that it refers to "the essence of the pleasure" (*Etzem HaOneg*) (and that it is inapplicable to utilize terms such as "root" or "source" and the like [in regard to it] except as a borrowed term, and even then, it would require great analysis as to whether [such terms] could be applied) – [referring to] "the delight of the King in Himself" (*Sha'ashu'ey HaMelech b'Atzmuto*) which is something that is not found in desire (*Ratzon*).

[57] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 88

he indeed has essential pleasure from his father, just by the fact that he is his father. Proof of this is the fact that if his father is in pain or is missing, the son will be pained to the very depths of his soul. It thus must be said that he indeed has pleasure in him, except that he is not at all aware of it.

The same is so spiritually, in that the soul is drawn to Godliness just because of its essence, not because of any pleasure in Godliness, as explained before (in the above-mentioned discourse). It thus must be said that there indeed is a hidden pleasure (*Taanug Ne'elam*) in this, meaning that to him Godliness is his ultimate good, but he does not at all sense it. Moreover, he is not drawn to Godliness because of this [hidden pleasure], but only because of his essential desire. Nevertheless, in a hidden way there indeed is unfelt pleasure (*Taanug Bilti Murgash*) mentioned before.

Likewise, when it was said that with the power of desire he will accept difficult suffering and torment with love, this too is because he has a hidden pleasure in this. The same is so of suffering for the sake of sanctifying *HaShem's*-יהו"ה Name, which is only out of the strength of his desire.

This is because from the angle of love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) he would never accept such suffering under any circumstance, but this solely out of the strength of stubbornness, in that "they are a stiff-necked people". Here too, there is a hidden pleasure (that for the sake of the Oneness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה and the true reality of His will, it is worthwhile to accept the most difficult suffering and torment upon oneself.

That is, concealed in his soul there is a certain pleasure that for the sake of the Oneness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה and the true reality of His will it is worthwhile for him.) only that this [pleasure] is not sensed by him (and it could be that if there was a dominance in him of the actual sense that for the sake of the Oneness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה it would be worthwhile for him, he could be unable to withstand the sufferings etc.)[58] Rather, [in a revealed way] his self-sacrifice only stems from the strength of his desire, that he is incapable of being separated, whereas in concealed way there indeed is a hidden and essential pleasure in this.

(Moreover, the pleasure is not the cause of the desire, because they both come forth equally from the essence, and the desire does not require a cause, since it too literally comes directly from the essence of the soul, except that there is no desire without pleasure,[59] being that the pleasure is the innerness, as will be explained.)

Now, about [the statement before] that the desire (*Ratzon*) rules over the pleasure (*Taanug*), this is only over the expressed and revealed pleasure and not the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*). This is because the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) does not spread forth into revelation, but indeed is found in the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*). This itself is the primary difference between pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*). That is, about the desire (*Ratzon*), even the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) spreads forth and is revealed as is, whereas

[58] See *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 409.

[59] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24 ibid.

about the pleasure (*Taanug*), what spreads forth and becomes revealed is only a radiance of the pleasure, whereas the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) does not spread forth and become revealed.

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Now, the explanation[60] is that in the essence of the soul, pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*) literally come from a single root. That is, they are not two separate powers but both are literally from a single root, except that pleasure is inner and desire is external. This is why pleasure is specifically concealed and desire is specifically revealed.

To further explain, desire (*Ratzon*) is the drawing out of the soul-Nefesh-**נפש**, as in the verse,[61] "If it is truly your desire-*Nafshecha*-**נפשך**," That is, it specifically is the bond of the desire to something outside of oneself. This is why[62] desire has a beginning and end, called the beginning of the thought and the end of the thought. That is, [its beginning] is the beginning of the arousal and drawing forth of the desire from the soul, and its end is where the desire spreads forth to and is bound to, meaning that which he desires and yearns for.

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[60] Regarding the coming section, see *Hemshech* 5672 ibid. Vol. 1 p. 409.

[61] This is as the verse is cited in various places in Chassidus. See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bereishit p. 339; Also see Genesis 23:8 and Rashi and Targum Onkelus there; Kings II 9:15 and Targum and Radak there; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 2 p. 456, note 9*.

[62] Regarding the coming section, see at length in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bamidbar Vol. 2 p. 378 and on; Also see the discourse entitled "*Shuvah Yisroel*" (p. 27).

That is, being that the state of desire is that of revelation,[63] it therefore has a beginning, that is, the beginning of the arousal, meaning the beginning of its revelation. It likewise has an end, this being the object [of the desire] to which it is bound.

In contrast, this is not so of pleasure, which is only inner to the one who experiences it, and its pull is not at all recognized in the thing he delights in. In other words, when one has pleasure in any given thing, meaning something outside of himself, the attraction to it is not recognizable, being that the delight for it is **in himself**. That is, the pleasure is primarily experienced within himself and is not at all drawn out to anything [outside of himself].

This is as explained elsewhere about the essential delight of a king,[64] which is not a composite of anything, meaning that he does not delight in anything in particular, not even in his essential greatness and exaltedness, but only in his essential being, rather than the exaltedness of his being. This delight is an essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*).

We likewise see that the strongest pleasure is specifically in the pleasure of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*). An example is the pleasure in something sharp and spicy which is very delightful to the soul, far more than the pleasure in something inherently sweet. (This is as explained

[63] See *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 409 that "this is because the desire (*Ratzon*) is the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) of the soul. That is, although it is essential, it is nevertheless the externality of the essential self, and therefore its entire substance matter is the aspect of revelation etc."

[64] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Bamidbar Vol. 2 ibid. p. 379 and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Kuntreisim p. 569 and on; Also see Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim 27a.

elsewhere[65] on[66] "[the analogy of the princess who] smelled the scent of the spices adhering to the bottom of the pot," that this is pleasure that comes from the refinements (*Birurim*) and reaches very high, in that specifically "through the restraint of the side opposite holiness, the glory of the Holy One, blessed is He, is elevated etc.")[67] All this is because pleasure (*Taanug*) is primarily inner, and specifically is concealed in oneself, rather than being drawn forth and revealed. In contrast, desire (*Ratzon*) is in a state of revelation.

Nonetheless, for this very reason there is an element of superiority to desire (*Ratzon*) over and above pleasure (*Taanug*). This is because the word "desire-*Ratzon*-רצון" also indicates "running-*Merutzah*-מרוצה," meaning the attraction of the soul to something, as in the verse,[68] "After You we will run-*Narutzah*-נרוצה," and,[69] "With You I rush-*Arutz*-ארוץ [a barrier]." It likewise states in Midrash Rabbah,[70] "Why was she called 'earth-*Aretz*-ארץ?' Because she 'ran with desire-*Ratzetah*-רצתה' to do the will of her Maker," the meaning of which[71] is both "desire-*Ratzon*-רצון" and "running-*Merutzah*-מרוצה", as explained elsewhere.[72]

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[65] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 2 p. 364; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 404c and on; Kuntres Etz HaChayim, Ch. 9 (p. 35); *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 437, and elsewhere.

[66] Talmud Bavli, Pesachim 56a

[67] In Tanya, Ch. 27 (34a) and Likkutei Torah, Pekudei 3a, they cite to Zohar II 128b; In Likkutei Torah ibid. it also cites to Zohar II 67b; Also see 184a; Torah Ohr Vayakhel 89d; Likkutei Torah Chukat 65c, and elsewhere.

[68] Song of Songs 1:4

[69] Psalms 18:30; Also see Samuel II 22:30

[70] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 5:8

[71] See the commentary of Maharzu and Etz Yosef to Midrash Rabbah ibid.

[72] See Torah Ohr, Bereishit 1c and on, and at length in Ohr HaTorah Bereishit Vol. 3 p. 481b and on.

As known, whatever comes with the [attraction of the soul to desire to] "run-*Merutzah*-מרוצה" to it, comes with very great force of strength, as explained elsewhere[73] on the verse,[74] "Like a powerful warrior to run-*Larutz*-לרוץ [the course]." That is, there is very great strength and power in the drawing forth and bond of the soul to this desire, such that he runs with all his strength with the essence of his soul and with force and strength. This desire is from "the innerness of the heart and the depths of man,"[75] to a much greater degree.

In contrast, such power is not present in pleasure, because although the soul can delight with such a great pleasure that it literally can expire from what it delights in, it nevertheless is not truly the running of the essential power of the soul, but only its radiance. This is unlike a very deep desire, in which the very essence of the soul is attracted.

The mark and sign of this is what we see in the reality of the desire to its ultimate end, namely, that his entire desire and yearning is for the true being and essence of that which he desires, and not for something secondary and nullified to it or included in it. For example, in the love of a son for his father, his desire is specifically for the essential self of his father [simply put, for his father himself] as explained before (in the above-mentioned discourse)[76] about the essential bond between a son and his father.

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[73] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 182b and on, and at length in Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe 27a and on.

[74] Psalms 19:6

[75] See Psalms 64:7

[76] The discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 81)

The same is so of one's love for a friend who he loves like his own soul. That is, he does not desire his property, nor his wisdom, nor the treasures in his house, but his desire is for his friend himself, meaning specifically as he is, in and of himself. In contrast, this is not so of pleasure, in which he desires that which he can delight in, such as the wisdom or goodness of his friend.

The same is so of the love of a father to his son, in that he specifically desires his essential self. We clearly see this in the love for one's children, that even when the child is not as he should be, Heaven forbid, meaning that he is not going on the straight path, may the Merciful One protect us, nevertheless, the father has an essential desire for him, meaning that he desires his essential self and it thus is entirely not relevant that he is not as he should be.

However, from the angle of pleasure he certainly does not delight in him, but on the contrary, is anguished by his improper behavior. Nonetheless, from the angle of desire he indeed desires him. This is because the pleasure only grasps the externality, meaning specifically that which he can delight in. In contrast, the desire takes hold of the essential self.

The same is so Above in the love of the Holy One, blessed is He, for the Congregation of Israel (*Knesset Yisroel*). That is, so to speak, His desire for the souls of the Jewish people is specifically for their essential self, and even if they are not as they should be, Heaven forbid, He nonetheless desires them, as the verse states,[77] "Despite all this… I will not reject them."

[77] Leviticus 26:44

That is, He desires their essential self, and their essential self is good. For, as known,[78] when a Jew is in an evil state, Heaven forbid, the evil is only superimposed over his essential self, whereas his essential self is good. This is as the verse states about the coming future,[79] "I will gather them… amongst them will be the blind and the lame etc.," this only being in reference to the revealed powers. Nonetheless, [as the verse continues], "A great congregation will return here," this being because of the essence, which is good, and it thus will all automatically be repaired.

Though we find that there also is delight in which one takes pleasure in the essence of the thing, such as in the essence of his beloved and faithful friend, and the like, without any personal benefit, nonetheless this only is so specifically of pleasure that comes from the strength of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*). That is, because he desires his essential self, he therefore delights in him. That is, the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) also draws the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) forth, and the essential pleasure also takes hold of the essential self of the thing.

However, that which comes by the strength of the pleasure is specifically only in that which he delights in. This is because the pleasure drawn into revelation is only in the aspect of a radiance and thus only grasps the externality of the thing. In contrast, in the drawing forth of the desire, one's essential self is drawn forth, and it thus specifically takes hold

[78] See (in the name of the Maharal of Prague) Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 85; 5679 p. 655; 5691 p. 362; 5693 p. 548; Also see Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Geirushin 2:20

[79] Jeremiah 31:7

of the essential self. Therefore, the sign of the true depth of his desire, that it truly is because of his essential self, is when the desire for the innerness and depth of that which he desires, specifically is for how it is in essence, rather than just its externality.

The likeness to this is also understood in the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, in the matter of true self-sacrifice to the True One, such as in the *Shema* recital. That is, the primary thing is specifically the matter of drawing forth the light of the desire (*Ratzon*) such that it comes to [greater and greater depth], specifically with one depth following another depth. (For example, about the matter of repentance (*Teshuvah*) the verse states,[80] "From the depths-*MiMa'amakim*-ממעמקים I called You," this being the aspect of the depth of the depths of the heart,[81] which is why it is written "*Ma'amakim*-**מעמקים**" with two letters *Mem*-מ etc., as explained elsewhere.)[82]

This is much loftier than the depth of the light in the arousal of the pleasure, even the great pleasure in *HaShem*-יהו"ה with delight in Him (*Ahavah Rabbah b'Taanugim*) to the point of expiry. That is, that does not reach the depth of the soul to such a degree, literally in its essential self. It therefore only grasps that which he delights and derives pleasure in, which is not the true Essential Self of the Unlimited One who "no thought can grasp."[83]

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[80] Psalms 130:1

[81] See Zohar II 63b; Zohar III 70a

[82] Ateret Rosh 55b; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 Vol. 1 p. 169 and on; Maamarei RaZa"L p. 233 and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek Vol. 2 p. 777 and on; Also see Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 63b; 64a; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 142 and elsewhere.

[83] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar (17a)

Rather, it only is specifically the true desire (*Ratzon*) in the inner depths of one's soul, in that his whole essential self is attracted, that it reaches the the innerness of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, to His ultimate truth, blessed is He. This is like the verse,[84] "To You *HaShem*-יהו"ה I uplift my soul," meaning "to You-*Eilecha*-אליך" literally. This also is like the verse,[85] "Whenever we call to Him," meaning,[86] "to Him-*Eilav*-אליו and not to His attributes," referring to the self-sacrifice of the *Shema* recital, which specifically is "to Him."

Another verse states,[87] "if he sets his heart to Him," specifying "to Him-*Eilav*-אליו," not to the upper pleasure that will be drawn from Him in the coming world, but literally to Him alone, as He is in the true reality of His Essential Self,[88] and as Dovid said,[89] "for Your Truth, my God."

The explanation is that, in truth, the primary sign by which to understand whether it is a desire from the innerness and depths of the depths of the heart of man or not, is solely in the spreading forth and bond of the grasp of the desire, in that which he desires and yearns for. This is [the case] when it truly is into the innerness, depth, and essence of the object [of the desire] and not when the grasp, yearning, and desire is only into its externality. This is because that is a sure indication that even

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[84] Psalms 25:1; 86:4

[85] Deuteronomy 4:7

[86] Sifri cited in Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 32 (Shaar HaKavanah) Ch. 2; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 85b and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch p. 34; Derech Mitzvotecha 117a and on.

[87] Job 34:14

[88] Also see the introduction to Imrei Binah of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gateway to Understanding.

[89] Psalms 71:22

the beginning of the arousal of the desire was only from the externality of his soul, and not from its innerness and essence.

This is as explained elsewhere[90] on the verse,[91] "My sheaf arose," that this was the superiority of Yosef's elevation of the feminine waters (*Ha'ala'at Mayim Nukvin*) over and above that of the tribes. That is, it was from the inner point of the desire of the heart and soul to a greater degree, and therefore the spreading forth of his desire was to the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One on a much higher level.

This is why prayer from the inner recesses of the heart,[92] such as the prayer of Chanah[93] and the prayer of Chizkiyahu,[94] ascends much higher in His Essential Self, literally. This is as the verse states,[95] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה is close to all who call Him, to all who call Him in truth," meaning, truly from the inner recesses of one's heart.

As known,[96] prayer is called "a ladder set earthward whose head reaches heavenward,"[97] literally to the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*). This is the aspect of "the depth of below"[98] (*Omek Tachat*) that reaches "the depth of the heights" (*Omek Rom*).[99] This is the ascent of the depth

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[90] Torah Ohr, Vayeishev 28b, and at length in Torat Chayim Vayeishev 68a and on.

[91] Genesis 37:7

[92] See Jeremiah 4:19

[93] Samuel I 1:10 and on

[94] Kings II 20:2-3; Isaiah 38:2-3

[95] Psalms 145:18

[96] See Zohar I 266b (Hashmatot); Zohar III 306b (Hashmatot); Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 45, 83a; Torah Ohr Bereishit 2b; Vayakhel 88a; Likkutei Torah Beshalach 2b; Naso 26b and on; Shir HaShirim 49b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5655 p. 45 and on.

[97] Genesis 28:12

[98] See Sefer Yetzirah 1:5; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 99c

[99] See the citations in the preceding note.

of desire, with elevation upon elevation, meaning, into that which he desires to adhere to.

Now, Above this specifically refers to the bond of the desire to the Essential Self of the Unlimited One alone, blessed is He. This is as Dovid said,[100] "My soul thirst for You," specifically "for You-*Lecha*-לך." He also said,[101] "Who do I have in the heavens, and but for You I desire nothing on earth."

The intention in this statement is to negate everything other than "*HaShem* is One-*HaShem Echad*-יהו"ה אחד" alone, and in doing so, he comes to instruct and provide us with the true sign of the depth of desire in one's soul to adhere to *HaShem*-יהו"ה. That is, he desires and yearns for nothing but the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) alone.

Rather, the totality of his yearning and desire is specifically only to reach and grasp the innerness of the Unlimited One, specifically as He is in His Essential Self, and nothing other than Him, even that which is drawn forth and branches out from the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, even in a way of closeness, meaning, even the loftiest of levels.

This is the meaning of his words, "Who do I have in the heavens," that is, in the upper heavens, referring to the general surrounding and encompassing light (*Makif*). This refers to the general pleasure and desire that came forth for the sake of bringing about the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) of Emanation, Creation, Formation, and Action (*Atzilut*, *Briyah*,

[100] Psalms 63:2
[101] Psalms 73:25; Also see Derech Mitzvotecha 138a and elsewhere.

Yetzirah, *Asiyah*). About this the verse states,[102] "Even the heavens and the heavens of the heavens cannot contain You." That is, this is not the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One, in that they "cannot contain You" whatsoever, nor can they be receptacles for the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, in that "no thought that can grasp You altogether," even the uppermost encompassing aspect of thought.

Moreover, even that which descended and came down from the upper pleasure, such as the Upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*) and the Lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*) which is called "the earth," and about which the verse states, "But for You I desire nothing on earth," all this is nullified and only secondary to the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*).

This is because it all is only the aspect of the constriction (*Tzimtzum*) of the light of His pleasure and desire for the chaining down (*Hishtalshelut*) during the six millennia of the world. That is, included in this are the revelations of the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*) and the revelations of the Coming World (*Olam HaBa*), as discussed before.

All this is only secondary, merely like a light and ray of radiance compared to the essential delight called[103] "the Delight of the King in His Essential Self" (*Sha'ashu'ey HaMelech b'Atzmuto*). (This refers to the aspect of the essential concealed

[102] Kings I 8:27

[103] See the beginning of the prior discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 14).

pleasure in the essential desire for Torah and *mitzvot*. This pleasure will be revealed in the future.)

This is higher than the source of all the upper delights, both generally and particularly. This is as stated,[104] "For with You-*Eemcha*-עמך is the source of life," even the source of all pleasures. Therefore, "Who do I have in the heavens," and "but for You-*Eemcha*-עמך," meaning, that which is with You and is secondary and nullified to You, that is, the aspect of "with you-*Eemcha*-עמך is the source of life," this too I do not yearn for in the primary desire, not even for the reward of the *mitzvot* and the Coming World (*Olam HaBa*) that are called "the sweetness of *HaShem*-יהו"ה."[105] Rather, [I only] specifically [desire] Your Essential Self and Being, literally. This is the primary indicator of the degree of the depth of desire from the innerness of the heart and soul, for the above-mentioned reason.

Now, this is specifically by the power of desire (*Ratzon*), in that the desire draws out his essential self, and thus reaches and grasps the essence of that which is [desired]. In contrast, pleasure does not actually reach its very essence, as explained above. This is because only is a radiance of [the pleasure] is drawn forth, and it therefore does not reach the actual essence. However, this only is so of the spreading forth of the pleasure (*Hitpashtut HaTaanug*), whereas the essential pleasure (*Etzem HaTaanug*) is specifically concealed in His Essential Self, and is the primary inner aspect of everything. Even when the aspect of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*)

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[104] Psalms 36:10

[105] Psalms 27:4; 90:17; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5668 p. 162 and on; 5684 p. 304 and on; 5709 p. 130 and on.

only stems from his essence and not from his sense of the pleasure, it too has the aspect of pleasure in it, except that this is the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) that is utterly hidden and does not become revealed, nor is it at all sensed, so that all that is revealed is only the desire.

This then, is the meaning of "there is no reason (*Ta'am*-טעם) for desire,"[106] not even the "flavor-*Ta'am*-טעם" of the pleasure. This is because in the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) there is no sense of revealed pleasure at all, but only the desire. Though there indeed is pleasure in it, it nonetheless is an essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) which is hidden and utterly simple, such that it is not even in the aspect of a reason or cause for the desire, except that it is present in the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) and they both stem from the essence.

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Now, based on the above, we can understand why pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*) garb one another when they spread forth. This is because they both come from a single root in the essence of the soul, except that one is inner and concealed, whereas the other is external and revealed. However, there cannot be pleasure without desire, nor desire without pleasure.[107] This is because in whatever one has pleasure, there also is desire and in whatever he desires, there also is pleasure. Moreover, even in the essential desire (*Ratzon*

[106] See the previou discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 49).

[107] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24 ibid.

Atzmi) there is pleasure, except that it is a hidden and essential pleasure (*Taanug HaNe'elam*).

Thus, when it states that desire (*Ratzon*) has the power to rule over pleasure (*Taanug*), this refers to the spreading forth of the pleasure, whereas in truth, the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) indeed is like the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*).

It may be posited that this is why the pleasure that spreads forth (*Hitpashtut HaTaanug*) submits to the desire (*Ratzon*), and is why in their spreading forth their manifestations interchange. That is, sometimes the pleasure is inner and the desire is external, which accords to the [true] order of inner (*Pnimiyut*) and external (*Chitzoniyut*). In contrast, sometimes the desire is inner and the pleasure is external, this being the expressed pleasure (*Hitpashtut HaTaanug*) whereas the desire is essential (*Ratzon Atzmi*). There thus is first the arousal of the desire, followed by the pleasure.

However, sometimes, through the desire there also comes to be the revelation of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*), such as when one delights in the essential self of his friend. (This is akin to the coming future when the revelation of the essential pleasure in the *mitzvot* will be revealed, and likewise, "*HaShem*-יהו"ה will rejoice in His works,"[108] and "Israel will rejoice in its Maker.")[109] This is specifically when the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) comes to be revealed, because the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) is also in it, as explained, and thus it too is revealed through the desire.

[108] Psalms 104:31
[109] Psalms 149:2

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Now, based on all the above, we can understand the matter of the desire of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*) for the *mitzvot*. That is, the desire for them is the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, which is not a composite with anything else. Moreover, this desire is specifically for the *mitzvot* to be fulfilled in actual deed, and there is no rationale for this desire, not even a hidden and concealed reason, nor is there a revealed pleasure in it at all. (What is meant by "revealed" here is not a spreading forth of actual revelation, but not even a concealed drawing forth.[110]) Nonetheless, so to speak, hidden in His Essential Self there indeed is pleasure in this desire, except that it literally is essential and concealed.

This then, is the meaning of the teaching,[111] "It brings satisfaction of spirit before Me," specifying, "before Me-*Lefanai*-**לפני**," meaning in the innerness-*Pnimiyut*-**פנימיות** of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, blessed is He. However, in a revealed way, "the *mitzvot* were not given for enjoyment,"[112] being that there is no reason (*Ta'am*-טעם) for the desire. However, in a concealed way there indeed is pleasure in them, except that it specifically is the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*).

Now, what presently comes into revelation is only the aspect of the desire. However, in the coming future the aspect

[110] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 205 and on.
[111] Torat Kohanim and Rashi to Leviticus 1:9; Sifri and Rashi to Numbers 28:8
[112] Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 28a

of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) in the desire of doing the *mitzvot* will be revealed, in that "it brings satisfaction of spirit before Me." This will be revealed in the coming future to the souls of the Jewish people who fulfill the *mitzvot* in actuality, such that it literally will be as it is in His Essential Self.

This then, is the meaning of the verse,[113] "He shall do for whoever awaits Him." The word "awaits-*Mechakeh*-מחכה" here refers to the matter of "hoping-*Tikvah*-תקוה."[114] To explain, hope only applies when one does not know whether something will be. That is, in that which one knows must necessarily be, and in that which one knows will certainly be, "hope-*Tikvah*-תקוה" does not apply. Rather hope specifically applies when it is unclear that it will be [and thus one hopes for it].

Spiritually, this refers to that which is beyond all relativity and comparison, about which the matter of hope applies. For example, the verse,[115] "Our soul hoped to *HaShem*-יהו"ה," means that we hope for that which we do not know, in that [the knowledge of this] is not something one knows must necessarily be, and we also do not know how it could be. Furthermore, as matters presently appear to be, it altogether is not understood how this could possibly be. Still and all, we have the strong faith and hope that it certainly will be.

Moreover, hoping involves the nullification of the one who hopes. For example, one who hopes and waits for his

[113] Isaiah 64:3
[114] See Metzudat Tziyon to Isaiah ibid.
[115] Psalms 33:20

fellow is sublimated, humbled, and secondary to him, as in the teaching,[116] "One who hopes [to eat] at the table of his fellow." This is akin to fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality, in that through this there will be a drawing forth of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) and essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) in the coming future, that is, that which is separate and of no relative comparison altogether. Thus, here the matter of hope applies.

The nullification in this is the matter of accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom, this being the matter of entirely setting oneself aside. About this the verse states, "He shall do for whoever awaits Him," by fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality, with the acceptance of the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom through which in the coming future there will be a drawing forth of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) and the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*).

This then, is the meaning of the verse,[117] "I have seen a conclusion to every end-*Tichlah*-תכלה, but Your commandment is exceedingly broad." That is, in every aspect of "expiry-*Kilayon*-כליון" and pleasure in the worlds, "I have seen a conclusion," in that they are not the aspect of essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*), "but Your commandment is exceedingly broad" in the aspect of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*).

This is because His desire for the *mitzvot* is the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*), and it specifically is here where His essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) is found, this being His essential delights. Except that what is presently revealed is only the the desire (*Ratzon*), whereas the pleasure (*Taanug*) is

[116] Talmud Bavli, Beitzah 32b
[117] Psalms 119:96

hidden. However, in the coming future, this essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) will be revealed, may it be speedily in our days, Amen!

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Now, based on all the above, we can understand the verse, "For I have loved him (*Ki Yedaativ*-כי ידעתיו) because he commands," which Rashi explains as being a term of love and affection. This refers to His essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) drawn forth through fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality. This then is the meaning of, "For I have loved him-*Ki Yedaativ*-כי ידעתיו," in that He showed him His essential affection and love (as in the teaching,[118] "With three expressions of affection the Holy One, blessed is He, expressed His love [for the Jewish people]"). This is "because he commands [his children]… doing charity and justice." This refers to fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality by accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom. This is akin to the verse,[119] "who does kindness, charity, and justice in the earth, for it is in these that I desire," specifically, in the aspect of the essential desire and pleasure, as explained elsewhere.[120]

Targum translates it as "for I have known him-*Ki Yedaativ*-כי ידעתיו" as a word meaning "knowledge-*Yediyah*-ידיעה." About the words, "Because he commands," this

[118] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 80:6; Midrash Tehillim 22

[119] Jeremiah 9:23

[120] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5568 p. 43; Sefer HaMaamarim 5634 p. 69 [and the citations there on p. 66]; 5654 p. 75 and on; 5677 p. 81 and on; Also see Moreh Nevuchim, Part 3, Ch. 54.

means[121] that the knowledge (*Yediyah*) does not compel the choice (*Bechirah*). That is, even though "it is revealed before Me," there nevertheless is free choice (*Bechirah Chafsheet*), meaning that the knowledge is of how it will be after the choice has been made, as explained elsewhere.[122] (See the discussion on this in the discourse entitled "*v'Hayah Emunat Eetecha*" 5652.)[123]

This then, is the meaning of the words "for I have known him-*Ki Yedaativ*-כי ידעתיו" that "It is revealed before Me" – "*Lema'an Yetzavah*-למען יצוה" – "that he will command." That is, it presently is known before Him that this is so, so that he should choose this.

Now, it can be posited that when Targum explains ["*Yedaativ*-ידעתיו"] as meaning "knowledge," whereas Rashi explains it as meaning "affection," this itself is the difference between the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) and the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*). That is, when Targum states, "It is revealed before Me," it refers to the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*), for as explained above, the desire (*Ratzon*) is in a state of revelation whereas the pleasure (*Taanug*) is hidden and will be revealed in the coming future. This then, is why Targum Onkelos states, "It is revealed before Me that he will

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[121] See Ohr HaTorah Vayera 89a (citing Panim Yafot of the author of Sefer HaHafla'ah); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5680 ibid. p. 140; For further elucidation of this point, see the discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" 5736, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 7.

[122] See Shaarei Teshuvah Vol. 1 p. 18c and on; Torat Chayim Toldot 13b and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek Vol. 1 p. 265 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 112 and on; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 7 p. 365 and on; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 5 p. 65 and on; Vol. 27 p. 251, note 14, and elsewhere.

[123] Sefer HaMaamarim 5652 p. 51.

command," in that through the *mitzvot* there is a drawing forth of the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*).

Rashi explained "*Yedaativ*-ידעתיו" as a term of affection, meaning that the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) is also drawn forth. This is because this is also drawn forth through presently fulfillment the *mitzvot* in actuality, except that the revelation of it will be in the coming future. Nonetheless, even now it is drawn forth through fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality. This then, is the meaning of "for I have loved him-*Ki Yedaativ*-כי ידעתיו," as a term of affection.

Discourse 10

"*v'Avraham Zakein… -*
Now, Avraham was old…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Chayei Sarah, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "Now, Avraham was old, coming on in days, and *HaShem*-יהו"ה blessed Avraham in all." Now, we must understand why it states, "in all-*BaKol*-בכל," without defining what He blessed him with. This is unlike earlier blessings in which He specified and clarified the details of the blessing, as in verse,[3] "I will make you a great nation; I will bless you and I will make your name great etc.," and likewise the verse,[4] "Your offspring shall inherit… and they shall bless themselves by your offspring etc." However here it simply states that He "blessed Avraham in all-*BaKol*-בכל" without specifying what [He blessed him with].

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[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah SheB'Brachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kalah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 522 and on, [and also see p. 478-479 there]; Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe, Ch. 95 (60c and on) – as cited in later notes. Regarding the beginning and end of the discourse, see the discourse entitled "*v'Avraham Zakein*" 5737 in Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 300 and on (p. 53 and on in earlier editions).

[2] Genesis 24:1

[3] Genesis 12:2

[4] Genesis 22:17-18

Now, Zohar[5] likewise points out that the verse simply states, "in all-*BaKol*-בכל," and cites the verse,[6] "No eye has seen it besides You God, who does for whoever awaits Him." However, we must understand the relation between the verse, "He does for whoever awaits Him," and the matter of "*HaShem*-יהו"ה blessed Avraham in all-*BaKol*-בכל."

Now, to understand this, we must begin with the explanation before,[7] that in the verse, "He shall do for whoever awaits Him," the word "awaits-*Mechakeh*-מחכה" denotes the matter of "hope-*Tikvah*-תקוה," and that it applies to that which is beyond relative comparison, referring to the aspect of the essential desire and pleasure (*Ratzon v'Taanug HaAtzmi*).

Moreover, in this hope (*Tikvah*-תקוה) there is the matter of nullifying and entirely setting oneself aside, referring to fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actual deed by way of accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom. About this the verse states, "He shall do for whoever awaits (*Mechakeh*-מחכה) Him," in that through this a drawing forth of the essential desire and pleasure (*Ratzon v'Taanug HaAtzmi*), which is the aspect of Eden.

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Now,[8] Zohar I 130b, on the verse, "No eye has seen it besides You God, who does for whoever awaits Him," states,

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[5] Zohar I 130b – in regard to the connection between the Zohar and Rashi's commentary on the verse, see the discourse entitled "*v'Avraham Zakein*" 5737 ibid.

[6] Isaiah 64:3

[7] At the end of the previous discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 102).

[8] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" 5689 and the discourses entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" and "*Lehavin*

"What is the meaning of, 'for whoever awaits Him-*L'Mechakeh Lo*-למחכה לו'? It is akin to the verse (Iyov 32),[9] 'Elihu waited-*Cheekah*-חכה before addressing Iyov.' This refers to those who are persistent with words of wisdom (*Chochmah*-חכמה) and are exacting in them and patient (*Mechakan*-מחכאן) with them, to come to know their words with clarity."

That is, it explains the word "*Mechakeh*-מחכה" as meaning "waiting" and "pausing," as in the verse "Elihu waited-*Cheekah*-חכה etc.," or the verse,[10] "though it may tarry, await it-*Chakei Lo*-חכה לו," denoting both "hope" (*Tikvah*-תקוה) and "waiting" (*Hamtanah*-המתנה), in that he waits for something. The same is so of engaging in Torah study, that it must be with patience and pause, this being the matter of in-depth study (*Iyun*).[11]

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Now, the explanation[12] is that in-depth study (*Iyun*) and analysis in Torah is solely the matter of restraining oneself to

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Inyan Simchat Torah" 5706 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 59 and on; 5706 p. 37 and on; p. 40 and on) – which are based on this discourse. Also see the discourse entitled "*v'Avraham Zakein*," of the 20th of Marcheshvan, 5735 (translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5735, Discourse 7).

[9] Job 32:4 – Also see Rashi there that "*Cheekah*-חכה" means "waited-*Heemteen*-המתין."

[10] Habakkuk 2:3

[11] Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1.

[12] Regarding the coming section, see the notes of the Rebbe Rayatz to Sefer HaMaamarim 5678 ibid. p. 453 and on; p. 456 and on; p. 459 and on; Discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" 5684; Discourse entitled "*BaYom HaZeh Yechaper*" 5709 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 p. 21 and on; 5709 p. 31 and on), which are based in this discourse.

spend time and give pause to the subject[13] until he comes to truly grasp it to its depth. We observe this in every wisdom, that to come to its ultimate depth and truth, such as arriving at the true and correct ruling in a matter of Torah law, this specifically comes through immense toil with one's brain. That is, specifically through strenuously using the vessel of his brain to greatly delve into the matter with much scrutiny and patience, one arrives at the true [ruling] of the matter.

Now, this strenuous toil is[14] the matter of not sufficing with his grasp of the matter at first glance. This is because through this he will only come to a surface level knowledge of the subject and will not know its inner aspects at all. This is because if he only learns the matter once or twice, or even several times, he still will not fully understand it, meaning that he has yet to know its innerness at all.

On the contrary, until he invests the entire power of his intellect and comprehension into the matter with great scrutiny and analysis, delving his mind to know how it truly is, he will find many difficulties in it. The more he delves into it, the more

[13] In Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 and 5709 ibid., he adds that this restraint and pause is not only a pause in time, but rather, restraining oneself and giving pause to the essence of the matter. That is, he becomes entrenched in it. This is as we see physically in business, that when a person has a fixed business engagement, it is not merely that he apportions a set time during the day for engaging in it, but rather, this engagement is such that he is completely invested in it etc. The same is likewise so of this restraint and giving pause, meaning that he becomes invested in this subject matter to the point that it becomes personal to him, and thereby his brain and the power of his intellect become receptacles etc.

[14] Regarding the coming section, see at length and with some variations in Sefer HaMaamarim 5650 p. 359 and on. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1 ibid.

wondrous it will become for him,[15] until he comes to its inner depth and true intention, that it must be in such and such a way.

This is the great advantage of in-depth study (*Iyun*), through which one comes to the true depth of matters, much more than his understanding of them at first. That is, even a person with sharp intellect who can grasp the matter immediately at first glance, will not come to its true depth[16] compared to one who has greatly toiled with the vessel of his intellect thereby coming to the true depth and intention of the matter.

It thus is he who brings forth many novel insights into the matter, which he would not have otherwise come to if not for the toil and in-depth study (*Iyun*) specifically. Moreover, he can expand the matter to a great degree, with many details and into many related matters, and can explain each particular from several angles and with clear explanations.

This is as explained elsewhere[17] about the difference between Mishnah study and Talmud study. That is, no novel insights are born of the superficial study of Mishnah, but only

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[15] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 5; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 & 5709 ibid., which add, that "because Wisdom-*Chochmah* is in a state of separate transcendence, it automatically follows that the more he comes closer to the matter, the more distant it becomes from him. However, this distance is not that he does not know it at all, for he nonetheless does know it, only that his knowledge of it is not yet clear, and it thus is called an intellectual assessment (*Hash'arah Seechleet*).

[16] In Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 & 5709 ibid. they add, "This is the deficiency of one of sharp intellect, in that he constantly comes up with questions on the subject even before he comes to know it. That is, though he still only knows the subject at first glance (which is not true knowledge altogether) he already has questions, and because of this he will not come to know the subject etc. All this is because he does not bring himself to toil in it.

[17] Regarding the coming section see Likkutei Torah, Ha'azinu 76d; Also see Ateret Rosh 48a and on; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 15b.

what the Mishnah plainly states. In contrast, Talmud study is the matter of in-depth analysis and scrutiny of the laws stated in Mishnah. It thus is called,[18] "plants yielding seed, and trees yielding fruit," referring to the novel discoveries yielded through scrutinizing the law. This is like [the Talmudic statement],[19] "A [new] matter emerged amongst them," in that through in-depth study a novel ruling emerges that was hidden within it before the in-depth analysis (*Iyun*).

This is akin to a person who digs into the depths of the earth by which he discovers a new flow of spring water from the source. One who does not dig to such depth will only discover gathered waters or river waters but not the waters of a living spring (*Mayim Chayim*). In contrast, specifically by digging into the depths one discovers a new flow from the source - called "living waters" (*Mayim Chayim*).[20]

Moreover, the deeper that he digs, the greater the flow and there thus will be a greater spreading forth of water. For example, the entire spreading forth of the river is specifically from the spring,[21] and as stated,[22] "a river is blessed from its riverbed," meaning, from its [subterranean] source and root in the spring.[23]

The same is so of Torah study, in that specifically when one greatly toils in delving into every matter, he will then come

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[18] Genesis 1:11; Also see Likkutei Torah and Ateret Rosh ibid.

[19] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 121b and elsewhere.

[20] Genesis 26:19; Song of Songs 4:15, and elsewhere; Also see Mishnah Mikva'ot 1:8

[21] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1 ibid.

[22] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 65b

[23] See Rashi to Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 65b ibid.

to its depth and discover new and deeper insights, and there thus will automatically also be a much greater spreading forth and expansion of each matter.

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Now, as known, this is explained elsewhere[24] about the matter of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*. That is, there can be Wisdom-*Chochmah* without Understanding-*Binah* and Understanding-*Binah* without Wisdom-*Chochmah*. That is, one can be a person of understanding (*Baal Havanah*),[25] such that he can introduce novel insights and new explanations, without being a person of comprehension (*Baal Hasagah*) who can grasp and understand matters and refine and clarify everything. There also can be one who is a person of comprehension (*Baal Hasagah*) but is not a person of understanding (*Baal Havanah*). There also can be a person with both powers, or one whose strength is primarily in the power of understanding (*Havanah*),[26] or one whose strength is primarily

[24] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Maamarei RaZa"L p. 7 and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Devarim Vol. 1 p. 251; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema 56a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 287 and on; 5659 p. 74 and on; 5678 p. 389 and on; 5679 p. 613 and on; 5689 p. 129 and on.

[25] Regarding to the term "a person of understanding" (*Baal Havanah*-בעל הבנה), see the discourse entitled "*Zachor*" 5680 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5680 p. 279) and the note of the Rebbe there that, "this is what is written in the manuscript, and is also called such later, but in some places is called 'a person who discovers [novel insights]' (*Baal Hamtza'ah*-בעל המצאה)." Also see Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe 2d; Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 246. [Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 25 and Torat Chayim, Lech Lech 82c that this refers to one who has the power of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.]

[26] [See Shaar HaYichud Ch. 25 ibid. that this "understanding-*Havanah*-הבנה" refers to Wisdom-*Chochmah*.]

in the power of comprehension (*Hasagah*), in that he has great strength in grasping and clarifying everything as to how and what it is.

Now, as known,[27] the source of clarification is specifically in Understanding-*Binah*. That is, specifically when one delves into the matter to understand how it is and what it is, this being the matter of truly comprehending, in that he analyzes everything deeply thereby arriving at many questions and contradictions in the matter, or that the matter is not settled in him, that he then toils to delve into it to an even greater degree, thus discovering its depth.

Through this he removes the questions and contradictions, or the matter becomes more settled [for him]. He then delves further into it to understand it to an even greater degree. The more that he delves into it, the more he comes to its depth and clarifies and refines it further.

This is the meaning of the additional portion of Understanding-*Binah* given to women.[28] That is, it specifically is through the power of Understanding-*Binah* that the seminal point of Wisdom-*Chochmah* becomes clarified and refined, until one comes to the depth and point of the Wisdom-*Chochmah*. From there the seminal point of Wisdom-*Chochmah* illuminates as it is in its true depth. Moreover, from the novel revelations of the depth of intellect and wisdom the matter comes with a much greater flow.

To further explain, the power of Wisdom-*Chochmah* comes as a direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) from above to below, not

[27] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 207 and on; 5669 p. 172.
[28] Talmud Bavli, Niddah 45b

through toil and in-depth study, as the verse states,[29] "Wisdom-*Chochmah* is found from nothing-*Ayin*." There thus is measure and limitation as to how much he will be capable of conceptualizing and grasping, meaning that it only will be commensurate to the strength of its source in his power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) and his strength will then dissipate, such that he will be unable to conceptualize or grasp any more.

This is because, as known, the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) also has form as to how it will conceptualize and the degree to which it will conceptualize. This is because it too is a power in a state of being drawn forth from the soul, except that it is a hidden drawing forth, as explained elsewhere.[30]

Thus, since its state is that of being drawn forth, the way it is drawn forth necessarily has form. We thus[31] see that some sages can study one wisdom but are incapable of studying a different wisdom, one having a talent for one wisdom and another having a talent for a different wisdom. This results from the form of his power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) which has a specific form that empowers it for that particular wisdom. For example, the power to conceive the wisdom of astronomy, or the power to conceive the wisdom of mathematics, and the like, may be revealed in [one sage] to a

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[29] Job 28:12

[30] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 478-479.

[31] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 2 p. 635 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid.; 5659 p. 198; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 p. 73 and on; Et'halech Liozhnah p. 245 and on.

greater degree [than in another sage], as explained at length in the discourse entitled "*Samach Tesamach*" 5657.[32]

Thus, since there is form in the drawing forth of each kind of wisdom and the degree that it can be drawn forth and expressed, therefore how he conceives them will also have form and limitation to the degree of his strength in conceptualizing each wisdom.

For example, there are many levels of sages, in that one conceptualizes in one way, another conceptualizes in a different way, and yet another conceptualizes to a greater degree than his fellow. Now, although this also depends on whether the vessels of one's brains are broad and fit to receive the light of the wisdom, nevertheless, the brains are merely the receptacles (*Keilim*), whereas it primary depends on his power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*), such that if it is drawn forth well, he will be capable of conceptualizing to a greater degree.

(As we see, there can be a person whose power of intellect is great, but the vessel of his brain is small. We thus see a revelation of intellectual light in him, in that he is capable of much conceptualization, but not with great breadth and strong grasp or in a very settled way. Nevertheless, in essence his conceptualization of ideas is good, in that he has a good power of intellect.) He nevertheless is limited by the degree of his strength to conceptualize. For, since there are levels in this, whether it will be great or small, and whether it will properly be drawn forth or not, it thus follows that its goodness and greatness is also limited.

[32] Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid. (p. 206 and on).

However, through toil and in-depth study, he thereby affects a drawing forth of the concealed essence of the power of wisdom, from which there can be revelations that literally are limitless (*Bli Gvul*). We observe this empirically, in that there are some people whose brains and intellectual powers are small, but specifically through great toil and strenuous labor in studying, understanding, and delving into every matter, they thereby attain the loftiest levels of wisdom, much greater than those who are smart because their power of intellect is innately good. This is because through toil we reach the concealed essence of the power of wisdom, from which revelations are drawn forth in a completely different way.

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Now, as a direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) Wisdom-*Chochmah* is also drawn from the concealed power of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This refers to the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) of the soul called "intellect concealed from all conception" (*Sechel HaNe'elam MiKol Ra'ayon*)[33]. Now, as known,[34] every hidden power (*Ko'ach Ne'elam*) transcends limitation, since it specifically is when the light (*Ohr*) is revealed that it comes into a state of limitation. In contrast, in its concealed state it is not

[33] See the liturgical hymn "*E"l Mistater*" for the third meal of Shabbat (printed in some Siddurim) [In the Siddur of Rabbi Yaakov Emden it is attributed to a student of the Ramak; In Siddur Kol Yaakov of Rabbi Yaakov Kopel (17a) it is attributed to Rabbi Avraham the son of the Rambam.]; Torah Ohr, beginning of Lech Lecha 11a; Torat Chayim, Bereishit 22b; Lech Lecha 80a, and elsewhere.

[34] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5644 p. 354 and on; 5654 p. 303 and on; 5663 p. 96 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid. (p. 204 and on).

yet limited and measured, being that it has yet to have been drawn forth and revealed, as known and explained elsewhere.[35]

However, the explanation is that there are two aspects of concealment (*He'elem*).[36] The first is concealment that has existence (*He'elem Sheyeshno b'Metziyut*) thus automatically also having limitation even as it still is concealed, except that this limitation cannot at all be compared to the limitation in revelation. Nevertheless, since it has an existence, it too is limited. The second aspect is the essential concealment and *Heyulie* power, which is not an aspect of existence (*He'elem She'eino b'Metziyut*). This truly is in a state of limitlessness (*Bli Gvul*).

Now, by way of analogy, this may be understood from physical fire, in which there also are these two above-mentioned aspects of concealment. An example is a flintstone[37] (called "*Kremen*-кремень-קרעמין" [in Russian])[38] from which fire is brought forth. However, in the flintstone itself, though it has the potential for heat from the foundational element of fire (*Aish*), which is why it can bring forth fire, there nevertheless is no existence of fire in it at all. Moreover, its heat is concealed and is [only there potentially] in the most refined way, such that there is no felt heat at all, meaning that there is no actual

[35] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid.

[36] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid. (p. 209); 5659 p. 196 and on; 5679 p. 325 and on; 5700 p. 23; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 320 and on (Vol. 2 p. 287 in earlier editions), and elsewhere; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5692 p. 343.

[37] See Deuteronomy 8:15; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 140; Also see the citations in the preceding note.

[38] Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 1 p. 8; Ohr HaTorah Devarim Vol. 5 p. 2,136; Ohr HaTorah Shlach p. 75

existence of heat in it. Only by striking it with a piece of iron is the spiritual power of fire concealed in it brought forth.

In contrast, this is not so of "the flame that is bound to a [hot] coal."[39] That is, even when it is in the coal and is neither seen nor revealed externally, there nonetheless is the existence of actual fire in it, except that it is unseen, and it then comes forth into revelation.

Now, the difference between them, as it relates to their revelation is in two ways. The first is that fire cannot be brought out from a flintstone except through the toil of striking it with iron. In contrast, this is not so of the flame that is bound to the [hot] coal, in that it does not require toil or labor to bring it out from its concealment, but can be done by merely blowing on it with one's mouth. However, there is an end and limit to the revelation of the flame, in that when the potential power for fire in the coal is consumed, meaning when the coal dims and is extinguished, the revelation [of the flame] also ceases.

In contrast, this is not so of [the fire in] a flintstone, which never ceases or becomes extinguished, in that more sparks of fire can always be brought out from it. This then, is the second difference, in that the fire [in the coal] is limited (*Gvul*), which is not so of the fire in the flintstone, which is unlimited (*Bli Gvul*).

Now, all this depends on the above-mentioned difference between the essential existence of fire in its source. This is because in the flame [bound to the hot coal], even as it is in its source in the coal, it exists as actual fire, except that it then comes out of its concealment to be revealed as a flame.

[39] See Sefer Yetzirah 1:7

This is like [the coming into being of] something from something (*Yesh M'Yesh*). That is, what is present in the source is revealed without great effort or toil.

In contrast, in a flintstone there is no existence of fire at all, in that it only is like a *Heyulie* power. This is like the foundational element of fire (*Aish*) which is the *Heyulie* power[40] for the existence of fire, whereas in [this state] it is not fire at all. Rather, the fire drawn out from it is like [the coming into being of] something from nothing (*Yesh MeAyin*). Therefore, its revelation is specifically by way of effort and toil, through striking it. Nevertheless, its power never ceases and can always be brought forth.

This then, is the difference between concealment that has existence (*He'elem Sheyeshno b'Metziyut*) and that which is essentially concealed (*He'elem Atzmi*). That is, concealment that has existence (*He'elem Sheyeshno b'Metziyut*) has an end and limit to its revelations. In other words, being that it has existence, it therefore is in a state of measure and limitation, and when its potential power is consumed, that which is revealed from it automatically also ceases.

In contrast, that which is essentially concealed (*He'elem Atzmi*) and has no existence at all, is even concealed in relation to itself. This is unlike fire as it is in a [hot] coal, in that even as the fire is in the coal, it only is concealed in relation to another [outside of itself], whereas in relation to itself, the fire

[40] See Moreh Nevuchim Part 2, Ch. 30; Ramban to Genesis 1:1; Sefer Shvilei Emunah (of Rabbi Meir Aldabi), Netiv 2, Shvil 1; Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 96c; 97a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5646 p. 15; Also see the citations in Sefer HaArachim Chabad, Vol. 2 p. 222.

is revealed as the existence of fire and is thus in a state of measure and limitation.

In contrast, as the fire is in the flintstone it is in the aspect of essential concealment (*He'elem Atzmi*), in that even in relation to itself the fire is concealed. That is, even in relation to the flintstone itself the fire has no existence, and it thus follows that it also is not in a state of limitation. Because of this there is no measure to the revelations that can be drawn out from it, nor does its potential power ever cease. Nevertheless, the way to reveal it is specifically by striking it. For, since it is in a state of the complete absence of existence, therefore for existence to come from it, there specifically must be the toil of striking it.

Now, with the above in mind, we can understand the difference between the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah* that comes in a way of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) relative to that which comes in a way of a rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*). That is, in Wisdom-*Chochmah* that comes in a way of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*), even though its source is a hidden power (*Ko'ach Ne'elam*), it nevertheless is a concealment that has existence (*He'elem SheYeshno b'Metziyut*) and is in a state of revelation in its source, except that as of yet, the light has not actually come to be revealed to another. The revelation of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which is the flash of insight, is also revelation to another.

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Now, the explanation[41] is that, as known,[42] each power of the soul includes ten. The same is so of the power of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, in that it too has ten powers, from desire (*Ratzon*), which is the aspect of its Crown-*Keter*, until the end of its revelation, which is its aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*.

The aspect of its Crown-*Keter* is the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of the revelation of the "something" (*Yesh*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, referring to the flash of insight that comes to be revealed in the intellect. That is, this is the "something" (*Yesh*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* (and is the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah* within Wisdom-*Chochmah*).

In contrast, the Crown-*Keter* is the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of the "something" (*Yesh*), as in the verse,[43] "Wisdom-*Chochmah* is found from nothing-*Ayin*." By saying "is found-*Timetzeh*-תמצא," this refers to how it is that Wisdom-*Chochmah* is the aspect of a "something" (*Yesh*).

(Now, in this there is Wisdom-*Chochmah* of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah* of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. Wisdom-*Chochmah* of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is the essential point of the concept, whereas the Understanding-*Binah* in it is the matter of "be understanding in wisdom,"[44] this being the

[41] See Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe, Ch. 95 (60c and on).

[42] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Devarim Vol. 2 p. 375 and on; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 157 and on; 5665 p. 61 and elsewhere; Also see *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 418 and on; Vol. 2 p. 893 and on; p. 1,177 and on.

[43] Job 28:12

[44] Sefer Yetzirah 1:4

ability for the seminal point to come to be grasped in Understanding-*Binah*, as explained elsewhere.[45]

It is explained elsewhere[46] that Wisdom-*Chochmah* of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is the sight (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* etc. However, this refers to the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and is unrelated to the matter being discussed here.)

Now, about the verse, "Wisdom-*Chochmah* is found from nothing-*Ayin*-אין," the aspect of "nothing" (*Ayin*) is the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* within Wisdom-*Chochmah* and is the particular source to bring about the revelation of the light of a particular concept.[47]

This is the difference between the Crown-*Keter* of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Crown-*Keter*. That is, Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Crown-*Keter* is the *Heyulie* ability for intellect before anything has been drawn forth into a particular concept. Nevertheless, all concepts are drawn from it, since it is the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) which is the *Heyulie* power for intellect before the source of the light of the concept flows from it.

In contrast, the Crown-*Keter* of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is as the light of the concept already flows from the power to

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[45] See at length in Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 73 and on; Also see the beginning of the previous discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 91).

[46] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 286; 5663 p. 89; 5665 p. 269 and on.

[47] In Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 59 and on, in which he adds that "just as in the worlds and in the *Sefirot*, the *Sefirah* of the Crown-*Keter* is the particular source for that particular world, or for the ten *Sefirot*, such as the Crown-*Keter* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) which is the source and particular desire to emanate the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), so likewise, the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* within Wisdom-*Chochmah* is the particular source to bring forth the revelation of the light of a particular concept."

conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*), except that it has not yet come into revelation as the light of revealed intellect, in the actual existence of intellect. Nonetheless, it already is prepared and destined to be revealed. Here there certainly is already the actual existence of the light of the concept, being that it is a particular power to conceptualize a particular concept. (However, it is not that there is actual intellect there in the same way as it comes into revelation, being that this still is in the source.

Albeit, there is the existence of the light of the intellect, meaning that it is in the way of the existence of intellect, but not as actual existence. Nevertheless, it is in the same way as that existence, in that it cannot be said that it is not the existence of intellect (as can be said about the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*).) Rather, it is the actual light of the concept that then comes to be revealed, in that it is its particular source.)

By way of analogy, this is like someone who toils in a concept, such as a Torah law (*Halachah*) that he does not understand and toils and endeavors to understand it. Now, before the light illuminates him in a way of actual revelation, in his intellect he already senses the light of the concept. This is as it begins to illuminate for him, because when he does not understand the matter, he then is in a state of darkness and the absence of light.

It then begins to illuminate for him (That is, it begins to be illuminated, but as of yet he does not know the light of the concept, except that he already has gone out of the darkness and senses the light of the matter, though he still does not know how

it is and what it is). After this the light of the intellect comes into actual revelation.

Now, this sense of the light before its revelation is because the light of the concept is already flowing from its concealment into revelation from the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*), except that it still is in the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, this being the Crown-*Keter* of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. Being that there it already is in a state of existence as the light of intellect, therefore its light and rightness is already sensed by him, except that it still is in a state of concealment, though it then comes into the actual revelation of revealed intellect.

This is called the "wonder-*Pele*-פלא" of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, in which the "wonder-*Pele*-פלא" becomes a "teaching-*Aleph*-אלף,"[48] this being the revelation of the Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as in the verse,[49] "I will teach you wisdom-*A'alephcha Chochmah*-אאלפך חכמה." For, as known, the word "*Aleph*-אלף" denotes "teaching," referring to how the Wisdom-*Chochmah* comes into actual revelation.

That is, "I will teach you wisdom-*A'alephcha Chochmah*-אאלפך חכמה" refers to how the Wisdom-*Chochmah* comes into revelation from its source in the aspect of "wonder-*Pele*-פלא," which is the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is called a "mystery" (*Sod*) that comes into

[48] See Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 70 (135a); Also see the introduction of the Raavad to Sefer Yetzirah, Netiv HaAleph (11a); Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Maamarei RaZa"L p. 6 and on; Imrei Binah, Petach HaShaar 1b; 3a (translated as The Gateway to Understanding); Shaar HaKeriyat Shema 54d; 57b and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 462; Sefer HaMaamarim 5678 p. 386 and on; Also see at length in Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema 57b and on.

[49] Job 33:33

revelation, even though it presently is still a hidden mystery. It is an aspect of an encompassing light (*Makif*) that encompasses Wisdom-*Chochmah* but is destined to come into revelation.

This is like a person who studies a deep matter of intellect, in which he understands some small measure of it but not all of it. This being so, that which is wondrous and beyond him is in the aspect of an encompassing light (*Makif*) that [hovers] over his brain, so to speak. Nevertheless, it certainly will come to be revealed, in that his intellect has the power to understand it, and it thus will come into revelation.

This being so, the wondrousness of that which presently is wondrously beyond him and is still concealed from him, is not a true wonder and concealment. This is because in that which is completely wondrously beyond him, he has no knowledge at all, not even a small measure of it.

An example is when a person studies a deep matter and sees that there is depth to it, but does not yet know what it is (not that he does not understand it, but that he does not yet know its depth). Nonetheless, he at least knows that there is depth here. This is because there is an even [deeper] depth in which he does not even know that there is depth there, whereas in this case, he does know.

This is because this is the "wondrousness-*Pele*-פלא" of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which is the aspect of the light of the intellect. Therefore, at the very least he senses that there is depth here. This likewise is so when he understands some of it, but the rest remains wondrously beyond him in an encompassing state (*Makif*) (and this too is the aspect of the

encompassing light (*Makif*) that is sensed and will come to be revealed.)

Now, even in the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Crown-*Keter*, which is called[50] "the hiddenness of wisdom" (*Ta'alumot Chochmah*), or the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*), or "intellect hidden from all conception" (*Sechel HaNe'elam MiKol Ra'ayon*),[51] or in the terminology of the Geonim[52] is called "the wondrous intellect" (*Sechel Mufla*), which in the soul is the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*), this being the *Heyulie* power to conceive every concept as it still is divested of intellect (*Sechel*), and as known,[53] every *Heyulie* is divested of all the revelations drawn from it.

However, this only means that it is divested of revealed intellect, in that this altogether does not apply to it. Nevertheless, it too is an aspect of intellect (*Sechel*), which is why it is called "the hidden intellect" (*Sechel HaNe'elam*) or "the wondrous intellect" (*Sechel Mufla*). Thus, at the very least, it still is intellect (*Sechel*). This is because it already is drawn forth from the essence of the soul to be the source of intellect, and is not truly the aspect of an essential power, but only that which has already been drawn forth.

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[50] See Job 11:6

[51] See the liturgical hymn "*E"l Mistater*" for the third meal of Shabbat (printed in some Siddurim) [In the Siddur of Rabbi Yaakov Emden it is attributed to a student of the Ramak; In Siddur Kol Yaakov of Rabbi Yaakov Kopel (17a) it is attributed to Rabbi Avraham the son of the Rambam.]; Torah Ohr, beginning of Lech Lecha 11a; Torat Chayim, Bereishit 22b; Lech Lecha 80a, and elsewhere.

[52] See the introduction of the Raavad to his commentary on Sefer Yetzirah, Netiv 1 (10a; 11a); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 12 (Shaar HaNetivot) Ch. 2 & Ch. 3 (citing the Geonim).

[53] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 161 and on; 5659 p. 184; 5665 p. 97 and on.

Now, just as the Crown-*Keter* of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is that which has already flowed forth from the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) to be the source of the light of a particular concept, and is the aspect of intellectual light already sensed in the vessel of the intellect even before its revelation, although it is unlike the actual light of the revealed intellect, it nevertheless is already intellect.

The same is so of the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) after it already has been drawn forth from the soul to be the source of intellect, in that it too is already the aspect of intellect (*Sechel*), except that it is a hidden intellect (*Sechel Ne'elam*).

We therefore see that there are changes in the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*). That is, sometimes it becomes filled with light, at which time he will conceptualize to a greater degree. For example, when a person reaches maturity (*Gadlut*) his power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) becomes stronger and he will increase in becoming wise in all matters of wisdom.

In contrast, this is not so during his youth when his intellect is immature (*Katnut*), at which time he has less wisdom. This is as in the verse,[54] "Days speak and many years teach wisdom," meaning, that there is greater [revelation] from the concealed power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*). He then is called "an elder who has acquired wisdom,"[55] meaning, within his essential power of intellect. He thus will conceptualize every kind of wisdom to a greater degree.

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[54] Job 32:7

[55] Talmud Bavli, Kiddushin 32b and elsewhere.

This is like "elder Torah scholars, in that the older they become the more settled their mind becomes,[56] in that "the mind of an elder is concealed, like good wine which is tranquil [and settled]."[57] This is when the essence of the power of his intellect is strongest in unifying and bonding opposite concepts, as well as the deepest matters, without becoming confused by them at all. Moreover, he is capable of bringing the deepest matters into revelation and "no secret is hidden from him,"[58] as explained elsewhere.[59]

(Now, though[60] there can be a weakening of the power of intellect in old age, nonetheless, the weakening is only of the vessel of the brain, but this does not affect the essential power of intellect. On the contrary, it indeed becomes stronger. However, elsewhere[61] it is explained that in old age the essential power of intellect is weakened and becomes like that of an infant.

However, the fact that because of the loss of sleep one becomes incapable of conceptualizing, and following sleep he then will be able to conceptualize better, is not a matter of the ascent or descent of the essential power of intellect, but rather

[56] Mishnah Kinnim 3:6; Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 152a

[57] See Zohar III 128b (Idra Rabba).

[58] See Daniel 4:6; Zohar I 129b

[59] See at length in Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefillin 199d and on; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 300b and on; Also see Torah Ohr, Vayera 13d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5566 Vol. 1 p. 46; Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1 p. 161; Vol. 2 p. 264 and on; 5679 p. 379, and elsewhere.

[60] See *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 223.

[61] See Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe, Ch. 95 (60c and on) ibid.

relates to the clarity of the vessel of the brain, as explained elsewhere.)[62]

It thus is understood that even in regard to the *Heyulie* power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) there is a source that either increases or diminishes its strength through the lessening [or increase] of the bestowal of its light and influence, akin to the changes between immaturity (*Katnut*) and maturity (*Gadlut*). This is like the verse,[63] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה gave wisdom to Shlomo," and like the verse,[64] "He gives wisdom to the wise." "The wise" refers to the essential power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) which receives its bestowal from a source higher than Wisdom-*Chochmah*. Likewise, when the verse states, "*HaShem*-יהו"ה gave wisdom to Shlomo," it means that He specifically strengthened his essential power of wisdom, so that his power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) came to be in the ultimate state of dominance, to conceive and become wise in every matter with great and abundant wisdom.

Now, all the above is about the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) as it is in a state of being drawn forth from the soul, which is why development, abundance, and increased strength is possible. That is, it exists in a state of intellect and wisdom.

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[62] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Ketuvim Vol. 1 p. 38 and on; p. 179 and on; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Maamarei RaZa"L p. 308; p. 315 and on; Ohr HaTorah Vayechi, Vol. 5 p. 1,009b; Vol. 6 p. 1,148b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 98; 5670 p. 11; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 686; 5678 p. 131; Discourse entitled "*Rabbi Shimon Patach*" 5722 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5722 p. 87, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5722 Vol. 1, Discourse 12).

[63] Kings I 5:26

[64] Daniel 2:21

In contrast, the essential *Heyulie* power of intellect as it is in the essence of the soul, meaning in a state of not of being drawn from the soul at all, it altogether is not in the category of being a source for intellect. Although the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) is drawn from the essential *Heyulie* power too, it nonetheless is only "found" from it, but it is not that the essential power of intellect is the source of the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*), being that it is not at all in a state of being drawn forth.

For example, regarding the aquifer from which all springs are drawn forth, it is not that the aquifer is a source for springs, since it is not at all in a state of being drawn forth that the term "source" could apply to it. Rather, the springs emerge from it automatically [and naturally, of themselves].

The same is so of the essential *Heyulie* power. All concepts are found from it, but it itself is not within the definition of being a source for them, being that it is not at all in a state of being drawn forth, and is not at all in a state of existing as intellect whatsoever.

That is, even though it is the *Heyulie* power for intellect, nevertheless, since it literally is an essential power and is not at all in a state of being drawn forth, it thus follows that it is not at all the existence of intellect (like the above-mentioned example of the flintstone). Therefore, specifically from there is a drawing forth of the loftiest and most wondrous concepts, being that, in and of itself, it is not an existence of intellect at all.

This is unlike the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) because since it already is drawn forth from the soul, therefore, at the very least, it has the form of intellect.

Therefore, the revelations drawn from it are akin to how they are in their source and will thus not be so wondrous. Rather, one who has a good power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) will automatically also have deeper and loftier ideas. Nevertheless, they essentially will be limited in their existence and wondrousness.

In contrast, regarding the essential *Heyulie* power that in and of itself is not limited to the form of intellect at all, from there the loftiest and most wondrous of ideas will be found, meaning that in their essential existence they are without limitation. There likewise will be no measure or limit to their revelation, and there thus can be revelations beyond measure.

This is because when it comes to the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*), since it is in a state of being drawn forth, it therefore is essentially limited in the way it is drawn forth, as explained before. Therefore, there automatically are limitations to its revelations, in that its strength dissipates.

In contrast, when it comes to the essential *Heyulie* power, which is not at all in a state of being drawn forth, it is essentially unlimited in and of itself, and it thus follows that its strength does not at all dissipate and the state of its revelations will be that of limitlessness.

However, to reach the essential *Heyulie* power, this comes specifically through in-depth study (*Iyun*) and toil, in that one specifically toils and labors with the vessel of his brain over every concept to come to its true depth. It specifically is then that he will reach the essential concealment.

To further explain, the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) is also drawn from the essential *Heyulie* power, except that it is what already is drawn forth and present, not that [the essential Heyulie] itself is drawn forth. However, for there to be a drawing forth of the essential *Heyulie* itself, this comes specifically through labor and toil.

This is like bringing fire out of a flintstone by specifically striking it. This then, is the matter of toiling in the study of Torah, in that specifically through laboring and toiling in Torah one thereby comes to the essence of Wisdom-*Chochmah* as it is in the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, literally.

This is as stated in Zohar,[65] "With toil in Torah, which is higher than the sun." That is, the sun of *HaShem*-יהו"ה shines in the way of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*). However, toiling in Torah is the aspect of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*) and it specifically is the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*) that rebounds to its original source, meaning that it literally reaches and draws from the Primordial Existence of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*).

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Now, with the above in mind, we can understand the verse, "Now, Avraham was old, coming on in days, and *HaShem*-יהו"ה blessed Avraham in all." This is because Avraham-אברהם is the aspect of the "Exalted Father-*Av Ram*-

[65] Zohar I 223b; Also see Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 30b (and Rashi there); Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 2 p. 383 and on; 5669 p. 210 and on; 5670 p. 189 and on; 5689 p. 219 and on.

אב רם,” referring to “intellect hidden from all conception” (*Sechel HaNe’elam MiKol Ra’ayon*). That is, it is the aspect of the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima’ah*) of the Crown-*Keter*, this being the concealed aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. Nonetheless, it is the concealed aspect of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*).

However, when it states, “*HaShem*-יהו״ה blessed Avraham in all-*BaKol*-בכל,” this means that he reached the aspect of the essential concealment (*He’elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is why it simply states, “in all-*BaKol*-בכל,” since this is the aspect of the essential concealment (*He’elem HaAtzmi*) from which the revelations are drawn forth in a limitless way and in a completely different manner. This is why the verse does not at all specify the particulars, since He specifically gave him the aspect of the essential concealment (*He’elem HaAtzmi*).

In contrast, the reason in the earlier blessings the particulars are specified, is because it is the aspect of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) and particulars apply there, as explained before that even the source is in the aspect of a limited power, and the revelation is according to the limitation of the source. In contrast, in the essential concealment (*He’elem HaAtzmi*) particulars do not apply at all, since it is a general unlimited essential power and thus all revelations drawn from it are in a way of limitlessness (*Bli Gvul*).

Now, Avraham attained this through his tests. This is as mentioned before, that to reach the aspect of the essential concealment (*He’elem HaAtzmi*) this comes specifically through toil, such as in-depth study and increased labor in Torah

- the toil of Torah. The same was so of Avraham, that it specifically was through his tests that he was given the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

This is also why the primary labor in this final exile is specifically through tests (*Nisyonot*), as the verse states,[66] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה your God is testing you." That is, in everything there are obstacles and obstructions. That is, [during this exile] "the way of the wicked prospers,"[67] whereas those who desire coming close to *HaShem*-יהו"ה face many obstacles and obstructions, up to and including obstacles and obstructions in the actual fulfillment of the *mitzvot*, and each obstacle must be overcome.

Likewise, one must be strong in actually fulfilling the *mitzvot* with full strength, without taking any obstacle or obstruction into consideration. However, specifically through doing so, in the coming future there will be the revelation of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One. The same was so with our forefather Avraham, peace be upon him, that specifically through the tests (*Nisyonot*) he reached the level of being given the aspect of the concealed essence (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

This then, is the meaning of the verse, "Now, Avraham was old, coming on in days." That is, he was an "elder who acquired Wisdom-*Chochmah*," akin to the verse, "*HaShem*-יהו"ה gave Wisdom-*Chochmah* to Shlomo," this being the aspect of the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the direct light (*Ohr*

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[66] Deuteronomy 13:4; Also see Likkutei Torah, Re'eh 19b and on; Derech Mitzvotecha 185b and on, and elsewhere.

[67] Jeremiah 12:1

Yashar) which was the strengthening of the essential power of his intellect. After this, "*HaShem*-יהו"ה blessed Avraham in all-*BaKol*-בכל," in that He gave him the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

This then, is the relation between the verse, "He shall do for whoever awaits Him," and the word "in all-*BaKol*-בכל." This is because "whoever awaits-*Mechakeh*-מחכה" means "those who are persistent with words of wisdom (*Chochmah*-חכמה)," this being the matter of toiling in Torah, because specifically through doing so we reach the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*). This is also the meaning of "*HaShem*-יהו"ה blessed Avraham in all-*BaKol*-בכל."

This then, is the meaning of the statement in Zohar there, "To what does 'in all-*BaKol*-בכל' refer to? To the place from which the flow of its waters are eternally unceasing." This is because in the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) there indeed is measure and limit, as mentioned before. However, Avraham was given the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*), and "all blessings come out from there," and the revelations are in a state of limitlessness, in that "its waters are eternally unceasing."

Discourse 11

"*VaYitein Lecha HaElokim… - May God give you…*"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Toldot, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

[In Yitzchak's blessing to Yaakov, the verse states],[2] "May God-*Elo"him*-אלהי"ם give you of the dew of the heavens." Concerning this the Midrash states,[3] "[The words], 'of the dew of the heavens' refer to Torah (*Mikrah*), 'and of the fat of the land' refers to Mishnah, 'grain' refers to Talmud, 'and wine' refers to Aggadah." Now, we must understand what blessing him with Torah means here. For, is it not so that the Torah was given to the Jewish people at the giving of the Torah? Moreover, *HaShem's*-יהו"ה original Supernal intent was for the Torah to be given to the Jewish people, as in the teaching[4] on

[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Psal Lecha*" 5632 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 1 p. 82 and on; p. 244 and on); 5634 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5634 p. 140 and on); Shaarei Orah 22b and on; Discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah SheB'Brachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 524 as cited in later notes. For the general content of this discourse also see the discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Machar Chodesh*" 5731 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 343 and on (Vol. 1 p. 113 and on in earlier editions), translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5731, Discourse 9); Discourse entitled "*v'Aseeta Chag Shavuot*" 5733 (translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5733, Discourse 31); Regarding the beginning and end of the discourse, see the discourse entitled "*Vayitein Lecha*" 5728 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid. p. 339 and on (Vol. 4 p. 63 and on in earlier editions), translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5728, Discourse 9).

[2] Genesis 27:28

[3] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 66:3

[4] Midrash Shemot Rabbah 48:2

the verse,[5] "These (*Eileh*-אלה) are the products [of the heavens and the earth]," that "In whose merit were these (*Eileh*-אלה) created and in whose merit are they sustained? In the merit of the verse,[6] 'These (*Eileh*-אלה) are the names of the children of Israel.' And in whose merit were these? In the merit of the verse,[7] 'These (*Eileh*-אלה) are the testimonies.'"

It likewise states,[8] "The Holy One, blessed is He, established a precondition with the act of creation, that 'if the Jewish people fulfill My Torah etc.'" We thus see that His primary Supernal intent in the creation and existence of the world was for the Jewish people to accept the Torah.[9] This being so, what is the meaning of Yitzchak blessing Yaakov with Torah?

We also must understand the order of the blessings, "of the dew of the heavens and of the fat of the land." This is because "the dew of the heavens" comes from above and is much loftier than "the fat of the land." Thus, at first glance, the blessing should have begun with "the fat of the land". This is because the usual way of stating such things is "not just this, but also this."[10] This being so, here too it should have first said, "an abundance of grain and the fat of the land" and then "and of the dew of the heavens."

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[5] Genesis 2:4

[6] Exodus 1:1

[7] Deuteronomy 4:55

[8] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 88a

[9] This being so, the matter of the giving of the Torah is an integral matter, and this being so, how is a blessing applicable to this? (See the discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Machar Chodesh*" 5731 ibid.)

[10] See Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 75a; Yevamot 19a, and elsewhere.

We also must understand[11] why the verse states, "May God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם give you." That is, at first glance, it should have used the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, being that all blessings and revelations are from the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה. This being so, why does it use the name God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם here?

Now to understand this, we must begin with the explanation before[12] on the verse,[13] "He shall do for those who await (*Mechakeh*-מחכה) Him," that it refers to "those who are persistent with words of wisdom (*Chochmah*-חכמה) and are exacting in them."[14] [It was explained] that the primary matter specifically is in-depth study (*Iyun*) and toil in Torah. That is, one does not [suffice with] understanding a Torah matter at first glance, but on the contrary, the matter is difficult for him and the more he delves into it, the more difficulties he discovers, until he comes to the depth of the intellect. It was explained that this is much higher than a person who has a sharp intellect and can to come to the matter at first glance, in that he does not arrive at the depth of the intellect and the truth of the matter as one does through toil, in that it specifically is through [toil] that one comes to [grasp] the true intention.

[11] Also see Torat Chayim Toldot 149a; Ohr HaTorah Toldot 161b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 65; 5684 p. 103; 5692 p. 147; 5700 p. 37 and on; 5702 p. 66.

[12] In the discourse that precedes this (entitled "*v'Avraham Zakein*").

[13] Isaiah 64:3

[14] Zohar I 130b

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However, all this is still unsettled, for is it not known[15] that the matter of toiling in the study of Torah in general was introduced at "the Waters of Strife" (*Mei Merivah*)[16] when Moshe struck the rock?[17] In doing so it was newly introduced that to come to its true intention one must toil in the study of Torah. For, he was told "speak to the rock,"[18] about which Yalkut states,[19] "Teach one chapter over it [and the rock will put forth its waters]." They then would not have needed to toil in Torah study at all.

However, by hitting it, it is as stated in Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 21 53b,[20] that "had he not hit it, the Jewish people, the Tana'im and Amora'im, would not have had to toil in the Oral Torah, which is the 'rock,' and it would have sent forth its waters without questions and disputes."

The explanation is that, as known,[21] in essence the Torah is the aspect of the Tree of Life, as the verse states,[22] "It

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[15] [In addition to Tikkunei Zohar cited in the discourse] also see Emek HaMelech Shaar Reisha d'Zeir Anpin, end of Ch. 9 [cited in Ohr HaTorah Chukat p. 832]; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Parshiyot Vol. 1 p. 225; Shaarei Orah 24a; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 4a.

[16] Numbers 20:13

[17] See Numbers 20:11

[18] Numbers 20:8

[19] Yalkut Shimoni Chukat, Remez 763-764, cited and explained in Ohr HaTorah Chukat p. 823; p. 829; p. 859; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 2 p. 378 and on; 5652 p. 60 and on.

[20] In the Mantoba-Amsterdam edition of Tikkunei Zohar; In our edition of Tikkunei Zohar see 44a.

[21] See Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 26 (142b; 144a); Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 2 p. 407; 5634 p. 94; 5643 p. 57; Kuntres Etz HaChayim Ch. 11 (p. 37 and on); Ch. 13 (p. 41 and on), and elsewhere.

[22] Proverbs 3:18

is a Tree of Life for those who hold onto it." Now, the Tree of Life has no admixture of evil or dross in it at all, and there thus is nothing at all that conceals and hides. Rather, the light of truth shines as is, without any toil or effort at all. About this the verse states, "speak to the rock," meaning "teach one chapter over it" only by speaking, without effort and toil.

Now, the reason that at the very least speech is necessary,[23] could possibly be understood based on the explanation elsewhere[24] about the ten *Sefirot* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). That is, Sefer Yetzirah states,[25] "Ten *Sefirot* without being, like a flame bound to the coal."

That is, it is analogous to the flame as it is in a [hot] coal, within which it is concealed, and to draw the flame out from its concealment into revelation, all that is necessary is to blow upon it with strength. The same is so, that through the breath of the mouth in speaking words of Torah, this being the aspect of "the speaking spirit" (*Ru'ach Memalela*),[26] there thereby is a drawing forth of the light of Torah from concealment to revelation.[27] This is as stated in Sefer Yetzirah, "Ten *Sefirot*…

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[23] At first glance it is not understood why speech is necessary in [the study of] Torah. Is it not so that Torah is the matter of understanding and comprehension, and thus, shouldn't thought alone be adequate? (See the discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Machar Chodesh*" 5731 ibid. translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5731, Discourse 9).

[24] See Likkutei Torah citated later in the discourse itself. Also see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Vayikra Vol. 2 p. 463 and on; Derech Mitzvotecha 184a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 1 p. 162; p. 265; p. 313.

[25] Sefer Yetzirah 1:5

[26] Targum Onkelus to Genesis 2:7

[27] The same is so of the Torah, that there must be the matter of speech in Torah, through which there is a drawing down from concealment into revelation. This is because, even from the perspective of the first Tablets, the Torah was specifically given below and not Above (as explained in the discourses on the teaching of our sages, of blessed memory, "When Moshe ascended on high"), and there must

like a flame bound to the coal… One is the breath (*Ru'ach*) of the Living God."

That is, through the breath (*Ru'ach*) there then is a drawing forth of the fire as well, this being the revelation of the aspect of the flame. All this is discussed in Likkutei Torah,[28] in the discourse entitled "*Kamiflegi b'Metivta d'Rakiya*."

Thus, it was through hitting the rock that the Torah was caused to descend and manifest in the aspect of the Tree of the Knowledge of good and evil, in which there is an admixture of dross that conceals and hides the light of truth. It therefore is necessary for there to be toil and effort until we arrive at the truth of the matter.

We thus find that the general matter of why toil is necessary in Torah study is that it is in way of punishment. This being so, how do we say that specifically through this we arrive at the depth of the matter and to a greater degree of truth, and that the knowledge brought about through toil is much better than one who arrives at it without toiling, in that he does not reach the truth of the matter to the same degree as through toil?

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Now, the explanation[29] is that we find a similarity to this in the first and second Tablets. That is, at the giving of the

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therefore be the matter of speech in Torah. (See the discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Machar Chodesh*" 5731 ibid. translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5731, Discourse 9).

[28] Likkutei Torah, Tazriya 23a

[29] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Psal Lecha*" 5632 & 5634 ibid.; Discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" 5677 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5677 p. 31 and on); 5689 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 57 and on);

Torah the Jewish people were on the level of righteous *Tzaddikim*, because "when the Jewish people stood at Mount Sinai their contamination ceased."[30] This came about through the revelation from Above, in that below there literally was a revealed illumination of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) as the verse states,[31] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה descended upon Mount Sinai," as a result of which their contamination ceased. That is, this did not come about through their own strength but was rather from Above.

Now, although [about the exodus from Egypt] the verse states that "the people fled,"[32] in that they fled from the evil, nevertheless, this was only in a way of self-restraint (*Itkafiya*), as stated in Tanya.[33] This likewise is so of the counting of the Omer, as known[34] that the refinement (*Birur*) is in a way of self-restraint (*Itkafiya*), whereas through the revelation from Above their contamination ceased.

However, it returned with the sin of the [golden] calf,[35] and they then were given the final set of Tablets through the matter of repentance (*Teshuvah*). This is why the [second set

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Sefer HaMaamarim 5706 p. 35 and on; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 420 and on; 5668 p. 129 and on.

[30] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 146a; Also see note 35.

[31] Exodus 19:20

[32] Exodus 14:5

[33] Tanya, Ch. 31 (40b)

[34] See Likkutei Torah Bamidbar 16d and elsewhere.

[35] This is as stated in Zohar I 52b; 126b; Zohar II 193b and elsewhere. With respect to what seems to be indicated in Tractate Shabbat (146a) and Avodah Zarah (22b), that it did not return, and this is similarly indicated in Zohar III (14b) – it is explained in Nitzutzei Orot there that it was not all their contamination that returned. Also see Chiddushei Aggadot of the Maharsha to Yevamot 103b; Torah Ohr Mishpatim, beginning of the discourse entitled "*Vayiru… Livnat HaSapeer*" (76d). However, this is not the place for further elucidation of this. (A note of the Rebbe in Igrot Kodesh, Vol. 5 p. 310.)

of Tablets] were given on Yom HaKippurim,[36] the day of repentance and forgiveness of sins. Still and all, their contamination did not cease, and they thus needed refinement (*Birur*).

Nevertheless, our sages, of blessed memory, stated in Midrash Shemot Rabbah 46:1, "This is the meaning of the verse,[37] 'He would tell you the secrets of wisdom, for His sagacity is manifold.' The Holy One, blessed is He, said to Moshe, 'Do not regret the first Tablets, as they were only the Ten Commandments alone. However, on the second Tablets that I am giving you there will be Midrash, Halachah, and Aggadah.'"

Now, at first glance, this is not understood, being that the level of the first Tablets was certainly loftier, as also explained in Talmud, Tractate Eruvin 54a, that "had the first Tablets not been broken, the Torah would never have been forgotten by the Jewish people, and no nation or tongue would ever have ruled over them." This is because the first Tablets were entirely of the front (*Panim*), whereas as known,[38] forgetfulness comes from the aspect of the back (*Achorayim*). Since the first Tablets were entirely front (*Panim*), [if they had not been broken] there would not have been forgetfulness at all.

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[36] See Midrash Tanchuma Tisa 31; Rashi to Exodus 33:11; 34:29, and elsewhere.

[37] Job 11:6

[38] See Ramaz to Zohar III 112a, cited in Ohr HaTorah, Na"Ch (Vol. 2) p. 1,085; Also see Torah Ohr Tetzaveh 85b; Likkutei Torah Bamidbar 18c; Sefer HaMaamarim 5653 p. 181 and on, and elsewhere.

(Although in Iggeret HaKodesh, in the Epistle beginning, "*Dovid Zemirot Karit Lahu*,"[39] it states that the final Tablets also had no front (*Panim*) and back (*Achor*), it can be suggested that had the Tablets not been broken there would not have been the aspect of a back (*Achor*) in all of Torah altogether. However, it was only in the final Tablets that there was no aspect of a back (*Achor*), whereas in general the Torah has the aspects of front (*Panim*) and back (*Achor*), as the verse states,[40] "It was written front and back.")

This is also the why no nation or language would be able to rule over them. For since they entirely were in the aspect of the front (*Panim*), there was no hold there [by the external forces] and they therefore could not have dominion over them altogether.

Although even now "there is no free man except one who is involved in Torah learning."[41] This refers to the [specific] individual occupied in Torah, that he is regarded as a free man. Nevertheless, with the first Tablets, no nation or language could have had dominion over the [entire] Jewish people. We thus see that the level [of the first Tablets] was much loftier than the final Tablets.

Now, in Likkutei Torah of the Arizal,[42] at the end of the Torah portion of Ki Tisa, it states that after the Jewish people sinned with the [golden] calf, Moshe's grasp was diminished,

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[39] Tanya, Kuntres Acharon 161a – regarding the coming section also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 29; Hagahot L'Dibur HaMatchil "*Patach Eliyahu*" SheB'Torah Ohr 5658 p. 2 and on (in the glosses).

[40] Ezekiel 2:10

[41] Avot 6:2; Also see Ohr HaTorah Tisa p. 2,022.

[42] In the discourse entitled "*Psal Lecha*" 5632 & 5634 ibid., here it cites "Torah Ohr, in the discourse entitled '*HaShamayim Keesee*'" (Bereishit 1b).

and all that remained of it was one part in a thousand [compared to his previous grasp], this being the mystery of the little letter *Aleph*-א of the word, "He called-*Vayikra*-ויקרא."[43]

Our sages, of blessed memory, hinted to this [in their statement][44] on the words,[45] "Go descend," that it meant, "Descend from your greatness, since I only gave you greatness for the sake of Israel." In other words, this is because the Jewish people are the aspect of Moshe's foot, as it states,[46] "Six hundred thousand foot-soldiers are the people in whose midst I am."

Nevertheless, in them and through them there is a drawing down to Moshe of the encompassing aspect (*Makif*) and the head, and those lights were not later refilled when the second Tablets were given, and it only is on Shabbat that they are given to him as a gift.[47]

Moreover, since the second Tablets are the product of Moshe's hands,[48] they certainly are of no comparison to the first Tablets which were the handiwork of God.[49] Even though the writing on the second Tablets was also "the script of God,"[50] nevertheless, there is a greater advantage in the first Tablets being the handiwork of God. That is, the reason that about the first Tablets there was no nation or language that could rule over

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[43] Leviticus 1:1; See Zohar I 234b; 239a

[44] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 32a; Also see Ohr HaTorah Tisa p. 1,988.

[45] Exodus 32:7

[46] Numbers 11:21

[47] Likkutei Torah of the Arizal ibid.

[48] See Exodus 34:1; 34:4; Deuteronomy 10:1; 10;3.

[49] Exodus 32:16 and Rashi there.

[50] Exodus 32:16 (in regard to the first Tablets); Also see Exodus 34:1; Deuteronomy 10:2; 10:4; Ohr HaTorah Tisa ibid. (p. 2,022; p. 2,057); Sefer HaSichot 5703 p. 1123; HaYom Yom for the 17th of Tammuz.

all the Jewish people is because they were the handiwork of God, as explained elsewhere.[51]

Now, in Tractate Nedarim 22b they said, "Had Israel not sinned, they would have only been given the five books of Torah and the book of Yehoshua, as the verse states,[52] 'For in much wisdom is much vexation.'" From this it is understood that the reason they were given much Torah is because of having sinned. However, at first glance, this is not understood, for if this is so, the sinner is rewarded, in that because they sinned they were given additional Torah. However, Rashi explains that "since they kicked and sinned, they were given an additional spirit of wisdom to perturb them all the more." However, this is not understood, being that this nevertheless is an increase in the abundance of Torah.

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Now, the explanation[53] is that the verse states,[54] "I *HaShem*-יהו"ה have not changed, and you the children of Yaakov have not expired." That is, the prophet is expressing astonishment that though[55] "I *HaShem*-יהו"ה have not changed,"

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[51] See the commentary of the Rif (Rabbi Yoshiyahu Pinto) to Ein Yaakov, Eruvin ibid., cited and explained in Ohr HaTorah Tisa ibid. p. 2,022.

[52] Ecclesiastes 1:18

[53] The discourses entitled "*Psal Lecha*" 5632 & 5634 cite "Torah Ohr, discourse entitled '*BaChodesh HaSheleeshee*'" (Yitro 67a and on); Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5567 p. 148; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 295; 5655 p. 90.

[54] Malachi 3:6 – regarding the coming section, also see Likkutei Torah Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah 61d and on.

[55] For variations of the wording here, see the discourses entitled "*Psal Lecha*" 5632 & 5634 ibid., and Torah Ohr Yitro ibid.

and this being so, how is it that "you the children of Yaakov have not expired" through contemplating that "I *HaShem*-יהו"ה have not changed," and that "You are He, before the creation of the world, and You are He, after the creation of the world,"[56] with no change whatsoever.

This is because the totality of the chaining down of the worlds (*Hishtalshelut*) is merely the aspect of a radiance that is of no relevance at all. This is because the entire coming into being [of the worlds] is from the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, in that "His Name is called King over them."[57] This is similar to one's name, which is insignificant in relation to his essential self, but is only significant to others, so that they may call him by his name. The same is so of the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*[58] which becomes the source of the worlds, that it merely is the aspect of a radiance and is entirely insignificant.

Now, in truth the verse states,[59] "His Name alone is exalted." That is, even the aspect of His Name is exalted alone, whereas in regard to the creation of the worlds it states,[60] "for the excellent works of Your hands," meaning that it only is "the works of Your hands," this being an even more external radiance than the aspect of His Name.

To further explain, in a person's name, though it is unimportant to himself, it nevertheless has some relation [to him], since he indeed turns toward whoever calls him by it.

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[56] See the liturgy of the morning prayers.

[57] See the liturgical hymn "*Adon Olam*."

[58] In the manuscript of this discourse there is a word here that is unclear. See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 116, note 58.

[59] Psalms 148:13

[60] In the *Yotzer* blessing of the morning prayers.

However, action has no relation to him altogether, being that one is not drawn after the works of his hands. In other words, this is a completely external radiance.

Now, through contemplating this a person should come to a state of expiry and yearning for Him, blessed is He, to be in a state that "but for You (*Eemcha*-עמך) I desire nothing,"[61] not even the aspect of "with You (*Eemcha*-עמך) is the source of life,"[62] since it only is "with You" (*Eemcha*-עמך) and secondary and nullified to You, because, "who do I have in the heavens," [referring to] the upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaElyon*).

That is, he desires nothing at all, not the lower and upper Gardens of Eden, nor the coming world (*Olam HaBa*), but solely the Unlimited One, the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic Being. This is because they all are merely a radiance, such that "I have not changed" at all by their existence. This being so, what should he desire? A separated radiance or His Essential Self, which is the essence and source of everything?

Thus, about this the prophet expresses astonishment. That is, how is it that you have not expired through the contemplation that "I *HaShem*-יהו"ה have not changed?" However, the reason is because you are the children of Yaakov-**יעקב**, which is of the same root as in the verse,[63] "The heart is the most deceitful of all-*Akov*-**עקוב**, and it is fragile," meaning weak, this being because of the weakness of the soul, in that it

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[61] Psalms 73:25; Also see Derech Mitzvotecha 138a; Torah Ohr Noach 9a; Toldot 17d; Likkutei Torah Emor 31c; Also see the previous discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 100), and elsewhere.

[62] Psalms 36:10

[63] Jeremiah 17:9; Also see Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 24d

does not have the strength to go out of imprisonment from its sheath to properly contemplate Godliness, meaning, to the point that it is sensed in his soul and he thereby is moved by it.

This is as in the verse,[64] "Because of my iniquity my strength has failed." That is, sins bring about the failure and weakening of the power of the soul, as the verse states,[65] "Rather, your iniquities have separated between you and your God." The word "**your** God-*Elo"heichem*-אלהיכ"ם" refers to the Godliness in the soul, like "*HaShem*-יהו"ה **our** God-*Elo"heinu*-אלהינ"ו".

Now, as known,[66] specifically the name "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם" is [sometimes] written as "**our** God-*Elo"heinu*-אלהינ"ו," that which is not found in the other names. This is because it specifically is the name "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם" that constricts to illuminate in the innerness of souls of the Jewish people, akin to the teaching,[67] "He constricted His Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) [between the two poles of the Ark]," as discussed in Likkutei Torah in the discourse entitled "*Mah Tovu*."[68] This also is the meaning of the verse, "Rather, your iniquities have separated between you and your God-*Elo"heichem*-אלהיכ"ם," such that Godliness is not sensed in the soul.

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[64] Psalms 31:11

[65] Isaiah 59:2; Also see the citations in note 68.

[66] See Likkutei Torah Nitzavim 53c

[67] See Midrash Tanchuma VaYakhel 7; Bereishit Rabbah, 5:7; Vayikra Rabbah 10:9; Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:14 (3); Likkutei Torah, Emor, 34b (in the name of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch); Ohr HaTorah, Chanukah, Vol. 5, p. 925a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632, Vol. 1, p. 48; p. 210, and elsewhere.

[68] Likkutei Torah, Balak 73b; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 p. 48; p. 210; 5654 p. 127 and on; 5658 p. 88 and on; 5678 p. 140 and on.

In truth, this is not only because of actual sins, for the physicality and materiality of the body also becomes a separating veil. This is because the word "sin-*Avon*-עון" is of the same root as "perverseness-*Eevoot*-עיוות" and crookedness, in that one's path has become crooked and he is drawn after the materiality of the body, thus separating between Godliness and the soul and causing a weakening of the soul.

This is like the teaching,[69] "The strength of the body is the weakening of the soul." That is, the strength of materiality weakens the soul, so that he becomes incapable of departing from and overcoming the materiality of the animalistic soul to properly contemplate and come to be in a state of love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He.

This is the meaning of the verse,[70] "You saw the poverty of our forefathers in Egypt," in that "there is no poverty except [poverty] in knowledge (*Da'at*)."[71] Now, Knowledge-*Da'at* divides into Kindness-*Chessed* and Might-*Gevurah*,[72] these being love (*Ahavah*) and fear (*Yirah*). This is the aspect of the above-mentioned desire and yearning brought about because they are in "Egypt-*Mitzrayim*-מצרים," referring to the "constraint-*Meitzar*-מיצר" of the body, which limits and garbs the soul to a very great degree.

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[69] See Zohar I 180b; 140b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5685 p. 207; 5709 p. 63; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 291 (Vol. 1 p. 34 in earlier editions), and elsewhere.

[70] Nehemiah 9:9; Also see Torah Ohr Yitro ibid. that "our forefathers" refers to the emotions of love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה etc., as Avraham is the emotional quality of love etc.

[71] Talmud Bavli, Ketubot 68a; Nedarim 41a

[72] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 34 (Shaar Tikkun HaNukva) Ch. 3; Tanya, Ch. 3 (7b); Ch. 41 (56b); Ch. 43 (62b) and elsewhere. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 32.

This is why the Torah was given to the Jewish people, because the Torah is called "Strength-*Oz*-עוז,"[73] in that it empowers and strengthens the Godly soul to overpower the materiality of the body and animalistic soul and their coarseness, to go out from imprisonment and captivity.

This is as stated,[74] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה will give strength (*Oz*-עוז) to his nation," meaning, through the Torah, which is called the "strength" (*Oz*-עוז), that He gives to his nation. He thereby "blesses them with peace-*BaShalom*-**ב**שלום," meaning "2-*Beit*-ב aspects of peace-*Shalom*-שלום,"[75] as in the teaching of our sages, of blessed memory,[76] "Peace (*Shalom*-שלום) in the upper entourage and peace (*Shalom*-שלום) in the lower entourage."

Now, peace (*Shalom*-שלום) is the aspect of bonding. Therefore, "peace in the upper entourage" refers to the actual revelation of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), blessed is He, in the Godly soul, to be bound and unified in a state of literal nullification (*Bittul*).

In contrast, "peace in the lower entourage" refers to the radiance of the powers of the Godly soul that manifest in the body and animalistic soul, so that there will be no obstruction or hindrance from the body and animalistic soul, but that they rather will be in agreement and desire this nullification (*Bittul*).

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[73] Midrash Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:4 (1); 2:3 (3); Midrash Tehillim to Psalms 8:3; Also see Talmud Bavli, Zevachim 116a; Vayikra Rabba 31:5; Yalkut Shimoni Beshalach, Remez 244; Sefer HaMaamarim 5687 p. 112; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 4 p. 59 (Vol. 1 p. 196 in earlier editions).

[74] Psalms 29:11

[75] See Torah Ohr, Ki Teitzei 22d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken Al Maamarei RaZa"L p. 458; Sefer HaMaamarim 5626 p. 298, and elsewhere.

[76] Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 99b; Midrash Bamidbar Rabbah 12:8; Also see Likkutei Torah Matot 85d and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 4.

This is because the Torah, which is called "strength" (*Oz*-עוז), is also called "counsel-*Tushiyah*-תושיה,"[77] in that it "weakens-*Meteshet*-מתשת" the power of the side opposite holiness stemming from the body. This is the matter of Torah in general, that it adds strength to the Godly soul and weakens the strength of the animalistic soul.

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Now, with the above in mind, we can understand the difference between the first Tablets, before the sin of the [golden] calf, and the final Tablets after the sin of the [golden] calf. That is, the first Tablets were like the general principles of the Torah. This is why they were only comprised of the Ten Commandments, or the five books of the Torah, meaning, only the Written Torah. This is Torah as it still is in a general state. This is because "the Torah came out of Wisdom-*Chochmah*,"[78] and Wisdom-*Chochmah* is the aspect of the general principle (*Klall*).

In contrast, the final Tablets included Midrash, Halachah, and Aggadah. The meaning of Halachah (Torah law) is that it includes every law with measure and precision. This is the matter of the particulars of Torah, in that every matter is explained in a particular way etc. Now, as known,[79] the

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[77] Mechilta to Exodus 15:2; Midrash Vayikra Rabbah 31:5; Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 26b; Midrash Tehillim 7:1, and elsewhere. Also see Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 22 (134a); Erchei HaKinuyim (by the author of Seder HaDorot), section on "*Tushiyah*-תושיה."

[78] Zohar II 62a; 85a; 121a; Zohar III 81a; 182a; 261a

[79] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 1 p. 211; Vol. 2 p. 449; Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Chag HaShavuot p. 167.

particulars are drawn specifically from the **Hidden** Brain (*Mocha Stima'ah*), which is higher than the general principles (*Klallim*) of Torah that [only] are from the Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is the aspect of the Measuring Line (*Kav HaMidah*), called "the dark flame" (*Botzina d'Kardunita*),[80] this being the Might-*Gevurah* of the Ancient of Days-*Atik Yomin* that manifests in the Hidden Brain (*Mocha Stima'ah*),[81] and causes all measurements, such as that a Sukkah must specifically be [at least] seven handsbreadths and a bit,[82] and the like. See the statement in Likkutei Torah on this, in the discourse entitled "*b'Sha'ah SheHeekdeemoo*."[83]

This is called "the hidden recesses of Wisdom" (*Ta'alumot Chochmah*), which is the depth of the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Hidden Brain (*Mocha Stima'ah*). This is like "the words of the scribes-*Divrei Sofreem*-דברי סופרים," that are rooted in the aspect of the "Author-*Sofer*-סופר" which are higher than the "book-*Sefer*-ספר," as explained in Likkutei Torah, in

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[80] Zohar I 15a; Zohar III 292b; Also see Tikkunei Zohar, beginning of Tikkun 5, "the dark flame that measures the oil"; Torah Ohr Mikeitz, in the explanation of the discourse entitled "*Hamagbeehee*" [39a]; Hosafot to Torah Ohr Shemot, discourse entitled "*Lehavin… Inyan Chalav uDvash*" Ch. 2 [107d and on] – note o the Rabbe in Sefer HaMaamarim 5710 p. 17.

[81] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 13 (Shaar Arich Anpin), Ch. 6-7; Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 24.

[82] See the note of the Rebbe to the discourse entitled "*MeEimatai Korin*" 5642 (printed as a pamphlet – Kehot 5725), p. 5, where it says, "This is as stated in various places – "and a bit." See Talmud Bavli, Sukkah 16b; Tur and Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chayim 634; Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 10. However, this requires further analysis. (For, seemingly, the "bit" is necessary, as "when a person sits, he occupies one cubit, and his table a handbreadth [i.e., there are six hands-breadths in a cubit, plus one handsbreadth is seven hands-breadths], and [another] handsbreadth cannot sit within a handsbreadth. Moreover, it should be noted (Sukkah 5a) that the smallest dimension of the vessels is a handsbreadth.)

[83] Likkutei Torah, Bamidbar 13b; Also see the explanation there on 14c.

the second discourse entitled "*Shechorah Ani*."[84] It therefore is called "abundant Wisdom" (*Rov Chochmah*) and "the hidden recesses of Wisdom" (*Ta'alumot Chochmah*).

Now, all this is for the purpose of refining the Tree of the Knowledge of good and evil. This is because the root of the refinements (*Birurim*) is specifically from the aspect of the Hidden Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*). That is, when they stated,[85] "It is with wisdom (*Chochmah*) that they are refined," this specifically refers to the Hidden Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*), as stated in Iggeret HaKodesh, in the section beginning "*Lamah Nismecha*."[86]

This then, is why after the sin of the [golden] calf they were given an abundance of Torah, since they had to affect the refinements (*Birurim*) of the Tree of the Knowledge of good and evil. They therefore were given much Torah, meaning the particulars of the Torah, which are from the aspect of the Hidden Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*).

That is, if not for the sin of the [golden] calf, the general aspect of Torah would have sufficed, being that their contamination had ceased and they required no further refinement. However, because of the sin of the [golden] calf, they were given an increase of much Torah, meaning all the

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[84] Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 7a; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 2 p. 545.

[85] See Zohar II 254b (Heichalot); Etz Chayim, Shaar 8 (Shaar Drushei Nekudot) Ch. 6; Shaar 18 (Shaar RaPa"Ch Nitzutzin) Ch. 5; Shaar 39 (Shaar Ma"N uMa"D) Drush 1; Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 20 (144b); Derech Mitzvotecha 31b; 66b; Ohr HaTorah Emor Vol. 3 p. 863; Sefer HaMaamarim 5708 p. 206; 5709 p. 55.

[86] Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 26 (148a).

particulars of the Torah, so that they thereby could affect the refinements (*Birurim*).

This then, is why over the course of time additional Torah was added, such as all the safeguards and protective fences of the precise enactments of the scribes. That is, we see that virtually the entire Talmud is full of laws and stringencies in that our sages, of blessed memory, enacted strictures and added various safeguards and protective fences to the Torah. All this was added in the time of the second Holy Temple.

Now, as known,[87] the safeguards, protective fences, and strictures instituted by our sages, of blessed, memory, are rooted very high above. This is as in the teaching of our sages, of blessed memory,[88] on the verse,[89] "Your love is more delightful than wine," that "the Congregation of Israel said before the Holy One, blessed is He, 'The words of Your scribes are more delightful to me than the wine of Torah."

The "wine of the Torah" refers to the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Torah, and as our sages, of blessed memory, stated,[90] "When wine enters, secrets emerge." However, the words of the scribes are sweeter to the Congregation of Israel (*Knesset Yisroel*) than the wine of Torah, meaning, the secrets of the Torah. This is because all the parameters and strictures in the words of our sages, and the ways of rebuke in the Aggadot and in Pirkei Avot, are drawn from the aspect of great love

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[87] See Torah Ohr, Shemot 52d; 53a and on; Likkutei Torah Drushim L'Chag HaSukkot 80b; Shir HaShirim ibid.

[88] Talmud Bavli, Avodah Zarah 35a

[89] Song of Songs 1:2

[90] Talmud Bavli, Eruvin 65a; Sanhedrin 38a; Tanchuma Shemini 5; Zohar III 39a

(*Ahavah Rabba*), as the verse states,[91] "I love you, said *HaShem*-יהו"ה."

This is analogous to a person who, out of his love for his son, is more exacting with him, and increases in safeguarding him with boundaries and protective fences to the greatest degree and by force, so that he will be clean of all. The same is so of the Holy One, blessed is He, that because of His great love for us, he is strict and exacting with us with the strictures of the scribes, which are themselves the words of His Torah as they are drawn down with great love into the safeguards and protective fences, to bring merit to us for our good, so that we will be clean before Him, blessed is He.[92] It thus is specifically through the safeguards and protective fences of the strictures of the scribes that there is a drawing forth of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) in the souls, since their root is specifically in the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*), as discussed before.

Now, during the time that the Holy Temple was standing, it sufficed with the [Written] Torah, since "our spirit was faithful to *HaShem*-יהו"ה,"[93] being that we did not draw "the bonds of the chords of our love"[94] into physical lusts. It thus was easy to be in a state of passion in serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה, even without an awakening of the love, (that is, the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*). Moreover, it also was not

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[91] Malachi 1:2

[92] In Likkutei Torah Matot ibid. it states, "See what is written on the verse '*Shechorah Ani v'Naavah*' [Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim ibid.], and also see Midrash Rabbah on the verse '*v'Ohavo Shicharo Musar.*'"

[93] See Psalms 78:8

[94] See Hosea 11:4

necessary to have such a great degree of protection, since they were far from evil and in a state of closeness to Godliness.)

However, generation after generation, as the hearts have diminished in their wholeness in serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה with love and flames of passion, and we have become scorched in the fire of alien love and bodily lusts, and they have overpowered us to such an extent, may the Merciful One save us, such that we are incapable of serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה without awakening our great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) through the strictures of the scribes and their stringencies in every detail, both in the aspect of turning away from evil according to all the stringencies discussed in the Talmud and the legal authorities (Poskim), as well as in doing good, with the words of rebuke (Musar) in the Aggadot and the words of our forefathers.[95]

The same is likewise[96] understood about the difference between the first Tablets and the final Tablets. That is, had the Jewish people not sinned with the [golden] calf, they would only have been given the five books of the Torah and the book of Yehoshua, and this would have sufficed to affect the refinements (*Birurim*).

This is because when the Jewish people stood at Mount Sinai, their contamination ceased, but they nevertheless required the strength and sagacity of the Torah. For, even

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[95] "Based on this we can explain the question on the beginning of Tractate Avot… that the teachings were not at all 'words of Chassidus' from all generations until the teachings of the men of the Great Assembly and Shimon HaTzaddik who was of the last of the men of the Great Assembly. For, it was only in that generation that there began to be a need for 'words of Chassidus.'" (See Likkutei Sichot Vol. 28 p. 283, in the glosses to note 48 – in explanation of Likkutei Torah Matot ibid.)

[96] Regarding the coming section also see Sefer HaSichot 5752 Vol. 2 p. 429 and on.

though it ceased, it nevertheless was not utterly nullified, in that this will specifically take place in the coming future.

However, through the sin of the [golden] calf, it returned. Therefore, to refine the aspect of the Tree of the Knowledge of good and evil, the final Tablets also comprise the Midrash, Halachot, and Aggadot, that are rooted in the Hidden Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*) and in the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*), for, "it is with Wisdom-*Chochmah* that they are refined." Thus, when it is necessary to affect more refinements (*Birurim*), it is imperative that there be a drawing from the aspect of the inner recesses of Wisdom (*Ta'alumot Chochmah*), this being the aspect of the Hidden Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*).

This then,[97] is the meaning of [Rashi's words, that this is] "in order to perturb them," in that the matter of "perturbing" them is the toil in the work of affecting refinements (*Avodat HaBirurim*), through which the blemish is repaired.

Had they not sinned they would not have needed this. However, due to the sin they required an abundance of Torah drawn from the loftiest of levels to affect the refinement. Nevertheless, specifically through the refinements (*Birurim*) there is caused to be a much greater ascent.

This is as stated,[98] "It shall be on that day that living [spring] waters shall flow out of Yerushalayim – referring to *HaShem's*-יהו"ה name of *Ba"N*-ב"ן-52 [יו"ד ה"ה ו"ו ה"ה] – half of it [will flow] to the Eastern Sea (*Yam HaKadmoni*) – referring

[97] Also see the discourses entitled "*Psal Lecha*" 5632 & 5634 ibid.
[98] Zachariah 14:8

to Understanding-*Binah*[99] or Wisdom-*Chochmah.*[100] This is as in the verse,[101] "Behold, My servant will become wise," specifically, thus affecting the refinement of the Name of *Ba"N*-ב"ן-52 [יו"ד ה"ה ו"ו ה"ה] and specifically through this, "he will be exalted, lofty, and exceedingly high."

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Now, just as there is a general difference between the first Tablets and the final Tablets, this being the general difference between the Written Torah and the Oral Torah, in that the Written Torah is the aspect of the general principle (*Klall*) of the Torah, whereas it is specifically in the Oral Torah that the particulars (*Pratim*) are specified. These [particulars] are on a very lofty level. This is [because they serve] to affect refinements, and it specifically is through the refinements (*Birurim*) that we reach a higher level, as discussed before. The same is so[102] of the Oral Torah itself, that there is a difference between Talmud Bavli and Talmud Yerushalmi.

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[99] See Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim), section on "Sea-*Yam*-ים"; Likkutei Torah, Chukat 63c; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 90d; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek p. 481; Ohr HaTorah Tisa ibid. p. 2,057.

[100] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5567 p. 310; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek; Ohr HaTorah Va'etchanan p. 248; p. 276; Sefer HaMaamari 5638 p. 440; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666, p. 695.

[101] Isaiah 52:13

[102] Regarding the coming section (until close to the end of the discourse) see Shaarei Orah of the Mittler Rebbe 22b and on; Also see the discourse entitled "*Chayav Inish L'Besumei*" 5681 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5681 p. 194 and on; 5708 p. 121 and on); Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 Vol. 1 p. 57 and on; Ohr HaTorah, Va'etchanan p. 75 and on; Vol. 6 p. 2,217 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 1 p. 25; p. 32; 5633 Vol. 2 p. 427 and on.

To explain, in Talmud Bavli the primary thing is the matter of sharp analysis with many questions and concealments until one arrives at the true reasoning. In contrast, Talmud Yerushalmi mostly consists of final legal rulings without the sharp analysis.[103]

The primary matter of sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) is that after the initial grasp of the matter, many questions are asked on it. These questions hide and conceal the light and revelation of the grasp, until one comes to reveal a higher grasp that answers all the questions. He then delves further into it and nullifies his second grasp through questions that he discovers in that grasp too, and the same applies to his third grasp, such that the matter remains in a state of concealment and hiddenness, in that the matter is completely beyond him as to how and what it is.

However, it does not remain in this state of concealment, but after all the concealment and lack of knowledge, he then comes to truly grasp the matter, through much toil and in-depth analysis (*Iyun*), in that he delves deeply into the essence of the matter with much greater depth. It is then that he discovers the true grasp of the depth and innerness of the matter, as to how and what it is, and through doing so, the questions and concealments are automatically removed, and the light of the truth radiates in very refined and brilliant way.

However, it is specifically the questions and concealments that caused him to arrive at the ultimate truth of the matter as it truly is. Furthermore, beyond the effect of the

[103] Also see Shaalot uTeshuvot of the Rambam (Yerushalayim 5694), Section 349 (note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5681 and 5708 ibid.)

questions, namely, [the advantage of the] fact that through concealment and hiddenness one thereby arrives at the inner depth of the concept, [there is yet another advantage]. For [if this were the only advantage, certainly] a person who has a better and sharper intellect would be able to come to the depth of the concept even without the concealment and hiddenness. The truth is, however, that through the concealment and hiddenness of the questions one reaches even higher.

This is because the power of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*) specifically reaches into the essential power of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, whereas the aspect of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) does not draw from there, as explained before (in the previous discourse).[104] However, there is another even greater element of superiority to this, in that through the questions he refines the dross that is mingled with the intellect, until the concept emerges clean and refined, with no admixture of dross in it at all, such that a higher light illuminates in it.

This is as we observe in the grasp of any matter, that when one asks questions on it, and answers them, the matter becomes clearer and more radiant for him and has a greater illumination of light. This is so even though no particular depth was added by the questions, except that it essentially becomes more radiant by asking questions and answering them.

This is because through doing so the dross mixed in the light of the intellect becomes refined, thus bringing more clarity and radiance in it. Therefore, in that very intellect itself, (even though no greater depth has been added to the intellect itself),

[104] In the previous discourse entitled "*v'Avraham Zakein*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 106 and on).

there is a greater illumination of light. This is because, when it comes to the light of the intellect as it comes by way of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*), since this is not the true light, there thus is still an admixture of dross in it, these being the questions. However, through asking questions with sharp analysis, as discussed before, one thereby refines all the dross in the intellect.

This is like pouring the wine through a sieve several times, in that each time removes sediment that is more refined, until the wine becomes completely refined and clean. The same is so of sharp analysis (*Pilpul*), the purpose of which is to remove the dross, done through many questions and answers, until the light of truth radiates. This is like a crucible for [the refinement of] silver,[105] in which the flame causes the agitation and admixture of the silver to ascend and descend, but thereby the dross is refined [out of it]. The same is so of sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) with many questions and answers, and the subsequent nullification of those answers etc., in that through this follows a radiance of the light of the truth as it is to its ultimate truth.

This then, is the meaning of [the teaching],[106] "[The words],[107] 'He has made me dwell in darkness' refer to Talmud Bavli," in that it is called darkness and concealment. This is because the primary matter of Talmud Bavli is sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) with many questions to darken and conceal the entire light of the grasp. This is because it is in a way of rebounding

[105] See Proverbs 17:3; 27:21
[106] Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 24a; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 24 p. 174.
[107] Lamentations 3:6

light (*Ohr Chozer*) from below to above, to conceal everything with concealment upon concealment.

However, the intention is not for to it remain in this state of concealment, but that through this, one reaches the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, from where there is a drawing down of a deeper light to remove all the concealments, this being because of the superiority of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*).

However, there also is another advantage in this, in that he refines and removes the dross, through which he reaches even higher than the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, meaning, to the aspect of Torah as it is in the true reality of His Essential Self, blessed is He, in which "man does not know it's worth,"[108] but "[only] God understands it's way."[109]

This is much higher than the light of Torah that is drawn forth in the aspect of a direct light (*Ohr Yashar*), which is what "man knows etc." In contrast in the aspect of the true reality of the light of Torah that is not in a state of being drawn down at all, it is "only God alone[110] who understands its way."

This refers to "the delight of the King in His Essential Self" (*Shaashu'ey HaMelech b'Atzmuto*).[111] That is, this aspect of "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם" refers to the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), which transcends the aspect of the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה that is in a

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[108] Job 28:13

[109] Job 28:23

[110] See Isaiah 64:3

[111] See the beginning of the previous discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 14); Also see the prior discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (p. 100).

state of revelation. Rather, this aspect of "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם" is literally the aspect of His essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*).

This then, is why the Torah is called "counsel-*Tushiyah*-תושיה," in that it "weakens-*Meteshet*-מתשת" the power of the animalistic soul. That is, this is specifically due to the root of the Torah, as it literally is in the aspect of His essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*). It is by this power that it repels the darkness of the animalistic soul, as explained in Likkutei Torah in the discourse entitled "*Ki HaAretz*" and in the explanation[112] of the verse,[113] "So will my Lord God-*Adona"y Elo"him*-אדנ"י יהו"ה cause righteousness and praise to sprout," (in which the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה is vowelized and pronounced as 'God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם').

It specifically is through the refinements (*Birurim*) in Torah that one reaches the true aspect of Torah as it literally is in the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*), this being the aspect of His essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*) which are higher than the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

This specifically is so of Talmud Bavli, in which the study is by way of sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) with many concealments and hiddenness so that it specifically illuminates out of the darkness. In contrast, Talmud Yerushalmi is mostly the final legal rulings and reasons for the laws as a received knowledge, but without many questions.

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[112] Likkutei Torah Nitzavim 51c and on; 52d and on.
[113] Isaiah 61:11

However, in truth it cannot be said that the Torah study of the sages of the land of Israel was only superficial, and that they did not reach the light of the truth, Heaven forbid. This is utterly impossible to say, but on the contrary, it states that "there is no Torah like the Torah of the land of Israel."[114] Rather, the explanation is as stated in Ra'aya Mehemna,[115] that all questions stem from the side of the external husks (*Kelipah*), and they are harsh judgments, but through asking and answering them one overcomes those judgments (*Gevurot*).

To further explain, as known[116] in the land of Israel influence is drawn from the world of Formation (*Yetzirah*), whereas outside the land of Israel it is drawn from the world of Action (*Asiyah*). As also known[117] the external husks (*Kelipot*) are primarily in the world of Action (*Asiyah*). This is why the sages decreed that the atmosphere outside the land of Israel imparts ritual impurity,[118] in that it is impure because of the shiny husk (*Kelipat Nogah*).

This is why outside of the land of Israel there cannot be an illumination of the light of truth except by way of many questions that darken and conceal the light, and through much sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) which refines all the dross and excess in this, this being the matter of refining (*Birur*) the shiny husk

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[114] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 16:4

[115] Zohar III 124b, cited in Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 26 (142a; 144b).

[116] See Mikdash Melech to Zohar III 94b (cited in Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 1 p. 22; p. 36); Likkutei Torah Masei 89b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 2 p. 374; 5678 p. 352; 5696 p. 113.

[117] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 43 (Shaar Tziyur Olamot ABY"A), end of Hakdamah L'Drush; Shaar 45 (Shaar HaKelipot) Ch. 3, and elsewhere.

[118] Talmud Bavli, Gitting 8b; Also see Likkutei Torah Masei, Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 and 5678 ibid.

(*Kelipat Nogah*), and specifically then one arrives at the light of the truth.

This is as the Arizal did,[119] that he would ask so many difficult questions on the Halachot, to the point of sweating, and through doing so he would break the power of the side opposite holiness (*Sitra Achara*) and the light of truth would illuminate.

In contrast, regarding the people of the land of Israel, where there is not such great concealment, it is easier to come to the light of the truth and [to do so] they have no need for many questions. This is because for them, the light shines in the way of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) without anything causing concealment. For example, in the Written Torah the light of Torah illuminates as it is in a state of refined wisdom, without requiring any further refinement, being that it already is refined from Above. It thus shines below in a state of revelation as the aspect of the light of truth, as explained elsewhere.[120] The same is so of Talmud Yerushalmi.

In contrast, outside of the land of Israel the light of Torah manifests through various concealing garments (the aspects of the straw and hay[121] of Torah) and it thus is necessary to refine and remove the concealments.

This then, is the element of superiority of Talmud Yerushalmi over and above Talmud Bavli. Namely, there is an illumination in it of the aspect of clear wisdom as it is Above in

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[119] See Likkutei Torah (Taamei HaMitzvot) of the Arizal to Parshat Va'etchanan; Shaar HaMitzvot there; Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Hanhagat HaLimud; Also see Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 3c.

[120] See Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe 111a; Torat Chayim Chayei Sarah 134a and on; Also see Torat Chayim ibid. 11b.

[121] See Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Hanhagat HaLimud Ch. 1; Taamei HaMitzvot, Parshat Va'etchanan; Hagahot HaRamaz to the end of Mevo She'arim, Hagahah 2.

a state of a very great revelation of light, beyond comparison to the revelation illuminating in Talmud Bavli, in which the light is concealed.

This is why it states that "every [Rabbi called] Rav-רב is from Babylonia, whereas every [Rabbi called] Rebbi-רבי is from the land of Israel,"[122] with the addition of the letter *Yod*-י, this being the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which in Talmud Yerushalmi illuminates in a revealed way.

Nevertheless, there also is an advantage to Talmud Bavli. Namely, that through the toil of clarifying the questions, one reaches the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Torah, [about which the verse states that] "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם understands its way," this being something that is not drawn down through the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*).

This is akin to a flintstone, the power of which [to bring out fire] is unlimited, but specifically is brought forth by [the toil] of striking it. The same is so that specifically through toil with many questions, with concealment upon concealment in a way of rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*) from below to Above, one thereby refines all the dross and excess [out of it] and reaches the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) from which there is a radiance of much deeper and

[122] End of Seder Tana'im v'Amora'im; Iggeret Rav Sherirah Gaon; Hakdamat Sefer HaTikkunin in manuscript form, cited and explained at the beginning of Shaar Maamarei Rashbi; Etz Chayim, Shaar 19, Ch. 3, explained according to Chassidus in Hosafot to Torah Ohr, Esther, discourse entitled "*Lehavin Lamah L'Atid*" Ch. 3 (see the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5681 & 5708 ibid.) [Also see the discourse entitled "*Bati LeGani*" 5736, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5736 Vol. 1, Discourse 15, Ch. 7.]

more inner light. (This is like [explanation about] the first Tablets and the second Tablets.)

Now, with the above in mind, it is understood that even though the requirement for toil in Torah study was newly introduced through Moshe striking the rock, such that the light of Torah was caused to descend and manifest within garments, and toil is necessary to refine the garments until one reaches the light of the truth, nonetheless, specifically through doing so a greater advantage is brought about, in that we literally reach the true light of Torah, as it is in its essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*), much higher than even the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

(Now, based on the above, being that Talmud Bavli is on such a high level, we must understand why Rav Zeira fasted one-hundred fasts to forget [Talmud Bavli].[123] Now, it may be suggested that this is similar to the soul, in that upon its departure from this world, in order to ascend from this world to the Lower Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaTachton*), it must immerse in the River of Fire (*Nahar Dinur*), as explained before.[124]

That is, even though in this world the soul was engaged in the work of affecting refinements (*Avodat HaBirurim*), it nevertheless must undergo this immersion. For, even though through the refinements (*Birurim*) the refinement of the sparks

[123] Talmud Bavli, Bava Metziya 85a; Also see Torah Ohr, Yitro 69c; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 2 p. 421, and elsewhere.

[124] See the previous discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 21).

of the world of Chaos-*Tohu* is caused, and as known,[125] there is a great advantage and great light in this, nevertheless, since[126] the one refining must don the garments of the one being refined, and the dross adheres to those garments, as in the verse,[127] "Their lifeblood spurted on My garments, so I soiled all My garments," therefore, for this a purification which requires passing through [the River of Fire-*Nahar Dinur*] is necessary.

The same may be suggested regarding engaging in Torah study with questions and concealments, which stem from the external husks (*Kelipot*). Namely, it is because of this that although through them one comes to a higher level, nonetheless, this [activity] requires manifestation within the garments of the shiny husk (*Kelipat Nogah*), and purification is therefore required, for if not, confusion is caused.

However, based on this [answer], this is only because of the garments, whereas according to the explanation before (in the discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom*")[128] it is because of the grasp one comes to in the [study of] Talmud Yerushalmi. It perhaps is because of this that there is the grasp of Torah as it is in a state of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*). For, in Talmud Bavli there also are [both] aspects of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) and rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*).

However, the grasp of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) as it is in Talmud Bavli is of no comparison to the grasp of the direct

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[125] See Torah Ohr Vayishlach 25d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 353; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek, Vol. 2 p. 841, and elsewhere.

[126] Regarding the coming section see Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 277 and on; 5629 p. 190 and on; 5658 p. 172 and on.

[127] Isaiah 63:3

[128] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 18 and on.

light (*Ohr Yashar*) as it is in Talmud Yerushalmi, as explained before. Nevertheless, it certainly is so that Rav Zeira also had the aspect of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*). For as known, Rav Zeira was incisive and raised pertinent difficulties, as stated in Talmud at the end of Tractate Horayot,[129] this being the matter of sharp analysis (*Pilpul*).

Now, based on the explanation elsewhere[130] about the difference between being "incisive and asking pertinent questions" and being "patient and drawing correct conclusions," the matter of being "incisive and asking pertinent questions" is that because of the great sharpness in asking questions, even though this is a great level, nevertheless, after descending into such ultimate darkness as this, he is incapable of arriving at the true ruling and law as it is according to the truth of the Torah.

In contrast, one who is "patient and draws correct conclusions" is also "incisive and asks pertinent questions," however his descent into the sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) is specifically to engage in the study for the purpose of arriving at the correct Halachic ruling.[131] (See Rashi to Horayot ibid.,[132]

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[129] Talmud Bavli, Horayot 14a, "Rav Zeira is incisive and raises pertinent questions, whereas Rabba bar Rav Mattana is patient [and not so incisive] but draws correct conclusions." Rashi there explains that Rav Zeira "is incisive and raises pertinent questions through a greater degree of sharp analysis (*Pilpul*), posing questions and answering them, whereas Rabba bar Rav Mattana was not as incisive, but because he would patiently analyze everything very well, he would draw the correct Halachic conclusions."

[130] See Shaarei Orah ibid. 23a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5681 ibid. (p. 196 and on); 5708 ibid. (p. 123 and on), and the note of the Rebbe there.

[131] See Talmud Bavli, Yoma 26a; Sotah 21a; Bava Kamma 92a; Sanhedrin 106b.

[132] See Rashi to Horayot 14a ibid., quoted in the preceding note.

as well as Tosefot HaRosh as cited in Ein Yaakov.)[133] Based on this, the matter is resolved.

It may also be suggested that in regard to the revelation of light there is a greater superiority to Talmud Yerushalmi. Whereas in the sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) of Talmud Bavli, although one reaches the true reality of the Essential Self of the Singular Preexistent Intrinsic and Unlimited One, nevertheless, this will primarily be revealed in the coming future,[134] when the Torah will be revealed as it is in the aspect of His essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*).)

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This then,[135] is the meaning of the verse, "He shall do for whoever awaits (*Mechakeh*-מחכה) Him," referring to "those who are persistent with words of wisdom (*Chochmah*-חכמה), and are exacting in them, and patient (*Mechakan*-מחכאן) with them, to come to know [the meaning of] their words with clarity."

That is, it specifically is when one is exacting in engaging in Torah study, with much work, labor, and toil, to

[133] Kuntres Etz HaChayim Ch. 29 (p. 56) cites this in the name of the Rosh [which refers to Tosefot HaRosh to Horayot ibid., section beginning "*Eebaya Lahu*"] and Rashi, that Rav Zeria would also arrive at the correct Halachic conclusions. The same is likewise stated in Shaarei Orah ibid. (Also see Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 18 p. 380); Also see the note of the Rebbe to Sefer HaMaamarim 5681 and 5708 ibid. However, in HaKoteiv to Ein Yaakov he cites the RaMa"H [Rabbi Meir HaLevi] that "Rav Zeira… did not know how to engage in the study in a way of arriving at the correct Halachic conclusions."

[134] Also see Sefer HaSichot 5752 Vol. 2 p. 430, note 83.

[135] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 ibid. p. 524.

delve very well into it, to come to the true intention by asking many questions, clarifying everything in a way of rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*), that he thereby returns to its original source in the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*).

This is analogous the toil in working a field, that when one toils with great labor in working the soil and preparing it by removing whatever can obstruct the growth, until the field is in a state of repair, it then will grow with much greater abundance and he will see great success and goodness in his work. This is as stated,[136] "He who works his soil" – specifically with toil and labor – "will be sated with bread" – in an unlimited way.

The same is so of in-depth study (*Iyun*) into the words of the Torah with all one's intellectual strength, to the point of being perturbed over it, and toiling[137] with all his effort, specifically spending much time on each matter, in that he specifically desires to truly grasp the light of its truth by refining all the dross [out of it].

Through this he will come to its true depth, with depth after depth, until every concealment is revealed for him. This is because he toils in the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*), and the drawing down from there is the aspect of revelations in a state of limitlessness (*Ein Sof*).

This then, is the aspect of Eden itself, which is as Torah is in "the delight of the King in His Essential Self," which "no eye has seen" within all the revelations of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) of the Torah, nor is it grasped by even the loftiest souls in the Upper Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden HaEylon*), but "only

[136] Proverbs 12:11; 28:19
[137] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee ibid.

God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם [has seen it]," and "only God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם understands its way," and "He will do for those who await (*Mechakeh*-מחכה) Him," meaning, "those who are exacting with words of wisdom (*Chochmah*-חכמה)."

Even though the "Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Torah is found from the nothing-*Ayin*"[138] of the Crown-*Keter*, from which it comes forth from concealment into revelation, nevertheless, this toil in being exacting and asking questions on everything to a great degree is the ascent that awakens the essence of Eden, adding additional abundance of strength to grasp the concealed of the concealed and the hidden of the hidden who "no thought can grasp,"[139] and "no eye has seen," even [the sight] of the Primordial Wisdom (*Chochmah HaKedooma*).

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Now, with the above in mind, we can understand the verse, "May God-*Elo"him*-אלהי"ם give you of the dew of the heavens," which [Midrash states] refers to Torah (*Mikrah*). That is, at first glance, why did Yitzchak bless Yaakov with Torah, for the Torah was given to the Jewish people [at Sinai]?

However, the explanation is that when it states that the Torah was given to the Jewish people, this refers to how it is in the aspect of a direct light (*Ohr Yashar*).[140] This is as explained

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[138] See Job 28:12

[139] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a

[140] That is, the Torah given at the giving of the Torah was the aspect of the Torah as it is in and of itself. However, the blessing of Yitzchak was in regard to the matter of toiling in Torah study. (See the discourse entitled "*Vayomer… Machar*

before about the first Tablets, that they are the general aspect (*Klallut*) of Torah, as "the Torah came out of Wisdom-*Chochmah*." That is, this is as the Torah is in a state of clear Wisdom-*Chochmah* and is drawn down in a way of a direct light (*Ohr Yashar*).

In contrast, with the final set of Tablets the Midrash, Halachot, and Aggadot were given, these being the particulars (*Pratim*) of the Torah rooted in the aspect of the hidden recesses of Wisdom (*Ta'alumot Chochmah*). Moreover, the intention is to thereby be able to affect refinements (*Birurim*), by which we reach even higher than the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

Now, these blessings were to thereby be able to affect refinements (*Birurim*). For, as known,[141] Yitzchak wanted to bless Esav, so that Esav would thereby become refined in and of himself. However, he erred in this, since the refinements (*Birurim*) had to come specifically through Yaakov. It thus is in this regard that there is the matter of blessings, in order to refine.[142]

Chodesh" ibid. 5731 (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 343 and on (Vol. 1 p. 113 and on in earlier editions), translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5731, Discourse 9)

[141] See Torah Ohr, Toldot 20b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 1 p. 26 and on; 5654 p. 65 and on; 5684 p. 103 and on; 5702 p. 66 and on; Also see the discourse entitled "*VaYitein Lecha*" 5728 ibid. (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket ibid. p. 339 and on (Vol. 4 p. 63 and on in earlier editions), translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5728, Discourse 9).

[142] With this in mind we can also understand Yitzchak's thought process in wanting to bless Esav, in order that he be refined, (this being why he blessed him with Torah, in that he thought that he would thereby be refined in and of himself). For, at first glance, how does this fit with what took place in actuality (since our forefathers are themselves the Supernal Chariot (*Merkavah*)). That is, in actuality, the blessings were given to Yaakov, and this being so, what is the matter of blessing Yaakov with the Torah etc. However, it is through the blessings by which he blessed

This then, is the meaning of, "of the dew of the heavens and of the fat of the land, and an abundance of grain," referring to Mikrah, Mishnah, and Halachot, that is, specifically the particulars (*Pratim*) of the Torah, because through this empowerment he is able to refine Esav. Then, through the refinements (*Birurim*) there literally will be the revelation of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) and His essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*).

This is why he said, "May God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם give you," meaning, that which is indicated by the verse, "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם understands its way," this being the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) from which the power to affect refinements (*Birurim*) is drawn, as discussed before. This then, is the meaning of "May God give you," that he gave him this aspect and level. In Midrash Rabbah[143] it also states, "May He give you His Godliness," meaning, the aspect of His essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*).

This then, is the meaning of the words "of the dew (*Tal*-טל) of the heavens, for as known, "dew-*Tal*-טל-39" is the aspect that is drawn down from Above, this being the aspect of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) of the Torah. In contrast, the aspects of Mishnah, Halachot and Aggadot, are the particulars (*Pratim*)

Yaakov in the matter of toiling in Torah study, that he thereby granted him the empowerment to refine Esav. For, since it is through the toil that we draw from the aspect of Eden, he therefore is able to refine not only the aspect of the shiny husk (*Kelipat Nogah*), but even the sparks of the three completely impure husks (*Shalosh Kelipot HaTemei'ot*) etc. (See the discourse entitled "*Machar Chodesh*" 5731 ibid. (Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 1 p. 343 and on (Vol. 1 p. 113 and on in earlier editions), translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5731, Discourse 9).

[143] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 66:3

of the Torah, that are from the aspect of the hidden recesses of Wisdom (*Ta'alumot Chochmah*).

The primary refinement of the laws is in the Mishnah, as well as in the Aggadot, which are of the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*), as discussed before. This then, is the meaning of "May God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם give you," in that he blessed him with Torah, meaning as it is in a way of rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*). It thus states, "May God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם give you," so that he will be empowered to affect the refinements (*Birurim*), and through doing so bring about a revelation of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), literally.

Discourse 12

"*Vayeitzei Yaakov… -*
Yaakov departed…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Vayeitzei, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "Yaakov departed from Be'er-Shova and went to Charan." Now, we must better understand this, for did it not already state,[3] "He went to Paddan-Aram"? Why then does it repeat, "Yaakov departed… and went etc."? About this Midrash Rabbah states,[4] "[Before this] it already is written,[5] 'Yaakov obeyed his father and mother [and went] etc.' Why then does this verse state, 'Yaakov departed from Be'er-Shova'? It rather is that he said [to himself], 'When father sought to leave the land of Israel, from where did he seek permission? Was it not from Be'er-Shova? I too will go to Be'er-Shova. If I will be given permission, I will leave, but if

[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*Lehavin Mah SheB'Brachah… Mesame'ach Chatan v'Kallah*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 2 p. 524 and on; Discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 3 p. 1,120 and on, as cited in later notes. For the beginning and end of the discourse, see the discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei Yaakov*" in Ohr HaTorah Vayeitzei p. 172a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 29 and on; 5680 p. 168 and on.

[2] Genesis 28:10

[3] Genesis 28:5

[4] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 68:5

[5] Genesis 28:7

not, I will not leave etc.'" We therefore must understand the matter of receiving permission specifically from Be'er-Shova.

Now, about why the city is called "Be'er-Shova-באר שבע" we find two matters. About Avraham it is written,[6] "Therefore that place was called 'Be'er-Shova-באר שבע' because there the two of them took an oath-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה." About Yitzchak it is written,[7] "And he named it 'seven-*Sheevah*-שבעה'; therefore, the name of the city is 'Be'er-Sheva-באר שבע' until this very day." That is, this was the seventh well (*Be'er*-באר) [that he dug]. For, there were the first three dug by Avraham which the Philistines stopped up and he dug up again, and there then were his three wells, and this was the seventh well.

Now, in the commentary of our Rabbi and master, Ovadia Seforno,[8] it states that in the times of Avraham the city was called "Be'er-Shova-בְּאֵר שָׁבַע" with a *Komatz*-קָמָץ vowel, the meaning of which is "oath-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה," whereas in the times of Yitzchak it was called "Be'er-Sheva-בְּאֵר שֶׁבַע" with a Segol-סֶגוֹל vowel, which means "oath-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה" and also means "seven-*Sheva*-שבע." Based on this, we must understand why here it states "Be'er-Shova-בְּאֵר שָׁבַע" with a *Komatz*-קָמָץ vowel, for is it not so that he departed from the "Be'er-Sheva-בְּאֵר שֶׁבַע" [in the time] of Yitzchak? This being so, the verse should have said "Be'er-Sheva-בְּאֵר שֶׁבַע" with a Segol-סֶגוֹל vowel.

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[6] Genesis 21:31

[7] Genesis 26:33

[8] Seforno to Genesis 26:33 ibid., cited in the discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei*" in Ohr HaTorah and in Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 and 5680 ibid.

Now, Midrash[9] explains that the word "Be'er-Shova-באר שבע" denotes an "oath-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה," and that it states there, "'from Be'er-Shova-באר שבע' meaning, 'from the well of the oath-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה.'" Matnot Kehunah explains,[10] "From the root and source of oaths-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה," meaning from the depth of the oath. We therefore must understand what the relation is between the matter of the oath (*Shevu'ah*-שבועה) and our subject here, and what the matter of "the depth of the oath" is.

Now, to understand all this, we must begin with the explanation before[11] on the verse,[12] "He shall do for whoever awaits (*Mechakeh*-מחכה) Him," referring "to those who are exacting with words of wisdom (*Chochmah*-חכמה)."[13] That is, the aspect of Eden that will take place in the coming future, meaning, the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), is [attained] specifically through precision and in-depth study (*Iyun*) in Torah. It is specifically in this way that we reach the actual essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*).

[9] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 68:7

[10] Matnot Kehunah to Bereishit Rabbah ibid.

[11] In the previous discourses (entitled "*v'Avraham Zakei*" and "*Vayitein Lecha*").

[12] Isaiah 64:3

[13] Zohar I 130b

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However,[14] this still must be better understood. For, based on the explanation before, the entire matter of Eden and the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) is solely for those who are engaged in sharp analysis (*Pilpul*) and precision in the wisdom of Torah. However, in truth, our sages, of blessed memory, stated,[15] "Every Jew has a portion in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*)." Thus, even the unlearned and simple folk who have no relation to engaging in Torah study, and especially to the matter of sharp analysis (*Pilpul*), will also merit Eden and the coming world (*Olam HaBa*).

Another matter we must understand is that it was explained before[16] that the primary revelation of Eden in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) is brought about solely through *mitzvot* fulfilled in action, in that they are the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) and essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) and for a desire (*Ratzon*) there is no reason (*Taam*), not even a hidden reason (*Taam Kamus*).[17]

This is why every Jew has a portion in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*), even the unlearned. That is, through them fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality, they thereby cause a drawing forth of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) as it is in the

[14] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah ibid. For the answer to these questions see the end of the discourse entitled "*VaHaShem Amar HaMechaseh Ani*" 5667 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 536).

[15] Mishnah Sanhedrin 10:1; Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 90a (Perek Chelek).

[16] In the discourse entitled "*Shuvah Yisroel*" until the discourse entitled "*Eileh Toldot No'ach.*"

[17] See the discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 49 and on).

innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*).

It was explained that this is because the essential desire and pleasure do not come as composites with other matters. They thus are not drawn forth in the intentions (*Kavanot*) of the *mitzvot* which are aspects of reason and intellect. They rather, [are drawn forth] in *mitzvot* fulfilled in action through accepting the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom, which is not a composite with anything else. This is because the action in actual deed is not in the category of being a receptacle or having any relation to this, (as explained before in the discourse entitled "[*Eileh*] *Toldot Noach*").[18]

Based on this, it is very astonishing that through precision and in-depth analysis of words of wisdom one reaches the aspect of Eden. This is because the matter of in-depth study entirely relates to the reasoning of the matter, to come to know its true intention, as discussed before. This being so, how can this reach the essential pleasure and desire, which does not come as a composite with any reasoning or intellect?

Of further astonishment is the verse,[19] "I was with-*Va'Eheyeh*-ואהי"ה Him as His delights," in that the Torah is the essential delight (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One. However, is it not so that Torah is the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as in the teaching,[20] "The Torah came out of Wisdom-*Chochmah*," such that until the highest levels, Torah is the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, up to

[18] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 75 and on.
[19] Proverbs 8:31
[20] Zohar II 62a; 85a; 121a; Zohar III 81a; 182a; 261a

the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*)? However, being that it is the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, how then is it the aspect of His essential delight (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*), which is not a composite with Wisdom-*Chochmah*?

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However,[21] the explanation is that when it states, "He shall do for whoever awaits… to those who are exacting etc.," the primary matter in this is in-depth study (*Iyun*) and precision, this being the aspect of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*) that returns to its first source. Even though this is to know the true intention with the reasoning and intellect for the matter, and this being so, how can it reach His Essential Self, nonetheless, since this is done through the power of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*) it thus reaches His Essential Self.

This is akin to the flintstone, in that specifically through striking it fire is drawn forth from its essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) in which it has no existence whatsoever. The same is so that through in-depth study (*Iyun*) in concealment after concealment, with many challenging questions, one reaches the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*).

However, at first glance, all this is only in the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This

[21] Regarding the coming section, see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah ibid. p. 526.

being so, what relation does it have to the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) which is not a composite?

Now, the explanation is that, as known,[22] the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*. That is, it is not that Wisdom-*Chochmah* **receives** from the Ancient One-*Atik*, but rather it itself literally **is** the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*. (For, in truth, about the essence of the Ancient One-*Atik*, it does not apply to say that Wisdom-*Chochmah* receives from there. For, as known,[23] every matter of "receiving" is merely that of a ray and radiance.

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[22] See the note of the Rebbe (Sefer HaMaamarim 5700 p. 49 and on; Kuntres Limud HaChassidus p. 6 [printed in Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe Rayatz, Vol. 3 p. 335 and on]; Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2 p. 198), "See the citations in Likkutei Torah [Nitzavim 49d] in the explanation of the discourse entitled '*Sos Asees*,' end of Ch. 3." He continues to point out that "in various places we find the language, 'The inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [i.e., Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is the inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*,' and in various places that it is 'the external aspect (*Chitzoniyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*.'" He concludes that "it seems that we can align what is stated above with what is stated in the discourses entitled '*Vayeitzei*' and '*Vayishlach*,' and the discourse entitled '*HaShamayim Keesee*' (**in *Hemshech* 5666**) that 'the inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [i.e., Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is the inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*' refers specifically to pleasure that is felt (*Taanug Murgash*), and even this ascent will only take place in the coming future… however the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) also does not come into the inner aspect (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [i.e., Wisdom-*Chochmah*]." He continues that "further insight can be gleaned from the discourses of the Siddur, Vol. 2, in Seder Seudat Shabbat [204c; Also see Igrot Kodesh of the Rebbe, Vol. 2 p. 232]; From the end of the discourse entitled '*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*' 5696 [Sefer HaMaamarim 5696 p. 9]; Also see the end of the discourse entitled "*Samach TeSamach*" 5657 [Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 266 and on]." In regard to this matter also see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Kuntreisim p. 425 and on; Ohr HaTorah Lech Lecha (Vol. 4) p. 728a; Nitzavim p. 1,275 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5660 p. 60 and on; 5672-5676 p. 25; Discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" 5691 Ch. 4 and on (Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 p. 84 and on).

[23] See Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 2a and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek Vol. 2 p. 613; Derech Mitzvotecha p. 3a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 Vol. 2 p. 602 and on; 5657 p. 267; 5659 p. 3; Also see Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim 39d, and elsewhere.

For example, as known, the bestowal of intellect from a teacher to his student is only the aspect of a radiance.[24] Thus, that which the student receives is merely a radiance. However, since the essence of the Ancient One-*Atik* is the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*), therefore, [being that][25] every essence is neither drawn forth nor expressed[26] to be the revelation of a light and ray, there rather is a drawing of the actual Essential Self.

However, when it states that the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*, this means that it literally is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*, not that there is a drawing forth in this of the essence. This is because even in the matter of bestower and recipient,[27] there also is such a thing as essential bestowal, such as the bestowal in begetting [a child] similar to oneself, which is an essential bestowal.

However, this is when there is a bestower and recipient, in which the recipient is an entity unto himself and receives the bestowal. However, here it is not that Wisdom-*Chochmah* receives from the essence of the Ancient One-*Atik*, but that the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* itself literally **is** the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*.)

This is as known and explained elsewhere,[28] that in the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), the

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[24] See the citations in the preceding note.

[25] See Moreh Nevuchim Part 1, Ch. 51 and elsewhere; Also see the beginning of the prior discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*" (p. 36).

[26] In the manuscript it is not clear whether this word was erased or not.

[27] See Biurei HaZohar ibid.; Derech Mitzvotecha ibid.; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640, 5657, 5659 ibid.; Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim ibid.

[28] See *Hemshech* "*v'Kachah*" 5637, Ch. 23 (p. 27 and on); Ch. 32 (p. 43).

aspect of the "nothing-*Ayin*-אין" within Wisdom-*Chochmah*-חכמה, meaning, the aspect of "What-*Ma"h*-מ"ה" within it, is literally the "nothing-*Ayin*-אין" of the Crown-*Keter*, about which the verse states,[29] "Wisdom is found from nothing-*v'HaChochmah MeAyin Timatzeh*-והחכמה מאין תמצא."

That is, it is akin to finding something (*Metziyah*-מציאה), in which what was lost by one person is found by another person, but there is no change in the essential being of the object itself, except that it has been transferred from one domain to another domain.

The same is so of the "nothing-*Ayin*-אין" of Wisdom-*Chochmah* "found" from the "nothing-*Ayin*-אין" of the Crown-*Keter*. That is, it itself is actually the "nothing-*Ayin*-אין" of the Crown-*Keter*, only that it now is found with the emanations, and thus was not given for enjoyment at all[30] and completely transcends grasp and comprehension, meaning that it does not at all come to be grasped. This is because it literally is the "nothing-*Ayin*-אין" of the Crown-*Keter*.

The same is so of the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*). That is, the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*) is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-*Keter*, as known[31] about the two aspects of concealment in the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*).

The first aspect only is that which is concealed from the recipients, meaning that it already has some measure of relation

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[29] Job 28:12

[30] See Likkutei Torah Tzav 11d; *Hemshech* "*v'Kachah*" 5637 Ch. 23 ibid.; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 3 p. 1,253.

[31] See Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefillin, Ch. 183a and on; Also see earlier in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 16.

to the recipients, except that [as of yet] the recipients are incapable of receiving the revelation, but it nevertheless is possible for it to be revealed. The second aspect is that which is concealed in and of itself, meaning that it altogether is not in the category of being revealed, and it will never be revealed.

This itself is the difference between the Ancient One-*Atik* and the Long Patient One-*Arich*. That is, the Long Patient One-*Arich*[32] is the head and source of the emanations, and this being so, it relates to being revealed to them, except that it transcends actual revelation within the emanated.

In contrast, the Ancient One-*Atik*[33] is the lowest aspect of the Emanator, who altogether is beyond relation to the emanations. It is called "Ancient-*Atik*-עתיק" which is of the same root as in the verse, "He uproots-*Ma'atik*-מעתיק mountains,"[34] in that it is "removed-*Ne'etak*-נעתק" and separately transcendent from them.

The same is so of the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*), in that the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*) is altogether beyond relation to the recipients, for as explained elsewhere,[35] the primary

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[32] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A) Ch. 1; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5570 p. 78; Ohr HaTorah, Beshalach p. 572; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 1 p. 136; *Hemshech* "*Mayim Rabim*" 5636 p. 157 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 193 and on, and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24.

[33] See the citations in the preceding note.

[34] Job 9:5; Also see Likkutei Torah, Chukat 67b; Derech Mitzvotecha 39a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5638 p. 314; 5658 p. 198 and on.

[35] See Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefilin 182c and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 399 and on; p. 452 and on; Discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" 5731 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5731 p. 336, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5731, Discourse 5), and elsewhere; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 8a.

intermediary between the Emanator and the emanations is the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*).

This is because every intermediary must include two levels, and the same is so of the intermediary between the Emanator and the emanations, in that it has the lowest aspect of the Emanator and it also has the aspect of the head and source of the emanations. In general, this is the Crown-*Keter*, which includes both the Ancient One-*Atik* and the Long Patient One-*Arich*,[36] these being the two above-mentioned aspects, as explained before. However, in the Crown-*Keter* these are two distinct statures (*Partzufim*).

In contrast, the primary intermediary is the aspect of the Concealed Wisdom (*Chochmah Stima'ah*), which is a single level that includes the two above-mentioned levels. That is, its externality (*Chitzoniyut*) relates to the emanations, whereas its innerness (*Pnimiyut*) is beyond relation to the emanations, similar to the essence of the Ancient One-*Atik*.

Now, as known,[37] the Ancient One-*Atik* is the aspect of pleasure (*Taanug*). This being so, since the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*, it thus is the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) and is the pleasure of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*). Yet, we

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[36] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A) Ch. 1; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5570 p. 78; Ohr HaTorah, Beshalach p. 572; Sefer HaMaamarim 5632 Vol. 1 p. 136; *Hemshech* "*Mayim Rabim*" 5636 p. 157 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 193 and on, and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24.

[37] See Likkutei Torah Bamidbar 19b and on; Shir HaShirim 48a, and at length in Ohr HaTorah Balak p. 964 and on, and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24 ibid.

see that even in the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) of the intellect there is a drawing of the pleasure (*Taanug*), meaning that the concepts a person conceptualizes in his intellect (*Sechel*) will specifically be according to the pleasure (*Taanug*).

An example is a person who desires to build a house, in that he has pleasure in the house that is built. That is, according to his pleasure (*Taanug*) in the essence of the house, he will conceptualize in his intellect how the house should be built, with the specific form of its rooms, and the like. That is, [his conceptualization of it] will be exactly according to the pleasure he has in it, as explained elsewhere.[38]

The same is so of the conceptualization of every matter. That is, the reason that one person conceptualizes it in one manner and another person conceptualizes it differently, is due to the pleasure [in it] (*Taanug*). That is, according to the way that his soul delights in the matter, so will he conceive it.

This is because Wisdom-*Chochmah* and pleasure (*Taanug*) relate to each other, in that both are called "*Ta'am*-טעם," such that the pleasure in a "flavor-*Ta'am*-טעם" or "reason-*Ta'am*-טעם" in the [intellectual] counsel.[39] Thus, the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is itself literally the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) and essence of the pleasure (*Taanug*). (This is why the cantillations-*Ta'amim*-טעמים are sometimes in

[38] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 241c; Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 p. 102; 5657 p. 150; Also see the beginning of the prior discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 36).

[39] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5658 p. 137; 5660 p. 15; 5663 p. 27; Also see the end of the prior discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 89) and elsewhere.

the Crown-*Keter*[40] and are sometimes in Wisdom-*Chochmah*[41].)

This then, is the meaning of [the teaching that] "the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is literally the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*," this being the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*).

Proof for this is from the verse,[42] "For You are our father," referring to the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as stated in Zohar II 90a, as well as in Idra Zuta 290a.[43] (See there in Idra Zuta [where it states], "This father-*Av*-אב emerges from the Holy Ancient One-*Atika Kadisha*, because of which it is unknowable. Come and see, the verse states,[44] 'God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם understands its way,' whereas He (apparently referring to the Holy Ancient One-*Atika Kadisha*) does know." Also see Sefer Hod Melech[45] p. 216b.)

Now, as known, the souls of the Jewish people are literally rooted in the innerness of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*), as in the teaching,[46] "The thought of Israel preceded everything." It thus must be said that

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[40] Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 69 (105a); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 28 (Shaar HaTaamim) Ch. 5; Etz Chayim, Shaar 5 (Shaar TaNT"A) Ch. 1 (Mahadura Tinyana); Ch. 5; Ohr HaTorah Va'era (Vol. 7) p. 2,558 and on; p. 2,572 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 2 p. 120; 5640 Vol. 1 p. 81, and elsewhere.

[41] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A) Ch. 1; Torah Ohr Vayechi p. 48b; Shemot 53a; Likkutei Torah Vayikra 4a; Bamidbar 11c; Chukat 57d; Ohr HaTorah Va'era ibid. (p. 2,574 and on); Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 ibid. (p. 121); 5640 ibid. (p. 85 and on).

[42] Job 28:23

[43] Zohar III 290a

[44] Job 28:23

[45] A commentary on Sefer Yetzirah (by the author of Mikdash Melech).

[46] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 1:4

this is because the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is literally of His Essential Self, as the verse states,[47] "You are the children of *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God."

That is, it is just as a child is drawn from the essence of his father's brain,[48] in which the father gives over the totality of his essential self to the child, so much so that "the power of the son [could] be greater [than that of the father]."[49] This is because there is a drawing down to him of the essential self of the father, which transcends all revelations, as explained elsewhere.[50]

The same is understood Above, that the essence of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is literally of His Essential Self. Therefore, the souls of the Jewish people which are drawn from the Wisdom-*Chochmah*, are rooted in the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*).

The same is so of the Torah, which is from Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as our sages, of blessed memory, stated in Midrash Rabbah[51] on the verse,[52] "They shall take an offering to Me," that "it is Me they are taking… I sold you My Torah, and it is as though I was sold along with it," in that "the Torah and the Holy One, blessed is He, are entirely one,"[53] **literally one**!

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[47] Deuteronomy 14:1

[48] Also see Tanya, beginning of Ch. 2 (6a) and elsewhere.

[49] Talmud Bavli, Shevuot 48a

[50] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 269 and on, and elsewhere.

[51] Midrash Shemot Rabbah 33:1; 33:6; Vayikra Rabbah 30:13; Tanya, Ch. 47 (67a).

[52] Exodus 25:2

[53] Tanya, Ch. 4 & beginning of Ch. 23 citing Zohar; [Also see Adir BaMarom p. 110 citing Zohar]; See Zohar I 24a; Zohar II 60a; Tikkunei Zohar, beginning of Tikkun 6; Likkutei Torah Nitzavim 46a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5700 p. 66 and elsewhere.

This then, is why the Torah is called Eden, as stated in Zohar Yitro there.[54] As explained before,[55] in many places Eden refers to the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, and Eden is the aspect of the simple essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi HaPashut*). This is because "the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is literally the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*" - the aspect of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*). This is why about the Torah the verse states, "I was with-*Va'Eheyeh*-ואהי"ה Him as His delights," that is, the aspect of His essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*).

We thus find that the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is itself the essential simple pleasure (*Taanug HaPashut*) (that transcends the revealed pleasure). This being so, the revelation of intellectual concepts stemming from the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) is truly in a completely different way than intellectual concepts drawn forth in a way of direct light (*Ohr Yashar*), both in their depth, as well as in their wondrousness, in that these are more wondrous, being that they are from His essential pleasure.

It can be said that this is akin to the explanation before (in the discourse entitled "*Ki Yeda'ativ*")[56] about the *mitzvot*, that they are His essential desire (*Ratzon HaAtzmi*) within which His essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) is found, except

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[54] Zohar II 90a ibid. Also see Zohar I 247b; Zohar III 290a and on (Idra Zuta); Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 55 (88a); Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 5 (107a); Epistle 17 (125a) and elsewhere.

[55] In the previous discourse entitled "*Zeh HaYom Techilat Ma'asecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 14 and on).

[56] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 101.

that presently the revelation is only of the desire (*Ratzon*) whereas in the coming future the pleasure (*Taanug*) will be revealed.

The same is so of the Torah, in that the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of Torah is His essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*), except that what presently is revealed is the essential Wisdom-*Chochmah* and intellect [of the Torah]. However, in the coming future its true aspect will be revealed, which is the aspect of pleasure (*Taanug*).

This then, is the matter of the [hidden] reasons (*Taamim*-טעמים) of the Torah that will be revealed in the future.[57] That is, it will not be a matter of intellect, but in every matter the simple essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi HaPashut*) of it will be revealed.

However, to arrive at the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, that is, the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba*, this comes through being precise with words of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. That is, it specifically is through in-depth study (*Iyun*) and precision, in a way of toiling, this being the aspect of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*), that one thereby reaches the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

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Now, it could be posited further that the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein*

[57] See Rashi to Song of Songs 1:2; Likkutei Torah Tzav 17a; Shir HaShirim 48a and elsewhere.

Sof), which is the aspect of His essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*) is much higher than the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Supernal Wisdom-*Chochmah*, and that is specifically reached through in-depth study (*Iyun*) and precision in words of wisdom. This is the matter of "the yoke of Torah"[58] which reaches even higher into the essential delights of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*). And although the essence of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is also the essence of the pleasure (*Taanug*), as mentioned before about the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba*, there nonetheless is an even higher level.

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Now, [to explain] we should preface[59] with the fact that we find differing teachings about the coming world (*Olam HaBa*).[60] That is, it states in Tractate Brachot 17a that "in the coming world there is no eating and no drinking etc., but rather, the righteous sit with their crowns on their heads and delight in the ray of the Divine Presence (*Shechinah*)." However, in Midrash Rabbah Vayikra Ch. 13[61] it states, "Rabbi Berachyah said in the name of Rabbi Yitzchak, 'In the coming future the Holy One, blessed is He, is destined to make a feast (of meat –

[58] See Midrash Bamidbar Rabba 48:21; Midrash Shmuel, Ch. 29; Tanna d'Bei Eliyahu Rabba, beginning of Ch. 2; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Ner Chanukah*."

[59] Regarding the coming section (until the end of the discourse), see the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem Eetcha*" 5684 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 p. 317 and on) – which is based on this discourse.

[60] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5650 p. 366 and on.

[61] Midrash Vayikra Rabbah 13:3

see Matnot Kehunah) for His righteous servants.'" This refers to the feast of the Leviathan (*Livyatan*) and the Wild Ox (*Shor HaBar*) which will take place in the coming future.[62]

The explanation[63] is that there are two levels in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*). As known,[64] the revelation of the coming world is the aspect of His Name "I will be-*Eheye"h*-אהי"ה,"[65] indicating the future, meaning,[66] "I am destined to be revealed." However, there are two levels in this, [as the verse states], "I will be as I will be-*Eheyeh Asher Eheyeh*- אהיה אשר אהיה."[67]

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Now, the explanation is that the general pleasure (*Taanug*) of the coming future will be a simple pleasure (*Taanug Pashut*). That is, there is simple pleasure (*Taanug Pashut*) and there is composite pleasure (*Taanug Murkav*),[68] as known,[69] that there is a simple song (*Shir Pashut*), a doubled song (*Shir Kaful*), a tripled song (*Shir Meshulash*).

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[62] See Talmud Bavli, Bava Batra 74b; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 104c and on, and elsewhere.

[63] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid.; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 165 and on.

[64] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5568 Vol. 1 p. 48; p. 57; Ateret Rosh 28a and elsewhere.

[65] Exodus 3:14

[66] Zohar III 11a; 65b

[67] Exodus 3:14 ibid.

[68] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5650 ibid.; 5657 ibid.; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 2 p. 436 and on; 5663 Vol. 1 p. 24.

[69] See Zohar III 227b (Ra'aya Mehemna); Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar (3a); Explained in Torat Chayim Bereishit 37d and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch p. 558; Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 p. 97 and on.

The doubled song (*Shir Kaful*) refers to the composite pleasure (*Taanug Murkav*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, this being a pleasure that is a composite with comprehension. That is, when one grasps some Godly matter he has pleasure in it, both pleasure in that which is grasped in essence, as well as pleasure from grasping the concept.

This certainly is so of the sight (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, in that there is pleasure in it. For, as known,[70] great pleasure (*Taanug*) manifests in [the power of] seeing (*Re'iyah*). However, the general totality of this pleasure (*Taanug*) is merely a ray of radiance that comes in a way of constriction (*Tzimtzum*).

We see this in the arousal of pleasure and joy in the comprehension of Understanding-*Binah*, that it is very constricted and only commensurate to the grasp in each person. That is, this pleasure does not spread and expand within oneself by way of additional expansion, but is only commensurate to his comprehension.

Even in the distilled essence of the depth of the concept, which is called the depth of Understanding-*Binah*,[71] and is the aspect of the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of the "something" (*Yesh*) of the comprehension, referring to how the essential essence of the concept is grasped out of all its particulars and explanations, by which one thereby grasps the essence of the concept to a greater degree, being that the particulars and explanations clarify it,

[70] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5569 p. 112 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 242 and on; p. 81 and on, and elsewhere.

[71] Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 75; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 1 (2b) and on.

nonetheless, while he is preoccupied in the particulars and explanations, he does not yet sense the essence of the concept to such a degree.

Nevertheless, afterwards, when he comes to the depth of the comprehension (*Omek HaMusag*), meaning as the essence of the concept is based on all the particulars and explanations, he then comes to know the essence of the concept very well, and there then is an illumination for him of the light of the essence of the concept, with much intellectual light and with great brilliance and clarity. From this the song is automatically drawn to the breath of the heart, meaning that the heart spontaneously becomes roused with the voice of song, resulting from the intent in the innerness of the brain.[72]

(As known and explained elsewhere,[73] when the grasp of the concept is only external, meaning only into the garments of the subject, such that the Godly matter is concealed in the garments of the subject, he then must toil within himself to rouse his heart with the emotions of love and fear arising from the "therefore" [of the matter]. Moreover, the love and fear are only in an aspect of externality (*Chitzoniyut*).

However, when through his contemplation (*Hitbonenut*) he senses the Godly matter that he grasps and contemplates, and not just the intellect and garments of the concept, but there is an illumination for him of the essential Godly matter which he

[72] This is as we clearly observe that when he is deeply preoccupied in a deep concept he begins to sing in an automatic manner from the depth of the inner intention of his brain. (See the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid.)

[73] See at length in Kuntres HaHitpaalut of the Mittler Rebbe, Ch. 3 (printed in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Kuntreisim p. 106 and on, translated as Divine Inspiration).

grasps in his brain in a revealed way, then he automatically is roused in his heart and does not at all need to toil for this. That is because the heart will automatically be roused and drawn after the brain.)

This is similar the song of the Levites,[74] in that they knew how to have intentions in their songs.[75] That is, for them the primary matter was the inner intention of the mind. This is as stated,[76] "The Levite shall serve Him-*Hoo*-הוּא," referring to the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Understanding-*Binah*. Thus, there automatically was caused to be song in the breath of their heart.

Nevertheless, even in this, the song and pleasure comes constricted in accordance with the grasp of each person, for there are different levels in this. That is, just as there are different levels of comprehension, each person according to his measure, this likewise is so of the **depth** of the comprehension (*Omek HaMusag*). That is, even for the Levites there certainly were different levels. For example, in the song of the angels (which also is a song that comes automatically, as explained elsewhere)[77] there also are many different levels.[78]

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[74] See Nehemiah 12:27; Mishnah Tamid 7:4; Talmud Bavli, Rosh HaShanah 30b and on; Also see (regarding the song of the Levites) Torah Ohr Beshalach 62c; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 107b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 1 p. 154; Vol. 2 p. 386 and on.

[75] See Ohr HaTorah, Vayeishev Vol. 5 p. 904a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 p. 112; 5664 p. 132; 5677 p. 43; Discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" 5691 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5691 p. 86).

[76] Numbers 18:23; Also see Likkutei Torah Korach 55b and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 95b; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 40.

[77] Also see Shaarei Orah 25a and on.

[78] For example, the camp of Michael is with love, and in the camp of Michael there are 186,000 camps, and although all of them are in a state of love, that is their level, that they are [on the side] of love. Yet, even so, they are 186,000 camps, and just as it is physically the case in an army that each camp differs from one another in

The same is so of the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which is a much higher song than the letters of speech. This is because the song from the depth of the comprehension (*Omek HaMusag*) comes by way of manifesting in letters of speech, like the song of the Levites that stemmed from the above-mentioned inner intention. However, even so, the song came into speech.

In contrast, the upper song of the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* does not come into letters of speech. It is called "the song of God-*Shir E"l*-שיר א"ל"[79] and is the mode of serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, on Shabbat, with the song and pleasure indicated by the verse,[80] "Then you shall delight in *HaShem*-יהו"ה."

That is, the song comes automatically, and as the verse states,[81] "He saw no toil in Yisroel," referring to Shabbat, at which time they are in the [higher] aspect of "Yisroel-ישראל," as it forms the words "the song of God-*Shir E"l*-שיר א"ל," which comes without effort and toil. Rather, because of the sight (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* it comes automatically.

Nonetheless, this too[82] is a constricted pleasure according to each person. This is because this pleasure also

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the appearance of their garments and their weapons, the same is likewise so of the 186,000 camps of the camp of Michael, that they differ in the manner and level of their love. (See the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid.)

[79] See introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 3a; Tikkun 10 (25a); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 10, section on "*Yisroel*-ישראל"; Also see Ch. 21, section on "song-*Shir*-שיר"; Likkutei Torah Balak 72a; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5564 p. 178 and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bamidbar Vol. 4 p. 1,538; p. 1571 and on, and elsewhere.

[80] Isaiah 58:14; Also see Zohar II 88b; Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 173a and on; 199c.

[81] Numbers 23:21

[82] See the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid.

comes as a composite with something, meaning with the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. That is, it is not the actual essence, but is like the verse,[83] "You shall see my back," as explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Lulav v'Aravah*").[84]

It thus follows that the pleasure in this is a composite pleasure (*Taanug Murkav*), which only is a ray of radiance of the pleasure, and by respect, it comes in a way of constriction. It therefore is called the "doubled song" (*Shir Kaful*) consisting of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, these being the two depths of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*.

In contrast, the simple song (*Shir Pashut*) is what we observe that after the above-mentioned arousal of the constricted pleasure and joy in Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, one then comes to a much greater state of arousal of pleasure and joy in the essence and being of his soul, not at all commensurate to the grasping and seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. Rather, this is called the joy and delight of the soul, literally with essential pleasure and joy. This is like the song of the sea which stemmed from their souls - from the *Yechidah* essence of the soul.

This is because there literally was a revelation to them of the concealed Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, and as they said,[85] "This-*Zeh*-זה is my God." That is, each one pointed with his finger and said, "This is my God,"[86] with the actual sight of the eye.

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[83] Exodus 33:23
[84] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 39.
[85] Exodus 15:2
[86] Midrash Shemot Rabbah 23:15

This is much higher than the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, which is with the eye of the intellect. For example, it states,[87] "Who is wise? He who sees [what is born]," in that he sees what is born from nothing (*Ayin*) to something (*Yesh*).[88] This is seeing (*Re'iyah*) with the eye of the intellect. That is, even though he indeed sees the truth of it with the eyes of his intellect, as though he sees it with his actual eyes, and it is not just a matter of comprehension, nonetheless, it is not the same as seeing the actual essence of the matter.

That is, it is unlike prophecy, which is the matter of actually seeing the essence of the thing. Now, regarding the prophets, of which the verse states,[89] "Through the prophets I am likened (*Adameh*-אדמה)" [that is, by way of allegory], this is because their vision was from Kingship-*Malchut*, which is the aspect of a "likeness-*Dmut*-דמות". Nevertheless, it is the seeing of the essence of that particular level.

Moreover, even though there is an element of superiority to the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, in that it can reach much higher, as in the teaching,[90] "A wise sage is greater than a prophet," for with the eye of the intellect he can see much higher levels of grasp of Godliness in the ten *Sefirot* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), and still higher, even in Primordial Man (*Adam Kadmon*) and even in the Essential Self

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[87] Talmud Bavli, Tamid 32a

[88] See Tanya, Ch. 43 (61a).

[89] Hosea 12:11 [and Rashi there]; Regarding the coming section see Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 p. 136 and on; p. 142 and on; Also see *Hemshech* "*v'Kachah*" 5637 Ch. 56 (84b).

[90] Talmud Bavli, Bava Batra 12a; Also see (in addition to the citations in the preceding note) Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzeddek 64a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 ibid. p. 135; p. 150.

of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*) before the constriction (*Tzimtzum*), such as Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai, Rabbi Akiva, and the elder sages who saw much higher, nonetheless, all this was with the eye of the intellect.

In contrast, in prophecy, even though it is of the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, or only of Victory-*Netzach* and Majesty-*Hod*,[91] it nevertheless is literally the matter of actually seeing with the eye. This is as explained elsewhere,[92] that the level of a prophet is such that the essence and being of Godliness comes to be revealed in [his] Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and Knowledge-*Da'at*, as well is in his mouth and tongue. Thus with his physical power of sight he literally sees the essential Godliness.

Higher than this is the prophecy of Moshe, who prophesied with the word "This-*Zeh*-זה" etc.[93] About him the verse states,[94] "Mouth to mouth [I speak with him] with clear vision and not in riddles [and he beholds the image of *HaShem*-ה"הו"]. It likewise is written,[95] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה spoke to Moshe face to face, as a man speaking to his fellow."

That is, this specifically was with the sight of the Essential Self and Being of the Unlimited One, as He is in the True Reality of His Singular Preexistent Intrinsic Being,

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[91] See Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 1, section on "*Aspaklariya*"; Also see Iggeret HaKodesh ibid.; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 6 p. 252 and on; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 114c.

[92] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken, HaKetzarim p. 387.

[93] Sifri and Rashi to Numbers 30:2, explained in Likkutei Torah Matot 82a and on, and elsewhere.

[94] Numbers 12:8

[95] Exodus 33:11

literally in a way of actually seeing, and even though[96] about Moshe the verse states, "You shall see My back," this only refers to the sight of the intellect, whereas prophetically he literally saw[97] the Essential Self and Being of the Unlimited One in a way of actual sight. This is as stated in Zohar Mishpatim[98] 115b,[99] that "Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai said to him, 'With the eye of the intellect in your heart you see all… but in prophecy it is with the actual eyes.'"

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[96] Regarding what he writes here, that "even though it is written about him, 'You shall see My back etc.,' this refers to the aspect of sight with the intellect, whereas prophetically he literally saw with actual sight… with the eyes," this requires deeper analysis. 1) The verse "You shall see My back" is referring to prophetic vision, as per the simple meaning of the verses, and as stated in Kuntres Acharon (157a) and as also brought in Iggeret HaKodesh, beginning of Epistle 19. This is likewise the conclusion of the passage of Zohar cited above (117a), "With it (i.e., with your thought) you should gaze at He who has no end, which you were not initially granted permission to gaze at **with your eyes**. This is the meaning of the verse, 'You shall see My back, but you shall not see My face.'" 2) With the eye of the intellect it is possible to see much higher levels than with the eye of prophecy, as explained at length in Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 19. Yet, here it states the opposite. Perhaps it can be suggested that the intention here is that there are two matters. 1) There is **the level** in which there is the sight and comprehension, and in this the sage is greater than the prophet, since in prophecy there is only the aspect of "you shall see My back, but you shall not see My face" (until the coming future). 2) There is **the manner** of the sight of the level in which one sees, in which the matter is reversed. That is, prophecy is sight of the essential being of the thing, and is called the sight of the "face" (*Panim*), whereas the sage does not see the actual being of the thing, and it is called "you shall see My back" (*Achor*), and that is what is discussing here (though the wording requires further analysis), and there are various explanations to the meaning of "you shall see My back." (Likkutei Sichot Vol. 6 p. 251 and on.)

[97] See (in regard to whether the prophecy of Moshe was with actual sight with the eye or only the visions of prophecy) Ohr HaTorah Mishpatim p. 1,285; p. 1,293; Also see Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzeddek 70b.

[98] Cited in Maamarei Admor HaZaken HaKetzarim ibid. p. 386; Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 ibid. p. 151.

[99] This should perhaps say 116b.

Now, as known,[100] at the splitting of the sea they all were on the level of Moshe, in that they all merited to prophecy in the way indicated by the word "This-*Zeh*-זה". That is, they literally saw the Essence and Being of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) and this was their song.

The same was so at the giving of the Torah, as the verse states,[101] "The entire people saw the thunder," meaning with actual sight, such that "with each utterance their souls flew out of them."[102] This is like what will be in the coming future, about which the verse states,[103] "There we will rejoice in Him," literally in Him.

(A glimmer of this shines for perfectly righteous *Tzaddikim* on Shabbat and the festivals.[104] On Shabbat it is in [the recitation of][105] "A Psalm, a song for the day of eternal rest (*Shabbat*)," this being the aspect[106] of the simple song in the essence of the soul, and on the festivals it is with essential joy. This is as we recite,[107] "Israel shall rejoice in You," meaning, "in You-*Becha*-בך" literally).

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[100] See Mechilta to Exodus 15:1; Ohr HaChayim to Exodus 15:1; Also see at length in Likkutei Sichot Vol. 31 p. 70 and on.

[101] Exodus 20:15

[102] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 88b; Also see Midrash Shemot Rabbah 29:4; Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:16 (3); Midrash Lekach Tov to Exodus 20:2 (Yitro).

[103] Psalms 66:6

[104] See the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid. for a variation in the wording.

[105] Psalms 92:1; Talmud Bavli, Tamid 33b

[106] See the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid. for a variation in the wording.

[107] See the blessing "*v'Hasee'einu*" in the Amidah prayer of the holidays.

This likewise is [the meaning of], "The song of songs etc.,"[108] which is the song and singing[109] of the Torah with cantillations (*Ta'amim*-טעמים) and melody, in which there is the "flavor-*Ta'am*-טעם" and simple pleasure of the essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*).

This then, is the general matter of the pleasure (*Taanug*) of the coming future. That is, there will be the simple song (*Shir Pashut*) referring to the simple pleasure (*Taanug Pashut*) in the essence of the soul that stems from the concealment of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*) that does not come as a composite of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, nor even in the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, as explained before.

(We thus must say that the fact that Moshiach will teach Torah to all the Jewish people,[110] which will be in a way of seeing, as explained elsewhere,[111] will be with the actual sight of His Being, and not just seeing with the eye of the intellect. Rather, he literally will show the Truth of Godliness to all the Jewish people.

Elsewhere it says[112] that when the verse states,[113] "Behold, My servant will become wise… exceedingly lofty," this is lower in level than the sight of Moshe, which was face to face and "with clear vision." This is because the word, "will

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[108] Song of Songs 1:1

[109] See Zohar I 8a

[110] See Likkutei Torah Tzav 17a; Shaar HaEmunah of the Mittler Rebbe 89a and on; Derech Mitzvotecha p. 110b-111a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 1 p. 266 and on; 5698 p. 200; 5699 p. 203; p. 207.

[111] Likkutei Torah Tzav ibid. 17b; Shaar HaEmunah ibid. 94b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 ibid. p. 269; 5698 p. 201; 5699 p. 207 and on.

[112] See Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 156c and on.

[113] Isaiah 52:13

become wise-*Yaskeel*-ישכיל" refers to the sight (*Re'iyah*) of the intellect, whereas Moshe had the sight of His actual being, as discussed before.

We therefore must say that the difference between the revelations of the times of Moshiach (*Yemot HaMashiach*) and the revelations of the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) is that the primary revelation will take place in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) and will [specifically] be brought about by Moshe, the final redeemer,[114] and he will be Moshiach.)[115]

However, in the song of the simple pleasure (*Taanug Pashut*) there are two levels. The first level is the hidden pleasure (*Taanug Ne'elam*) which specifically comes to be sensed. This is as we observe, that even in regard to this simple essential song that literally is of the essence of the soul, it nevertheless comes [to manifest] in an actual physical way in the breath of the heart of flesh, as the verse states,[116] "My heart and my flesh sing."

This is like the song of the sea, which was with the actual sight of His Essential Being, but even so, there was a song that came into speech. In other words, this is specifically when the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) of the essence of the soul comes into physicality. This is as we find about Dovid in the verse,[117] "Dovid was hopping and dancing," with the actual essential arousal of excitement, akin to the dancing at the

[114] See Midrash Shemot Rabbah 2:4; Shaar HaPesukim of the Arizal, Genesis 49:10 (Vayechi).

[115] Also see Torah Ohr, beginning of Mishpatim (75b); Torat Chayim Bereishit 14b; Torat Chayim Shemot 282c.

[116] Psalms 84:3

[117] Samuel II 6:16

Celebration of the Drawing of Water (*Simchat Beit HaSho'evah*)[118] which was altogether without song.[119]

The dancing indicates the arousal of excitement, such that the totality of one's essential being is literally moved. For, as explained elsewhere,[120] the excitement of the external limbs, such as the clapping of the hands, and certainly the dancing of the feet, comes spontaneously, without any preparation (and this certainly is so [if it comes spontaneously] when there is no song), since these movements stem from the movement of the essence of one's soul, which even[121] the pleasure of the simple song (*Shir Pashut*) cannot reach[122] as it truly is. Yet, even so, it comes in a way that is felt, with the felt dancing and movement of one's limbs.

The same was likewise so at the giving of the Torah, that in a completely felt way their bodies received the entire upper pleasure (*Taanug*) hidden in the innerness of Torah, through the "dew-*Tal*-טל-39" of the Torah that revived them.[123]

This likewise is the meaning of their souls flying out of them with each utterance, in that it was not a matter of death, Heaven forbid,[124] but rather was a foretaste of the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) where there is freedom from death.[125] Rather,

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[118] Mishnah Sukkah 5:1; Talmud Bavli Sukkah 51a

[119] Here it says "without song-*Shir*-שיר" but should perhaps say "without measure-*Shi'ur*-שיעור" as it is stated in the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" of the Mittler Rebbe ibid. (See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 133, note 121.)

[120] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Drushei Chatunah Vol. 1 p. 262 and on; p. 340 and on.

[121] As stated in the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid., "even the simple song (*Shir Pashut*) cannot contain (or bear) it whatsoever."

[122] For a variant rendering of this see the discourse "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid.

[123] See Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 88b; Tanya, Ch. 36 (46b).

[124] See Chiddushei Aggadot of the Maharsha to Shabbat ibid.

[125] See Midrash Shemot Rabbah 32:1; 41:7; Zohar I 37b; Also see 131b.

this was simple pleasure (*Taanug Pashut*) as it comes in a felt way, which one automatically cannot bear, and He then revived them with the "dew-*Tal*-טל-39 of resurrection."

It can be said that this is [what is expressed in the verse],[126] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה will give strength to His people," so that they will be capable of receiving. We thus find that the reason that at first they were incapable of receiving was because it came in a felt way. Likewise, that which they subsequently were able to receive also came specifically in a felt way.

This likewise is so of the revelations of the coming future, as the verse states,[127] "I have something (*Yesh*-יש) to bestow [to] those who love Me," meaning the "something" (*Yesh*) of felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*) that comes from the hiddenness of the concealed simple essential pleasure, into full revelation in a felt way without at all undergoing any change of being.

This is akin to how even now there is spiritual pleasure for the souls, which also is felt by the palate of those who taste it, as in the verse,[128] "Our soul longed for *HaShem*-יהו"ה." This is [felt] in the grasp of the secrets and mysteries of the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Torah, like Rabbi Akiva whose eyes flowed with tears,[129] this being because it came in a felt way.

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[126] Psalms 29:11; Also see the prior discourse entitled "*Yom Tov Shel Rosh HaShanah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 6).

[127] Proverbs 8:21

[128] Psalms 33:20

[129] See Zohar I 98b (Midrash HaNe'elam); Ta"Z to Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chayim 288 S"K 2 (citing Zohar Chadash); Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 6, and elsewhere.

The same will be so in the coming future, as in the verse,[130] "They shall come with weeping," this being because the pleasure will be felt, thus causing the weeping. Even though the weeping is because one's vessel cannot contain it, and as known,[131] [weeping] comes because of the constriction of the brain, nevertheless, this is because the light comes into the vessel in a felt way. This also is because the entire pleasure is felt and the vessel cannot withstand it, because of which he weeps. However, if it did not come in a way that is felt, the matter of weeping, would not apply.

In contrast, the second [higher] level of the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) is that the souls of the Jewish people will literally ascend in the essential concealed pleasure of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*). This is called the actual essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*), that do not at all come into revelation as a felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*), even in the [hidden] reasons (*Taamim*) of the Torah. It rather remains in an encompassing state (*Makif*) and in concealment. This aspect is reached specifically through the work of affecting refinements (*Birurim*), as will be explained.[132]

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[130] Jeremiah 31:8; Also see Shaar HaYichud ibid.

[131] See Torah Ohr Vayishlach 26a; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, HaKetzarim p. 448; Shaarei Orah 8a; 89b, and elsewhere.

[132] See the later discourse entitled "*Ner Chanukah*" 5666 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 147); Discourse entitled "*Tikoo*" 5667 (p. 460 and on); Also see the discourses entitled "*Lech Lecha*" and "*Hamchaseh Ani*" 5667 (p. 514 and on; 525 and on).

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Now, with the above in mind, we can understand the verse, "Yaakov departed from Be'er-Shova." That is, Yaakov's departure was to affect refinements (*Birurim*), in that this was his work in the house of Lavan,[133] in that he refined the "sheep" of Lavan.

As known,[134] the word "sheep-*Tzon*-**צאן**" is of the same root as "departure-*Yetziyah*-**יציאה**," as in the verse,[135] "Go out (*Tze'i*-**צאי**) in the footsteps of the sheep (*Tzon*-**צאן**)." This refers to the lights (*Orot*) that were shed[136] and fell from the Upper Whiteness (*Loven HaElyon*-לובן העליון),[137] in that he refined very lofty levels, these being the matter of the "bound" (*Akudim*), "speckled" (*Nekudim*), and "splotched" (*Brudim*),[138] which is the general matter of [bringing about] the world of Repair-*Tikkun*, as explained elsewhere.[139]

Now, the empowerment to affect this refinement (*Birur*) specifically comes from the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*). This is as explained

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[133] Regarding the coming section see Torah Ohr, Vayeitzei 23c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5564 p. 12 and on; Torat Chayim Vayishlach 39c and on; Ohr HaTorah Vayishlach 228a.

[134] See Shoresh Yesha, section on "sheep-*Tzon*-צאן"; Ohr HaTorah, Shir HaShirim Vol. 1 p. 128; Also see the citations in the preceding note.

[135] Song of Songs 1:8

[136] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate One (*Malchut*), section on the root "*Nesher*-נשר."

[137] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Ten (*Keter*), and elsewhere.

[138] See Etz Chayim, beginning of Shaar HaAkudim; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 20 (regarding the worlds of Chaos-*Tohu*).

[139] See Torah Ohr Vayeitzei 23c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5564 p. 12 and on; Torat Chayim Vayishlach p. 39c and on; Ohr HaTorah Vayishlach p. 228a.

before (in the discourse entitled "*Vayitein Lecha*")[140] about the verse,[141] "God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם understands its way." Through the refinements (*Birurim*) this aspect is caused to be revealed, this being the aspect of Eden that will be [revealed] in the coming future.

Thus, about this the verse states, "Yaakov departed from Be'er-Shova-בְּאֵר שָׁבַע," a word meaning "oath-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה," as the verse states,[142] "As You swore to our forefathers in the preexistent days-*Yemei Kedem*-ימי קדם."[143] That is, the oath (*Shevu'ah*) is specifically from the very innerness and Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*), as explained elsewhere.[144]

However, "the well of the oath-*Be'er Shova*-באר שבע" refers to "the depth of the oath," referring to the second [higher] level, this literally being the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*). From there the power to affect refinements (*Birurim*) is drawn.

This then, is the matter of his getting permission from "the well of the oath-*Be'er Shova*-באר שבע," [as stated], "From where did father seek permission," (even though he [Yitzchak] was never actually given the permission, being that he was [sanctified as] a burnt offering to *HaShem*-יהו"ה.[145] Nevertheless, getting permission must specifically be from the

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[140] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 124

[141] Job 28:13 & 28:23

[142] Micah 7:20

[143] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Ten (*Keter*), section on the title "Preexistent-*Kedem*-קדם."

[144] See Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Shemini Atzeret 83b and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Devarim Vol. 4 p. 1,321 and on; Ohr HaTorah Drushim L'Shemini Atzeret p. 1,803 and on, and elsewhere.

[145] See Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 64:3; Rashi to Genesis 26:2

"the well of the oath-*Be'er Shova*-באר שבע"). [The Midrash continues that] "he therefore said [to himself], I too shall go to Be'er Shova]." That is, the matter of getting permission is the empowerment to affect refinements that specifically come from this level.

We thus find that the matter of getting permission from "the well of the oath-*Be'er Shova*-באר שבע" is one and the same as the matter of "May God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם give you,"[146] in that Yitzchak gave Yaakov the actual essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) so that he will be able to affect refinements (*Birurim*), as explained before.[147]

The same is so of the matter of getting permission from "the well of the oath-*Be'er Shova*-באר שבע," the aspect of "the depth of the oath," from which the power to affect refinements (*Birurim*) specifically comes. This is why it is called "Be'er-Shova-בְּאֵר שָׁבַע" with a *Komatz*-קָמָץ vowel, as a word meaning "oath-*Shevu'ah*-שבועה." This is because this was necessary for him to have the ability to affect refinements, the primary aspect being "the depth of the oath," as explained before.

This also is the reason for the redundancy in speaking about his departure. That is, in one place it is discussing the "well" from which he departed in order to affect refinements, and [it then continues] to discuss by what power he had the ability to affect the refinements, and about this the verse states, "Yaakov departed from Be'er-Shova-בְּאֵר שָׁבַע." That is, his departure was from "the depth of the oath," and he thereby had the ability to affect the refinements (*Birurim*). Through these

[146] Genesis 27:28; See the prior discourse entitled "*Vayitein Lecha Elohi"m*."
[147] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 124 ibid.

refinements he thereby ascended and reached this aspect, that is, the actual essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*).

Discourse 13

"*Vayishlach Yaakov… -*
Yaakov sent…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Vayishlach, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "Yaakov sent angels ahead of him to Esav his brother… He charged them, saying: Thus shall you say, 'To my lord, to Esav… I have sojourned with Lavan and have lingered until now. I have acquired oxen and donkeys, and flocks… and I am sending to tell my lord to find favor in your eyes etc.'" What is mostly not understood here is him saying, "I have acquired oxen and donkeys etc.," for did he not know that Esav despised him? This being so he should have hidden the goodness he had from him. Why then did he inform him, "I have acquired oxen and donkeys etc."

Now, on the words, "I have sojourned (*Garti*-גרתי-613) with Lavan," Rashi explains[3] "I kept the 613-תרי"ג *mitzvot*." This too is not understood, for did he not know that Esav placed no value on fulfilling *mitzvot*? This being so, why did he inform him that he kept the 613-תרי"ג *mitzvot*?

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[1] Part of this discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 3 p. 1,126 and on; Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah Vol. 6 p. 2,464 and on, as cited in later notes.

[2] Genesis 32:4-6

[3] Rashi to Genesis 32:5

We also must understand his words, "and have lingered until now." What caused him to rush that he had to say "I have lingered?" Moreover, he did not state the reason or cause for having lingered.

Now, to understand all this, we must preface with the explanation before,[4] that the general revelation of the pleasure (*Taanug*) of the coming future is the aspect of the simple pleasure (*Taanug Pashut*) that does not come as a composite with anything else, not even with the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

Nonetheless, within the simple pleasure (*Taanug Pashut*) itself, there are two levels - there is the simple pleasure that comes in a felt way in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of the Torah, and there is the actual essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im Atzmiyim*) that do not at all come in a felt way, not even in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of the Torah.

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Now, the explanation is that according to what was stated before, we must say that the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) that does not come in a felt way is higher than the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) that comes in a felt way.

However, at first glance, it is not understood how it applies to have a division of levels in the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*), being that both are of the essence. Thus, even if we were to say that they are equal in level, why then does one

[4] In the prior discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei Yaakov*."

come in a felt way and the other not come in a felt way, not even in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of Torah and *mitzvot*.

Moreover, it cannot be said that the pleasure in Torah is not an essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*), that is, the aspect of His essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im Atzmiyim*), for it states in Midrash Rabbah[5] that, so to speak, through [receiving] the Torah "it is Me that you are taking," literally "Me-*Otee*-אותי," as discussed before (in the discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei*").[6]

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However, the explanation[7] is that it was previously elucidated (in the above-mentioned discourse)[8] that "the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is literally the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*." It was explained before[9] that this is the "nothing" (*Ayin*) and "what-*Ma"H*-מ"ה" of Wisdom-*Chochmah*-חכמה, which is actually the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of the Crown-*Keter*, except that it is found in the emanations. It thus cannot be enjoyed, since it is the aspect of the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-*Keter* which "no thought at all can grasp."[10] Now, it is explained elsewhere[11] that since the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of

[5] Midrash Shemot Rabbah 33:1; 33:6; Also see Tanya, Ch. 47 (67a)

[6] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 128.

[7] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem Eetcha*" and the discourse entitled "*v'Heenei Kdei*" 5684 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5684 p. 323 and on; p. 329 and on), which are based on this discourse.

[8] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 126

[9] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 127

[10] Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a

[11] *Hemshech* "*v'Kachah*" 5637 Ch. 23 (p. 27 and on).

Wisdom-*Chochmah* is not given to be enjoyed, of what benefit is it that it is found amongst the emanations?

However, the explanation is that in regard to the "nothing" (*Ayin*) as it actually is in the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-*Keter*, it is not at all in a state of being knowable or graspable, since it altogether is not in the category of grasp. This is the matter of the Unknowable Head (*Reisha d'Lo Ityada* [*RaDL"A*])[12] that is not known and will not be known, meaning that it altogether will not be known. This is like the matter of the essential concealment explained before,[13] called "the Concealment of all concealments" (*Steema d'Kol Steemeen*)[14] because it is not known, as explained elsewhere.[15]

However, when this comes into the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah* to be amongst the emanations, it then becomes possible to come to this level by prefacing with knowledge and grasp. That is, through knowledge by way of negation (*Yediyat HaShelilah*) it is possible to come to have some recognition of the essential being of the thing, as discussed elsewhere.[16]

However, based on what was explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*"),[17] grasp through negation (*Hasagat HaShelilah*) and the recognition brought about by it, only applies to the **revelation** of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, but not to its essential being. Moreover, it also

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[12] Zohar III 288b (Idra Zuta); Also see Zohar I 65a

[13] In the discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei Yaakov*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 127).

[14] See Tikkunei Zohar ibid.

[15] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 39c and on; Pirush HaMilot of the Mittler Rebbe 59d and on; Also see *Hemshech* "*v'Kachah*" 5637 ibid.

[16] See earlier in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 79.

[17] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 79 ibid.

was explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei*")[18] that even the seeing (*Re'iyah*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is not of the essence, but is merely the aspect of a radiance.

However, it can be posited that, at the very least, this is what is grasped by way of the negation in the 365 negative prohibitive *mitzvot*. For, as known,[19] the negative precedes the positive, and the root of the negative *mitzvot* is higher than the root of the positive *mitzvot*.[20] That is, they specifically are in the aspect of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that transcends revelation and grasp.

In other words, through keeping the negative *mitzvot* we grasp the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah* - that which is not given to be benefited from by way of the revelation of light. This is the matter of "My Name-*Shmee*-שמי-350" plus *Yod-Hey*-י״ה-15 being equal to the 365-שס״ה [negative prohibitive *mitzvot*].[21]

However, as the aspect of "nothing" (*Ayin*) in the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-*Keter* is ungraspable, even through the negation (*Shelilah*) of the negative *mitzvot*, but specifically only when it comes into the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. Even though this literally is the aspect of the "nothing" (*Ayin*) of the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-

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[18] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 129 and on.

[19] See Torah Ohr Shemot 52d; Beshalach 62a; Likkutei Torah Pekudei 6d; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 443c; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefillin 160a; Also see Pelach HaRimon Vayikra p. 214 that "it is known from the Baal Shem Tov, whose soul is in Eden, that the negative precedes the positive. In Pelach HaRimon Shir HaShirim 45a he states, "as explained elsewhere in the name of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch, of righteous memory, about the matter of the negative prohibitive [*mitzvot*] preceding the positive." Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 36 p. 98.

[20] See Likkutei Torah and Torat Chayim ibid., and elsewhere.

[21] Zohar III 278b; Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 4b

Keter, which is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*], nonetheless, there is no comparison between how it actually is in the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Crown-*Keter* and how it comes into the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, since at the very least, it comes into a state of grasp in the aspect of the negation of the negative *mitzvot*.

It can be posited that this is akin to the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik* itself. For, as known, the word "Ancient-*Atik*-**עתיק**" is of the same root as "copying-*Ha'ataka*-**העתקה** from one manuscript to another," as in the verse,[22] "[These too are the proverbs of Shlomo] that were copied-*He'eteekoo*-**העתיקו** by the men of Chizkiyah." That is, it is the aspect of the drawing down of the actual Essential Self and Being that is drawn into the aspect of the Crown-*Keter*.

For example, when one copies from one manuscript to another manuscript, the same thing is literally stated in the [first] manuscript, except that it has been copied into the [second] manuscript. Nonetheless, with this copy there comes to be the aspect of an intermediary between the Emanator and the emanated. For, although it is so that even as the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik* is drawn into the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* it is the lowest aspect of the Emanator,[23] and is still removed and completely separately transcendent from the ten *Sefirot* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), nonetheless, the Essential Self of the Emanator is not in the category of being an intermediary, whereas that which comes into the aspect of the

[22] Proverbs 25:1

[23] See Etz Chayim, Shaar 42 (Shaar Drushei ABY"A) Ch. 1; Also see earlier in *Hemshech* 5666, p. 126.

Crown-*Keter* is at the very least, the aspect of an intermediary between the Emanator and the emanations.

(It can be posited that this is like the interpreter who receives from the teacher and bestows to the people. This is like how it was in the olden days,[24] in that there was an interpreter (*Meturgeman*) between the sage who would expound, and the people. This is because the sage was separate and above relative to the people, and they thus were incapable of receiving directly from him, except by way of an intermediary.

Now, about the matter of the intermediary, as known,[25] when the intermediary, that is, the interpreter (*Meturgeman*), receives the bestowal from the teacher as is, for him the bestowal comes according to [the limitations of] his own receptacles and sensibilities. For, although the interpreter (*Meturgeman*) is capable of receiving the bestowal of the teacher, nevertheless in actuality, his sensibility cannot compare to the sensibility of the teacher, because if that was so, the people would be incapable of receiving directly from him too. Rather, his receptacles and sensibilities are of similar measure to the people.

Thus, by him bringing the intellect of the teacher into the measure of his own sensibilities, the people are thereby able to receive the bestowal. However, what the people actually receive of the bestowal is only according to how it is in the

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[24] In the times of the Tana'im and Amora'im (see the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid.)

[25] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 190 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 442; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 Vol. 1 p. 312; 5632 Vol. 1 p. 134; 5671 p. 80 and on, and elsewhere.

sensibility of the interpreter, whereas the essential bestowal of the teacher is completely hidden from them, and continues to be hidden from them even later.

Moreover, even for the interpreter, even after he brings the matter into the measure of his sensibilities, nonetheless, relative to him the essence of the teacher's bestowal remains in a state of transcendence. For, when he brought the matter into the measure of his sensibilities, it is not that the essential bestowal of the teacher changed in him and came into him according to his sensibilities, being that this is not at all in the capacity of the interpreter.

(For, since in actuality his sensibilities are not similar to the sensibilities of the teacher, and in relation to him the intellect of the teacher is beyond him, it therefore is not in his ability to bring the intellect of the teacher into his own sensibilities in an actual inner manifest way, such that it would undergo change and be according to his own sensibilities.)[26]

This is unlike the people who receive from the interpreter, such that the actual bestowal of the interpreter comes according to their receptacles and sensibilities, since they are of comparable measure to each other. In contrast, the bestowal of the teacher is separate, even from the sensibilities

[26] This itself is the difference between the interpreter (*Meturgeman*) and the student (*Talmid*), whose substance matters differ from one another. For, even when it comes to a student (*Talmud*), his senses are also of no comparison whatsoever to the senses of the teacher. Nevertheless, since he is a student (*Talmid*) (and primarily because of his sublimation and nullification (*Bittul*), this being the primary aspect of the student, that he is nullified and receives the words of the teacher as they are, as known, meaning that he guards the [precision] of the letters), over the course of time he acquires a likeness to the senses of the teacher. However, the interpreter (*Meturgeman*) has no relation to this altogether. (See the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid.)

of the interpreter. Thus, it rather is that of the intellect of the teacher that he receives, he takes that which **does** come into his receptacles and sensibilities.

By way of analogy, this is like when a person derives one matter from another matter that he studies, in which that which is derived is not the same as that from which it is derived, but they actually are two distinct matters. The same is understood in the case of an interpreter (*Meturgeman*), that what he brings according to his sensibilities is only that which he took [and derived] from the intellect of the teacher, but it altogether is not the essence of the teacher's intellect.

This is because in relation to him, the intellect of the teacher is separately wondrous and transcendent, except that he derives something from it. Nevertheless, specifically by receiving the bestowal from the teacher, he then can bestow to the people.

That is, that which the interpreter brings according to his own sensibilities is not actually his own intellect, because he would never have conceived it on his own, but it specifically is only because he received the intellect of the teacher.

Nonetheless, this is not [actually] the intellect of the teacher himself but is [only] according to the essential concept he received from the teacher. In other words, he has a sense of the teacher's essential concept, from which he derives the matter according to his own sensibilities, until it ultimately comes to be revealed to the recipients. This is the matter of an intermediary.

The likeness to all this may be understood as it is Above in regard to the aspect of the Crown-*Keter*, in that it is the

intermediary between the Emanator and the emanations, and includes the [two] aspects of the Ancient One-*Atik* and the Long Patient One-*Arich*.[27] That is, the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik* is completely elevated and separately transcendent, except that from it the lights of the Long Patient One-*Arich* are found. In other words, it is not an aspect of the actual lights of the Ancient One-*Atik*.

Then, from the aspect of the lights of the Long Patient One-*Arich* there is a drawing down to the emanations. This being so, that which illuminates for the emanations is only [a radiance] of the lights of the Long Patient One-*Arich*, whereas the essence of the Ancient One-*Atik* is utterly removed from them.

Moreover, even in the Crown-*Keter* itself, the essence of the Ancient One-*Atik* is in a state of elevation and separate transcendence, except that from it the lights of the Long Patient One-*Arich* are found, this being like a separate light.) This then, is the intermediary that relates to worlds, meaning the intermediary between the Emanator and the emanations.

Now, as known[28] through the intermediary of the Crown-*Keter* a bond is caused between the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) and the souls of the Jewish people. This too is like the matter of an intermediary, except that it is in a different way than the explanation before.

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[27] See Etz Chayim ibid.; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24.

[28] See *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 442 and elsewhere.

Now, the explanation[29] is that, as known[30] about the bond between the upper and lower, it can be in [one of] two ways. That is, either the upper descends to the lower, or the lower ascends to the upper. However, when the lower cannot ascend to the upper, there is a third way. This is when the upper descends to the intermediary between the upper and the lower, and the lower ascends to the intermediary, and they thus unite in the middle.

This may be compared to the difference between the verse,[31] "*HaShem*-יהו"ה descended upon Mount Sinai," in which there literally was a revelation below of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*), this being the descent of the Upper to the lower, and in the coming future, the lower will ascend to the Upper. For, as known, in the coming future the lower will be refined and uplifted to that place, as explained in the Siddur at the end of the discourse entitled "*Adona"y Sefatai Tiftach*" in the prayers of Rosh HaShanah.[32]

However, the third way,[33] is like the verse,[34] "Moshe ascended to God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם," and was on the mountain for forty days in which "he did not eat bread,"[35] not even the Manna

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[29] Regarding the coming section see Ohr HaTorah, Drushim L'Rosh HaShanah Vol. 6, p. 2,464 and on.

[30] See Likkutei Torah Re'eh 26a; 27d; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema 73d; Shaarei Teshuvah Vol. 2 p. 26b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 Vol. 1 p. 324; 5632 Vol. 1 p. 118; 5672-5676 p. 258 and on.

[31] Exodus 19:20

[32] Siddur Im Da"Ch 238c and on; Also see Ohr HaTorah Toldot (Vol. 4) p. 815a; Drushim L'Chag HaSukkot p. 1,749; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 2 p. 421 and on, and elsewhere.

[33] See Likkutei Torah, Re'eh ibid. 26a; 28b, and elsewhere.

[34] Exodus 19:3

[35] Exodus 34:28

bread,[36] and the [Supernal] speech unified with him there. This is because what Moshe grasped on the mountain was through the descent from Above to below and was so incredibly lofty that it cannot be [that which brings about the unification of the Upper and the lower in an inner manifest way, as explained in continuation].

(This is because the descent of the Upper to the lower is in [one of] two ways. Either the drawing down is so that in an inner manifest way the lower will have actual revelation, in which case only a radiance is drawn down [to the lower]. In contrast, when His Essential Self is drawn down this does not become revealed to the recipient in an inner manifest way, since the recipient is not a vessel for this. Thus, the drawing down to Moshe to reveal the Torah, that is, drawing down His Essential Self and [moreover] in an inner manifest (*b'Pnimiyut*) way, would not be possible through the descent of the Upper to the lower [alone].) Likewise, if there only would be the ascent of Moshe alone, he would be incapable of ascending to such a level.

However, after Moshe had ascended and became refined in accordance with what was possible for him, [up to the aspect of] "and what-*Ma"h*-מ"ה are we,"[37] and from Above there also was a drawing of the light by way of descent, it then became possible for the two to bond. (That is, there was an illumination of the Upper [in the lower] in an inner manifest way-*b'Pnimiyut*).

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[36] Also see Torah Ohr Yitro 74a; Likkutei Torah Bamidbar 7b; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 2 p. 596 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5639 Vol. 2 p. 528; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 4 p. 1,037 in the glosses; Vol. 36 p. 177, note 37.

[37] See Exodus 16:7-8

The same is so of the souls of the Jewish people in general, that there also is a middle where they bond. This is as in the verse,[38] "for you to pass into the covenant," meaning, to pass from level to level until the place of the Upper Thought, this being the aspect of the Long Patient One-*Arich Anpin* - the root and source of the emanations, "and to be a God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם for you,"[39] meaning that the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, lowers Himself, so to speak, into the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik*, where there is the bond in which the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One illuminates within the souls of the Jewish people. This is as stated in Likkutei Torah, in the discourse entitled "*Atem Nitzavim*,"[40] and at the end of the explanation of the discourse entitled "*Ki Ka'aretz Totzee Tzimchah*."[41]

However, this specifically is when He lowers Himself, so to speak, into the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik*. That is, it is through the descent of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) into the Ancient One-*Atik*, that although in itself, it is the aspect of being transcendent and removed, it nonetheless becomes the intermediary by which a bond between the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) and the souls of the Jewish people becomes possible.

Now, just as the Crown-*Keter* is the intermediary between the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) and the emanations, so likewise, as known, the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) in general, is the intermediary between the

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[38] Deuteronomy 29:11
[39] Genesis 17:7; Deuteronomy 26:17; Also see Deuteronomy 29:12.
[40] Likkutei Torah Nitzavim 44d; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5652 p. 119
[41] Likkutei Torah ibid. 53c

limitless light of the Unlimited One who emanates, and the creations.[42]

In this too there is the descent of His Essential Self into the intermediary, this being the matter of "the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*." That is, the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik* is itself that which is removed and utterly separately transcendent. However, by being drawn into the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, it becomes an intermediary.

This is as known, that the two aspects of the intermediary of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) are the Upper Wisdom (*Chochmah Ila'ah*) and the Lower Wisdom (*Chochmah Tata'ah*), as discussed in Torah Ohr in the discourse entitled "*Ki Avraham Lo Yadaanu*."[43] Then, through the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) two opposites can unify, meaning, the Supernal Emanator - the Unlimited One, blessed is He, with the creatures of the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*).

Elsewhere[44] it is explained that the bond is brought about through Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*. This is because Understanding-*Binah* is called the Upper Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah Ila'ah*) in that "she causes the

[42] See Ohr HaTorah, Megillat Esther p. 132 and on; p. 145; p. 270 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 12 and on; p. 318 and on, and elsewhere.

[43] Torah Ohr, Megillat Esther 93a; Also see Ohr HaTorah Megillat Esther p. 134; p. 271.

[44] See Biurei HaZohar of the Mittler Rebbe 16d; Also see Ohr HaTorah Megillat Esther ibid. p. 272.

dwelling (*Mashkenet*-משכנת) and manifestation,"[45] which is that which relates to the lower. This is as known that the primary aspect of His light that fills all worlds (*Memaleh Kol Almin*) is from Understanding-*Binah*. Therefore, that is the place of the bond with the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) that radiates in Wisdom-*Chochmah*.[46] That is, the emanation of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) is as an intermediary, and in this aspect the bond can be.

Now, as known[47] the Torah is also an intermediary between the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One and the souls of the Jewish people. This is as in the teaching,[48] "Three knots[49] are bound to each other. The Jewish people are bound to the Torah, and the Torah is bound to the Holy One, blessed is He."

That is, through the Torah, a union and bond is caused between the souls of the Jewish people and the limitless light of the Unlimited One. This is because there are two aspects in the Torah, as the verse states,[50] "He dons light as a garment," meaning in an inner way (*Pnimiyut*) and in an external way

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[45] See Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 21, section on "*Shechinah*" (There it states, "The Understanding-*Binah* is also called the Indwelling Presence (*Shechinah*) because she causes the dwelling and manifestation of the three upper *Sefirot* over the seven *Sefirot* of construct."); Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 8b and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5680 p. 116, and elsewhere. [Also see Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Eight (*Binah*), section on "Upper *Shechinah*-*Shechinah Ila'ah*-שכינה עילאה."]

[46] See Tanya, Ch. 35 in the author's note.

[47] See Ohr HaTorah, Beshalach Vol. 7 p. 2,657; Chukat p. 848; Ohr HaTorah to Tehillim (Yahel Ohr) p. 398; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek Vol. 1 p. 98; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 324 and on, and elsewhere.

[48] Zohar III 73a

[49] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 28 in the glosses; Sefer HaMaamarim 5689 p. 138.

[50] Psalms 104:2

(*Chitzoniyut*). That is, the souls of the Jewish people ascend to the aspect of the garment, and the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He, descends and lowers Himself into the light in the garment, thereby bringing a union about, in that the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One dwells and is revealed in the souls of the Jewish people.

(This is because, as known, the Torah is called a covenant (*Brit*),[51] as the verse states,[52] "These are the words of the covenant (*Brit*)," and similarly,[53] "According to these words did *HaShem*-יהו"ה seal a covenant (*Brit*) with you." The matter of the covenant formed by the Torah is that nothing separates between them and they are bound to the Essential Self of the Unlimited One in the Torah, as explained elsewhere.[54]

This then,[55] is the difference between the intermediary that relates to the worlds, and the intermediary between the limitless light of the Unlimited One and the souls of the Jewish people. That is, in relation to the worlds, the intermediary causes a separation between them, so that what is drawn into the world is only a mere radiance, and not His Essential Self, as explained before about the matter of an intermediary. In contrast, the intermediary of the Torah causes no separation, and there thus is a bond between the souls of the Jewish people

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[51] See Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 33a that "'covenant-*Brit*-ברית' refers to nothing other than Torah." This is similarly stated in Yalkut Shimoni, Remez 195. (Also see Pesachim 68b; Nedarim 32a); Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 Vol. 2 p. 681; Ohr HaTorah Bechukotai p. 203; Eikev p. 486 and on.

[52] Deuteronomy 28:69; Also see Rashi there.

[53] See Exodus 34:27

[54] See at length in Shaarei Teshuvah Vol. 2 59a and on; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5563 and Ohr HaTorah Eikev ibid.

[55] See Shaarei Teshuvah ibid. 59b and on.

and the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He.)

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Now, based on the above, we [also] can understand the two levels in the simple essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi HaPashut*). That is, in the pleasure that comes to be felt, even though it literally is the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) of the essential concealment of the Unlimited One, nevertheless, this is as the above-mentioned pleasure comes into the essential concealment of the wisdom of the Torah, as it is in the Essential Self of the Unlimited One. That is, it indeed is literally the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) but being that it comes into Wisdom-*Chochmah*, it therefore is in a way that is sensed by the souls of the Jewish people in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of the Torah and the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of the *mitzvot*. (That is, this is the hidden essential pleasure in the *mitzvot*, as explained before.)[56]

This is like how, so to speak, the Ancient One-*Atik* is literally the aspect of the Supernal transcendence of His Being, but nevertheless, through coming into the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* and the Ancient One-*Atik*, it thereby at the very least, becomes an intermediary, thereby causing the bond and illumination of the light within the souls of the Jewish people, as explained before.

[56] In the discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 89) and the end of the discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (p. 101).

The same is so of the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik* when it comes into the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*]. It is an intermediary, and thus a bond and grasp is possible through keeping the 365 negative *mitzvot*, this being the matter of "My Name-*Shmee*-שמי-350" plus *Yod-Hey*-י״ה is 365-שס״ה.

The same is so of the intermediary of the Torah, in that through it the souls of the Jewish people bond with the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One in the Torah.

The same is understood even in the first root, literally in His Essential Self, in that through His essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) coming into the concealed essence of the wisdom of Torah, it thereby will come to be sensed by the souls of the Jewish people in the coming future, in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of the Torah and *mitzvot*.

This then, is the matter of the "four hundred worlds of delight that the righteous will inherit in the coming future,"[57] in the aspect of felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*). For, although this pleasure does not come as a composite with wisdom and reason, being that the concealed essence of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is not the matter of reason and wisdom, but is rather the matter of pleasure, as explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei Yaakov*"),[58] though presently this is revealed as a matter of intellect, nevertheless, in essence, it literally is the matter of pleasure (*Taanug*). This is the matter that the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* actually is the

[57] Zohar III 288a (Idra Zuta); Also see Zohar I 123b; Zohar III 128b (Idra Rabba); Etz Chayim, Shaar 13 (Shaar Arich Anpin) Ch. 5; Torah Ohr, Vayishlach 24c; Torat Chayim Vayishlach 41d and on.

[58] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 129 and on.

innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*. Yet, even so, it comes in a felt way, as discussed before.

This is also the meaning of the statement in Midrash Rabbah, that "it is Me you are taking" through the Torah, this being the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One as it comes into the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Torah.

However, the aspect of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) as it literally is in the essential concealment of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*) is much higher than this, in that it does not at all come into the aspect of the concealed essence of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is because it is altogether unfelt, not even in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of Torah and *mitzvot*.

This is like the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One that does not come to be the aspect of the Crown-*Keter* and the Ancient One-*Atik*, or like the Ancient One-*Atik* itself before it has come to the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. In other words, it is not at all an intermediary, and thus having any grasp of it does not apply, not even in a way of negation through the negative *mitzvot*.

The same is so of the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) as it literally is in the hidden encompassing aspect (*Makif HaNe'elam*) which altogether is not in a state of being drawn down, not even into the essential concealment of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This aspect does not at all come in a felt way.

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This then, is the second ascent that will take place for the souls of the Jewish people in the coming future. To explain, even in the coming future there will be ascents, as the verse states,[59] "Those whose hope is in *HaShem*-יהו"ה will have renewed strength; they will grow wing like an eagle." About this our sages, of blessed memory, stated,[60] "In the thousand years when the Holy One, blessed is He, is destined to renew His world, what will the righteous be doing? The Holy One, blessed is He, will make wings like eagles for them and they will fly above the surface of the water." This refers to the coming future when they will come to the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) concealed in Wisdom-*Chochmah*, this being the reasons (*Taamim*) of Torah. This aspect is called "renewing His world."

It may be posited that this is because even now there is a likeness to this in the world, this being the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] which is the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Ancient One-*Atik*, and likewise is the intermediary aspect of the Crown-*Keter*, as explained before. Therefore, the revelation of the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) concealed within Wisdom-*Chochmah*, is only called "the renewal of His world."

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[59] Isaiah 40:31

[60] Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 92b; Also see Torat Chayim Bereishit 4c and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bereishit p. 87 and on; p. 149 and on; Ohr HaTorah Bereishit 30a and on; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 264 and on; 5658 p. 242 and on.

[The teaching then continues], "What will the righteous be doing?" That is, they undergo further ascent, in that "they will fly above the surface of the waters" of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, this being the essential encompassing aspect (*Makif HaAtzmi*) of the essential delights of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, literally, which does not come into the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is as the verse states,[61] "We will live before Him," **literally** before Him, in the aspect of the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*).

For, since the souls of the Jewish people are rooted in the Essential Self that transcends the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of Torah, even in its first root, and as the verse states,[62] "Only that *HaShem*-יהו"ה had delight in your forefathers," meaning that even before the Torah was given, "*HaShem*-יהו"ה had delight in your forefathers," in His actual essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) which has not yet come into the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. This is why in the coming future they will ascend to this aspect and level. (In regard to the fact that in the coming future there will be no further ascents,[63] this refers to when they will ascend in His essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) and will literally live before Him.)

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[61] Hosea 6:2

[62] Deuteronomy 10:15; Also see the earlier discourse entitled "*Lech Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 90).

[63] See Torat Menachem, Hadranim Al HaRambam v'Sha"S p. 308, note 65, that even then there will be ascents, only that they will not be in a way of movement and departure from His Essential Self, but in a way of tranquility, this being in His Essential Self.

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Now, based on the above[64] we can understand the differences in the Midrashic teachings about the coming world (*Olam HaBa*). That is, the Midrash[65] states that the Holy One, blessed is He, will make a feast. However, in Talmud[66] it states that in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) there is no eating and no drinking.

The explanation is that the feast of the Levitathan (*Livyatan*) and the Wild Ox (*Shor HaBar*) that will take place in the coming future[67] is the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) that comes in a felt way, in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of the Torah.[68] This refers to the first ascent[69] of the coming future, in which the concealed essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi HaNe'elam*) will be revealed.

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[64] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid.; Also see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Vayikra Vol. 1 p. 145 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5650 p. 367 and on; 5663 Vol. 1 p. 26; Sefer HaSichot 5697 p. 158 and note 19 there.

[65] Midrash Vayikra Rabbah 13:3

[66] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 17a

[67] See Talmud Bavli, Bava Batra 74b; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 104c and on, and elsewhere; Also see earlier in *Hemshech* 5666, p. 129.

[68] In the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid., he adds "this being the matter of studying the Torah teachings of Moshiach."

[69] See Likkutei Sichot Vol. 21 p. 87 note 33, that here he is explaining these two teachings of our sages, of blessed memory, (i.e., that the Holy One, blessed is He, will make a feast for the righteous *Tzaddikim*, and that in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) there is no eating or drinking) to be referring to two different times. This is unlike what is explained in various places (Likkutei Torah Tzav 15c and elsewhere) that the physical feast will take place at that same time that "their crowns are upon their heads," which is the same time as the their teaching that "in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) there is no eating or drinking etc." Also see the citations in Likkutei Sichot ibid. p. 86; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 4 p. 193, note 61 (Vol. 2 p. 73 in earlier editions).

However, when they stated that in the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) there is no eating or drinking, this refers to the second ascent,[70] which is the aspect of "I will be as I will be-*Ehe'eh Asher Eheyeh*-אהיה אשר אהיה"[71] and follows the revelation of the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) in the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Torah, [but is the aspect] of "I am destined to be revealed further"[72] in the aspect of the simple essential pleasure that is unfelt (*Taanug HaAtzmi HaBilti Murgash*) even in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of the Torah. This is why there will be no eating or drinking in it, since it does not at all come in a felt way.

This is like the verse,[73] "Eat, friends etc.," about which Zohar states,[74] "But afterwards it is not His way to eat." Elsewhere[75] it is explained that "eat, friends" refers to the aspects of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, whereas "afterwards," referring to the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik*, "it is not His way [to eat]."

This is like what we explained before, that when the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) comes into the essential concealment of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, it then applies for there to be a matter of eating. That is, this refers to how it comes into the aspect of felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*). However, "afterwards," in the aspect of the Ancient One-*Atik* itself, which

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[70] See the preceding note.
[71] Exodus 3:14
[72] Zohar III 11a
[73] Song of Songs 5:1
[74] Zohar III 242a
[75] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 251b; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Vayikra Vol. 1 p. 138; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 376 and on; 5639 Vol. 2 p. 552; Also see Likkutei Torah ibid.

does not come into the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of the Father-*Abba*, which in its first root refers to the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) as it literally is in His Essential Self, "it is not His way to eat," meaning that it does not at all come into a state of being felt.

This is also the difference between Shabbat and Yom HaKippurim.[76] That is, it is a *mitzvah* to make Shabbat pleasurable by eating and drinking,[77] this being the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) that comes into sensation. For, as known,[78] eating [food] on Shabbat has no admixture of evil in it whatsoever, akin to how the eating will be in the coming future. This is because it is the aspect of the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*), and there thus is no admixture in it at all. In contrast, on Yom HaKippurim it is forbidden to eat or drink,[79] and is akin to how the coming world (*Olam HaBa*) will be when there is no eating or drinking.

On the contrary, one must afflict himself with the five afflictions [of Yom HaKippurim].[80] This is because Yom HaKippurim bears a likeness to the coming world (*Olam HaBa*),[81] this being the aspect of the essential pleasure (*Taanug*

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[76] Regarding the coming section, see Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 2 p. 436 and on; 5636 Vol. 2 p. 311 and on; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 1,125 and on; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 250a; 251b; Also see the conclusion of *Hemshech* 5666 (p. 713 and on).

[77] See Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 118b; Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Shabbat 30:7; Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe, Orach Chayim 242:1.

[78] See Zohar II 88b; Torah Ohr, Chayei Sarah 15c; Siddur Im Da"Ch 201b; 203c.

[79] See Talmud Bavli, Yoma 73b (in the Mishnah).

[80] See Yoma 73b ibid.

[81] As stated in the discourse entitled "*Yetzav HaShem*" ibid., "it bears a likeness to the second level of the coming world (*Olam HaBa*)." The same is likewise stated

Atzmi) that does not come into sensation at all. Therefore, all sensed pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*) is forbidden on Yom HaKippurim, and on the contrary, there must be affliction, which is the opposite of sensed pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*), as the verse states,[82] "You shall afflict yourselves (*Nafshoteichem*-נפשותיכם)," also referring to the soul-Nefesh-נפש,[83] in that through the affliction, every felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*) will be nullified and he will come to the essential pleasure that is altogether unfelt (*Taanug HaAtzmi HaBilti Murgash*).

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Now, to reach the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) as it literally is in His Essential Self, this cannot possibly happen through Torah and *mitzvot*, because this is something that even transcends the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of Torah and *mitzvot* as they are in their first root etc. Rather, this specifically is brought about by repentance (*Teshuvah*) alone from the depth of the heart, which literally reaches the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) Himself.

(This is the advantage of the final set of Tablets over the first set of Tablets at the giving of the Torah which relate to the elevated level of Torah and *mitzvot*. In contrast, the final set of Tablets relate to the elevated level of repentance (*Teshuvah*), which is why they were given on Yom HaKippurim, which is

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at the end of *Hemshech* 5666 ibid. (p. 713); Also see Ateret Rosh of the Mittler Rebbe 28a and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim Vol. 3 p. 913.

[82] Leviticus 16:31 and elsewhere.

[83] See Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Devarim ibid. p. 1,126.

the matter of forgiveness for sins through the thirteen attributes of mercy that Moshe drew down.)

The explanation is that our sages, of blessed memory, stated,[84] "In the place where those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) stand, even the perfectly righteous (*Tzaddikim Gemurim*) cannot stand." Zohar[85] states that the reason is because "those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) draw Him down with even greater strength."

However, at first glance, this is not understood. This is because the perfectly righteous (*Tzaddikim Gemurim*) serve *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, in a way of essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) with the essence of their souls. That is, they are in a state of great love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*), literally delighting in *HaShem*-יהו"ה with the expiry of the soul. This certainly reaches the entire innerness of their souls to the point of expiry.

This being so, why is it that "those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) draw Him down with even greater strength," apparently indicating that it even is with greater strength than the great love with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) of the perfectly righteous (*Tzaddikim Gemurim*). However, is it not so that the righteous also serve *HaShem*-יהו"ה with the very essence of their souls, as mentioned above?

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[84] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 34b

[85] Zohar I 129a; Tanya, Iggeret HaTeshuvah, Ch. 8 (98b)

However, the explanation is that as known[86] about the verse,[87] "From the depths I called to you *HaShem*-יהו"ה," that the first *Mem*-מ of the word "depths-*Ma'amakim*-מעמקים" refers to the depth (*Omek*) of the Crown-*Keter* of the Crown-*Keter*, which transcends the "depths-*Omkeem*-עומקים" of the Crown-*Keter* of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*. This is called "the depth of the depth" (*Omka d'Omka*),[88] and is present specifically in those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*), but is not within the capacity of the perfectly righteous (*Tzaddikim Gemurim*).

To further explain, the root of the souls[89] of the righteous (*Tzaddikim*) is in the simple pleasure (*Taanug HaPashut*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and emotions (*Midot*) of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). Higher than this, in the first root, is the aspect of His essential delights (*Sha'ashu'im HaAtzmiyim*) in His wisdom, blessed is He. Therefore, even with their great love of Him with delight in Him in a way of a simple song (*Shir Pashut*) or with joy in Torah and *mitzvot*,[90] they only are capable of reaching the first source from where they are hewn, this being the essential pleasure

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[86] See Ateret Rosh 54a; 55b; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 234d; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Devarim Vol. 3 p. 994 and on; Also see the prior discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 99).

[87] Psalms 130:1

[88] See Zohar II 63b; Zohar III 70a

[89] Also see the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid.

[90] These being the two modes of service by the righteous *Tzaddikim*. The first is the service with essential joy in Torah and *mitzvot*, the revelation of this being in the essential joy on the holidays. The second is the aspect of the simple song (*Shir Pashut*) of Shabbat, as mentioned before (see the discourse entitled "*vHinei Bichdei*" ibid.)

(*Taanug HaAtzmi*) in the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

This is called a felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*) in comparison to the true light of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, as a concealed pleasure (*Taanug HaNe'elam*) that transcends the revelation of the light of the wisdom of the Primordial Torah. Proof for this is from the fact that their service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, is in a way of felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*).

Moreover, even their self-sacrifice in the aspect of the expiry of the soul because of the dominance of the great love of Him with delight in Him, with sweetness, delight, endearment,[91] and the strong bonds of their soul to the Living God, is also only in a way of a felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*) in their souls. It thus follows that this is not the actual arousal of the very essence of the soul.

However, the essential arousal of those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) is higher than this, with many tears from the depths of the depths of the recesses of the heart, literally to the point of expiry, like Rabbi Elazar ben Dordiya whose soul departed with weeping,[92] and the like. This is much higher than self-sacrifice with great love of Him and delighting in *HaShem*-יהו"ה. This is because even the self-sacrifice with great love of Him with delight in Him is in the aspect of a felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*).

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[91] See Ohr HaChayim to the beginning of Parshat Acharei (section beginning "*Oh Yomar Al Zeh HaDerech*"), explained in Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Et'halech Liozhna p. 33; Maamarei RaZa"L p. 465; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 32 p. 98, note 7.

[92] Talmud Bavli, Avodah Zarah 17a

In contrast, in those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) the opposite is true, in that it is in a way of anguish and the embitterment of the soul to the greatest degree, meaning that literally in the inner depth and recesses of his soul he is moved to the point of expiry.

That is, this actually touches the very essence of the soul much more than the felt pleasure (*Taanug Murgash*).[93] Likewise, Above, it reaches the concealed pleasure (*Taanug HaNe'elam*) in His Essential Self, something that the perfectly righteous (*Tzaddikim Gemurim*) are incapable of reaching through love of Him with delight in Him, or through joy in Torah and *mitzvot*.

(Rather, only through self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*) for Torah and *mitzvot* can they reach His actual Essential Self, like the ten martyrs who caused the ascent of the feminine waters (*Mayim Nukvin*) until the time of the coming of Moshiach and the time of the coming world.[94] This is because this self-sacrifice was for the Torah[95] itself, and not for the sense of the wisdom of the Torah, as discussed before. That is, this was like the days of Mordechai and Esther and the Hasmoneans, and is

[93] For, even though the pleasure (*Taanug*) also literally reaches the essence of the soul, nevertheless, there itself it is a motion of pleasure (*Taanug*), which is a motion of expansiveness. In contrast, the motion of pain and embitterment is a motion of constriction, and in the soul itself, the constriction touches the soul to a greater degree than the expansiveness. (See the discourse entitled "*v'Hinei Bichdei*" ibid.)

[94] See Etz Chayim, Shaar HaKlallim Ch. 1; Shaar 39 (Shaar Ma"N uMa"D) Drush 1; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 1 p. 13; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Bereishit p. 357; Shemot Vol. 1 p. 261 and on.

[95] In the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid., it states "Torah and *mitzvot*."

the self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*) for the sanctification of *HaShem*-יהו"ה present every Jew.

The same is so of the afflictions of love (*Yissurin Shel Ahavah*)[96] that the perfectly righteous endure, and this likewise is so of the souls of the Jewish people in general because of the pressures and difficulties of servitude [about which the verse states],[97] "The children of Israel groaned because of the work and they cried out."

That is, there thereby is caused to be an opening of the essential point of Jewishness in the depths of their souls, in the *Yechidah* essence of the soul, to a greater degree than the arousal of great love of Him with delight in Him.)

This is why those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) "draw (*Mashcheen*-משכין) Him down with even greater strength," that is, they draw down (*Mamsheecheem*-ממשיכים) the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) with much greater and stronger force of strength than that which the perfectly righteous (*Tzaddikim Gemurim*) draw through their wondrous adhesion [to Him].

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However,[98] at first glance, this is not yet understood. For, how is it that there is greater strength in the great anguish and bitterness of one who truly returns in repentance (*Baal Teshuvah*), more than the wondrous pleasure of the perfectly

[96] See Talmud Bavli, Brachot 5b and elsewhere.

[97] Exodus 2:23

[98] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid.

righteous (*Tzaddik Gamur*)? Is it not well known[99] that pain and pleasure are two equally counterbalanced lines, and that to the degree of the depth of the pleasure in something will be the anguish and embitterment over its absence?

This being so, here too, in those who return in repentance (*Baal Teshuvah*), even though their embitterment is not out of a sense of pleasure, such that they are anguished over its absence, but they rather are anguished and embittered because of being essentially distant, it nonetheless is certain that the power of their embitterment about the distance, will not be greater than the power of the pleasure they would have if they were close, since the two lines are equally counterbalanced.

On the contrary, if in their repentance they would sense the wondrous pleasure in coming close to Godliness, there then would be room to say that the anguish would be greater than the pleasure in coming close, this being due to the pleasure itself. For, as known, what is impossible for a person to grasp causes greater yearning and desire for it in him, and he thus will suffer more by its absence.

An example of this is lovesickness. That is, it specifically is after having sensed the pleasure in the closeness that there then is room to say that the suffering may be greater than the pleasure in the closeness, since because of the distance greater pleasure is caused in being close, [specifically] because of its absence, which is why there is an automatic increase in the suffering over the distance.

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[99] See Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, p. 6a; 19a (Ch. 6 & Ch. 23).

That is, this is because of the pleasure itself, in that to the degree of the pleasure in closeness (which is increased and expanded in him because of its absence, as mentioned before) commensurate to this will be the anguish over the distance.

However, since those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) truly have no pleasure in the closeness, and this is not what causes their anguish, but they rather are anguished over the essential distance,[100] why then should this anguish and embitterment be greater than the pleasure of the righteous (*Tzaddikim*)?

Moreover, although we indeed see that their anguish and embitterment truly is greater than the pleasure of the righteous (*Tzaddikim*), it could be posited that had they been righteous (*Tzaddikim*), their pleasure in the closeness would also be greater and this is why their suffering is greater. That is, [it could be said that] it is not that their suffering over the distance is essentially greater than the pleasure in the closeness, but it specifically is commensurate to the pleasure. This being so, why is it said that their suffering is greater than the pleasure, such that "they draw down the Holy One, blessed is He, with greater strength?"

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However, the explanation is as the verse states,[101] "From the straits I called to *Ya"H*-י"ה," and specifically through this, "*Ya"H*-י"ה answered me with expansiveness."

[100] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 143 note 99.
[101] Psalms 118:5

To explain, this is the general principle in all things that come out of constraint and pressure, in that it comes in a way of spreading forth with great strength that is altogether beyond one's own measure.

An example is the straits of the veins and fissures of the earth, which cause the waters in the depths [of the aquifer] to ascend from below to above with great strength and force and to burst forth through the stones (called[102] "the damp stones"). It also is like the stone of a catapult, that because it is restrained in the catapult and pulled down to below, the stone is thereby thrown with great force, altogether beyond the force it would otherwise have. The same is so of stretching a bow and arrow, that to the degree that the string of the bow is pulled back, the arrow will fly a greater distance. This likewise is the matter of blowing the Shofar through its narrow end, which comes with greater constriction and pressure, and specifically thereby the sound spreads forth with strength from the wide end.

The same is understood about those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*), that their constriction with anguish and embitterment over their distance, reaches a much greater depth in the innerness of the soul, much greater than the pleasure in closeness.

In other words, it touches the very essence of his Jewishness, that is, the essential point of the inner recesses of the Godly soul. This then, is why the suffering is much greater than the pleasure, because it comes from the greater constraint

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[102] See Sefer Yetzirah-Nuscha Yesheinah Chapter One, Mishnah 12; Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 12a (and Rashi there); Zohar I 16a, and the notes in Derech Emet of Rabbi Chayim Vital there; Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 25 (Shaar HaTemurot) Ch. 7; Rabbi Chayim Vital to Zohar II 105a; Siddur Im Da"Ch 74d.

over the distance, and he thereby reaches a deeper and more inner aspect of the soul, much greater than the pleasure from the closeness.

He thus automatically also reaches even higher in the innerness and Essential Self of the Unlimited One, higher than the perfectly righteous (*Tzaddik Gamur*), being that "they [the repentant] are drawn to Him with greater strength," meaning with greater strength in the essence of their souls.

This then,[103] is why repentance (*Teshuvah*) is specifically by way of a leap and is not by way of gradation. That is, it is unlike the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, of the righteous *Tzaddikim* which is in a way of order and gradation, as in the verse,[104] "He went and traveled" from level to level, and like the verse,[105] "They advance from strength to strength" [about] the delight of the souls in the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*). The same is so of the great love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*) below, that it all is in a way of gradation.

In contrast, the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, of those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) is like "leaping over a wall,"[106] meaning not in a way of gradation, but rather [a leap] from the ultimate distance to the ultimate closeness. That is, he leaves the ultimate lowliness and materiality to the ultimate elevation and refinement.

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[103] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid.

[104] Genesis 12:9

[105] Psalms 84:8

[106] See Samuel II 22:30; Psalms 18:30; Also see Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Yom HaKippurim 69d and elsewhere.

Now, as known,[107] all leaps specifically require much greater strength. For example, when a person wants to go over a wide river or a wide pit, he does not have the power to skip and leap over from one side to the other side except if he invests all of his strength with great abandonment, altogether beyond gradation. He then will leap with a much greater leap far beyond his strength and beyond relativity altogether.

For example, when in war a person gives over his life in a way of abandonment, he will then be able to leap over the river or the deep pit. In contrast, when he is not in a state of abandonment, in his soul he will estimate his ability and strength in a way of gradation, and will only be able to leap according to his strength.

These are all examples by which to understand the statement about those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) that "they draw Him down with greater strength," this being the strength of the great leap of departing from the materiality of his body with essential abandonment and literally despising his life.

This is because the embitterment has literally touched him in the very essence of his soul and this is what causes the ascent of his soul to the highest of heights, altogether not in a way of gradation. This is because he has placed all the strength in the depths of his heart in a way that is beyond measure, like the repentance of Rabbi Elazar ben Dordiya whose soul departed etc. That is, his soul ascended to the highest of heights, beyond what a perfectly righteous *Tzaddik* can ascend

[107] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5569 p. 65; Sefer HaMaamarim 5671 p. 70 and on, and elsewhere.

to. The reason it is not in a way of gradation is for the above-mentioned reason. That is, the greater the constraint and pressure, the greater will be his strength come to be beyond all measure.

This then,[108] is the meaning of the verse, "From the straits I called to *Ya"H*-י"ה." That is, it specifically is because of the constraint and pressure in the inner point of his heart that the essential point of his Jewishness is touched, such that he literally despises his life of vanity, because to the strength of his embitterment, and it specifically is thereby that "*Ya"H*-י"ה answered me with expansiveness," with the expansiveness of the light of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One, this being something that one is incapable of coming to in a revealed way whatsoever, even through the depths of the pleasure in Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah* etc. This is **true** expansiveness, whereas whatever is in a state of being drawn forth is automatically not actual true expansiveness. This is because the true essential expansiveness is as it literally is in His Essential Self.

This then, is the meaning of the *Mem*-מ of "from the depths-*MiMa'amakim*-ממעמקים."[109] That is, it specifically is through repentance (*Teshuvah*) from the depths of the heart, that one reaches the depth and essential concealment of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*), meaning the actual essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*) in the Essential Self of the Unlimited One

[108] See the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid.

[109] See the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid. p. 1,131, which specifies "the first *Mem*-מ" of "from the depths-*MiMa'amakim*-ממעמקים" (as was already mentioned previously in the discourse above).

(*Atzmut Ein Sof*), much higher than the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of Torah and *mitzvot*.

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This then, is the meaning of the verse,[110] "It shall be on that day that living [spring] waters will flow out of Yerushalayim, half of it [will flow] to the Eastern Sea (*Yam HaKadmoni*)." As known,[111] "living [spring] waters" (*Mayim Chayim*) refers to waters that burst forth through the dust of the earth. They are the sparks that fell all the way to below.

This likewise is generally so of the descent of the soul, which descended to below into the material body and animalistic soul and became distant from Godliness, and came to be in a state in which "the lower waters weep, 'we yearn to be before the King.'"[112] This is the aspect of the "living [spring] waters" (*Mayim Chayim*) which ascend with great force because of the strength of the embitterment, similar to the verse,[113] "He who goes weeping on his way," and like the springs that burst through the rocks. This refers to the matter of breaking the rock of the animalistic soul with great force and strong embitterment. This is especially so of those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*), as discussed before.

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[110] Zachariah 14:8

[111] See Torah Ohr, Toldot 20b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 180; 5639 Vol. 2 p. 409.

[112] Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 5 (19b); Tosefot HaRosh to Genesis 1:7; Also see Rabbeinu Bachaye to Leviticus 2:13; Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 5:4.

[113] Psalms 126:6

Thus, this ascends higher than the aspect of the "Eastern Sea" (*Yam HaKadmoni*-ים הקדמוני), which is the aspect of the Primordial Wisdom (*Chochmah HaKedoomah*-חכמה הקדומה) of the Torah and the essential pleasure (*Taanug Atzmi*) in it. Rather, through breaking the rock of the animalistic soul, especially through repentance (*Teshuvah*), one literally reaches the concealment of His Essential Self, and from there he draws down completely new revelations.

This is like the verse, "From the depths I called You, *HaShem*-יהו"ה." That is, he literally calls forth the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה anew from the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) etc. About this the verse states,[114] "Return, O' Israel, until *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God." That is, through true repentance (*Teshuvah*) one literally reaches His Essential Self.

This is the meaning of "until *HaShem*-יהו"ה [is] your God-*Elo"hecha*-אלהי"ך," meaning, higher than the aspect of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in Torah and *mitzvot*, as explained elsewhere.[115] He thereby also draws additional lights into Torah and *mitzvot*. That is, in engaging in Torah [study] and fulfilling the *mitzvot* after the repentance (*Teshuvah*), there also is literally an illumination in them of the essential pleasure (*Taanug HaAtzmi*).

About this the verse continues,[116] "Take words with you and return to *HaShem*-יהו"ה." The "words-*Devarim*-דברים"

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[114] Hosea 14:2

[115] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 2 p. 913 and on; Also see Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Shabbat Shuvah 65a and on, and elsewhere.

[116] Hosea 14:3

refer to Torah and *mitzvot*, as the verse states,[117] "These words-*Devarim*-דברים shall be [upon your heart]." Thus, "Take words-*Devarim*-דברים with you" of Torah and *mitzvot* "and return to *HaShem*-יהו"ה" so that there is an illumination within "these words-*Devarim*-דברים" of Torah and *mitzvot* of this wondrous[118] Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה,[119] of the aspect of "from the depths-*MiMa'amakim*-ממעמקים."

This is like the teaching,[120] "The ultimate objective of Wisdom-*Chochmah* is repentance and good deeds," in which "repentance" precedes "good deeds,"[121] in that it is through [repentance] that the deeds are caused to be good and illuminating.

About this it states that from the aspect of the above-mentioned "living waters" (*Mayim Chayim*) brought about through repentance (*Teshuvah*), "half of it [will flow] to the Primordial Sea (*Yam HaKadmoni*)," this being the aspect of the Torah, "and half of it [will flow] to the final sea (*Yam HaAcharon*),"[122] referring to the good deeds done with the complete acceptance of the yoke of the Heavenly Kingdom, which is called "the final sea" (*Yam HaAcharon*) etc. In other words, there thereby is caused to be a drawing down of additional light in Torah and *mitzvot*.

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[117] Deuteronomy 6:6

[118] In the discourse entitled "*Inyan Yom HaKippurim*" ibid. it states "this **new** Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה."

[119] See Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*) and on.

[120] Talmud Bavli, Brachot 17a

[121] See Likkutei Torah Matot 82a; Drushim L'Shemini Atzeret 85a; Shir HaShirim 17a; Shaarei Orah 38b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 122.

[122] Zachariah 14:8 ibid.

This then, is why "Moshiach is destined to bring the righteous (*Tzaddikim*) to return in repentance,"[123] so that they will reach the place where those who return in repentance (*Baalei Teshuvah*) stand. Because to reach the aspect of the concealed essential pleasure (*Taanug HaNe'elam HaAtzmi*) as it literally is in His Essential Self, is not possible through Torah and *mitzvot*, but specifically only through repentance (*Teshuvah*). Through doing so we thereby draw down additional lights into Torah and *mitzvot* as well, as explained above.

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Now, based on the above, we can understand the verse, "Yaakov sent angels ahead of him… I have sojourned with Lavan etc." To explain, it was previously explained (in the discourse entitled "*Vayeitzei*")[124] that Yaakov traveling to Lavan was to bring about refinements (*Birurim*). However, that was the refinement he affected from Above in a way of goodness and holiness, meaning, that which he refined of the aspects of the "bound" (*Akudim*) and "speckled" (*Nekudim*),[125] this being the general matter of the world of Repair-*Tikkun*.

[123] See Zohar III 153b; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 2 p. 534 and on; p. 542 and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Kuntreisim p. 281 and on; Biurei HaZohar of the Tzemach Tzeddek, Vol. 2 p. 1,047 and on, and elsewhere.

[124] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 134 and on.

[125] See Etz Chayim, beginning of Shaar 6 (Shaar HaAkudim); Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 20 (regarding the worlds of Chaos-*Tohu* and Repair-*Tikkun*).

The refinement was of the lights that were shed[126] and fell from the aspect of the Upper Whiteness (*Loven HaElyon*-לובן העליון)[127], all of which is a refinement Above. Additionally, the refinement was brought about through Torah and *mitzvot*. For, since the refinement was within goodness, it thus automatically follows that the refinement was through Torah and *mitzvot*.

However, the refinement of Esav was a refinement of the evil in the shiny husk (*Nogah*). This is because the root of Esav was very lofty, in the aspect of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the world of Chaos-*Tohu*, which fell into the aspects of evil below.

This refinement is specifically brought about through repentance (*Teshuvah*), in that through it even the evil is transformed to good. However, to refine the aspects of evil, there first must be the refinement of the aspects of goodness, as stated,[128] "First correct yourself [and then correct others]." It thus was necessary for him to first strengthen himself in the refinements of the world of Repair-*Tikkun*, and only then was it in his ability to refine the aspects of evil.

It thus is in this regard that he sent angels to Esav and informed him, "I have sojourned-*Garti*-גרתי with Lavan," and "I kept the 613-תרי"ג *mitzvot*." That is, he informed him that he even completed[129] refining all the refinements Above in the

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[126] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate One (*Malchut*), section on the root "*Nesher*-נשר."

[127] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Ten (*Keter*), and elsewhere.

[128] Talmud Bavli, Bava Metziya 107b; Bava Batra 60b, and elsewhere.

[129] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 146, note 122.

aspect of goodness through the *mitzvot*, and that he already became strong in the aspects of the world of Repair-*Tikkun*, and that the time had now come to refine Esav, the aspect of evil, in that it now was in his ability to do so.

About this he said, "I have acquired oxen and donkeys etc.," these being aspects in levels of holiness.[130] [This is as stated],[131] "A sovereignty is his ox-like one,"[132] and,[133] "Yissachar is a strong boned donkey." Therefore, having strengthened himself in the aspects of the world of Repair-*Tikkun*, it was now in his ability to refine the evil of Esav.

This then, is why he said, "I have lingered until now." For, in truth, he did not have to linger so much, being that the blessings by which Yitzchak blessed him were to refine Esav.[134] This is because Yitzchak wanted to bless Esav, so that he thereby would be refined. However, in truth, this had to specifically be done by Yaakov.

We thus find that the primary intention of the blessings of Yitzchak were in order to grant the empowerment to refine Esav. (He blessed him with Torah, because in Torah there even are false arguments, this being the matter of refining the evil.) This being so, immediately upon receiving the blessings he should have refined Esav.

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[130] See Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 75:12; Also see the discourse entitled "*Vayishlach*" 5637 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5637); Sefer HaMaamarim 5656 p. 299 and on; p. 307; 5668 p. 55; Also see Torat Chayim, Vayishlach 42d.

[131] Deuteronomy 33:17

[132] Referring to Yosef – see Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 75:12 ibid.

[133] Genesis 39:14

[134] See Torah Ohr Toldot 20b and on; Also see the end of the previous discourse entitled "*Vayitein Lecha*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 124).

However, this was not yet possible, because he first had to strengthen himself in the aspects of the world of Repair-*Tikkun*. It thus is about this that he said, "I have lingered until now."[135] That is, he should not have tarried but was forced to tarry. The reason is because "I sojourned with Lavan," meaning [that he was occupied] in refining the aspects of good and strengthening himself, as discussed before. However, immediately upon departing from the house of Lavan, he sent [angels] to Esav, this being the matter of refining the evil.

This then, is the meaning of his words, "I am sending to tell my lord to find favor in your eyes." For, as known[136] about "finding favor" (*Chein*-חן) it is the aspect of the encompassing light (*Makif*), meaning the aspect of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the world of Chaos-*Tohu*. Thus, the meaning of "to find favor" is for there to be a drawing down of the encompassing lights (*Makifim*) of the world of Chaos-*Tohu* into the world of Repair-*Tikkun* in an inner manifest way (*b'Pnimiyut*), thereby bringing addition in the lights (*Orot*).

This is as explained before, that through the refinements brought about by repentance (*Teshuvah*), the "living waters" (*Mayim Chayim*) are thereby brought down, as they are refined [sparks], "half of which flow to the Primordial Sea (*Yam HaKadmoni*), and half." Through this, additional lights are drawn into Torah. This then is the meaning of "finding favor," that additional lights should be drawn into the Torah.

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[135] Also see Torat Chayim Vayishlach 41c and on; Ohr HaTorah Vayishlach 230b and on.

[136] See Torah Ohr Vayishlach 24c; Discourse entitled "*Vayishlach*" 5637; Sefer HaMaamarim 5656 ibid. (p. 307); 5668 ibid. (p. 57).

This is why immediately after departing from Lavan he sent [angels] to Esav to refine him, and he informed him that "I sojourned (*Garti*-גרתי) with Lavan," and refined the refinements of the side of goodness through the *mitzvot*, and that he already strengthened himself, and that it now is in his ability to refine Esav, who is the evil, through repentance (*Teshuvah*). [He thus said], "I am sending… to find favor (*Chein*-חן)," that there should be a drawing down of additional lights in the Torah.

Discourse 14

"*Ner Chanukah… -*
The Chanukah lamp…"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Vayeishev,
Shabbat Chanukah, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

It states in Talmud,[2] "It is a *mitzvah* to place the Chanukah lamp at the entrance to his house on the outside. Where is he to place it? On the left, so that the Chanukah lamp will be on the left and the Mezuzah on the right." Now, we must understand the relation between the Chanukah lamp and the Mezuzah, such that the Mezuzah must be on the right and the Chanukah lamp [on the left]. This seems to indicate that if there is no Mezuzah, it then is not possible for the Chanukah lamp to be on the left. However, it is not understood how they are interdependent one on the other.

Now, the verse states,[3] "for a *mitzvah* is a flame and Torah is light." About this Shnei Luchot HaBrit[4] states that "Torah is light" is like a big torch, whereas "a *mitzvah* is a

[1] This discourse (as well as some of the discourses that follow it until the discourse entitled "*VaHaShem Amar HaMechaseh Ani*" 5667) are founded upon the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel Moshe*" of the Mittler Rebbe in Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 393d and on; Discourse entitled "*Asher Bara Elokim*" 5628 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5628 p. 4 and on), as cited in later notes.

[2] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 21b and on.

[3] Proverbs 6:23

[4] See beginning of Shnei Luchot HaBrit 1a, cited in Ohr HaTorah Na"Ch to Proverbs 6:23 ibid. (Vol. 1) p. 568 and on.

flame" is like a single candle. Based on this, it is not understood why the verse gives precedence to "a *mitzvah* is a flame" over "Torah is light." It should have rather given precedence to Torah over *mitzvot*.

Now, to understand all this, we must preface with the explanation before,[5] that the ultimate revelation of the coming future will be in the pleasure and essential delights that altogether are unfelt (*Taanug Bilti Murgash*) not even in the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of Torah and *mitzvot*. This refers to that which does not even come into the aspect of the essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*. [It was explained that] it is not possible to attain this through Torah and *mitzvot*, since it does not even come into the reasons (*Ta'amim*) of Torah and *mitzvot*, but specifically by repentance (*Teshuvah*) alone, through which "they draw Him upon themselves with greater strength,"[6] in that they literally reach the aspect of His essential concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*).

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Now, in truth, by engaging in the study of Torah we indeed can reach the aspect of the simple essential unfelt pleasure, meaning, as it is in the concealment of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One. This is brought about by being precise in the words of wisdom.[7]

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[5] In the previous discourse (entitled "*Vayishlach Yaakov*"), *Hemshech* 5666 p. 141.

[6] See Zohar I 129a; Tanya, Iggeret HaTeshuvah, end of Ch. 8 (98b).

[7] Zohar I 130b

To explain, based on what was previously explained (in the discourse entitled "*Vayitein Lecha*")[8] it is understood that there are two matters in this. The first is that through toil one comes to the true intention of the light of a concept as it is to its ultimate truth and greatest depth. This is when there is a drawing down from the **essential** concealment (*He'elem HaAtzmi*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, so that the depth of the light of that concept is drawn from there to a much greater degree than from the depth of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*), which refers to that which is only drawn from the concealment (*He'elem*) of Wisdom-*Chochmah*.

However, there is another matter in this, in that through questions and answers one thereby refines the dross and waste from the concept. For, as explained before,[9] all questions stem from the side opposite holiness which conceal and hide. Then, when he reaches a greater depth in the concept, he thereby removes the concealments and hiddenness of the questions. We thus find that besides reaching a greater depth of the concept, he also thereby refines the dross and waste that cause the concealment.

Now, in this Talmud Bavli has an advantage over Talmud Yerushalmi. This is because even though Talmud Yerushalmi is clear wisdom in which there are no concealments and hiddenness, nonetheless, no matter of refinements (*Birurim*) are brought by it. In contrast, in Talmud Bavli [about which it states],[10] "The words,[11] 'He has made me dwell in

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[8] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 120 and on.
[9] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 120 and on ibid.
[10] Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 24a; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 24 p. 174.
[11] Lamentations 3:6

darkness' [refer to Talmud Bavli]," in which there are many concealments that hide the truth of the wisdom, and a great deal of toil and sharp analysis is required with [many] questions and answers. However, through this toil one thereby refines [and removes] the dross and comes to the true intention, and through doing so, he reaches much higher. This literally is the aspect of the essential delights (*Sha'ashu'eem HaAtzmiyim*), as previously discussed.

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Now, the explanation[12] is that the verse states,[13] "These are the last words of Dovid: The words of [Dovid, son of Yishai], and the words of the man raised on high-*Hookam Al-*הוקם על." About this our sages, of blessed memory, stated in Bamidbar Rabbah at the end of Parshat Korach,[14] "He raised the yoke-*Heikim Ol-*הקים עול of the Torah." We therefore must understand what the matter of "the yoke of the Torah" is, and what is meant by him raising this yoke. For, this seems to indicate that he raised, elevated, and uplifted it to a much higher level.

[12] Regarding the coming section see Torat Chayim Shemot ibid., which is founded upon the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 2 p. 361.

[13] Samuel II 23:1

[14] Midrash Bamidbar Rabbah 18:21; Also see Midrash Shmuel Ch. 29; Tanna d'Bei Eliyahu Rabbah, Ch. 2.

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Now, we should begin by [explaining] the verse,[15] "The soul of man is the flame of *HaShem*-יהו"ה." That is, it is like the flame of a candle, the nature of which is to ascend to above and descend to below, and it constantly is ascending and descending. The same is so of the soul, which is compared to a flame.[16] That is, it is in a constant motion of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*). This is like the verse,[17] "Let all the soul (*Neshamah*) praise *Ya"H*-י"ה," and it likewise states about the *Chayot* and *Seraphim* [angels],[18] "The animal-*Chayot* [angels] were running and returning (*Ratzo v'Shov*)."

However, it cannot be said that the essence of the soul is in the aspect of fire, being that the verse states,[19] "He **blew** into his nostrils etc.," and blowing is with air, not fire. Likewise, the name "soul-*Neshamah*-נשמה" is akin to "breathing-*Nesheemah*-נשימה" with the nostrils and nose.[20] It likewise is akin to the spirit and breath of life (*Ru'ach Chayim*) in the heart, which [also] ascends and descends with the pulse of the heart[21] in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), all of which are aspects of air (*Ru'ach*).

However, the truth of the matter is that the essential self of the soul is the aspect of air and breath, as in the verse, "He

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[15] Proverbs 20:27; Also see Zohar III 218b and on; Tanya, Ch. 19 (24a and on).

[16] Also see Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 32a; Torat Chayim Shemot ibid. (p. 394a).

[17] Psalms 150:6

[18] Ezekiel 1:14

[19] Genesis 2:7

[20] See Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 14:9; Torah Ohr Mikeitz 36b; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 318d; Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 325; 5704 p. 254.

[21] See Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 69 (105a); Likkutei Torah Pekudei 5d; 7d; 8d; Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 446d; Also see p. 445c; 459b, and elsewhere.

blew into his nostrils etc.," or like the verse,[22] "The spirit (*Ru'ach*) shall return to God who gave it," seeming to indicate that what was given was air and spirit (*Ru'ach*).

Rather, in this there are two levels - *Ru'ach* and *Neshamah*, as the verse states,[23] "But [in truth], it is a spirit (*Ru'ach*) in man, and the soul (*Neshamah*) from the Almighty gives them understanding." That is, the *Ru'ach* is in the heart, whereas the *Neshamah* is in the brain.[24]

Now, the *Ru'ach* is the matter of the emotions (*Midot*), and the emotions (*Midot*) are entirely the matter of arousal and excitement, this being the aspect of the *Ru'ach*. In contrast, the matter of the *Neshamah* is intellect and grasp. The superiority of the *Neshamah* is that it is the aspect of actual light (*Ohr*) and is called "the flame of *HaShem*-יהו"ה." That is, it is the actual radiance of Godliness called an illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*),[25] and is drawn from the Supernal Godly light. This is why it literally is called "the soul (*Neshamah*) from the

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[22] Ecclesiastes 12:7

[23] Job 32:8

[24] See Rabbi Avraham ibn Ezra to Exodus 23:25; Etz Chayim, Shaar 4 (Shaar Ozen, Chotem, Peh) Ch. 1, and elsewhere; Also see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Shemot Vol. 2 p. 435 and on; p. 543 and on; Ohr HaTorah Mishpatim p. 1,129 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5668 p. 143 and on; 5680 p. 279 and on; p. 287 and on; Discourse entitled "*v'Hayah Ka'asher Yareem Moshe*" 5694 (Sefer HaMaamarim Kuntreisim Vol. 2 p. 288a and on); 5701 p. 82 and on; Discourse entitled "*Zachor*" and discourse entitled "*v'Hayah KaAsher Yareem Moshe*" 5730 (translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5730 Vol. 2, Discourse 25 & Discourse 30); Also see the discourse entitled "*Ki Machoh Emcheh*" in Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5572 (p. 160 and on); Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 1 p. 145a. Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 27 and on.

[25] See Shaarei Orah 34b and on; 43b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1 p. 110; 5685 p. 38; 5708 p. 39; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Vayelech Ish MiBeit Levi*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 191); Also see Sefer HaArachim Chabad, Vol. 3, section on "*Ohr HaMe'ir*" (p. 325 and on).

Almighty," in that it literally is in the aspect of "a part of God from on high."[26]

This is the matter of the light in grasping and understanding Godliness, like a sage whose eyes are illuminated with intellect. This is because Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah* are the aspects of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*), as known.[27] The root of the particular light for the soul of a person is drawn from the general light, about which the verse states,[28] "For *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God is a fire etc." That is, He is the root and source of all aspects of illuminating light, analogous to the foundational element of fire.[29] Even so, the essence of the soul is generally the aspect of *Ru'ach*, as the verse states,[30] "He blew into his nostrils the soul of life," as discussed before.

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[26] See Job 31:2; Divrei Shalom of Rabbi Yitzchak Aderabi, Drush 3 ("A part of His Essential Self, blessed is He"); Ayelet Ahuvim of Rabbi Shlomo Alkabetz, Shir HaShirim 1:2 (Yerushalayim 5744 – p. 9b); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 32 (Shaar HaKavanah), Ch. 1; Ohr Ne'erav Vol. 1, end of Ch. 3; Reishit Chochmah, Shaar HaAhavah, Ch. 1 ("*Od Nitba'er*" 53b); Shaar HaKedushah Ch. 6 ("*u'B'Inyan Eem Atifat Tzitzit* – p. 144d); Romemot El to Psalms 29:1; Shoshanat HaAmakaim to Song of Songs 7:11; Midrash Shmuel, Mishnah Avot 2:5; Seder HaYom, Kavanot LeOlam Yehei Adam (p. 49); Kli Yakar to Genesis 1:31, 2:7; Exodus 20:12, 20:13, 26:1; Shnei Luchot HaBrit, Beit Chochmah 18a; Mesechet Chullin 115b; Mesechet Pesachim, Matzah Ashirah 158b; 165b; Mesechet Shavuot 188b, 194b; Hakdamat Rabbi Nathan Shapira to Pri Etz Chayim; and with the addition of the word "literally-*Mamash*-ממש" see Tanya, Likkutei Amarim Ch. 2; Shefa Tal, Hakdama ben Me'ah Shanah; Choker u'Mekubal 3:1; Ma'or Einayim to Exodus (Yitro) (36a – section beginning "*Ach*-אך") in the name of **his teacher**; Pri HaAretz of Rabbi Menachem Mendel of Vitebsk, Vayeishev (7b); Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Vayikra Vol. 1, p. 373. [See Torat Chayim of the Mittler Rebbe, Va'era, "*Inyan Yichud Kudsha Brich Hoo uShchintei*" p. 102 and note 7 there (in the new edition).]

[27] See Shaarei Orah of the Mittler Rebbe 43b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5663; 5685, and 5708 ibid.

[28] Deuteronomy 4:24

[29] See the prior discourse entitled "*v'Avraham Zakein*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 107).

[30] Genesis 2:7 ibid.

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Now, as known[31] the nature of fire (*Aish*) is specifically to withdraw to above,[32] and not to descend to below at all.[33] This is unlike air (*Ru'ach*), which although it ascends above, nevertheless, does not ascend completely above, but spreads to the sides in a broad plane.[34]

That is, fire (*Aish*) completely ascends above, not as a matter of ascent, but as a matter of withdrawal, in that it completely withdraws. In contrast, air (*Ru'ach*) does not withdraw completely, but ascends somewhat, spreads to the sides and even descends to below, in that wind (*Ru'ach*) blows from above to below. This is because air (*Ru'ach*) is the intermediary between fire (*Aish*) and water (*Mayim*).[35] For, as known about the four foundational elements, fire (*Aish*) is the highest of all, and below it is air (*Ru'ach*), and below it is water (*Mayim*).

Now, the nature of fire (*Aish*) is to be in a state of complete withdrawal. This is because the essential nature of fire is to only be above and to not descend at all. For example, the foundational element of fire itself never descends to below.

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[31] See Tanya, beginning of Ch. 19 (24a and on); Likkutei Torah Acharei 25c; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5569 p. 226 and on; "*Mayim Rabim*" 5636 p. 109 and on, and elsewhere; Also see the citations in the coming notes.

[32] Also see Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 2, section entitled "The three letters *Yod-Hey-Vav*-יו"ד ה"א וא"ו" and on.

[33] Regarding the coming section see Sefer HaSichot 5749 Vol. 1 p. 283 and on, and the notes there.

[34] See Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One ibid.

[35] See Sefer Yetzirah 3:3; Zohar II 24a; Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla ibid.; Maamarei Admor HaZaken and "*Mayim Rabim*" 5636 ibid.; Ohr HaTorah Terumah p. 1,399, and elsewhere; Also see Sefer HaArachim Chabad, Vol. 2, section on "*Avir*" (p. 210).

Because of this, as fire is below it too has the nature to withdraw to above. In contrast, the nature of water (*Mayim*) is specifically to descend to below, from a high place to a low place. On the other hand, being that air (*Ru'ach*) is the intermediary between water (*Mayim*) and fire (*Aish*), it thus has both matters, in that it ascends to above and also descends to below.

From the above we can also understand the likeness to this as it is in the soul of man, based on what was explained before that the *Ru'ach* is in the heart, whereas the *Neshamah* is in the brain. To explain, when it comes to the emotions (*Midot*), even though there is a matter of excitement and arousal in them, and as known, primarily excitement is specifically in the emotions (*Midot*), nevertheless, in the motion and arousal of the emotions there are the aspects of ascent (*Ha'ala'ah*) and drawing down (*Hamshachah*).

The explanation is that the general difference between intellect (*Mochin*) and emotions (*Midot*), is well known.[36] Namely, they are opposites of each other, both in their arousal, as well as in the essence of their being. This is because the effect of the emotions (*Midot*) such as bringing about an act of kindness (*Chessed*), specifically applies when there is one for whom to bestow the kindness. Likewise, the act of mercy (*Rachamim*) only applies when there is one for whom to be compassionate. The same is so of the opposite quality of might

[36] Regarding the coming section see Sefer HaMaamarim 5628 ibid.; Also see Likkutei Torah Masei p. 93a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 9; 5631 Vol. 1 p. 289; p. 317 and on; 5633 Vol. 2 p. 540 and on; 5634 p. 54 and on; 5653 p. 280 and on; 5677 p. 168 and on; 5697 p. 218 and on; 5708 p. 272 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 3 p. 90 and on (Vol. 5 p. 200 and on in earlier editions).

and judgment (*Gevurah*), in that it also relates specifically to another. This is because in regard to oneself the terms kindness and compassion are entirely inapplicable.

That is, even when it applies to awaken great mercies upon oneself, this is when there is someone other than himself that he should be roused with compassion for him. This also includes rousing great mercies upon his own soul, meaning when he is so distant from Godliness that he in the state of being "another", (and in truth, none can compares to His Essential Self), it then applies to rouse [mercies] upon one's own soul. However, it does not apply for a person act kindly with himself or be merciful to himself.

The same is so Above, as the verse states,[37] "Remember your mercies and your kindnesses, for they are of the world." That is, the aspects of mercies and kindnesses only apply specifically when there is a world. In contrast, without the world, mercies and kindnesses do not apply. For example, even the essential emotional quality, which is that of love (*Ahavah*), specifically applies when there is something other than oneself to love, and that is when the emotion of love is aroused. However, when there is nothing other than himself, one is not roused with love altogether.

In contrast, the matter of intellect (*Sechel*) is the very opposite. Even when there is no one to bestow to, a person can sit by himself and conceive intellectual ideas. Now although it is true that by bestowing [intellect] to another, additional

[37] Psalms 25:6; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5700 p. 82.

[insight] is caused in the one bestowing,[38] nevertheless, we clearly see that even without bestowing to another, he is capable of conceiving many ideas, as well as very deep concepts, and to understand the matter in and of himself. (In truth, even the fact that through bestowing to another he comes to have additional [insight], is not because the power of the intellect specifically requires another. It rather is because "their beginning is wedged in their end, and their end in their beginning,"[39] such that this is how the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*) was established,[40] that there will be the matter of bestower and recipient, as explained in the Siddur in the discourse after [the] "*Aleinu*" [prayer].[41]

However, it is not that the effect of its essential power specifically applies when there is another. This is unlike the emotions (*Midot*) as they are in and of themselves, in that their effect specifically applies only when there is another. In contrast, as the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) are in and of themselves, they apply even when there is no other.)[42]

Likewise, the essential being and nature of intellect is the opposite of the nature of emotions. This is because when one must conceive a new idea, the presence of another is actually distracting to him and he specifically must be alone.

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[38] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5646-5650 p. 157; p. 412; 5665 p. 240; 5670 p. 123 and on; 5671 p. 169, and elsewhere.

[39] Sefer Yetzirah 1:7

[40] See at length in Sefer HaMaamarim 5627 p. 430 and on; 5639 Vol. 2 p. 537 and on; Discourse entitled "*Amar Rabbi Shmuel Bar Nachmeini*" 5690 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5690; Sefer HaMaamarim Kuntreisim Vol. 1 p. 119a and on).

[41] Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 97c and on.

[42] Also see Moreh Nevuchim, Part 3, Ch. 54.

Furthermore, even within himself, he must constrict and conceal all his other [soul] powers, because if another [soul] power is revealed, this distracts the intellect. Moreover, even if the power of desire illuminates in a revealed way, this too will distract the intellect. Even his desire to become wise, if it is revealed, he will be incapable of conceptualizing [wisdom]. It is rather when in a concealed way he desires a specific matter of intellect and wants to become wise in it, that he will then become wise and succeed. However, when it is revealed, it distracts the intellect, making it impossible for him to conceptualize [wisdom], as discussed in the discourse entitled "*v'Kol HaAm Ro'eem*" 5665.[43]

How much more is this so of the [soul] powers below the intellect. They certainly cause distraction and it thus is necessary to conceal them. Moreover, even in the power of intellect (*Ko'ach HaSechel*) itself, one must constrict and quiet it from acting out when he must conceive some intellect and elevate it to the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*) which is the source of the intellect, until there is a bestowal of intellect from the power to conceptualize (*Ko'ach HaMaskeel*). This is like the matter of "Rav kept silent,"[44] or like the verse,[45] "He was bewildered (*Eshtomem*-אשתומם) for a while." That is, silence and bewilderment are the matter of the elevation of his

[43] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 243 and on.

[44] Talmud Bavli, Beitza 6a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 286; 5659 p. 74 and the note of the Rebbe there; 5708 p. 102 and the note of the Rebbe there; Also see Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bereishit p. 95; Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 26, and elsewhere.

[45] Daniel 4:16; Also see earlier in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 19.

intellect to its source, and specifically because of this there is a bestowal of intellect.

Furthermore, in essence the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) are primarily in a state of ascent and adhesion to above, as known about the matter of cause and effect (*Ilah v'Alul*), that every cause is an effect relative to the cause above it, and as known, every effect adheres to its cause. This [adhesion] is in the upper three [*Sefirot*] of the cause,[46] being that it is an effect relative to the cause above it. Thus, in a state of ascent and adhesion to the levels above it, it does not descend and bestow to below. The aspects of descent and bestowal to below are only in its seven lower aspects, whereas its three upper aspects are in a state of adhesion to above.

This is as explained elsewhere,[47] that in every stature (*Partzuf*), the aspect of Shabbat is in its three upper [*Sefirot*]. This itself[48] is the difference between Shabbat and the mundane days of the week, which are the aspect of the emotions (*Midot*).[49] That is, from them the bestowal is drawn down, this being the aspect of the descent and drawing down of the light from Above to below, which is the matter of the six days of the act of creating and bringing the worlds into being, to create all beings and enliven them. That is, this specifically comes from the aspect of the emotions (*Midot*). In contrast, Shabbat is

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[46] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 ibid. that when the cause bestows to the effect, this is only from the seven lower [*Sefirot*], whereas its first three [*Sefirot*] are the aspect of an effect relative to the cause that is higher than it.

[47] See Pri Etz Chayim, introduction to Shaar HaShabbat.

[48] See Likkutei Torah, Drushim L'Yom HaKippurim 68a and on; Ohr HaTorah Yitro p. 925 and on; Beshalach p. 636 and on; Tisa p. 1,899 and on; Behar (Vol. 2) p. 611 and on.

[49] See the citations in the preceding note.

specifically the aspect of the three upper *Sefirot*, this being the matter of the rest and ascent from below to Above.

(Now, about the fact that all birth specifically comes from the intellect (*Mochin*), as known about why a child cannot give birth,[50] being that his intellect (*Mochin*) is not yet complete, as stated in Etz Chayim,[51] this specifically is when the intellect (*Mochin*) illuminates in *Zeir Anpin*.

There also is an aspect of birth drawn from the expanded mature intellect (*Mochin d'Gadlut*) of the Father-*Abba* [Wisdom-*Chochmah*] and Mother-*Imma* [Understanding-*Binah*], however all this refers to when the intellect (*Mochin*) illuminates in *Zeir Anpin*. That is, when there is the revelation of the mature intellect (*Mochin d'Gadlut*), there then is the union (*Yichud*) of *Zeir Anpin* and *Nukva* to give birth to souls, as explained elsewhere.[52] However, the intellectual aspects (*Mochin*) themselves specifically are in a state of adhesion and ascent to Above).

The same is so of the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) as they are below, in that they specifically are in a state of elevation. For example, by nature an intellectual is aloof and does not mingle into anything. Thus, one who has expansive mature intellect (*Mochin d'Gadlut*) does not become emotionally excited about anything, and because of his

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[50] See Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 68b; 69a

[51] Etz Chayim, Shaar 25 (Shaar Drushei HaTzelem) Drush 3; Also see Shaar 23 (Shaar Mochin d'Tzelem) Ch. 6, and elsewhere; Also see Torah Ohr Mikeitz 43a; Likkutei Torah Va'etchanan 10c; Siddur Im Da"Ch 272d; Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 p. 178 and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 34.

[52] See Ohr HaTorah Vayishlach (Vol. 5) p. 879b; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5657 ibid., and elsewhere; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 26.

aloofness nothing can confuse him. This is as explained elsewhere[53] about Yosef, that nothing disturbed him from his service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, being that he was separate and transcendent. (As explained elsewhere,[54] this itself is the matter of the expanded mature intellect (*Mochin d'Gadlut*), which is the aspect of the Upper Knowledge (*Da'at Elyon*)).

The same is so in serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, that intellect (*Mochin*) is the matter of adhesion (*Dveikut*), in that one adheres to the Godly matter in a way of literal nullification (*Bittul*) and union (*Yichud*). In contrast, emotions (*Midot*) are in a state of arousal. And although this too is a matter of excitement and a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire, it nonetheless is not the same as an actual state of union (*Yichud*) and nullification (*Bittul*). It rather is the arousal toward something that is external to oneself, and is like the matter of being drawn to something separate.

Therefore, the primary matter of the *mitzvot* is specifically through the emotions (*Midot*).[55] For, as known,[56]

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[53] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 192 and on; Torat Chayim Vayechi p. 101d and on; Ohr HaTorah Mikeitz (Vol. 6) p. 1,102a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 63 and on; 5677 p. 103 and on; 5688 p. 23 and on; 5720 p. 161 and on, and elsewhere.

[54] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 193; Torat Chayim Vayechi ibid. p. 108c; Ohr HaTorah Mikeitz ibid. p. 1,102b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 ibid. p. 66 [and the citations there]; 5677 p. 105; 5688 ibid. p. 26.

[55] See Moreh Nevuchim, Part 3, Ch. 54 ibid.

[56] See Zohar III 122b and on; Pirush to Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Yesodei HaTorah, beginning of Ch. 2; Hilchot Talmud Torah of the Alter Rebbe 4:6, and elsewhere.

love (*Ahavah*) and fear (*Yirah*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה are the primary[57] vitality of [fulfilling] the *mitzvot*, which sustain them.

This is because of two reasons. The first is because the emotions (*Midot*) are not in a state of ascent and actual adhesion, and he therefore desires to fulfill the [*mitzvot*] so that he thereby will come to a state of adhesion. This is as stated in The Book for the Average Person (Tanya),[58] "He who fulfills them in truth, is he who loves the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה." Moreover, being that the [love and fear] are in a state of being drawn down, they therefore relate to the *mitzvot* and give vitality to the fulfillment of the *mitzvot*.

In contrast, intellect (*Mochin*) does not relate to the actual fulfillment of the *mitzvot* in deed. This is as we observe that in serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה solely with the intellect (*Mochin*), even the toil involved in this [service], if it is with the intellect (*Mochin*) alone, this [itself] will not bring a person to fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actual deed, nor will he have vitality when fulfilling them in actual deed. Rather, this is only brought about specifically through the emotions (*Midot*) of love and fear, in that this brings him to fulfill the *mitzvot* and gives him great vitality in doing so.

Even about the aspect of a "good thought" (*Machshavah Tovah*),[59] which the love and fear realized in one's mind, it only is "the Holy One, blessed is He, who joins them to a deed,"[60]

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[57] This word is unclear in the handwritten manuscript, and it perhaps says "source-*Makor*-מקור" [rather than "primary-*Ikar*-עיקר"]. See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 151, note 52.

[58] Tanya, Ch. 4 (8a)

[59] See the beginning of Kuntres HaHitpaalut of the Mittler Rebbe.

[60] Talmud Bavli, Kiddushin 40a.

since they transcend the aspect of deed, as stated in chapter sixteen of The Book for the Average Person (Tanya). [Moreover, this too] is because, at the very least, they are the aspect of emotions (*Midot*), except that they are of a far higher order, as stated in The Book for the Average Person (Tanya) there. In contrast, the intellectual aspects (*Mochin*) themselves have no relation to action, since they specifically are in a state of ascent and adhesion to Above. Thus, from this there is no arousal to deed, nor do they give vitality to the deed, but rather this comes specifically from the emotions (*Midot*).

This then, is the difference between the *Ru'ach* and the *Neshamah*. That is, the *Neshamah*, which is the intellectual aspect (*Mochin*) is the aspect of fire (*Aish*). For, just as the nature of fire is specifically to be in a state of ascent and withdrawal, the same is so the nature of intellect, that it is in a state of withdrawal to Above and is in a state of separate transcendence.

In contrast, about the *Ru'ach* in the heart, which is the aspect of the emotions (*Midot*), even though they too are in a state of a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire, and in a state of ascent, they nonetheless also have the aspect of being drawn down. This is because the entire matter of emotions (*Midot*) is specifically that they relate to another. They therefore have two matters in them - the matter of ascent to that which is above, and the matter of being drawn down to that which is below.

However, from the essential matter of relating to another, indeed their primary aspect is that of being drawn down. For, when it comes to the intellectual aspects (*Mochin*), since they specifically are unto themselves, they thus are the

opposite of being drawn down. This is why their primary nature is specifically that of ascent and separateness. In contrast, since the emotions (*Midot*) are for the other, their primary aspect is specifically that of drawing down and revelation.

This being so, even the matter of ascent and its cause is different in the intellect (*Mochin*) than as it is the emotions (*Midot*). This is because in the emotions it is because of the desire (*Ratzon*) that he wants it, and not because their own nature is to ascend. Rather, their essential nature is to be drawn down and bound to something. Therefore, they sometimes are in a state of ascent and sometimes are in a state of being drawn down. However, the ascent is only because of their nature to be bound to and drawn to something. In contrast, this is not so of the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*). That is, their ascent is specifically because their nature is to be in a state of ascent and withdrawal to Above, like the nature of an intellectual to be aloof, as mentioned before.

Now,[61] indeed the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) are [also] in a state of being drawn down, as known.[62] However, this is only the externality (*Chitzoniyut*) of the intellect, whereas the essence of the intellect is in a state of ascent and adhesion.

In general, the aspect of the intellect that is drawn down is when it is in the aspect of an illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*), such that when the intellect is very great, it is drawn down and illuminates to a [greater] distance, such as a wise sage who illuminates the eyes of all the people. Nonetheless, wherever it is drawn to it remains in a state of separate

[61] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 152 note 55.
[62] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1 p. 101 and on, and elsewhere.

transcendence. This is akin to oil which does not mingle with anything,[63] and although it permeates everything,[64] nonetheless, wherever it is, it is separate, as explained elsewhere.[65]

Therefore, the general difference between the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) and the emotions (*Midot*) is that the intellect (*Mochin*) is concealed, as in the verse,[66] "The concealed are for *HaShem* our God-*HaShem Elo"heinu*- יהו"ה אלהינ"ו" referring to the aspects of Wisdom-*Chochmah* and Understanding-*Binah*, in that they are concealed and hidden. In contrast, the emotions (*Midot*) are specifically in a state of revelation and are called "These-*Eileh*-אלה-36," as known.[67] These then are the two levels of air (*Ru'ach*) and fire (*Aish*) as they are in the soul of man, these being the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) and the emotions (*Midot*).

Now, in Moreh Nevuchim, part one, chapter forty,[68] Rambam explains that *Ru'ach* (spirit) refers to the desire (*Ratzon*), as in the verse,[69] "Who can appraise the spirit (*Ru'ach*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה." The explanation is that as

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[63] See Mishnah Tevul Yom 2:5; Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Tumat Ochleen 8:10

[64] See Talmud Bavli, Chullin 97a; Shulchan Aruch, Yoreh De'ah 105:5

[65] See Imrei Binah, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema 52d and on; Kuntres Inyana Shel Torat HaChassidus, Ch. 7.

[66] Deuteronomy 29:28; Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 22 (63b); Tikkun 70 (129a); Also see Likkutei Torah Pekudei 3c and on; Acharei 28d; Shlach 35d, and elsewhere.

[67] See Likkutei Torah Pekudei 4c; Bamidbar 5d; Sefer HaChakirah of the Tzemach Tzeddek 58b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 2 p. 393; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 36.

[68] Cited in Ohr HaTorah, Shir HaShirim Vol. 1 p. 312; Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 Vol. 2 p. 489.

[69] Isaiah 40:13; Also see Radak there.

known,[70] desire (*Ratzon*) is the aspect of the essence of the soul which transcends intellect and emotions. It was explained before that the soul in general and its essence is the aspect of air (*Ru'ach*), as in the verse, "He blew into his nostrils." This is because desire (*Ratzon*) is also the aspect of being drawn down and bonding with another. This is because this itself is the matter of desire (*Ratzon*), which is the pull of the soul to be drawn to what it desires.[71]

This is like the explanation before about the emotions (*Midot*), that their nature is to be attached to something other, which is why they are in a state of ascent as well as being drawing down. The same is so of the desire (*Ratzon*). That is, even though it is in a state of ascent, to ascend Above, as in the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire of great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, nonetheless, this is not because its essential nature is to ascend, but is rather because its nature is to be drawn to bond to something other. Because of this it is equally in a state of ascent and drawing down.

It thus is in this way the *mitzvot* are the desire of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*). That is, there are *mitzvot* that are the aspect of ascent (*Ha'ala'ah*) and there are *mitzvot* that are the aspect of drawing down (*Hamshachah*). However,

[70] See the prior discourses entitled "*Lech Lecha*" and "*Ki Yedaativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 86 and on).

[71] See Ateret Rosh 65a and on; Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 23-24; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 87 and on; Also see the prior discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 55 and on) and the discourse entitled "*Vayechulu HaShamayim*" (p. 61).

about the Torah, which is the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah*, the words of Torah are compared to fire (*Aish*).[72]

Now, about the fact that Torah is in a state of being drawn down, this is because it is the aspect of an illuminating light, and is the aspect of a very great light, like a big torch that illuminates to a very great distance. Nevertheless, wherever [the light] is, it specifically is the aspect of a wondrous and separate intellect.

(The root of the matter is as explained before (in the discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*")[73] about the matter of pleasure (*Taanug*) and desire (*Ratzon*). That is, pleasure (*Taanug*) is in a state of concealment and is specifically in the aspect of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*). In contrast, desire (*Ratzon*) is specifically in a state of revelation and being drawing forth. The same is so of the difference between desire (*Ratzon*) and intellect (*Mochin*) and likewise between intellect (*Mochin*) and emotions (*Midot*).)

(Also see the statement in chapter nineteen of The Book for the Average Person (Tanya), "Like the flame of a candle… so also with the *Neshamah* of a Jew… by nature… and this nature… is the soul's faculty of Wisdom-*Chochmah* etc." About the statement there, "So also with the aspects of the *Ru'ach* and *Nefesh* etc.," it may be posited that this is due to the aspect of Wisdom-*Chochmah* whose nature is such, whereas the essential nature of the *Ru'ach* is that of bonding [with another], as discussed before. It could be that this statement in The Book

[72] Talmud Bavli, Taanit 7a; Also see Jeremiah 23:29; Talmud Bavli, Brachot 22a and elsewhere.

[73] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 97 and on.

for the Average Person (Tanya), is based on the statement in Etz Chayim,[74] that the speaker (*Medaber*) is the aspect of fire (*Aish*), whereas in various discourses in Likkutei Torah[75] it states that the speaker (*Medaber*) is air (*Ru'ach*), whereas fire (*Aish*) is the animal (*Chai*).)

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Now, fire also has the aspects of ascent and descent. We observe this in the flame of a candle, in that it is in a state of constantly ascending and descending, and also has the matter of being drawn down (*Hamshachah*). Even though this comes about by it taking hold of a wick or wood, nevertheless, if there was no matter of drawing down and descent in it, it would never rest upon the wick or the wood. It would not take hold of them, but instead would be in a state of [complete] ascent and withdrawal. Thus, the fact that it nevertheless takes hold of and rests upon the wick, consuming and burning it, is because it also has the matter of being drawing down (*Hamshachah*) in it.

The same is so of its ascent, that it is not in a state of complete withdrawal. This is because besides the fact that it does not completely ascend, but also descends and rests upon the wick, beyond that, its essential ascent is not that of [complete] withdrawal. That is, it does not jump off the wick

[74] Etz Chayim, Shaar 50 (Shaar Kitzur ABY"A) Ch. 10; Also see Likkutei Sichot Vol. 6 p. 112, note 42.

[75] See Likkutei Torah Shlach 40b; Pinchas 75d; Teitzei 34c; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 33a; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bamidbar Vol. 5 p. 1,643 and on; Ohr HaTorah Pinchas ibid.; Na"Ch (Vol. 1) p. 507; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 283; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 2 p. 380.

but ascends in a way of tranquility and gradation. Even though, at first glance, this is because of the wick, being that when it is a wick that the fire cannot take hold of, meaning that it is not burned by the fire, the fire then jumps and ascends,[76] nonetheless, if the fire only had a matter of ascent in it, it would have to jump and withdraw even when taking hold of the wick. It thus must be said that the reason it ascends in a way of tranquility and gradation is a function of the fire itself, rather than its hold [on the wick]. Thus, even after the wick is completely consumed and burned, the fire does not jump but only ascends.

Now, as known[77] the ascent and descent is in the white of the fire that never [directly] takes hold of the wick. That is, the fire that [actually] takes hold and rests upon the wick is the black fire, whereas the white fire is what ascends and descends. However, at first glance, this is the very opposite of the nature of fire (*Aish*).

Now, the explanation[78] is that the ascent and descent of the fire is specifically caused by the air (*Ru'ach*),[79] as we observe,[80] that without air fire can neither be kindled nor will it illuminate. This is why it is forbidden to place a vessel over a

[76] See Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 21a; Tur and Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chayim 264:1; Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe, Orach Chayim 264 ibid.

[77] See the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel*" in Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 394b; Also see Sefer HaArachim Chabad Vol. 3, section on "*Ohr Ookma*" etc.

[78] See Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 ibid. p. 394a.

[79] See Sefer HaSichot 5749 Vol. 1 p. 284, notes 34-35.

[80] Regarding the coming section see Torah Ohr Mikeitz 42c; Ohr HaTorah Tazriya Vol. 2 p. 520; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 1 p. 197; Vol. 2 p. 481; 5692 p. 119.

flame on Shabbat,[81] since it will be extinguished by the lack of air. This is likewise so of stale air in which a flame cannot be kindled, and even if there is a proper wick to which the flame can adhere, it nevertheless will be extinguished, in that the fire will not rest upon the wick. Likewise, it also will not ascend, but will be extinguished and go out, and though this is because of the thickness of the air, nevertheless, it will not ascend but will withdraw. This is because the ascent and descent of fire is brought about by the air, in that the air affects it in a way that is the opposite of its nature, causing it to rest upon the wick. Likewise, its ascent, in that it ascends with tranquility, is brought about by the air.

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Now, the likeness[82] to all this is understood about the verse, "The soul of man is the flame of *HaShem*-יהו"ה." That is, it is called a candle or a flame (*Ner*-נר) this being the aspect of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*) of the intellect (*Mochin*) as discussed before. The same is so of the general whole of the aspect of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*) of the soul. That is, it is akin the nature of fire (*Aish*) to ascend above, and is like the spark drawn to [be absorbed in] the flame.

The same is so of the spark of Godliness of the soul, that its nature is to ascend Above and become subsumed in and

[81] Magen Avraham, Orach Chayim 277 S"K 9 (cited in Ohr HaTorah and Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 1 ibid.); Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe, Orach Chayim 277, end of the Siman.

[82] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel*" in Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 394b ibid.

adhere to the light of *HaShem*-יהו"ה with the giving up of the soul (*Mesirat Nefesh*) to the point of being extinguished and withdrawn, as in the verse,[83] "My soul expires." This is with great pleasure and yearning to depart from the materiality of the body, as in the verse,[84] "To You *HaShem*-יהו"ה I uplift my soul" to Above.

An example of this is the arousal of love of Godliness in a way of "your heart runs"[85] with the spirit of life (*Ru'ach Chayim*) in the heart. The same is so of the *Neshamah* in the brain, as in the verse,[86] "Let all the soul (*Neshamah*) praise *Ya"H*-י"ה." That is, the nature of the soul is to ascend. That is, just as it is the nature of fire to ascend to its source above in the foundational element of fire, so likewise, it is the nature of the soul to ascent to the source from where it was hewn and drawn, this being the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה and the name God-*Elohi"m*-אלהי"ם. This is because everything is drawn to its essential root. Therefore, this is like a nature in the Godly spark, in that it yearns to ascend and adhere to its root in the Living God, with yearning desire to adhere with wondrous love like flames of fire that ascend.

Thus, to awaken the aspect of the fiery flames of the Godly soul, this comes through contemplating[87] one's root and the source from where he was hewn. This is the substance of the *Shema* recital, in which we say, "Listen Israel, *HaShem*-

[83] Psalms 84:3
[84] Psalms 25:1
[85] See Sefer Yetzirah 1:8
[86] Psalms 150:6
[87] See Mishneh Torah, Hilchot Yesodei HaTorah 2:2, and elsewhere.

יהו"ה is our God,"[88] thereby bringing [the continuation],[89] "You shall love." That is, when one contemplates "*HaShem*-יהו"ה is our God," in which *HaShem*-יהו"ה means that "He was and He is and He will be-*Hayah v'Hoveh v'Yihiyeh*-היה והוה ויהיה"[90] as they are included in the Name *HaShem*-יהו"ה, meaning that for Him [the aspects of] "He was and He is and He will be-*Hayah v'Hoveh v'Yihiyeh*-היה והוה ויהיה" are all equal, and He alone is Singular and Unique [in His existence], and there is no difference or change in Him between "He was-*Hayah*-היה" and "He is-*Hoveh*-הוה" and "He will be-*Yihiyeh*-יהיה," as the verse states,[91] "I *HaShem*-יהו"ה have not changed," and "You are He before the world was created, and You are He after the world was created,"[92] in that, "before Him everything is as nothing."[93]

It is this aspect of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, referring to the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One, He Himself is "our God-*Elo"heinu*-אלהי"נו," meaning, "our strength and vitality,"[94] in that He is the source of vitality for all the souls of Israel who ascended in thought.[95] In contrast, this is not so of all other creations, in that the source of their vitality

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[88] Deuteronomy 6:4

[89] Deuteronomy 6:5

[90] Zohar III 257b (Ra'aya Mehemna); Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of Intrinsic Being (*Shaar HaHavayah*); Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 1 (Shaar Eser v'Lo Teisha) Ch. 9; Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 7 (82a); Shulchan Aruch of the Alter Rebbe, Orach Chayim 5:1

[91] Malachi 3:6

[92] See the liturgy of the morning prayers (after the minor *Shema* [*Shema Ketanah*]).

[93] See Daniel 4:32; Zohar I 11b

[94] See Likkutei Torah Balak 73c; Pinchas 80a and elsewhere; Also see Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 1, The Gate of His Title (*Shaar HaKinuy*).

[95] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 1:4

is from [His title] "King-*Melech*-מלך", as explained in Likkutei Torah, in the discourse on the Torah portion of the Libations (*Nesachim*).[96]

Through contemplating the source from where he was hewn one's heart will thereby become enflamed in the aspect of a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire and yearning to become subsumed in His Singularity, blessed is He. This passionate arousal is present in the essence of the soul, in that its nature is to be drawn to the source from where it was hewn, and the above-mentioned contemplation is what awakens the fiery flames and thirst.

However, it was explained before that the fact that the fire ascends above is specifically due to the wind and air (*Ru'ach*). This is as we see in a flame, that when it is in stale air it becomes smothered and extinguished, and the reason it ascends is specifically because of the air.

The same is understood about the Godly spark, that it ascends above specifically because of the *Ru'ach*. This is because the essential being of the *Neshamah* is the aspect of the breath of the *Ru'ach*, (except that this refers to the inner essential breath and spirit (*Ru'ach*), in that "He who blows, blows from within himself."[97] In contrast, this is not so of "the breath of His mouth"[98] which enlivens all the creations, this being from the breath of the speech of the Supernal One, which, as known, is only the externality (*Chitzoniyut*)).[99] This is the

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[96] Likkutei Torah Shlach 40c

[97] Tanya, Ch. 2 citing Zohar; Also see Marei Mekomot v'Ha'arot Ketzarim L'Tanya" to Ch. 2 of Tanya; Also see Shefa Tal, Hakdama Ben Me'ah Shanah (and the author's note citing Moreh Nevuchim).

[98] Psalms 33:6

[99] Tanya, Iggeret HaTeshuvah Ch. 4 (94b); Also see Likkutei Torah Balak 67b and on, and elsewhere.

aspect of the Godly spirit (*Ru'ach*) that flutters within the soul and awakens it to ascend like a flame with love, desire, and thirst.

This is akin to what we observe in man, that there is a spirit of arousal, in that he is roused with a spirit of purity to go in the ways of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, to love and adhere to Him in truth. This arousal causes the ascent of the spark of Godliness to be in a state of fiery flames. Even though this is the nature of the spark, as explained before, nevertheless, it specifically depends on the spirit (*Ru'ach*) that awakens. Thus, commensurate to the arousal of the Godly spirit (*Ru'ach*) within him, so will be the Godly passion of the soul in a way of fiery flames.

[In contrast], when there is no spirit of arousal in man at all, the Godly spark will not be roused with yearning and fiery passion, except in a concealed and a very minor way, such that it can come to be extinguished, Heaven forbid, through the breath and coarse spirit of the animalistic soul, in that "the spirit of the animal descends."[100] However, it specifically is through the arousal of the Godly spirit (*Ru'ach*) that the spark is thereby roused with passion.

(The general explanation is that the arousal of the passion of the *Neshamah* in a way of fiery flames with yearning to ascend Above, and likewise, its descent to below, this being the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), is specifically brought about in the *Neshamah* by a higher power that comes to it from Above, as will be explained.[101] [In

[100] See Ecclesiastes 3:21

[101] In the subsequent discourse entitled "*Vayigash Eilav Yehudah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 160).

contrast], the *Ru'ach* is the aspect of the essential being of the *Neshamah*, meaning the bond of the desire of the *Neshamah* to Godliness, the source from where it was hewn. Thus, the arousal is specifically brought about by the aspect of the *Ru'ach*, this being the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*), in that it is in this that there is the bond. Thus, it is specifically through the arousal of the *Ru'ach* that the passion will be.)

The same is so of the ascent of the spark of Godliness with flames of fire, such that it will be in a way of gradation. That is, this too is brought about by the *Ru'ach*. This is like the explanation before in the analogy, that about the fire as it is in and of itself, even if it has a hold on the wick, it would nevertheless jump and ascend, being that the nature of fire is to be above, and not to descend at all. Therefore, even if it has a hold on the wick, in and of itself, it would jump and withdraw. Rather, the reason the ascent of the fire is in a way of tranquility and gradation is specifically because of the air. The same is understood by this analogy, that for the passion to be in a way of gradation and balanced measure, this is specifically brought about by the *Ru'ach*.

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Now, the explanation of the matter is based on what is known and explained elsewhere[102] about the difference between Chaos-*Tohu* and Repair-*Tikkun*. That is, the *Sefirot* of the

[102] See the discourse entitled "*Vayikach Min HaBa B'Yado*" in Torat Chayim Vayishlach p. 52d and on; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 1 p. 89 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5647 p. 145; 5648 p. 210 and on; 5649 p. 244 and on, and elsewhere.

world of Chaos-*Tohu* are specifically in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*), whereas the matter of the world of Repair-*Tikkun* is primarily that of "return" (*Shov*).

To further explain, "running" (*Ratzo*) is the matter of the departure and withdrawal from the aspect of the vessels (*Keilim*), as in the teaching,[103] "If your heart runs," this being the aspect of the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire and thirst to ascend Above.

Now, when there is a greatly overpowering arousal and yearning for Godliness, a person will truly despise the life of his physical body, being that his desire and yearning is to adhere to "*HaShem* is One-*HaShem Echad*-יהו"ה אחד." This overpowering arousal of the soul can be with such yearning to the point that the powers and vessel of the brain and heart are incapable of containing the strength of the arousal, and he literally will come to a state of the expiry of the soul.

The same is so of the love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*), to delight over *HaShem*-יהו"ה. That is, that with the great overpowering delight and sweetness of Godliness, he then will come to the expiry of the soul. This is as the verse states about the sons of Aharon,[104] "When they came close before *HaShem*-יהו"ה," this being an aspect of ultimate closeness, delight, sweetness, and endearment,[105] to the point that the soul despises [physicality], similar to the three

[103] Sefer Yetzirah 1:8

[104] Leviticus 16:1

[105] See Ohr HaChayim, beginning of Parshat Acharei (section beginning "*Oh Yomar Al Zeh HaDerech*"); Also see earlier in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 142.

elders who passed away in the Idra.[106] This is like "the death of kiss,"[107] as explained elsewhere.[108]

Now, even though this is a very lofty mode of service, nonetheless this is not *HaShem's*-יהו"ה ultimate Supernal intent. This is as in the verse,[109] "Turn your eyes away from Me," in that the "eyes" refers to the matter of "gazing at the preciousness of the King,"[110] this being the aspect of love of Him with delight in Him (*Ahavah b'Taanugim*). About this the verse states, "Turn your eyes away from Me," meaning, "away from *HaShem*-יהו"ה," in that this is not His true Supernal intent.

Rather, [His true Supernal intent] is for us to specifically be in a state of "returning" (*Shov*), as the verse states,[111] "He did not create it for emptiness (*Tohu*), but fashioned it to be settled (*LaShevet*-לשבת)," this being the matter of Repair-*Tikkun*, which specifically is the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). This refers to the matter of drawing the lights (*Orot*) into vessels (*Keilim*) through fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*. This is because this is the essential inner desire of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*), which specifically is to draw the revelation of Godliness down to below, as in the teaching,[112]

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[106] See Zohar III 144a; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken Pashiyot Vol. 2 p. 919; Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1 p. 20.

[107] See Talmud Bavli, Barchot 8a

[108] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 1 p. 198; 5564 p. 144; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 p. 256; 5663 ibid. p. 27; Also see Moreh Nevuchim, Part 3, Ch. 54.

[109] Song of Songs 6:5; Also see Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim 36b and on.

[110] See Zohar I 199a; Also see 38a and on; Zohar II 134a; 247b; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 3.

[111] Isaiah 45:18; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 ibid. p. 198; Derech Mitzvotecha 162a and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 p. 244 and on, and elsewhere.

[112] Midrash Tanchuma Bechukotai 3, Naso 16; Bereshit Rabbah, Ch. 3; Bamidbar Rabba, Ch. 13; Tanya Ch. 36 (45b).

"The Holy One, blessed is He, desired to have a dwelling place in the lower worlds." This is the end action of fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot* in actual deed, which is what arose first in thought.[113]

Now, in the world of Repair-*Tikkun* there also is the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) desire. This is because there cannot be any drawing down to below without there first being an ascent. This is as in the verse,[114] "If he sets his heart to Him," and as in the teaching,[115] "Whosoever says he has nothing but Torah etc." That is, Torah is the drawing down from Above to below, but there also must be prayer, which is the ascent from below to Above.

The same is true of Torah and *mitzvot* themselves, that there are the aspects of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) in them, for as known,[116] some *mitzvot* are in the aspect of ascent, such as the Terumah-תרומה offering, which is of the same root as the word "elevation-*Aramuta*-ארמותא."[117] The sacrificial offerings (*Korbanot*) are likewise the aspect of elevation and ascent, in that "the mystery of the sacrifices ascends to the mystery of the Unlimited One (*Ein Sof*)."[118] Nevertheless, there also must be the aspects of drawing down and "returning" (*Shov*), this being the matter of "a burnt-offering and a meal-offering, a feast-offering and its

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[113] See the liturgical hymn "*Lecha Dodi*" in the Friday evening prayers.

[114] Job 34:14; Also see the introduction to Imrei Binah, translated as The Gateway to Understanding.

[115] Talmud Bavli, Yevamot 109b; Also see Likkutei Torah Vayikra 5a; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 14 p. 317, note 15.

[116] See Torah Ohr Yitro p. 71b.

[117] Zohar II 147a

[118] See Zohar II 239a; Zohar III 26b

libation,"[119] as known.[120] However, there also must be the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*).

Moreover, as known[121] in the world of Repair-*Tikkun* there also is the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) with such strong desire and thirst, to the point of literally giving over one's soul (*Mesirat Nefesh*). An example is the *Nefilat Apayim* prayer, which literally is the matter of actual self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*).[122] This is like the teaching,[123] "Every day they consider in their souls as if they will depart from the world today." This is akin the binding of Yitzchak, at which point his soul flew out of him,[124] as explained elsewhere.[125]

However, in the world of Repair-*Tikkun*, even as the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) is on the loftiest of levels, there nevertheless is subsequently the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). An example of this is Rabbi Akiva who "entered in peace and went out in peace."[126] That is, with the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) he entered the same place that Ben Azai entered, except that Ben Azai only did so with the powers of the might

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[119] Leviticus 23:37

[120] See Likkutei Torah Shlach 40a and on; 42a and elsewhere.

[121] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 p. 250 and on; p. 255 and on.

[122] See Zohar I 220a; Zohar II 200b; 202b; Zohar III 120b; Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar Nefilat Apayim, Ch. 2 and on; Also see Torah Ohr Bereishit 6a; Likkutei Torah Teitzei 37d and elsewhere; Also see Kuntres Inyan Tefilah of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as Praying With Passion.

[123] Zohar I 120b; Also see Torah Ohr Mikeitz 31a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 ibid.; Also see the discourse entitled "*Acharei Mot*" 5722 (Sefer HaMaamarim 5722 p. 200, translated in The Teachings of The Rebbe 5722 Vol. 2, Discourse 24, Ch. 3).

[124] See Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer Ch. 31 (toward the end); Zohar I 60a (Tosefta); Yalkut Shimoni Vayera Remez 101.

[125] Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 ibid.; Sefer HaMaamarim 5722 ibid. p. 200 and on (translated in The Teachings of the Rebbe 5722, Vol. 2, Discourse 24, Ch. 3 and on).

[126] Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 14b; Also see the prior discourse entitled "*Ki Yedaativ*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 95).

(*Gevurot*) of fire (*Aish*). This is as stated in Midrash,[127] that a flaming fire would surround him when he was engaged in the study of Torah. This is why he came to a state of the literal expiry of the soul, in the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) without "returning" (*Shov*). However, this is not *HaShem's*-יהו"ה true Supernal intent, as explained before.

In contrast, with Rabbi Akiva, though he had a very strong "running" (*Ratzo*) desire, nonetheless he then came to the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*), in that "he ascended and went out."[128] That is, his "running" (*Ratzo*) desire was measured and weighed such that there then would be the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*).

(Elsewhere[129] it is explained that this is because the essential desire (*Ratzon Atzmi*) of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One is specifically for the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). Thus, because of the general matter of setting oneself aside and nullifying his own desire to the true desire of the Supernal One, and the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire is such that he then comes to the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). In general, this is the matter of accepting the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven, which brings about that even the strongest form of "running" (*Ratzo*) desire will specifically accord to the will of the Supernal One.)

[127] Midrash Vayikra Rabba 16:4
[128] See Zohar I 26b
[129] Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 ibid. p. 257

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This then, is the aspect of the fiery flames of the *Neshamah*, that when it is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) desire, it is with measure and balance, so that he does not come to a state of complete withdrawal, but the ascent should rather be in a way of tranquility and gradation, without too much dominance, but such there subsequently will be the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). This is because the essential being of the *Neshamah* is the aspect of the *Ru'ach*, through which it ascends in the above-mentioned manner. This is because, in and of itself, the aspect of the fire (*Aish*) is in a state of complete withdrawal, like the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire of the world of Chaos-*Tohu*. However, the fire (*Aish*) of the *Neshamah* is from the aspect of Repair-*Tikkun*, in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), in that "he ascends and goes out." This is because its primary aspect is air (*Ru'ach*) and thus the fire (*Aish*) also includes the air (*Ru'ach*), so that its ascent is such that there subsequently will be the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*).

Likewise,[130] the general matter of "returning" (*Shov*) in the *Neshamah*, is brought about through the *Ru'ach* within it. This is like the explanation before in the analogy, that the reason fire rests upon the wick is specifically because of the air. Likewise, the reason that the spark of the Godly soul desires closeness to God, such that through Torah and *mitzvot* He is drawn down in it as it is below, this specifically being the aspect of the descent of the lights (*Orot*) into the vessels (*Keilim*),

[130] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel*" in Torat Chayim Shemot ibid. (394c and on).

which is the opposite of the ascent and withdrawal of the rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*), and is why it is called "the flame of *HaShem*-יהו"ה," in that it specifically is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), meaning that it also has the power of descent and being drawing down from Above to below to specifically contain the light (*Ohr*) within a vessel (*Kli*), as [in the words],[131] "Illuminate our eyes in Your Torah," so that there will be a revelation of Godliness in his soul as it is below, "in various different vessels"[132] through the *mitzvot* and the like (which is why the word "and you shall love-*v'Ahavta*-ואהבת-414" is twice [the numerical value of] "light-*Ohr*-אור-207,"[133] in that [it includes both] the aspect of the direct light (*Ohr Yashar*) and the aspect of rebounding light (*Ohr Chozer*) etc.), this descent and drawing forth is from the aspect of the *Ru'ach* which arouses him to draw down the revelation of Godliness in his soul.

That is, just as there is an arousal of the Godly spirit (*Ru'ach*) to love *HaShem*-יהו"ה and to adhere to Him[134] in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*), so likewise there is an arousal of the Godly spirit (*Ru'ach*) to go in the ways of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, in Torah and *mitzvot* and charity, as well as in thought, speech, and action.

This arousal causes the descent of the Godly spark of the *Neshamah* and draws down and causes the descent of the fire of the *Neshamah* to below, such that it desires that the light be drawn down to below, as explained before. This is as the

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[131] In the liturgy of the blessings of the *Shema* recital.
[132] See Esther 1:7
[133] Pri Etz Chayim, Shaar HaKeriyat Shema, Ch. 23 & Ch. 25
[134] See Deuteronomy 30:20

verse states,[135] "The spirit of *HaShem* (*Ru'ach HaShem*- רוח יהו"ה) led them." That is, the aspect of the descent and drawing down of the Godly fire to rest below, such that he desires the drawing down of Godliness through Torah and *mitzvot*, is specifically through the aspect of the Godly spirit (*Ru'ach*) of the soul.

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This then, is the meaning of the verse,[136] "For a *mitzvah* is a flame and Torah is light." That is, the meaning of "Torah is light" is that it is analogous to a big bonfire, this being the aspect of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*) of the intellect (*Mochin*), in that "the Torah came out of Wisdom-*Chochmah*,"[137] this being the aspect of fire (*Aish*). For, as explained before, the intellectual faculties (*Mochin*) are the aspect of fire (*Aish*), except that they are the aspect of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*) and the light of the Torah is the aspect of an abundance of light, and a wondrous light.

In contrast, "a *mitzvah* is a flame," this being the aspect of a particular fire. For, as known,[138] Torah is the aspect of the general totality of the light, whereas in the *mitzvot* the light is divided into particular vessels. It is for this reason that it is called a flame or candle (*Ner*-נר), in that it is like an individual candle (*Ner*-נר).

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[135] Isaiah 63:14

[136] Proverbs 6:23

[137] Zohar II 62a; 85a; 121a; Zohar III 81a; 182a; 261a.

[138] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 2 p. 482 and on; 5634 p. 87 and on; 5654 p. 329 and on; 5678 p. 122 and on.

However, this refers to how the *mitzvot* receive from the light of the Torah. Nevertheless, the root of the *mitzvot* is in the aspect of the desire of the Supernal One, which transcends the wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Torah. Thus, the aspect of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ri*) of the Torah is specifically dependent on the *mitzvot*. This is as explained before that the revelation of the fire (*Aish*) is dependent on the spirit (*Ru'ach*) and the air. The same is so of the light of the Torah, in that it is dependent on the *mitzvot*.[139] This is like the teaching,[140] "Whosoever says he has nothing but Torah etc." Rather, there also must be acts of lovingkindness, as in the verse,[141] "Teach me good reasoning and knowledge, for I have been faithful to Your commandments." This then, is why the verse gives precedence to "a *mitzvah* is a flame" over "Torah is light," since the light of the Torah entirely depends on the *mitzvot*.

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This then,[142] is also why it is a *mitzvah* to place the Chanukah lamp at the entrance to one's house on the outside, and specifically on the left, because the Chanukah lamp is "Torah is light."

To explain, as known the war with the Greeks was a spiritual war. That is, they did not want to enslave their bodies,

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[139] See Torah Ohr, Mikeitz 42c; 43b

[140] Talmud Bavli, Yevamot 109b; Also see Likkutei Torah Vayikra 5a; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 14 p. 317, note 15.

[141] Psalms 119:66

[142] Regarding the coming section see Torah Ohr Mikeitz ibid. 42c and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 Vol. 1 p. 106; p. 112 and on; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 5 p. 223 and on, and elsewhere.

but only "to cause them to forget Your Torah."[143] This is why they defiled all the oils in the Sanctuary,[144] referring to the fact that the external wisdoms cause the defilement of the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the side of holiness.[145] Thus, when the Hasmonaean dynasty overcame them and were victorious, they established that the Chanukah lamps be kindled, this being the aspect of "Torah is light," in order to illuminate the darkness. This is because the light of the Torah is the aspect of an illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*) [which illuminates] to a great distance. It thus is also in its power to illuminate the darkness. This is why it specifically must be on the outside in the public domain (*Reshut HaRabim*), called "the mountains of separation" (*Tura d'Pruda*),[146] and specifically on the left. That is, it is to repair the left column through the light of the Torah.

However, they first had to overcome and be victorious over them, brought about specifically through the power of self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*). This is because they defiled the aspect of the "oil" (*Shemen*) of the Wisdom-*Chochmah* of the Torah, and this being so, how was it possible for it to shine? It therefore was necessary for them to first overpower them, which they did through the power of self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*). It then was possible to illuminate through the light of

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[143] See the liturgy of the "*Al HaNissim*" recited on Chanukah; Also see Torah Ohr, Vayeishev 30a; Sefer HaMaamarim 5631 Vol. 1 ibid. p. 106; 5632 Vol. 1 p. 19 and on; p. 27; Sefer HaMaamarim 5688 p. 97; 5692 p. 185; 5698 p. 173; 5701 p. 59 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim Yiddish p. 185; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 164 (Vol. 2 p. 19 in earlier editions) and elsewhere.

[144] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 21b

[145] See Ginat Egoz of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as HaShem Is One, Vol. 3 (The Letters of Creation, Part 2), The Gate explaining how all of nature-*Teva*-טבע is sustained on the foundation of 26-כ״ו.

[146] See Zohar I 158a

the Torah. This is also why the Mezuzah must be on the right and the Chanukah lamp on the left. This refers to the fact specifically through the *mitzvot* the light of the Torah illuminates, as explained before.

Now, it may be posited that if one's soul has become defiled by external wisdoms, the light of Torah is then of no benefit in illuminating his soul, in that it does not shine, as explained before. Rather, this only comes about through fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality, and this should be with great strength, in that specifically this extracts his soul from the defilement mentioned above, and his soul can then be illuminated with the light of the Torah.

This specifically is when there is a Mezuzah on the right, meaning, fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actuality, and there then can be the Chanukah lamp on the left. This is like how in the times of the Hasmoneans it was necessary for there to first be actual self-sacrifice (*Mesirat Nefesh*). Only afterwards did they establish the kindling of the Chanukah lamp, the aspect of "Torah is light."

The same is so now, in that the *mitzvot* must be fulfilled in actuality, and only then can one's soul shine with the light of the Torah. This is why there must be the Mezuzah on the right, and thereby the Chanukah lamp on the left, to illuminate the left column.

Discourse 15

"*Vayigash Eilav Yehudah… - Yehudah approached him…*"

Delivered on Shabbat Parshat Vayigash, 5666[1]
By the grace of *HaShem,* blessed is He,

The verse states,[2] "Yehudah approached him and said, 'If you please, my lord.'" About this Zohar states[3] that Yehudah approaching Yosef is the matter of juxtaposing redemption (*Ge'ulah*) to prayer (*Tefillah*).[4] This is because Yosef is the aspect of redemption (*Ge'ulah*), and as known,[5] redemption (*Ge'ulah*) is the aspect of Foundation-*Yesod*, as the verse states,[6] "If he will redeem you, good (*Tov*-טוב)," and another verse states,[7] "Say of the righteous (*Tzaddik*-צדיק) that he is good (*Tov*-טוב)," and Yosef is the aspect of Foundation-

[1] This discourse is based on the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel*" in Torat Chayim Shemot Vol. 2 p. 394d and on; Discourse entitled "*Beha'alotcha*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bamidbar Vol. 3 p. 946 and on, as cited in later notes. Regarding the beginning and end of the discourse, see the discourse entitled "*Vayigash*" of the Tzemach Tzeddek which is found in manuscript 1088 8 (not published as of yet); Also see the beginning and end of the discourse entitled "*Inyan Hagashat Yehudah L'Yosef*" in Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 16 and on.

[2] Genesis 44:18

[3] Zohar I 205b (beginning of Vayigash)

[4] See Talmud Bavli, Brachot 4b; 9b

[5] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Two (*Yesod*); Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 36; Also see the discourse of the Tzemach Tzeddek entitled "*Vayigash*" ibid.; Also see the citations in *Hemshech* 5666, p. 168 note 101.

[6] Ruth 3:13; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 36 ibid.

[7] Isaiah 3:10; Also see Shaar HaYichud, Ch. 36 ibid.

Yesod, the Upper Righteous One (*Tzaddik Elyon*).[8] In contrast, Yehudah is the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, which is the matter of prayer,[9] [as the verse states],[10] "and I am (*VaAni*-ואני) prayer." Therefore, the approach of Yehudah is the matter of juxtaposing redemption (*Ge'ulah*) to prayer (*Tefillah*).

However, we must understand this better. For, is it not so that here it is Yehudah who approached Yosef? That is, Yosef was on a higher level than Yehudah, in that Foundation-*Yesod* is higher than Kingship-*Malchut*, and thus the lower one must ascend and approach the upper one. This being so, why is it called[11] "juxtaposing redemption (*Ge'ulah*) to prayer (*Tefillah*)," seeming to indicate that there is an advantage and superiority to prayer (*Tefillah*) which is the aspect of Yehudah?

Now, to understand this, we must preface with the explanation before[12] on the verse,[13] "The flame (*Ner*-נר) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה is the soul of man." That is, the soul is compared to a candle (*Ner*-נר) in that just as the flame of a candle ascends and descends, so likewise the soul has the matter of ascent in it, this being the matter of the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire in it. This is the aspect of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*) of the *Neshamah*, which is the revelation of the light of love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה with flames of fiery passion, with yearning and thirst. It was explained before that just as with the flame of a

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[8] See Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 10, section on Yosef; Ch. 18, section on Tzaddik; Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe ibid. Ch. 36; Discourse of the Tzemach Tzeddek entitled "*Vayigash*" ibid.

[9] See Torah Ohr Vayechi p. 45c and elsewhere.

[10] Psalms 109:4; Also see Pri Etz Chayim, introduction to Shaar HaTefilah.

[11] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 159, note 11.

[12] In the prior discourse entitled "*Ner Chanukah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 148 and on).

[13] Proverbs 20:27

candle, for it to be kindled and illuminate, this comes through wind (*Ru'ach*) and air, this likewise is so of the illuminating light (*Ohr HaMe'ir*) of the *Neshamah*, in that for it to be in a state of a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire, this is brought about specifically through the aspect of "the spirit (*Ru'ach*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה."

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Now, to explain this, we must better understand[14] where the arousal of the *Neshamah* to ascend comes from, and likewise, to descend below, in that, as explained before, it yearns to fulfill Torah and *mitzvot*. This is because it could be said that this comes from the *Neshamah* by its own volition, since by nature, everything is drawn to its root.

However, if this is so, where does its power to descend and be drawn down come from, something that does not apply to attribute to its nature of being drawn to its source? This is because that only applies to its ascent, but not to its descent and drawing down.

Now, in truth, even about the ascent it cannot be said that it only is because of its nature to be drawn to its source. This is because this nature, that everything is drawn to its source, specifically applies when it senses its source. Even though everything has the power of attraction (*Ko'ach HaMoshech*) in it and thus is automatically drawn to its source,

[14] See the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel*" in Torat Chayim Shemot ibid. p. 394d.

as in the teaching,[15] "Toss a stick in the air and it will fall to its base," this is because of its nature, without any sense of feeling the matter at all. Thus, this is not the matter of the attraction of the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire [of the soul]. Rather, to be in a state of a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire [to yearn] to be subsumed in his source, this specifically comes when one senses the source.

For example, about light (*Ohr*) as it is Above, the nature of the light (*Ohr*) is to be subsumed in its source, this being because it adheres to its source and senses its source. This is why it has the nature[16] to be drawn and subsumed [in its source]. However, when the source is not sensed, such as it is in the creatures, even though they too are a radiance of the Godly light, as explained in part two of Tanya,[17] nevertheless, they are not drawn to be subsumed Above, but on the contrary, "the spirit of the beast descends."[18]

This is like the general difference between lights (*Orot*) and vessels (*Keilim*). That is, the nature of the light (*Ohr*) is to ascend to Above, and the nature of the vessels (*Keilim*) is to descend to below. As known,[19] this is because the light (*Ohr*) adheres to its source, whereas the vessels (*Keilim*) are not in a state of adhesion (*Dveikut*). This is why the nature of the vessels (*Keilim*) is specifically to descend to below. The same is so of the creatures in general, in that because they do not

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[15] Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 53:15; 86:6; Bamidbar Rabbah 20:23; Tanchuma Balak 17; Rashi to Genesis 21:21

[16] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 159 note 16.

[17] Tanya, Shaar HaYichud VeHaEmunah, translated as The Gate of Unity and Faith, Ch. 3 (78b) and elsewhere.

[18] See Ecclesiastes 3:21

[19] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5654 p. 1122; 5662 p. 320; 5663 Vol. 2 p. 156; *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 1 p. 565 and on; p. 574, and elsewhere.

adhere to their source and their source is not sensed in them, it therefore is not their nature to ascend to Above.

The same is so of the soul as it descended below, in that it became very distant from its source. This is as known[20] about the blessing,[21] "The soul that You have given within me, she is pure. You created her etc." That is, as the soul is in its root, she is pure (*Tehorah*-טהורה). This refers to how the soul is in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*) and higher than the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), in the aspect of the Upper Purity (*Tehiru Ila'ah*-טהירו עילאה).[22]

There it truly is in the state of ultimate adhesion and union with Godliness, as in the words,[23] "She hugs and adheres [to You]." That is, it is in a state of literal union and adhesion to Godliness. Although it states in Iggeret HaKodesh, in the discourse entitled "*Eehoo v'Chiyohee Chad*"[24] that even as the souls are in the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*), it is as they already have emerged from and become separated from the vessels (*Keilim*), this refers to the coming into being of the souls to be an independent existence unto themselves, but even so, they still are in a state of adhesion and are unified, (like a child who is bound to the essence of his father.)

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[20] See Torah Ohr Mishpatim p. 77a; Likkutei Torah Bechukotai 46d and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5662 p. 361; 5686 p. 36 and on; 5688 p. 174; 5699 p. 227.

[21] The "*Elokai Neshamah*" blessing in the morning blessings (Talmud Bavli, Brachot 60b).

[22] See Zohar I 15a; Also see Shaar HaYichud of the Mittler Rebbe, translated as The Gate of Unity, Ch. 10-11.

[23] See the liturgy of the Hoshaanot prayers for the third day of Sukkot.

[24] Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 20 (130a); Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 49; p. 51; 5632 Vol. 1 p. 40; 5650 p. 288 (also see p. 323); 5654 p. 201; 5664 p. 49; 5677 p. 131; Also see the later discourse entitled "*Heekavtzu v'Sheemoo*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 657).

It must also be said that there are various levels in the soul. That is, there are the levels of the *Nefesh*, *Ru'ach*, *Neshamah*, *Chayah* and *Yechidah* of the soul and the level that "hugs" and is in a state of constant union is the *Yechidah* level within it. (This is so, even though in reference to the general whole of the soul it states that they already emerged and became separated).

However, in the levels below this, it specifically is at auspicious times when there is an illumination from Above, that they then come to be in a state of adhesion and become subsumed in their source. However, as the soul descended below, about which it states, "You created her, You formed her etc.," meaning that it came into the aspect of a novel creation of something from nothing (*Yesh MeAyin*), it is not in a state of adhesion to its source.

For, although the matter of something from nothing (*Yesh MeAyin*) as it is in the soul, is not the same as the matter of something from nothing (*Yesh MeAyin*) as it is in the creations in general, as known and explained elsewhere,[25] nonetheless, it still is the aspect of a "something" (*Yesh*), such that that it can manifest in the body and animalistic soul, this being the matter of [the continuing words], "You blew her into me etc."

Certainly as it is below the soul does not have a sense of its source that it should thereby have an attraction and "running" (*Ratzo*) desire to it, being that it has become very

[25] See Likkutei Torah Nitzavim 47a; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Devarim Vol. 3 p. 840; p. 890; Ohr HaTorah Nitzavim p. 1,249; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 652 and on.

distant. Thus, if we would nonetheless say that it indeed senses its source, and that this is why it has a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire to be drawn to its root, why then does this only takes place on auspicious occasions? At first glance, it should be in a constant state of "running" (*Ratzo*). This being so, it must be said that it is not because of the above-mentioned reason.

However, the explanation[26] is that the arousal of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) in the soul is caused by the Godly power that shines upon it from Above. This is akin to what Aharon was told about the kindling of the flames (*Neirot*),[27] "toward the face of the Menorah shall the seven flames cast light." As known,[28] the seven flames (*Neirot*) refer to the souls of the Jewish people, and the matter of kindling the flames is that Aharon, the High Priest, would draw the aspect of great love of Him (*Ahavah Rabbah*) to bring them to a state of "running" (*Ratzo*).

The power for this elevation is "towards the face (*Pnei*-**פני**) of the Menorah," referring to the innerness (*Pnimiyut*-**פנימיות**) of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One. More generally, it refers to the innerness (*Pnimiyut*) of Kingship-*Malchut*, which is the aspect of the Congregation of Israel (*Knesset Yisroel*)[29] - the root and inner source of the souls of the Jewish people.

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[26] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Vayakhel*" in Torat Chayim Shemot ibid. p. 394d.

[27] Numbers 8:2

[28] See Likkutei Torah Beha'alotcha 29c; 33b and elsewhere.

[29] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate One (*Malchut*).

From there comes a drawing down to illuminate the flames (*Neirot*) of the souls of the Jewish people to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) with great love of Him (*Ahavah Rabbah*), and it likewise is from there that there is a drawing down to be in a state of "returning" (*Shov*).

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Now, the explanation is that, as known,[30] the vitality and Godly light that [manifests] in the creations in general, is drawn forth in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), specifically in a way of ascent and descent. About this the verse states,[31] "The *Chayot*-חיות [angels] were running and returning," which also refers to the Godly vitality (*Chayut*-חיות) that enlivens all creations and all worlds [bringing them into being] from nothing to something. That is, [this too] is in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*).

This is as stated,[32] "For *HaShem*-יהו"ה your God is a consuming fire." That is, this is compared to fire (*Aish*) which in a constant state of ascending and descending, except that from Above to below it is the matter of "coming" (*Mati*) and "not coming" (*Lo Mati*).[33]

The aspect of the power of the Actor (*Ko'ach HaPo'el*) of the Godly light and vitality also causes the acted upon (*Nifal*)

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[30] See the previous discourse entitled "*Vayechulu*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 58 and on).

[31] Ezekiel 1:14

[32] Deuteronomy 4:24

[33] Zohar I 16b; Also see Torah Ohr Bereishit 2d; Torah Ohr, Hosafot to Megillat Esther 123a; Likkutei Torah Masei 95c; Discourse entitled "*Vayechulu*" ibid., and elsewhere.

to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*). About this the verse states, "The *Chayot* [angels] were running and returning," in that the service of the animal-*Chayot* and fiery-*Seraphim* [angels] of the worlds of Creation (*Briyah*) and Formation (*Yetzirah*) is in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*).

This is such that even the hosts of the heavens of the world of Action (*Asiyah*), recite [their] song (*Shirah*-שירה) specifically with "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*). This is like the teaching,[34] "All that have a chain (*Baalei Sheir*-**בעלי שיר**) may go out with their chain (*Sheir*-שיר) and may be pulled by their chain (*Sheir*-שיר)," referring to the song (*Shirah*-**שירה**) of the upper angels and the heavenly hosts.[35]

This is like the verse,[36] "The heavenly hosts prostrate to You," specifically with a "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*). (As explained elsewhere,[37] the revolutions of the cycle-*Ophanim* [angels] and the celestial spheres (*Galgalim*) is a matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*). See the explanation in the discourse entitled "*Le'umat HaMisgeret*" 5665.)[38]

All this is because of the power and bestowal of the Godly light upon them in a way of "running" (*Ratzo*) and

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[34] Talmud Bavli, Shabbat 51b

[35] See Likkutei Torah, Zot HaBrachah 98a (in the name of the Rav, the Maggid of Mezhritch); Siddur Im Da"Ch 275d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Maamarei RaZa"L p. 120; Ohr HaTorah Beshalach p. 494; Sefer HaMaamarim 5633 Vol. 1 p. 269; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 373 (Vol. 6 p. 95 in earlier editions).

[36] Nehemiah 9:6

[37] Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 1 p. 48 and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Kuntreisim p. 437 and on; Ohr HaTorah Terumah p. 1,467 and on.

[38] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 161

"returning" (*Shov*), ascending and descending. This is why they too have the aspects of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), this being the matter of nullification and ascent to Above, as well as the matter of the descent and drawing down to below.

The same is understood about the soul of man, that it is in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), brought about by an upper power coming from Above. However, in man this is on a loftier level for two reasons. The first reason is that because he descended and manifested in a garment of physicality, therefore, the "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*) of the *Chayot* angels is not enough to awaken him with the aspects of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), being that this is not sensed in him to such an extent.

Moreover, since his work is an inner work which, as known, transcends the work of the angels and the heavenly hosts,[39] therefore, the arousal also comes from a higher level, meaning from the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*). That is, there is a drawing down of a revelation of the Supernal light upon the souls to awaken them to a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) to ascend to Above.

This is as known[40] about the verse,[41] "Lavan woke early in the morning," that "Lavan-לבן" refers to the aspect of the

[39] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5640 Vol. 2 p. 604 and on; 5646 p. 400; 5650 p. 290; 5656 p. 244 and on; 5660 p. 70; p. 125 and on.

[40] See Torah Ohr Vayeitzei 23a; 24b; Torat Chayim Vayeitzei 37a and on; Also see the discourse entitled "*Vayashkeim Lavan*" 5748.

[41] Genesis 32:1

Upper Whiteness (*Loven HaElyon*-לובן העליון),[42] meaning, the aspect of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) which transcends the order of the chaining down of the worlds (*Seder Hishtalshelut*). There is a drawing down of a radiance from the aspect of the Upper Whiteness (*Loven HaElyon*) into the aspect of "the morning" of "Avraham who loved Me,"[43] to awaken the souls of the Jewish people to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*).

This is as we clearly observe that every morning there is a spontaneous awakening in every soul, in that it is roused to the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, to go and cleave to *HaShem* is One-*HaShem Echad*-יהו"ה אחד with true love and fear of Him, and not to pursue vanity, and likewise, to have no desire for physical life and be soiled with physical lusts, but rather, to despise them and to only desire closeness to God alone.

This awakening is found in each person according to his stature, at every auspicious and appropriate time Above, such that there is a spontaneous drawing down upon him of a spirit from Above to awaken him to this in the spirit of life within his heart.

This refers to when one's heart is suddenly roused without any prior preparation. For, had there been a prior preparation and arousal in his heart of his own volition, then

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[42] See Shaarei Orah of Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, translated as Gates of Light, Gate Ten (*Keter*); Etz Chayim, Shaar 6 (Shaar HaAkudim) Ch. 1; Shaar 38 (Shaar Leah v'Rochel) Ch. 3; Also see Midrash Bereishit Rabbah 70:10.

[43] See Isaiah 41:8; Also see Zohar I 203a; 247b; Zohar III 22b; 204a; 242a; Torah Ohr Lech Lecha 12a; Shemot 50b; Likkutei Torah Ki Tavo 42d; 43b; Shir HaShirim 44a, and elsewhere.

certainly "a spirit awakens a spirit and draws forth a spirit,"[44] so that there would be a drawing down upon him from Above to rouse him. However, when he is suddenly roused without any prior preparation within himself at all, this is a clear sign and demonstration that they are rousing him from Above. This is akin to the Heavenly proclamation (*Bat Kol*) that comes forth each day and proclaims, "Return etc."[45]

The same is so of even loftier levels of "running" (*Ratzo*), in that they too are brought about specifically by an arousal from Above. For example, there is a Godly power in the angels that rouses them to ascend. For, as known,[46] the five powers of might (*Gevurot*) of the Mother-*Imma* (Understanding-*Binah*) rouse the upper angels from Above.

The five powers of might (*Gevurot*) are the aspect of the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire and the withdrawal of the Godly light, which brings the aspect of the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire in the creations, as mentioned before. The same is so of the powers of might (*Gevurot*) of Kingship-*Malchut*, in that through the aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) within it, there is caused to be the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire in the creations and upper angels. This is as stated in Zohar,[47] "When She withdraws, they all follow

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[44] Zohar II 162b; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 163d; Imrei Binah, Shaar HaTefilin 163a and on; Ohr HaTorah Chanukah (Vol. 2) p. 286a.

[45] See Mishnah Avot 6:2; Talmud Bavli, Chagigah 15a; Also see Keter Shem Tov, Section 146; 255; Hosafot, section 101 and on; Likkutei Torah Bamidbar 6c; Ha'azinu p. 71d; Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5565 Vol. 2 p. 602; Also see later in *Hemshech* 5666 p. 626; Sefer HaMaamarim 5688 p. 120; 5692 p. 399; 5702 p. 139; Likkutei Sichot Vol. 9 p. 25; Sefer HaSichot 5747 Vol. 2 p. 503 and on, and elsewhere.

[46] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 2 p. 394; Ohr HaTorah Masei p. 1,395; p. 1,405; Sefer HaMaamarim 5629 p. 158 and on; 5664 p. 139 and on.

[47] Zohar I 229b

and withdraw with Her," in the strongest aspect of "running" (*Ratzo*) desire.

The same is so of the souls, which are called "the flame (*Ner*-נר) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה," in that there is a drawing down to them from Above, so that they automatically are roused to ascend Above, like a spark which rises in and of itself to become subsumed in the flame.

This is the matter of the great love (*Ahavah Rabba*) that [is roused] in the souls to be in a strong state of "running" (*Ratzo*) desire, as it is in the essence of the soul by the nature of its birth, to literally be drawn to the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*), as in the verse,[48] "Who do I have in the heavens, and but for You I desire nothing." This is because the root and source of the soul is in His Essential Self, and it is bound to the Essence of the limitless light of the Unlimited One with an essential bond.

This is why it is drawn to Him, blessed is He, to become subsumed with the totality of its essential self and being. This is akin to a spark that is quickly drawn to be subsumed in the flame. The same is so of the soul, that it is drawn with great speed to be subsumed in the limitless light of the Unlimited One, blessed is He.

However, all this does not cause arousal in the soul itself, except specifically by way of an upper power, this being the matter of Aharon, the high priest, kindling the flames (*Neirot*), by which he brings about the aspect of great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) in the souls of the Jewish people, thus awakening them to ascend Above.

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[48] Psalms 73:25

[This is the meaning of the verse], "Toward the face (*Pnei*-פני) of the Menorah [shall the seven flames] cast light," meaning that the ascent is to the aspect of "the face (*Pnei*-**פני**) of the Menorah," referring to the innerness (*Pnimiyut*-**פנימיות**) and Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ohr Ein Sof*). It is from there itself that there is a drawing down of this empowerment and awakening for them to be able to ascend to Above.

That is, when there is an illumination of the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One within the soul, it then is caused to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) to become subsumed in the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One.

This is as stated in the writings of the Arizal on the verse,[49] "Her flames are flames of fire, [the flame of *Ya"H*-י"ה]," that this refers to the flames of fire of the Congregation of Israel (*Knesset Yisroel*). From where does this flame emerge – that is, the flame of the Congregation of Israel? – from the flame that emerges from *Ya"H*-י"ה, as stated in Likkutei Torah of the Arizal to Parshat Vayera[50] on the matter of Ammon and Mo'av.

That is, this refers to the aspect of the flames of fire of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) in the souls of the Jewish people that comes from Above. About this the verse states,[51] "this service is a gift that I have given your priesthood." That

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[49] Song of Songs 8:6

[50] In the section beginning "*Sod Amon uMo'av*"; Also see Likkutei Torah Chukat 66b; *Hemshech* "*Mayim Rabim*" 5636 p. 68 and on; Also see Sefer HaMaamarim 5697 p. 241; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 279 and on (Vol. 1 p. 22 and on in earlier editions).

[51] Numbers 18:7; Also see Tanya, Ch. 14 (20a); Chinuch Katan (76a); Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 6 (110b); Epistle 18 (126a and on).

is, it is an upper love that comes from Above to be a flame that ascends in and of itself, as explained in the Siddur in the note on Tikkun Chatzot.[52]

We thus find that although there is a nature in every Godly spark to ascend Above and become subsumed in and adhere to the source from where it was hewn in Godliness, this being the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*), akin to a spark that ascends and becomes subsumed in the flame, nonetheless, this awaking to ascend is drawn to it from Above, as in the verse,[53] "Until a spirit from on high will be poured out upon us," specifically.

This takes place at times that are auspicious and propitiously desirable Above, such as on Shabbat. At such times there is an illumination of the aspect of the desire of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*) and there is a drawing down of the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabba*) in the souls of the Jewish people, and the same is true on the festivals.

We thus find that the aspect of the general awakening that takes place every day is because of the revelation from Above, such that the soul is renewed each day with the aspect of empowerment and Supernal light to awaken it to the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, this being the radiance of the above-mentioned aspect of the Supernal Whiteness (*Loven HaElyon*).

This is the matter of the verse,[54] "They are new every morning," in that she is renewed, as discussed before. This likewise is so of the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*)

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[52] Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 152a
[53] Isaiah 32:15
[54] Lamentations 3:23

in the souls, which is like the spark that is drawn. This specifically comes to the soul from Above, and as the verse states,[55] "For You are my flame *HaShem*-יהו"ה." That is, the arousal of the aspect of "the flame of *HaShem*-יהו"ה" of the soul, to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*), is specifically from Above, in that "You are my flame."

Now, this awakening is specifically of the aspect of the *Ru'ach* [of the soul], as in the verse, "Until a spirit (*Ru'ach*) from on high will be poured out upon us," specifying the "spirit-*Ru'ach*-רוח." This is because the *Ru'ach* is the aspect of the desire (*Ratzon*),[56] in that from Above there is an arousal of the desire (*Ratzon*) of the soul.

This is because the matter of "running" (*Ratzo*) desire is in the aspect of flames of fire (*Aish*), this being the *Neshamah* [aspect of the soul], which is in a state of *being* drawn forth (but is not actually bound and in a state of actual adhesion etc.), since that is where it applies for there to be a matter of fiery flames [of passion] to ascend.

This is roused through the desire (*Ratzon*), because the upper light that awakens a person, whether to the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in general, or whether in to great love of Him, is as desire (*Ratzon*) that is felt this the soul, such that his desire is awakened, and the desire is the aspect of the *Ru'ach* (air) that brings the fire (*Aish*) of the soul into revelation, to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*).

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[55] Samuel II 22:29

[56] See the previous discourse entitled "*Ner Chanukah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 152).

The same is so of the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*). That is, his desire for closeness to God and to draw His light down through Torah and *mitzvot*, as explained before, is through the arousal from Above. This is as explained before, that just as the arousal of the *Ru'ach* in man is what brings him to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*), meaning, to love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, the same is so, that the arousal of the *Ru'ach* is to go in His ways in Torah and *mitzvot*.

This is because, in and of himself, he would not go in the ways of *HaShem*-יהו"ה in the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*) by fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot*, in that this is the opposite of the nature of the *Neshamah*. Rather, this is only because this is the will of the Supernal One (*Ratzon HaElyon*). However, as the soul is below, this is not sensed, in that but for the arousal from Above, by which he is awakened, he himself would not go [that way]. This too is because of the upper radiance from the aspect of the Upper Whiteness (*Loven HaElyon*), such that with this arousal he can spend the entire day engaged in fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot* as is fitting.

This is especially so of the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*) which follows the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire of great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) of Him brought about by the upper power. This is the meaning of the words,[57] "You preserve her within me," so that he will not come to a state of total expiry in his great love, but is rather in a state of "returning" (*Shov*) to below.

All this is in the desire (*Ratzon*) which is the essential bond with Godliness, and one being given over and invested in Godliness. (See later in the discourse entitled "*Ki Ka'asher*

[57] In the liturgy of the "*Elokai Neshamah*" blessing of the morning blessings.

HaShamayim.")[58] That is, the **true** desire of the Essential Self of the Unlimited One (*Atzmut Ein Sof*) is for the matter of "returning" (*Shov*),[59] in that "He did not create it for destruction."[60] This desire (*Ratzon*) is sensed in man's desire, causing that after the aspect of the "running" (*Ratzo*) desire, there then will specifically be the aspect of "returning" (*Shov*) in him.

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However, we still must understand this better, because according to the above explanation, it seems that man's service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, is not at all by his own volition, but that he simply is roused from Above to be in a state of "running" (*Ratzo*) and "returning" (*Shov*), meaning, to love *HaShem*-יהו"ה and go in His ways.[61] However, is it not known that of primary importance in serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה is that it should be specifically by his own volition and strength,[62] by his free choice and willingly? However, if he is brought to this through an awakening from Above, is it not so that this is not service stemming from his own free choice and volition? This being so, this is not work or service at all.

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[58] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 203.

[59] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5649 p. 257; Also see the prior discourse entitled "*Ner Chanukah*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 157).

[60] Isaiah 45:18

[61] Deuteronomy 30:16

[62] See Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5562 Vol. 2 p. 361; Sefer HaMaamarim 5700 p. 133; Also see Sefer HaSichot 5749 Vol. 2 p. 524 and on; 5702 p. 505; p. 518, and elsewhere.

However, the explanation is that indeed it is true that the above-mentioned arousal comes from Above, such that one is spontaneously roused to love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה without any prior preparation. However, this only serves as an introduction to the **true** service, in which one toils within himself and labors in his mind and heart, as we clearly see that this is a fleeting arousal that quickly passes in a short time.[63]

That is, even though in its time it is with great force, nonetheless, after a short period of time it dissipates and passes, as though it never was. Only that at such times, when one has an awakening from Above, he then must toil within himself to come to the inner work of contemplating Godliness, thus giving rise to emotions of love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. For, since because of the above-mentioned arousal his heart is opened, and in general his soul becomes opened, it thus is a propitious time to engage in the true contemplation (*Hitbonenut*) of contemplating Godliness and understanding it well, until his brain will absorb it in a very settled way, such that the Godly matter will illumination in his soul in a revealed way.

However, not all times are propitious for this. For, there are times that even if he wants to contemplate and be brought close to Godliness, he is incapable of doing so, in that [at such times] he does properly grasp and lacks vitality in it, and thus the matter is not absorbed in his brain.

This is because of matters that cause concealment and hiddenness in his soul, these being bodily matters, those of the animalistic soul and its materiality. (It could be that these are

[63] See Likkutei Torah Vayikra 2b and on; Shir HaShirim 22c; 24a and elsewhere.

revealed matters, which distract the soul during prayer, such as various alien thoughts and bad thoughts.

[At such a time] no matter how much he endeavors to contemplate, the matter does not become settled in him at all, nor is [the contemplation] effective in banishing the thoughts. This is because his soul has become defiled by the sins of youth and the like,[64] which hide and conceal the soul, so that the Godly light does not illuminate in him. This also is why the distracting thoughts come to him. Moreover, because of this his soul becomes gross and physical, and thus cannot be receptive to Godliness.

On the other hand, it could be that these matters are concealed in a person. That is, though in a revealed way they do not distract him, still and all, some obstacle or obstruction is caused. This too is due to the above-mentioned matters, except that here they are from matters that took place in the past, even though he presently has no relation to such things, except that he has yet to repair them. Therefore, even though they do not distract him in a revealed way, nonetheless, they sometimes cover over the soul, causing the dulling of his mind and heart.) As a result he cannot contemplate, and certainly cannot come to love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה.

(Therefore, the advice for this is to awaken great mercies upon his soul, through which he rouses and draws the aspect of the Supernal mercies upon himself,[65] and through the radiance of the Supernal mercies, the concealment and

[64] See Tanya, Ch. 29 (36b).

[65] See Tanya, Ch. 45 (64b); Likkutei Torah, Re'eh 32c; Shir HaShirim 49b, and elsewhere.

hiddenness brought about by the animalistic soul is caused to be nullified, thus opening his soul be able to contemplate.)

However, when there indeed is an awakening from Above, this removes the concealments and hiddenness, and it then becomes an auspicious and propitious time for the contemplation (*Hitbonenut*). He then must toil within himself to grasp the Godly matter well with the adhesion of the mind (*Ha'amakat HaDa'at*) until it is felt very well in his soul, so that his heart is roused with the love to be close to God and adhere to Him, such that his desire and yearning is entirely for the Godly light and vitality.

This is **true** service which is sustaining to his soul. That is, to be in a constant state of contemplation and love is not possible, nonetheless, some [impression] of this remains throughout the day, so that he turns away from evil and does good in actual deed, guarding himself greatly from all things that are in opposition to Godliness and that hide and conceal Godliness, such that he has vitality in doing the *mitzvot* and desires them.

In contrast, when there only is the aspect of the above-mentioned awakening, which is only in an encompassing (*Makif*) way, it follows that it has no relation to fulfilling the *mitzvot* in actual deed, and especially of repairing and refining the animalistic soul. This is because this comes through the above-mentioned work, specifically in an inner manifest (*b'Pnimiyut*) way.

That is, when he is roused with such love that he truly desires Godliness, then he has no desire for anything other than Godliness at all, especially whatever is in opposition to

Godliness. This automatically humbles and weakens the natural emotions of the animalistic soul, and over the course of time they become nullified.

This certainly is so if he toils in refining and repairing the particular emotions of the animalistic soul. That is, he toils in himself so that even the animalistic soul should come to understand the Godly matter and that Godliness is good, so that it too will be roused with love of *HaShem*-יהו"ה. Through doing so the restraint and nullification of the natural emotions of the animalistic soul follow automatically. All this does not apply to the arousal that only comes from Above, but comes specifically through the work done by the power of that arousal.

Although it too [the arousal from Above] also has an effect on the animalistic soul, so that it does not hide and conceal the Godly soul, thus giving him the ability to contemplate, as discussed before, nevertheless, this only brings about a general nullification of the animalistic soul, and only temporarily, but it is not that it becomes humbled and nullified in essence through this. This is because the animalistic soul has no relation to this light and revelation that it should illuminate in him [in an inner manifest way]. Rather, it specifically is the Godly soul that in essence relates to the upper light, thereby causing the opening of the soul in him, so that it is a propitious and auspicious time for him to engage in true service and work, as explained before.

However, the animalistic soul has no relation to this at all, and it only is because this is a very lofty radiance that it thereby causes a general nullification of the animalistic soul. (Moreover, this too does not relate to matters that are inner and

essential to it.) Nevertheless, it does not cause an essential nullification in it. Thus, upon the withdrawal of the light, he remains as he was.

(However, this is unlike the matter of the "counsel-*Tushiyah*-תושיה" of the Torah[66] which "weakens-*Meteshet*-מתשת" the power of the animalistic soul, as explained before (in the [previous] discourse entitled "*Vayitein Lecha*"),[67] since that is in a way of refinement (*Birur*). For, since the Torah is the aspect of an inner manifest light (*Ohr Pnimi*), and it even manifests in false matters to refine and clarify, it therefore brings about the refinement of the animalistic soul, so that it becomes refined and nullified in essence. Moreover, it is in a way that is sustaining in him, like the above-mentioned work with the mind and heart. On the contrary, it is to an even greater degree, since it is a refinement from Above to below, as known.[68] In contrast, the above-mentioned awakening is a transcendent encompassing aspect (*Makif*), and it thus follows that the animalistic soul is not refined by it.)

Rather, it is through working in the innerness (*Pnimiyut*), specifically in the mind and heart, that there thereby is caused to be the refinement and nullification of the animalistic soul. Moreover, it is the inner work (*Avodah Pnimit*) that empowers and strengthens his soul to engage in this

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[66] Mechilta to Exodus 15:2; Midrash Vayikra Rabba 31:5; Talmud Bavli, Sanhedrin 26b; Midrash Tehillim 7:1, and elsewhere. Also see Tanya, Iggeret HaKodesh, Epistle 22 (134a); Erchei HaKinuyim (by the author of Seder HaDorot), section on "*Tushiyah*-תושיה."

[67] *Hemshech* 5666 p. 121.

[68] See Sefer HaMaamarim 5659 p. 162 and on; 5704 p. 106 and on; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 45 and on (Vol. 2 p. 181 and on in earlier editions).

work of contemplating and awakening the love and fear, in that through doing so, he truly comes to a state of essential closeness to Godliness (and even the animalistic soul becomes weakened and nullified, as explained before).

He thus will thereby automatically engage in this work to a greater degree and will not require another awakening from Above. He rather will engage in his work in and of himself and ascend in levels of elevation, elevation upon elevation in levels of closeness and adhesion, in a way of going and traveling.[69]

Now, this work in an inner way (*Pnimiyut*) does stem from his own power, meaning that he toils within himself in contemplating (*Hitbonenut*) so that the matter is sensed in him inwardly. Doing so requires the labor of the soul and the labor of the flesh. Likewise, to arouse love and fear of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, though it comes by way of cause and effect, there nevertheless must be preparation for this, as discussed in the discourse entitled "*v'Khol HaAm Ro'eem*" 5665.[70] Even though all of this comes by the power of the awakening from Above which brings about the opening of his soul, as discussed before, and likewise, even at the time of his contemplation and emotional arousal the above-mentioned awakening is present in a concealed way, nevertheless, the contemplation and inner sensitivity and arousal of love and fear are all brought about through his own strength and his own toil, except that they come through the empowerment brought about by the awakening. (The truth of the matter is that at the time of contemplation (*Hitbonenut*) it is necessary to conceal the [emotional] arousal [and excitement]

[69] See Genesis 12:9

[70] Sefer HaMaamarim 5665 p. 248 and on.

that comes from the awakening, for if one does not do so, he will be incapable of properly contemplating, and [the light] will not come to manifest as an inner manifest light (*Ohr Pnimi*).) Thus, it only is like aid and assistance for him to be able to engage in the contemplation (*Hitbonenut*). However, the contemplation itself, as well as the general work, must be by his own strength.

Moreover, the inner work (*Avodah Pnimit*) is the primary work and service. This is because by itself the above-mentioned awakening is not the actual work, but only is a preface for there to then be the actual work (*Avodah*). (For, as known,[71] the arousal in a way of excitement coming from the transcendent encompassing aspect (*Makif*) is not actual work (*Avodah*), and as mentioned before, it does not relate to fulfilling Torah and *mitzvot* and refining the animalistic soul.) That is, it is like the verse, "Lavan woke early in the morning," which is the preface for the subsequent work of serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, in prayer. However, in and of itself, the awakening is not actual work (*Avodah*).

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Now, this is unlike the aspect of the upper love drawn down by Aharon, the High Priest. [For in that case] the love itself is a labor, and on the contrary, it is a very lofty and elevated labor in the aspect of powerful love and "running"

[71] See Kuntres HaTefilah Ch. 2 (p. 12); Kuntres HaAvodah Ch. 7 (p. 46); Also see Kuntres HaHitpaalut of the Mittler Rebbe, printed in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee, Kuntreisim p. 79 and on; p. 82; p. 166 and on, translated as Divine Inspiration.

(*Ratzo*) desire stemming from the essence of the soul. In contrast, in and of itself, the above-mentioned awakening is not a labor, but is only an introduction.

It may be posited that this is like the difference between the inauguration (*Chanukah*-חנוכה) [of the Tabernacle] by the tribal leaders and Aharon's service of kindling the flames,[72] about which he was told,[73] "By your life! Your part is greater than theirs."

To explain[74] by way of analogy, the matter of the inauguration (*Chinuch*-חינוך) is similar to the education (*Chinuch*-חינוך) of a child who goes to cheder. The education is such that he subsequently will go on his own accord without at all being commanded to do so. Therefore, in this the primary education takes place specifically at the beginning.

For example, when a father educates his child and takes him to cheder, the primary matter for him is to then go willing of his own accord and by his own desire, and that he should be very receptive to everything he will learn. To this end, it is necessary for his father to go with him at first, and to endow him with gifts[75] and uplift his heart with "the right hand that draws near,"[76] beyond the usual measure. He thus bestows him with many gifts that are precious in the eyes of the youngster, in order to uplift his soul and awaken his desire to go this first

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[72] Regarding the coming section, see the discourse entitled "*Baha'alotcha*" in Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Bamidbar Vol. 3 p. 946 and on; Also see Maamarei Admor HaZaken 5566 p. 243 and on; Sefer HaMaamarim 5635 Vol. 2 p. 331 and on; 5654 p. 319 and on.

[73] Rashi to Numbers 8:2

[74] Regarding the coming section see Torah Ohr Vayeishev 29d; Likkutei Torah Naso 29a; Siddur Im Da"Ch p. 277a and on; Shaarei Orah 15b and elsewhere.

[75] See Genesis 34:12

[76] See Talmud Bavli, Sotah 47a

time, so that he will subsequently be able to go of his own accord.

The same is so of the inauguration of a new house (*Chunakat HaBayit*-חנוכת הבית).[77] That is, when one first enters the house it is necessary to inaugurate it with a feast and a meal, and his friends bring him gifts, such as various good foods, and bless him to be successful in this home. All this is to affect a drawing down of the encompassing aspect (*Makif*) of the source of the upper flow (*Mazal*) so that it will dwell in this home, to give him the power of blessing and abundance in his livelihood, children, and health etc., as the verse states,[78] "To bring a blessing to rest upon your house," in that one's place and home have an effect. Through this inauguration there subsequently is caused to be a drawing forth of success because of the place of the home in and of itself, so that there is a drawing forth of blessing and beneficence in all he will do in this home.

Now, with these examples in mind we can understand the matter of the inauguration of the Altar by the tribal leaders. For, as known[79] about the matter of the outer Altar, it is the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* of the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*). About this the verse states,[80] "A constant fire shall remain aflame upon the Altar," referring to the five powers of might (*Gevurot*) of Kingship-*Malchut* which cause the refinement (*Birurim*) of the 288-רפ"ח sparks.

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[77] Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 21a and on.

[78] Ezekiel 44:30

[79] See Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 23 (Shaar Erchei HaKinuyim) Ch. 13, section on "*Mizbe'ach*"; Likkutei Torah, Shir HaShirim 51b; Ohr HaTorah Bereishit Vol. 3 p. 480b; Sefer HaMaamarim 5663 Vol. 1 p. 51; Vol. 2 p. 25.

[80] Leviticus 6:6; Also see Likkutei Torah Shir HaShirim ibid.; Ohr HaTorah Vayakhel p. 2,147; Ohr HaTorah Tzav p. 12.

This is the matter of serving *HaShem*-יהו"ה in prayer, with the aspect of love with passion and fiery flames. This fire of the side of holiness burns and consumes the alien fire of the side opposite holiness, as will be explained.[81] It was in this regard that there initially was the inauguration performed by the tribal leaders with an abundance of sacrifices,[82] as well as the burning of incense on the outer altar.[83] In doing so, they drew down the revelation of a very lofty light into the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*.

Now, all this was to grant empowerment and strength to the Altar to have the power to elevate the feminine waters (*Ha'ala'at Mayim Nukvin*) of the fire from below, this being the aspect of the five powers of might (*Gevurot*) of Kingship-*Malchut*, to elevate and refine the 288-רפ"ח sparks and cause the nullification of the "something" (*Bittul HaYesh*) to the Godly "nothing" (*Ayin*). Though all this,[84] in and of itself the Altar would have the power in a way of constancy going forward, without cessation, as the verse states, "A constant fire shall remain aflame upon the Altar." It thus was only the first time that there was this inauguration with an increased drawing down, so that there subsequently would be the ascent of the feminine waters (*Ha'ala'at Mayim Nukvin*) in and of itself.

In contrast, the work of Aharon in kindling the lights (*Neirot*) was a constant service every day. That is, this is not a matter of inauguration or education (*Chinuch*-חינוך), but it itself

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[81] See the later discourse entitled "*Yehudah Atah*" (*Hemshech* 566 p. 180 and on); Also see the discourse entitled "*Vayeilech Ish MiBeit Levi*" (p. 189).

[82] See Numbers 7:12 and on.

[83] See Talmud Bavli, Menachot 50a and on; Rashi to Numbers 7:14

[84] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 167 note 84.

is the work and labor, namely, to affect a drawing down of great love (*Ahavah Rabba*) of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, which transcends intellect and reason, into the souls of the Jewish people.

In other words, [his work was] to draw down a revelation of the essential light of the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) in them, this being the aspect of "the face (*Pnei*-פני) of the Menorah." Through him doing so, they would thereby be roused with the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*), as explained before.

That is, this was not in a way of an introduction to some [other] work and labor, but it itself is the work and labor etc. Therefore, this service took place every day. (This is the meaning of the verse,[85] "On His wedding day, the day of His heart's rejoicing," referring to when the Holy Temple was standing,[86] at which time this service was possible in the souls of the Jewish people etc. Likewise, even now, it is possible for this to come about through the joy of the *mitzvah*. See the statement about this in Torah Ohr, in the discourse entitled "*v'Atah Tetzaveh*.")[87]

Likewise, about the matter of the awakening that comes spontaneously from Above, it should be said that, in and of itself, is not a labor or service, but only that thereby he then specifically performs his work and service by his own strength. This is like the education of a small child, in that he is given many gifts, but only to uplift his soul so that he thereby will then go of his own volition with desire and yearning.

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[85] Song of Songs 3:11
[86] See Talmud Bavli, Taanit 26b
[87] Torah Ohr 81a and on; Hosafot 110c

The same is so of the above-mentioned awakening, that it is so that he subsequently will himself go and engage in prayer and in his work of contemplation (*Hitbonenut*) and in bringing about love and fear and closeness to Godliness etc., and that he will always go in his path of progressing in this. This is as explained before[88] that through the inner work (*Avodah Pnimit*) once he has come to a state of closeness, he thereby will automatically continue to engage in this work and ascend in levels of closeness in a way of traveling and progressing, without requiring another awakening. He rather will continuously progress and ascend by his own strength.

However, the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) of Aharon is not the aspect of an introduction, but is rather the work itself. That is, he comes to the aspect of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) to ascend and become subsumed in the limitless light of the Unlimited One (*Ohr Ein Sof*) on account of the essence of his soul, like a spark that is drawn to the flame, as discussed before.

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Now, elsewhere[89] it is explained that the above-mentioned inner work (*Avodah Pnimit*) also comes from the power of Aharon kindling the flames (*Neirot*). About this the verse states,[90] "Outside the partition… Aharon shall arrange it,"

[88] See *Hemshech* 5666 p. 165.
[89] Ohr HaTorah Tetzaveh p. 1,968 and on.
[90] Exodus 27:21; Leviticus 24:3

and it is written,[91] "And when Aharon kindles the flames etc."[92] The meaning of "He shall arrange it-*Ya'aroch*-יערוך" as it is in the service of *HaShem*-יהו"ה, blessed is He, is that there should be service with the aspects of the intellect (*Mochin*) and emotions (*Midot*). That is, "arrange it-*Ya'aroch*-יערוך" is a word denoting "ordering and arranging it," as in Onkelos's translation of the word "*Ya'aroch*-יערוך" as "He shall order it-*Yesader*-יסדר." It also a word that denotes "relativity-*Erech*-ערך" as in the verse,[93] "But it is you, a man of my measure-*Erchee*-ערכי," this being a matter of comparison, as in the Targum translation of the word "of my measure-*K'Erchee*-כערכי" as "who compares to me-*d'Damee Lee*-דדמי לי."

It is this aspect of the soul that should be like the aspect of man-*Adam*-**אדם** [who is called this] in that "I am likened to the Supernal One-*Adameh L'Elyon*-**אדמה** לעליון,"[94] which is brought about through adhering to His qualities.[95] This refers to working on the ten powers of the soul so that they bear a likeness to the One Above. This likewise is the matter of the order, meaning the order of the ten *Sefirot* of the soul in relation to those Above, to bind the Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and Knowledge-*Da'at* of his soul to the Wisdom-*Chochmah*, Understanding-*Binah*, and Knowledge-*Da'at* of the One Above, which is brought about through the Torah. (It can be said that this also is brought about through

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[91] Exodus 30:8

[92] Also see Torah Ohr, Tetzaveh 81c.

[93] Psalms 55:14

[94] See Isaiah 14:14; Also see Sefer Asarah Maamarot (of Rabbi Menachem Azariah de Fano), Maamar Eim Kol Chai, Part 2, Ch. 33; Shnei Luchot HaBrit 3a; 20b; 268b; 301b; 373a; 386b; Avodat HaKodesh, Part 1, Ch. 17 and on.

[95] See Talmud Bavli, Sotah 14a

grasping and contemplating Godliness, and it is possible that this too is included in cleaving to His attributes.)

This likewise is so of the thought, speech, and action of one's soul, [in that he binds them] to the Supernal thought, speech, and action. Another matter of "measure-*Erech*-ערך" is that it refers to emotions (*Midot*) that according to intellect, which come in a way of cause and effect from the intellect. For, as known,[96] every effect has some measure of comparison (*Erech*-ערך) and relation to its cause.

However, the matter of "When Aharon kindles the flames" is that it refers to the matter of the great love (*Ahavah Rabbah*) that transcends the intellect. This refers to when "man-*Adam*-אדם" comes to the aspect of "exceedingly-*Me'od*-מאד". This refers to the ascent to the aspect of the Essential Self of the limitless light of the Unlimited One to whom none can compare,[97] as explained elsewhere[98] about the matter of "to Him and not to His attributes."[99] As known,[100] in the soul there also is the aspect of emotions (*Midot*) that transcend the intellect (*Sechel*) in that there is no matter of measure. Nevertheless, according to the explanation before, the essence of the work with the intellect and emotions in man (*Adam*-אדם) is as it stems from his own strength and is by his own toil, to

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[96] See the prior discourse entitled "*BaYom HaShemini Atzeret*" (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 52).

[97] See the "*HaKol Yodoocha*" passage of the Shabbat morning prayers.

[98] See Siddur Im Da"Ch 85b and on; Also see Likkutei Torah Hosafot to Vayikra 51c; Shir HaShirim 49b; Derech Mitzvotecha 117a and on, and elsewhere.

[99] Sifri cited in Pardes Rimonim, Shaar 32 (Shaar HaKavanah) Ch. 2; Also see Siddur Im Da"Ch 85b and on; Maamarei Admor HaEmtza'ee Na"Ch p. 34; Derech Mitzvotecha 117a and on.

[100] See Likkutei Torah Naso 23a; Shir HaShirim 46d; Also see Torah Ohr Toldot 19b; Yitro 73a; Likkutei Torah Bechukotai 47a.

adhere to His attributes etc., except that Aharon drew down the empowerment for this by the arrangement of the flames (*Neirot*). Nevertheless, the actual work (*Avodah*) is specifically by one's own strength.

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This then,[101] is the meaning of the verse, "Yehudah approached him." This is because Yehudah is the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut*, and for there to be the ascent of Kingship-*Malchut*, there must be a drawing down from Above. This is like the prayer,[102] "Come my Beloved to greet the bride" in the ascents of Shabbat brought about through a revelation from Above. The same is generally so of the ascents of Kingship-*Malchut*.

Now, the revelation is from the aspect of Yosef, the Upper Righteous One (*Tzaddik Elyon*) who draws down the light from Above to the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* in order to bring about the ascent of Kingship-*Malchut*. This is the matter of Yehudah approaching Yosef, which is the matter of the ascent and inclusion of Kingship-*Malchut*, in that she ascends

[101] Regarding the coming section see the discourse entitled "*Vayigash*" of the Tzemach Tzeddek ibid. Also see the discourse entitled "*Inyan Hagashat Yehudah L'Yosef*" 5629 ibid. Also see the beginning of the discourse entitled "*Vayigash*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 487 and on); End of the discourse entitled "*HaShamayim Keesee*" 5668 (*Hemshech* 5666 p. 533 and on); Also see *Hemshech* 5672 Vol. 2 p. 794; p. 802; Torat Menachem, Sefer HaMaamarim Meluket Vol. 2 p. 200; p. 215 and on (Vol. 4 p. 117 and on; Vol. 5 p. 128, in earlier editions).

[102] See the liturgical hymn "*Lecha Dodi*" in the Kabbalat Shabbat; Also see Likkutei Torah, Zot HaBrachah 97a and on; Siddur Im Da"Ch 211c and on; Maamarei Admor HaZaken, Maamarei RaZa"L p. 455; Sefer HaMaamarim 5680 p. 151 and on, and elsewhere.

from the worlds of Creation, Formation, and Action (*Briyah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*) to the world of Emanation (*Atzilut*).

This is likewise the matter of juxtaposing redemption (*Ge'ulah*) to prayer (*Tefillah*). This is because prayer (*Tefillah*) is the ascent from below to Above, and the juxtaposition of redemption (*Ge'ulah*) to prayer (*Tefillah*) is the power drawn down from Above for there to be the ascent etc., as explained elsewhere.[103]

However, the revelation from Above is only for there to be the ascent, whereas *HaShem's*-יהו"ה ultimate Supernal intent is for the ascent itself, this being the primary aspect, especially the ascent of Kingship-*Malchut* when she ascends Above, at which time she will be on a loftier level. This is the element of superiority of Yehudah over the level of Yosef. This is like the coming future, about which the verse states,[104] "My servant Dovid will be leader over them." That is, the aspect of Kingship-*Malchut* will ascend to a higher level.

This then, is the matter of the juxtaposition of redemption (*Ge'ulah*) to prayer (*Tefillah*), this being the drawing down of the light from Above so that there will be a "running" (*Ratzo*) desire and ascent of Kingship-*Malchut*, this being the matter of Yehudah approaching Yosef. Nevertheless, the language used in this is "the juxtaposition of redemption (*Ge'ulah*) to prayer (*Tefillah*)," since this refers to when Kingship-*Malchut* ascends Above, at which time she will be on a higher level, this being *HaShem's*-יהו"ה ultimate Supernal

[103] See the discourses cited in note 101.
[104] See Ezekiel 37:25

intent, for her to be on a higher level. This will be revealed in the coming future, when “My servant Dovid will be leader.”